

In the name of God most Gracious, ever Merciful!

The Beloved and I

Volume 5: Psalms to Sirach

Thomas McElwain

New Jubilees Version of Sacred Scripture in
Verse

With Verse Commentaries

Revised Edition

Adams & McElwain Publishers

Copyright © 2007 Adams & McElwain Publishers and Thomas McElwain

First published in two volumes, The Beloved and I 2005, and Led of the Beloved, 2006.

Second edition, 2010

Third and revised edition, 2012

All rights reserved.

No part of this verse commentary on the sacred

Scriptures may be reproduced, transmitted, or stored in a retrieval system, in any form or by any means, without permission in writing from the publisher.

Published by

Adams & McElwain Publishers

Puijonrinne 7

70200 Kuopio, Finland

ThomasGMcElwain@gmail.com

www.lulu.com/ThomasMcElwain

Cover photos by Ritva and Anna Maria McElwain

Contents

Foreword, page 5

Psalms, page 9

Proverbs, page 168

Ecclesiastes, page 219

Song of Solomon, page 235

Wisdom, page 247

(Ecclesiasticus) Wisdom of Sirach, page 278

Foreword

Dear reader, dear you are indeed,
If you have read thus far in speed,
I lift my hat and greet in turn,
And pray your burning heart still burn
With love and faith, obedience
To YHWH (Jah, HUU) within your earthly
tents.

I still proclaim the Decalogue
Furqan, criterion for bog
To give good guidance in the way,
The wandering paths where Scriptures
stray.

No other text makes so great claims,
To be given direct in flames
Without vehicles such as dream
Or vision or angels to beam.
No other text claims to be spoken
To millions by the mount as token
In any classic text of faith
Produced by saint, prophet or wraith.
It's brief and comprehensive too,
Enough to deal with all that's true.
And so by it I judge the writing
As well as the own life I'm fighting.

I broach the revelation with
My own style though without the myth.
I take the English tongue as free,
Not cramped by French academy.
I speak my own ethnicity
In all its fine diversity.
I took a local word and slang,
I took elevated harangue,
And made all mine in what I sang.
I take expressions and aesthetic
From many foreign ways pathetic
And trump them up in four-beat rhymes
To meet my sonnets and my crimes.

I thank God that aesthetic props
That differ from expected crops
And may offend the ear and eye
Of educated on the sly
Do not offend God's sense of proper.
In fact I realized this stopper:
If God's name is my joy to hear,
And reading His word will appear
A pleasure to my listening ear,
God too's inspired by what I write,
Just as I am by revealed light.

Just as I used to roam the sights

Of London to hear Shakespeare's rights,
Or find old altarpieces where
In triptych shines the structured share
That raises spirits to resound
With new songs scattered on the ground.

Four painted panels make the store
Of my work on the sacred shore:
The Torah or Tawrat before
Zabur or Psalmic writings that
Bring me to where the Gospel sat
Or Injil as the Muslims say,
At last Qur'an to finish fray.
It can be read from left to right,
Seen as a whole picture's delight,
Or contemplated anywhere
The brushstroke meets the eye with glare.
Dear reader, make an effort now
To see this altarpiece and bow
At one glance in the glory there.
Leave pride of life and thought behind,
Open the soul's eyes, don't be blind
To the foundation theme of all.

The Decalogue stands first in call,
The vision of many faiths' thrall
Comes next to please the mind and eye
With coloured textures to comply.
The third word of secrets I show
Is that the first sonnet in row
To be written in this book stands
In comment of Genesis' bands,
Chapter one and verse twenty-six:

Said Alohim *then to Himself*,
"Let us make humankind, *not elf*,
Into our image, by our plan,
Let them have rulership *who can*
Over fish of the sea, the birds
Of the air, and the *lowing* cattle,
All earth and over those that *prattle*
And creep on the earth *without words*."

Your image is a canvas vaster than
What sea and sky and earth forever can.
Yet Your self-portrait in perfection lies
Within the atom's small peripheries.
To each wrought figure either small or vast
You have his own dominion wisely cast.
Each mite within Your image has been
crowned
And granted each its nourishment and
bound.

Your sovereignty of sovereigns knows no
press,
While I'm in Your creation, free to guess.
Though I myself am not Your image whole
As some would trust whose faith has
greater goal,
I glory in the honour of the part
I have in Your creation's noble art.

The idea that image of God
Is not a man upon the sod,
But the whole of creation's prod
Is not found anywhere before
As far as I can find in store.
That humankind's the last piece set
Within the puzzle is not yet
Understood by the world of men.
Even so great a mystic as
Ayatollah Khomeini had
Adhered to the common view of
This text setting man up to love.
Awareness I draw from this view,
That human soul's reflection due
Of the divine soul on the screen
Of universe whereby is seen
Image of God's not quite so strange
To other seekers on the range.
It hardly departs from the heart
Of mystical thought any part
Of classical traditions' start.

The fact that concept's not in favour
More widely among free and slaver,
Comes from astute awareness that
It flies in face of where we've sat
In modern and post-modern thought.
Now days the vehicles that raise
The mystical experience rays
Are themselves the content en masse,
Making all the traditions pass
For one and the same surface crass,
Reducing spirituality
To titillation of the tree
Of fair exotica to see.
This essence of mystical life,
Sufism, Cabbalism rife,
Christian contemplation as it
Commonly appears, is form fit
Of microwave in meditation,
And instant coffee contemplation.

While it may not be needful to
Read four thick volumes to find true,

One must relinquish the false view
That alpha brainwaves are the goal,
And realize that's a mere shoal,
A vehicle and not the pole.
That simple concept's hard to get
Across today, and failure yet
To internalize it's the root
And source of violence to shoot,
And no improvement's yet in sight
Till realization's delight
That humankind reflects divine
Has been firmly set in design
Of human thought. Albert Schweitzer
Said it in a way that for sure
Could be understood by the young
And simplest person on the rung:
That life is sacred. Unless that
Is grasped in practice, techniques flat
To slow brainwaves or chemical
Substances to create the sal
Of visionary will not do
The slightest bit of good in true.

The contemplation of the role
Of individual in the toll
Of the community and stress
Point of conflict of interests' mess
Has something to do with the charge
Of development in the large
Of personal aesthetic sense
In context of the common vents.

The writings in which figures of
Both Moses and David in love
Are known and acknowledged have here
Already been seen in the gear
Of second volume of this work
To refer to the question's irk
Of what a single soul must do
When faced with systems in the pew
That represent authority
Conflicting with both liberty
And God's law in highest degree.
This concern comes to a high point
In Psalms continued in this joint.
The stress between the single soul
And enemies around the pole,
The individual and state
And congregation to tempt fate,
Is shown from every point of view.
This gross honesty's hard with rue
For Christian sensibility.
That's why Psalm-singing's been set free,

Replaced by other forms by most,
And even where there is Psalms' boast,
The curses on the enemy
Are avoided in psalmody.

The individual and her God
In the community to plod
Are the three reference points made bright
In the Psalms, wisdom's writings' site,
And in the prophets for their right.
As such Zabur or David's books
Are logical extension's looks
From Torah or Tawrat or law
That precedes them as in their awe.
As I move with the reader here
Among these issues, I move sheer
In the dynamic lines among
These three points that I now have sung,
Rather than in their distinctness
As opposition of address.
Awareness of complexity
Found in the universe makes free
Not at all, does not imply need
Of shady morals as in seed.

At the same time, the question may
Arise in regard to the fray
Of religious traditions not
Represented in writings' plot
Chosen for this work. Among those
Are prominent the Christian pose,
Judaic and Karaim rose,
Samaritan and Islam's nose.

The dualist traditions are
Not far off, and a glance at star
Sabaeans of all kinds and bar,
The Zoroastrian is not
Inappropriate, even lot
Of Manichaeism and the word
Of Mandaean, Avesta stirred,
The writings of the Ahlil-Haqq:
Do not appear among this stock.

The underlying assumption
Basic to this work when it's done,
Is that there are two ways that God
Reveals His will upon the sod.
The first is natural and found
Inside the body, on the ground.
The second is a special kind
Or verbal revelation's bind.
The natural faiths I do not touch
Here, not because I find them much
Invalid, but because this work

Is focused on the word for quirk.
Yet verbal revelation's not
In necessary conflict sought
With natural faith. No, not at all.
They're complementary at the ball.
Hinduism, Jainism too,
Buddhism, Taoism in view
And Confucianism all have
A natural basis and a salve.
That very natural basis is
Foundational in every whiz
Of human faith and faithful biz.
That foundation is true, no doubt,
No matter where it comes with shout.
Each of those faiths has gained some
ground,
Awareness of some aspect found
In natural faith to unique heights,
And each deserves respect for lights.
By the same token, Decalogue
May serve as rule of thumb in fog
Of judging the validity
Of those faiths without poverty.
It can be used as well to judge
The revealed faiths in claim of smudge.
There's no faith anywhere that takes
Adultery, murder of rakes,
And lying as a thing well done.
The Decalogue criterion
Shows no faith anywhere to lack
More than half of commandments' stack.
So all faiths are more positive
Than they can be said negative.
By the same token none of them
Conform to Decalogue in gem
With its perfection, all of them
Are thus imperfect in their hem.

This brings us back to what we found
About the Zabur, Psalms on ground,
The way by which a single man
Ought to relate to power in scan
Of systems that conflict with that
Great Decalogue in what they spat.
All faiths include enough of right
Morality to keep in sight
As faiths continuing for spite.
All of them stay in context of
Large social systems with a glove
To defend territories and
The governmental powers that stand.
They all succeed because they leave

Off those aspects of YHWH's law's sleeve
That limit man's authority.
As such, the popular faiths show
Help to sustain the systems' row
On violence contained that's needed
By every government that's seeded.

While the first half of the Zabur,
Especially in the Maccabees,
Expressed acute conflict and sure
Between faith and authorities,
The second half is no less bright
In concentrating on that site.
Auschwitz was an experiment
That proved successful as it went,
Which is why it has been in fact,
With modifications it lacked,
Applied globally until now.
The Soviet Union was how
Far an experiment could go
To show to what extent the people
Can function in a state sans steeple,
Where military spending runs
Into abuse by tonnes and tonnes.
It too was a success, and so
Military industries show
Themselves foundation of the glow
Of global economics' row.
Result's proliferation of
That time of trouble hand in glove
Described in Daniel chapter twelve
And verse number one if you delve.

This writing does not contemplate
The world as pessimistic state.
It simply suggests that the law
Of ten commandments kept in awe
For a few years of education,
Would change the world and every nation,
Into a paradise for ration.
The twentieth century has taught
That hell exists in what men wrought,
For it has used technology
To create hell in earthly spree.
It just remains in next century
To prove the same of heavenly tree.

In the meantime the single man
Can and must create in his span
That vast reality and in
His own sphere of action and bin.
Such is the purpose of these few
Contemplations I set in view.

This volume of the Zabur sets

The name of Muhammad and gets
The glory for that in the Psalm
One hundred and six without qualm,
Verse twenty-four. Besides that news
The name's repeated in bright hues
In Song of Solomon sixteen
Of chapter five in shining sheen.
The prophets amplify the sound
Of the last sent one on the ground
In Jeremiah three nineteen,
And in twelve passages to glean.
I have recuperated more
By suggesting the Hebrew store
Behind Greek texts sometimes reveals
The flash of eye and silver heels.
So Sirach two, for instance, waits
With the same message in its gates.

The greater expectation here
Is in the book of Daniel near
The end, where every prophecy
Focuses on Jerusalem
And shows the great variety
Of fates for that town like a gem,
Which at last shall become the hem
Of justice in age messianic
For all the world in a titanic
Rule of uprightness that's instilled
In Decalogue. The date is billed
As twenty twenty-six, just wait
To see if this world's folk in state
Will follow in the great prediction
And set up justice without sliction.
The prophecy provides the date,
The way, the rule, the time and hope.
It just remains for us, no pope,
To lay hold on the great divine
And offered government's design.

So may all faiths, races, and sorts
Of people leave their evil sports
And join as one under one God
To live in justice on the sod.

My path of scholar has been lost,
My path of Christian faith been tossed,
As I walk in the gardens here
Of divine words with awe and fear
To find a single word of cheer:
An artist willing to appear
Each day in different dress and still
Remain enthralled upon the hill
With glories that flame and fulfil
The hopes of none by my own soul

Caught without hopes and without goal.

Cry fie upon the institutions
Of faith and fine belief's solutions!
The day of churches, synagogues
And even mosques goes to the dogs.
And since I am a dervish dog
I bend to take up from the bog
The tattered volumes, Hebrew tome,
Greek letters and Arabic gnome,
And kiss the pages dank and wet
And taste the fruit of glories met.

Introduction to The Book of Psalms

When I was four years old, I remember my grandmother for the first time with absolute clarity. I had received a copy of the Bible for my fourth birthday and reflected my parents' enthusiasm for the Seventh-day Adventist church. I had it with me when we went to my grandmother's and I showed it to her and asked her why she did not belong to the Adventist church. She took me aside and we sat down together. She took my Bible and opened it at the very centre and said, "I belong to the Baptist church, but what church you belong to is not what matters. I do not attend church at all. But every night and every morning I open the Bible to the middle, and I read from it. That is what you should do." Thus was begun the informal religious instruction that she started to give me, and gave me up until the very year she died.

From then on, until I learned to read for myself, I would go to different neighbours, open the Bible at the middle and ask them to read to me. I thought at the time I was carrying out the mandate of the Adventist church to give Bible studies and I remember once or twice wondering why no one ever joined the church. After I learned to read, I learned by heart some of the passages my grandmother directed me to: the Psalms from the middle of the Bible and the Ten Commandments. I also learned the proof-texts or memory verses the Adventists provided, but as time went on I found Adventists were surprised that I could repeat long passages by heart,

passages that had no particular significance, and thus little importance, to Adventists.

My grandmother was not a very active or aggressive teacher. She only offered information in response to a question. I have no precise idea what spiritual influence she had on her other grandchildren, but I'm sure that some of them experienced something similar to mine. Her influence was pervasive and in the end much stronger than what I got from church and religious school. I came into conflict with a teacher already in the fourth grade over the issue of original sin and the forgiveness of sins. I maintained that all people are born pure and holy and only by their actions separate themselves from the will of God, but that God is able and willing to wipe away the sin of those who repent and make restitution. Later in an Adventist high school or academy as it was called, when I was far from my grandmother's influence, the Bible teacher, James Zachary, asked in class why Jesus had to die for our sins. No one answered and he called on me. I could not accept the vicarious sacrificial atonement for the sins of the world and the rest of the class period was a tirade of horror at my lack of spiritual perception. This man was, nevertheless, one of the greatest influences on my life, taking me three times a week to teach me Biblical languages without pay and without thanks. May God rest his loving, unselfish soul.

I went to college to study for the Adventist ministry. It was four years of quandary in which I constantly questioned the atonement of Christ on the cross and the Trinity, constantly emphasizing to all about me the importance of individual prayer and meditation of the Book of Psalms.

In the spring of 1979, I had an awakening and was directed to my grandmother to ask for instruction in her faith, the very personal one transmitted to her by her father, although she had maintained membership in a Baptist church for a good share of her life. I had already

learned from her to read the Psalms and keep the ten commandments. At that time she pointed me to the Islamic Revolution in Iran as right and just, saying people ought to support it. She especially approved the disappearance of disco and rock music, alcohol and the sex industry.

It was only a few years later that I came to her for her opinion of the Qur'an, which I had picked up in a university bookshop and read from cover to cover in one sitting. I told her that I thought it was in harmony with the Bible. It was only then that she gave me a fuller knowledge of the tradition which she claimed to have inherited from her father. She only taught those who had discovered for themselves. She also taught me to revere the group of twelve Imams, to seek the four gates, the four hidden guides, and to read the four books, that is, the Bible and the Qur'an. I was thus introduced into the house of David and hosted by Hajji Bektash. She repeated her earliest instruction: it does not matter what church you belong to, there is an invisible tabernacle made of the Psalms and we have the privilege of being a doorkeeper in the house of God. We need not aspire to religious leadership. The highest office is to guard the shoes of those who go in to pray. The dervish is a dog at the gate, and has the right to wag his tail at those who keep God's commandments and bare his teeth at those who do not and yet presume to enter. There is no thanks or reward for the task, but only kicks and cuffs and a rare kind word.

My grandmother lived that faith her whole life, beginning her career as a body-washer, then a cleaner in a hotel, and then as a cleaning woman for people about town. At the age of 18, she out-spokenly told a man living in the hotel, but secretly sleeping in the room of a lady living in the same establishment, "Just lay your hat on the bed. Don't mess up your bed so I have to make it every day. Everybody already knows where you're sleeping. Just lay your hat on the bed." When she was eighty-three she walked about town with my wife, showing all the houses she had cleaned and

telling in the inordinately loud voice of the aged what scandalous behaviour each of the inhabitants had engaged in fifty years before. I learned from her that the epitome of spiritual excellence is the testy shaking of a wrathful but impotent fist.

Only once did I become the focus of her anger, and that was on my last visit. I made the careless remark that decent people do not chew tobacco. That is a relevant issue in Appalachia still. My grandmother said to me, "Now you listen here. I don't ever want to hear you say that again. My father chewed tobacco, and he was a decent man." Be that as it may, she herself never touched tobacco and as far as I know all of her descendants are also free if it.

In her old age my grandmother never went to bed. The hearth of her father, about which circle prayer used to take place, had become a coffee table upon which the Bible stood. She read the book of Psalms through every night, dozing between-times. Before she died she said that there was a gem in the middle of the Bible, and asked me if I had found it yet. I said I was not sure. She grimaced and said, "When you find it, you'll know it."

In 1988, after the death of my grandmother, a Turkish guest was present in one of our Friday evening devotions. I happened to mention that we were followers of Hajji Bektash and he became very excited, and said that he and his family were also. I was not ignorant of a tenuous or possible historical connection, at least in sharing veneration for the saint of that name, but after talking with him more I was surprised at how much we had in common. Since then I have had cordial contacts not only with Alevis but with Sunni admirers of Hajji Bektash as well in Turkey. I felt a deep kinship, not only on the personal level, but in the fact that they too maintained a quasi-secret, uninstitutionalized order stationed between the official faith, which is Hanafi Sunni Islam and personal practice. For us, the Baptist church or some other was the official faith, to which we related exactly as Alevis and Bektashis in Turkey do to

official Islam: sometimes participating fully, sometimes being seen as heretics, and sometimes keeping an official membership but largely ignoring the institution to go our own way.

The reading of the Psalms as a dervish practice is hardly unique to my grandmother, wherever she got the tradition. There are reports of one or two groups in the southeast of Turkey who use their own translation of the Psalms as liturgy, but I have never had any contact with them. The Alevis, Bektashis, Chelebis, Qizilbash, and Sari groups I have visited all spoke of the Four Books, many of them read them, and some actually referred to Biblical as well as Qur'anic passages in evidence of their beliefs and practices. Miracle-working using the Hebrew text of the Psalms has at some periods at least been almost standard fare among Middle Eastern practitioners.

None of these can be directly related to the tradition my grandmother transmitted, and I have never made the claim that any did. It is clear that her family had contact with both the Eckerlins and other Seventh Day Baptists as far back as the 1700s, who were in correspondence with Edward Elwall, who was clearly a dervish from a Turkish order. Whether or not there is thereby a connection with my grandmother can never be known, but I also have a connection with the Elwallian line through Albourne Peat of the Sabbatarian Baptist Society in London, under whose wings I worked intermittently throughout the 1980s almost until his death. The ministers of that society are known to have preserved the liturgy of the Psalms, at least in the case of Albourne Peat's predecessors MacGeachy and Jones, who both used the Psalms personally in Hebrew, although the singing of anthems in the church was in English. MacGeachy also read the Qur'an in Arabic, and it was on a visit to his resting-place in York that I was introduced to the spiritual depth of that book.

The transmission from my grandmother was, as I have always claimed, a practice that could well have been based on nothing

more than Native American tradition and a Baptist reading of the Bible, except for a very few references to Islam: a garbled list of names including the twelve Imams and Hajji Bektash, and that a prophet by the name of Muhammad had brought a true book called the Qur'an. Insofar as I know, she never read it.

The Psalms here are mostly translated or versified in eight-syllable lines like the rest of The New Jubilees Version, and can be sung to the same tunes, that is, folk tunes of many traditions such as Finnish Kalevala and Turkish Alevi or Bektashi, as well as Christian Long Meter. But some Psalms are set in eleven-syllable lines. This is also a common Bektashi-Alevi metrical form, and the intention was for the Psalms to be sung accordingly. However, there are also hymn-tunes set to the same meter: 11.11.11.11.

The Psalms are presented here divided into stanzas based on complete thought sections. These are marked by alternating bold and normal type faces, except in Psalms 1-4 and 42, where some bold-facing distinguishes the text of the Psalm from some eight-syllable commentary. Breaking the Psalm into stanzas makes it readily possible to use tunes of various lengths. The four-line quatrain can take any of the hundreds of Long Metre tunes. A couplet of just two lines can be sung to Long Metre by repeating both lines. A three-line stanza can be sung to the tune Holy Sepulchre, or to a Long Meter tune with the repetition of the last line. A stanza of five lines in eight syllables can be sung to the tune Rolland, or to any Long Metre tune by repeating a section of the music. Often the music of the third or four line can be comfortably repeated. An eight-syllable line in a stanza of six lines can be sung to dozens of tunes, but among the more accessible are Old 113th and Old 117th. The well-known St. Catherine is a handy tune for a six-line stanza. A seven-line stanza can be sung to the tune Atwood. An eight-line stanza can best be sung to the tune O Grosser Gott. A ten-line stanza can be sung to the tune Wir Glauben All.

The choice of tunes for eleven-syllable lines is far more limited, although that is not at all true if one uses Turkish Bektashi tunes. The use of Turkish tunes is not advisable unless one has Turkish background. First of all, Turkish tunes are difficult. Secondly, they tend to be distracting, and feed the fascination with the exotic. But there are dozens of good hymn tunes for eleven-syllable quatrains, among them being Adoro devote and Corpus Domini. The Welsh tune St. Denio is also wonderful for eleven-syllable quatrains. Eleven-syllable lines set in five-line stanzas have very few good tunes, but Haydn's St. Alban is the best. There do not seem to be any six-line stanza tunes available that can be used with the Psalms. All of them are filled with 19th-century bathos or even worse melodies from later. They should be avoided at all costs.

The division of the Psalms into stanzas of varying lengths provides for better concentration than metrical tunes generally do. Alternating between singing and reading is extremely helpful for concentration. The use of a Psalm in which, for example, all of the quatrains are sung and the rest is read is very effective. Singing and reading alternately can be very effective. Some Psalms are finely recited by reading the Psalm throughout, and singing the final stanza.

Finally, two successive stanzas may be combined, for example to sing a six-line stanza together with the following couplet to the tune of O Grosser Gott, which is normally sung to an eight-line stanza. Three- and four-line stanzas can be combined and sung to Atwood. But in fact, a single Long Metre or four-line 11-syllable tune can be used throughout by repeating lines of text to fill out the tune, or by repeating lines of melody to extend to the end of the text stanza.

Rather frequently there is a feminine rhyme at the end of an eight-syllable line, that is a rhyme of two-syllables. In such cases, there are nine syllables in the line, which means that the last two syllables of the line must be sung on the last note of the

line. This is common practice in metrical Psalms, but is disturbing to some people today. Such stanzas can be read rather than sung, if the reader is irritated by the extra syllable.

The book of Psalms presents the 2527 verses or steps of divine guidance. The first book of Psalms provides meditations for each of the days of forty days of spiritual retreat. Psalms 9 and 10 form one acrostic whole and may be counted as one. So the forty-one Psalms can be read as forty.

The following commentary on the Psalms has grown out of my long spiritual connection with not only the faith transmitted to me, but my own contemplation and experience. It has been written, more than any other part of The Beloved and I, under the vivid impression of the presence and guidance of the Master of the Age, Muhammad al-Mahdi, may the peace and blessings of God be upon him.

This is the teaching that is sent
On the adepts within the tent
Of David at the loving hand
Of Hajji Bektash and his band
Of forty. Peace and blessings be
On all the prophets of the free,
On Adam, Noah, Abraham,
Moses, David, Jesus, the Lamb
Muhammad as though on the best
Who came at last and to invest
The divine guides, Ali, Hasan,
Husein, Ali again by plan,
Muhammad, Sadiq, Musa and
Ali Ridha among the band,
Taqi, Naqi, and Askeri
At last Muhammad Al-Mahdi.
There are two thousand steps to take,
Five hundred twenty-seven's sake,
And then the soul is pure and free
And entered on eternity.

Psalm 1

**1 The blessings of the man who does
Not walk in the counsel that was
Of the ungodly, nor stand in
The path of sinners in their sin,
Nor sit down on the judgement seat
Of the scornful in their retreat,**

2 Are that in YHWH's law's his delight, To murmur His law day and night.

The sons of David in appointment
Who have partaken of anointment
Allahumma Huu from above
And keep themselves from men of sin.
That's why they hold such blessings in
Their seat, the throne of David won.
Mahdi's the last of that line done.
The first step here to blessedness
Is to know him and his address,
And yet he wanders without home
Upon the earth, its sand and loam,
And hardly any recognize
His passing under this disguise.
He grants the barakat (blessing) to come
In the steps following in sum,
But only on the chosen few
Who purify themselves in view
Of Allahumma whose name's HUU.

"The blessings of the man" echoes the last
Word of the Torah, where the word is
passed

But once, and promises the path of joy,
The mystic path the Divine Guides enjoy,
Expressed in seven steps in this first book,
And then repeated everywhere you look.
Beloved, grant me the blessings of the man,
The hidden ruler of the earth who can
Alone dispense a just verdict and truth,
Who sits on David's throne beneath his
booth.

Grant me the hidden guidance of his hand
Who walks unseen, unheard about the land.
Beloved, the blessedness of David's law
Fills me now and forever with Your awe.

Ashrei ha-ish, the blessings of the man
Abound from the Torah as far as can
Be seen the lovely rays of Your fine fires,
Beloved, to satisfy human desires.
While men and angels strive for
blessedness,

And all the ranks of beings still confess
The universe fraught with a changing will,
The blessings of Your appointment go still
Upon Your chosen man to grace the load
Of Torah's promise and its duties flowed.
Beloved, I seek the blessings of the one

Whom You have sent and shall send when
You're done,
And find the waiting by the rain and sun
In no departure from the battle won.

Asher lo halakh, who deigns not to walk
Giving by his behaviour and his talk
The evidence of that blessing that You,
Beloved, bestowed upon the humble few.
Let me not walk, Beloved, in paths set out
By false messiahs where Your word's in
doubt,
And where the simple knowledge of Your
law
Is set at naught, Your name not held in
awe.

The walking of the man that You have sent
Is a straight walking among pages bent,
And given to run in splendid groves not yet
Appearing where the desert hours are set.
I find, Beloved, the footprints in the sand
Where one refused to walk with evil band.

Ba'atsat resha'im, in counsel of
The wicked ones, the ones whose fatal
glove
Is stained with what men's hands should
never wear:
The blood of friend and foe upon the stair
Of pilgrimage. For every step I take
Is in the pilgrimage set for my sake.
I walk in no counsel given by the fair,
Nor in the false wisdom that such would
share,

But take to paths of violets and cane,
And leave the fevered competition vain.
Beloved, let me avoid the fool's advice
To wear button and buckle he thinks nice,
But while the advertising still runs on
I find Your sage instructions in the dawn.

Uvderekh khatta-im, and in the path
Of sinners, ah Beloved, I flee that wrath.
The way of those who fail to meet the mark
That You set up already in the park
And gave to Adam and his sons to do,
And showed to Enoch and to Noah's few,
And finally to Abraham and Moses,
I seek instead that road paved since You
chose us.

Beloved, the sinners' way is all around,

I see it set in law and practice found
Among both priest and worker, in the
bound
Of legislator, judge and wealthy man.
I see the sinners' way as far as can
Be seen the human truck under the ban.

This sign speaks of Mahdi's delight
In Allah's law and in the sight
Of Sinai's falling and the sound
Of divine voice shaking the ground.
The law is ten commandments found
As Furqan given to Moses' hand.
It stands in Baqarat to see:
**"You ought to give thanks, 53 and when
We**

**Gave Moses Scripture and the great
Criterion** (of love and hate
And right and wrong, the bright Furqan)
So you might be led to the dawn."
It's also four books set to stand
In mercy and grace in the land.
Therefore Hajji Bektash once wrote
In Makaalaat those four of note,
Tawrat, Zabur, Injil, Furqan,
That is, Bible and the Qur'an.
Recite that law, recite those books
Once in the day, once in the nooks
Of the night-time, and still recite
Them always by day and by night.
Murmur in meditative light,
Sing aloud in the beauty where
The tent of David meets the air.
Recite the ten commandments so,
In syllables that gleam and glow
From Exodus twenty to show:

**"1 Then Alohim spoke all these things
2 I am YHWH Alohim whose wings
Brought you from Egypt and slavery.
3 You shall have no gods except Me.**

**4 No graven image shall you make,
Nor heavenly likeness shall you take,
Nor from the earth beneath nor from
The waters under earth in sum.**

**5 Before them you shall not prostrate,
Nor shall you worship them *in state*.
For I YHWH am your Alohim,
A jealous husband *it may seem***

**Who limits evil on the score
Of generations to not more
Than three or four, what parents do
Affecting children's children too,
By the hate that they bear to Me.
6 But multiplying wonderfully
To thousands of their generations
Effects of any cultivations
Of good they might do who love Me
And keep My statutes faithfully.**

**7 Do not lift up the name of YHWH
Your Alohim in vain, for who
Does so shall surely not receive
Acquittal from YHWH *and reprieve*.**

**8 Remember now the Sabbath day
To keep it holy *every way*.**

**9 Six days work and do all your tasks,
10 But seventh day's a rest that asks
YHWH your Alohim to keep well,
*Do no work in it, buy or sell.***

**In it you shall not work nor labour,
You, son nor daughter, nor the
neighbour
Man nor the maid in your employ.
Let even animals take joy,
And every visitor that's strayed
Your gates. 11 For in six days YHWH
made
The pair of skies and earth and stayed
To make the sea and what's in it.**

**Then He lighted on seventh day
To take comfort in it as fit,
And *kneeling* blessed the Sabbath day,
So did YHWH sanctifying it.**

**12 Give honour to your mom and dad,
So that your life may *not be sad*,
But long upon the ground YHWH's
given,
And Alohim for you to live in.**

**13 You shall not kill. 14 And you shall
not
Commit adultery. 15 Do not
Steal. 16 Do not bear against your
neighbour**

**False witness. 17 Do not covet neighbour
Of his house, do not covet his
Wife, nor his male worker, nor his
Female worker, oxen, nor his
Donkey nor anything which is
Your neighbour's *property or labour*."**

Hide these words day and night within
Your tongue and heart to keep from sin.

If Ali does delight in Your bright law
That shone from Sinai where all stood in
awe,

Let me too, my Beloved, have no god but
You only, let from me no image shut
Your holy name from my sight and heart
but

Give me grace and forgiveness so to live
And recognize Your sovereign will to be
Enthroned upon Sabbath's eternity.
May I honour parents, avoid the sword,
Adultery, theft, and the lying poured
So often on the court of justice where
The covetous encounter for their share
Of power and wealth. Beloved, I seek Your
word

By which alone I shall be always stirred.

**3 And he indeed, he shall be like
A tree planted beside the *dyke*
Of rivers' water, that makes ripe
Its fruit in its season, whose leaf
Also shall not wither *nor stripe*,
What he does shall not come to grief.**

This third step on the way to grace
Is to rest here before my face
To eat the blessed fruit that spills
From Ramadhan which only fills
The hunger of the soul, to take
The healing leaves for Allah's sake.
Mahdi's a tree that's planted on
Underground rivers that the dawn
Does not discover, while the sand
Of desert seems to cover land.
Though he's a tree that is unseen,
The hidden friends that still are keen
To purify the life and soul
May see the tree and reach the goal.
I eat the bidden fruit, its taste
Is sweet, my fasting without waste
Fills me better than any meat!
I taste and faint in pleasure's treat.

The tree of life, 'ets-hahayim,
Contains the letters that would seem
To make the hidden names appear,
The twelve names sacred to my fear
And set the very name of God
Within the berry, seed and pod.

Beloved, I thank You for the blessings of
The Guide who takes his guidance from
above,

I seek that secret guidance and avoid
The scornful joy of bishopric and Freud.
I join my voice with his to sing Your law,
The flickerings of love that Moses saw
Beyond the thunderous trumpets on the
mount.

Beloved, I thank You for the desert fount
Beneath the sands, a hidden cup of wine
That nourishes the root, the leaf and vine.
Let me, Beloved, follow that true Guide
To where the fields of Kauthar open wide,
To stand upon divine, eternal way,
Still cantillating Your name night and day.

The tree of life has in its name the sign,
Initial letters naming the divine
Guides to flow to the end of all the earth
In the sweet waters full of life and worth.
The four streams from its head in secret
flow

Throughout the world wherever my steps
go

Until at last I meet the tree of life
Within the city at the end of strife.
Beloved, those waters that feed mystic fruit
By hidden channels in the sand and root
Are life to me who chants Your sacred
names

And kisses those names that greening tree
frames,

From Ali and Sadik the word for tree,
And from the word for life the other three.

**4 The ungodly, they *are not so*,
But are like chaff as the winds blow.**

The fourth step is to know the truth
That all the world and without ruth
Stands against Mahdi and his Lord,
But he's the one who holds His sword,
And they, despite the pleasant view
Of success in all that they do,

Shall fly away and disappear
Before Allah's wrath, in His fear.
So do not envy the grand scheme
Of palaces and powers that seem,
But trust in his unseen hand now
And you will conquer anyhow.

The verdicts of those who set up their ways
By people's will or by the interplays
Of scholarship and knowledge taught and
won

Are merely breaths of wind beneath the sun
That steadily reveals life, light and power.
The chaff is blown away within the hour.
The verdicts of all leaders but the chosen
Are lifeless, caught in grief, hewn, cut and
frozen,

And make obedience an idol's reign.
The blessings of the grand are given in
vain.

Beloved, make me discern the chaff and
wheat,

Reject the empty husk and eat the sweet.
The daily bread and cup revealed in song
Divide the breath and show the right and
wrong.

**5 Therefore ungodly shall not stand
In judgement, nor sinners in band
Of the righteous ones by command.**

Though it seems now the wicked rule
And make the laws, each one's a fool
And shall find punishment at last
When judgement breaks forth with a blast
Of trumpet. Yet the righteous folk
Stand weekly in the judgement's yoke
As at the start of Sabbath Day
After the noon prayers and the sway
Of 'Asr prayer, they find their way
Reciting Scripture in the ray
Of weekly judgement purifying
Souls to make them at last undying.
I stand upon the judgement floor,
The gallows meet me at the door,
I am a lamb, I am a goat,
I pour the blood out of my throat,
I crush the self that in me lies,
I flee to one Self that relies
On Him alone who's all in all,
The glory of the inner hall
Where neither forms to vision wait

And disappear hunger and plate.

The first of forty steps to Your regard,
This Psalm gives out the hidden and the
starred

And famous secret that the rabble seeks.
If any such knew it, they'd lie for weeks
Upon the windy threshing floor in faint.
What is the Bektashi secret in paint
So large as not to be mistaken here?
It is that You are one and only dear,
All else is blown away in emptiness.
As my first step I come here to confess
That You alone are hidden at the root,
The stream of life that gives my branches
fruit.

Beloved, I take on tongue the sweetened
sip,
Proclaiming You are one and near to lip.

**6 For YHWH knows well the righteous
way,**

But the ungodly's path's astray.

Eternal life in paradise
Is something everyone thinks nice,
And yet it does not come by trying
Or even by evil defying,
But by the knowledge of our God
Who knows the righteous way on sod
And in eternal knowing grows
Undying being in repose.
But acts outside the divine will
Expressed in His commandments still
Are void and disappear at last
When this life on the earth has passed.

Beloved, Your gracious name of YHWH
returns

In this Psalm twice: once for the law that
burns

And once for the reality of knowing.
There is no flight of spirit to be showing,
No mantra, no, nor breath beside that given
Which is the law divine I have to live in.
Twice daily, day and night, I shall recite
The Decalogue in glowing words and
bright.

And thus I shall keep on the only path
That escapes vanity and empty wrath.
Beloved, I seek the secret of the way

That only is known by Your sceptre's
sway,
Turn from the wind-blown husks that fill
the air
Of what is called religion everywhere.

Psalm 2

1 Why do the nations rage, why do The Leummim murmur vain untrue?

The ways of all religions on the earth
Are ragings of the nations in their berth.
Their worship and their counsel is untrue,
So do not give yourself to them as due.
Reside in what official cult may take
The sceptre temporal and of it make
A public force to govern one and all,
But keep the soul aloof from every call
Of rabbi, mullah, priest and Sufi sheikh.
The truth is not in visible relief,
Nor in the proclamations of belief,
But in stillness of Mahdi's unseen rule,
And in submission to his given school.

Though You may sit in silent rage and
wake
To see what happens for the earth's sweet
sake,
I hear no voice of raving from Your throne
While I seek justice on the race alone.
Only the nations rage who have no right
To spoil the world with claw and glaring
fight,
Only the peoples murmur at their due
Forgetting You, forgetting what is true.
Beloved, the rage of powerful and sound
Of the oppressed and weak upon the
ground
Alike fall with the sea-waves on the sand
Forgetful of Your law and sacred band.
I seek the silence of Your rage and still
White judgement of Your shining fortress
hill.

The contemplation of Your sacred law,
Beloved, is known to Ali, but the straw
Of rage and vanity are contemplation
Of peoples in the earthly, evil nation.
Before two ways I do not linger long,
Before two contemplations, know my song,
And follow in the path of hidden streams

Instead of on the pounding waves of
dreams.

Beloved, the bands once cast away I find
And kiss the bruised stems of the jewelled
vined,
And take their scented yoke on heart and
hand

To plough in whirling dance the desert sand
Till rage of meditation sinks away
Into eternal gulfment of the day.

2 The kings of the earth set themselves, And take counsel rulers like elves, Against YHWH and against His chosen, Left in the worldly cold and frozen.

See how these rulers that now smile
And make their policies of guile
Shut Mahdi from his hearth and home a
while.

All the establishment of faith sets up
To take the power like raging beast and tup
To support kings and presidents and those
Who rule from companies and boardroom
rows.

All visible establishment now gives
Allegiance to usurper and still lives.
But such faith is a false one to oppose
Allahumma Huu and Mahdi He chose.
"Listen to me and no one else and I
Will give You truth, love, awareness and
sky."

Four hidden ones still live and still are true,
In secret counsel guiding what I do,
And ruling over kings and history.
Anointed and above the sword's fell reach,
They meddle in states with calm dignity
Practising justice that the others preach.
The truth upon the scaffold, error's throne,
Are just the painted skin and not the bone.
Enoch still preaches to the prophets' own,
Elijah still attends the Sabbath meal,
And Jesus lobbies yet to cut a deal,
While the hooves of the Mahdi's steed still
thunder

Upon a world that may or may not wonder.
Truth may be word debated, but I'm real.

3 "Let's break their bonds asunder and Betake their cords from us in band."

Muhammad Al-Mahdi gives the decree:

“The counsel of all faiths that stand to see
Is to disobey God as well as me.”

The call of false faith in the heathen path
Sounds ever and alluring, though Your
wrath

Marks out the higher way. The aftermath
Of breaking laws and statutes as the way
To freedom and by sacrifice to slay
Vicarious sons for the blood of day
Is sudden spoiling of the golden dome,
And ruin to the sacred hearth and home.
Beloved, I call the wreaths of lilies and
Roses in sweet concord to make a band
About my heart and breath, about my feet
As I turn from the thoroughfare and street
To find the donkey’s yoke in winding mill,
Your bag upon my maw I find my fill.

**4 He who sits in the heavens shall laugh,
YHWH holds them in derision’s staff.**

But God shall have the last laugh in their
case

As He said once and to a noble race
In Suratul Baqara’s place:

**14 And when they meet believers, say
“We too believe,” but on the day
They’re with their satans, then they say
“We were just joking all the way.”**

**15 So Allah makes of them a joke
And lets them wander like blind folk
In their wrong-doing. 16 These are they
Who bought instead of guidance error,
Such purchase profits not but terror,
And so such ones have lost the way.**

Tenth step in way to grace is found
In laughing in heart without sound
At fate of those praised and renowned.

You sit, Beloved, in heaven, while I
Stand here on earth, or then else lie.
You laugh, not in mirth, but in scorn,
While I find ever since I’m born
The humour of the universe
From playpen and the caring nurse
To the light of the death-bed’s curse.
You sit in scorn, and steal the chair
Of which the first psalm warned the fair.
I stand in laughter as I see
Your hand create eternity.
Beloved, Your judgement’s just alone,

For that Your chair becomes a throne.

**5 Then he shall speak to them in din
Of His wrath, and distress them in
His deep displeasure for their sin:**

God speaks to wicked ones but leaves
The righteous in silence and sleeves,
Always calls evil men to grace
And penitence before His face.
But mercy is a raging fire
To those who stand in sin’s desire,
While it destroys in righteous men
The self and makes them live again
In Allah’s heart and in His ken.

Beloved, You always speak to sinful men
And warn them of Your judgement once
again,

But never do You whisper to the right
And true and good a warning of their
plight.

That shows that Your perspective is not
ours

Who sit beneath the sun and dew and
showers,

But is the view of judge of righteousness,
Creator of the universal mess.

At least You speak, Beloved, in wrath and
not

In mercy to the wicked ones in lot.

At least Your words distress the sinful
heart,

Even if You give no hope for the part
Of those who quietly work out Your will
In word and act by Your commandment
still.

**6 “On My holy hill’s fortress set
I My King whom I’ll not forget.”**

The holy hill of Zion, the true hill
Is hidden where the Mahdi comes to fill,
For he now reigns as the king that God
chose

To guide in secret both the righteous rows
And unseen temper every evil hand
That’s raised upon the earth as in
command.

The fortress or Zion is really not
Much of a hill by any mountain plot.
It’s more a slight ravine upon the east

And hardly any slope at all increased
Upon the westward flight. The gates are old
And have been rebuilt many times and
sold.

And yet You claim to set a king as bold
And permanent upon that rugged spot.
Set rather in my heart Your king and own
The ground where footprints of my life
atone

Or not the days and nights that struggle
where

Your holy hill remains among the fair.
Beloved, I find a throne not seen or known,
And yet its beams and cornices are there.

**7 “I’ll declare the decree: YHWH’s said
To me, ‘You’re my son-servant led,
Today I have both brought you forth,
Anointed, set as son of worth.**

As every son of David’s called
God’s son, though God would be appalled
That any think He bore a son
Or had a consort bought or won,
So Mahdi’s also servant of
Allah and Master set above
All His creation till he come
With Jesus Christ to reign in sum.

In order to divide the truth and cling
To veils of the illusion humans sing
Antiphonies of son and servant while
You stand above the choir, derisive smile
And wait a moment before tapping on
The music stand with the divine baton.
The word by which You speak the universe
Into existence is both son and worse
A servant, yet You have no wife to bear
Your child nor bill of sale or purchase fair
To show You are the slave-master of any.
So all are right and all are wrong as many.
Set Your word brought forth before time
was made

On son and servant, generate or paid.

**8 Ask of me, and I will give nations
Inheritance, and terminations
Of the earth and for your own rations.**

God tells Mahdi to ask and He
Will give him sway on all the fee
Of nations. So he asks to take
The helm for all the righteous’ sake,

And curtail the evil they plan
Who think they rule the world in span.
If he were not there, to a man
These rogues would destroy all the earth
With deadly weapons built in dearth.

Your king, Messiah, and appointed one,
Your servant bought, and generated son
Is he who must ask for the ration won,
The heritage of earth and battles done.
I am not such in plot, and so I ask
Not for the earthly shot or worldly task,
But rather for the wealth of heaven’s store,
The privilege and horror of the door
That opens on the brightness of Your
throne

Set outside time and space for You alone.
Beloved, I seek the heritage allowed
To dervish dog thrust out of every crowd
To eat the scraps of love discarded by
The faithful and religious and the sly.

**9 You shall break them by stratagem
With iron rod, you shall dash them
To pieces like a potter’s gem.”**

They do not know what he’s in store
For them when he comes at the door
Of the Kaaba to call his own
Who faithfully bow at the throne
Of Allahumma Huu and groan
In sorrow for oppression’s gale.
He’ll shatter them and never fail.

Beloved, You chose David to reign instead
Of wicked Saul, as those before who led
And those who came age after age to guide
The innocent and peaceful where to hide.
Who plot against Your chosen one are
those

Who also plot against You though heaven
knows

Lip service to Your majesty is rife
In every mosque and synagogue for life.
I do not say church too for they would
make

Your servant be a Son, heathen mistake.
Though I am neither son, nor judge nor
king,

I press towards wisdom despite its sting.
Beloved, I have not powers to serve You,
yet

My gift for love to You is firm and set.

**10 Now therefore, be wise, O you kings,
Be instructed, you earth's judgelings.**

Allah and the father David,
Father of Muhammad who hid,
Speaks to priest, mullah to forbid,
And to the rabbi, to be wise
And take instruction from the skies
That comes in David's hand and pen
And voice resounding once again
As Mahdi takes up his dad's tale
To show the world God does not fail.

There are indeed kings of the earth,
Not of Your choosing for their worth,
But there to prove that men unsound
Are faithless where they take up ground.
You speak to them and give them warning,
Command them to be wise at morning,
And educated before night,
So that they might judge earth aright.
Beloved, I take Your words to heart,
And know that I am one apart,
Who has no kingdom but myself,
And even that is beyond elf
To rule, and so I give up all
To Your control, a dog in stall.

**11 Serve HUU alone with fear and kiss
His feet with trembling, do not miss.**

The Qur'an says God has a foot,
But that's no human place to put.
To kiss His feet is to submit
In love to His will and to sit
Humbly within His law and take
His will alone and not to stake
Fear in what other people say
Or how they act or when they pray.
Who pray to Allah only stay
With trembling before Him, that way
They meet grace quickly without pay.

I kiss the son of David's throne and give
Him honour while I stay to breathe and
live.

I put my trust in him whom You set on
The throne to rule the darkness and the
dawn.

May his hand behind what things seem to
be

Guide always to the blessed reality,
In either mercy or in wrath as he
Best knows who wields the sceptre on the
tree.

Tremble in fear or kiss, it is but one
When all is set to rights and justice done.
I look for justice only, not attraction
To charismatic flights in the distraction.
Beloved, David alone has right to be
A charismatic figure to the free.

**12 Lest He be angry, and you pass
Away upon the road's morass,
When His wrath's kindled but a jot.
Blessed all who confide in His plot.**

God's wrath falls on all who confide
In church and synagogue, abide
In mosques thinking God does not see
Their sinful plans and ways to be.
But those who trust in Him alone
Instead of sacrificial bone
Find blessing, bread and not a stone.

I kiss the son on David's throne and give
Acknowledgement that words arise and
live,
And move from feet to sons within the
sieve
Of language change from ancient Hebrew
to

The Aramaic of the few and true.
I kiss both feet and son, and take the slave
That represents You from cradle to grave,
And pass Your wrath and his with loving
glance
In confidence to whirl in sacred dance
With David in the cobbled streets and turns
Jerusalem offers the sun for burns.
Let all be angry with the way I go,
I wag my tail and whimper at the show,
Confiding in the hand I smell for earns.

Psalm 3

**1 A Psalm of David by his flight
From face of Absalom, his right.**

As David had to flee his kingdom when
His own son Absalom rose up again,
So the own kin of Ridha was betrayed,
And the Mahdi fled into hiding, stayed
There to rule, though never afraid.
The principle to follow is just this:

Only Allah is safe, men give the kiss.

When David gave the name Council of
Peace

To his son with a hopely heart's release,
Did he, a prophet, know he would some
day

Be fleeing from his own son's hand to
slay?

Kingship's a thing that sucks both water
and

The blood from fathers and from sons in
band,

A thing more precious than the mother's
breast,

More sought for than the islands of the
west.

Beloved, though I am not a king or fair,
Nor wield a sceptre's power anywhere,

I still feel that sting David was aware
Upon the loving heart. I feel and share.

Give now, Beloved, the kingship and the
throne

To him who hides beneath the darkened
stone.

2 HUU, how they have increased who are A trouble to me! Many *are* They who rise up against me so.

These words were written and to glow

In mind of Muhammad, who felt

The sting of persecution's welt.

He drank the bitter cup that passed

From Jesus' lips and could not last.

He felt the teeth in their attack

On Jeremiah's bleeding back.

We wept for forty innocents

That martyrdom claimed without vents.

But few know what trouble he sees

As Mahdi walks unseen to please

Through city and through justice-hall

To find fatted calf in the stall.

It's said this is the favourite psalm of

The holy prophet Muhammad whose love

Of You, Beloved, caused many to arise

Against him, to insult with flood of lies,

Force into exile and attack with army.

This psalm may well be dark and cloud and
stormy

Prediction of the holy prophet's fate,

More accurate in fact than history late

Attached to his name by inventors in

Traditions for pay. Pay them for their sin,

Beloved, and purify Your servant's name,

And may the words of David be his fame.

I too flee to You only from a nation

That knows no love or justice in their
station.

3 Many *are* they who wish to show Me no help in Alohim's tow.

Contemplate now, my friend, how many

Alive today could give a penny

For Mahdi's help as he works on

From light to dark, and dark to dawn,

And how few are touched by his share,

Who gamble life and pay for air.

So says Muhammad Al-Mahdi:

"Be of those who remember me,

Though unseen by the fruitful tree,

And by your just deed give a hand

To help me passing through the land."

What were You thinking on that rainy
night,

Beloved, when David fled and hid from
sight

Among the howling pits, almost alone?

His own son taught the people heart of
stone

Lived in that breast that beat for every man

That was oppressed. Now every oppressed
clan

Turned enemy to their own truest friend.

Divinely chosen then came to an end.

Divine choice seemed to take another way,

Since all the land forsook one, and for pay,

Went to the son. The will of God be done!

But David did not fear nor doubt the One

Who was Beloved of him, no human word

Or threat could win at last. David endured.

4 But You're, O HUU, a shield for me, My glory, who lifts my head *free*.

Allah is great protection here

From magistrates that he could fear

For their purpose is to do wrong

To every faithful one along.

Allah's shield in his case is that

He is invisible from fat,

But Allah shields also the one

Who hides his hope in him when done.
He has no glory, honour where
Human parade strikes out in fair,
But Allah is his glory too,
He lifts his head to know and do,
And in his knowing and his rule
You also can share as a tool
Submitting to Allah alone
And bowing only at His throne.

I walk the streets of Babylon and Rome
As though I sought and vainly for a home,
Without the recognition of the fair,
Without applause of any that I'm there.
There is no glory in myself to bide,
There's only You and in Yourself I hide,
You who are glory and fame for my tide
And longing to fill at my reedbed's bank
The sight and smell of silver grass and
rank.
My rank is at the black and fertile show
Where sluggishly the Jordan waters flow.
I seek no other shield but that I know
Beneath the humble rate of Jericho,
A red cord and silence before night's glow.

**5 I cried to HUU with my voice, and
He heard me from His hale hill's land.**

Although the Mahdi cries aloud
To Allah in middle of crowd,
None hear him of the faithful nor
Any who stand within the door.
Only Allah hears that loved voice,
And for that let men all rejoice.

I cry to You, Beloved, beneath the hill
Of granite and of quartzite that now still
Is shelter and a home for me and those
Small beasts so harelly, foxly in their toes
Peek at my slumber by unsleeping rill.
I cry to You, Beloved, and trust You hear
The faint prayer of the dervish dog whose
gear

Is piled by chimney slated with the best
Green stone of Lapland in which I invest.
I whine at Your approach and perk my ear.
I cry to You, Beloved, with slender voice
And wait a moment for Your whispered
Word,

And then go back to flitting beast and bird
Who join me as I lie down to rejoice.

**6 I lay down and slept, I awoke,
For YHWH sustained me by His yoke.**

Where the lovely occulted leader rests
There is no safety as of earthy nests.
He only relies on the hope of God
In hidden places where no man has trod.
Yet for his work untiring in the earth
I find amid the evil a safe berth,
And waken to the new day once to know
His presence in the field and ways I go.

The pillows of my soul are yet unseen,
From breath to breath I struggle and my
lean

Life stops and whimpers, staggers on a
pace,

Falls into sleep eternal but for grace.
In faith I close my eye, in faith I sleep,
Not knowing I shall wake. You stand to
keep

My hovering on dreams until the hour
You will me back to life by Your own
power.

No sustenance is found for human breath
Nor even for a dog's sound above death,
Except you kiss my muzzle and return
With air and water where my nurtures burn.
I lay down and I sleep, and I awake
By You alone, and alone for Your sake.

**7 I shall not fear ten thousand men
Who make siege around me again.**

The hidden leader of mankind who waits
Upon the throne of David at four gates
Is crowded round about by myriads who
Would seek to do him harm in all their
crew.

But no fear enters the heart of that one
Who knows God's comfort for the things
he's done

And calmly rounds the Kaaba while the
crowd

Ignores his presence as they pray aloud.

Ten thousand at poor David's time awoke
To attack at the dawn and at a stroke.
Ten thousand more took Ahmed by
surprise

As though if possible to blind his eyes.
Ten thousand men today are hardly put

Upon the battle field in army foot.
 After Napoleon rushed on the sod,
 Two million became standard in the pod.
 Today a billion and more rise to seek
 My downfall as I tread the busy week,
 And hope the Sabbath brings about my
 death,
 But I still find life in You breath to breath,
 And live in Your love only as I fall
 Beneath the weight of hopelessness in all.

8 Arise, O YHWH, save me, my God!
For You've struck all my foes *with prod*
Upon the cheekbone, and You break
All ungodly ones' teeth *by stake*.

The sweet Christian is one who fails
 To rejoice in the rod that flails
 Against ungodly harms and sails,
 But rather speaks of love that makes
 The law of jungle for men's sakes.
 The true man of faith, woman too,
 Is one who's glad that judgement's rue
 Is cast when cast upon the crew
 Of wicked men in every pew.

I look about the voting hall and see
 The dark proponents of democracy
 Who hope the legislature will defeat
 Any bill You propose upon the sheet.
 I see that all of them have still intact
 Jawbone, cheekbone, and pearly white
 unslacked
 Peering from grimace and commercial
 smile.

I wonder that You don't see through their
 guile.

It's time to break both tooth and jawbone
 now

Before the holocaust resumes the row.
 Beloved, it seems You have forgotten how
 To strike the foe with iron rod and break
 Rebellion at the fount for goodness' sake,
 The enemy set up and burn at stake.

9 And salvation is YHWH's alone.
Your blessing's on Your people shown.
 There is no saving but that wrought
 By God alone, no Moses taught
 Can save from Pharaoh, and the plot
 Of hidden leader, Mahdi sought,
 Is of no vantage unless caught

Up in the divine favour's lot.

Salvation is Yours and it's Yours alone,
 That's something I cannot help but believe.
 I feel the striking to the narrow bone
 And feel it often and without reprieve.
 There is no help in justice staid by law,
 There's no acquittal for one's poverty,
 All forces are out to break off the jaw
 Of helpless ones strong in impunity.
 Salvation's Yours alone, and always kept
 Far from the ones who need it and have
 wept.

Your blessing's on Your people, truly so,
 And yet Your blessing's not salvation's
 glow.

Your blessing is a hidden thing, I guess,
 An other-worldly staying out of mess.

Psalm 4
1 To the Chief Musician to hold
Stringed instruments, and so a bold
Psalm of David as any told.

David himself says Mr Koch
 Plays only saz and like the roach
 Endures for generations' store.
 I would ask God for nothing more.

Harp or guitar or violin, who knows
 What's best in view of human praise that
 shows

What You, Beloved, create, restore and
 hold

Of earth and sky in quiet, darkling gold?
 The tinkling angel notes accompany
 The songs of watchers on eternity,
 While I print silent steps across the pale
 Hoar-frosted boulders that make up the
 vale

Where my small lara opens to the view
 Of nothing and of everything that's true.
 Beloved, meet my four strings at the four
 gates

That rise up where the sparked mosquito
 mates

And pluck one note to find if any hear
 That You are One and that You have come
 near.

2 Hear me when I call, O God of
My righteousness! You from above

**Relieved me in distress, then do
Have mercy, and hear my prayer too.**

The hidden Mahdi calls alone
To the God of his righteous throne
Who only relieves such distress
On those human shoulders might press.
The Mahdi himself must cry out
For mercy, what of those about
Their evil works? They fail to pray
Asking for mercy on a day.
May I follow in Mahdi's way
Relying on God's mercy's sway.

I have no righteousness, Beloved, but that
You set upon my heart and hand and mat.
The I-ness that I know is up for grabs
And ready to join in the fried rehabs.
I have no distress but the call to be
A god above all gods eternally,
And yet You hear me with grace and mercy
And touch my prayer with Your own
melody.

So hear me when I call without a care
Of any hearer listening anywhere,
And fill my lack with Your own
righteousness
And in You mercy bend down here to
bless.

Beloved, I call in quiet, passed refrain
In notes in which there whines but little
pain.

**3 Then how long, O you sons of men,
Turn you my glory to shame then,
Seeking idols' falsehood again?**

With every turn of the passage to right
Men bow with burning eye into the night.
Each hopeful and prophetic rise towards
truth
Takes the soul further from the earth in ruth
And further from the flood that might
descend
To bring the thirsty soul out to its end.
How long shall paradise shine in the eye
Of pagan faith that covets by and by
The god-flesh instead of the warming soil
Where only life can be had by the toil
Of six days in communion with the late
Sweetness of obeying the mountain state?
I lay aside hope for the righteous man

Who wanders in the air as best he can.

**4 But know that YHWH has set the good
Apart for Himself, and YHWH would
Hear when I call to Him *as should*.**

Have You, Beloved, taken a remnant
bought
From the great human crowd that ever
sought
The way to peace and hope and
righteousness,
And justice for the eater in address?
Take all, Beloved, both good and bad I
plead.
The divine Self in me no doubt would seed
This prayer for all of humankind to wear
The benefit that is due to all life.
And yet that divine Self bows to the strife
Of freedom and sinks into silence while
The unknown path that seemed to rise a
mile
Fails narrowed in the search and disappears
Unknown even to Your heart and Your
ears.
I turn and turn in sorrow from the share.

**5 If you become angry, don't sin.
But meditate with your heart in
Your bed, and *on your bed* be still.**

The evening comes, before I sleep I hear
Your lovely names within my heart and
ear,
I move from waking into dreams Your
voice
Resounding in the chambers where rejoice
The inner soundings where I am well
dwelt.
My peace and wrath entwine where I have
felt
The workings of Your spirit and Your word
Known through the crusty graven tomes
that stirred
The hearts of ages past and stir my own.
Communities of faithful past atone
For that bare desert of the living earth
That fires my hurt and wrath to welcome
worth.
Keep me from sin but dampen not my ire

Who burn in love to You with midnight's
fire.

**6 Offer then righteous sacrifice
And let your trust in YHWH suffice.**

What is the sacrifice of righteousness,
Beloved, that I bring to Your love's
address?

The flaying of the ram beside the tomb
Of Hacı Küresh perhaps makes more room,
But still I look beyond the flowing blood
Of man and beast or even god or stud.
The sacrifice of righteousness, is it
To carry out commandment straight and
fit?

The offering of the law, Beloved, is Yours,
Who spoke on Sinai to thousands in scores.
Beloved, I bring the righteous sacrifice
As I whirl mind and body on the slice
Of winter-covered island and lake ice
Beneath a sky's mosaic and concise.

**7 Many say "Who what good will show?"
YHWH, lift up Your countenance' glow
Upon us and do not be slow.**

Indeed there is no good but One, and how
Can any show that Good with sacred cow?
Your face, Beloved, is truly good to know,
But death waits in the balance of the show.
Lift up Your face, Beloved, and I shall see
Engulfment of my self's eternity,
The resurrection outside time and space,
Eternal rest within Your heart and grace.
Who will show any good? I ask the task
And find only the silence of the mask.
Again I whirl, again the idol rises
To lay no hand at all upon the prizes.
The global treat is still here to be bought,
The faces turn still from the true that ought.

**8 You have put gladness in my heart,
More than when their grain fields up
start
And their grape juice increases part.**

The corn and wine are basic human rights.
And yet You recognize that there are nights
When surpluses of food and drink are
stored

And then destroyed upon the marble-
floored
While twenty-five thousand children each
day

Die of hunger accessing no e-bay.
You put gladness in my heart even now,
More than in the time when the field and
cow

Gave to each mouth its own. And I am glad
Beneath the sun and snowflake. I have had
A heart of waiting, tranquil happiness
Amid the fields stricken with death and
gness.

This more than greed and power to crush
the least
Brings me up short to contemplate the
beast.

**9 I'll lie down and in peace I'll sleep,
For You alone, YHWH, my life keep.**

Beloved, now I lay me down to sleep,
Hear my prayer this night as the shadows
creep

Across the islands, continents and seas.
In You I find my refuge and heart's ease
As I turn from the shame of what men do
Who make pretence of Your faith and of
You.

Keep me from idols, images, and ways
That overprint Your simple love with maze.
Let me look only to the godly one
You have established till the world is done.
Turn my unquiet anger into trust
That You deal with injustice as You must.
No stop-gap measures do to show the good,
But You alone suffice who only could.

Psalm 5

1 To the Chief Musician. With flutes. A
Psalm of David.

2 Give ear now to my words, O YHWH,
Consider meditation's *dev*.

My whirling steps come near the stations'
end

As I turn toward Your house and body
bend,

Hand grasping at the universal good,
Distributing the barakat as should.
Yet I turn back to You and raise a cry

That You might hear my words here just as
I

Listen to the great sema' of the speech
Of David and his birds, while staghorns
preach.

Consider, my Beloved, while I say hear,
And let that be Your sema' without peer.
I am the word that proceeds from Your
mouth,

And yet from that word, living north to
south

As long as You will to breathe, speaks to
You

And grants Your sema' in the things I do.

3 Give heed to the voice of my cry,
My King and my God *now and aye*,
For I will pray to You *on high*.

Because You are my King and Alohim
I pray to You in everything I deem
Precious to hand and heart, the goal of foot
Walking in a straight line then once it's put
To earth beneath the air turns in the line
That circles world and Sabbath with the
fine

Eternity of earthworm and the grate
Of humus on prostrating, balding pate.
Beloved, take heed to my cry warning You
That I'm on the collision course of true,
Whirling below the knowing and the love
To land far, far below the portals of
Your law and justice, covered with the will
Of green umbrellas shining on blue hill.

4 My voice You shall hear on the morn,
O YHWH, at morning I'll direct
To You, and will look up, *elect*
And not one left alone for scorn.

Your sema', my Beloved, the one You hear
In tinkling tones of sweetness on Your ear,
Is that one that arises when I wake
To celebrate Your name for mercy's sake.
In one moment I become one with that
Word that You spoke by David, golden flat,
Twist in the morning light and disappear
From all creation's senses to appear
Eternal and beloved within Your time
And place, and heart and love, and silver
rhyme.

I look up, and in one brief swirl of gate
I become one with You, both soon and late,
Let fall the grape and nut, let fall the store,
Of bread and wine upon the gallows floor.

5 For You *are* not a God who takes
Pleasure in wickedness, nor makes
Evil stay with You *for men's sakes*.

The round is closed, the footsteps now
return

To the way of the first Psalm where I learn
That You know the way that I go, but spurn
The way I go in evil. So I find
That the return to You is never blind.
Pleasure there is in full in sacrifice
That whirls up from the altar where the
mice

Still scurry in their praises and their known
Encirclings in sema' about Your throne.
The round is closed, my supplications
cease,

The truth's exposed, my soul now rests in
peace,
And no word even of the Psalms remains
To feed the world of pleasures and of pains.
I grasp the sun and moon and then release.

6 Boastful ones stand not in Your sight,
You hate all those who do not right.

**7 You destroy those who falsehood
speak,**

**YHWH abhors those who bloodshed
seek**

And the men who of deceit reek.

Beloved, the theories that describe Your
being
Are far beyond my mind, hearing and
seeing.

Some say that You are One and three to
boot,

And others that You have no leaf or root
To know pleasure or pain in anything,
Since You are not contingent on the ring.
A third alternative hides in the shy
Unthinking views of common people's dye,
Those with no current of theology:
That You are anthropomorphic really.
The theriomorphic concept of You fails
These days because of scientific gales.

I set these all aside to know that You
Take no pleasure in what the wicked do.

8 But as for me, I will come in
Your house *to stand there without sin*
In the multitude of Your grace
And in fear of You *and Your face*
I'll bow down toward Your holy house.

**9 Lead me, O YHWH, wherein to browse
In Your righteousness because of
My enemies *who lack in love,*
Make Your way straight before my face.**

10 For *there's* no faithfulness *nor grace*
In their mouth, and their inward part
Destruction *is and to the heart,*
Their throat *is an open grave,* they
Flatter with their tongue *every day.*

**11 Pronounce them guilty, Alohim!
Let them fall by their own esteem
In counsels, cast them out *indeed*
In the multitude of their *greed***

And transgressions, for they've rebelled
Against You. 12 But let all rejoice
Who put their trust in You, *with voice*
Let them for ever shout for joy,
Because You defend them, *deploy*
For them deliverance unquelled,
Let those also who love Your name
Be joyful in You *for Your fame.*

**13 For You, O YHWH, will bless indeed
The righteous and the righteous seed,
With favour You'll surround him as
A shield, *with what defence it has.***

The pre-dawn hush prevents my prayer: I
stand
With face toward Your house, Beloved, the
land
Still shrouded with the cloak of night, the
sky
Still velvet with Your perfumes passing by,
And know Your mercy covers wood and
field,
Its under-seam Your wrath that will not
yield
The blessed earth to those whose unjust
deeds
Harass the poor and turn their bread to
weeds.

The pre-dawn flush precipitates my prayer,
I stand with face toward Your house, the air

Is fresh in my damp beard, the quiet
broken,
Again the age-old words as newly spoken
Prostrate both soul and body to the earth
Toward Your holy house before dawn's
birth.

Psalms 6

1 To the Chief Musician. With stringed
instruments. On an eight-stringed harp. A
Psalm of David.

2 O YHWH, do not rebuke me in
Your anger, nor chasten *for sin*
In Your displeasure heated. 3 Do
Have mercy upon me, O YHWH,
For I *am* weak, O YHWH, heal me,
For my bones are troubled *greatly.*

**4 My soul also is sore distraught
But You, O YHWH, how long are
*sought?***

**5 Return, O YHWH, deliver me!
Oh, save me for Your great mercy!**

6 In death *there's* no remembrance of
You, in the grave who'll give You *love*
And thanks? 7 I am weary with my
Groaning, all night I sigh and cry
Making my bed swim, drenching my
Couch with my tears. 8 My eye wastes for
My grief, and it grows old before
My enemies. 9 Depart from me,
You workers of iniquity,
For YHWH has heard my weeping's voice
10 YHWH's heard my supplication,
YHWH

Will hear my prayer, *make me rejoice.*

**11 Let all my enemies be true
Ashamed and greatly troubled, let
Them turn back in sudden shame met.**

O my Beloved, have mercy on the weak!
For love of You I do not hurt nor seek
To harm the enemy who hates my soul.
Let You alone, Beloved, be my goal.
Deliver me from those around who hate
And keep me safe within the earthen gate
Where there is none I've left at all but You
Whom none can hurt no matter what they
do.

Keep me within the gate and I shall there
Remember to call on Your name and spare
No efforts to return from self to Self.

The enemy has left me on the shelf.
Alone in my dark closet I am here,
I turn to You alone and without fear.

Psalm 7

1 A Meditation of David,
Which he sang to YHWH when he hid
From the words of the Benjamite
Whose name was Cush *and did not right*.

**2 O YHWH my God, in You I put
My trust, save me from all whose foot
Is against me to persecute**

**And save me, 3 lest they like a brute
Lion tear me, rending in pieces,
While none's to save, it never ceases.**

4 O YHWH my God, if I've done this:
If there's iniquity remiss

In my hands, 5 if I have repaid
Evil to him who always made
Peace with me, or have released my
Enemies from their empty *sty*,

6 Let the enemy pursue me
And overtake *me*, yes, and be
Treading my life down to the earth,
And set my honour as no worth.

As evil as the act that perpetrates
Against the innocent is that he rates
The guilty good and fair and without
shame.

It is a duty once to stand and blame.
And yet that is a duty that's regarded
By the sweet Christian as a thing retarded.
To carry out the right is hard to do
When it incurs the wrath of tooty-froo.

Beloved, let me do good to every man,
Give health and wealth in stealth much as I
can,

And at the same time raise accusing word
Against the crafty, evil-doing bird.
Let me give good for good from day to day,
And give me courage to make wicked pay.

7 Arise, O YHWH, in wrath, lift up
Yourself because the raging *cup*
Of my enemies *draws near*, rise
Up for me *to the judgment wise*
You have commanded! 8 So the group
Of people shall surround in troop
Their hope in You, therefore, return
On high. 9 YHWH's a judge very stern

For all the peoples; judge me, YHWH,
According as I rightly do,
According to *what's found by You*
In me as my integrity.

**10 Oh, let end the iniquity
Of the wicked, sustain the just,
For the righteous Alohim must
Test hearts and minds. 11 My defence is
Of Alohim, who saves all His
Upright in heart. 12 Alohim is
A just judge, and El El God is
Angry with the wicked each day.**

13 If he does not repent his way,
He will sharpen His sword, He bends
His bow and makes it ready, 14 sends
His instruments of death prepared,
Makes arrows fiery shafts *and bared*.

The holy one You sent, the blessed
Messiah,

Told us to pray in plain words like the fire,
For enemies and love each bad pariah.
Dismayed, I find to love the sweet a trier,
Say nothing of the enemy. A prayer
For enemies is hard to utter where
The childless widow fasts in sorrow for
The lost to tanks, embargos, bombs and
more.

Must one pray for such enemies as well,
And love them too, as far as I can tell?
One cannot love the neighbour as oneself
Until one knows there is but that one Self.
Still I am glad to find this prayer for those
Who persecute, where no sweet loving
shows.

15 See, who brings forth iniquity,
Yes, he conceives trouble *freely*
And brings forth falsehood. 16 He has
made

A pit and dug it out, *waylaid*
And fallen in the ditch he made.

**17 His trouble shall return upon
His own head, and his violence
Shall come down on his own defence.**

18 I will praise YHWH according to
His righteousness, and will sing praise
To the name of the Most High YHWH
Now and as long as I have days.

The prayer for the foe is not just words
sweet,
Forgiveness in his sins to eat the treat.
The prayer is that the wickedness might
end,
Not merely to accept him as a friend.
The Christian duty to pray for the foe
Seems hard because some think that it
should show
Acceptance of his wicked way to go.
Oh no, the prayer for wicked folks is that
They should do no more evil where they
sat,
And that's an easy prayer indeed to say
Even for the victim inside the fray.
Beloved, I come before Your throne to pray
For all the enemies I have today,
That they will stop right now their evil
way!

Psalm 8

1 To the Chief Musician. On the instrument
of Gath. A Psalm of David.
**2 O YHWH, our Lord, how excellent
Is Your name in all of the earth,
Who have set Your glory's ascent
Above the heavens *in its worth!***
3 Out of the mouth of suckling child
You have ordained strength, and enfiled
Your enemies, that You may show
Sabbath on the avenging foe.
**4 When I consider Your heavens,
The work of Your fingers, the lens
Of moon and the stars, which You've set,
5 What is man whom You don't forget,
And son of man to whom You come?**
6 For You have made him little lower
Than gods or angels *some adore*,
And You have crowned him with the sum
Of glory and honour *and more*.
**7 You have made him to reign in state
Over the works of Your hands *great*,
You have established all beneath
His feet, *that has both claw or teeth*,**
**8 All sheep and oxen, beast of field,
9 The fowl of air, the fish that yield
The sea, whatever passes through
The sea's paths swimming *not a few*.**
10 O YHWH, our Lord, how excellent
*Is Your name, in all the earth *sent!**

O my Beloved, how sweet of You to plan
And tell beforehand what the promised
man
Would do to honour and respect his
mother.
When she was lied about and when another
Accused her wrongly, he spoke up and said
She was a righteous maid, not wrongly led.
He spoke when just a baby in her arms
To comfort her and quiet her alarms.
Why did You, my Beloved, reveal this
thing
To David, peace on him, the prophet-king?
The son of man's made lower than the
gods,
Those trinities and idols, empty pods,
That some would try to raise him to in vain.
We worship You, he, I, the angel train.

Psalm 9

1 To the Chief Musician. Upon death to the
son." A Psalm of David.
**I will praise *You*, O YHWH, with my
Whole heart, I will tell, *not deny*,
Of all Your wondrous works. 2 And I
Will be glad and rejoice in You,
I'll sing praise to Your name, Most High.**
3 When enemies turn back anew,
At Your presence they'll fall and perish.
4 For You have maintained *what I cherish*,
My right and cause, You sat *to bless*
On the throne judging righteousness.
**5 You have rebuked the nations, You
Destroyed the wicked, *truly* You
Have blotted out their name forever.**
6 O enemy, destructions are
Finished forever! Cities far
And near you have destroyed and their
Memory's perished *in thin air*.

Blot out the name of every empty thing
That I have done or thought or in the wing
Of silver speech fathered upon the world.
Blot out all vanities in flags unfurled.
Blot out, Beloved, the idol that my heart
Would set up to replace You from the start,
The secret that would waver and reveal
The hopes of silvered notes and brazen
heel.
Beloved, I ask the miracle of You

That You might cast the memory from
view
Of all things whether mine or others' share
That depart from Your youth
everywhere,
Till I find nothing where I turn to look
Except Your face, and let that be my book.

7 But YHWH shall always endure, He
Prepared His throne for clemency.

8 He shall judge the world righteously,
Judge the people in uprightness.

**9 YHWH also will be a refuge
For oppressed in troublous deluge.**

**10 And those who know Your name will
place**

**Their trust in You, and in Your grace,
For You, YHWH, do not abandon
Who seek You and rely upon.**

11 Sing praises to YHWH, who dwells in
Fortress! Declare His deeds within
The people. 12 When He venges blood,
He will remember them *in flood*,
Forgetting not the humble cry.

**13 Have mercy on me, O YHWH! And
Note my trouble from hateful band,
You lift me up from gates of death,**

**14 To tell Your praise *with all my breath*
In the daughter of fortress' gates
Rejoicing where salvation waits.**

15 The nations have sunk in the pit
Which they made, in the net they fit
In hiding, their own foot is caught.

16 YHWH is known *by* his judgment
wrought,

The wicked is snared in the work
Of his own hands *and without shirk*.

**17 The wicked shall be turned in hell,
All the nations that *do not well*,
Forgetting Alohim. 18 For not
Always shall needy be forgot,
The expectation of the poor
Shall *not* always go out the door.**

19 Arise, O YHWH, do not let man
Prevail, and let Your judgement fan
The nations in Your sight. 20 Put them
In fear, O YHWH, *that* nations may
Know themselves *to be* men *that stray*
While You're holding the diadem.

Destroy in me the enemy and all

That seeks another hope but You, I call
On You alone and seek my help alone
In You, let fail my will and flesh and bone,
But You lift me up from the gate of death
First to the gate of law and air and breath,
Then to the gate of burning fire where none
Can be an enemy, but love made one.
Oh, turn my wicked parts to hell and give
The expectation of the poor to live,
Poor dervish let me be forever in
Your loving heart at peace where none
knows sin.

Let my own foot be troubled by Your
snares,

Tripped up by bands of love, caught
unawares.

Psalm 10 continued from Psalm 9

1 Why do You stand afar off, YHWH?
And hide in troublous times *debut*?

2 The wicked in pride persecutes
The poor, let them be caught, *the brutes*,
In the plots which they have devised.

**3 For the wicked boasts in the prised
Of his heart, and blesses the greedy
Renouncing YHWH, *outdated, seedy*.**

**4 The wicked with his proud face does
Not seek *from Bethel unto Luz*,
Alohim's in none of his thoughts.**

5 His ways are always prospered plots,
Your judgement far, out of his sight,
He sneers at all his foes in spite.

6 He has said in his heart, "I shall
Not be moved to a troubled cell."

**7 His mouth is full of cursing and
Deceitfulness, oppression, and**

Under his tongue is mischief and

**Iniquity. 8 He sits in places
And lurking for the village *faces*,
And there he murders without traces
The innocent, his eyes are fixed
In secret on the helpless *mixed*.**

9 He lies in wait and secretly,
As lion in its den, to be

In wait to catch the poor, and he
Catches the poor when he draws him
Into his net. 10 He crouches dim,

He lies low, that the helpless may
Fall by his strength. 11 He has his say
In his heart, "El El God's forgotten,
He hides His face *from the begotten*,

He'll never see *what's done that's rotten.*"

Though I have prayed, Beloved, that You'd forget,

The truth is that the evil act to get
Is Yours to see and in the judgement day
That comes this week or in the future way
The thing shall go out and not unrequited:
You are a furore when You are incited.
Though I may seek a hidden place to foil
Myself and lose my righteous, midnight
toil,

Your eye finds all the depths and sounds
the deep,

You mind here unforgetful all my sleep.
Beloved, I strike the folly down from view
And hold it up to grace and help from You
Until no thing remains in secret hand
Or openly, except Your divine stand.

12 Arise, O YHWH! O El El God,
Lift up Your hand *upon the sod!*
Do not forget the humble here.

**13 Why do the wicked fail to fear
Renouncing Alohim? He's said
In his heart, "You will not be sped
To ask account of whom I've bled."**

14 But You have seen, for You observe
Trouble and grief, and who deserve
Get payment *for it* by Your hand.
The helpless commits him to *stand*
In You, You help the fatherless.

**15 Now break the power of wickedness
And of the evil, seek out his
Wickedness till there's none in biz.**

16 YHWH's King forever and always,
The nations perished from His braes.

**17 YHWH, You've heard the humble
desire,**

**You will prepare their heart with fire,
You'll cause Your ear to hear the crier,**

**18 To do justice to fatherless
And vexed, that no more may oppress
The man of earth in wickedness.**

Beloved, I guess this is permission for
Me to pray before open window, door
That You will break the arm of the
oppressor
Or enemy of which I am confessor.

Knowing that Christians are so sweet and
turn

The other cheek while they let oil fires
burn,

And Muslims and Jews both reject the truth
Of blinded eye for eye and tooth for tooth,
I hesitate to call down condemnation.
I thank You now for this lasting elation.
Please break the arm of Georgie the insane
And send So damn to hell to file his claim.
To say the word does not make me feel
better,
But satisfied to pray You to the letter.

Psalm 11

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of
David.

In YHWH I put my trust, how can
You say to my soul, *man to man*,
"Flee as a bird to your mountain"?

2 For look! The wicked *creeping in*
Bend bow, make ready arrow on
The string, that they may shoot *at dawn*
In secret at upright in heart.

3 If the foundations here depart,
What can the righteous do *for start?*

**4 YHWH's in His holy temple, and
YHWH's throne's in heaven to
command,**

**His eyes behold, his eyelids try
The sons of men who live and die.**

5 YHWH tries the righteous, but the vain
And violent He hates again.

6 Upon the wicked He will rain
Coals, fire and brimstone and a flame
Of wind's their cup's portion and shame.

7 For YHWH *is* righteous, He loves *true*
Righteousness, His face sees them do
The uprightness *that He foreknew.*

The vision of my small horizon here
Does not extend up to Your throne, my
dear.

I see the arrows of the wicked point
And feel already how they strike the joint.
I see the mountain where I should take
flight,

I see oppression and the wicked spite.

I see no throne, I see no face at all,

I hear no answer to my fainting call.

It is enough, Beloved, that Your eyes see

The wicked violence surrounding me.
And though I cannot see Your loving face
Nor near nor far from where my footsteps
 race,
It is enough, Beloved, if You can spy
My countenance, and where my treasures
 lie.

Psalms 12

1 To the Chief Musician. On an eight-stringed harp. A Psalm of David.
Help, YHWH, for the godly man ceases!
From humankind the faith decreases.
2 They speak idly each one with neighbour,
Lip flattering *and with the labour*
Of double heart they speak. 3 May YHWH
Cut off all flattering lips, *and too*
The tongue that speaks proud things, 4 for
 who
Have said "With our tongue we'll prevail,
Our lips *are* our's, who *can* avail?"
**5 "For the oppression of the poor,
For sighing of the needy sure,
Now I'll arise," says YHWH, "I will
Set him in safety to his fill."**
6 The words of YHWH *are* pure words,
 tried
Silver in a furnace of dried
Earth, purified seven times over.
**7 You shall keep them, O YHWH, in
 trover,
You shall preserve them now and ever.**
8 The wicked prowl, *thinking them clever*,
On every side, when vileness raised
Among the sons of men *half crazed*.

Oppression is the normal state of things
In this world made by senators and kings.
The right proportion of greed, cruelty
And lust makes up in each society
The man ideal for each. Keep me from
 greed
And cruelty, O my Beloved, I need
No motive but my lust for Your approach.
Remove all manners from me, Lord, and
 coach
My soul in singleness, heart undivided,
And my heart satisfied with what's
 provided
In You alone, the treasure that makes bare
The courtesies and castles built in air

That are the substance of the faith in things.
Of You alone my lustful language sings.

Psalms 13

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of David.
**How long, O YHWH? Will You forget
About me forever? And yet
How long will You hide Your face from
Me? 2 How long shall my counsel come
In my soul, *having* sorrow in
My heart daily *and not for sin?*
How long will my foe be exalted
Over me, *though I'm not one faulted?*
**3 Consider *and* hear me, O YHWH
My God, enlighten my eyes, do,
Lest I sleep the *sleep of death*, 4 lest
My enemy say, "I've got best
Against him", *lest* who trouble me
Rejoice when I'm moved *woefully*.**
5 But I've trusted in Your mercy,
Heart rejoices in Your salvation.
6 I'll sing to YHWH *and with elation*,
For He's dealt bountifully with me.**

The enemy without, within, is pain
To soul and heart until at last he's slain.
The burning question how to conquer self
Again I dust and take down from the shelf.
How long shall nafs be lifted over me?
As long as my veiled eyes refuse to see
That every self is only Self or naught,
And besides You there's nothing to be
 sought.
Let me trust in Your mercy and not sight,
Illusions only come to plague the night.
Let cantillation kindle loving fire
By which I see the faces of desire
Melt into one unseen, but loved and known,
The one reality hidden and shown.

Psalms 14

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of David.
**The fool has said in his heart, "No
God." Now they are corrupt, they show
Abominable works, there's none
Who does good, *no not even one*.**
**2 YHWH looks down from heaven upon
Men's children, and to see anon
If there are those who understand,**

Seek Alohim on every hand.

3 Together they've all turned aside,
Corrupt, not one does good *in pride*.
4 Have all the wicked no knowledge,
Who eat my people *up* like bread,
And do not call on YHWH *instead*?
5 There they are on a great fear's *edge*,
For Alohim's with righteous folk.
6 You shame the counsel of the poor,
But YHWH's his refuge *at a stroke*.
7 Oh, that salvation *would come sure*
For Israel from the fortress tower!
When YHWH comes back to *show His*
power
Release His folk's captivity,
Let Jacob joy, Israel sing free.

All men are fools, for each one in his heart
Says there is no God but myself, my art
And strength are singular, I am unique,
There is no other God, and so I seek
My own good and the benefit of none
But those who help inflate this number one,
Ah, not always in just these words, but in
The words that time and place cover its sin.
Beloved, I know there's no escape from
this

Fond whisper of the human heart's abyss,
For no word is there but the word of You,
Hear only this one prayer, let me be true
And add there is no god but God and so
Relinquish self and my true Self once
know.

Psalm 15

1 A Psalm of David.
YHWH, who may abide in Your tent?
Who may live in holy ascent?
2 He who walks uprightly, and works
Righteousness, and speaks truth *that irks*
In his heart, 3 He does not backbite
With his tongue, nor do evil spite
To his neighbour, nor does he take
Up a reproach for his friend's sake,
4 In whose eyes the vile is despised,
But honours those who are *apprised*
To fear YHWH, he swears to his hurt
And does not change, does not revert.
5 **He does not put his money out
At interest, nor take bribe in doubt
Against the innocent. He who**

Acts in these ways always stands true.

Your tents arise dark against holy hill
To fill my eyes with glory I see still
As I turn from the Kidron and its fill:
Your tents seduce my steps with golden
dome
And crimson marble where You make
Your home.
My eyes are filled with longing, so I come
To find You spiced and wooed in
cardamom
And lavender and veiled in fine-spun gold.
My heart is diced and pounded: it is sold.
Beloved, I would indeed live in Your tent,
Unless conditions stated here prevent.
The ten commandments of the Psalms
relent:
I eschew usury, despise the vile,
But may I not backbite the vile a while?

Psalm 16

1 A Michtam of David.
**Save me, O El El God, in You
I put my trust. 2 You've said to YHWH,
"You are my Lord, my goodness stands
Nowhere apart from Your commands."**
3 As for the saints upon the earth,
"They're excellent ones in their worth,
In whom is all of my delight."
4 **Their sorrows shall be dynamite
Who hasten after other gods,
Their drink offerings of blood and sods
I will not offer, nor take up
Their names on my lips nor in cup.**
5 O YHWH, *You are* the portion of
My heritage, my cup *in love*,
And You alone maintain my lot.
6 **The lines have fallen in the plot
To me in pleasantness, yes, I
Have a good heritage. 7 And I
Will bless YHWH who has given me
Counsel, my heart too instructs me
In the night seasons righteously.**
8 I have set YHWH always before
Me, because *He is at the door*
At my right hand I'll not be moved.
9 **Therefore my heart is glad and proved,
My glory joys, my flesh also
Will rest in hope that You bestow.**
10 For You'll not leave my soul in hell,

Nor will You let the *fetid spell*
Of such corruption come to touch
Your holy one *or see as much*.
11 You will show me the path of life,
In Your presence *there is no strife*
But joy's fullness, at Your right hand
Eternal pleasures *still command*.

I do not take a god who died and rose
As did the Canaanites and I suppose
Egyptians, Babylonians and who
Knows who. Belovèd, I take only You.
I find delight in saints in twelves who
sound

Your warning to the godless crowds
around.

I live and move in pleasant places, yes,
I know that You are God, I need not guess.
The Holy One, who silently sleeps through
The centuries of wait to live anew,
Sees no corruption, when I meet You there
Who guard the sacred body from the air,
I find You show me to the path of life,
Fulness of joy, and pleasures like a knife.

Psalm 17

1 A Prayer of David.

Hear a just cause, O YHWH, attend
To my cry, and let Your ear lend
To my prayer not made in deceit.

2 Let my vindication *complete*
Come from Your presence, let Your eyes
Look on the things upright *and wise*.

3 You have tested my heart, and You
Have visited *me* in the night,
You have tried me *and all I do*
And have found nothing in Your sight,
For I have purposed *faithfulness*
That my mouth shall never transgress.

4 And concerning the works of men,
By the word of Your lips *again*,
I've kept from the destroyer's paths.

5 Uphold my footsteps in Your paths,
That my footsteps may never slip,
But walk on firmly while I sip.

The heart, the lips, the works come step by
step

And in those three degrees of hip and hep
The path of right and wrong is full
revealed,

Even the heart is capable and sealed
To bring forth good or evil in its yield.
You test the heart, Beloved, in the night
season

When action no more covers perfect
reason,

And judge whether the sin is their laid bare,
Or whether righteousness sleeps with the
fair.

Beloved, the lips are left for me to take
Control of after You in silent wake
Have taken over heart and cast out sin.
And from the lips pour out in action's bin
The life on sod or death upon the stake.

6 I've called upon You, for You'll hear
Me, El El God, incline Your ear
To me, *and* hear my speech. 7 Show Your
Marvellous loving-kindness' *store*
By Your right hand, O You who save
Those who trust, from those who are brave
To rise up. 8 Keep me as the apple
Of Your eye, hide me under dapple
Wings with which You have shadowed me,
9 From the wicked who oppress me,
And deadly foes surrounding me.

10 They have closed up their fat *and*
sleek,
And with their mouths they proudly
speak.

11 They've now surrounded us in our
Steps, they have set their eyes *on power*,
Crouching down to the earth *to slay*,
12 As lion quick to tear his prey,
And like young lion lurking in
Secret places. 13 Arise *and win*,
O YHWH, confront him, cast him down,
Deliver my life from *the frown*
Of the wicked and with Your sword,
14 With Your hand from such men, O Lord
YHWH, from men of the world *with* their
Portion in life, *and in the air*,
Whose belly You fill with Your treasure,
Hidden to satisfy their measure
With children, and leave the rest of
Their *goods* for their babes *whom they love*.

15 As for me, I will see Your face
In righteousness *without mistake*,
I'll be satisfied to awake
In Your likeness *and in Your place*.

By the word of Your lips, Beloved, I keep
Remembrance in my waking and my sleep.
You visit me at night, what do You find?
Nothing at all, not even deaf and blind.
For in remembrance I have cast off all
That might be self against Your Self's
recall.

My will is Yours, and let Your will be
mine.

The nothing then You find shall sit and
dine.

Cut with Your sword the wicked one in me
And like the surgeon save my life and see
My belly filled with hidden treasure sought
In every market place, though never
bought.

And from the surgeon's knife I shall awake
Upon the screen of nothing for Your sake.

Psalm 18

1 To the Chief Musician. To David a
psalm,

The servant of YHWH, who spoke to
YHWH the *calm*

Words of this song on the day when
YHWH had saved

Him from the hand of all his enemies
braved

And from the hand of Saul. And he said "I
will

Love You, O YHWH, my strength." 2
YHWH is my rock still

And my fortress, indeed my deliverer,
My God, my strength, in whom I trust, my
shielder

And the horn of my salvation, my
stronghold.

**3 I will call upon YHWH, whose praise
may be told**

So shall I be saved from every enemy.

**4 The pangs of dreaded death have
surrounded me,**

**And floods of ungodliness made me
afraid.**

5 Sorrows of Sheol surrounded me *and
stayed,*

The snares of death confronted me *with
feared raid.*

**6 In my distress I called upon YHWH,
and cried**

**Out to my God, He heard my voice
*satisfied***

**From His temple, and my cry came
before Him,**

***Even unto His ears that have not grown
dim.***

I cry Allahu akbar in distress

Toward Your house, Beloved, that You
may bless

The soul in sorrows. Though my years are
few

And I have tasted little of sweet dew
Of morning prayers, my sorrow still
abounds.

My ear tuned to the early morning sounds
Is blemished with the rumours of new war
And hurt to hear word of conspirator
Against the peace and faith for subtle gain
Of oil. I seem to raise my prayer in vain
To silence such conspiracy, but then
Above the fury of the how and when
I hear my lips once more cry out in faith
You're greater far than earth- or water-
wraith.

7 Then the earth shook and trembled, the
foundations

Of the hills also quaked shaken gyrations,
Because He was angry. 8 Smoke went up
from His

Nostrils, and a devouring fire from His
Mouth, coals were kindled by it. 9 He
bowed the skies

Also, and then came down with darkness *in
guise*

Under His feet. 10 And He rode upon
cherub,

And flew, He flew upon the wings of the
hub

Of wind. 11 He made the darkness His
secret place,

His canopy around Him dark waters' *face*,
Thick clouds of the skies. 12 From the
brightness before

Him, thick clouds passed, hailstones, coals
of fire that soar.

**13 YHWH thundered from heaven, and
the Most High spoke**

**With His voice, hailstones and coals of
fire and smoke.**

**14 He sent out His arrows and scattered
the foe,
Abundant lightnings, and He vanquished
their *show*.**

Now that the century of cannon and the fire
Of missiles atomic above the choir
Has made the arrow obsolete, do You
Remember to up-grade Your derring-do?
Two thousand years ago and even three
It may have been enough to go on spree
With arrows in the thunder and the rain,
But now men have a better sort of stain.
Beloved, the arrows I see in the sky
To crash about they say are now more spry
Than arms in ages past, the energy
You waste on weather could kill all men
free
Who rise against Your law, who rise in hate
Or in the simple incommensurate.

15 Channels of the sea appeared, the
foundations
Of the world were uncovered *to the nations*
At Your rebuke, O YHWH, at Your
nostrils' breath's
Blast. 16 He sent from above, He took me
from *death's*
Many waters. 17 He saved me from my
strong foe,
From those who hated me, for their
overthrow
Was too strong for me. 18 They confronted
me in
My calamity's hour, but YHWH would
begin
To be my support. 19 He also brought me
out
Into a broad place, He saved me *with a
shout*
Because He delighted in me. 20 YHWH
rewards
Me according to my righteousness, *not
swords*,
According to the cleanness of my hands He
Has recompensed me. 21 For I have kept
fully
The ways of YHWH, and I have not
wickedly
Departed from my God. 22 For all His
judgements

Before me, I did not put away His *fence*
Of statutes from me. 23 I was also
blameless
Before Him, I kept myself from
wickedness.
24 Therefore YHWH has recompensed me
according
To my righteousness, according to
cleanness
Of my hands *before His face* in His seeing.
25 With the merciful You show Yourself to
be
Merciful, with a blameless man You will
show
Yourself blameless, 26 With the pure You
show also
Yourself pure, and with the devious You
show
Yourself devious. 27 For You will save
humble
Folk, but will bring down haughty looks.
28 For You light
My lamp, YHWH my God will my
darkness make bright.

A wind, Beloved, a fire and lamp You are
To the pure who look constant to Your star.
I follow David in his great desire
To walk in righteousness and in the fire
Of living service, blameless in the way.
Show Yourself pure with me, I seek the day
Of Your appearing. Let me see the tricks
You play on tricksters, other lunatics,
You are the best of tricksters, so You say
In later Scriptures in a warning word.
Give me clean hands, not those in water
stirred,
But clean hands in the actions that are right.
Water does not clean hands made of mere
clay,
But actions that can meet the cloud and
light.

29 For by You I can run against a troop, by
My God I can leap over a wall *set high*.
**30 God! His way's perfect, the words of
YHWH refined,
A shield is He to all such who are *not
blind*
To trust in Him. 31 For who is God,
except YHWH?**

And who's a rock, except our God? 32 *El God*
 Who arms me with strength, and makes my
way of sod
 Smooth. 33 He makes my feet like the *fleet*
feet of deer,
 And sets me on my high places. 34 *Without*
fear
 He teaches my hands to make war, so my
 arms
 Can bend a bow of bronze. 35 *In the face of*
harms
 You've also given me shield of salvation,
 Your right hand has held me up *with*
elation,
 Your gentleness has made me great. 36
 You enlarged
 My path under me, my feet *when they had*
charged
Did not slip. 37 I have pursued my
enemies
And overtaken them, neither did I please
To turn away again till they were
destroyed.
 38 I have wounded them, so they could not
 be buoyed,
 They have fallen under my feet. 39 For
 You've armed
 Me with strength for the battle, and You
have harmed
 Subduing under me who rose against me.
40 You have also given my foes' necks to
me,
So that I destroyed *all* those who hated
me.
 41 They cried out, but none saved, *they*
cried out to YHWH,
 But He did not answer them. 42 I beat them
too
 As fine as the dust before the wind, I cast
 Them out like *driven* dust in the streets
 amassed.
43 You have delivered me from a
striving folk,
You've made me the head of the nations
You spoke,
And a people I have not known shall
serve me.
 44 As soon as they hear of me they obey
 me,
 The foreigners submit to me, 45 fade away,

And come frightened from the hideouts
 where they stay.
 46 YHWH lives! Blessed *be* my Rock! Let
 be exalted
 The God of my salvation, and not faulted.
47 El El God avenges me, subdues the
folk
Beneath me, 48 delivers me from my
foes' stroke,
You also lift me up above those who rise
Against me, delivered me from who
despise.
 49 Therefore I'll give thanks to You, O
 YHWH, among
 The Gentiles, and praises to Your name
 I've sung.
 50 Great deliverance does He give to His
 king,
 Mercy to His anointed one does He bring,
 To David and his descendants *old and*
young.

Beloved, who ride upon the wings of wind,
 The wind invisible, undisciplined
 About my face, I lift these cheeks red with
 The stamping of Your horse's hooves
 (though myth),
 In hopes invisible though You must be,
 As are Your flying horses in the tree,
 That You will plant a passing kiss upon
 The one that holds You loved here in the
 dawn.
 A son of David I aspire to be
 As I recite the Psalms here in the lee
 Of passing winds and storms that bear Your
 name,
 Which though unseen, I praise it just the
 same.
 I sing this Sabbath in the month of fasting,
 Though wind pass, You, Beloved, are
 everlasting.

Psalm 19

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of
 David.

The heavens do declare the glory
Of El El God, and so the story
Of His handiwork's shown *indeed*
By firmament with all good speed.

2 Day unto day utters speech, and
 Night unto night reveals *the hand*

Of knowledge. 3 *There's no speech nor tongue*

Where their voice is not heard and sung.

4 Their line's gone out through all the earth,

And their words to the planet's girth.

In them He has set up a tent

For the sun, 5 like a bridegroom went

Out of his chamber, rejoicing

Like a strong man to run and spring.

6 Its rising's from one end of heaven,

Its circuit to the other ends,

And there is nothing, *even leaven,*

That's hidden from the heat *it sends.*

Some worship the sun that You've set
abroad

To light and warm the budding leaf on sod,
The bightness of gold and the flame of
fame

That flickers on the dusty page of game,
The lusty fire that springs up in the heart
To rage a while and all too soon depart.
The line of sun goes all around the earth
And shows that all men lie within one
berth.

Beloved, though I am bound to that round
where

The sun and star in circuit come to share
Obedience to You, I break the bands
And rush to You and come beneath Your
hands.

Though nothing's hidden from the solar
pass,

It is itself a witness of Your glass.

7 The law of YHWH *is* perfect, and

Converting the soul *to Your band,*

The testimony of YHWH's sure,

Making wise the simple *and pure,*

8 The statutes of YHWH, they are right,

Rejoicing the heart *in the night,*

The commandment of YHWH *is* pure,

Enlightening the eyes, 9 the fear

Of YHWH *is* clean, and shall appear

To everlasting, the judgments

Of YHWH *are* true and a defence,

And righteous altogether *too.*

10 More to be desired *they* than gold,

Yea, than fine gold, and sweeter too

Than honey and the honeycomb.

11 Moreover by them Your servant

Is warned, in keeping them *is* home

And great reward. 12 Who can with cant

Start to understand errors *sold?*

Cleanse me from secret *faults.* 13 Keep
back

Your servant from presumptuous tack,

Let them not have dominion on

Me, then I shall be blameless *drawn,*

And innocent of great transgression.

14 Let the words of my mouth's

confession

And meditation of my heart

Be acceptable on Your part,

O YHWH, my strength and my

Redeemer,

My strength, O YHWH, and my

Redeemer.

All things obey, Beloved, all things obey
Their maker in their going on their way.

The sun itself submits to Your command,

And only man thinks to resist Your hand.

All things obey, but all things do not love.

Your words upon my tongue with tastings
of

The sweetest honey all profess that I

Go past obedience to love, then die.

The weight of love displaces human will,

And shows it to be nothing but the mill

Of veiled illusions, let it die or live.

The only I I am is here to give

Itself to You, and so let always be

No I but You now and eternally.

Psalm 20

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of

David.

**May YHWH answer you in the day of
trouble,**

**May the name of the God of Jacob
double**

**Your defence, 2 May He send you help
from the *gate***

**Of the temple, and strengthen you where
you wait**

**Upon the fortress. 3 May He remember
all**

**Your offerings, accept holocaust *when*
*You call.***

4 May He grant you according to your heart's *wish*,
And fulfil all your purposes *with relish*.
5 We'll rejoice in Your salvation, in the name

Of our God we'll set up *our* banners' acclaim!

May YHWH fulfill all your requests in *His name*.

6 YHWH saves His anointed, and now that I know,

He'll answer him from His holy heaven's show,

And with the saving strength of His right hand *'s go*.

7 Some *trust* in chariots, and some in horses,

But we will remember where our great name is:

In YHWH our Alohim. 8 They bowed down and fell,

But we have arisen and stand upright *well*.

9 Save, YHWH! May the King answer us when we call.

I sacrifice myself upon the fire,
My bones are burnt and burnt is my desire.
Accept my sacrifice that rushes up,
A spark, a grape divided in the cup.
I fly to You as one small burning ash
That in a moment's time, a second flash,
Extinguishes in You, the star-filled night,
The silence of the universe, a slight
Thing, then a nothingness and then at last
The wholeness of the Undivided fast
And bound in glory and unchanging light,
Unfailing love and love burnished and bright.

I sacrifice myself upon the fire,
Accept my sacrifice is my desire.

Psalms 21

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

The king shall with *his* joy in Your strength outbid,

O YHWH, and in Your salvation how greatly

Shall he rejoice! 2 You have given him *freely*

His heart's desire, have not withheld the request

Of his lips. 3 For You meet him with goodness blessed,

You set a crown of pure gold upon his head.

4 He asked life from You, You gave it him *instead*

In length of days forever and forever.

5 His glory's great in Your salvation, honour

And majesty You've placed on *servitor*.

6 For You have made him most blessed forever,

You have made him exceedingly glad with Your Presence.

7 For the king trusts in YHWH, *indeed YHWH*, and through

The mercy of the Most High he shall not *true*

Be moved. 8 Your hand will find all Your enemies,

Your right hand will find those who hate You *to please*.

9 You shall make them as a fiery oven in The time of Your anger, then YHWH shall *begin*

To swallow them up in His wrath, and the fire

Shall devour them. 10 Their offspring You shall in ire

Destroy from the earth, and their descendants from

Among the sons of men. 11 Against You they come

Intending evil, they have devised a plot *Which* they are not able *to give their best shot*.

12 Therefore You will make them turn back, You will make

Ready on Your bowstring toward their faces' *sake*.

13 Be *now* exalted, O YHWH, in Your own strength!

We will sing and we shall praise Your power at length.

Ah, my Beloved, how do You put Your darts

Upon the bowstring, and despite their arts
Not one among Your enemies but feels

The sting of arrow to the heart and wheels
 In whirling, burning love to You alone!
 All men must come to bow before Your
 throne,
 And every enemy must feel the fire
 That burns all enmity and all desire.
 The king thus lays his crown upon the
 ground
 For love and joy and gladness he has found
 To be near You, before Your throne
 rejoicing
 With cherub choirs and seraph choirs a-
 voicing
 In heaven their praises while on earth the
 birds
 And beasts make joyful memory of Your
 words.

Psalm 22

1 To the Chief Musician. Set to "The Deer
 of the Dawn." A Psalm of David.

**My God, My God, why have You
 forsaken me?**

**Far from helping me, my words of
 agony?**

2 O my God, I cry in the daytime, but You
 Do not hear, and in the night time, it is true
 I am not silent. 3 But You *are* holy, and
 Dwelling in the praises of Israel's *hand*.

**4 Our fathers trusted in You, they
 trusted, and**

**You delivered them. 5 They cried to You,
 and were**

**Delivered, they trusted in You, and they
 were**

**Not ashamed. 6 But I *am* a worm, and no
 man,**

**A reproach of men, despised by those
 who can.**

7 All those who see me ridicule me, they
 shoot

Out the lip, they shake the head, *saying to
 boot,*

8 "He trusted in YHWH, let Him rescue
 him, let

Him deliver Him, He delights in Him yet!"

The sweet Messiah on the torture stake,
 Not to say heathen cross and so awake
 The prejudice of neighbour on the left,
 Sang this Psalm aloud when he felt bereft.

How many men sent from the throne divine
 With messages and actions in the wine
 Of revelation have felt all alone.

The crossly way is common if a groan.
 Beloved, I've met my crosses in the way
 Of my own throat in passages to sway,
 In those who trample me as they would
 climb

Illusions hill of wealth and fame sublime,
 In church and synagogue, in mosque and
 where

The faithful gather to engage in prayer.

9 But You *are* He who took me out of the
 womb,

You made me trust *while* on my mother's
 breasts' room.

10 I was cast upon You from birth, and
 from my

Mother's womb You *have been* my God
and so nigh.

**11 Be not far from me, for *now* trouble is
 near,**

**For *there is* none to help. 12 Many bulls
 for fear**

**Have surrounded me, strong *ones* of
 Bashan have**

**Encircled me. 13 They gape at me *with*
 their suave**

**Mouths, *like* a raging and roaring lion.
 14 I**

**Am poured out like water, and all my
 bones *shy***

**Are out of joint, my heart is like wax, it
 has**

**Melted within me. 15 My strength is
 dried up as**

**A potsherd, and my tongue clings to my
 jaws, You**

**Have brought me to the dust of death. 16
 For dogs do**

**Surround me, congregation of the
 unmeet**

**Has enclosed me, attacking my hands
 and feet,**

**17 I can count all my bones. They look,
 stare at me.**

18 They divide my garments among them
 freely,

And for my clothing they cast lots. 19 But
 You, O

YHWH, do not be far from me, O my
Strength, Oh,
Hasten to help me! 20 Deliver me from
sword,
My precious *life* from the power of the
dog's *lord*.

As dervish and a dog, I do protest
The use of such terms for those who're not
best!
And yet I know my own fussed doggish
ways
Are just as unrighteous as those in plays
For power and right. I hang my head in
shame
To hear You whistle when You call my
name.
I come with tail down, squirming where I
find
Your hand to pat my head, for You are
kind.
Beloved, let me, a wet dog, not ignite
A word against Your Messiah for night,
But let his struggles for the manly cross
Be in my heart successful to emboss
My flesh with an obedience to You
That's shown in love by everything I do.

21 Save me from the lion's mouth and from
the horns
Of the wild oxen! You've replied to my
bournes.
22 I will declare Your name to my brothers,
in

The assembly I will praise You *without sin*.

23 You who fear YHWH, praise Him!

All you descendants

**Of Jacob, glorify Him, and fear His
grants,**

**All you offspring of Israel! 24 For He has
not**

**Despised nor abhorred the affliction
that's wrought**

**On the afflicted, nor has He hidden His
Face from him, but when he cried to
Him, He is**

**The One to hear. 25 My praise *shall be* of
You in**

**The great assembly, I shall pay without
sin**

My vows before those who fear Him. 26

The poor shall

**Eat and be satisfied, those who seek Him
shall**

**Praise YHWH. And let your heart live
forever, *do!***

27 All the ends of the world shall
remember YHWH

And turn to Him, and all the families of
The nations shall worship before You *in
love*.

For the kingdom's YHWH's, He rules over
nations.

**29 All the prosperous of earth shall eat
rations**

**And worship, all those who go down to
the dust**

**Shall bow before Him, even he who must
trust**

**In You to keep himself alive. 30 A
remnant**

**Shall serve Him and be counted of the
Lord's grant**

**For a generation, 31 They'll come and
declare**

**His righteousness to a people *not yet
there***

**Who will be born, that He has made *this
His share*.**

The poor shall eat and thus be satisfied!

What promises the prophet notified!

Whole duty as it seems of humankind

Is just to eat, and bowing to earth find

To kiss the earth which gives the bread is
true

And righteous sacrifice and prayer to You.

O my Beloved, let me eat and be fat

And I shall tell the secret where You're at.

I am not one to keep myself alive,

But bow to dust and in my bowing strive

To find You here before the cunning dogs,

The lions and wild oxen catch my clogs.

Beloved, enthroned in praises that I sing,

Let my breath fly with You as You take
wing.

Psalms 23

1 A Psalm of David. YHWH *is* my
shepherd, I

Shall never *be in* need. 2 He makes me to lie
Down in green pastures, He leads me beside still
Waters. 3 He restores my soul, *and without chill*
He leads me in the paths of righteousness for
His name's sake. 4 Indeed, though I walk *on before*
Through the valley and through the shadow of death,
I will fear no evil, for You *give me breath*,
Your rod and staff, they comfort me. 5 You prepare
A table before me in the presence where
Are my enemies, You pour oil on my head,
My cup is overflowing. 6 *As I am led*
Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me
All the days of my life, and so I shall be
Living in the house of YHWH forever *free*.

Your house is made of Psalms sung by the likes
Of me. I give You only breath in spikes,
While You give me a place to rest and feed,
Deep waters and whatever I may need.
You give me paths of divine law and more,
You take me there and back from death's bare shore.
You guide with comfort, and You give both meat
And drink in safety from the brawling street.
The oil of mercy and the cup of good
Accompany my footsteps where they should.
All these and more make up the palace where
I live on earth below the gates of air.
All these I need to make a home, but You
Are satisfied to live where I say YHWH.

You are a shepherd, if David's bright words
Have weight against a morning filled with light
Winging upon a sky after the night
Has turned from silence to the voice of birds.

Many are those shepherds of flocks and herds
You send out on the barren hills to fight
Sometimes for danger, sometimes for the right,
But always in bare boredom on the sherds.
"Effendim" said the man who kept the sheep,
Piling flatbread with succulent cold meat.
Hours on the hillside and I knew his song.
Everywhere such are bottom of the heap,
Robbed of the right to read, unseen to greet.
Do You look like a shepherd to the throng?

Psalm 24

1 A Psalm of David. The earth's YHWH's,
And all its fullness, world and those
Who live there. 2 For He's founded it
Upon the seas, and made to sit
Upon the waters. 3 Who may go
Up to the hill of YHWH? Or who
May stand in His holy place? 4 He
Who has clean hands and a pure heart,
Who has not lifted up his part
To idol, sworn deceitfully.
**5 He shall receive blessing from YHWH,
And righteousness from the God true
Of his salvation. 6 This is Jacob,
The generation who will wake up
To seek Him, and who seek Your face.**
7 Be raising up your tops, you gates!
Be lifted up, eternal doors!
The King of glory *who awaits*
Shall enter in the corridors.
**8 Who is this King of glory? YHWH
Strong and mighty, the mighty YHWH
In battle. 9 Be lifting your tops,
O you gates! Lift up where it drops
The everlasting doors! The King
Of glory shall come in *and sing*.**
**10 Who is this King of glory? YHWH
Of hosts, He's King of glory true.**

I come with hands washed clean in that
ablution
That prophets' long have taught for
distribution
To faithful and untried. I bring my prayer
To temple and to throne in gate of air
In lawful and appropriate prostration.

My literal and humble soul and nation
 Do not distinguish from the spirit act,
 But follow and perform the simple fact.
 And You, Beloved, draw near to such as I,
 Once they have lifted not the hand to sky
 Nor idol for Your name, nor sworn to do
 And failed to carry out the sworn and true.
 And so I pray You enter in the door
 Where I bow down with forehead on the
 floor.

Psalm 25

1 A Psalm of David. To You, YHWH,
 I lift up my soul, 2 Trust in You,
 My Alohim let me not be
 Ashamed, let not my enemy
 Triumph over me. 3 Indeed, let
 None waiting on You be ashamed,
 Let those be ashamed *and be blamed*
 Who deal treacherously no fret.

**4 Show me Your ways, O YHWH, teach
 me**

**Your paths. 5 Lead me in Your truth
*free***

**And teach me, for You *are* the God
 Of my salvation, on Your rod
 I wait all day. 6 Remember, YHWH,
 The tender mercies that You do
 And Your lovingkindnesses, for
 They *are* from of old *and from yore*.**

Remember, if You will, Beloved, and note
 The times when my heart twined with
 Yours to dote

On You alone. Remember, if You will,
 Or mind not those times on the darkly hill
 When I forgot to glory in You still.
 My youth is filled with days forgetful and
 With actions that I should never have
 planned,
 And yet my breath from birth has always
 caught

Your sacred Name without having been
 taught.

You are alone my teacher in the rude
 And simple way I walk without a brood.
 And yet I find with memory or not
 Your guidance is a thing so starkly wrought
 That it serves as my only drink and food.

7 Do not remember youthful sins

Of my days and their outs and ins,
 Nor my transgressions, bear in mind
 Me by Your mercy *unconfined*,
 And for Your goodness' sake, O YHWH.
 8 For righteous and upright *is* YHWH,
 He teaches sinners in the way.
 9 The humble He guides *every day*
 In justice, and the humble He
 Teaches His way. 10 All the paths *free*
 Of YHWH *are* mercy and truth, to
 Such as keep His covenant true
 And all of His testimonies.

11 For Your name's sake, O YHWH, no
 please

Pardon my iniquity, for
 It *is* great. 12 Who *is* the man more
 Who fears YHWH? He'll teach him the
 way

He chooses. 13 He shall live his day
 As prosperous, and his descendants
 Shall inherit the earthly pendants.

**14 The secret of YHWH *is* with those
 Who fear Him, it is He who shows
 Them His covenant. 15 My eyes *are*
 Always toward YHWH *like a star*,
 For He shall pluck my feet from net.**

16 Turn back to me, and on me set
 Your mercy, for I'm desolate
 And afflicted. 17 The troubled state
 Of my heart is enlarged, bring me
 Out of my distresses *and free!*

18 Look on my affliction and pain,
 Forgive all my sins *and their stain*.

**19 Consider my foes, they *are* many,
 And they hate me cruelly with any
 Hatred. 20 Keep my soul, and deliver,
 Let me not be ashamed *or quiver*,
 For I put *all* my trust in You.**

21 Let my integrity and true
 Uprightness preserve me, for I
 Wait for You. 22 Redeem Israel nigh,
 O Alohim, from every sight!

I merely wait in silence for Your word,
 In my own silence is my spirit stirred.
 Some think remembrance is to say Your
 name
 Again and once again, always the same.
 But Your remembrance is not speech of
 mine,

But divine speech beyond world and its sign.

The true remembrance is the word You speak

In mercy to the soul that comes to seek
Instruction in the way and turning round
To leave the evil act, and thought, and sound.

Remembrance is that You repeat my name,
Not that I whirl in gratifying game.
Remember me, Beloved, in mercy yet,
Perchance I also shall fail to forget.

Psalm 26

1 A Psalm of David. Judge me, YHWH,
For I have walked right *before You*.

**I have also trusted in YHWH,
I shall not slip. 2 Examine me,
O YHWH, and prove me, try my mind
And heart. 3 For You are loving-kind
Before my eyes, and as You see
I have walked in Your truth *not blind*.**

4 I've not sat with idolatrous,
Nor will I join with garrulous
Hypocrites. 5 I have hated the
Wicked and evil assembly,
And will not sit with the wicked.

6 I will wash hands *of what I hid*
In innocence, so I will walk
About Your altar, *and not balk*,
O YHWH, 7 and that I may proclaim
With grateful voice Your marvels' fame.
**8 YHWH, I have loved the habitation
Of Your house, and the place *and station*
Where dwells Your glory. 9 Do not
gather**

**My soul with sinners, nor life *rather*
With bloodthirsty men, 10 in whose
hands**

***Is a sinister scheme and bands,
And whose right hand is full of bribes.***

11 But as for me, *as love prescribes*,
I'll walk in my integrity,
Redeem, be merciful to me.

12 My foot stands in an even place,
And in the congregations' trace,
I will bless YHWH *eternally*.

Since I do not sit with the wicked people,
Nor with the evildoers under steeple,
And since I do not enter hypocrites'

Mosque nor the synagogue where sinner
sits,

And yet my soul, Beloved, adores Your
house

Above the palaces of king and mouse,
Then show me congregations and the place,
The even place that spreads out from Your
face.

I walk in my integrity, be sure,
But I find no church made up of the pure,
Unless it is the church where You alone
Stand to be worshipped, and not gold or
stone.

To enter that place and its altar I
Give up myself and let my own will die.

Psalm 27

1 A Psalm of David. YHWH's my light
And my salvation, whom *in sight*
Shall I fear? YHWH is my life's strength,
Of whom shall be afraid *at length*?

**2 When the wicked came against me
To eat up my flesh, enemy
And my foes stumbled, fell *sadly*.**

**3 Though armies encamp against me,
My heart shall not fear, though war
should**

**Rise against me, in this *one good*
I will be confident. 4 One thing
I have desired for YHWH *to bring*,
That will I seek: that I may live
In house of YHWH *no fugitive*
All the days of my life, behold
The beauty of YHWH, things untold
To inquire in His temple. 5 For
In time of trouble He shall hide
Me in His pavilion *and floor*,
In His tent's secret place He'll bide
Me, He shall set me high upon
A rock. 6 And now my head *withdrawn*
Shall be uplifted above my
Enemies all around I spy,
Therefore I'll offer sacrifice
Of joy in His pavilion's *spice*,
I will sing, yes, I will sing praise
To YHWH *forever and always*.**

Beloved, do not hide me within your tent!
I'm not an Arab wife who's only meant
To be seen by her husband and her brother.
Do not hide me away to sink and smother!

First take away my vain desires to be
Known by the vagrant multitudes that see
Their idols swell and gyrate on the stage.
Free me first from such pride before the
cage.

When I am hidden from myself at last
And known only to Your Self in the blast,
Then hide me in the darkened comfort of
Your private tent and sacred springs of
love.
Beloved, once hidden, set me on Your rock
To view a grand horizon and take stock.

I inquire in Your temple with the word
Of Baqir hidden in my heart of bird,
The dove upon my bosom, and I wait
To let it fly out living for its mate.
Inquiring in the Hebrew turns at last
To splitting verdicts in the burning blast
Of questioning and doubting that You stand
Alone as Sovereign King in every land.
Beloved, I catch Muhammad Baqir's hand
And race to find the better light to show
The way across the desert where I go.
Beloved, I catch the hand that bent the
bow.

The temple sweeps above me in its glow,
And shines first gold, then crimson in its
band.

7 Hear, YHWH, *when* I cry with my voice!
Have mercy also on my choice,
And answer me. 8 *When You said*, "Seek
My face," my heart said from Your week,
"Your face, YHWH, I will seek." 9 Do not
Hide Your face from me, and do not
Turn Your servant away in wrath,
You have been my help on the path,
Do not leave me nor forsake me,
O God of my salvation free.

**10 When my father and mother shall
Forsake me, then YHWH *eternal*
Will take me up. 11 Teach me Your way,
O YHWH, lead me in a smooth path,
Because of my enemies' *fray*.**

12 Do not deliver me to wrath
Of adversaries, false witness
Has risen on me to oppress,
And such as breathe out violence.

**13 *Lost I should be and without sense*
Unless I had believed that I**

**Would see the goodness of YHWH by
The land of the living. 14 Wait on
YHWH, be of good courage *at dawn*,
And He shall strengthen your heart,
wait,
I say, on YHWH, *and not be late!***

Some sink the hopeful sight on things past
looking

For Your goodness once raised in what's
been cooking.

Some hope in worlds of justice to be fair
When mahdis and messiahs shall be there.
My strength and life is in my waiting now
To find Your face of goodness in the
plough.

Who find You not instead of petty gain
And quarrel on the sunny side and rain,
Who find You not today shall seek in vain
Your footprints on earth's yesterdays of
pain,

Your healing balms tomorrow on the dole.
The path to death is long before the soul,
But path to You and life is just a point:
It's now alone the graces can anoint.

Psalm 28

1 A Psalm of David. To You I
Will cry, O YHWH my Rock *and tie*:
Do not be silent to me, lest,
If You *are* silent to my *rest*,
I become like those who go down
To the pit. 2 Hear, *beneath your crown*,
My supplications' voice when I
Cry to You, when I lift up my
Hands toward Your holy temple's *sway*.
**3 Don't take me with wicked away,
With workers of iniquity,
Who speak peace to their neighbours
free,**

But evil's in their hearts *and hand*.

4 Give them what their bad deeds demand,
According to the wickedness
Of their endeavours, come to bless
Them according to their hands' work,
Render them their desert for shirk.

**5 Because they don't regard the work
Of YHWH, nor action of His hands,
He shall destroy them *in their bands*
And not build them up *in their stands*.**

6 Blessed *be* YHWH, because He has heard

Voice of my supplications' word!
 7 YHWH *is* my strength, He is my shield,
 My heart trusted in Him, appealed
 To Him and I am helped, therefore
 My heart greatly rejoices, for
 With my song I will praise Him. 8 YHWH
Is their strength, and He *is* the *crew*
 Of saving refuge of His own
 Anointed. 9 Save Your people *shown*,
 And bless Your inheritance, and
 Shepherd them too, always in hand.

The Psalmist makes complaint that when
 You speak
 The human ears hear not the sounds they
 seek.
 Your silence is the problem in the show:
 If You would speak more constantly, we'd
 know
 That You are there to see, to judge, to aid.
 Beloved, You need to go on flash parade.
 If we could only hear You in the dark,
 And understand Your message in the park,
 If we could only have a radio
 Transmission of Your music and tango,
 Then we would be more likely to remember
 To do what You tell us to in December.
 You are too quiet for this age of brash,
 You need to advertise, lay on the cash.

Psalm 29

1 A Psalm of David. Give to YHWH,
 O you mighty ones, give to YHWH
 Glory and strength. 2 Give unto YHWH
 The glory that to His name's due,
 Worship YHWH in holy beauty.

**3 The voice of YHWH *thunderously*
Sounds over the waters, glorious
 God thunders, YHWH over the fuss
 Of many waters. 4 Voice of YHWH
Is powerful in *thunder true*,
 The voice of YHWH in majesty
Of His thunders sounded fully.**

**5 The voice of YHWH breaks cedars,
 yes,**

YHWH splinters Lebanon's address.

6 He makes them also skip like calf,
 Lebanon and Sirion *to laugh*
 Like young wild ox. 7 The voice of YHWH
 Divides the flames of fire *in crew*.

8 The voice of YHWH shakes wilderness,

YHWH shakes in Kadesh wilderness.

**9 The voice of YHWH makes deer bear
 young,**

**And strips the forests bare, and sung
 In His temple all shout, "Glory!"**

10 YHWH sat *upon* the flood *to see*,
 And YHWH sits King eternally.

11 YHWH will give strength to His folk,
 YHWH

Will bless His folk with Islam's *dew*.

O my Beloved, the faith that You have
 given

Needs not to leave a single soul unshriven.

The strength You gave to Adam was a joy

To labour on the earth and field, employ

His days and nights in cantillation of

Your holy names with obedience and love.

The covenant and blessing that you gave

To Abraham brought forth from being
 slave
 The people working Egypt's land for
 naught.

From Flood of earth to Red Sea's flood

were brought

The people of Your strength and blessing.

Now

Beyond strength, blessing and salvation
 how

You cap the edifice of faith with peace!

In strength and blessing may it never cease.

Psalm 30

1 A Psalm. A Song at the dedication of the
 house of David.

Now I shall extol You, O YHWH,

For You have lifted me up *true*,

And have not let my foes rejoice

Over me with triumphant voice.

2 O YHWH my God, I cried to You,

And You healed me. 3 And so, O YHWH,

You brought my soul up from the grave,

You've kept me alive, that *as slave*

I should not go down to the pit.

**4 Sing praise to YHWH, You saints *most*
*fit***

Of His, and give thanks zikr held

Of His holy name *unbeheld*.

5 For His anger's a moment *brief*,

His favour life *in its relief*,

Weeping may endure for a night,

But joy *comes* in the morning *light*.

6 In my prosperity I said,

“I shall never be moved, *though led*.”

7 YHWH, by Your favour You have made

My mountain stand strong for my shade,

You hid Your face, I was distraught.

8 I cried out to You *in my plot*,

O YHWH, and to YHWH I have made

My supplication *unafraid*.

You hid Your face, and I was troubled, yet

You are not One, Belovèd, lightly met.

You hide Your face that I be led to cry

Allahu akbar, and repeating sigh

The heart full longing for my divine Friend,

My breath calls You and Huu and does not end.

Through weeping of a night I call Your name,

And morning joy is just more of the same.

Allahu akbar, You are greater far

Than all the round world’s joys and sorrows are.

My mountain stands from birth to death as firm

As life is fleeting, dogwood white in germ

Or red in autumn, oak and maple full,

Belovèd, You are greater miracle.

9 “What profit *is there* in my blood,

When I go down to the pit’s *flood*?

Will the dust praise You and declare

Your truth *in hearing everywhere*?

10 Hear, O YHWH, have mercy on me, YHWH, be my helper *faithfully*!”

11 You’ve turned mourning to dance for me,

You’ve put off my sackcloth freely And clothed me with gladness to be,

12 To the end that glory may sing

Praise to You and in silence ring.

O YHWH my God, to You I’ll give

Thanks always as long as I live.

Some people expect to rise in the air

As spirit beings when the body’s stair

Is cast aside. Belovèd, that may be true

For all I know of nature in the crew.

Some people think the blood spilled on the ground

Is useful to the God or gods around

Who thirst for fleshly pots and when they get

The treat forgive the sins against those set

To be the victims of grief, greed and let.

Instead I lift a voice to cantillate

Your name and praise and Your divine estate,

And for the present reward stop and wait,

Expecting no more in the course of hope

For punishment or pay beyond this scope.

Psalms 31

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

In You, O YHWH, I put my trust,

Let me not be ashamed *in dust*,

Deliver me in righteousness.

2 Bow down Your ear to my distress,

Deliver me quickly, and be

My rock of refuge, a fortress

Of my strong defence to save me.

3 For You *are* my rock and You *are*

My fortress, therefore, be not far

For Your name’s sake, lead me, guide me.

4 Pull me out of the net which they

Have secretly laid in my way,

For You *are* my strength *day to day*.

5 Into Your hand my spirit I

Commit, *and though I groan and sigh*,

You’ve redeemed me, YHWH God of truth.

6 I have hated whom without ruth

Regard vain idols, but I trust

In YHWH. 7 I will be glad and must

Rejoice in Your mercy, for You

Have considered my trouble, You

Have known my soul’s adversities,

8 And have not shut me in the hand

Of any of my enemies,

You’ve set my feet in a wide place,

And made me stand before Your face.

How many at the moment of their death,

When they see ending of the loan of breath,

Commend the spirit into Your hand till

You shall call back to life and at the spill

They must return to that one face that’s set

Divinely for all creatures to have met.

How many at that moment quote the word

Of commendation with a heart that's stirred!

Beloved, let me say the word now though I Perceive no end of life that has come by.

Around me I see only life and health,
The gathering of morning's gold in wealth,
The soft return of evening in its stealth,
Yet I commend my spirit to Your net.

9 Have mercy on me, YHWH, for I Am in distress, and so my eye Wastes away with grief, *yes*, my soul And my body! 10 For my life whole Is spent with grief, and my years sighing, My strength fails because *I am dying* In my iniquity, and my Bones waste away. 11 *And here* am I Reproach among my enemies, Especially as my neighbour sees, And *am* repulsive to those who Know me, and *also all* those who See me outside flee from me *too*.

**12 I am forgotten like the dead,
Out of mind, like a broken shred.**

**13 For I hear the slander of many,
Fear is on every side *and any*,
While they take counsel against me,
They scheme to take my life *in fee*.**

14 But as for me, I trust in You, O YHWH, I say, "My God is You"

The reason everyone around here schemes To take my life is simply for the dreams Illusive for reality. All think

The self within is the Almighty brink,
The very god of power and universe,
The one and only, so that self must curse
Every self that in competition comes
To multiply from one the divine sums.
Truth is there is no self existent but
The one Self of You, my Beloved, and what

Is its perfection and love thrown upon
The screen of néant and the shining dawn.
All selves are but reflections of the true,
And all reveal in truth nothing but You.

15 My times *are* in Your hand, and so Deliver me from hand of foe,
And from those who persecute me.
16 Make Your face also shine on me

Your servant, for Your mercies' sake
Save me. 17 And do not let me shake
Ashamed, O YHWH, for I have called
Upon You, let the wicked walled
Be ashamed, let them in the grave
Be silent. 18 And now let the glaive
Of lying lips in silence be,
Which speak insolent things proudly,
Against the righteous in contempt.

19 How great *is* Your goodness *undreamt*,
Which You have laid up for those who
Fear You, *and which* You have prepared
For *all of* those who trust in You
In presence of the sons of men!

**20 You'll hide them in the secret laired
Of Your presence from plots of men,
You'll keep them secretly in tent
From the strife of tongues *where they went*.**

21 Blessed *be* YHWH, for He has shown me

In a strong place marvellously
His kindness. 22 For I said in haste,
"I'm cut off from before Your eyes,"
Nevertheless You heard the *paced*
Voice of my supplications' *cries*
When I cried out to You *in faints*.

23 Oh, love YHWH, all of you His saints!
For YHWH preserves the faithful, and
Fully repays the proud one's hand.

24 Be of good courage, and He'll make
Your heart strong for all your hopes' sake,
All of you who hope in YHWH's *stake*.

I see, Beloved, why You have so seen fit
To hide Your anointed one from the wit
And persecution of the milling crowd.
If he should walk the streets and talk aloud,
The very righteous would come out to strike

Him down. This generation is like shriek.
And yet his spirit is not one to take
Lightly, for he lacks all the give and take
Of sweetness in the competitive stake.
The judgement of his mere humility
Suffices to make blind those who now see.
If You Yourself in mercy hide that we
Might not be struck down with Your bright glory,

He hides a humble heart in his mercy.

Psalm 32

1 A Psalm of David and a contemplation.
Blessed *is the one* forgiven *his*
transgression,

Whose sin is covered, 2 and blessed *is the*
man

To whom YHWH does not impute a
wicked span,

And in whose soul *there arises* no deceit.

**3 When I kept silent, my bones grew old,
complete**

**Because of my sad groaning all the day
long.**

4 For day and night Your hand was heavy
and strong

On me, my life turned into the summer
drought.

**5 I acknowledged my sin to You, and my
thought**

**Of wickedness I have not hidden. I said,
“I’ll confess my transgressions to
YHWH as led,”**

**And You forgave the wickedness of my
sin.**

6 For this cause everyone who’s godly’ll
begin

To pray to You in a time when You are
found,

Surely in great floods they’ll not stand on
His ground.

Beloved, in every way I turn I find
Your face, in every time and breath I mind
That You hear prayer. And yet I know the
day

Is marked by Your commanded hours to
pray.

There is a note when You are found in
waiting,

Who know not time’s arising and abating,
But stand upon eternity. You show

Your face by day and night who do not go
Nor come, begin nor end. And yet there is
A moment when the sun sets on Cadiz

That You hear prayer. Who look for You in
vain

Throughout a stumbling, dazzled world in
pain,

Stop at the moment, look toward Your
house

And find You worshipped by the gnat and
grouse.

7 You my hiding place, You shall preserve
me

From trouble, You surround me with
minstrelsy

Of deliverance. 8 I’ll instruct you and teach
The way to go led as far as My eyes *reach*.

I questioned You, as did my neighbours
too.

They heard Your voice, they saw the
leading of

Your master plan, they felt Your grace and
love:

You told them everything to think and do.

I questioned You the way that I should go
And waited in the fragrance of fresh dew

On lilies-of-the-valley where they grew
Beside my unpaved road. There was no
show

Of thunder, miracle or sign, or even

The still small voice divine. I was bereft

In every way. I’d only silence left,

No vision as had Daniel or Stephen.

And yet I tread a heavenly threshold while
Your unseen eye turns on the rank and file.

9 Do not be like the horse, *don’t be* like the
mule,

Without discernment, which must be set to
rule

Of bit and bridle, else they’ll not come near
you.

10 Many sorrows *shall be* to the wicked
crew,

But he who trusts in YHWH, mercy shall
surround.

**Be glad in YHWH and rejoice, you
righteous found,**

**And shout for joy, all upright in heart
and sound!**

Beloved, the horse is beautiful and fine,
Although he’s more obedient in line

Than clever. Yet his beauty is enough

To bring forgiveness since he has no scruff.

A mule is even better in the way
It turns the field of clover into hay.

Do You imagine people of my sort

Are better than these animals in sport?
 Indeed, without a bridle I resort
 To Your remembrance daily, yet my mind
 Finds You for only the brief second blind
 And then goes on through breath to death
 resigned.
 I see the divine spark flash by and I
 Return into the dark beneath the sky.

Psalm 33

1 Rejoice in YHWH, O you righteous!
 Praise from the upright's beauteous.
 2 Praise YHWH with the harp, melody
 Make to Him with an instrument
 Of ten strings. 3 Sing to Him newly
 With song, play with dexterity
 And with a shout of joy augment.
**4 Because the word of YHWH is right,
 And all His work is in truth's light.**
**5 He loves righteousness and justice,
 The earth is full of YHWH's goodness.**
 6 By the word of YHWH skies were made,
 And all the host of them were stayed
 By the breath of His mouth *relayed*.
 7 He gathers waters of the sea
 Together as a heap, and He
 Lays up the deep in storehouses.
**8 Let all the earth fear YHWH and His,
 Let all the world's inhabitants
 Stand in awe of Him at His glance.**
 9 For He spoke, and it was *done*, He
 Commanded, and it stood firmly.
 10 YHWH brings the counsel of the nations
 To nothing, He makes plans *and stations*
 Of the peoples of no effect.
**11 The counsel of YHWH stands select
 Forever, the plans of His heart
 To all generations apart.**

You speak, Beloved, and every thing is
 done.
 You do not need nine months to sire a son,
 But word's enough, and Your anointed is.
 If anything, You are creation's whiz.
 I step out on the leafy ground and rain
 Where autumn sings its songs as though in
 pain,
 And see the thousand greys the sky is made
 Below the places where Your hand has
 stayed.
 I join the round of all creation's sound

In their remembrance on the bursting
 ground,
 And set my ten strings to recite the note
 That once drew light and air, and on sky
 wrote
 The suns and moons that linger with their
 torch.
 Before I sleep I step out on the porch.

12 Blessed the nation whose God is
 YHWH,
 The people He has chosen *true*
 As His own inheritance *due*.
**13 YHWH looks from heaven, He sees all
 The sons of men, 14 and from the hall
 Of His dwelling He looks on all
 The earth's inhabitants as small,
 15 He fashions their hearts one by one,
 He considers all their works done.**
 16 No king is saved by multitude
 Of arms, a mighty man renewed
 To salvation by his great strength.
**17 A horse is a vain hope at length
 For safety, neither shall it save
 By being powerful and brave.**

I think that David must despise the horse.
 He keeps on speaking against it in course
 Of prophecy and praise, eternal song.
 I quite agree, as a vehicle strong
 For movement or for military wrong.
 A horse cannot save, no, not from a throng
 Of wicked ones invading all along
 The city walls and gates. But still the beast
 Is bright-eyed, running like wind when
 released.
 Though neither horse nor arm of man can
 save
 Despite the rush to rage among the brave,
 The both reflect the beauty that I crave
 From Your heart and Your throne above
 the mass
 Of tinsel and of sparkle of the crass.

18 Behold, the eye of YHWH is on
 Those who fear Him, and on *their spawn*
 Who hope in His mercy *and grace*,
 19 To save their soul from death's
 embrace,
 And to keep them alive in want.

**20 Our soul waits for YHWH, and will
vaunt**

In Him our help and our snug shield.

21 For our heart shall rejoicing yield

To Him, because we've trusted in

His holy name to keep from sin.

22 Let Your mercy, YHWH, be on us,
As we hope in Your radius.

Indeed You see all living things on high,
Because it is Your sight that makes them
try

To be and become in the universe.
Without Your seeing they would all be
worse,

The mere flight of a failing breath of sky.
Indeed You see all men and women here,
None can escape from Your eye and appear
In hidden places to think, act, and speak.
Without Your seeing all men are but weak
Reflections of the rippling waters' bound
Away to disappear in ocean's sound.
Beloved, You see and I become at last,
You hide Your face and my being is past,
You are eternal in the lightning's blast.

Psalms 34

1 A Psalm of David when he feigned
Madness before Abimelech,
Who drove him away and disdained,
And he departed. I will bless
YHWH at all times, His praise *confess*
Always by mouth *along my trek*.

**2 My soul shall make its boast in
YHWH,**

**The humble shall hear it on cue
And be glad. 3 Oh, magnify YHWH
With me saying 'The Lord is great',
Let us exalt His name in state.**

Together down the row of congregants
I hear the words in tones of resonance
Repeated, whispered by the few who will,
Loud sounding by the others, none are still,
But all say You are greater than the days
And ways that make our humble lives and
stays,

That You are greater than all human
thought

And needs no matter with what power
they're wrought,

That You are greater than the universe
That has no purpose better than or worse
To raise aloft Your name and fame because
You are mighty even above Your laws.
The humble hear of it and they are glad
To hear You praised with every voice we
had.

4 I sought YHWH, and He has heard me,
And saved me from all my fears' *plea*.

5 They looked to Him with radiant eyes,
And their faces were not ashamed.

**6 This poor man cried out with surprise,
And YHWH heard and saved him
unblamed**

Out of all his troubles replies.

I too look at You, my Beloved to see
With radiant eyes the One's eternity,
The hope of gnat and fly and bumblebee.
I too look for You without call to shame,
Remembering now to declare Your name
With each breath I breathe in the humble
game

Of forest, glen and boulder under flame
Of painted cloud and dome of sky for wear.
I too look to You, my Beloved and share
Of life and love and faith and charity.
Beloved, I look with radiant eyes and find
Salvation without sacrifice to bind,
With nothing to give merit to my claim
But Your grace only upon land and sea.

7 The angel of YHWH encamps all
Around those who fear Him *and call*,
And saves them. 8 Oh, taste *now* and see
That YHWH *is* good, and blessed *be*
The man *who* trusts in Him! 9 Oh, fear
YHWH, you His saints! No wants appear
To those who fear Him. 10 And the young
Lions lack and suffer on *tongue*
With hunger, but those who seek YHWH
Shall not lack any good *thing due*.

**Come, you children, listen to me,
I'll teach you fear of YHWH sweetly.
Who is the man who desires life,
And loves many days without strife,
That he may see good? 13 Keep your
tongue**

**From evil, and your lips from rung
Of speaking treachery. 14 Depart**

**From evil and do good, seek art
Of peace and pursue it. 15 The eyes
Of YHWH are on the righteous wise,
And His ears open to their cry.**

The face of YHWH's against the sty
Of those who do evil, to cut
Off their remembrance from the rut
Of earth. 17 *The righteous* cry out, and
YHWH hears, delivers from the hand
Of all their troubles. 18 YHWH *is* near
To those of broken heart *and fear*,
And saves such as have contrite spirit.

**19 Many afflictions may come near it
But the righteous YHWH saves from all.
20 He guards all his bones *should he fall*,
Not one of them is broken there.**

21 Evil shall slay the wicked share,
And those who hate the righteous shall
Be condemned *alphabetical*.

**22 YHWH redeems the soul of His
slaves,
And none of those shall suffer staves
Who trust in Him nor be condemned,
But rather with honour begemmed.**

They say in the gospels that have been set
In churchly canons for the righteous met
That no bone of the son of David broke
When Roman soldiers came by on the
stroke.

Like Paschal lamb he was lifted up whole
While soldiers of the cross gambled the
dole,

Dividing up the spoil with joke and word
That echoes everywhere and is still heard.
Some say that You saved him from death
and took

Him back to be with You in safety's nook,
And so no bone was broken though he
shook.

But I say that that evil come to slay
Your Christ or any other in the play,
Beyond destruction I see divine ray.

Psalms 35

A Psalm of David.

**1 Plead my cause, O YHWH, with those
who strive with me,
And fight well against those who fight
against me.**

2 Take hold of shield and buckler, stand for
my help.

3 Draw out also the spear, stop pursuing
whelp.

Say to my soul, "I'm your salvation
begun."

**4 Let those be shamed and dishonour
garrison**

**Of those who seek my life, let those be
turned back**

**And brought to confusion who plot my
attack.**

5 Let them be like chaff before the wind,
and let

The angel of YHWH chase *them*. 6 Let
their way get

Dark and slippery, and let the angel of
YHWH

Pursue them. 7 For without cause they
would construe

Their net for me *in* a pit, *which* they have
dug

Without cause for my life. 8 Let destruction
hug

Him unexpectedly, and let his dire net

That he has hidden catch himself *in the set*,
Into that very destruction let him fall.

**9 And my soul shall be joyful in
YHWH's recall,**

**And it shall rejoice in His salvation. 10
All**

**My bones shall say, "YHWH, who is like
You, saving**

**The poor ones from those who are too
strong for wing,**

**Indeed, the poor and needy from
plunderer?"**

11 Fierce witnesses rise up, and they would
concur

To ask me *things* that I do not know. 12
They give

Me evil for good, *to* sorrow where I live.

Indeed, I've got the evil for my share

Instead of the good that I brought to bear,
And by that token I come in to keep

The company of David's son with sheep.
Indeed, when I've done good, a rare thing

too,
Reward upon my head has been the shoe,
But that's as may be typical in state

Where president and priest both come to
mate.

Beloved, I flee to You, where only's found
The glory of creation in the bound

Of forest laced with birch on morning wing
Through noon at last at evening where they
sing

Who look for nothing better than Your day,
The trudging through the hours beneath
your sway.

13 But as for me, when they were sick, I
was dressed

In sackcloth, I humbled myself, fasting
breast,

And my prayer returned to my own heart
unblessed.

14 I paced round as though *he were* my
friend *confessed*

Or brother, I bowed down heavily, as one
Who mourns *for his own mother and is*
undone.

**15 But when trouble hit me they rejoiced
to be**

**Gathered together, attackers against me,
And I did not know *it*, they tore *sore at*
*me***

**And did not stop, 16 ungodly mockers at
feasts**

**They gnashed me with their teeth of
*ravenous beasts.***

17 O YHWH, how long will You look on?
Rescue me

From their destructions, my darling *devotee*
From the lions. 18 And I will give You the
thanks

In the great assembly, I'll praise You in
ranks.

**19 Let then my wrongful foes rejoice
over me,**

**Nor let them wink the eye who wrongly
hate me.**

O YHWH, how long is what the Psalmist
cries,

And that's because all human's realize
That time is the chain that catches the eyes
Created on earth to look for the prize.

O YHWH, how long is what the prayer
must say

That's caught in rounds of night and noon
and day,

And punctuates the brief life of the will
With prostrations upon the sacred hill.

Beloved, I too say how long in the fray,
How long does fleeting breath and word
give way

To hopelessness, if that were just the
sound.

Fact is, to hope all men are chained and
bound.

Free me from time, Beloved, and hope, and
I

Will find You visible beneath the sky.

20 For they speak no peace, but in deceit
devise

Matters against *the* quiet ones in the land.

21 They also opened against me their
mouth grand

And said, "Aha, aha! Our eyes have seen
it."

**22 *This* You have seen, O YHWH, do not
keep quiet.**

**O Lord, do not be far from me. 23 Stir
You up,**

Awake to my vindication, my cause' cup,
My God and my Lord. 24 Vindicate me, O
YHWH

My God, according to Your righteousness
do,

And let them not rejoice over me. 25 Let
them

Not say in their hearts, "Ah, so's our
stratagem!"

And let them not say "We have swallowed
him up."

**26 Let them be ashamed and brought
into the cup**

**Of confusion *all* who rejoice at my hurt,
Let them be clothed with shame *as is*
*their desert***

**And dishonour who exalt them against
me.**

27 Let them shout for joy and be glad, *who*
sweetly

Favour my righteous cause, let them always
say

"Let YHWH be magnified [Allahu akbar],
who has pleasure's sway

In the prosperity of His servant's *song.*"

28 And I'll sing Your right and Your praise
all day long.

I have no tongue to praise You all day long,
O my Beloved, yet so says here the song
That David sang. So let my breath repeat
Unthinkingly that praise, I do entreat,
When I have turned to find my bread and
drink

And found my daily words and deeds to
think.

I kindle in my heart Your praise with
tongue

And when tongue's still the praises still are
sung

Within the burning love remaining there.

My loves praise on upon the road and stair

And through the weary steps and through
the laughter,

And through the mirth and songs and
sorrows after.

In my prosperity I sing Your praise,

And may You, my Beloved, so guide my
days.

Psalm 36

To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of David,
YHWH's slave. 1 A voice in my heart for
the wicked

Transgression: no fear of God's before his
eyes.

2 For he will flatter himself in his own
eyes,

When he finds out his errors *and* when he
hates.

**3 Wickedness and deceit are what his
mouth states,**

**He has stopped being wise, and stopped
doing good.**

**4 He invents wickedness on his bed, like
hood**

**He sets himself in a way *that is not good,*
He does not abhor evil things *as he
should.***

5 Your mercy, O YHWH, in the heavens
abides,

Your faithfulness *reaches up* to the clouds'
sides.

**6 Your righteousness is like the great
mountainsides,**

**Your judgments *are* a great deep, O
YHWH, besides**

**You preserve man and beast. 7 How
precious *is* Your**

**Lovingkindness, O Alohim! And
therefore**

**The children of men put their trust
beneath Your**

**Wings' shadow. 8 They're abundantly
satisfied**

**With the fullness of Your house *and
glory's pride,***

**And You give them a drink from Your
pleasures' stream.**

For with You *is* the fountain of life *and
dream,*

In Your light we see light. 10 Oh, continue
Your

Lovingkindness to those who know You,
and Your

Righteousness to the upright in heart. 11
Let not

The foot of pride come against me, and let
not

The hand of the wicked ones drive me
away.

There the workers of iniquity will stay

**Having fallen, they have been cast down
*today***

And are not able to rise up *in the way.*

I stop in hurried rush about the days

Of life to take a drink from the kind rays

Of that stream that runs down from
Paradise

Where the four hidden ones above the dice
Of world affairs look down on trial and
turn.

I see the blessing waters from the urn

In chosen hands pour out to quench the
thirst

Of all who come in faith, rejecting worst.

Four rivers come from Eden and they hide

Beneath the sands where trees of life abide
Until the golden rays outshine the sun

Below the lovely visions John begun.

I come at last to Kauthar hidden fast

Beneath the silver syllables and last.

Psalm 37

1 A Psalm of David. Do not fret

Because of evildoers' bet,
 Nor be envious of the workers
 Of such iniquity *and shirkers*.
**2 For they shall soon be cut down like
 The grass, and wither as the spike
 Of the green herb under the strike.**
 3 Trust *now* in YHWH, do good and live
 In the land, and feed on His true.
 4 Delight yourself also in YHWH,
 And He'll give you your heart's desires.
**5 Commit your way as YHWH inspires,
 Trust also in Him, and He'll bring
 To pass. 6 He'll bring forth your
 judgement
 Of right as the noonday *unspent*.**
 7 Rest in YHWH, and wait patiently
 For Him, do not go fretfully
 Because of him who prospers in
 His way, wicked and man of sin.

If patience is a virtue, by my faith
 I find it rather ghostly and a wraith,
 As rare in me as anything to be.
 And yet, Beloved, I come to rest in Thee.
 My ways have led me all around the earth
 To find its beauty and to dare its dearth.
 But now I shall commit my ways and
 means
 To You, Beloved, and forget other scenes.
 Beloved, Your judgement of the noon is
 right,
 Your carrying of sombre, silent night
 Is ready and appropriate in sight.
 Let me fret no more for the willowed wrath
 That snares my feet before the loose-vined
 path.
 I turn returning to the waiting math.

8 Cease from anger, and forsake wrath,
 And do not fret in the harm's path.
 9 Evildoers shall be cut off,
 But those who wait on YHWH *to scoff*,
 They shall inherit the earth's *pile*.
**10 For yet you wait a little while
 And the wicked shall be no more,
 Indeed, you'll search about his shore,
 But his place, it shall be no more.**
 11 But the meek shall inherit earth,
 And delight themselves in the worth
 Of Islam. 12 The wicked one plots
 Against the just, and aims the shots

Of his teeth at him. 13 The Lord laughs
 At him, for He sees his day coughs.
**14 The wicked have drawn out the sword
 And have bent their bow at scabbard,**
 To cast down the poor and the needy,
 To slay those who, *though maybe seedy*,
 Are of upright conduct. 15 Their sword
 Shall enter their own heart *adored*,
 And their bows shall be broken *shored*.
**16 A little that a righteous man
 Has is better than riches' span
 Of many wicked. 17 For the arms
 Of the wicked shall meet alarms,
 But YHWH upholds the righteous' fight.**
 18 YHWH knows the days of the upright,
 And their inheritance for aye.
**19 They shall not be ashamed to spy
 The evil time, and in the days
 Of famine they shall have their trays.**

I have a little as compared to those
 Who live around me with their twinkling
 toes,
 But I know that around the world there be
 Many who are far more righteous than me,
 Who have so little of the worldly store
 That life can barely glimmer on the shore.
 Is little that the righteous has enough
 To be better than all the sinful stuff
 The wicked in the companies and gruff
 Display around the market when they're
 tough?
 That may be the view of the king and great
 David who's raised to near divine estate,
 It may be Your view too, who have no pate
 To bald nor stomach empty where to wait.

20 But the wicked shall perish, and
 The enemies of YHWH *not stand*,
 Like the fields' glory, they shall vanish,
 And into smoke *their grass* shall banish.
**21 The wicked borrows, does not pay,
 But the righteous will give away
 With mercy. 22 For those blessed by Him
 Shall inherit the earth *undim*,
 But those cursed by Him are cut off.**
 23 The steps of a *good* man *in soph*
 Are ordered by YHWH, He delights
 In his way. 24 Though he fall *through*
 spites,
 He'll not be utterly cast down,

For YHWH upholds *with* His hand's
crown.

**25 I have been young, and now am old,
Yet I've not seen the righteous fold
Forsaken, nor his descendants
Begging for bread or shirt and pants.**

26 *He* is ever merciful, and
Lends, and his descendants *in hand*
Are blessed. 27 Depart from evil, and
Do good, and live forevermore.

**28 For YHWH loves justice, and what's
more**

**Does not forsake His saints, they are
Preserved forever like a star,
But the descendants of the wicked
Shall be cut off because they're crooked.**

29 The righteous shall inherit earth
And live forever *in its worth*.

The Christ and blessed Messiah also speaks
Of those who should inherit after weeks
The earth and all its glories and its peeks.
Too many sweet ones think he got his
words

From You directly or the passing birds,
Forgetting that his mother knew the tunes
Of David's Psalms before the busy croons
Of jazz and rock spilled out upon the
dunes.

Beloved, the righteous shall inherit earth
Is well put, since they have not yet from
birth

Found resting place on sea or land or air,
But falls the fatal mesh of toil and care.
Beloved, the righteous shall receive indeed,
But first I wait the germinating seed.

30 The mouth of the righteous speaks wise,
And his tongue talks of justice' *size*.

31 The law of his God's in his heart,
None of his steps take sliding part.

**32 The wicked watches the righteous,
And seeks to slay him, slay not us.**

**33 YHWH will not leave him in his hand,
Nor condemn him when he's judge
manned.**

34 Wait on YHWH, and keep to His way,
And He'll exalt you in your sway
To inherit the land, and when
The wicked are cut off *again*,
You shall see *it*. 35 For I have seen

The wicked in great power *and spleen*,
And spreading himself like tree green.

**36 Yet he passed away, and behold,
He was no more, though I was bold
To seek him, but he was not found.**

37 Mark the blameless *man on the ground*,
And observe the upright *and calm*,
The future of *that* man's Islam.

**38 But transgressors shall be destroyed
Together, for the future's void
For the wicked. 39 But the salvation
Of the righteous is from YHWH's ration,
He is their strength in troublous time.**

40 And YHWH shall help them *from the
slime*

And deliver them, He shall save
Them from the wicked *and his grave*,
Because they trust Him *as they climb*.

The forty verses of this Psalm reflect
The Abdal who in forties stand erect
To whirl below Your throne and guard the
way,

And guide the way to where You hold the
sway.

The green trees of earth's kings have roots
that sink

Into the dry sand desert without drink.

They are judged by their doings and their
day

Of fine destruction dawns already bright.
Above the groaning of their power the sight
Of Your anointed guide stands still to steer
The course of suns and stars. I never fear,
As sure today when hidden from the stars
His hand is resting on the guiding bars,
As when he shall reveal his form and cars.

Psalm 38

1 A Psalm of David. To bring to
remembrance.

O YHWH, do not rebuke me in Your
wrath's dance,

Nor chasten me in Your hot displeasure's
stance!

**2 For Your arrows pierce me deeply, and
Your hand**

**Comes to press me down. 3 No healthy
spots still stand**

In my body because of Your anger, nor

Any health in my bones because of my sore.

4 For my iniquities go over my head,
Like a heavy burden heavy with my dread.

Perhaps the good man Job wrote out the
Psalm

Upon the day when he got his first qualm.
I should not be surprised, yet many since
Have read his words beneath their time to
wince

And found them fragrant with familiar
sound.

Many there be that suffer on the ground.
Beloved, my bones ache too, for age
perhaps,

Or just because I've been caught in the
lapse

Of my intemperance in work or lack
Of drinking enough nectar when Your back
Is turned. Beloved, my pains are small
compared

To those who wrote the Psalms when they
despaired,

And yet I take my comfort for my small
Hurts at the jaspered, jewelled, singing
wall.

5 My wounds are foul *and* festering *all*
because

Of my foolishness. 6 I'm troubled *at Your*
laws,

I am bowed down greatly, I go mourning
all

Day long. 7 For my loins are full of
caterwaul,

And *there is* no soundness in my *earthly*
flesh.

**8 I'm feeble and severely broken, I
thresh**

**And groan because of the turmoil of my
heart.**

**9 Lord, all my desire is before You, the
start**

**Of my sighing is not hidden from Your
eye.**

10 My heart pants, my strength fails me, as
for the wry

Light of my eyes, it also has gone from me.

**11 My loved and friends stand far from
my destiny,**

**And *all* my kin avoid me. 12 Those also
who**

**Seek my life lay snares *for me*, also those
who**

**Seek my hurt speak of destruction, and
they plan**

**Deception all day long. 13 But I, like deaf
*man,***

**Do not hear *what they say*, and *I'm* like a
mute**

***Who open's not his mouth when they
come to shoot.***

14 And so I am like a man who does not
hear,

And in whose mouth *there is* no response
to fear.

My loved and friends stand far off too and
see

My complaints and passions here where I run
free,

But not for ill, I trow, but rather for

The lack of funds to buy one ticket more
And lack of time to take so long a trip

Across the sea to sit down where I sip
Your gifts of life and love and plenitude

Beside the failing waters and the brood
Of springs the quartzite hillside is imbued

With in the springtime and the happy lip
Of waking from the winter's joint and hip.

Beloved, though loved and kin may not be
near,

May never answer missive for a tear,
Still You are comfort and You are my dear.

15 For in You, O YHWH, I hope, and You
will hear,

O Lord my God. 16 For I said "*Hear me,*
lest they

Rejoice over me, lest, when my foot slips,
they

Exalt *themselves* against me." 17 For I'm
ready

To fall, and my sorrow *is* continually

Before me. 18 My iniquity I'll declare,
I will be in anguish over my sin's share.

**19 But *see* my foes *are* vigorous, and
they're strong,**

**And those have multiplied who hate me
in wrong.**

20 Those also who render *me* evil for good,

They are my enemies, since I follow good.
**21 Do not forsake me, O YHWH, O my
God, be
Not far from me! 22 Make haste to come
and help me,
O Lord, my salvation and eternally!**

Now every sheikh and grandfather and aunt
Brings out a text for sema' ground and
gaunt!

Yet here is one word of remembrance
sweet

That David wrote down as a special treat.
I sing the sema' of his wrinkled words
And watch the circling of the stormy birds
Of repentance sink on the carcass' flesh.
Once all is eaten then the air is fresh.
I too repent my veils and blindnesses
Beneath the lowering clouds and sun that is
Too stark to share my looking and my pain.
I too repent reciting in the rain.
And as a bow to You I see the tumble
Of all earth's kings and priests except the
humble.

Psalm 39

1 To the Chief Musician and to Jeduthun.
A Psalm of David. I said "I'll guard my
boon,

Lest I sin with my tongue, I'll restrain my
mouth

With a muzzle, while the wicked range the
south."

**2 I was mute with silence, I even held my
peace
From good, and my sorrow was stirred
up in lease.**

**3 My heart was hot within me, and while
I mused,**

**The fire burned. Then I spoke with
tongue unused:**

4 "YHWH, make me know my end, and
what's the measure

Of my days, know how frail I *am a
treasure.*

The thought is that if I could mind the fact
That my end is so near, I'd not be whacked
To fall beneath temptations piled and
packed.

That's optimism for the weighty show

Of heart bent on the flame and fatal glow.
Truth is that nothing can abate the power
Of the illusion of the human hour
That self is great and never born to die:
The crowds believe eternally that lie.
I only know mortality is true
When I am willing to attend that You
Alone are Self and my self is the view
Reflected from Your face and glory's hue.
It is Your wonder that makes men to rue.

5 Indeed, You have made my days *as a
handbreadth,*
And my age *is* nothing, before You *a
breath,*

**6 Surely every man at his best is mere
mist.**

**Surely every man walks about like a
kissed**

**Shadow, surely they busy themselves in
vain,**

**He heaps up riches, and does not know
what brain**

**Will gather them. 7 "Now, Lord, what do
I await?**

My hope's in You. 8 Deliver me from *the
gate*

Of all my transgressions, and do not make
me

The reproach of the foolish. 9 I stood
mutely,

I did not open my mouth, because it was
You who did *it.* 10 Remove Your plague
and sharp claws

From me, I'm consumed by the blow of
Your hand.

**11 When with rebukes You correct a
man on land**

**For iniquity, and You make his beauty
Melt away like a moth, and surely every**

**Man is a vapour. 12 "Hear now my
prayer, O YHWH,**

**And give ear to my cry, do not be undue
Silent at my tears, for I'm stranger with
You,**

A sojourner, as all my fathers before.

**13 Remove Your gaze from me, that I
may restore**

**Strength, before I go away and am no
more."**

Though forty men surround me and Your throne,
I've learned a man must whirl, and whirl alone.

The hand that sweetly dips within the pot
Set before me is often in the plot
To trip my feet while my eyes rise to see
The glory of Your passing solemnly.
Though forty men surround me and do right

By tracing out the sema' in the night,
I can rely on neither friend nor store
To keep me pure and constant at love's door.

Though friend despise and in his treachery
Sink teeth in my washed flesh for cemetery,

I make no sign my clammy skin can feel
Any pulse but Your sacred name to heal.

Psalm 40

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

I waited patiently for YHWH,
And He inclined to me *to do*,
And heard my cry. 2 He also brought
Me up out of the horrors' plot,
Out of the miry clay, and set
My feet upon a rock *well met*,
And established my steps *and taught*.

**3 He's put a new song in my mouth
Praise to our God from north to south,
Many will see it and will fear,
And trust in YHWH with eye and ear.**

**4 Blessed is that man who sets his trust
On YHWH, and does not tread the dust
Of the proud, nor such as turn back,
Aside to lies of wicked slack.**

5 Many, O YHWH my God, *are* Your
Wonderful works *which* You've made
score,
And Your thoughts toward us cannot be
Recounted to You in their fee,
If I should declare and speak *them*,
They're more than can be numbered *gem*.

**6 A sacrifice and offering You
Did not desire, but my ears You
Have opened. Burnt offering and sin
Offering You don't want in the bin.**

7 Then I said "Behold, I come, in

Scroll of the book of me *it's* written.
8 My delight's to do Your will fitting,
O my God, Your law's in my heart."

Beloved, You do not wish a sacrifice,
You do not lust for burning flesh and nice,
Nor human offerings on the cross or altar,
But rather that humans come without falter
Obeying Your commands that You once spoke

Upon Mount Sinai with the thunder's stroke.

You rather would that humans do Your will
Instead of looking up to Calvary's hill.
Beloved, Your grace is good enough for me,

I bring no more than that to set me free
From guilt and sin, in penitence my prayer
Comes with the sweet incense upon the air
Of lilies-of-the-valley and the birch
Where pines and firs make columns of my church.

9 I have proclaimed the better part
Of righteousness in the assembly,
Indeed, I don't restrain my trembly
Lips, O YHWH, You Yourself know. 10 I
Have not hidden Your justice' *die*
Within my heart, I have declared
Your faithfulness, *with others shared*
Your *great* salvation, I have not
Concealed Your lovingkindness *taught*
And Your truth from compatriot.

**11 Do not withhold Your tender mercies
From me, O YHWH, in controversies
Let Your lovingkindness and truth
Always preserve me from my youth.**

12 For untold evils surround me,
And sunken in iniquity,
So that I cannot look up, they
Are more than my head's hairs *and grey*,
Therefore my heart fails me. 13 Be pleased,
YHWH, to save me, YHWH, when I'm squeezed

Make haste to help me! 14 Let them be
Ashamed and brought to anarchy
Who seek to destroy my life, let
Them be driven backward to get
Dishonour who wish me not well.

**15 Let them be confounded a spell
Because of their shame, who tell me,**

**“Aha, aha!” 16 Let all sweetly
Who seek You rejoice and be glad
In You, let such as love Your pad
Of salvation keep on saying
“YHWH be magnified [Allahu akbar]!”**

**17 For my thing
I'm poor and needy, yet the Lord
Remembers me. You *are* my sword,
My help and my deliverer,
Do not delay, O my God, stir.**

You want no sacrifice, Beloved, I know.
You patiently endure the pageant show.
You stoop in mercy on the mosque and rail
Of church and synagogue without avail.
But You have opened up my ears to hear
The sema' of Your Scriptures without fear,
While all the prancing popes go mutely by
Ignoring that small rustle from the sky.
Though I am poor and needy, still You
tramp
With showers of words remembering in my
camp
That my soul is a humble one and damp.
Yet the fire of Your memory bears the
stamp
That flings the code of sema' in the air
And traces Your remembrancers up there.

Psalm 41

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of
David.

**Blessèd is he who considers the poor,
YHWH**

**Will deliver him in time of trouble. 2
YHWH**

**Will preserve him and keep him alive,
and he**

**Will be blessed on the earth, and You
will not see**

Fit to deliver him to his enemy.

3 YHWH will strengthen him on his bed of
illness,
You will sustain him on his sickbed's
address.

4 And I said “O YHWH, be merciful to me,
Heal my soul, for against You I've sinned
freely.”

**5 My enemies speak evil of me, say
“When**

**Will he die, and his name perish?” 6 And
if then**

**He comes to see *me*, he speaks lies, his
heart draws**

Iniquity to itself, *ex cameras*

**He tells *it*. 7 All who hate me whisper in
choir**

**Against me, against me they devise my
dire**

**Destruction. 8 “An evil disease clings to
him.**

And *now* that he lies down, to rise again's
dim.”

**9 Even my own familiar friend I trusted,
Who ate my bread, has lifted up *his*
dusted**

**Heel against me. 10 But You, YHWH, be
merciful**

**To me, and raise me up, that I may *in*
full**

**Repay them. 11 By this I know that You
are well**

**Pleased with me, because my enemy *is*
fell**

**But does not triumph over me. 12 As for
me,**

**You empower me in my integrity,
And set me before Your face forever. 13
Blessed**

**Be YHWH God of Israel from the
ungessed**

Eternity to eternity again!

Say David's assembly Amen and Amen.

Blessed is the One indeed whose memory
Is touched by the poor faqir's artistry,
Who cites again and once more the words
taught

From Torah and Qur'an and Zabur wrought
Into a Gospel bright though poorly sung.

Blessed is the One indeed who touches
rung

Of the ladder's first steps and in His fasting
Gives life and bread and nectar everlasting.

Let me too be blessed as I finish fast

And write a note upon my gypsum cast

To scatter bread of barley as well as

The words to eat the sacred volume has.

The height of spirit's flight, the faqir's goal
Is merely to engage the beggar's bowl.

Psalms Books Two to Five

The Psalms are divided into five books. It is thought that this reflects the division of the Torah into five books as well. Indeed, the five books of the Torah, arbitrary as they are in representing divisions largely resulting from the limitations of scroll formatting, can be seen to represent the five roots of faith that can be logically established: the oneness of God, God's impartiality, God's revelation through prophets, divine guidance, and human responsibility to give account. The subject matter of the five books of Psalms does not lend itself to such a summary.

Rather, there are other motives for the division of the Psalms. First of all, we should see at least three levels in the compilation. The first level is the original intention of the author of the Psalm. The second level is the intention of the compiler in the Psalm's inclusion in a liturgical cycle or compilation of liturgical texts. The third level is the intention of the final gathering of such collections into one book.

The first level of intention is revealed by several indicators. These may be the Psalm headings that authors or early editors have attached to the Psalms, although such headings also seem to include rubrics for the recitation of the Psalms. The content of the Psalms also gives an indication of the original intention, and this has been the focus of Psalm studies among traditional scholars.

The intention of compilers has been neglected by scholars. The five books of Psalms may indicate a second level, that of the earliest compilations. The compilers' intentions may differ greatly from those of the original author of each Psalm. The first book of Psalms appears to have been intended to include a symbolically significant number of Psalms, specifically 40. It appears that Psalms 9 and 10 were split in the Masoretic text in order to make 40. Possibly Psalm One was added in the final compilation of 150 Psalms, making 41 Psalms in the first book and disguising the intention of the original compiler.

The intention of the second book of Psalms is less clear. The compiler may have desired to create a collection again with a symbolic number, 70, including books one and two. This is no longer readily visible in the final collection, not only because of the addition of a Psalm to book one, but because of another split Psalm, numbers 42 and 43, which are also clearly one Psalm. It is interesting that the later editor split Psalms which can be immediately recognized as belonging to one another. Psalms 9 and 10 for an acrostic and Psalms 42 and 43 are structurally a coherent whole with a common, repeated refrain.

It is impossible to suggest the purpose of the first two compilations. The last book is clearly in the sequence of the annual festivals. The first two books may relate to the two daily sacrificial events in the second temple.

The third book of Psalms does not show a concern with symbolic numbers. It may have been a collection of hymns compiled for use on the first day of the month. It must be remembered that the original intention of each Psalm is not always taken into account by the compiler. There are two reasons for thinking the third book is for the first day of the month. The first reason is that the fifth book clearly follows the sequence of annual feasts. It is reasonable therefore to suggest by analogy that books three and four correspond to the first of the month and the Sabbath, thus providing a collection for each of the daily, monthly and annual festivals. If that is plausible, then the mention of the Sabbath in Psalm 92 would identify this as the Sabbath collection, and the mention of the new moon in the third book tentatively identifies it as for that purpose.

The fifth book is clearly a collection of compilations in view of the annual feasts. The first section refers to the Passover and Feast of Unleavened Bread and includes the Great Hallel, a sequence recognized in Jewish tradition as appropriate to the annual feasts. The section is Psalms 107-118. Psalm 119 relates to the feast of

weeks. Psalms 120-134 are identified in the titles as Psalms of pilgrimage. As such they represent a year-end pilgrimage event (thinking in terms of the year beginning in autumn) that is no longer known in Jewish tradition but is traceable in the Torah (Deuteronomy 12). Psalms 135-144 are not so clearly marked as the pilgrimage Psalms, but lie between them and the Psalms of praise that thematically fit the feast of tabernacles or Succoth. Psalms 135-144 are thus in a structural slot to suggest that they are appropriate to the feast of trumpets and the Day of Atonement or Yom Kippur. Psalms 146-150 are identified as Psalms of praise, certainly appropriate to Succoth.

The gathering of the five collections into one finally represents the third level, that of imitating the Torah sections. As such, the intention of the earlier compilations has been neglected and subsumed. It is doubtful that the intentions of either the original authors or the compilers of the earlier collections was taken into account in the second temple. However, the problem arises, in that case, in identifying any period when this sequence of annual festivals actually took place. Some of the Psalms are post-exilic, so that they could not have been included in the earlier compilations upon which the 150 is based.

Christians have long found prophetic references to Jesus the Messiah in the Psalms. Parallels between the wording of some Psalms and events in the Gospels are already noted in the Gospels themselves. No less evident, in fact more so, is the way that the Psalms can be related prophetically to the rise and development of Islam. The central text of Psalm 106:24 identifies the name Muhammad as a point of contention far more clearly than anything in regard to Jesus. Beyond that, sequences of twelve are often applicable to the sequence of the twelve Imams, especially the third and the fourth slots relating to the martyrdom of Hussein (as) and the characteristic of praise on the part of Zeynul Abideen (as). The sixth slot is also important in a number of cases. Finally, the twelve Psalms for the

sons of Korah and the twelve Psalms of Asaph contain striking parallels to the lives of the corresponding twelve Imams. If one accepts the principle of prophecy in the sense of predicting future events and individuals, one can hardly expect the ambiguous references to Jesus to be valid and at the same time disregard references to the twelve Imams which are certainly equally clear and relevant. The reference to Muhammad is so much stronger than any reference to Jesus that the only way to escape its intent is to deny prophecy altogether.

Psalms Book Two Psalm 42

1 To the Chief Musician *a law*,
Meditate the sons of Korah (1).
Twelve psalms are written on the way
Of the sons of beloved Korah
And in their number and their sway
Bring to mind in a prophecy
The number of imams in fee
Who rose after the prophet's time
To bear the world in act and rhyme.

This first of the maskil, of meditations
Of Korah's sons set out in their elations
Addressed to the chief of the song and
whirling
Before the ark of covenant uncurling
Uprises in my heart to cantillate
Your name, Beloved, because Your name
is great.

When David set aside apportioning
Of service to the realm and ancient king,
In prophecy of action he proclaimed
That temple of praise should not fail once
aimed.

I join the sacred words of the Zabur
Set out in quiet lays and for the poor
Remembering that once the world was set
With a divine appointment seen and met.

2 As the deer pants for water brooks, So pants my soul for You, O God.

The hidden leader of all men
Lies sometimes in the desert glen
Without the springs of water known
To those who never wander, groan.
I ask the dear Lord God above

To look down on that man in love
And lead him to a springing well
As He did once when Ishmael
Waited beneath the sprig to hear
The tinkling of Zamzam on ear.

I've never seen the deer pant for the brook,
But only stand among the trees and look.
I've never seen the beast in fright take
flight

With tongue laid out and heaving sides in
sight.

But I can see in mind's eye that the cool
Of water would attract the deer in school,
And bring the shy ones from the glade to
find

Refreshment in the water and the kind.
Beloved, my cervine soul pants for the
fresh,

Delightful waters that no feet enmesh,
But flow from fountains of Kauthar to
make

The green bowls filled that holy imams
take.

My soul pants for You more than food and
drink

And so I bend my neck toward the brink.

3 My soul thirsts for Alohim, looks
For the living God. When shall I
Come and appear before God's eye?

Beloved, when shall I appear before You?
The days are filled with rainbows and the
hue

Of life and breath above the aspen thicket
Beyond the slough, beyond the open
wicket,

But I see not the divine face, though it
Reflects in everything created fit.
Beloved, when shall I appear before sight
Of Your throne set above the world of
might

To hear aloud the voice I hear now in
The stillness of my heart beyond the din
Of worship and of praise, to see the view
Of Your divine face from the right and
true?

Beloved, I come in quietness and by
The inner vision beneath leaden sky.

4 My tears have been my food by day
And night, while other ones still say
To me, "Where *is* your God, *I pray?*"

Who reads the Torah law, commandments
met

At Sinai for the folk that You once let
Hear Your voice loud and clear, who reads
the choice

Must eat his tears as often as rejoice.
As day and night I read the sacred Word
Of Decalogue I still am not deterred
From sorrow and from tears, and still recall
The plague of human stance against the
wall

That would deny to me the right and love
That You bestow on others in the shove.
Beloved, though I am dervish dog unmeet
To lick the common dust from off Your
feet,

I taste the tears of longing that I may
Receive You in the temple of my day.

5 When I remember these *things*, I
Pour out my soul within me. I
Used to go with the multitude,
I went with them *in joyful mood*
Up to the house of Alohim,
With the voice of joy and *I deem*
With praise, and with a multitude
That kept a pilgrim feast of *food*.

I went with multitudes around the stone
Of Kaaba whereupon sits the great throne
Reflecting from the sky Your arsh above,
I went with multitudes to find Your love.

I poured out my soul as my steps went
round

And heard the murmuring of voices sound
In supplications in all nations' tongues.
I climbed alone the sacred temple rungs.
With voice of joy and praise the Mekkah
dawn

Grew bright upon me as well as upon
Those gathered in Your name, the Mahdi
too

Invisibly walked within ken and view.
Beloved, I rejoice in the memory
Of that day and the day that I still see.

6 Why are You cast down, O my soul,

Disquiet within me unroll?
Hope in Alohim, for I'll yet
Praise Him *for* help of His face set.

My soul, Beloved, disquieted in me,
Both fed on tears, and longing utterly,
Seeks You despite my joy, in face of praise
The loving, faithful congregations raise.
I turn from false hopes in that unity
And from false loves that force themselves
on me,

I turn from myself and from others to
That Self above creation that is You.
I turn from safety without enmity
And satisfaction in the bread I see
Upon the table and I seek the better:
I seek the Word behind the word and letter.
In all abundance I still feel bereft:
In my abundance You are all that's left.

7 O my God, my soul is cast down
Within me, therefore from the town
Of Jordan I'll remember You
And from the heights of Hermon's *dew*,
And from the hill of Mizar's *view*.

**8 Deep calls to deep and at the noise
Of Your waterfalls, Your waves poise
And all Your billows cover me.**

9 YHWH will command diurnally
His lovingkindness, in the night
His song with me shall be my light,
A prayer to the God of my life.

**10 I'll say to Alohim my Strife,
"Now why have You forgotten me?
And why do I go mourningly
For oppression of enemy?"**

11 *As* with a breaking of my bones,
My enemies reproach *my groans*,
While they say to me all day long,
"Where is your God *and where your song?*"

**12 Why are you cast down, O my soul?
And why unquiet in my toll?
Hope in Alohim, for I shall
Yet praise Him, who's the arsenal
Before my face, God I extol.**

I flee to You in memory of Your names
From enemy and from oppressors' claims.
My soul is cast down, it is true, and yet
My casting down itself when it is met

Turns me toward You and at Your coming
get
The joy of Your praise high above all
blames.

I flee to You in memory of the great
Deeds of Your hand, and find I am not late
To see the smaller deeds in air and breeze,
The manufactures of the whispering trees.
Beloved, I am unquiet, it is true,
And yet unquietness leads but to You,
Forgotten all the sorrow come in view,
Known every weight of glory come anew.

Psalm 43 (Korah 2)

**1 Judge me, O God, and plead my cause
Against an ungodly nation,
Deliver me, oh, from *the claws*
Of the deceitful man of dun.**

2 For You *are* God of my strength, why
Do You cast me away? And why
Do I go mourning because of
The enemy and his hard shove?

**3 Oh, send out Your light and Your
truth!**

**Let them lead me, bring me *uncouth*
To Your pure hill and to Your tent
Invisible and where You went.**

4 Then I will go up to the altar
Of Alohim, *and not to falter*
To Alohim exceeding joy,
And on the harp I'll praise employ
To You, O Alohim, my God.

**5 Why are you cast down to the sod,
O my soul? Why disquieted
Within me? Hope in *and be led*
Of Alohim, for I shall yet
Praise Him *who is still my best bet*,
The help of my countenance and
My God *and choice from every brand*.**

Judge me, indeed! I have traversed the
court,
Past altar and past laver and in sort
Enter the tent, leaving the deer behind
Where bread and light and incense are
combined

To show the way into the sacred place
Where the ark stands before the divine
face.

Judge me, indeed! I enter in the way
Of inner temple in the heavenly ray

Where only the high priest comes once a
year,
Or in the heavenly places standing sheer
Upon the grandest eras of the ages.
Your throne of judgement set, the open
pages
Of life and deed and motive gleam in
lustre,
The grapes are cut in forties for a cluster.

Psalms 44

1 To the Chief Musician. A Contemplation
of the sons of Korah (3).

**We have heard with our ears, O God,
Our fathers have told us the deeds
You did in their old days by rod.**

2 You drove out the nations with Your
Hand, but You set *our fathers'* score,
The nations You afflicted and
Cast them out. 3 For the *promised* land
They did not gain by their own sword,
Nor did their own strength *unexplored*
Save them, but it was Your right hand,
Your arm, and the light of Your face,
Because You favoured them *as race*.

**4 You are my King, O Alohims,
Command deliverances for Jacob.**

**5 By You we push down all *that seem*
Our enemies, through Your name wake
up**

To trample those who rise against us.

6 For I'll not trust my bow *that fenced us*,
Nor shall my sword save me. 7 But You
Have saved us from our enemies,
And shamed those who hated us too.

**8 In Alohims we boast *decrees*
All day long, and praise Your name ever,
Your name forever and forever.**

How have the lovely fallen! See how quaint
Are all the words of King David, the saint!
I doubt the new age helpers of the power
Lounging under their energy an hour
Such condemnations of the Canaanites
On grand parade going down in their
plights

Note with much favour. Positive's in
fashion,

Or not to knock the ones in glitter crashing.
For my faith, my Beloved, I count the woe
Damning the Trinitarian and slow

Among the Baal worshippers not amiss.
Vice is a thing that I refuse to kiss
In myself or in others. You do well
Demanding Jebusite to die by spell.

9 But You have cast *us* off in shame
Our armies go without Your name.

**10 You make us turn back from the foe,
And those who hate us take *for show*
The spoil for themselves. 11 You have
given**

**Us up like sheep for slaughter riven,
And scattered us among the nations.**

12 You sell Your people for *small* rations,
And have no profit in their sale.

**13 You make us a reproach *and tale*
To our neighbours, a scorn, derision
To those around us *in our vision*.**

14 You make us a byword among
The nations, *and a song that's sung*
With shaking of the head among
The peoples. 15 My dishonour *stands*
Always before me, and expands
The shame of my face over me,

16 Because of his *loud* voice when he
Reproaches and reviles, because
Of the avenger, enemy,
Because of their words and their laws.

You laid the Amorite down in the dust
For filling up iniquity's last crust,
And Israel triumphed over them the day
They swept across the Jordan on dry clay.
You are a dangerous hand for a God,
You give the land of heathen grouch and
sod,

But then You sell the winners in the tale
And scatter them beneath the rain and hail.
Beloved, I flee from You to You again
As I hand down my pagan gods with wen,
And grasp at You to hold in desperation:
Where can I grab and hold You for a
ration?

If You are dangerous You're slippery.
My hands stay empty though eternity.

17 All this has come upon us, but
We've not forgotten You, nor what
We should not deal falsely with Your
Covenant *You promised before*.

**18 Our heart has not turned back, nor
our**

**Steps strayed from Your way and Your
power,**

**19 But You have greatly broken us
In jackals' places, covered us
With the shadow of death. 20 If we
Forgot the name of our God, we
Stretched out our hands to foreign god,
21 Would not Alohim search and prod?
For He knows secrets of the heart.**

22 Yet for Your sake *and for our part*
We're killed all day, counted as sheep
For slaughter. 23 Wake! Why do You
sleep,

O Lord? Arise! Do not cast off
Forever. 24 *Before heathen scoff*
Why do You hide *from us* Your face,
Forget affliction, our disgrace?

**25 For our soul is bowed down to dust,
Our body clings to earth and rust.
26 Arise for our help, and redeem
Us for Your mercies, Alohim.**

Have not the sons of men come out to
dance
Around the faith that You give them to
prance
In wealth and health and all posterity?
Long is the sign of Your favour's mercy.
Some glory in Your good will as they say,
Only believing that their roundelay
Neat and cool proves superiority
Over all those beneath them in the spree.
Full well I know the good and evil lot
Done up in human plights is simply not
A sign or proof of goodness in parade.
Vehemently I deny punishment
In pain, but only take from Your hand sent
Damage and resurrection where You went.

The Psalms of Korah are set out to please
With one minus twelve headings in the
breeze
That mention that dear name of trust that
sang
Above the sounds of pagan din and clang.
The hidden twelfth is that which comes to
pass
After the hart that pants for water grass.
The sequence thus is hidden from the crew

Who count the Psalms out bravely on the
dew.

This is the third, the Psalm of sacrifice,
The slot that in each twelfth comes to
suffice

In prophecy of Karbela in round.
The foul destruction that came on the
ground

Where Husseyn rode in thirst is forecast
here,
As well as his faithfulness without fear.

Psalm 45

1 To the Chief Musician. Set to "The
Lilies." A Contemplation of the sons
of Korah (4). A Song of Love.

My heart is overflowing with a good
theme,

I recite my words concerning the King's
dream,

My tongue is the pen of a ready writer.

**2 Than the sons of men indeed You are
fairer,**

**Grace is poured upon Your lips, as
Alohim**

**Has blessed You forever. 3 So gird Your
sword's gleam**

**On Your thigh, O Mighty One, with
Your glory**

**And Your majesty. 4 And in Your
majesty**

**Ride out prosperously because of the
truth,**

**Humility, and righteousness, in its ruth
Your right hand shall instruct You in
awesome things.**

5 Your arrows *are* sharp in the heart of the
King's

Enemies, the peoples fall under Your
wings.

**6 Your throne, O exalted one, is forever
And ever, sceptre of righteousness,
sceptre**

**Of your kingdom. 7 You love
righteousness and hate**

**Wickedness, therefore Alohim, Your
God great,**

**Has anointed You with the oil of
gladness**

**Above all Your companions in their
address.**

Why are the rightly guided ones so rare,
 Beloved, why with Your loving, tender
 care
 Do You not sent more guiding lights into
 The dark world where we must have faith
 and do?
 A thousand years have passed since one
 was born
 Into this world with light of truth and scorn
 For wrong, and he remained a hidden one
 And still lurks secretly it seems to shun
 The gaze of adulation and of danger.
 Ah, You could never send to us a stranger
 To loving righteousness and hating wrong.
 So few consistently do so, and long
 We wait for such few to appear. Imam
 From age to age fulfils the loving psalm.

8 All Your garments with myrrh and aloes,
 cassia,
 Out of the ivory palaces, in awe
 They have made You glad. 9 Kings'
 daughters *are* among
 Your honourable women at Your right
 strung,
 There stands the queen in the gold from
 Ophir *sung*.

**10 Listen, O daughter, consider and
 incline
 Your ear, forget your own people too,
 who dine
 In your father's house, 11 So the king
 will greatly
 Desire your beauty, because he *is fitly*
 Your husband, bow down before him
faithfully.**

12 And the daughter of Tyre *will come* with
 a gift,
 The rich among the people will seek *to lift*
 Your favour. 13 The king's daughter's all
 glorious
 Within, her clothing *is* sewn in golden
dress.

**14 She shall be brought to the king in
 broidered robe,
 The virgins followed her *from ends of the*
globe,
 They shall be brought to you 15 glad and
 rejoicing.**

They shall be brought entering the king's palace.

16 Instead of your fathers shall be your
 sons' *place*,

Whom you shall make princes on all the
 earth's *face*.

17 I'll make your name remembered in
 every age,
 So the folk shall always praise your
 heritage.

I'll make Your name remembered, but I
 can
 Not lay hand on the great ages in span.
 I only have the power to say Your name
 Varied by no more than one breath in
 claim.

Out of the silent wings of night's low veil,
 Revealing not more than a spark in trail,
 You hear my narrow voice upon the air
 Propelling that one syllable in share
 Among the many glittered, bittered words
 Laughing aloud like hop-twittering birds.
 Around the simple pyre I whirl and say
 Cured names perhaps, but still of just one
 day,

Ensnared in songs that rise at once to fall,
 Stung, fluttered, disappearing at the wall.

The fourth Psalm of Korah in the twelve
 met

Reminds me of the prostrations once set
 By Ali Zeynul-Abideen to show
 What beauty in sweet supplications know
 The one who comes by night and day to
 read

The incensed prayers of Ali in his greed.
 Beloved, the glory and the majesty,
 The aloes, and myrrh, the ivory,
 As light and shade above the odours that
 Surround Your throne and every place You
 sat.

Beloved, this second book of Psalms is
 made
 Of deeper heart yearnings and signs'
 parade

That echo in the inner temple where
 No troubled ear may enter without fear.

Psalm 46

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of the sons of Korah (5). A Song for Alamoth.

Alohim's our refuge and strength,
A very present help in trouble.

**2 Therefore we will not fear at length,
Though earth be shaken like a bubble,
And though the mountains be cast down
Into the heart of the sea brown,**

**3 Though its waters in frothy spume
Roar and be troubled in their room,
Though the mountains shake with its
swelling**

Across the world where we are dwelling.

4 *There is* a river whose streams make
Glad the town for Alohim's sake,
The holy *place* of Most High's tents.

**5 Alohim gives her His presence,
She shall not be moved, Alohim
Helps her, at the break of dawn's gleam.**

The streams of Kauthar wake me from my dream

And take me from this land of things that seem

Into the tents of Your reality
Before the fruited branch upon the tree.

I find the inner temple where the cry
Of righteousness never fails to pass by,
And let the earth burst like a shaken ball,
A bauble floating, dashing on the wall.

Beloved, Your draughts of life make glad the town,

Make glad the meadows and the ploughed fields brown,

Make glad the heart that comes from sorrow down

Toward the gleam of earth, toward the seat
Of everlasting favour and retreat.

Within Your temple, my Beloved, we meet.

6 The nations raged, kingdoms were moved,

He uttered His voice, unproved
The earth melted. 7 For YHWH of hosts
Is with us, God of Jacob's boasts.

8 Come, see the works of YHWH, who's made

Desolations in the earth *splayed*.

9 He makes wars cease to end of earth,
He breaks the bow and cuts the girth

Of spear in two, He burns with fire
The chariot. 10 Be still, *desire*,
And know that I *am* Alohim,
I'll be exalted by the cream

Of the nations, I will be praised
In the earth *by the nations razed!*

**11 YHWH of hosts is with us, the God
Of Jacob's our refuge and rod.**

I still my heart before the shaken sword,
Before the bombs that flatten out the horde,
And see the fighting cease before the eye
That darkens where the earth melts from the sky.

I still my heart and find no I but You,
And know You're Alohim upon the dew,
Above the scented lily, in its hue,
Beyond the questionings of how and why.
Beloved, my heart is still, my hand at rest,
My feet both folded, and within my breast
I find no I but You, Beloved and best.
My heart is still, and yet I hear the tone,
I see the gleam of righteousness alone,
I bow a mere illusion at Your throne.

This Psalm of Muhammad Baqir arose
To quench the raving thirst of all of those
Who seek the temple and the river cool
In You, Beloved, the great desired for pool.
"Inquire in His temple" repeats the name
A single time in Psalms to light the flame
In the first book, and secretly comes here
To recite the name's meaning without fear
And in a hidden way, so only souls
Who search the word Baqir come to the goals.

The Hebrew waiting to inquire turns to
The Arab breaking of the nut in two,
And shows the inner meat as tasty sweet,
Spear broken, but the verdict laid out neat.

Psalm 47

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of the sons of Korah (6).

Oh, clap your hands, you peoples all!
Shout to Alohim with the call
Of triumph! 2 For YHWH is Most High
In awe, *He's* a great King though nigh
Over all the earth. 3 He'll subdue
The peoples under us, the crew
Of the nations under our feet.

**4 He'll choose us heritage and meet,
The excellence of Jacob whom
He loves *above all time and room.***

5 Alohim has gone with a shout,
YHWH with the sound of trumpet rout.
6 Sing praises to Alohim, sing
Praises! Sing praises to our King,
Sing praises! 7 For Alohim's King
Of all the earth, sing praises *well*
With understanding *to excel.*

**8 Alohim reigns over the folk,
Alohim sits upon the stroke
Of His holy throne. 9 Princely folk
Have gathered together, the folk
Of the God of Abraham's *oak.***
For the shields of the earth *belong*
To God, greatly exalted *song.*

You are the God of Abraham, they say
And then continue that in Your own way
You are one of a thousand tribal gods
That used to swell up like peas in their
pods.

Each patriarch of every clan would hold
A god of his ancestors made of gold,
And You were one of those until the rhyme
Of evolution helped You in the climb
From ancestor to deity to be
A tribal god with divine company,
Till polytheistic views changed at last
To monolatric worship in the blast.
From worship of one god it's one small
step
To belief that there's only one vine cep.

I might have thought to find the name that
graces

The sixth Imam with all his holy traces
In this Psalm, but the fact is in the twelve
There's rarely hint beyond the third to
delve

And fourth to raise the praises that resound
In the heart temple from Zaynel's abound.
In Zaynel's Psalm the name Sadiq comes
twice,

And in the seventh Psalm it would suffice
To sound just once, but in the hopeful
dream

No divine guide is taught but Alohim.
But with the sixth Imam You become King
In all the earth, for he taught everything

In clarity while in his upper room
He sounded the alchemy of earth's doom.

Psalm 48

1 A Song. A Psalm of the sons of Korah
(7).

Great *is* YHWH, greatly to be praised
In the city of our God *blazed,*
In His holy mountain *and free.*

**2 Beautiful in its heights to be,
The joy of the whole earth, the mount
Of the fortress upon the fount
Of the north, and the great King's town.**

3 Alohim in her palace *brown,*
Is known as her refuge. 4 For see,
The kings assembling passed freely.

**5 They marvelled at what they could see,
Troubled they quickly sought to flee.**

6 Fear took hold of them there, *and* pain,
As a woman in birth pangs' *reign,*
7 You break the ships of Tarshish' *band*
With an east wind *come from Your hand.*

The palaces of old are long gone now,
The stones lie not on stones, thrown down
somehow,
And trampled by the wicked feet that pass
Unseeking spire and psalm and sea of
glass.

The palaces of old upon the mount
Have disappeared beneath the dried up
fount,

And only days and years mark off the way
To You, Beloved, in temples where I pray.
The Sabbath of Your divine guides I find
Within the inner chambers of my mind,
Upon return of Sabbath and each week,
I find, Beloved, the very thing I seek.
The birth pangs of the slave wife now
betray

The joy of the seventh son's birth today.

8 As we have heard, so we have seen
In the city of YHWH of hosts,
In the city of our God *clean:*
Alohim always sets its boasts.

**9 We've thought, O Alohim, on Your
Lovingkindness, here at the door
Of Your temple. 10 According to
Your name, O Alohim, so *true*
Is Your praise to the ends of earth,**

**Your right hand's full of righteous
worth.**

11 Let the mountain fortress rejoice,
Let Judah's daughters *in their choice*
Be glad, because of Your judgments.

**12 Walk about the fortress *with sense*,
And go all around her to count
Her towers, 13 mark her bulwarks'
mount,**

**Consider her palaces, so
As to make of them a bright show
To the generation to come.**

14 For this *is* Alohim, in sum
Our God forever for each breath,
He'll be our guide *even* to death.

I count the visions parapets to know
In days to come the temple's golden row,
The image to keep shining in my heart,
The inner temple where I take Your part.
Beloved, I count the stones upon the court
And find the mystic numbers of resort
That cry within my soul encouragement
To keep Your law as faithfully as meant.
A hundred sixty-six in count to make
The court of Zion for Your blessed sake,
Takes my feet from the warm stones lying
there
Into the cooler recesses of prayer.
You are my guide indeed as I turn round
The temple stones and gather on the
ground.

Psalms 49

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of the
sons of Korah (8).

Hear this, all peoples, and give ear,
Who dwell on the earth *far and near*,
2 Both low and high, and rich and poor.

**3 My mouth shall speak wisdom's
contour,**

**The meditation of my heart
Shall be an understanding part.**

4 I will incline my ear to *hear*
A proverb, I'll disclose *the fear*
Of my dark saying on the harp.

**5 Why should I fear the days that carp,
When the iniquity abounding**

At my heels comes at me surrounding?

**6 Those who trust in their wealth and
boast**

**In the abundance of their roast,
7 None of them can by any means
Redeem his brother when he leans,
Nor give Alohim his ransom,
8 For the redemption and the sum
Of their souls is costly, and it
Shall cease forever, 9 for the pit
Shall not be seen by him whose life
Is eternal and without strife.**

No man can pay the ransom of a soul
By human sacrifice, nor god nor troll
Suffices to redeem the human crown.
All golden crosses turn to lead and brown.
Though Christ should die again and once
more give

The spark of divine life to make men live,
It would not be enough, not ten times more,
To ransom humankind from his death's
door.

Beloved, the divine Self that You have
given

To every soul is all by which man's
shriven,

And in creation's power that gift alone
Is all that ever can and will atone.

I lay my wooden self aside and take
Hold of Your Self and rise up in the wake.

10 For he sees wise men die, likewise
The fool and senseless in his guise
Perish, and leave their wealth behind.

**11 Their inner thought is that their rind
Will last forever, and their houses**

**To all generations with spouses,
They call their lands by their own names.**

12 But the man, *though* in honour's claims,
Does not remain, *for* he is like
The beasts *that* perish *at the strike*.

**13 This is the way of foolish ones,
And of their progeny by tons**

Who rejoice in their words and runs.

14 Like sheep they are laid in the grave,
And death shall feed on them *as slave*,
The upright shall have dominion
Over them in the morning *sun*,
And their beauty shall be consumed
In the grave, far from dwelling *doomed*.

The gift of being I taught from the start
Of Your creation is the fatal dart

That also supplies humankind with myth,
The dark belief that he's immortal with.
The green twig when it's cut off from the tree

Of life fades quickly in its poverty,
Its leaves wilt on the air, its blossoms fail,
The fruit is shrivelled on the stem and veil.
Beloved, the fool can never see the trail,
Can never realize his soul is just
Reflection of the divine on the dust.
It is the divine beauty found within
That tempts the lonely man to commit sin,
Aspiring and believing he can win.

The name of Ridha's hidden in the word
That sweetly sounds like voice of robin stirred

To chirp with gladness, though the well-
turned earth

Is frozen and he must return to berth
Of safety in the south. "The upright shall
Have the dominion", spoken of the pal
And eighth Imam to prophesy the truth
That caliphs make their promises to youth,
But fail to carry out, and yet the way
Was truly given into Ridha's sway.
Ridha's his name, and prophesied as such
In centuries before the caliph's touch,
In lovely lays to make his name appear
Recited in the Psalm and in Your fear.

Of every cognate in Hebrew and tongue
Of holy Qur'an, both of which are sung,
One cannot always be sure of cognate:
Perhaps the name of Ridha came not late
Upon rejoicing of the verse before
Instead of on dominion to the core.

The children of the foolish were not kind
To caliph's choice of Imam in the bind,
And so they rejoiced when they came to find

That promises need not be kept in store.
The sea of faith becomes a desert shore.
Beloved, I rejoice in dominion found
In You and in Your throne upon the ground
And in the light of faith and courtesy
That lies in Ridha's humble way to be,
Not caring for the wealth and honour bought

But clinging to the truth from You once taught.

15 But Alohim, He will redeem
My soul from the power that may seem
Of the grave, who accepts my *dream*.

**16 Don't be afraid when one is rich,
When his glory reaches a pitch,**

**17 For when he dies nothing shall he
Carried away of all the fee,
His glory shall not follow him.**

18 Though while he lives he is not dim
(For *men* will praise you when you do

Well for yourself *and raise a hue*),
19 He shall go to ancestors' *blight*,
A place where they never see light.

**20 A man who is in honour, yet
Does not understand what he's met,
Is like beasts that perish in net.**

The human body made of dust shall go
Down to the grave like every beastly show,
And like the breath of beast to rise on wind,
The spirit of a man flies up with finned
And winged to makes its way back to the
One

Who gave it when creation's hour was done.

And yet, Beloved, You do not leave the soul

To disappear in its delusion's goal,
But take up that reflection from the soil,
And give each man the reward of his toil.
Your image once impaled on wood and air,
In water and in fire upon the share
Of clay will rise up in its destiny
Of righteousness forever on the tree.

Psalm 50

1 A Psalm of Asaph (1)
El Alohim YHWH spoke and called
Earth from the sun rising *unwalled*
Unto its going down *unstalked*.

**2 Out of the fortress perfectly
Beauty of Alohim to see.**

3 Our Alohim comes and shall not
Keep silent, consuming fire wrought
Before Him and around about
Him is a mighty storm to rout.

**4 So He calls to the skies above,
And to the earth, that He in love
May judge His people without shove.**

5 Gather My holy ones to Me,

Those who've made with Me a treaty
By sacrificial *honesty*.

**6 And so the skies proclaim his right
For Alohim Huu's judge in *might*.**

The first of twelve of Asaph's Psalms, I
sing
The twelve Imams that make the heavens
ring
With righteousness and guidance where
You call

The skies to being and the earthly stall.
You gather here Your holy ones to make
The revelation of Your will at stake
In human flesh. Ali's the first name flung
Against the parapets of heart and tongue.
Beloved, I make a pact with You indeed,
By sacrifice of storm and lust and greed,
I turn toward the glowing morning sky,
And hear the proclamation and the sigh,
And know that You are just in every act,
Because You've sent Your guidance in
Your pact.

7 Hear, O my people, and I'll speak,
O Israel, I'll lay bare cheek
In witness against you, for I
Am Alohim, your God *who cry*.

**8 I shall not reprove you for your
Sacrifices, burnt offerings' store
Continually before My door.**

9 I'll take no bullock from your house
Nor he-goats from your paddock's blouse.
10 For Mine's each forest beast and still
The cattle on a thousand hill.

**11 I know each bird of mountainside,
And the wild animals abide
In the field to be at My side.**

12 If I were hungry, I should not
Tell you about it, for the plot
Of the world's Mine and the whole lot.

**13 Shall I eat bulls' meat or then drink
The blood of goats *there where they sink*?**

**14 Offer to God thanksgiving and
Pay your vows to the most High's hand.**

15 Call out to Me in trouble's day,
I'll save you to praise Me *in sway*.

I have laid hand to sacrifice of goat
And sheep among the beastly ones of note,
But I have not expected that You might

Eat such meat and drink such blood in my
sight.

I know that all things in creation's pale
Belong to You by virtue of the veil
Of Your creating hand and power and light.
I eat myself the sacrifice by night.
Beloved, as I feed on the body's weight
Of what You have provided now to sate
The hunger after fasting, I relate
Your praise and name and so participate
In the true sacrifice before Your gate.

Let me put it once simple, what You say:
You do not care for sacrifice today,
Nor blood of beast or man to show the way.
Instead of sacrifice You command me
To offer thanks in praise that is comely,
And carry out my promises in fee.
As for salvation, it does not depend
On sacrifice or thanks, but in the end
On calling on Your name for help alone,
And then You'll save from what things
would atone.

Beloved, the message is now clear for all:
Salvation is what You do when we call
In trouble of any kind that we see,
From now until Your last eternity.

16 But to the wicked God has said
What have you to do in declaring
My laws, to take in your mouth's sharing
My covenant *on Sinai glaring*?

**17 For you hate teaching and cast out
My words behind you *without doubt*.**

**18 When you met a thief you agreed
With him and you've given your seed
Along with adulterers' *mead*.**

19 You give your mouth to evil and
Your tongue forms deceit *by command*.
20 You sit and speak against your brother,
You slander the son of your mother.

**21 These you have done while I remain
Silent, you thought I was as stain
As you yourself, yet I'll reprove
You and set by your eyes the groove.**

22 Consider this, you who forget
Allah, so I don't come to set
You in fragments so none can save
You from an early, painful grave.

**23 Who offers praise gives glory to
Me, and to him who acts as due**

I'll show his God's salvation true.

The sacrifice of truth is not the slaying
Of animals to hear their hopeless braying,
But to recite Your law, and yet that word
Is like to condemn even the heart stirred.
The repetition of the sacred text
Is condemnation to the hand perplexed
Of disobedience, and to the tongue
That takes in vain the name of neighbour
sung.

Beloved, let my lips gather to Your praise
Only the words that sacrifices raise
In honour to Your name, let me forget
The evil of the tyrant and the set
Of those who falsify Your way and deed.
Let me remember only You with speed.

Psalm 51

To the chief Musician, A Psalm of David,
when Nathan the prophet came to him,
after he had married Bathsheba.

**1 Have mercy on me, Alohim,
According as Your kindness seem,
By Your abundant grace relieve,
Blot out my sin and give reprieve.**
Wash me completely from my sin,
Make pure from wickedness within.
3 For I admit what I have done,
My sins always before me run.
**4 Against You and You only I
Have sinned and done evil to spy,
Yet You are justified to speak
In condemnation of my leak.**

David admits that he committed fault
But not against Uriah in assault,
Nor against Uriah's engagement when
He preferred to further career with men
Of war against the sacred law and so
Abandoned hopes of marriage in the row.
David's sin was not that he failed to keep
The letter of the law, but he did peep
At one beauty bathing for him to see
Upon the rooftop, and came to agree
To marriage not advisable and one
Likely to cause some trouble he should
shun.

Against You only David sinned despite
Nathan's hyperbole to set things right.

5 See I was born in wickedness,
In sin my mother did address
To conceive me. 6 See what You want
Is truth inside a man to haunt,
And in the secret places You
Will bring Your wisdom to my view.

Was David born in wickedness? Indeed,
From what we know of the times and their
seed

When Ali's sons increased the weight of
guilt

In Israel, it was a time of silt.

Does David make excuse for self that
where

He lived was filled with sinfulness to
share?

I think not, nor does he bring mother's trait
To witness against his own choice and fate.

Beloved, You know that where I live is
filled

With the iniquity of Rome that's killed
The conscience of the human heart and
soul.

And yet You wish that purity control
The innermost shrines of the human heart.
Let me, Beloved, succeed to do my part.

Sweet Christians beg two words from one
to hear

About poor David trembling in his fear.
Some say that he was framed in sin relates
To sin original on human pates.

But others wonder if in fact his mam
Was not yet married to his dad in scam,
And being illegitimate, he crows
About the sin of which he hardly knows.

I think that both are wrong and fail to see
The spirit of the living poetry.

So let all who are sure they understand
The Scripture be burned up in hell in band.

7 Cleanse me with hyssop, I'll be clean,
Wash me and I'll be whiter seen

Than snow. 8 Make me *at last* hear joy
And gladness, so the bones *like toy*
That You have broken take glad mien.

**9 Turn Your face from my sins and blot
Out all my iniquities' plot.**

**10 A clean heart create for me, God,
A right mind renew where I nod.**

11 Don't put me from before Your face,
The breathing of Your holy place
Remove not from me *without trace*.
**12 Return to me Your saving's joy,
Your guiding mind uphold, deploy.**
**13 So I'll teach transgressors Your ways,
Converting sinners to Your praise.**
14 Save me from bloodshed, Alohim,
Alohim of my saving's scheme,
My tongue proclaims Your right *regime*.

Your divine action on the human heart,
And on the page of witness from the start
That rises in the actions of the hand
And foot that follow or leave Your
command,
Is that You cleanse the way, blot out the
sin,
And make the heart clean from without,
within.
The guidance that You give to David's
mind
Provided him with teaching of the kind
That he could share with others on the day
When You preserved his hand from
bloodshed's way.
Beloved, I lay hold of the teaching here
That David comes to give my heart as clear
As tongue can sing, and beautiful as rain
That washes away human striving's pain.

You blot out sin, Beloved, upon the breath
Of the holy sanctuary by death.
David knew that when he should go to rest,
You would reign on Your throne above the
best.

The cherub wings that overshadow the ark
Shine with the golden mercy seat and park
Above the tables of the law now set
Within most holy place in heaven met.
Atonement's made by prayer before Your
throne,
So save me from bloodshed that would
atone,
But cannot blot out sin from holy place.
This is the secret teaching I would trace
In David's words astounding for Your
grace.
In David's words I come to trust alone.

15 O Lord, my lips open, and my

Mouth shall declare Your praise for aye.

**16 You did not want a sacrifice,
Else I'd provide it in a trice,
You do not take any delight
In burnt offering and smoke in sight.**

17 The great sacrifice is a mind
Repentant and a heart refined
By contrition and mourning eyes,
O Alohim, You'll not despise.

**18 Do good in Your good pleasure to
The fortress, build the walls anew
Around Jerusalem. 19 Then You
Shall be pleased with the sacrifice
Of righteousness, and with address
Of burnt offering and the whole gift,
Then shall they offer bullocks, lift
Them on Your altar and confess.**

Rather than righteousness brought into
view

By Your grace, and without repentance
due,

Foolish Christian would take a sacrifice
Of Your best and Your sweetest to suffice
For the atonement of his sin for slice.
You do not accept crosses and their load,
You abhor agony of Romans stowed
Upon Your one beloved, but You accept
The sacrifice of spirit though inept
Repenting with contrition and with tear.
Such ones may bring their offering and
come near.

Beloved, repentance opens up the way
For sacrifice of praise in temple's sway,
On altar and on golden voices' lay.

Psalms 52

1 To chief musician a maschil
Of David when Doeg from hill
Of Edom came and told Saul and
Said to him, "David's in the land,
House of Ahimelech to stand."

**Why boast in evil, mighty man?
God's goodness always has a plan.**

**2 Your tongue invents the evil thing
Like a sharp razor and working
Deceit. 3 You love the evil more
Than good, lying rather than store
Of righteous speech. 4 You love all
words**

Consuming deceitful tongue's curds.

5 So God will destroy you for ever,
He shall take you away and sever
You from your house and *then* root you
Out of land of the living too.

**6 Those who do well will see it too
And fear and ridicule the view.**

7 See the man who did not make God
His strength, but trusted in the prod
Of his own wealth and took address
Of strength in his own wickedness.

**8 But I'm like a green olive tree
In the house of Alohim's key,
I trust in Alohim's mercy
For ever and ever confess.**

9 I'll praise You for ever, because
You have done so, I'll hope in pause
Of Your name, because it is good
Before Your holy ones *who could*.

My moments of remembrance are spun like
The green tree and the olive with its spike
Established by the hill of fortress and
Raising its praise in leaves caught up in
band.

Shall I indeed praise You forever when
I raise my voice in Psalms spoken again?
The time I have to whirl on earth is small,
And I am pressed by life against the wall.
Yet on the Sabbath day eternity
Returns to bless my ears, my eyes to see.
Beloved, in this brief moment that I cast
My cantillation to recoup my past,
I see the future melt in gifts away
And raise me into Your eternal day.

Psalm 53

1 To the chief Musician upon Mahalath or
flute, Maschil, of David.

**The fool has said in his own heart,
"No God, la ilaha" to start.**

**They are corrupt and they have done
Abominations under sun.**

There's none that does good, *no, not one*.

2 Alohim looked down from the sky
Upon men's offspring and to spy
If there were some of understanding
Who did seek Alohim's *commanding*.

**3 Everyone of them has turned back,
They're altogether filthy slack,
There is not one under the sun
Who does good, no, not even one.**

4 Who work iniquity, have they
No knowledge? Who eat up like prey
My people as they eat their bread,
They've not called upon God as led.

**5 Without cause they are in great fear,
For Alohim has scattered near
And far the bones of him that came
Against you, You have put to shame
Such ones, because then Alohim
Despised them as well as their scheme.**

6 What shall make from the fortress come
Israel's salvation? When Alohim
Returns captivity to drum
His people, Jacob then shall gleam
With joy and Israel be gladsome.

The crowd pretending to follow Paul in
Avowing that all men are caught in sin
By quoting the Psalm when they cannot
win,

By classing themselves with the ones the
prophet

Says are iniquitous and ones You scoff at,
Place themselves outside the group that he
sees

You call "My people" in Your truth and
ease.

Such people think that by the death of
Christ

Iniquity's forgiven, death sufficed.

But there's no saving of that crowd at all,
But only of Your people in the stall.

Beloved, if I have choice at all to make,
I move away from pseudo-Pauline wake,
And join Your people scattered by the rake.

Identifying fools by the great text
Of David is something that leaves
perplexed.

They are the ones who say there is no God,
And sin outright in pride upon the sod.

It may refer to Muslims in the pod,
Who start with la ilaha under rod,
Or it may be such Christians that deny
That there is one God by the thing they try
In making three of one upon the sly.
Denying Your law both of them seem
vexed.

I turn to You, Beloved, as though one
hexed

And take no name but Yours upon my
head,
No crown but Yours, no nourishment when
fed,
No drink but well of Kauthar where I'm
led.

Psalm 54

1 To the chief musician upon
Neginoth, a maschil *and psalm*
Of David when the Ziphim came
And said to Saul *as if to blame*,
“With us does David hide *for shame?*”
Save me, Alohim, by Your name,
And judge me by Your strength *the same*.
**2 Alohim, hear my prayer, and give
Ear to my mouth's words, I may live.**
**3 For strangers do rise against me,
And violent men seek my free
Soul, they have not set Alohim
Before them waking or in dream.**
4 See, God's my helper, and my Lord
With them I keep my soul from sword.
**5 He'll recompense my foes with woe,
And cut them off in Your truth's glow.**
**6 I'll freely sacrifice to You,
I'll praise Your name indeed, O YHWH,
For that is a good thing to do.**
7 For He's saved me from all my woe,
My eye has seen it on my foe.

I have not fled the foe as David did
When he went into Ziph and there he hid.
He may have trusted men or may have not.
We humans are constrained to stay in plot
Of land in space and time, we cannot go
At speed of light to find another show.
So David may have been in that town with
A mind not to believe the traitor's myth.
You saved him from the secret plot and
sent
Him back into the wilderness and spent.
Beloved, I too live outside the town's pale,
Though no one seeks my life to whip my
tail,
And breathe the fragrance of the
wilderness,
And leave the happy world to strive and
guess.

Psalm 55

1 To the chief musician upon
Neginoth, a maschil *and psalm*
Of David. Give ear to my prayer,
O Alohim, and hide nowhere
From my supplication *in air*.
**2 Attend to me and hear me too,
I mourn in my complaint and do
Make noisy moaning, 3 for the cue
Of enemy to me, and for
The wicked one's oppressing sore,
For they accuse me of such sin,
Angrily hating me. 4 Within
My heart is pain, and terrors black
Of death have fallen on my back.**
5 A fear and shaking come on me,
And horror has overwhelmed me.

David who fled before the enemy,
And Jeremiah in the cistern wee,
The ones who would not bow, the children
three,
Christ in the garden turning from the cup,
The thirsty band of Husseyn like a tup,
All cantillated in this vein to You,
Beloved, to see what You had come to do.
Some saw Your great salvation come in
view,
Some died with words of faith upon their
lips,
But all of them took the source in small
sips
That waits in great droughts for the Sabbath
day
When You shall put all things under Your
sway
And justice fill the earth in awesome ray.
My prayers are done. I wait with hands on
hips.

6 So I said “Oh that I had wings
Like a dove! Then I'd flee *from stings*
And be at rest. 7 See I would go
Into the desert where I'd stay.
**8 And I'd quickly make my escape
From boisterous storm and tempest's
nape.**

If I had wings like a dove I would fly
Above the watered earth and by and by
Pluck off an olive leaf beneath the sky
And bring it to the prophet where he hides

Within the ark of safety and abides.
I'd pluck an olive leaf with joyful cry.
If I had wings like a dove I would go
Down on the dripping head, I'd not be slow
To bring the light and lift of God above
Upon the Christ in signal of Your love.
Instead I creep upon the desert wave,
Flash flooding from my temporary grave,
To rise in life and breath where angel sings
Before Your face, Beloved, if I had wings.

9 Destroy, my Lord, divide their tongues,
For I've seen violence *in rungs*
And struggle in the city *there*.

**10 Both day and night they go about
Upon the walls of it and stout,
Mischievous is there too and the grief
Brought in its midst without relief.**

11 It's wickedness down to the core,
Deceit and guile depart no more
Out of her streets *kept in their store*.

**12 For it was not an enemy
That came *raving* to reproach me,
Then I could have borne it, and not
One that hated me who has got
Up to greatly challenge me, then
I would have hidden *in a den*.**

13 But it was you, my equal and
My guide and mate *at my right hand*.

14 We took sweet counsel each with each,
In Alohims's house came *to teach*.

The nearest human being is the one
Who causes greatest pain when life is done,
Unless one gets caught in the holocaust
Now refined since tri-racial cause is lost
And Jews have disappeared under the sun
Of European skies. (The loss is great.
The Turk has replaced them in German
hate.)

But to avoid the pierced heart and the hand
It's best to avoid churches and their band,
And even synagogues can be cold places
And mosques too where men fall down on
their faces.

Beloved, I take sweet counsel now with
You,

And sometimes even have to turn on cue
And flee from You to find Your smile in
view.

15 Let death seize on them, let them go
Down quickly into hell *below*,
For wickedness is where they stay
And with them *always every way*.

**16 Myself, I'll cry to Alohims
And YHWH shall save me *from the
dream*.**

17 Evening and morning and at noon
Will I pray and cry out loud *soon*,
And He shall hear my voice *aboon*.

The first prayer of the day arrives at
evening
When sun has set. The soul full of
believing
Returns to prostrate toward Your holy
room.

Its lights are dim for all its sweet perfume.
At dawn before the sun comes up the next
Prayer of the day greets every soul unweary
And odourless, yet pearly bright with light.
Noon wanes and all rush to the right and
sight

To lay the last prayers ever comes the
night.

Three times of prayer contain them all or
might.

The incense of my breath sweet with Your
names

Accumulates in full stops and inflames
The rising to love's labours in the air
Until the calls of prayer sound everywhere.

18 He's saved my soul in Islam from
The battle that's against me come,
For there were many in my sum.

**19 El God shall hear and worry them,
Even Huu that stays from old stem,
They have no change and they do not
Hold Alohims in fear *for plot*.**

20 Such a one has stretched out his hands
Against those who in peace commands
Were with him, and he's broken pact.

**21 His mouth's smoother than butter
sacked,**

**But war's in his heart, his words soft
Like oil, yet they were swords aloft.**

22 Just cast your load of care on YHWH
And He shall surely sustain you,
Nor let the righteous move from view.

23 But You, O Alohims, shall bring

**Them down into the pit of sting,
Bloody deceitful man shall not
Live out half their days in the plot,
But I shall trust in You *a lot*.**

Islam is not a sect's monopoly
Among the world faiths in their poverty,
But rather that peace that accords with
You,
No matter what identity is true,
Or where a man may live and bow in pew.
I rush into Islam, Beloved, and find
Submission to Your will is of the kind
That frees me from the need to seek a pope
Or sect or establishment as a rope.
Beloved, You save me by Islam indeed,
When I see in Your law that I am freed
From human sacrifices and the creed
That would bend mind to myth in majesty
Of priestly hopes and scopes eternally.

Psalm 56

1 To the chief musician upon
The Silent Dove Distant from Dawn,
Michtam of David when the wrath
Of Philistines took him in Gath.

**Have mercy, Alohim, on me,
For man would swallow me, and he
Fights daily and oppresses me.**

2 My enemies would come daily
To swallow up, for they're many
That come to battle against me,
O You most High *eternally*.

3 The day I fear, I'll trust in Thee.

**4 In Alohim I'll praise His word,
In Alohim I undeterred**

**Put my trust, I'll not be afraid,
What can flesh do to my *blockade*?**

5 Each day they wrest my words, all their
Thoughts for me bring their evil share.

6 They gather themselves in one place,
They hide themselves, they mark my trace,
When they wait for my soul's disgrace.

Some wrest my words on purpose, others
sink

Beneath the verbiage failing to make link,
Yet there are some who get it right first
time,

Despite the twists of rhythmic lines in
rhyme.

But none have been so busy wrestling words
As those who feast on Your Scriptures like
birds.

Beloved, save me from such sins that
appear

Not only in the docket as sincere
But wrench Your loving heart with pain to
see

How many would scorch You and then run
free.

If one or two hide looking for my trace
And hoping to make me a stumbling place,
The thousands of religious leaders here
Run You through with their sermons and
their gear.

7 Shall they escape by strategy
Of evil? In wrath thrown down the
Evil people, O Alohim.

**8 You count the places where I dream,
You save my tears in Your closed flask,
Are they not in Your book, I ask?**

**9 When I recite the psalm, my foes
Shall turn back, what to me it shows**

Is that Alohim's on His toes.

10 In Alohim I'll praise His word,
In YHWH indeed I'll praise His word.

11 In Alohim I've put my trust,
I'll not be afraid of what must
Man try to do to me *with dust*.

**12 The vows of Your praise are on me,
O Alohim, and I shall be
Here to render praises to Thee.**

13 For You have saved my soul from death,
My feet from falling, that with breath
I may walk before Alohim,
In light of living *in His stream*.

I walk before You, my Beloved, and see
The autumn hand upon the fern and tree
That mark the path up hill and down for me
As four times in the day I seek the free
Air of the woods alone, in company
Of bird and beast, of angel on the wing,
Of You invisibly who stop to sing.
I walk before You, my Beloved, and hear
The footfall of the frost come to appear
Before the dawn, and where his steps
severe

Mark in dark lines the fallen leaf and sheer
I make my way past turns and then I steer

My own steps back towards my yellow
house,
Homely and bright, and safe from squirrel
and mouse.

Psalm 57

1 To the chief Musician, the tune
Do Not Destroy, michtam to croon
Of David, when he fled from Saul
In the cave. Oh be merciful
To me, O Alohim, and be
Merciful to me for my soul
Trusts You, indeed, I make my goal
The shadow of Your wings to flee
Until is past calamity.

**2 I'll cry to Alohim most high,
To Alohim who works for me.**

3 And he will send down from the sky
Salvation from reproach on me
By him that would swallow me up.

**Alohim shall send out His cup
Of mercy and truth *constantly*.**

4 My soul is in the lions' den,
I lie among them kindled then
With fire, even the sons of men,
Whose teeth are spears and arrows, and
Their tongue is a sharp sword *in hand*.

5 Be You exalted, Alohim,
Above the heavens, and let beam
Your glory above all the earth.

**6 They have prepared a trap in mirth
For my steps, my soul is bowed down,
They've dug a pit for me, and yet,
They themselves fell into the net.**

7 My heart's steadfast, O Alohim,
My heart's steadfast and I esteem
My song and praise *to You supreme*.

**8 Awake, my glory, and awake
Psaltery and harp, I will awake
The dawn. 9 I will praise You, O Lord,
Among the people, I will sing
To You among the nations' ring.**

10 For Your mercy's great to the sky,
Your truth up to the clouds on high.

**11 Then be exalted, Alohim,
Above the heavens, and let gleam
Your glory above all the earth.**

The pit that they have dug to take my soul
Is simply the cathedral on the dole.
Established faiths are out to get a crowd

And take them captive where they're not
allowed.

My temple is the dome of sky above,
My temenos the angle of Your love,
My tabernacle is the living voice
Of Psalms in cantillation by the choice
Harp of my David king. So I rejoice.
Beloved, I see the hunters fallen in
Their own pit dug with malice and with sin
And covered with the crooning of false
faith

And love pretended, fatal breath of wraith,
The pagan gods rising up from the bin.

Psalm 58

1 To the chief musician, to tune
Do Not Destroy, michtam to croon
Of David. Do you indeed speak
Righteously, O assembly weak,
Do you judge right, O sons of men?

**2 Yea, in heart you work wickedness,
Weigh violence of your hands' guess
Upon the earth *on hill and fen*.**

3 The wicked all have gone astray
Even from birth, who will relay
Lies from seeing the light of day.

**4 Their poison's like poison of asp,
Like the deaf adder closes hasp
Of her ear, 5 not to hear the voice
Of charmers, charming of their choice.**

6 So break their teeth, O Alohim,
In their mouth, break out the extreme
Great teeth of the young lions, YHWH.

**7 Let them melt away as the flow
Of waters running on the go,
When he bends to shoot arrows, let
Them be as cut in pieces yet.**

8 As a snail melting, let them pass,
The untimely birth of the mass
Of a woman from the sun's *brass*.

**9 Before your pots can feel the thorns,
He'll take them away as with horns
Of whirlwind, as living as wrath.**

10 The righteous shall rejoice when he
Sees the vengeance, and then shall he
Wash his feet in the wicked's blood.

**11 So that a man gone down that path
Shall say "Surely there is a cud
To reward the righteous, truly
He is a God that judges earth
Before the day has given birth."**

In California when a young man I
 Was camping in the woods with classmates
 by
 The mammoth redwood trees where on the
 ground
 Crawl giant yellow slugs, be they
 renowned.
 A boy poured salt on one, I saw it melt
 Away like dew, curled up with what it felt.
 Beloved, pour salt upon the tempter here
 That would bring me in bondage with my
 gear
 To church and synagogue, the mosque
 fear,
 And let the tempter melt away before
 The salty truth poured out upon his sore.
 I do rejoice to see the vengeance fall
 Upon the teachers of false faith and call,
 And flee to You alone in hearth and stall.

Psalm 59

1 To the chief Musician, Altaschith
 (destroy not), Michtam of David;
 when Saul sent, and they watched the
 house to kill him.

**Save me from foes, my Alohim,
 Set me above the rising stream.**

**2 Save me from evil doers and
 Save me from the bloody men's hand.**

3 For here they set an ambush for
 My life, the strong gather by score
 Against me, not because I've done
 Any wrong or sin under sun,
 O YHWH. 4 They run and set themselves
 Though I have no fault *on my shelves*,
 Wake to help me and see *what's done*.

**5 Then You, YHWH Alohim of hosts,
 The Alohim of Israel's boasts,
 Rise up to punish all the folk,
 Have no mercy on wicked bloke.**

6 They come back at evening to bark
 Like a dog round the city *dark*.

**7 See they sound with their mouth, and
 swords**

**Are in their lips, for who *in hordes*
 Hears what they do *for their rewards*?**

8 But you, YHWH, laugh at them to scorn,
 You'll put down all the heathen *born*.

That other dogs surround the good and
 kind.

The many words of Psalmist in the bind
 That call down curses on the dined and
 wined

Are just short-hand upon the path entwined.
 Let's not crab for semantics on the lot.
 A curse may be a blessing when it's caught.
 The ones who fear the evil energy
 And grapple with fair words and make a
 plea

That opposition creates false relief
 Are simply dealing with the love of grief.
 Let me curse, my Beloved, when it is well,
 With tender blessing too when time to
 quell.

All things have their time, though the hour
 is brief.

9 By his might! I shall wait for You,
 For Alohim's my defence *due*.

**10 My Alohim of mercy comes
 To my encounter, and the sums
 On my foes Alohim makes see.**

11 Do not kill them, lest it should be
 My folk forget, scatter them by
 Your power, and bring down from the sky,
 Who are our shield, O Adonai.

**12 The sin of their mouth and the words
 Of there lips cast them in the turds
 Of their pride, and for curse and lie
 That they go speaking *by and by*.**

13 Consume in wrath, consume so they
 Are not, and let them know the way
 That Alohim holds Jacob's sway
 Unto the ends of the earth's way.

**14 And at evening let them return,
 Let them bark like a dog and *learn*
 To wander round what cities *spurn*.**

15 Let them go up and down for meat,
 Howling unfilled and without treat.

**16 While I shall praise and sing Your
 power,**

**Sing loud of Your mercy the hour
 Of morning, for You've been my shield
 And refuge in troubled day's *field*.**

17 To You, my strength, now I shall sing,
 For Alohim's my shield and wing,
 The God of my mercy to bring.

The dervish dog escapes, Beloved, to find

The ranging curs about the town come soon

To chase the smell of flesh and gain a
boon.
Though I'm a dog beside the mosque
gate,
And lie unfilled with goods of bloody rate,
I'm satisfied with treats beyond the moon.
My mouth is filled with praises of Your
name,
I howl Huu on the silences and flame
Of night beneath the stars in rapid game.
Beloved, the morning comes upon my song
And I find that You have not been too long
In Your return upon the daily wheel.
I rise up sniffing and snap at Your heel,
And in a moment rise upon the wing
Of hope, though canine for the service
sting.

Psalm 60

1 To the chief Musician upon
Shushaneduth, Michtam of David, to
teach; when he fought with
Aramnaharaim and with Aramzobah,
when Joab returned, and attacked
Edom in the valley of salt twelve
thousand.

Alohim, You have cast us off,
You've scattered us as if to scoff,
So turn to us again. 2 You've made
The earth tremble, its balustrade
Torn down, now heal its breaches bare,
Because it's shaking everywhere.
**3 You've shown hard matters to Your
folk,**

**You've made us drink wine gone for
broke.**

4 You've given a flag to those who fear
You, to be flown where truth appear,
5 That Your beloved may be saved, save
With Your right hand and hear Your *slave*.

**6 Alohim speaks in holiness,
I shall rejoice, I shall divide
Shechem and mete out side by side
The valley of Succoth to hide.**

Salvation for the Psalmist seems to be
The gathering of his folk where they flee
Into the promised land and there rejoice,
Dividing Shechem once again with voice
Of vengeance for the way Dinah's been
treated

After the circumcised have been defeated.
The martyrdom in white has touched my
brow

For three hundred years running anyhow,
So I can understand the scattered gain
That is salvation in King David's reign.
Beloved, a nomad pilgrim on the earth,
I too look for salvation and safe berth
As I come in the chamber of my heart
To bow to You alone and without art.

7 Gilead's mine, Manasseh too,
Ephraim also's my strength to do,
Judah's my lawgiver *in crew*.

**8 Moab's my washpot, on Edom
I'll throw my shoe, Philistia, come
Triumph because of what I do.**

9 Who will bring me in the city
Of Strength? And who then will lead me
Into Edom? 10 Will not You, God,
Who once cast us out *on the sod*?
And Alohim who did not go
Out before our armies *in show*?

**11 Give us help from our trouble, vain
Is the help of a man for gain.
12 By Alohim we'll do greatly,
For He'll tread down our enemy.**

Gilead's mine, and so is Manasseh,
And Ephraim too, so You come to say.
Beloved, I understand the trial here,
How sometimes Simeon wants to appear,
And Joseph takes the name beneath his
wing

When Ephraim would stand and try to sing
And Manasseh claim to be son and king.
It's hard to fit all who would represent
You, my Beloved, in just twelve lines'
descent,

But Ishmael's fair example seems to mean
That all and ever after on the scene
Must meet the public gaze in groups of
twelve,

And others remain extras and to shelve.
I count the twelve and rejoice with a bean.

Psalm 61

1 To the chief Musician upon Neginah (a
stringed instrument), *A Psalm of
David*.

Hear my cry, Alohim, attend

My prayer. 2 I cry from the earth's end
To You, when my heart's overwhelmed,
Lead me to the rock higher realmed
Than I. 3 For You're shelter for me,
A strong tower from the enemy.

**4 I shall stay in Your safety's tent
Forever, I shall trust the vent
Of Your wings. 5 For You, Alohim,
Have heard my vows, as it may seem
You make reward to me appear
As those who Your name come to fear.**

6 You make the king's life last as long
As generations of his song.

**7 He shall forever sit before
The face of Alohim and more
Mercy and truth save at his door.**

8 So I shall sing praise to Your name
For ever, to perform the same
Daily in my vows *without shame*.

King David is the figure in my heart
That makes me turn to You, Beloved, and
part

With other kings that vie for company.
I turn to You alone, no Trinity.
Your reward on the king is set and sure,
Let my heart too be cleansed and so made
pure

Of every sin defiling. Let me wake
Each morning to live one day for his sake
And for the sake of my Beloved. Your face,
Beloved, is ever in the hidden place
Where I flee to enjoy the prophet's race.
Give me a generation of his song
And I shall strive to walk and not be long
To enter in the tent with ancient throng.

Psalm 62

1 To the chief Musician, to Jeduthun, a
Psalm of David.

Indeed for Alohim awaits
My soul, from Him open the gates
Of my salvation from *these fates*.

The gates, the lovely gates, lead to the town
Of Holiness, Jerusalem and crown,
Into the faith where dear Muhammad waits,
And by the path of all the holy gates.
Muhammad is the city, says the rune,
And Ali is the gate, goes on the tune.
But every faith both natural in boon

Or predicated on the high-blown noon
Of special revelation, at the core
Accepts no one but You, Beloved, no more.
Beloved I enter in the gate of pearl
And walk the street of gold and see unfurl
The tree of life with twelve fruits and in
leaf
And leave outside the gate sorrow and
grief.

2 He only is my rock and my
Salvation, my defence and I
Shall not be greatly moved awry.

The beautiful, the Hasan, led the way
Of acquiescence before kings astray,
Not out of fear and cowardice nor yet
For lack of trust that You could come and
set

All things to rights, nor even lack of hope.
No, Hasan clung to all of these for rope,
But in his verdicts called Your guidance
true:

He acquiesced in fact only to You.
You were his rock and his salvation too,
You were his defence, he was unmoved
then.

Hasan gives an example to all men.
I take the guidance, my Beloved, and make
You only my rock for salvation's sake,
Only You my defence, unmoved I wake.

3 How long will you imagine vain
Mischief against a man? Be slain
All of you like a bowing wall
And as a fence about to fall.

The dearest, my Hussein, calls out again
"How long will you take vanity for men?"
He sees the columns raising the dry dust,
He sees the frightful coming, but his trust
Is in You, my Beloved, till very death,
And He proclaims Your name with the last
breath.

He could have taken this verse as his spell,
He could have shaken down a flowing well,
He could have smitten all the enemies
Down like a wall and bowing to their
knees.

Instead he turned from idol vanity,
He met the sacrifice, and came to be

The banner of oppressed till light of day
At last illuminate the divine sway.

4 They only consult to cast down
From his high place, they do not frown
At lies, although with mouth they bless,
Inside they curse *and do not guess*.

The well of Kauthar that transmitted drops
Of blessing from Ali to his sons stops
To gather sweetness where Ali again
Called Zaynel Abideen among earth's men
Bows down in supplication and in word
Of beauty to thank for all that occurred.
Would that his innocence and that which
stirred
His heart from Hussein's sacrifice were
heard
Throughout the world, and every heart
made pure,
And every hand and foot strong to endure.
Ah, my Beloved, some even say his name
And yet are filled with hypocritic blame.
They do not frown at lies, they come to
reign.
Beloved, I feel the Imam's joy and pain.

5 My soul, wait only upon God,
For my hope's from His hand *and rod*.

"Whoever thinks that there is change
In You, Beloved, is in the range
Of unbelief!" said Muhammad
The son of Ali Hussein had.
That is the reason why in truth
A man goes not astray in youth
Nor in old age who only waits
On You, Beloved, upon hope's gates.
Beloved, I take the teaching brought
By the dear hand that split the sought
And showed the kernel and the nut
Of righteousness that had been shut.
Beloved, I wait for You alone
And plant my hope before Your throne.

6 He alone is my rock and my
Salvation, my defence, and I
Shall not be moved *under the sky*.

Imam Ja'far Al-Sadiq once proclaimed

That he would make men know their faith
enflamed

So well that none should need to ask
another

For verdicts on how to deal with his
brother.

Since that time there has been no need to
ask

For information in the faith to bask,
But those who ask, ask as asking in blame
To multiply unnecessary fame.

Beloved, I see since Ja'far in his due
That all knowledge of faith has come in
view,

And what is not known after him is just
The glimmering of fool's gold in the dust
To tempt the mind to doubt and hesitate
Instead of rushing through the open gate.

7 In Alohim's salvation and
My glory, the rock of my hand,
My refuge is in God's *command*.

The lion may come to the path to ask
Me of the way the lioness in task
Shall bear her young, and whether it shall
be

A male or female, but in all safety
I turn to Makkah and repeat the prayer
That You, Beloved, will meet the lion's
share.

You are my great salvation and my rock,
My glory and my refuge from the stock
Of beast and fowl that fall upon such men
As trample on the lion and his den.
I ride the mule of Abul-Hasan and
Find everything submitted to Your hand,
The Sabbath of Imams brings out Your rest
And so I dine and chatter with the best.

8 Trust in Him at all times, you folk,
Pour out your heart before His stroke,
God is our refuge *like an oak*.

Beloved, I say no word at all about
My debt of twenty-eight dinars in rout,
But only trust in You, for at all times
Your secret is known where the goatherd
climbs.

If I pour out my heart in secret prayer,
The one who does Your service is aware.

I only stop to take a meal with him,
 I make no request of him bright or dim,
 But take from his hand what he has to give
 And humbly go my way. And so I live.
 Beloved, let me pour out my heart again
 In Psalms of praise to You without the men
 Around me knowing what I lack or save.
 With You as my refuge I can be brave.

9 Indeed low men are vanity,
 And false are men of high degree,
 To be laid in the balance they
 Are wholly in vanity's sway.

The vain and cunning question was allowed
 Before Al-Jawad, spoken by the proud:
 What of the man a pilgrim purified
 Kills a beast while he's hunting on the
 side?

False men of high degree will stand to
 share
 Humiliation at the speech to bear:
 Was it known or unknown, deliberate
 Or by mistake, was he free or in state
 Of slavery, young or old, did he know how
 To hunt or was he ignorant in brow?
 Was the beast winged or not, one great or
 small,
 Did the man justify himself at all
 Or was he in regret, was it at night
 Of in the day, umra or hajj by right?

10 Do not trust in oppression's way,
 To become vain in stealing's pay,
 If wealth rise, turn your heart away.

Ten thousand dinars at a glance are not
 Enough to deflect Al-Hadi in thought
 From his prayer in prostration. So I seal
 The morning light of gold and turn my heel
 Toward the glitter of the mica face
 Of stone that beckons me out of my place.
 I do not trust the force of arms that bear
 The shield of ill-gained peace upon the
 stair,
 Nor do I give my hand to those who share
 The legislator's power upon the trace.
 Beloved, I turn my heart from every grace
 Of worldly way and hold fast to the cloak
 And hat of wool that shows upon the
 stroke,

And turn with righteous ones toward
 Makkah's oak.

11 Once spoke Alohim, twice have I
 Heard this, that power's Alohim's die.

The power is Yours, Beloved, who came to
 bear

Upon Hasan the warrior for the share
 That made his name great, though his
 humble rate

Was seen in the simplicity he ate.

The power is Yours, Beloved, though few
 men know

That You control the way that things must
 go

Until the day of judgement come to show,
 And then each man will come to know his
 fate.

Fortuna is a goddess who is blind
 And deaf and non-existent in the rind,
 And only You, Beloved, can hold the sway
 Of power that balances the night with day,
 That leads to righteousness, away from
 wrong,

That turns to glory my own humble song.

12 To You, Lord, is mercy, for You
 Give every man by his work's due.

Your mercy, my Beloved, among mere
 men

Is that You've hidden some to stand again
 As witness to Your oneness and behind
 The scenes to guide events among the
 blind.

The dreams of state seem empty, no
 footfall

Is heard to echo on the royal hall,
 And yet the unseen messenger is there
 To turn the tide of terror and to dare
 The hand of the oppressor in the stall.
 Beloved, I search Your mercy and I wake
 To sense the presence of one whose estate
 Is more than royal, who takes David's
 share

And though unseen remains standing and
 tall.

This Psalm of vanity reveals the way
 The vain thing that an idol is in sway

May secretly enter into the heart
 To make the righteous man unwisely start
 To worship at the altar that seems right,
 But leads the soul into the darkest night.
 Beloved, let me trust in You only when
 I would turn to the praises of mere men.
 Those in the high degree seem to be good,
 They seem to lead the people as they
 should,
 But all is idol worship in the day
 They use their violence in controlled way
 To patch the status quo with golden ray.
 I turn from town to paddle in the wood.

Psalms 63

1 A Psalm of David, when he was in the wilderness of Judah.

**O Alohims, you are my El,
 Early will I seek You and well,
 My soul thirsts for You, my flesh longs
 For You in a dry land of songs
 For thirst, where no water belongs.**

2 To see Your power and glory, so
*As I have seen You on the go
 In the sanctuary to glow.*

**3 Better is Your lovingkindness
 Than life, my lips shall aye address
 Praise unto You and still confess.**

4 So will I bless thee while I live:
 I will lift up my hands and give
 Glory to Your name *as I bless.*

**5 My soul it shall be satisfied
 As with marrow and fatness *fried*;
 My mouth shall praise with joyful lips,**

**6 When I remember You upon
 My bed, think on You till the dawn.**

This book of Psalms is the book called in
 thirst

Both for the blessed and also those who're
 cursed.

The hart pants for the water brook and still
 The thirst of righteous souls to do Your
 will,

Beloved, is iterated on the hill
 Of Mizar and of Sinai to the flood
 Of the Euphrates where the day ran blood.
 Let me praise You, Beloved, and slake my
 own

Thirst in the waters that flow from Your
 throne,

And let me hear the joy that thunders down
 From dawn upon the sleeping of the town.
 Beloved, the soul is satisfied to know
 The lyrics of the ghazels in the show
 That ask of love nothing beyond the row.

7 Since You have ever been my help,
 Therefore in the shadow *and skelp*
 Of Your wings I'll rejoice *and yelp.*

**8 My soul follows hard after You,
 Your right hand holds me up to view.**

9 But those who seek my soul that they
 May plunder it shall go the way
 Of the lower parts of earth's sway.

**10 They'll fall by the sword: they shall
 be**

A meal for foxes *once set free.*

11 Let king rejoice in Alohims
 While all who swear by Him shall beam,
 But the mouth of those who speak lies
 Shall be stopped up *before Your eyes.*

It seems I live an era fraught with lies,
 I find so many lies about my size
 That I can hardly recognize myself.
 And yet I faithfully sit on the shelf
 To meditate and praise Your holy name
 As I remember Your diviner claim
 Upon my bed in the night-time when I
 Murmur the dhikr of the Psalms to find
 How many of the stars might become blind.
 Under Your wings and out of sight I stand
 Still wondering at the lies of human band,
 But filled with faith that You, Beloved, are
 near

To me and mine always to know and hear.
 I pray the prayer of David on the grand.

Psalms 64

1 To the chief Musician, A Psalm of David.
**Hear, Alohims, my voice,
 From fear of enemy rejoice
 To keep my life both safe and choice.**

2 Hide me from secret wicked plots,
 From the insurgents in their clots,

3 Who whet their tongues like swords and
 bend

Their arrows like bitter words' end,
 4 To shoot from hiding at the just,

And suddenly shoot from the dust
 Without fear *of reprisal's lust.*

**5 They strengthen in a wicked plan,
To lay snares secretly for man,
They say “Who shall reveal or can?”**

6 The search out dark iniquities,
They finish with their search at ease,
The inward of each one is deep,
And their heart never goes to sleep.

**7 But Alohim lets arrow fly
At them and suddenly they die.**

8 So they’ll turn tongue upon themselves,
And all who see them *among elves*
Shall flee *to escape from their shelves*.

**9 Shall fear each man and shall declare
The work of Alohim is there,
For they shall wisely think upon
The end of his doing that’s drawn.**

10 The righteous shall be glad in YHWH
And shall trust Him in what they do,
And everyone upright in heart
Shall glory in *Him for his part*.

How times and plots do not change on the
earth,

How it remains a desert in it’s dearth
Where snares are secretly set out by all
Who come around me with the craven pall.
Yet I step out upon a world set free
By winter’s march and snow’s new destiny
To follow Your tracks from the step into
The sleeping wood standing like ghostly
crew,

Knee-deep in white and cracking in the
frost.

I step out in faith that the story cost
Shall not bend down the trees that comfort
me

Beneath the pregnant sky till crimsonly
The night steps in to say the last word
where

My whirling and my turning make my
prayer.

Psalm 65

1 To the chief Musician, A Psalm *and Song*
of David.

**Praise waits for you, O Alohim,
In the fortress, and all esteem
To perform their vow to Your gleam.**

2 O you who hear prayer, to you will
All living come to prayer fulfil.

3 Words of iniquity prevail

**Against us, our transgressions’ pale
You shall clear away *without fail*.**

4 Blessed whom You choose and cause to
come

To live in Your courts, we’ll become
Satisfied with the goodness in
Your house, Your holy temple win.

**5 Terrible things in righteousness
You will answer us who confess,
O God of our salvation, hope
Of all the earth’s ends and to cope
For them afar off on the sea.**

6 By His strength He sets fast the hills
Belted with power *that all things fills*.

**7 He stills the roaring of the sea,
Its waves’ noises unceasingly,
The peoples’ tumult *wonderfully*.**

8 They too who live in regions far
Fear at the rising of Your star,
You make the morning to rejoice,
And evening coming lift its voice.

**9 You come to earth to water it,
You greatly enrich it as fit
With a mighty river *and fair*
Filled with waters, and You prepare
Them grain provided and with care.**

10 You sprinkle ridges thoroughly,
Settling down its furrows wetly,
And make it soft with showers to bless
The growing of it *and address*.

**12 They drop upon the pastures of
The desert, and the hills above,
The little hills rejoice *in love*.**

13 The pastures clad in flocks of sheep,
The valleys covered over deep
With corn, they shout for joy and keep
A song *above what they shall reap*.

The proud words that the Psalmist here
inscribes

In praise of You, Beloved, among the tribes
Is like to draw disdain from Baal’s first
priests

Who claim the rain is product of their
feasts.

It’s like to draw a sneering smile from
those

Who think the rain in scientific prose
Is but the condensate of what arose
From sea and lake, in dew and mist and
cloud.

Beloved, I speak to You above the crowd
Of worshippers who bow and pray aloud.
The singer on the temple steps is done,
The stones are barely to be seen by sun,
And Aqsa now within the portico
Is where the teachers sit, the pupils stow.

Psalm 66

1 To the chief Musician, A Song *or* Psalm.

**Make a joyful sound unto God,
All you lands on the earth and sod.**

**2 Sing out the honour of His name,
And make His praise glorious in fame.**

3 Say to Alohim "How are seen
Your works!" Through might of Your
demesne

Shall Your foes fall down at Your scene.

**4 All the earth comes to worship You
And sing together Your praise due,
They'll sing to Your name *all in crew*.**

5 Come see the works of Alohim,
Terrible toward children of men.

**6 He turned the sea into dry land:
They went through the flood on the sand
By foot: there we rejoiced in Him.**

7 He rules by His power never dim,
His eyes see the nations, do not
Let the rebellious raise a plot.

Beloved, for centuries the human race,
And best of it, perhaps, in this fine place,
Has harked back to the drying of Red Sea
When You fell on Pharaoh's band in a
spree

Of vast destruction and saved those who
tried

To leave the civilized and multiplied.

I do not come to point at violence
As something immoral about Your tents.
I rather come to say that if that's all
You've done to push the thug against the
wall,

Then Your hack record is not really great.
Two million came from Egypt, but in
freight

Three times as many died in better times
When men had learned to make both guns
and rhymes.

8 Bless then, O folk, our Alohim,
Raise the sound of His praise to gleam.

9 He keeps our soul in life and He
Does not let our feet stumble free.

**10 For You have tested us, O God,
Tried us as silver on the sod.**

**11 You brought us down into the net,
You laid affliction on us set.**

12 You made men ride over our heads,
We went through fire and riverbeds,
You brought us out into a place
Of wealth *and comfort by Your face*.

The place of comfort was not Palestine.
That has been war-ridden by Philistine
And Canaanite, and Hellene and the crew
Of Rome set out to fill up every pew.
That place of comfort was not the Ukraine,
Or Poland or the vasty German wain,
Or even Scotland under northern stain,
Where pogrom is the watchword of the
stew.

Och! I almost forgot that Scotland is
Perhaps the only land not in the biz
Of pogroms on the European front.
I leave the Scots in innocence to punt.
It's Andalus for sure that refuge when
David was living and singing with men.

13 I'll go into Your house to bring
You every kind of burnt offering,
To You I'll pay my vows *and sing*,
14 As my lips have promised the thing,
And as my mouth has spoken, when
I was in trouble *before men*.

**15 I'll offer You burnt sacrifice
Of fat flesh, and with rams' incense,
I'll offer bullocks in a trice
With goats raised up outside my tents.**

16 Come all you fearing Alohim,
And I'll declare what He in scheme
Has done for my soul *as He deem*.

**17 I cried to Him with mouth and lips,
Extolled Him with my tongues *that slips*.**

**18 If I hide sin in my own heart,
The Lord won't listen to my part.**

19 Truly God's heard and listened to
The sound of my prayer to Him due.

20 Blessed be Alohim who has not
Turned from my prayer, mercy forgot.

Beloved, I do not wish to hide my sin
Deep in my heart, but throw it in the bin.

Hear my prayer then, and wherein I have failed

To seek out sin and quell it now impaled
Upon the dagger of your word and law,
Let me seek further beneath armoured claw.

Turn not from my prayer that is turned to You,

And though You must escape from my eye's view,
Do not fail to answer the humble prayer
That follows Your flight on the open air.
Though I have no bulls on the frying pan,
Nor blood of sheep and goats, nor even man,

Hear, my Beloved, the prayer that does not fail

To seek You and Your heart beyond the gale.

Psalm 67

To the chief Musician on Neginoth, A Psalm *or* Song.

**1 Alohim have mercy on us,
Bless us and cause His face to shine
On us 2 So Your way obvious
May be known on the earth for sign,
Salvation among all folk fine.**

3 Let the people praise You, O God,
All folk praise You *upon the sod*.

4 Oh let the nations now be glad
And sing for joy *and not be sad*,
For You shall judge with righteousness
The people governing to bless,
The nations of the earth address.

**5 Let the people thank You, O God,
Let them give thanks all in the pod.**

6 Then shall the earth yield her increase,
God, our own Alohim's release
Shall bless us *and shall never cease*.

**7 Shall bless us Alohim and all
The ends of earth be in His thrall.**

The earth indeed yields her increase the day
The summer tinges winter's clouds of grey
And wakens all the tulips in my play
To gladden my springs and my soils to stay
As long as summer lasts. I make my way
Beyond the apple trees to where the wild
Bird cherries stand aghast, irreconciled
With new growth of the apples. I take saw

And axe and trim the cherries, cast in maw
Of mulcher the bright odours from their
crawl.

Beloved, the earth yields her increase again
To joy of bird and squirrel and of men.
I turn upon her dancing and return
To find the cycle of learn and relearn.

Psalm 68

To the chief Musician, A Psalm *or* Song of David.

**1 Let God arise, and let His foe
Be scattered and let them also
That hate Him flee before His row.**

2 As the smoke dissipates so drive
Them away and out of the hive,
As wax melts before fire so let
The wicked perish as they met
Alohim who is present yet.

**3 But let the righteous ones be glad,
Let them rejoice and not be sad
Before Alohim, and greatly
Rejoice before One not to see.**

4 Sing to Alohim to His name
Psalms praising Him who is not lame
To ride on the skies by His fame
Of YAH rejoicing just the same.

**5 A father of the fatherless,
A judge of the widows no less
Alohim's His holy address.**

6 Alohim sets in families
The lonely ones, He brings to please
Out those bound with chains, but the ones
Rebelling sit on their dry buns.

Some want to be set up in churches met
Where priests and elders rule them by the
net,

And that's catastrophe, whether it's set
By county, state, the crown or parliament
Or by the congregation with consent.
Beloved, take me away from every church,
I see in time they always leave in lurch,
But give me final resting place and perch
To be set in a family and tent.
The family of Abraham was spent
To show what faith can be once it is lent,
And Ishmael and Isaac knew from the go
That family is the best thing on show.
You are my family, Beloved, I know.

7 O Alohim, when You went out
Before Your people round about,
When You marched through the desert
drought,

8 The earth shook and the heavens also
Dropped at the presence of the glow
Of Alohim, Sinai itself
At the sitting upon its shelf
Of Alohim of Israel.

**9 Rain in abundance did You send,
Alohim, by it did You bend**

A confirmation of the lend

When it was too weary to spend.

10 Your congregation came to dwell
In it, Alohim, prepared well
Your good things for the poor as well.

**11 The Lord gave the command and
great**

Was the band who proclaimed its rate.

12 Kings of armies in flight apace
Left at home who divides the grace.

**13 Though you were lying among pots
Like silver wings of doves your lots
Shall be and feathers in their slots
Of yellow gold that never rots.**

14 When the Almighty scattered kings
In it like Salmon's snow *for wings*.

**15 The great hill like hill of Bashan,
A high hill like hill of Bashan.**

16 Why do you jump, you mountains high?
Alohim desires here to try
To live in this hill by and by,
Indeed YHWH will live there for aye.

I beg to say a word for Mount Sinai
Every chance I get in open or sly.
Bashan is great for cows, and I've no word
To say against the cattle, since I've stirred
From Ayrshire and escaped thence like a
bird.

And Zion is a fortress hill of fame
Although as hills go it has hardly claim.
And Point Mountain in West Virginia lies
At the gate where my grandfather's
disguise

Took him into the world to seek the prize.
But no hill is like Sinai, where You came,
Beloved, as Scriptures say to tell the game,
Unless it really happened as they say
At the Red Pipestone quarry on a day.

17 Great chariots twenty thousand
Thousands of angels at the hand
Of the Lord holy Sinai's stand.

**18 You have ascended to the sky,
You've led captivity thereby
Captive, You have received gifts there
For men, indeed rebels have share,
That YHWH Alohim will dwell there.**

19 Blessed be the Lord who day by day
Gifts us in an abundant way,
The El of our salvation's ray.

**20 Our El's a saving God, to YHWH
The Lord the matters of death due.**

21 But Alohim shall wound the head
Of His foes and the hairy spread
Of such as still in sins is led.

**22 The Lord said "I will then bring back
From Bashan, I will set the track**

From the sea's depths now *without slack*

**23 So your foot may be dipped in blood
Of your enemies and the flood
Of it for tongue of dogs in mud.**

The angels that mount at Sinai to greet
The burning law You speak without retreat
Number to twenty million. I should think
That would suffice to stop upon the brink
The ones who wish to diverge from Your
law

To make a troika of gods with a jaw,
Or fasten Your name on an idol bare,
Or come a day late to appointment where
You promise to meet every one alive.
Some wish to honour parents only when
They earn respect, and others for a yen
Are out to kill. I'd think the angel band
Should be enough to keep law in the land
And make order the order of the hive.

24 They've seen Your goings, Alohim,
The goings of my Alohim,
My King in the holy regime.

**25 The singers went before, and those
Who play on instruments to close,
Young ladies playing timbrels rose.**

26 So bless Alohim in assembly,
And YHWH from Israel's fountain
trembly.

**27 Little Benjamin ruler great,
Princes of Judah at the gate
Of council, chiefs of Zebulun,**

Heads of Naphtali under sun.

28 Your Alohim's commanded strength,
Strengthen, O Alohim the length
For us all of the things You've done.

29 Since Your house at Jerusalem Is where kings give You diadem.

If Benjamin is little, I would rather state
That Saul of Benjamin and king of late
Was tallest of all kings that reigned a while
In city of Jerusalem in file
Or even in Samaria for style.

King David does not try to hide the fame
Of Saul and Benjamin and some for blame
Who represent a dynasty renewed.
David is one with faithful love imbued.
Beloved, I too love Benjamin and Saul
As I look at the portraits on the wall
Of kings long gone whose fame and livery
Resound in cantillated word and free,
Look down upon Your grace eternally.

30 Rebuke the spearmen's band, the herd
Of bulls with the calves undeterred
Of the people, that he submit
Himself with silver pieces fit,
Scatter the folk all who delight
In warfare *and descent to night.*

31 Princes shall come out of Egypt, And Cush shall stretch out wings *unclipped*

To Alohim soon *and unzipped.*

32 Kings of earth, sing to Alohim,
Sing praises to the Lord *in scheme.*

33 To Him that rides above the skies From Ancient time, see He'll arise To send out His voice mightily.

34 Ascribe strength to Alohim's fee,
His excellence on Israel wee,
Strong in the clouds *above the sea.*

35 Terrible is Alohim from Your holy places where You come, Israel's El HUU gives strength and power To folk, Blessed be Alohim's hour.

Blessed be Your hour indeed, Beloved, and
Your

Holy places upon the distant shore
Of the skies realms of stars and on the near

Chambered temple rooms of the granite
sheer
Walls of my heart. Beloved, be blessed
indeed

Above the clouds, below the lingered seed
That waits the coming of the springtime
mead.

Who ride above the skies on chariot drawn
Of light and shadow on the trembling
dawn,

To send Your voice creating on the crest,
Stop in my soul once more to take a rest.
The terrible in mercy, I find You
Among the shawls and the lights of true,
Despite the knowing You are not in view.

Psalm 69

To the chief Musician on the lilies. *A Psalm*
of David.

1 Save me, O Alohim, because The waters come above my paws.

2 I sink in the deep mire where I
Cannot stand, I have come in sty
Of deep waters where floods arise
And overflow me *to the eyes.*

3 I'm tired of crying with throat dry, My eyes fail while I wait for my Alohim. 4 More than my head's prize Of hairs are those who hate my guise Without a reason, they'd destroy Me, wrongfully they would employ, My foes are mighty, I gave back What I had not taken in slack.

5 O Alohim, You know my way
Of foolishness, my sins today
Are not hidden from Your relay.

Now righteous men know also what it feels
Like to be numbered among the fair heels,
The ones who floundered all about the ark
And those who left the green Egyptian park
To trample in the Red Sea's bottom dark.
The waters rise above the reach of hand
And feet sink in the moving, sloughing
sand,
And cries grow hoarse before the turning
wheels.

Beloved, I see the rise of miqwe and
The dark baptisms flooding all the land
And turn my breath to Youward where You
stand

Above the mighty foes that dream of sin
And ways to circumvent the Judgement
bin.

All men are caught in the same stemped
tin.

6 Don't let be ashamed those who wait
On You, O Lord YHWH, for my state,
Let not those who see You confounded
Be for my sake, Alohim *sounded*
To Israel and her armies *grounded*.

**7 For Your sake I have borne reproach,
Shame covered my face like a roach.**

8 I have become a stranger to
My brothers, foreigner in view
Of My own mother's children too.

**9 The zeal of Your house consumes me,
Those who reproached You reproach
me.**

10 When I wept and with fasting cried,
That was to my reproach beside.

**11 I dressed in gunny sacks and I
Became a joke to every guy.**

12 Those sitting in judgement speak up
Against me, I was in the cup
Of drunkards singing to fill up.

**13 But as for me, my prayer's to You,
O YHWH, in time acceptable,
O Alohim, in the accrue
Of Your mercy, hear me in full
For truth of Your salvation's pull.**

But as for me, my prayer to You, O Huu,
In the acceptable time, Allah, You
Will find beneath the multitude of Your
Great mercy, that You in abundance pour
Upon the one You hear recite Your name.
Arising from prostration without shame
Like David I whirl in the flame of love
And send the hearing of my prayer above.
Acceptable the time, acceptable
The word that rises from prostration full
And clear, so let the time of prayer draw
near.

The time acceptable for prayer is dear
And bright from day to day. Beloved, I
come
In prayer to crack the nut, divide the plum.

14 Save me from mire, don't let me sink
Let me be saved from those who think

Evil against me, from the deep.

**15 Don't let the flood bury my sleep,
Nor let the water swallow me,
Don't let the pit close over me.**

16 Hear me, O YHWH, for good is Your
Mercy, so abundantly pour
Your tender mercies upon me.

**17 Do not hide Your face from Your own
Servant, I'm in trouble alone,
Hear me quickly before Your throne.**

18 Come close to me, redeem my soul,
Save me from my enemies' toll.

**19 You've known my reproach and my
shame,**

**And the dishonour on my name,
My foes before me all the same.**

20 Reproach breaks my heart, I am full
Of heaviness, I felt the pull
To see some to take pity, but
None came for comfort, but to shut.

**21 They gave me gall instead of food,
And when I'm thirsty they collude
To give me vinegar unstewed.**

22 So let their table be a trap
For them and their welfare a scrap.

The Gospel says that Jesus on the cross
Was thirsty for both water and the loss
Of Your bright presence and cried out in
thirst

To find what he was offered was accursed.
Instead of water of life or the cool
From Kauthar quietly upon the pool,
He's given vinegar to stun the duel.
The Psalm depicts the heritage at worst.
Beloved, whether the story is a myth
Or the true Gospel light in pun and pith,
I turn from numbing share of poisoned
reach

To find the simple truth that You would
teach.

I'm satisfied if Jesus took the word
To curse the table of the doomed and
blurred.

23 Let their eyes be darkened so they
Cannot see at all in their way,
And make them tremble *where they stay*.

**24 Pour out Your anger on them, let
Your wrath take hold upon them yet.**

25 And make their dwelling desolate,

Let none dwell in their tents *sedate*.

**26 They persecute the one that's downed,
They speak grief to the wounded found.**

27 Add wickedness to their sins and
Let them not in righteousness stand.

**28 Let them be blotted from the book
Of living, written not in nook
Of where the righteous people look.**

The Torah speaks of books and blotting
out,
And the Zabur of Psalms too, without
doubt

Reiterates the promise and the score,
While the Injil fills up the Gospel shore
With blotting out of sins forevermore.
In every case of human soul and reach
There is a blotting out, yes, and for each,
Either the name in recitation's hour,
The sema' of the human names that glower
Upon the single parchment and its gold,
Or else the sins under which each was sold.
Beloved, blot out my sins where I run free,
And keep me in the path I choose to be,
The ten commandments for eternity.

29 But I am poor and sorrowful,
Let Your salvation, Alohim,
Set me up on high *in the scheme*.

**30 I'll praise the name of Alohim
With a song and magnify full
Him with thanksgiving at the pull.**

31 Let this please YHWH better than ox
Or bull with horns and hoofs *and stocks*.

**32 The humble shall see and be glad,
And your heart live and not be sad
When You seek Alohim 33 For YHWH
Hears the poor and does not eschew
His prisoners. 34 Let heaven and earth
Praise Him, the seas and all of worth
That moves in them *and out of view*.**

35 For Alohim saves the fortress
And builds Judah's cities' address,
So they can live there and remain
To have possession *of the reign*.

**36 The servants of his children too
Inherit it, and those ones true
To love His name shall live there too.**

Let my words too, or silences in sleep
Or waking be, Beloved, to You a treat

Beyond the ox and the freshly sweet meat
Of lamb or goat, the sacrifice I keep
Is praise and honour to Your lovely name.
I find no other subject but Your fame,
Though You are known through all things
in the claim

Of earth and universe, forgotten You
Stand in the parliament and out of view,
In the cathedral hidden in Your pew,
Among the wealthy and the powerful
Whose hope is mere illusion of the pull
You are not seen more than in humble
dress

Where some slight recognition comes not
less.

Psalm 70

To the chief Musician, *A Psalm* of David,
to bring to remembrance.

1 Alohim, to deliver me,
And YHWH now make haste to help me.

**2 Let them be shamed, confounded who
Seek after my soul, in their due
Let them be turned back and confused
Who wanted to hurt me abused.**

3 Let them be turned back for reward
Of their shame who mocked me in horde.

**4 Let all those who seek You rejoice
And be glad in You for their choice
Who love Your salvation and say
"Let God be magnified today."**

5 But I am poor and needy here,
Make haste, Alohim, to appear,
You are my help and saviour, YHWH,
So do not tarry, *come anew*.

I call myself a dervish, poor and needy,
And yet I flourish far above the seedy
Despite my woollish dress and ragged
cloak.

I call myself a dervish, yet the flour
Of fine repasts hesitates not an hour
To whelm me with its polished grace and
sweet.

I call myself a dervish though not meet.
Yet I am glad as I come to repeat
Your golden names above the glowing fire
Of raucous winds that others would inspire.
Beloved, the hopeful shelter of the dance
Is still my refuge from the sudden prance
Of that horde that I flee to find Your own

Invisible wealth at Your ivory throne.

Psalms 71

1 In You, O YHWH, I put my trust,
Let me never sink to the dust.

2 Deliver me in righteousness,
And make me escape. Acquiesce
To hear me, and save *in distress*.

**3 Be my strong habitation where
I may every day enter there,
You've given command to save me,
You're my rock and my fortress key.**

4 Deliver me, O Alohim,
Out of the power of wicked scheme,
Out of the hand of unrighteous
And cruel man for blunderbuss.

**5 For You are my hope O lord YHWH,
My trust from my youth to renew.**

6 By You have I been held from birth,
You were my midwife beyond worth,
My praise shall always be of You.

**7 Many may marvel at my fare,
But You are my strong refuge there.**

The anthropomorphic in deities
Falls flat before the God of sureties:
You are the only God I know that comes
In form of a house before other sums.
If that seems strange upon the worldly
scheme,

God as a midwife is beyond my dream.
Some trust in God the Father, others find
That God the Son is better when resigned,
And many take raspar the ghost to be
The height of all gods and epitome.
But I think I like best Your form when You
Turn out to be a house without a pew
And a midwife. I only hope You're warm,
Without drafts and cut the cord from my
form.

8 Let my mouth be filled with Your praise,
And with Your honour days and days.

**9 Don't cast me off in my old age,
Nor forsake me when powers assuage.**

10 For my foes speak against me now,
Try to waylay my soul somehow.

**11 They say "God has forsaken him,
So persecute and capture him,
For there's none to deliver him."**

12 Alohim, don't be far from me,

My Alohim, run to help me.

**13 Let be confounded and consumed
My soul's enemies let be doomed,
Let them be covered with reproach,
And dishonour that would encroach.**

14 But I shall hope continually,
And praise You still eternally.

Some think the words of Psalmist too
severe

That doom the enemies that do appear.
But I think it is not too much to ask
That those who defecate without a mask
Beside my gate and leave the paper there
As well as the refined meals in their care
Ought to be doomed. There is a forest near.
Twenty steps would bring them to bushes
where

They might relieve themselves in privacy.
Its crass filth of the brain that makes them
be

So near my house. Beloved, cover them all
With their own reproach just below the
wall,

The brown mess they've produced let on
them fall.

The age I live in now demands degree.

15 My mouth shall show Your
righteousness

And Your salvation will confess
All day, it's too great to assess.

**16 I'll go in the strength of Lord YHWH,
I'll mention Your righteousness to,
For all to You alone is due.**

17 Alohim, You've taught me from youth,
Till now I proclaim Your work's truth.

18 Now also when I'm old and grey,
Alohim, do not let me stray
Until I've shown Your strength to this
Generation and not to miss

Your power to all who're in the way.

**19 Your righteousness, O Alohim,
Is very high, great things in scheme
You've accomplished, O Alohim,
Who is like You is but a dream.**

20 Who have shown me great and sore
troubles

Shall revive me and raise from bubbles
Of the depths of the earthly rubbles.

21 You'll increase my greatness and then

Comfort me because of false men.

22 I'll praise You with the psaltery too,
Your truth, O my Alohim, to
You I will sing with harp and well,
O Holy One of Israel.

**23 My lips greatly rejoice when I
Sing to You, and my soul come nigh,
Which You've redeemed as set on high.**

24 My tongue also shall talk of Your
Righteousness all the day to pour,
For they're confounded, for they are
Brought to shame who sought to disbar.

With psaltery and harp no less I praise
You as I cantillate with heart in daze
The words of Psalm and Torah on the maze
Of vine and branch that form the etching
craze

Of that existence mirrored in my ways.
The richness of Your revelation brings
To ear a joy, to eye a tear that stings
The jewelled syllables their lost pearl sings
Across the riven air rife with the wings
Of angel birds that twitter where it rings.
Beloved, my soul comes near to hear the
right

Confounding the wickedness out of sight
That would intrude upon the magic ways
Of Your revealed word in its roundelays.

Psalm 72

A Psalm for Solomon.

**1 Alohim, give the king your plots
Of judgement, and Your righteous lots
To the king's son. 2 He'll judge the knots
Of Your people with righteousness,
And Your poor with verdicts' address.**

3 The mountains bring peace to the folk,
The little hills by righteous stroke.

4 He'll judge the poorest of the folk,
He'll save the needy's children for
He shall break down the oppressor.

**5 They'll fear you as long as the sun
And moon shall last, throughout their
run.**

6 He shall come down like rain upon
The mown grass, as showers at dawn
That water the earth *when they're done*.

There was a time that I spent hours each
week

Mowing the grass of neighbours for a peek.
The mower was a thrill of power to one
Who navigated life with wheels that spun
A bicycle with motor made of pin
And cardboard in the spokes to make a din.
Your job, it seems, Beloved, is after mine:
To come down on the mown grass and the
vine

Like rain, the silent guest and unannounced
Except by cloud and thunder when it
pounced.

Beloved, fall on my mown grass in the
night

Or in the afternoon with dying light,
And I shall find the waters moving fair
And know that You, Beloved, at last are
there.

7 In his days shall flourish the just,
Abundant peace so long as must
The moon endure upon the dust.

**8 He'll have dominion also from
The sea to sea, and also come
From the river unto the ends
Of the earth where His mercy tends.**

**Those who live in the wilderness
Shall bow before him, in distress
His enemies shall lick the dust.**

10 The kings of Tarshish and the isles
Shall bring him presents and with smiles
The kings of Sheba and Seba
Shall offer gifts to him in awe.

**11 Yes, all the kings shall fall before
Him in prostration to adore
All nations shall serve him in store.**

12 For he shall save the needy when
He cries, the poor also of men,
And him who has no helper then.

**13 He'll spare the poor and needy, and
Shall save the needy's soul at hand.**

14 He shall redeem their soul both from
Deceit and violence to come,
And precious shall be in his sight
Their blood *when they die in the fight*.

**15 And he shall live, to him be given
The gold of Sheba where to live in,
And prayer shall rise on his behalf,
And he'll be daily praised to quaff.**

16 If there's a handful left of corn
In the earth from the mountains torn,
Its fruit shall shake like Lebanon,

And cities shall prosper like grass
Upon the earth *where no beasts pass.*
**16 His name for ever shall endure,
His name shall continue as sure
As the sun, and men shall be blessed
In him, all nations call him blessed.**

18 Blessed be YHWH Alohim the God
Of Israel upon the sod
Who only does wonders abroad.

**19 And blessed for ever be His name
In glory, and let the whole claim
Of earth be filled with all the same.
Amen, amen resound His fame.**

20 The prayers of David here are done,
The son of Jesse *here has won.*

I have no son to praise in poetry,
Only daughter and grandson for my glee,
And neither is a king or queen to see
The palaces of Solomon endure.
And yet those palaces, though ruined sure,
Are intact and in fact a magic pure
To creep across the winter and the cold
And warm the heart as though with molten
gold.

The palaces where once Your names were
told

Live on in the reality and bold
Verses of David here and there unsold
Beneath the stars and moon and sun which
stay

The guarantee and gauge of David's way.
Beloved, the cantillations come unrolled.

Psalms Book Three Psalm 73

A Psalm of Asaph (2).

**1 Indeed good to Israel is God
Who have a clean heart on the sod.**

2 But my feet were almost tripped up
And my steps had well nigh slipped up.

**3 For I envied the foolish ones
When I saw wicked on their buns.**

4 Without constraints in life or death
Their strength is firm, *they catch their
breath.*

**5 They avoid human troubles too,
Catastrophe's out of their view.**

6 Their pride's like a necklace of gold,
They wear violence like shoe's soled.

**7 Their eyes look up from a fat plate,
Desires of their heart never late.**

8 They are corrupt, speak wickedly
Of oppression, and haughtily.

**9 They set their words against the skies,
Their tongue licks up the earth in guise.**

10 That's why His people come back here,
For them full waters shall appear.

**11 And they say "How does El God
know?"**

**Does the Most High some knowledge
show?"**

12 See these are the ungodly ones
Who prosper in the world by tons,
They increase in such wealth *as stuns.*

**13 Truly, I've cleansed my heart in vain,
Innocently washed hands of stain.**

14 For all the day long I've been plagued,
From every morning I've been egged.

15 If I say "I will speak so," see
I'd offend Your children *freely.*

**16 When I intended to know this
For me it was too painful kiss.**

17 Until I entered holy tent
Of El, I understood what meant
Their end. 18 Surely You did set them
In slippery places' stratagem,
You threw them down in their destruction.

**19 How are they brought into abduction
In a moment, completely eaten
Up with terrifyings unbeaten.**

I've heard it said by some they cannot
come

To satisfy me with their tongue in sum
That must be kept so quietly between
Their teeth so I won't rage upon their
scene.

But I've the like impression in my greed:
No matter what I do with flower or weed,
It is not what the others want for feed,
And I am cast out of those who convene.
Beloved, I'll let You in Your higher chair
Decide which of the beasts is good and fair
And which is set for Your destruction's
share.

Destroy me, if You will, and I shall rise
Ephemeral, a spark against the skies
And with my smoke bring water to Your
eyes.

20 As a dream when one has awaked,
O Lord when You raise the unshaked,

You will despise their image *raked*.

**21 And so my heart was sad and grieved
For the punch my kidneys received.**

22 So foolish was I, ignorant,
I was before You beast *to rant*.

**23 And yet I continue with You,
You hold me by my right hand true.**

24 You guide me with Your counsel free,
And then receive me to glory.

**25 Whom do I have in heaven but You?
None upon earth I wish but You.**

**26 Fail now both my flesh and my heart,
But Alohim strengthens my part
Forever fills my store and cart.**

27 For see, those who are far from You
Will perish, you've destroyed in crew
Those that go whoring far from You.

**28 But it's good for me to come near
To Alohim, I set my gear**

**To trust in the Lord YHWH so I
May proclaim all Your acts *on high*.**

The Psalmist here describes in great detail,
Detail that's nearly gruesome in its gale,
The character of Abu Sofyan's son
Muawiyah whose people came to run
The government Umayyad and increased
In wealth and power unheard of and
released

Like plague upon the world of faith and
woe.

The Psalmist here describes things long
ago.

And yet the detail of his spelling breaks
Upon the coming reign and its mistakes
As though he saw before his eyes the time,
The place, the people and the raging climb.
The things that happened in Madina then
Were seen by Psalmist in prophetic ken.

Psalm 74

1 Maschil of Asaph (3).

**Why, Alohim, have You cast off
For ever? Does You anger scoff
Against Your meadow's sheep like
smoke?**

2 Remember Your assembly's yoke
Purchased from ancient time, the rod
Of Your inheritance on sod
That You've redeemed, this fortress mount,
Where You have sat *to give account*.

**3 Lift up Your steps because constant
Desolation in all the rant
The foe has done in wickedness
In the holy place *to confess*.**

4 Your enemies roar in the crowd
Of Your own, they set up aloud
Their names for worship unallowed.

**5 Fame comes proportionate to be
As one lifts axe on goodly tree.**

6 But now they break down the carved
work

With hammer blows and hatchet jerk.

**7 They've thrown fire in Your holy
place,**

**Defiled Your dwelling by Your face
To the ground. 8 They said in their
hearts,**

**"Let us destroy them for their parts,
They've burned up all the synagogues
Of El in the land, *demagogues*.**

9 We do not see our signs, no more
Is any prophet, and the score
Of how long no one keeps in store.

**10 How long, O Alohim, shall foe
Reproach? Shall blaspheme Your
name's show?**

**11 Why withdraw Your hand, Your
right hand?**

Take it out of Your pocket manned!

12 And Alohim's my king of old,
Working salvation on earth *bold*.

**13 You divided sea by Your strength,
You broke the heads of dragons' length
In the waters. 14 You broke the heads
Of leviathan torn to shreds,
And gave his flesh for those to eat
Who lived beneath the desert *heat*.**

15 You split the fountain and the flood,
You dried up mighty rivers' blood.

**16 The day is Yours and so's the night,
You have prepared the sun and light.**

17 You've set all the borders of earth,
You've made summer and winter's *worth*.

**18 Remember this, the enemy
Has reproached, O YHWH, and the
screw**

Of foolish folk blasphemed Your name.

19 Don't give up the soul of Your own
Beloved into the crowd to stone,
Do not forget assembled poor
Forever waiting at Your door.

**20 Have respect for the covenant,
The earth's dark places are not scant
With dwelling place of cruelty.**

21 Oh don't let the oppressed return
Ashamed, let the poor come to learn
With the needy to praise Your name.

**22 Get up, O Alohim, and plead
You own cause, remember indeed
How the foolish man daily scorns
You with reproach of butting horns.**

23 Do not forget the noise of foes
Against You, the tumult of those
That rise up against You, that grows.

The prophecy of prayer in Asaph's word
In the third Psalm that bears his name and
stirred

The heart of seventy-some in Karbela
Describes in detail down to broken straw
What happened on that day of infamy.
King David prays the cup might pass and
be

Far from the faithful few who stand beside
Hussein and love the flag of peace they
spied.

Beloved, I look back on the grave events
And see them all illumined like bright tents
Against the backdrop of the prophecy.
Beloved, I hear the cries that David heard
Long centuries before the thing occurred
And bow in pain with what I hear and see.

Psalm 75

1 To the chief Musician, Set to Al-tasheth
(do not destroy), A Psalm *or* Song of
Asaph (4).

**We give thanks to You, Alohim,
We do give thanks and so esteem
That Your name's near as Your works
share,**

Wonderful things they do declare.

2 When I come at the proper time
I'll judge righteously *in the clime*.
The earth and all its dwellers find
Themselves dissolved, I bear the kind
Pillars of it *beneath the air*.

**4 I say to arrogant ones, "Do
Not act with foolishness," and to
The wicked, "Do not flaunt you power.**

5 "Don't lift your horn up, do not speak
By a stiff neck *and a neck sleek*."

**6 Promotion's neither from the east,
Nor from the west, nor is increased
From the south desert where faith ceased.**

7 But Alohim *is* judge: He'll put
Down one, set another on foot.

8 For in YHWH's hand *there is* a cup,
And the wine is red; it's full up,
And He pours it out, but the dregs
Shall all the earth's wicked in pegs
Wring out and drink them *on last legs*.

**9 But I'll declare for ever; I
Will sing praises and lift on high
To Jacob's Alohim come by.**

10 All the horns of the wicked I
Will also cut off by and by,
But the power of the righteous shall
Be exalted in festival.

I think that Samuel's mother came to make
The horn a point of prophecy at stake
Before any other woman or child
Or man who cantillates upon the wild.
It's good to end the Psalm of praise that
points

To Zaynul Abideen with warning joints
Against the wicked. He was one to see
The horrors and the terrors of the spree
At Karbela, and yet his life was spent
In bowing down in praise to You, he lent
His heart and tongue to nothing more than
this.

He found no other king on earth to kiss.
Beloved, I join his Psalms of praise as I
Read David's words etched golden on the
sky.

Psalm 76 (Asaph 5)

1 To the chief musician upon
Stringed instruments *well tuned at dawn*.
A psalm of Asaph and a song.

In Judah Alohim's known *long*,
His name *is* great in Israel.

**2 In Salem also is the tell
Of His tent and His dwelling place
In the fortress. 3 And there to trace
He broke the arrows of the bow,
The shield and sword of battle show.**

4 You are more glorious and swell
Than mountains of the prey *to tell*.

5 The stouthearted were plundered, they
Have sunk into their sleepy way,

And none of the mighty men found
 The use of their hands *on the round*.
6 At Your rebuke, O God of Jacob,
Both chariot and horse to wake up
Were cast into the depth of slumber
From first to last and all their number.
 7 You Yourself *are* One to be feared,
 And who may stand *once he's appeared*
 In Your presence when You are wroth?
8 You caused the judgement to be heard
From heaven, the earth feared and was
stirred,
9 When Alohim arose to judge,
To save on earth all oppressed drudge.
 10 Surely the wrath of man shall praise
 You, with the rest of wrath *in days*
 You shall gird Yourself *in Your ways*.
11 Make vows to YHWH your God, and
pay,
Let all who are around Him stay
To bring presents to Him who ought
To be feared in all things He's taught.
 12 He shall cut off spirit of princes,
 Awesome on earth as each king winces.

Beloved, You clove in two the arrows that
 The enemy would shoot at righteous hat,
 And broke the universe in two to show
 The judgement that was true from the word
 go.
 In smaller measure those whom You have
 sent
 To represent Your law and love in tent
 Have split the cases open and found out
 Justice in verdicts against lean and stout.
 Beloved, the fifth Imam, the one who's
 called
 Al-Baqir also came to split the walled
 And show that You are one in justice
 standing
 Above both kings and presidents on
 landing.
 I bring my gifts to that one hidden where
 You pour our fragrances upon the air.

Psalms 77

1 To the chief Musician, to Jeduthun, A
 Psalm of Asaph (6).
My voice to Alohim I lift,
To El-Alohim as a gift,
And He lent ear to my song's drift.

2 In the day of my trouble I
 Sought out the Lord, with hand up high,
 Tears streaming in the night no cease,
 My soul without comfort's release.
3 Let me remember Alohim
When trouble comes upon my dream,
And pour out my fervent complaint
Whenever my spirit would faint.
 4 You keep my eyelids open while
 I am in speechless trouble's guile.
5 I've considered the days of old,
The years of ancient times once told.
 6 I make remembrance of my song
 In the night, I commune along
 With my own heart, my spirit makes
 Search diligent with all my might.

The dhikr or remembrance of Your name,
 Beloved, is raised by David in the claim
 Of Asaph's sixth Psalm, one that brings to
 mind
 The sixth holy Imam, a soul to find.
 The sema' that we know today goes back
 To the law as confirmed without a lack
 By Ja'fer al-Sadiq, and so I lay
 The open book Buyruk before the ray
 Of candlelight and as I stop to pray
 In circle prayer I bless the by-gone day,
 The Sabbath of both David and Imam,
 The faint and future light I know of calm.
 Beloved, I contemplate Your holy names
 Throughout the blessed night of candle-
 flames.

7 For all time will the Lord cast off?
 8 Is His mercy a mocking scoff?
 Does promise fail with the day's light?
 9 Does El forget His graciousness?
 Does His wrath close His mercy's dress?
10 I said "This is my weakness night,
But years are in hand of Most High."
 11 I'll remember all YHWH's works bold,
 Remember Your wonders of old.
12 I'll murmur of all Your acts where
I speak of Your doings to share.
 13 Alohim, in the holy place
 Is Your way, whose exalted trace
 Is like unto Alohim's *face*?
14 You are the El of wonders done,
Declared Your strength on people won.

I take the sema' on my tongue and seek
Remembrance of Your wonders week by
week.

When I declare Your strength abroad, I
hear

The echoes of Your miracles that cheer
The heart and mind, and raise spirits on
high

To see Your passing now against the sky.
Your way is in the holy place, I see,
The holy place of heavenly rooms' degree,
The sacred temples of the silent wood,
The inner chamber of my heart where could
Fall melodies of Scriptures nodding where
The pages turn from parchment into fair
And fleeting woodland flowers. My soul,
beware!

Beloved, flit out of hiding the bird's share!

15 You have redeemed with Your strong
arm

Your people, Jacob's sons from harm,
And sons of Joseph from alarm.

**16 The waters saw You, Alohim,
The waters saw You in the stream
They were oppressed, deep troubled
dream.**

17 The clouds poured out water, the skies
Sent forth a rumble, arrows rise
Abroad from You. 18 The *heavy* sound
Of Your thunder in heaven around:
The lightning flashed upon the world;
The earth trembled and shook and twirled.

**19 Your path is in the sea, Your way
In mighty waters, and the sway
Of Your footsteps an unknown ray.**

20 You led Your people like a flock
By hand of Moses, Aaron's stock.

Even the time of Ja'fer as Imam
Looks back to the Egyptian crowd with
Psalm

To mind the day when Pharaoh met his end
Beneath the Red Sea waters where they
blend

The sand and wheels of chariots with crew
To flounder in the floods, see how they do!
After twelve hundred years and more I
flush

To think how often people in the blush
Of life have contemplated what it meant

To be redeemed from Egypt and be sent
Into the desert to ride on a day
Of trouble both before and after sway
Of Sinai. I look all around the mount
To see how many footprints I can count.

Psalm 78

1 A Maschil of Asaph (7).

Give ear, my folk, to my Torah,
And tune your ears to my mouth's law.

**2 My opening is my mouth's rule
Revealing ancient things in school,**

**3 Which we have heard and which we
know**

From what our ancestors bestow.

4 We do not hide them from our sons,
But recite to generations,

The praises of YHWH and His acts
And wonders that His grace enacts:

5 Enactment set to Jacob and
Torah proclaimed to Israel's band,
He ordered our ancestors to
Inform their children what is due.

**6 So that the coming generations
And children yet unborn in nations
Might know and in their turn reveal
To their children the thing's appeal,**

**7 That they should trust in Alohim
And not forget Alohim's scheme,**
And keep His commandments 8 and not
Be like their ancestors in plot,
Rebellious and stubborn in ways
With hearts unstable in their stays
Whose minds did not with firm decision
Keep faith in El's spirit's *precision*.

The first Moses brought Torah out to see
And through Your power set the people
free

From Egypt to obey Your word and know
The brightness of Your spirit in the glow
Of desert and of Sinai and of cloud
That led them there to hear Your voice
aloud.

The second Moses, one of prophecy,
The hope of humankind came on the go
To face the many and the ruling proud.
Beloved, I love above all at this time
Musa the seventh Imam in the rhyme
And round of twelve, and see how he
fulfilled

The prophecy of one more Moses billed
Since Moses spoke the farewell sermon
stilled.

9 The sons of Ephraim well fit
As archers both to shoot and hit
Turned back before the battle day.

**10 They did not keep Alohim's way
To walk in His Torah's law's sway.**

11 They forgot His high acts, His great
Wonders He made them see *in state*.

**12 In their ancestors' sight He did
A wonder in the land and bid
Of Egypt, in the Vale of Soan.**

13 He split the sea where they had flown,
Brought them across and set the flood
In walls on both sides of the mud.

**14 He led them with a cloud by day
And all the night they did not stray
Out of His fire's glow on the way.**

The cloud by day and fire by night once led
Your people from the desert and from
dread.

Today I see the grey clouds gathered by
And covering the whole run of the sky,
So they can lead in every way to go
Or else no place at all as many show.
I cannot follow clouds or fires below
The stars that trek across the nightly woe.
Beloved, instead of cloud and fire I take
The loved Imam whom You sent for my
sake

To be the seventh in a line of twelve
And show the best of Sabbaths not to delve.
I walk between the towered walls of sea
And know Your guidance still will cover
me.

15 He split the desert boulders too
And watered them from the depths' dew.

**16 He let the streams spurt from the
rock
And brought from it fresh water's stock.**

17 And yet they sinned against Him there
In desert rebelled from the fair
Most High. 18 They troubled Alohim
To beg themselves bread *from the stream*.

**19 They spoke against Alohim, saying
"Can El deck out a table set
And food in the desert to get?**

20 "He struck the rock and it was paying
Out water in flood and streams staying,
But can He also give us bread
And meat to His own people led?"

The son of Umar used to scorn the way
Of Musa al-Kadhim in what he'd say.
The people said he ought to die since he
Was so free with his words of enmity.
But Musa went to meet him in the field
And heard him curse his feet that spoiled
the yield

Of all he planted. Musa took his purse
And gave him sum of planting and not
worse

The price of what he hoped to gain in stall.
The son of Umar changed his mind to call
Musa the sent of God, and so You blessed
With food and gain and did not try to wrest
The life out from the wicked. I love best
The changing of the evil at the wall.

21 So YHWH heard it and rose in wrath
And fire appeared in Jacob's path
And also anger on the way
Of Israel, 22 for they did betray
Their trust in Alohim, and they
Did not rely on His help's sway.

**23 He gave the clouds above command,
The doors of heaven He opened grand,
24 And brought rain on them for to eat
Manna, the sky's grain for a treat.**

25 The bread of angels mere men fed,
He sent them meat to fill them led.

**26 He sent the east wind from the sky
Brought by His power the south wind
dry.**

27 He rained down on them like the dust
Flesh, and like the seas' sand the lust
Of winged birds. 28 He dropped them
down

Right in the middle of their town.

In wrath, Beloved, You meet the common
bill,

And sometimes I wish You would come to
fill

The earth with violence and come to kill
Those who do mischief on the earth and
will.

Instead You send Your Musa with his
wares

Of flour and dates and money behind stares
And incognito to the poor that throng
Behind the doors of fair Medina's song.
Beloved, I love the sending of the feast
From heaven to those who have of goods
the least.

It is a better war than violence
Falling upon the broken hand and fence.
Send what You will, Beloved, and I shall
give

Thanks for the gifts You bring that I may
live.

29 They stuffed themselves up to the brim
With what He gave them at their whim.

**30 Their lusts were unrequited yet
And the food in their mouths still set,**

**31 When Alohim's wrath came and met
Them, and He slew them in their power,
And cast down Israel's youth that hour.**

32 For all this they still sinned a lot,
And did not trust in what He'd wrought.

**33 So ended in a mist their days,
Their resting place in worried maze.**

34 Upon His slaying them they sought,
Returned repenting to El's plot.

**35 And they remembered Alohim
To be their rock of high esteem,
And El 'Elyon great to redeem.**

Beloved, the slaying of the wicked brings
But little help repenting at the springs.
If tender loving care come from Your hand
Does not call for the gratitude to stand,
The plague will not call for the loving heart
To do the right and fulfil the good part.
Repentance was a brief thing on the day
When Moses caused the people in the way
To flee before the Pharaoh's army and
To come before the mountain once to
stand.

The golden gods they left in that far land
Were smuggled in their heart and mind to
make

Renewal and a resurrection's stake.
I seek the firm rock of faith in Your wake.

36 They flattered Him with their mouth and
With their tongue they seduced His hand.

**37 But their heart was not true with Him
Nor faithful to covenant trim.**

38 But Huu Rahum, He's merciful,
He covers sins and does not pull
Destruction, but many times He
Smothers His anger and the spree
Of His wrath covers faithfully.

**39 And He remembers they are flesh,
A moving wind not come afresh.**

40 How often they were snooty in
The wilderness against His bin,
Brought sorrow to His mind by sin
In the desert of *howling din*.

**41 Then they returned to trouble El,
Blight Holy One of Israel.**

This mind of mercy that You show to all,
Beloved, is something that You gave in
stall

To Musa al-Kadhim and made him tall.
He too knew how the evil heart would
spend

Itself against him in the fateful end,
And yet he gave the evil hand the sum
That was indebted by its failing rum.
You buy my heart too, my Beloved, as I
Look out with empty hand upon Your sky.
I follow sweet Musa with famous purse
And see him handing out the gold for
worse

And better, never thinking who might take
The pence from him and use it for the sake
Of evil. I beware blessing and curse.

42 They did not remember His hand
Delivering from enemy's land,
43 From Egypt when He showed His signs,
His wonders wrought from Soan's inclines.

**44 He changed their river into blood
They could not drink because of crud.**

45 He sent on them flies to devour them,
And river frogs come out to scour them.

**46 He gave to locusts all their fields,
To grasshoppers their labour's yields.**

47 He tore with hail their vineyards bare,
Their fig trees destroyed by storm's share.

**48 He gave their cattle to the hail,
Their flocks to thunderbolts' prevail.**

49 He cast on them His anger's fire,
His wrath and indignation's ire,
Evil angels upon the pyre.

Beloved, the miracles that You spread out
Upon Egypt that day I hold in doubt
Were caused by some volcano with a snout.
Should I consider only Your hand's sway?
Instead I care not for the wide expanse
Of success in the wicked tent and dance,
Nor for the way the righteous learn to beg
Because they have not bread to eat nor keg.
I hold, Beloved, fast to the law You gave
Through Moses and through Musa, both

Your slave,
And let my hand do nothing but the right
That they reveal in word and action bright.
There is reward perhaps, but if there's
none,
I'll take my comfort in what Musa's done.

50 He prepared His way in His wrath
And spared not their soul from the path
Of death, but gave over their life
To pestilence as well as strife.

**51 He struck down all Egypt's firstborn,
The height of strength in Ham's tents
shorn.**

52 But His own folk brought out like sheep,
Flock guided in the desert keep.

**53 And He led them on safely, so
That they did not fear where to go,
While seas fell drowning every foe.**

54 He brought them to the very edge
Of His holy place, to *the ledge*
Of this mountain that His right hand
Had purchased there *upon the land*.

**55 He drove out the heathen before
Them also and divided store
By line of lot and made the tribes
Of Israel dwell in their tents' *vibes*.**

Musa himself came to the reign because
You had struck down the first-born with his
claws

Caught in the wine and in the drunken
brawl.

And yet who knows what secret's in the
wall.

If Ibrahim was dead, the first-born son,
It follows that Musa under the sun
Is left to meet the plague and then to run.
Both are within Your will, Beloved, and I
Love every son of righteousness on sly,

The ones brought forth by Ja'far, every guy
Whose father is the righteous when he's
done.

The one is hidden and the other waits
In sweetness and in mercy at the gates,
I turn from one to other as elates.

56 Still they tried and provoked the most
High Alohim, and without boast
Did not keep His witnesses' coast.

**57 Instead they turned back and in act
Unfaithful like ancestors whacked,
They swerved aside like crooked bow.**

58 For they provoked Him to great ire
With their high places *set on fire*,
And they moved Him to jealousy
With their graven images' plea.
Alohim heard and was incensed
And left Israel greatly unfenced.

**60 So He forsook Shiloh's abode,
The tent He'd placed on human load.**

**61 He gave His strength to captives' fate,
His glory to enemy's plate.**

62 He gave His folk unto the sword,
Was angry with His plot unshored.

**63 The fire consumed their young men;
and**

Their maidens were not given in hand.

64 Their priests fell by the sword; and their
Widows made no lament to share.

The truth is simply that which Moses
preaches,

There is no safety and no peace that
reaches

Down to the human way until the law
Of ten is learnt and kept by every claw.

The violence must fall on good and ill,
On those upon the plain and on the hill,
Until a kingdom and society

Arise once that will set the evil free,
And keep the ten commandments without
pale

Or threat of punishment beneath the veil.

It is a simpler thing than playing ball,
With fewer rules and easier in stall,
And yet the church would sabotage the
weal

By claiming it's impossible to heal.

65 The Lord arose as out of sleep,

*And like a mighty man to sweep
As in the noise of wine to weep.*

**66 He attacked His foes from the back,
Made them eternal laughing stock.**

67 Moreover he refused the tent
Of Joseph, and He was not bent
To favour tribe of Ephraim.

**68 But chose the tribe of Judah, mount
Zion which he loved *above count*.**

69 And He built His holy place high
Like the earth established for aye.

**70 He chose David His servant too,
And took him from the sheepfolds' view,**

**71 From following the pregnant ewe,
He brought him to feed Jacob's folk
His people Israel, His lot's yoke.**

72 So He fed them according to
His heart's integrity and true,
And guided them, by His hands drew.

As You, Beloved, turned from Saul on a
day

And chose King David to reveal Your way,
So You turned from Ismail and took in pay
Fair Musa for his kindness and the ray
Of sweetness in his heart and in his sway.
And yet the northern kingdom hidden by
Knew righteousness at times beneath the
cry

Of vain idolatry. So Ismail's try
Also peeks from the secret hill to show
A flicker and a glimmer and a glow
Of right that You called forth from times
gone past

And sent upon the earth to live and last.
The sevens and the twelves are called to
stay,

Though sevens both failed expectation's
lay.

Psalm 79

1 A Psalm of Asaph (8).

**Alohim, the heathen have come
Into Your inheritance sum,
Your holy temple they've defiled,
Holy Jerusalem they've spoiled.**

2 Dead bodies of Your servants they
Have given to feed the birds by day,
The flesh of Your holy ones to
The wild beast of the earth as due.

**3 They've shed their blood like water
round**

**About Jerusalem's dry ground,
And left none to bury *the dead*.**

4 We're left a laughing stock to those
Around us, scorn, derision flows
From all our neighbours *on their toes*.

**5 How long, YHWH, will Your anger
last?**

**For ever will arise the blast
Of jealousy from You *aghost*?**

6 Pour out Your anger on the yoke
Of heathen who've not known Your stroke,
And on the kingdoms that have not
Called on Your name *in garden plot*.

**7 For they have consumed Jacob's lot,
And spoiled his place *in every spot*.**

The transfer of the power from Umayyad
To Abbasid might seem at first a glad
Change in the course of trends, but in the
end

Abbasid double-crossed the divine friend
More subtly and with greater abuse than
Yazid in wicked tantrum with his clan.
Yet in Jerusalem the wicked stain
Is not the perpetration of the vain
Abbasid rulers, but the crusades come
To shed blood both of Jew and Muslim
rum.

How long will anger last? I come to say
After the fact two centuries of sway
Until bright Saladdin came in to pay
Respects to You, Beloved, and the right
way.

8 Do not remember us because
Of former wickedness in laws,
But let Your tender mercies rise
Quickly before us, for our eyes
Are brought down to the earth *in guise*.

**9 Help, Alohim of our salvation,
For the glory of Your name's station,
And save us and purge out our sins,
For Your name's sake *where it begins*.**

10 Why should the heathen cantillate,
"Where is their Alohim *in wait*?"

**Let Him be known among the folk
Of heathendom and by the stroke
Of vengeance in our sight for blood
Of Your servants struck down *in mud*.**

11 Let sighing of the captive rise
Before You, by the power and size
Of Your greatness save those condemned
To death *where they have been enhemmed.*

**12 Revenge to our neighbours in all
Seven times more into their hall
For their reproach, since their reproach
Is of You, O Lord, to encroach.**

13 Then we Your people and the sheep
Of Your pasture will give and keep
Thanks to You for ever and show
Your praise in generations' flow.

The prayer of David, Asaph and the one
Sent as the eighth Imam is in praise done,
Though crying under every trial that makes
The faithful suffer under despots' stakes.
The prayer of these is that You should not
mind

The wicked past in action uncombined
With faith, but judge Your folk according
to

The greatness of Your grace and mercy's
view.

Indeed, Beloved, I bend to take Your grace
And mercy from the soil I see in trace,
The autumn violet, the single bloom
That blossoms against hope and fear of
doom.

Even in centuries laid in the dust
Of empires, You are One whom I can trust.

Psalm 80

1 To the chief Musician upon
Shoshannimeduth, A Psalm of Asaph
(9).

**Give ear, O Israel's Shepherd, You
Who lead Joseph in flock and dew,
Who dwell between the cherubim,
Shine forth in brightness and in vim.**

2 Before the face of Ephraim,
Before the face of Benjamin
And Manasseh stir up Your din
Of strength and come deliver us.

**3 O Alohim, turn back to us,
And make Your face to shine on us,
And we shall be saved from the fuss.**

4 YHWH Alohim of hosts, how long
Will You be angry with the throng
Of Your folk who prays *all day long?*

5 You feed them with the bread of tears,

You give them tears to drink for cheers.

6 You make us strife in neighbours' eyes,
Our foes laugh to themselves, despise.

**7 Turn back to us, O Alohim
Of hosts, and make Your face to beam,
And we shall be saved as You deem.**

The jealousy of Benjamin revolves
Around the golden calves and then resolves
In the Shekinah where its blessing sits
Between the cherubim and so befits.

The bread and drink of tears is nothing
new,

They fall upon the faithful and the few
In waves of punishment or with the dew
That rises as a sign on fleece for dew.
Beloved, the prayer of David and the one
Who was born of the eighth when he was
done

Is that You might return and show Your
face

In its salvation, mercy and in grace.
The round goes on, the prayer though
perfectly

Recited and answered eternally.

8 You've brought a vine from Egypt's land,
Cast out of it the heathen band,
And planted it *upon the sand.*

**9 You readied the way before it,
And made it take deep root as fit,
And it filled up the land to sit.**

10 The hills were covered with its shade,
Its boughs like goodly cedars made.

**11 She sent her boughs out to the sea,
Her branches to the river's lee.**

12 Why have You broken down her hedge,
So all that pass by on the ledge
Break off boughs and branches and sedge?

**13 The sylvan boar comes in to spoil,
The wild beast of the field in toil
Devours it leaf and root and soil.**

14 Return, we pray You, Alohim
Of hosts, look down from heaven's beam
And see and visit this vine's *dream,*

**15 The vineyard Your right hand has
made**

**Planted and the branch that has stayed
Strong for Yourself. 16 It's burnt with
fire,**

It is cut down and on the pyre

They perish at Your face's ire.

17 Let Your hand be upon the man
Of Your right hand, upon the span
Of the man's son You have made strong.

18 So we will not go back along
From You, invigorate our song,
And we will call upon Your name.

**19 YHWH Alohim of hosts, turn back,
Make Your face shine upon our slack
And we shall be saved in the track.**

The riddles were set from the marriage
place

Of Samson years before the come in trace
Of the man and the man's son in this word
Revealed by David and Asaph averred.

Taqi is made the bridegroom of the king
And set to answer riddles on the wing,
Atonement for the slaughter on the site
Of holiness, and marriage laws of right.
Beloved, another riddle I bestow
Upon the leader for the weal or woe,
Who is the plant brought up from Egypt's
way

To spread upon the sand and shade from
day?

If Benjamin and Judah will bear sway,
I know the blessed path that I should go.

Psalm 81

1 To the chief Musician upon Gittith, *A
Psalm of Asaph* (10).

**Sing loud to Alohim our strength:
Make joyful sound at last, at length
To Alohim of Jacob's strength.**

2 Take a psalm and bring here hand-drum,
The pleasant harp, the psaltery's *hum*.

**3 Blow the trumpet the month's first
day,**

On the appointed holy day.

4 For this is Israel's statute kept,
Alohim of Jacob's law *swept*.

**5 He ordained in Joseph witness,
When He went through Egypt's address,
I heard a tongue I could not guess.**

6 I removed his back from the load,
His hands saved from the pots *in goad*.

**7 You cried in trouble and I came
To save you from the burning flame,
I answered You from secret place
Of thunder, I proved You in trace**

At waters of Meribah's grace.

8 Hear, O my people, I'll bear word
Of testimony that you heard,
O Israel, if you'll obey me,
9 There shall be no strange god in fee,
Neither shall you bow down to see
Any strange god *eternally*.

**10 I am YHWH your Alohim who
Brought you out of Egyptian crew,
Open Your mouth, I'll fill it too.**

11 My folk would not obey My voice,
Israel would not make Me her choice.

**12 So I gave them to their hearts' lust,
They walked in their own counsels' dust.**

13 Oh that My folk had obeyed Me,
Israel had walked accordingly!

**14 I should soon have subdued their foes,
And turned My hand against their rows.**

15 The haters of YHWH should have
bowed

Themselves to Him, they'd been allowed
To endure for eternity.

**16 He would have fed them on the spree
With finest of the wheat and by
The honey from the rock then I
Would have satisfied you hungry.**

The wheat and honey might have been their
fare

If Israel had been obeying there
In desert and in promised land and air.
Instead they turned away to other gods
And worshipped at the altar of dumb pods.
They had endured throughout eternity,
Had they maintained You only without wee
Gods and their idols fallen on the spree.

Beloved, give the boils sheep's fat
intersticed

With purest rose water on the surpliced
And see how quickly health and room
increase

Until all wickedness fails from the lease!
The punishments of centuries remain
And yet You honour hope with its own
gain.

Psalm 82

1 A Psalm of Asaph (11).

**Alohim stands in assembly
Gathered from among the mighty,
He judges the exalted ones.**

2 How long will you judge unjustly
According to fame's wicked buns?
**3 Defend the poor and fatherless,
Do justice to needy's address
And the afflicted *help redress.***
4 Save the poor and the needy and
Take them out of the wicked hand.
**5 They do not know nor understand,
They progress in darkness and all
The earth's foundations lie in sprawl.**
6 I've said You are exalted ones,
And all of you children by tons
Of the Most High, *daughters and sons.*
**7 But you shall die like men, and fall
Each like one of the princes' call.**
8 Arise, O Alohim and judge
The earth, for You shall have the fudge
Of all the nations for Your own.

The Psalmist says that all are Your own
sons,
The tribes of Israel set out in tons.
Al-Askeri, eleventh in the line,
Maintains the same word as he's doing fine
To say "We all indeed belong to God,
And to Him we return upon the sod."
And so the prophecy bears record still
That the twelve sent of God are on the hill.
Beloved, I give my hand to You as set
Up Father to the universe and met
By every man created as a son
Who ought to obey Father when he's done.
I am content with that and come to die
To self and life itself under the sky.

Psalm 83

1 A Song *or* Psalm of Asaph (12).
**Alohim, do not be in peace,
Do not keep still, do not increase
Your silence, O El *of release.***
2 See here, Your foes come made a noise,
And those who hate You lift like boys
Their heads against You *and their toys.*
**3 They've taken evil counsel there
Against Your people everywhere
Consulting against those that You
Have hidden once away from view.**
4 They've said "Come, let us cut them off
From being a nation to scoff,
That Israel's name may be no more
Held up in her remembrance' store.

**5 For they've agreed with one consent,
They're united against Your tent.**
6 The tents of Edom, Ishmaelites,
Of Moab and the Hagarites,
7 Gebal, and Ammon, Amalek,
The Philistines as well as trek
Of Tyre's inhabitants *a speak.*
**8 Assur also has joined with them,
They've helped Lot's children *on the
hem.***
9 Do to them as the Midianites,
As to Sisera in the fights,
As to Jabin at brook Kison,
10 Who failed at Endor *in the dawn.*
They became as dung for earth's *pawn.*
**11 And make their nobles like Oreb,
And make them also like Zeeb,
Yes, all their princes as Zebah,
And make them all as Zalmunna,**
**12 Who said "Let's take now to ourselves
Possession of Alohim's shelves."**
13 O my Alohim, make them like
A wheel, and make them as the spike
Of stubble before wind *to strike.*
**14 As the fire burns the forest through,
And as the flame sets hills in view
On fire, 15 So rage on them with Your
Tempest and trouble them with store
Of Your storm waking at the door.**
16 Fill their faces with shame, so they
May seek Your name, O YHWH, *each day.*
**17 Let them be ashamed and in fear
For ever, indeed let appear
To them shame, let them perish near.**
18 Then all shall know that You whose
name
Alone is YHWH are in great fame
High over all the earth's acclaim.

This curse is laid out carefully to set
The sons of Abraham to rise and fret,
And only Israel remains to be
The holy, chosen seed under the tree.
Let not the sons of Abraham be left
In shame, Beloved, no matter what's been
cleft
In Psalm and prayer beside the temple gate.
Bring all of them back to Your face and
wait
To gather all into the kingdom's share.

Turn over this curse and David's whole
prayer

For Asaph on the mount. I live to learn
That life is long enough for those who
burn.

If we've invented hell at last, it's time
To let heaven have a day of prose and
rhyme.

Psalm 84

1 To the Chief Musician. On an instrument
of Gath. A Psalm of the sons of Korah
(9).

**How lovely is Your tent, O YHWH
Of armies! 2 My soul longs for You,
Faints even for the courts of YHWH,
My heart and my flesh cry out for
Alohim the Living in store.**

3 Even the sparrow has a home,
The swallow her nest not to roam,
Where she may lay her young, indeed
Your altars, O YHWH of hosts greed,
My King and my God in my need.

Beloved, the third step in the path of twelve
Speaks to the one who does desire to delve
Into the hidden mysteries of light.

Here find a secret song of right and might.
The third Imam, though weary with the
path

Through field and desert, did not know the
wrath

Of Yazid was upon him, yet he found
The home to which his faltered steps were
bound.

The darting swallows at the riverside
Could not bring water where the dears
abide.

In sacrifice he lifted up his son
And wept to see what battle had been won.
Pierce my heart and my eyes with arrows
sharp

With sacrificial love and voice of harp.

4 Blessed *are* those who live in Your
house,

They'll praise You still, body and nous.

**5 Blessed is the man whose strength's in
You,**

**Whose heart is set on pilgrimage
To Your house ever age to age,**

**6 Valley of Baca [Mecca] they pass
through,**

**Making of it a spring, the rain
Covers also its pools again.**

The pilgrimage calls on the desert air,
And wafts its notes seductive to come there
On wing or weary foot and find the spring
That hid from Ishmael's eyes until the thing
Was spoken by the angel. Guide me too
By Baca's parched and hidden ways till
dew

Cools hand and brow, till staggered foot
finds rest

Upon the Kaaba of Your heart, a nest.
Beloved, bring me the tender valley road
Where on the sands both saints and camels
strode,

And I shall make a well beyond the fears
Of Ishmael's disappointment and his tears,
And know that even Mecca has its rains
And through its drought and through its
thirst remains.

7 They go from strength to strength, each
one

El Alohim's in Zion done.

**8 O YHWH Alohim of hosts, hear
My prayer, God of Jacob, give ear.**

9 Behold, O Alohim, our shield,
Regard Your Messiah's face *sealed*.

**10 For good's a day within Your courts,
Better than thousands in resorts.
My place is to keep the shoes safe
In my Alohim's house like waif,
Rather than dwelling in the tents
Of wickedness and without sense.**

11 A sun and shield's YHWH Alohim,
YHWH will give grace, glory esteem,
No good thing will He dare withhold
From those who walk upright *and bold*.

**12 O YHWH of hosts, happinesses
Of Adam are that his trust is
In You, and his confidences.**

The qalendar sits at the mosque door where
The worshippers come in, and coming bear
Their shoes to wait them while they stay in
prayer.

The qalendar sits where I'd like to be,
Always beside Your door, and if You see

Me sitting there, call me inside to pray,
Or if I am not worthy of that bay,
Then let me wait content beside the door.
Beloved, I set the sandals in their store
And match them with a face. The job's not
light

Remembering the faces night to night.
Though I for memory of faces gone
Am weak, especially toward the dawn,
I thank You for the woollen shirt I've on.

Psalm 85

1 To the chief musician, a Psalm
For the sons of Korah (10) *in balm*.
You have blessed, YHWH, Your land
indeed,

Brought back Jacob's captives in seed.

**2 You've released the sins of Your folk,
Covered their wickedness in stroke.**

3 You've taken away all Your wrath,
Turned from Your anger's fierceness' path.

**4 Turn us, O Alohim of our
Salvation, and make fall the tower
Of Your anger toward us *sour*.**

5 Will You be angry with us aye?
Will You extend your wrathful eye
To many generations' spy?

**6 Will You not once again revive
Us, so Your folk may joy alive
In You as long as they survive?**

7 Show us, O Lord, Your mercy and
Grant us Your salvation *to stand*.

**8 I'll hear what speaks El YHWH, for
He**

**Will declare Islam to His free
Folk and His holy ones, but let
Them not turn back to folly yet.**

9 Surely His salvation is near
To them that live within His fear,
That glory may stay in our land.

**10 Mercy and truth have given hand,
Righteousness and Islam have kissed.**

11 Truth shall spring from the earth of mist,
And righteousness look down from heaven.

**12 Also YHWH shall give good from
leaven,**

And our land yield increase *undim*.

13 Al-Sadiq shall go before him,
And shall set in ways of His trim.

The sixth Imam, Ja'fer Al-Sadiq went

Before all those that came after him sent
With truth and mercy in establishment
Of law defined and refined by the way
Of sema' punctuating night and day.
Beloved, You do declare the way of peace
To Your folk, both the leaders on increase
And every lowly one, ones such as I
Who merely keep the shoes of those gone
by

To pray upon the floor of temple set
Between the earth and sky, the dry and wet.
Beloved, You give the good to some and
all,

You cause the tender soil on earthly ball
To bring forth meat and drink and fill the
stall.

Psalm 86

1 A prayer of David. Bow down ear,
O YHWH, to me, listen and hear,
For I am poor and needy here.

**2 Preserve my soul, for I am holy,
Save Your servant, for I am lowly,
You are my Alohim for I
Trust in You now and by and by.**

3 Be merciful to me, O Lord,
For unto You I cry adored
All the day long *in my accord*.

**4 Give joy to Your servant's soul, for
To You, O Lord, I lift in store
My soul, rejoicing as before.**

5 For You, O Lord, are good and kind,
Full of mercy front and behind
To all who call on You *in bind*.

**6 Give ear, O YHWH, unto my prayer,
Attend to the sound everywhere
Of my petitions on the air.**

7 In the day of my trouble I
Will call on You, for You are nigh
To answer me *the day I cry*.

**8 There's none like You among the high,
O Lord, none with such deeds as try.**

**9 All nations You've made come adore
Before You, O Lord, in their score
They glorify Your name in store.**

10 For You are great, and wondrous things
You do, You alone *among kings*
Are Alohim as the sky sings.

For You are great, O my Beloved, and do

Most wondrous things. The only God is
You!

The clatter of the armies would suffice
It seems to set a rival god in vice.
The one is god who has the loudest voice,
And better rockets amplify the choice.
But You belie the competition in
The wondrous things You do to hide their
sin.

The moment of destruction is held fast
As silently the earth becomes new-grassed.
And after all the building and the gore,
Your hand unseen creates it as before.
For You are great in tiny things and green,
In what You do and what You say and
mean.

11 Teach me Your way, O YHWH, I'll
walk

In Your truth, knit my heart in stock
To fear Your name *and not just talk*.

**12 I'll praise You, O Lord and my God,
With all my heart, and at Your prod
I'll glorify Your name for ever.**

13 For Your great mercy will not sever
From me, and You have saved my soul
From lowest hell and from Sheol.

**14 O Alohim, the proud arise
Against me, and the crowds despise
My soul in seeking violence,
They have not stood in Your presence.**

15 You're a Lord El compassionate,
And merciful, patient, in state
Of much mercy and filled with truth.

**16 O turn to me, pity my youth,
Give Your strength to Your servant
here,**

Save Your maidservant's son *and dear*.

17 Show me a sign for good; that they
Which hate me may see *it*, and sway
In shame, because You, YHWH, will aid
Me and comfort me *when I've strayed*.

Beloved, what sign can You show that the
ones

Who do the wicked act, the deed that stuns,
Would recognize as proof of intervention
Of Your strong arm even in some
prevention?

The truth is no such sign at all exists.
No matter what You do, the mind insists

On turmoil and on static myth and foil.

The human situation's one of toil.

Beloved, I need no sign at all where I
Tread on the needled path under the sky
Where fir trees pierce the mist and so
create

A temple great enough for Your estate.

Beloved, I need no sign at all to go
Toward the shine of You and Your throne's
glow.

Psalm 87

1 A Psalm or song for Korah's sons (11).
His foundation is set in tons
Of mountains of his holiness.

**2 YHWH loves the gates of His fortress
More than tents of Jacob's address.**

**3 Glorious things are spoken of you,
O city of Alohim *true*.**

4 I'll make mention of Rahab and
Babylon to them that know me,
See Philistia, and Tyre's land,
With Ethiopia's *fair strand*;
This *man* was born there *to be free*.

**5 And of the fortress be it said,
This and that man was born and bred
In her: and the highest himself
Shall set her upon safety's shelf.**

6 YHWH shall count when He writes the
folk

That this man was bore there *for stroke*.

**7 Both singers and players on strings
Are there in you and all my springs.**

Beloved, is it true that the birth that rises
In fair Jerusalem receives Your prizes?

If so, then Askeri, eleventh Imam

Is sad to have been born under the palm
In loved Medina, bright Medina's calm.

And yet I look on tower and fortress that
The conquerors have set upon the mat
Of holiness and wonder if the sky
Does not send benedictions on the sly.

Beloved, it is a place to be once born,
As well as sacred place above all scorn,
Whether of Bethlehem, Quds, Makkah
sworn,

Or fair Medina, as well as to die.

Let me come into any such and lie.

Psalm 88

1 A Song or Psalm for Korah's sons (12),
To chief of musicians in runs
Of Mahalath Leanoth, and
Heman's Maschil, of Ezra's band.
YHWH Alohim of my salvation,
I cry day and night for Your ration.

**2 Let my prayer come before You nigh,
Incline Your ear unto my cry;**

**3 For my soul is full of distress,
My life draws near the grave's address.**

4 I'm counted with them that go down
Into the pit: I'm weak *to frown*.

**5 Free among the dead, like the slain
That lie in the grave, and whose gain
You keep in mind no more, and they
Are cut off from Your hand *and way*.**

6 You've laid me in the lowest pit,
In darkness, in the deeps to sit.

7 Your wrath lies hard upon me, and
You strike me with Your waves *on sand*.

**8 You've put away my friends from me,
You've made me before them to be
Abomination, I'm enclosed**

And cannot come out *unopposed*.

9 My eye mourns because of my pain,
YHWH, daily I call on Your main,
Stretched out hands in entreaty's *rain*.

**10 Will You show wonders to the dead?
Shall the dead rise to praise instead?**

11 Shall lovingkindness be declared
By You to the grave? *Or Your shared
Faithfulness in destruction fared?*

**12 Shall Your feats be known in the
dark?**

**And Your righteousness in the park
Of oblivion *for a lark?***

13 But unto You I've cried, O YHWH,
And in the morning shall the view
Of my prayer come up before You.

**14 YHWH, why do You cast off my soul
And hide Your face from me *in toll?***

15 I *am* afflicted, set to die
From *my* youth up, *and so* do I
Suffer Your terrors while I lie.

**16 Your fierce anger goes over me,
Your terrors cut me off *from tree*.**

17 Surrounding me each day *to see*
Like floods together *crushingly*.

**18 Lover and friend You've put away
From me afar, and in night's way.**

How many think on earth today that it
Might not be a comfort in which to sit
That the divine guide hidden now avails
Without an address and without ship sails?
Though death and the grave may be far
from him,

He's still shut in the dark at night and dim
Without friends and without a brother near
To share his loaf and chatter without fear.
Beloved, I do not envy the long years
Of life without rest, laughter, yet with tears
That scatter in the way that he must go
To do his duty in the worldly show.
Beloved, I do not envy the long life
The Master of the Age must see for strife.

Psalm 89

1 Maschil of Ethan the Ezrahite.

I'll sing of the mercies of YHWH

**For ever: with my mouth I do
Make known Your faithfulness to all
Generations *upon the ball*.**

2 For I have said "Mercy shall be
Built up for ever: faithfully
You'll set it up unto the skies.

3 I've made pact with My chosen *wise*,
I've sworn to David My servant,

**4 'I shall set up your descendant
For ever, and build up your throne
To all generations *as shown*.'"**

My grandmother read at the midnight hour
Each night David's Psalms in glory and
power,

A humble dweller in David's vast house
Abandoned by all but the nibbling mouse.
Shunted aside by every church and priest,
Unknown by rabbi and mullah, she ceased
Not to recite the honeyed words till sleep
Taught her no more to joy, no more to
weep.

While I acknowledge Adam, Noah, and
Moses, Jesus, Muhammad on the sand,
I still come to the throne for ever set
And feed on David's speech until I get
The blessings written on tablets on high,
And see the golden crease upon the sky.

5 The skies shall praise Your wonders,
YHWH,
Your faithfulness also in crew

Of holy ones *bowing to You*.

**6 For who in heaven can be compared
To YHWH, and who among the bared
Sons of the might then can be shown
Like YHWH *sitting upon His throne?***

7 El's enormously to be feared
In the assembly of saints steered,
And to be had in reverence
Of all *those* around him in tents.

**8 O YHWH Alohim of armies,
Who's a strong YHWH like Your
degrees,**

Or in faithfulness of decrees?

9 You rule the raging of the sea,
When the waves rise in panoply,
You still them as far as can see.

**10 You have broken Rahab in pieces,
As one that's slaughters and increases,
You've scattered all Your enemies
With Your strong arm and in Your ease.**

11 The heavens *are* Yours, the earth also,
As is the world and all its show,
You've founded them *and set in row*.

**12 The north and the south You have
made,**

Tabor and Hermon Your name stayed.

13 You have a mighty arm, strong hand,
With raised right hand You come to stand.

**14 Justice and judgement *are* the place
Of Your throne's house and carapace,
Mercy and truth before Your face.**

A God of justice You're declared to be
By the wisest of kings, a prophet free,
And so justice is Your foundation stone,
An attribute inseparable, alone
Your own, You only are impartial here,
You have no parts or pieces in Your gear.
Beloved, I know that You are One above,
And as One have no parts, and so Your
glove

Of justice is inseparable from You,
And in Your justice You deign to give clue
Of Your will for humankind in the way
That You reveal to prophets on a day.
As humankind must have a demonstration,
You also send divine guides in their ration.

15 Blessed *is* the folk who know the sound
Of joy and walk, YHWH, where is found
The light of Your face *on the ground*.

**16 In Your name they'll rejoice all day,
In Your righteousness rise away.**

17 For You're the glory of their strength,
In Your favour our horn at length
Shall be exalted in a day.

**18 For YHWH *is* our defence, our king
The Holy One of Israel's wing.**

19 You spoke in vision to Your saint,
And said "I've raised one *without plaint*
Out of the people *and their spring*.

**20 "I have found David my servant,
With oil of My holiness plant
Him My appointed one *extant*.**

21 "With him My hand shall be upheld,
My arm shall strengthen him as spelled.

**22 "The enemy shall not exact
His toll on him, nor son of pact
In wickedness afflict his tract.**

23 "I'll crush his foes before his face,
And plague them all that hate his trace.

**24 "My faithfulness and My mercy
Shall be with him, and in decree
Of My name shall his horn rise free.**

25 "I'll set his hand too in the sea,
And his right hand where rivers flee.

**26 "He'll cry to me, 'You are my Dad,
My El, and my salvation's pad.'**

27 "Also I'll make him *my* firstborn,
Higher than the earthly kings *forsworn*.

28 "My mercy will I keep for him
For evermore, also My trim
Pact shall stand firmly and with him.

**29 "His descendants also I'll make
Endure for ever for the sake
Of his throne as the days of heaven.**

30 "If his children forsake my law,
And not walk in my judgments' leaven,
31 "If they break my statutes *with claw*,
And not keep My commandments' awe,
32 "Then I'll render their sin with rod,
Their wickedness with stripes *on sod*.

**33 "And yet My lovingkindness I
Will not wholly take from their sigh,
Nor let My faithfulness slide by.**

34 "My covenant I will not break,
Nor change the thing My lips instate,

35 "Once have I sworn by holiness
I'll not lie to David's address.

**36 "His descendants shall always be,
And his throne as the sun by Me.**

37 "It shall be set up like the moon

Forever as a faithful boon
To witness to the heaven soon.”

Beloved, You set up David as Your own
And gave him power and right and
righteous throne,
Delighted to hear his Psalms to intone
Upon the fields where sheep and bear alone
Could hear the silver notes. And all stayed
awed.

The birds themselves were silent, with a
nod
The lion brought its cubs to hear the tune,
And trees and grass danced in the light of
noon.

Beloved, You set up David as a king
Forever to proclaim Your law on wing
Of Psalm in song and prayer and for all
time.

That’s why I come to sing to You in rhyme.
The witness of Your own is etched on high
In moon and sun and stars that fill the sky.

38 But You have cast off and abhorred,
You’re angry with anointed lord.

**39 You’ve made void Your slave’s
covenant,**

Profaned his crown on the ground *rent*.

40 You’ve broken down all his Ghadir,
Brought his strongholds to ruin’s fear.

**41 All who pass by the way spoil him,
He’s mocked by all his neighbours *grim*.**

42 You’ve set up his foes’ right hand’s
choice,

Made all his enemies rejoice.

**43 You’ve also turned edge of his sword,
And left in battle to be gored.**

44 You’ve made his glory cease, and cast
His throne down to the ground *and passed*.

**45 You’ve shortened the days of his
youth**

And covered him with shame *in truth*.

46 How long, YHWH? Will You always
hide?

Will burning wrath always abide?

**47 Remember how short is my time,
Why have You made all men mere
rhyme?**

48 What man lives and shall not see death
To save himself from the grave’s breath?

49 Where are Your lovingkindnesses

You swore to David in truth’s fizz?

50 Remember, Lord, Your servants’ fray,
What heavy heart I bear in sway
Of all the mighty folk today,

51 By which Your enemies have mocked,
YHWH, footsteps Your anointed walked.

**52 Blessed be YHWH now and
evermore,**

Amen, amen, *from shore to shore*.

The third book of the Psalms prepares to
light

The first of the month by the moon at night
With songs of the appointment of Your
own

Divine guides sitting round King David’s
throne.

The Ghadir of appointment makes the
round,

The twelve Imams are mentioned on the
ground,

And they remain in David’s wake to be
Along with the Messiah of the free

To rule David’s kingdom eternally.

Beloved, I seek the blessing of the word
That called David from field of beast and
bird

To rule with rod of iron and Your law’s
truth.

I sought the blessing when I was a youth
And seek it now and always faithfully.

Psalms Book Four Psalm 90

1 A prayer of Moses man of Alohim.

Lord, You have been our refuge of esteem
From generation to generation.

**2 Before mountains ever came to be done
Or ever You had formed the earth and
world,**

From all eternity and it unfurled,

**You are El. 3 You return man back to
dust,**

**And say “Come back, you sons of Adam
must!”**

4 For one thousand years in Your sight are
just

Like yesterday when it is past and gone,
And as a night watch *coming on the dawn*.

**5 You carry them away as with a flood;
They are a sleep, at the dawn on the mud**

**Like grass that grows up *and blooms*
from the bud.**

6 In the forenoon it flourishes and grows,
At eve cut down and withering in rows.

Beloved, You give life to the human show
And take it back to Yourself suddenly.
And when the breath is gone and the body
Lies there inert, You come and in one go
Give life again, the man awakes and so
Rises to praise You with his breath and see
The wonders of Your universe on spree,
And then again return to the grave low.
Beloved, that sleep I find each time I take
A breath, and then in You again awake
To wonder and to joy: And so I learn
Through life to take my place in the clay
urn

From which cocoon at last I shall arise
To find only Your face instead of skies.

7 For we're drowned in your anger and
By Your wrath troubled *in the land*.

**8 You've set our failings before You,
Our secrets in light of Your view.**

9 For all our days have passed away
In Your wrath, we spend years to stay
As a mere legend in our sway.

**10 Our years are seventy and yet
If by strength eighty years are met,
They're filled with work and sorrow too,
And soon cut off we fly from view.**

11 Who knows the power of Your wrath?
As is Your fear, so is Your wrath.

**12 So teach us to count off our days,
Applying hearts in wisdom's ways.**

Beloved, not every man knows how to
count

So many days You give us in amount.
Some languages have numbers that do not
Go more than three or four, although the lot
Of all men is that they should count the
days

To seven to be able in their praise
To find the rhythm of creation's plot
And all the blessed Sabbaths that we've
got.

Beloved, I do not know Your wrath at all,
Backed as I am against the human wall
Of vain oppressions and vain pride on call.

But without numbers more than fingers
spent,

Or sliding sticks between them for a vent,
I seek the wisdom, my Beloved, You've
sent.

13 Return, O YHWH, how long until
You change Your mind about the bill
Of Your servants *on plain and hill?*

**14 Feed us at morn with Your mercy
So we'll rejoice and we shall be
Glad all the days *that we shall see*.**

15 Make us glad for as many days
As You've afflicted us in maze,
As many years as we have seen
The evil come *upon the scene*.

**16 Let Your slave see Your action show,
Your glory on their children glow.**

17 And let the beauty of YHWH our
Alohim be on us in power
And set the work of our hands fit,
Our hands' work then establish it.

I feed upon Your mercy even now,
Beloved, so many centuries of row
Beyond the days of David, yes, I feed
Upon the mercy that You gave in seed
In the sweet Psalms he sang when You
decreed.

And yet I do not forget in the bloom
The Psalms of Moses man above Your
doom,

And stand rejoicing now before the noon
To have from morning's hour the blessed
boon.

Beloved, I feed upon Your mercy when
I wake from troubled slumber among men
And when I walk the market ways and see
The busy lives progressing around me,
I feed upon Your mercy even then.

Psalms 91

1 The one who sits in secret place
Of Elyon, in the shadow's trace
Of Shaddai rests through the night's race.

**2 I'll say of YHWH, "He's my refuge
And my fortress, Alohim huge,
I find safety before His face."**

3 He'll set you free from fowler's snare,
From plague's ravages *everywhere*.

4 He'll wrap you in His feathers' band,

**Under His wings in trust you'll stand,
His truth your shield and armour grand.**

5 You'll not be afraid *of the flight*
Of terror coming in the night,
Nor of the bullet in the day.

**6 You'll not fear the plague in the way
Of darkness, nor destruction come
Wasting at high noon all in sum.**

7 A thousand may fall at your side,
Ten thousand at your right hand ride,
It shall not come near where you hide.

**8 Only with your eyes you will see
Punishment on the wicked spree.**

Beloved, how many men in foxholes here
On earth repeat this Psalm to calm their
fear!

And as they say the words of faith and
hope,

They come at last to the end of their rope.
The spirit crashes under weight and drain
Of pressure from the power of sleepless
pain,

The nerve is blasted beyond all recall
Of courage and of skill against the wall.
Beloved, how many men with this on
tongue

Have met destroying bullet or the rung
Of missile that exploded and then stung
The life and lust out of the loin and breast.
How many men sing this, then go to rest.
I turn away my eyes against the pall.

9 Since you have made YHWH my refuge,
Elyon, your hiding *from deluge*,

**10 No evil thing shall come on you,
No plague come anywhere in view.**

11 For He shall give His angels charge
Of you to guard your ways *at large*.

**12 They shall bear you up in their hands,
So no stone hurts your foot on sands.**

13 You'll tread down lion and the snake,
The young lion and dragon's stake
You'll trample under your feet's wake.

**14 "Because he's set his love on Me,
That's why I'll save him from the spree;
I'll raise him up upon a peek
Because My name he knew to seek.**

15 "He'll call on Me, and I'll reply,
I'll be with him where troubles lie,
I'll save him and I'll glorify.

**16 "With his long life I'll satisfy,
And show him My salvation high."**

So many now believe in angels met,
And every other dame that speaks is set
To tell me that the glittering ones yet
Guide life and love between the hedge and
bet.

I know some who've heard angels speak a
while,
Some in the night and some in daylight's
toil,

But I have never heard their words aloud
In English spoken like all of the crowd.
I've only heard their twittering beneath
The leafy vine as well as blossomed
wreath.

But I can stop to understand the song,
Decipher every word that comes along,
And see my feet go straight along the path,
Despite the quartzite mountain and its
wrath.

Psalm 92

1 A Psalm or song for Sabbath day.
Good to give thanks to YHWH and pray
Praises to Your name, O Elyon!

**2 To publish Your mercy as shown
In the dawn, and Your faithfulness
In every evening's light's address.**

3 On an instrument of ten strings,
Upon a psaltery as sings,
And harp as its melody flings.

**4 For You, YHWH, have made me
rejoice**

**Through Your works, I'll triumph in
choice**

**Works of Your hands where they have
flown.**

5 O YHWH, how great are Your works
grown,

And Your thoughts deep *beyond my voice*.

**6 A brutish man can never know,
Nor does a fool regard the show.**

7 When the wicked spring as the grass,
When evil doers rise and pass,
They shall be destroyed *in their crass*.

The blessed Sabbath day comes week by
week

And gives rest and strength to both strong
and weak.

The praising of Your Name, Beloved, is
where

Health rises and blessings fall on the air.
An instrument of ten strings is the way
To sing Your sema' on the Sabbath day.
And yet the foolish man, the multitude,
Forget Your name, Your day, Your faith
imbued

With love and power and wisdom in
address,

With care and help and song and
righteousness.

Beloved, I triumph in the gathering
That comes each Sabbath day and just to
sing

Your Torah and Your Psalms that will
destroy

All evil from the earth and bring us joy.

8 But You, YHWH, are most high for
good.

9 For see, Your enemies as could,
O YHWH, see Your foes fall in wood,
Scattered the wicked *as they should*.

**10 But my horn shall You raise like one
Of the unicorn, *when I've done*
I'll be anointed with fresh oil.**

11 My eye shall see *fruit of my toil*
Upon my enemies *in spoil*,
My ears shall hear *the frightful sound*
Of my foes *fallen on the ground*,
That once rose against me around.

**12 The righteous shall bloom like the
palm,**

Grow like cedar in Lebanon.

13 Those planted in the house of YHWH
Shall flourish in Alohim's view.

**14 They'll bring forth fruit in their old
age,**

And shall be fat and strong for wage,

**15 To show YHWH in His uprightness,
He is my rock, refuge address,
In Him there's no unrighteousness.**

The horn of power I let go its own way,
And so do not compete with evil's sway,
But let You only take Your time to make
All wickedness fall from earth for Your
sake.

I plant my feet in stillness and I grow
My pointed, harsh leaves of the palm in
show

Against the many firs and birches here
That claim the land and hope for help and
gear.

My stem and blossoms shine with holy oil
That You pour out on Sabbath after toil,
And so I flourish in the hidden court
Of Your grand temple under sky and fort.
Beloved, I love the rest of Sabbath day,
The coming back to You after the fray.

Psalm 93

1 YHWH reigns and clothed in majesty,
YHWH clothed with strength formidably,
Also the world is set so it
Cannot be moved from footer fit.

**2 Your throne's established anciently,
From everlasting You are He.**

3 The floods have lifted up, O YHWH,
The floods lift up their voices *true*,
The floods raise their waves *into view*.

**4 Than noise of many waters high,
Than mighty waves of the sea *nigh*
Mightier on high does YHWH *fly*.**

5 Your testimonies, they are pure,
Holiness becomes Your house sure,
O YHWH for ever *to endure*.

The concept that Your being is as sure
As earth itself must be here to endure
Is really quite parochial, I'm sure.
No doubt the Psalmist meant another thing:
That You from all eternity are king
No matter what the earth may be or sing.
The sea is great from where I take a look,
But in Your house it's just a little nook.
Beloved, the mind of man cannot contain
The boundaries of Your almighty reign,
But holy and apart are You from all
That You create in expanse and in ball,
While I join Moses, David and the stall
Of singers to remember You for gain.

Psalm 94

1 El of vengeance, You are YHWH
El of vengeance, come in view!

**2 Rise, judge of the earth and give share
To the proudful their due in ware.**

3 How long shall the wicked ones, YHWH,

How long shall wicked ones raise hue?

**4 Shall they bring great things into view,
With wicked boast of their own crew?**

5 Your people, YHWH, they break in
pieces,

As Your lot's affliction increases.

**6 They kill the widow and the guest,
Murder the fatherless and best.**

7 And they say "YHWH shall not regard,
Nor Jacob's Alohim take hard."

Some take vengeance into their hand a rate
A double portion on enemy's pate.

Some take vengeance into the land of law,
And being wealthy, make the law their
claw.

Some sweetly pretend vengeance has no
taste

For them because they're slender in the
waist

And wonderful above both spoon and plate.

Beloved, I leave the vengeance all to You,
Knowing that You're impartial as You do,
And mighty above all things in the air,
And You will surely fail not in the share
That everyone is due. If I've been late
To fall beneath oppressions' hand and state,
Then You know better than I what to pare.

8 Understand, brutish of the folk,
And fools, when will your wisdom stoke?

**9 The One that set the ear in place,
Shall He not hear the ball and mace?**

10 The one who punishes the wrong
Of pagans, shall He not be strong
To show chastisement, He the One
Who teaches man knowledge when done?

**11 YHWH knows the thoughts of man
are vain.**

**12 Blessed is the man whom You
restrain,
YHWH, and teach him Your law's
refrain.**

13 Then You might give him rest from pain
Until the pit's prepared to take
The wicked *in store and in stake*.

**14 For YHWH will not cast off His folk,
He'll not forsake His lot in yoke.**

**15 For unto righteousness shall sit
The judgement, and so after it
Shall follow innocent hearts fit.**

I'm waiting for the day the pit appears
For all those who regard it without fears,
And wrestle not with grief but bide the
tears

Of poor and oppressed once caught in the
weirs.

I'm waiting for the day and trusting that
You will not boil me living in that fat
Prepared for every willing and fat cat
That stands to make a buck, though he's a
rat.

Beloved, I trust that You will send me out
To miss the pit the wicked are about
And give me one chance at the golden
street

Where You provide the living and the treat.
Let me be of the righteous at Your feet,
And lend my voice to those who sing and
shout.

16 Who'll rise up for me against wrong,
To stand against the sinners' song?

**17 Unless YHWH had become my aid,
My soul had in the silence stayed.**

18 When I said "I'm about to fall,"
Your mercy, YHWH, held me in stall.

**19 When my thoughts crush me with
their weight,**

Your comforts delight my soul late.

20 Shall judgement seat of wickedness
Have fellowship with Your address,
One that makes mischief as by law?

**21 They gather themselves with sharp
claw**

**Against the righteous soul and lay
Death sentence innocent to pay.**

22 But YHWH is for me a defence,
My Alohim a rock from whence
I find my refuge *and my fence*.

**23 He'll bring their own sins down on
them,**

**And cut them from wickedness' hem,
YHWH our Alohim will cut them.**

My chances of salvation are still fair
Because I see that You've preserved me
where

My penitence may still come to repair.
Bring on each man the sin that he does not
Repent of in the compromising lot

And turn back to what You've revealed and taught.

Bring on me only grace, as I turn round
To repent of my sins upon the ground
Where turning to the Psalms is a sweet sound.

Beloved, I do not judge You that You judge
The wicked to the pit and do not fudge,
But praise You that You give me now a chance

To join the heavenly harpers and the dance
Of faith and obedience You enhance.

Psalms 95

1 Oh come, now let us sing to YHWH!
And let us shout joyfully to
The Rock of our salvation *due*.

**2 Let us come before His presence
With thanksgiving, let us with sense
Shout joyfully to Him with Psalms.**

3 For a great El God is YHWH and
A great king of all who command.

**4 In His hand are the depths of earth,
His also is hills' strength in girth.**

5 To Him's the sea that He has made,
His hands formed the dry *land displayed*.

**6 Come let us worship in prostration,
Kneeling to YHWH of our creation.**

7 For He's our Alohim, and we
The people of His pasture free,
The sheep beneath His hand and power.

If you hear His voice at this hour,
8 Do not make your heart hard as in
Meriba, on the day of sin

In the desert. 9 Your ancestors
Tried me and tempted Me in scores
And saw My works. 10 Forty years long
I sorrowed for this people's wrong,
And said "It's a folk that do err
In their heart, as it does occur

They have not known My works and ways,
11 To whom in anger I swore best
They should not enter in My rest."

Who despised Canaan's land were left
To walk the desert land bereft.
Who failed to keep the Sabbath day,
But went to gather manna's ray,
Were given putrid worms to eat,
Fit symbol of the feast they treat
Themselves to before idol's sway.

Who despised later pleasant land
Of Ahmed because they'd not stand
Another book and vision grand,
Enter no rest, but must repeat
The desert wandering with bare feet.
Beloved, I kiss both Palestine,
Makkah, Medina, Sabbath's wine.

Psalms 96

1 Sing to YHWH a new song, and sing
To YHWH, the earth and everything.

**2 Sing to YHWH and so bless His name,
Each day His salvation proclaim.**

3 Declare the nations His glory,
To all peoples His mystery.

**4 For great is YHWH, and to be praised
Greatly, feared above all gods razed.**

5 For all the nations' gods are vain,
But YHWH made the sky *and its rain*.

**6 Honour and majesty with Him,
Strength and beauty His temple's rim.**

7 Give to YHWH, families of folk,
Give YHWH glory and strength *in stroke*.

**8 Give YHWH glory as due His name,
Bring offering, come to His courts' fame.**

9 Bow down to YHWH in holiness'
Beauty, fear Him, all earth's address.

**10 Say among the heathen, YHWH
reigns:**

**The world too be set tight in reins,
He shall judge people righteously.**

11 Let heaven rejoice, let earth be glad,
Let the sea roar and all it had.

**12 Let the field be joyful, and all
That is in it, and then shall all
The trees of the wood joy to call.**

13 Before YHWH, for He comes to judge
The earth, the world without a smudge,
The people with His truth *in stall*.

Beloved, I joy to see and hear the truth,
That You are God among the heathen youth
And elders, men and women, and forsooth
The children too. You see I am no shoe
Of Abraham's seed nor the child of true
Jacob, so I rejoice I have You too.
Beloved, the field is joyful, so what sense
Is there in leaving out the folk of rents
When You make up Your own of those
whose lot
Is heritage of Jacob in his plot?

The sea too and all things that live in it
 Are here proclaimed both pure, righteous
 and fit
 To be Your own. Beloved, You rule the
 tide,
 And so I come to You, in You I hide.

Psalm 97

1 YHWH reigns, so let the earth rejoice,
 Let isles in multitude raise voice.
**2 Clouds and darkness are around Him:
 Righteousness and judgement undim
 Are footing of the throne of Him.**
 3 A fire goes out before Him, and
 It burns His foes on every hand.
**4 His lightnings enlighten the earth,
 The world saw and trembled in berth.**
 5 The hills melt like wax before YHWH,
 Before the whole world's Lord *as due*.
**6 The sky declares His righteousness,
 His Sadiq, and all people bless
 His glory they come to confess.**
 7 Shame on all those who bow down to
 Graven images, and boast too
 Of idols: bow to Him alone
 All you exalted ones *intone*.
**8 The fortress heard, and they were glad,
 The daughters of Judah then had
 Great joy because of Your judgements,
 O YHWH, when come into Your tents.**
 9 For You're high, YHWH, over the earth,
 Exalted above all of worth.
**10 You who love YHWH, hate evil then,
 He saves souls of His holy men,
 He saves them from the wicked den.**
 11 Light is well seeded for Sadiq,
 Gladness set in upright heart *thick*.
**12 Rejoice in YHWH, Sadiq, and give
 Thanks in the dhikr of His sieve.**

The twelve verses of David's Psalm give
 hint
 That the Holy Imams have entered print,
 And this one starts with the sixth in the row
 To magnify Al-Sadiq in the show.
 Light and joy come from keeping of the
 law
 That Sadiq carefully wrote out in awe,
 Identifying every case that glows
 From Decalogue and Torah and that knows
 To shine in every prophet's pages where

The help and hope of humankind is there.
 Beloved, I praise You for the ones You
 sent,
 I praise You for the great salvation lent,
 I see the hills melt down before the sight
 Of Your throne planted on earth day and
 night.

Psalm 98

A Psalm.
 1 Oh sing to YHWH a brand new song,
 For He's done marvels all along.
 His right hand and His holy arm
 Have overcome now every harm.
**2 YHWH's made His salvation appear,
 His righteousness He has shown clear
 In sight of all the heathen near.**
 3 He's remembered His mercy and
 His truth toward Israel in band,
 The farthest reaches of the earth
 Have seen the salvation in worth
 Of our Alohim *at His hand*.
**4 So make a joyful sound to YHWH,
 All the earth, sing a loud song too,
 Rejoicing and praising His due.**
 5 Sing to YHWH with the harp *and palm*,
 With harp and the sound of a Psalm.
**6 With trumpets and sound of cornet
 Make a joyful sound to YHWH met
 As King of earth and all in view.**
 7 Let the sea roar and all in it,
 The world and those that in it sit.
**8 Let the floods clap their hands, the hills
 Be joyful together in rills.**
 9 Before the face of YHWH, He comes
 To judge the earth *and all its sums*,
 With Sadiq He shall judge the earth,
 The people with judgement of worth.

The rule of Al-Sadiq is that in force
 When You shall come to judge the earth in
 course
 Of time, and bring all men before Your
 face.
 I live from breath to breath in that fair
 grace,
 From week to week in hearing of the trace
 Of Your law in the lilting Hebrew words
 That make up the teaching of wonder birds.
 Beloved, as Sabbath comes again, I see
 The harp appear against the sky to be

The harbinger of a new song to me.
Though Your songs are from ancient days,
I find
Them always fresh to heart, spirit and
mind,
The gauge of wonder and the joyful sound
Of Your justice and faith upon the ground.

Psalm 99

1 YHWH reigns, let the folk trembling
quake,

He sits in the cherubim's wake,
Let the earth be moved round and shake.

**2 YHWH is great in the fortress, He
Is high above all people wee.**

3 Let them praise Your great, awful name,
For it is holy *in its fame*.

**4 The king's strength is that his delight
Is in judgement, and You do right,
You apply judgement's righteousness
In Jacob and in his address.**

5 Lift high YHWH our Alohim, high,
And prostrate at His footstool nigh,
For He is holy *to confess*.

**6 Moses and Aaron of His priests,
And Samuel of those who in feasts
Call on His name, they called on YHWH,
And He answered them *what was true*.**

7 He spoke to them in pillared cloud,
They kept His testimonies' crowd,
Ordinances He gave *aloud*.

**8 You answered them, YHWH Alohim,
You were an El forgiving dream,
Though You took vengeance on their
scheme.**

9 Exalt YHWH our Alohim, and
Prostrate at His holy hill's sand,
For YHWH our Alohim is grand.

On Sabbath day I take the words sent down
To Moses in the desert dry and brown,
And see them nourish my heart and bring
out

The leaf and bud and flower after the
sprout.

On Sabbath day in my remembrance due
I take the words of Torah and the true,
Reciting them in Hebrew and the while
In rhymes and rhythms set down for a
smile.

Like Samuel in the days of old I sound

Your name, Beloved, and as I turn around
I hear Your footsteps falling on the ground,
I see Your coming in the morning light,
In footfalls of the deer, and in the sight
Of violets in fall surprising night.

Psalm 100

1 A Psalm of praise.

Make a joyful sound unto YHWH,
All you lands *and all in your pew*.

**2 Serve YHWH with gladness, come
before**

His face with singing *from the score*.

3 Know that YHWH, He is Alohim,
He has made us, it would not seem
That we have made ourselves *in dream*,
We are His people and the sheep
Of His pasture *and in His keep*.

**4 Come in His gates with gratitude,
Into His courts with praise renewed,
Be thankful to Him, bless His name.**

5 For YHWH is good, His mercy's fame
Is everlastingly the same,
His truth to generations' aim.

All lands are here to serve You, Alohim,
And so it comes out in the final scheme
That Israel alone is not Your own
To owe obedience before Your throne.
Israel may be Your favourite in store,
But that does not release those at the door
From obligation to serve You in all
The lands around the world where they're
in stall.

Beloved, all have the right and gift to sing
The Hebrew Psalms in praises, to You
bring

The offering of voice and harp and sound
Of thanks to You who made sky, sea and
ground.

You do not change, and You have always
been

The One to say for all men what is sin.

Psalm 101

1 A Psalm of David.

I'll sing of mercy and judgement,
To You, O YHWH, songs I present.

2 I'll act wisely in perfect way.

When will You come to me in sway?

I shall walk in my house to be

With a perfect heart *where You see.*

3 I'll set no wicked thing before
My eyes, I hate the work in store
Of those who turn aside *from lore*
Of Your law, I let all such be.

**4 Let wicked heart depart from me,
I will not know wicked one's spree.**

5 The one who brings a secret word
Of slander about neighbour stirred,
I will cut off, and those that show
A proud look and proud heart to go
I will not tolerate *in show*.

**6 My eyes shall look toward the just
In the land, they may sit in trust
With me, and he that acts aright,
He shall serve with me *in Your sight*.**

7 The one who does deceitfully
Shall not sit in my house with me,
The one that tells lies shall not stay
In my sight *in the place I pray*.

**8 Early shall I destroy all those
Who work their wickedness in rows
Upon the ground, so I'll cut off
All wicked doers, those who scoff,
From the town of YHWH to oppose.**

Sometimes the look that seems to be so
proud

Is one mistaken for feelings allowed.
The face is mirror of the soul indeed,
But reading faces is by higher creed
A task most difficult to face or do.
The proud look is not evidence, but clue,
And clue that has but little weight to bear
On showing who is sinful for their share.
Beloved, let the proud look be so or not,
I flee from lookers-on in evil plot,
And from the failures of a day untaught.
Lay low deceit, Beloved, in me and mine
And in the waltzers and bibbers of wine,
And I shall praise Your keeping things in
line.

Psalm 102

1 A prayer of the afflicted, when
He is overwhelmed among men,
And pours out his complaint before
YHWH *to keep things up in the score*.
Hear my prayer, YHWH, and let my cry
Come up before You as I try.

2 Don't hide Your face from me the day

I am caught up in trouble's sway;

Incline Your ear to me as soon

As I call and give me a boon.

3 For my days are consumed like smoke,
And my bones burnt in a hearth's stroke.

4 My heart is struck and withers bare
Like grass, so I forget my share
Of bread to eat *and fall in care*.

**5 I groan aloud until my bones
Stick to my skin *as without loans*.**

**6 I'm like a desert pelican,
An owl in the wilderness span.**

7 I watch like a sparrow alone
On the house top *unseen, unknown*.

The Psalm that is a prayer of one caught in
Affliction is a surprise in the bin.

I'd think the Psalms, if not plucked at the
harp

Of David, who was king, would be the
sharp

Note of some other on elitist tree.

One would not expect Psalms of poverty
And of affliction in the standard fare,
The State cult and the book of common
prayer.

And yet it is a thing that meets the eye:

A proof if ever that You in the sky
Inspired the compositions, did not let
The fears of human powers come to get
The blame and share of everything that's
set

In Scripture. So I stop and am aware.

8 My enemies reproach all day,
They rage against me, sworn for pay.

9 For I've eaten ashes like bread,
And mixed my drink with tears outspread.

**10 For Your raging and for Your wrath,
For You've lifted me from the path
And thrown me out *upon my head*.**

11 My days are like shadows to pass,
And I am withered like the grass.

**12 But You, YHWH, shall always
endure,**

As Your remembrance ever sure.

13 You rise and have mercy upon
The fortress, in her favour drawn
As set time and sure *as the dawn*.

**14 Your servants take joy in her stones,
And favour the dust of her loans.**

The dhikr, service of remembrance of
 Your names of grace and mercy and of
 love,
 Continues through the ages always met
 From generations of the elite set
 As well as generations of the poor,
 Illiterate and those without a show.
 When Sangmeister ate ashes with his bread,
 Beisel was patronizing of his head.
 When Jesus Christ into the hall was led,
 Caiaphas was conscious of his state
 As ruler and official at the gate.
 Beloved, unnoticed by the angel throng,
 I crash the gates of heaven with my song,
 And stand alone with or without the wrong.

15 The heathen shall fear name of YHWH,
 All earthly kings His glory due.

**16 When YHWH shall build up the
 fortress,**

He'll appear in His glory's dress.

17 He'll listen to the poor man's prayer,
 And He will not despise them there.

**18 This is written for generations
 To come, and the folk in their stations
 Created shall praise YHWH for rations.**

19 He's looked down from His temple
 height,
 From heaven did YHWH take earth in
 sight,

**20 To hear the prisoner's complaint,
 To free those under death's constraint;**

21 To publish YHWH's name in Zion,

Show His praise in Jerusalem,

22 When the people are gathered there,
 And the kingdoms to serve YHWH's share.

My only claim to fame in mountain track
 Is that I fear Your name behind Your back.
 The promise is a sure one and is true
 The heathen shall come fear the name of
 YHWH.

There's not a sign that any in my line
 Stood in the court of David to drink wine,
 Not even a Uriah or the lot
 Of Edomite in my ancestral plot.
 Beloved, the praise I bring to You is
 wrought

On heathen tongue and in a hapla sought

On distant shores from Sinai and the
 taught.

And yet I find my tongue avails as well
 To sing the Psalms in speech of Israel
 And quench my thirst at evening sound of
 bell.

23 He weakened my strength in the way,
 He entered to abridge my day.

**24 I said "My El, take not away
 Myself in middle of my life:**

**Your years endure *and without strife*
 Throughout all generations *rife*.**

25 "From ancient times You set the ground
 Of the earth, and the sky is found
 To be the work of Your hands *round*.

**26 "They perish, but You shall endure,
 Indeed they take a worn allure,
 And as a cloak, You'll change them and
 They shall be turned *over in hand*.**

27 "But You're the same and all Your
 years

Shall have no ending in arrears.

**28 "Your servants' children shall keep
 on,
 Their descendants set like the dawn."**

Beloved, how many You have taken out
 At thirty-five and in life living stout,
 The middle of three-score and ten devout!
 So have You done and so shall You still do
 Despite the prayer of David as Your cue.
 It is too late, Beloved, to cut me off
 Before the line of slumber and the scoff,
 Because a dozen years alone divide
 My breath from three-score and ten at the
 side.

But whether or not I reach to that state
 Of age and wait the coming of my fate,
 Or if the world comes to an end belate,
 I raise the prayer of David and recite
 The words that pray against my human
 plight.

Psalm 103

1 Of David. Bless YHWH, O my soul,
 All in me bless His holy Name.

**2 Bless YHWH, my soul, do not forget
 All the benefits that He's set.**

3 He forgives your iniquities
 And heals you of every disease.

**4 He rescues your life from the fall,
He crowns You with mercy withal
And lovingkindness above all.**

5 He satisfies your mouth with good,
Renews your youth like eagle's would.

**6 YHWH acts in His righteousness and
Judgement for all in oppressed band.**

7 He made known His ways to Moses,
His acts to Israel's folk *by this*.

The Sabbath day is set apart for me
To bless Your holy name eternally,
While time wastes body and the power to
be,

Each week I enter in a temple free
Of time and motion, lost in power and
strength

And loveliness of You, Beloved, at length.
The evil passions of the weekly round
Fall then confessed, forgiven on the ground
Of that great rescue from all time and place
To bring me back from whirling to Your
face.

Beloved, indeed my strength returns
renewed

With that blessed wine of Sabbath day
imbued

With Your vast spirit that once flew along
The waters of creation and Your song.

8 YHWH's merciful and gracious, slow
To wrath, and filled with goodness' *show*.

**9 He will not always chide, nor will
He always keep His anger's fill.**

10 He's not treated us as deserved
According to sins we have swerved,
Rewarding us for wickedness.

**11 For as the sky is high above
The earth, so great also's His love
In mercy for those who confess
Their fear of Him and His address.**

12 As far as east is from the west,
So far has He removed *the nest*
Of our transgressions from our *vest*.

**13 As a father has mercy on
His children, so YHWH's also gone
In pity of those who fear Him.**

The wise in sun's worship comes to confess
His sins before the cross of light to bless
Its deaths and resurrections and impress

Against all reason that to kill a man
Will make all things right in the divine
plan.

Instead I come the day before to get
The true in blessing, where Your grace is
met

By those whom You forgive in infinite
Mercy to which no sacrifice of blight
Can add a whit. The Sabbath fills my heart
With light brighter than sun and moon
impart,

Not just because it is the day You made
To review all creating power displayed,
But because on it You've set Your power's
right.

14 For He knows our frame and remembers
That we are mere dust, *ash and embers*.

**15 The days of man are like the grass,
Flowers of the field that bloom and pass.**

16 The wind runs over it, it's gone,
Never more felt there to be drawn.

**17 But YHWH's mercy is from the dawn
Of everlasting and upon**

**Them who fear Him beyond all time,
And His righteousness in the climb
Of children's children, *flesh and rhyme*.**

18 To those who keep His covenant,
Remembering His commandments sent
To act by them in full consent.

**19 YHWH has prepared His throne
above,**

His kingdom rules all push and shove.
20 Bless YHWH, you His angels and those
Of great strength standing in their rows
To do His commandments and hear
The voice of His word on the ear.

**21 Bless YHWH, all you His armies'
train,**

His slaves to do His will not vain.

22 Bless YHWH, all His works in the way
Of His own sovereign display,
Bless YHWH, my soul, *and every day*.

If on the Sabbath day I come to see
Remembering Your name eternally,
Remembering creatorship makes You
The Sovereign of my world and heart and
pew,
You also come upon the Sabbath day.

You come in Your remembrance of the
way
That I am fashioned of but wind and clay.
There's no evil original to pay,
But Your grace is sufficient for the weak
Form in which humankind is made to
speak.
I fail to rise in substance to the great
Image in which I'm made and set in state,
But Your grace is enough to place me
straight
Upon the pedestal of Artist's rate.

Psalm 104

1 Then bless, O my soul, YHWH! O
YHWH
My Alohim, for great are You,
Honour and majesty's Your dress.
2 He puts on light like cloak *no less,*
He spreads the sky like curtains' *press.*
3 He lays His palaces upon
The waters, He makes the clouds drawn
A chariot, He walks upon
The wings of the wind's *scattered spawn.*
4 He makes His angels winds in rife,
His servants flaming fire of life.
5 He lays foundations of the earth
Never to be removed from berth.
6 You covered it with the deep like
A garment, the waters to strike
Stood higher than the mountains' spike.
7 At Your rebuke they fled away,
At Your thunder's sound sped astray.
8 They go up by the mountains' side,
They go down by the valleys' ride
To the place You've made them abide.
9 You've set a bound they may not pass,
Not to cover the earth in mass.

The flame and wind, the waters rife
In all their depths on earth for life
Are merely servants in Your care,
Beloved, who made things everywhere.
Light is no sacred thing to You,
You change it like a cork on screw,
You speak to things without ears true,
And yet they rise up then and do.
I follow the waters that run
Upon the mountainsides that spun
Their paths down to the valleys wide
Until they find a place to hide.

You set all bounds, You see all things,
Establishing both pawns and kings.

10 He sends the springs in valleys rent,
Running among the hills' descent.
11 They give drink to every field's beast,
The wild asses quench thirst *at least.*
12 Beside them the birds of the air
Find nest and habitation where
They sing among their branches *fair.*
13 He waters the hills from His rooms,
The earth is satisfied with blooms
And fruit of Your works *rising there.*
14 For cattle He makes the grass grow,
The herb to serve humans below,
To bring food out of the earth's span,
15 And wine to make glad heart of man,
And oil to make his face to shine,
And bread to give man's heart its twine.

All things eat their own nourishment and
true
From the creating hand and mouth of You.
The fruit comes from the blossom, and the
flower
Comes from the bud and opens in an hour,
And as the waxwing hops about the bower,
You offer berries from the mountain ash,
And if upon a year there's no such stash,
You give the bird an apple on its twig,
To each bird not living in land of fig.
I too hop hopefully beneath Your hand
And look out on the winter-wasted land
And see the storehouse of Your treasures
where
The sky meets lake beneath the mountain's
share,
To find that You have not left table bare.

16 The trees of YHWH are full of sap,
The cedars of Lebanon's wrap,
Which He has planted in their gap.
17 There the birds make their nests, the
stork,
The fir trees shade her house in fork.
18 The high hills protect the wild goats,
The rocks for conies *behind moats.*
19 He made the moon follow its road:
The sun know to go down *in load.*
20 When You make darkness, it is night,
Wherein the forest beasts of fright

Creep *silently and out of sight.*

**21 Young lions roar after their prey,
They seek their food from El *each day.***

There is an argument among the men
Who pretend awareness and faith again
Despite the laxness of the church and state
In their maintaining of calendar's rate.
Some find the month by calculating late,
And other find it by observing when
The sickle hangs in silver above fen.
Some merely look at almanac and think
That decrees in themselves, though on the
brink

Of destitution and destroying's power,
Are safe enough to follow in this hour.
The year hangs on the equinox, I wait
Beneath the covering of child and mate
Until the morning lengthens, though not
late.

22 The sun comes up, they gather in
To lie down in their den *and bin.*

**23 Then man goes out to do his work,
Labours till evening without shirk.**

24 YHWH, how diverse are then Your
works,

In all of them Your wisdom lurks,
The earth is full of Your rich perks.

**25 The great expanse of sea in which
Innumerable creeping things pitch,
Both small and great beasts *without
hitch.***

26 There go the ships, leviathan,
Whom You made to play there in span.

**27 These all wait on You till You give
Them in their time their food to live.**

28 What You give them they gather in,
You open Your hand, *from Your bin*
They are filled with the good *in din.*

Leviathan's so great that I should think
There would not be enough to eat and
drink.

Its scales brush through the waters in the
night

And glitter in the morning come the light.
Leviathan's so far from me and mine
That I should think him legend of the kind
That's told to amuse king and court and
great,

But have no substance in the real of fate.
Beloved, the world of sense and matter
here

Is trussed up with the tents of form and
gear

Until the words of prophecy appear
And splinter sight and thought without a
tear

Where fan the fins and flaps leviathan
Lifts up beneath a moon no man can scan.

29 You hide Your face, they are downcast,
You take their breath, they die at last,
And return to their dust *when past.*

**30 You send out Your breath, they are
made,**

You renew the earth's face *with spade.*

31 The glory of YHWH shall endure
For ever, YHWH'll rejoice for sure
In His works *that He set and stayed.*

**32 He looked on the earth and it shook,
He touched the hills to smoke *in nook.***

33 I'll sing to YHWH so long I live,
I'll praise my Alohim to give
Me *life and being from His book.*

**34 I murmur sweetly at His view,
And so I shall be glad in YHWH.**

35 Let sinners fail from off the earth,
And let the wicked fail from birth.
And so now bless YHWH, O my soul!
And then praise YHWH *from goal to goal!*

The holy Qur'an also makes the point
That You, Beloved, breathe out life in a
joint

And man and beast rise up to sing and play
And work and eat and live again to pray
Until You take that breath again away
And all sink down to death no more to
stray.

Then once again under the morning bright
With resurrection all things come in sight
And live and breathe again for wrong or
right.

Beloved, this moment I am here to sing
And pray beneath the counter of Your wing
Until the darkness cover me and mine
And I am outside the hall where men dine.
All things look to You only for their fling.

Psalms 105

1 Give thanks to YHWH, call on His name,
Show to the folk His deeds of fame.

**2 Sing to Him, sing psalms to Him, talk
Of all His wondrous works and walk.**

3 And glory in His holy name,
Let their heart rejoice *without shame*
Who seek YHWH *without sin or blame*.

**4 Seek YHWH and His strength, seek
His face**

Continually in every place.

5 Remember His great works He's done,
His miracles *beneath the sun*,
The judgements *that His mouth has won*.

**6 Descendants of Israel, His slave,
You children of Jacob in wave,
His chosen ones, the good, the brave.**

7 He's YHWH our Alohim, His ways
Of judgement are to all earth's praise.

**8 Always remember His promise,
The word He commanded for bliss
To a thousand generations.**

9 What He made to the benisons
Of Abraham and His oath to
Isaac *son of Abraham true*.

**10 He has confirmed it for a law
To Jacob, and to Israel's maw
For everlasting covenant.**

11 Saying "To you I shall present
The land of Canaan for your lot
Inherited *in glorious plot*,

**12 When you were only few, a few
And strangers in the land *and pew*."**

13 They went from nation, land to land,
From kingdom to another band,

14 He let no one do any wrong
To them, even the kings *and strong*
He reproved for their sakes *along*.

**15 "Touch not My anointed and do
My prophets no harm *or pursue*."**

King David here repeats the pleasing word
That's written down in Chronicles the first
And chapter sixteen by a faithful bird
That sang the promises counted not worst.
He can say like good Händel at the stroke
His music bears repeating to the folk,
And all the sweetness of his harp and tones
Arises in glory above the thrones
Of every earthly monarch and the seat
Of company president for a treat.

Beloved, You've led me too from land to
land

Where I have fed protected at Your hand,
Saved for the purpose of tweeting Your
praise

Such as it is until my end of days.

16 He called a famine on the land,
He broke all the bread's staff *in hand*.

**17 He sent a man down beforehand,
Joseph, sold in a servants' band,**

**18 Whose feet they crushed with fetters,
he**

Was laid out in iron chains to be

**19 Until the time that His word came,
The word of YHWH tried him *in flame*.**

20 The king commanded him set free,
The ruler of folk by decree.

**21 He made him ruler of his house,
Governor of store, bin *and mouse*,**

**22 To bind his princes at his will,
And teach his senators their fill.**

The brothers were so shamed by what they
did

In selling Joseph for the highest bid,
That they clung to his word and echoed it
From Judah's generations for a fit.
Joseph had brought them consolation by
His saying it was Your plan on the sly
To save them all from hunger and not their
Fault they had sold him for the siller's
share.

Judah it was who came up with the plan
Of making profit on the blood of man.
Beloved, my first responsibility
Is to admit my fault in Your decree,
And as I profit by the way You care
For troubles, still admit my woeful share.

23 Then Israel came into Egypt,
And Jacob lived in Ham's land *fit*.

**24 And He increased His folk no end,
And made them stronger than their
fiend.**

25 He turned their heart to hate His folk,
To deal deceitfully in stroke.

**26 He sent His servant Moses back,
And Aaron chosen *without slack*.**

27 They showed His signs there among
them,

And wonders in the land of Ham.

28 He sent the cloud and made it dark,

They did not rebel at the lark.

29 He turned their waters into blood

And let their fish die *in the mud.*

**30 Their land brought forth frogs in
their lot**

And filled their rulers' chamber-pot.

31 He spoke, and there appeared on land

All sorts of flies and lice in band.

32 He gave them hail for rain and fire

Flaming upon their land in pyre.

33 He struck their vines and their fig trees,
He broke down their trees *in the breeze.*

**34 He spoke and locusts blew in where
Caterpillars swarmed without care.**

35 They ate up all the herbs on land,

Consumed the fruit of their ground
scanned.

**36 He also struck the firstborn down
In all their land, their strength and
crown.**

The Exodus is the tale that is heard
Every time humankind falls on the turd.
There's always hope that You might once
be stirred

Again to act, since one time long ago
You rose up to plague Egypt in the show.
If all that came was caused by volcano,
Then that gives room to doubt even the
blow

Of Your salvation in the tract and glow.
And still I lay my faith in You and know
That hands of all oppressors at last slow.
I wait Your kingdom in my heart and deed
And by my doing, slight though be the
seed,

Let Your will be done in my life decreed,
On days of midnight sun, on days of snow.

37 He brought them out with riches told
To tote wealth in silver and gold,
Not one was feeble in their fold.

**38 Egypt was glad when they went out,
For fear fell on all and redoubt.**

39 He spread a cloud for covering,
And fire to give light in night's wing.

**40 When they begged for them, He
brought quails,**

**And filled them with heavenly bread's
sales.**

41 He opened up the rock from which
Gushed waters that ran down like pitch
In the dry places like a ditch,

**42 Remembering His holy pact
With Abraham in how to act.**

43 He brought out His people with joy,
His chosen with gladness' employ.

**44 He gave to them the heathen's lands,
They got the fruits of the folks' hands,**

**45 So that they could keep His
commands**

And follow His laws kept in view.

**And so now then praise you, praise
YHWH!**

I've never eaten quails or manna yet,
And still I sit beside a table set
With twelve fruits from Your tree, with
bread to get
The cheeses of Your promised land for me.
I never sang with Miriam the song
Of victory that echoed all along
The shores of the Red Sea for right and
wrong,

But I have bowed before Sinai's decree.
Beloved, I eat the fruit of tree the hand
Of others planted on a foreign strand,
I drink the waters of artesian well
Unknown to any man of Israel,
I fill my life with blessings from Your law
Pronounced on Sinai to the people's awe.

Psalms 106

1 Praise YHWH! give YHWH thanks, for
He's good!

For His mercy *endures* forever.

2 Who can speak the great things YHWH
could,

And praise Him because He is clever.

**3 Blessed are those who announce
judgement,**

Always doing right and content.

4 Remember me, YHWH with the grace
That You bear to Your chosen race,
And shower me in saving pace.

**5 Then I may see how good things fall
Upon Your chosen in their stall,
And so rejoice and gladness take
In Your folk, and glory awake**

For Your inheritance's sake.

6 We've sinned just like our fathers too,
Done wickedness before Your view,
Committed outrages not few.

**7 Our ancestors did not perceive
With understanding by Your leave
What miracles You did before
All of the Egyptians on shore.
They did not mind the multitude
Of Your mercies, but were so crude
To provoke there beside the sea,
The Red Sea *gleaming fitfully*.**

8 He saved them still for His name's sake,
To show His mighty power in wake.

**9 He rebuked the Red Sea also,
It was dried up, He was not slow
To lead them through the deep and so
Into the wilderness to go.**

10 He saved them from the enemy,
Redeemed them from the foe's hand free.

**11 The waters covered up their foes,
There was not one left in their rows.**

12 Then they believed at last His words,
They sang His praises *like the birds*.

When I consider how oft I reveal
Impatience here beneath the treading heel
Of everyday, and spout a word's complaint,
I think that I too am no driven saint.
If some asked with a tongue in humour
dipped

If there were not enough graves when they
shipped

Out of Egypt, that they must find the soil
Of wilderness the place of rest from toil,
I'm not about to judge them for the spoil.
Between the Sea of Reeds and Pharaoh's
bait

I think I too might have come to relate
A bit of fear, perhaps not whimsical,
In fact more likely the hysterical.
Let me rise to those old complainers' fate.

13 They soon forgot His works, did not
Wait for His counsel *loving taught*,

**14 But in the wilderness greatly
Lusted to eat their meat freely,
And in the desert tested Him,
Alohim *with complaints sour and grim*.**

15 He gave them their request, but sent
Leanness into their soul *and spent*.

**16 They envied Moses in the camp,
And Aaron saint of YHWH *and lamp*,**

17 The earth opened and swallowed there
Dathan, and covered, *soil and air*,
Faction of Abiram *with care*.

**18 In their midst there was kindled fire
The flames consumed wicked *desire*.**

19 They made a calf in Horeb, and
Worshipped the moulded image grand.

**20 Thus they changed their glory into
The ox's image that eats dew**

**Upon the grass. 21 And they forgot
Alohim their Saviour, who taught
Great things in Egypt, 22 wondrous**

works

**In the land of Ham, awesome dirks
By the Red Sea. 23 Therefore He said
That He would destroy them instead,
Had not Moses His chosen one
Stood up before Him in the *sun*
To bear the breach, to turn away
His wrath, lest He destroy *that day*.**

24 So they despised Muhammad's land,
And they believed not his command.

**25 They sat complaining in their tents,
Heard not YHWH's voice for
arguments.**

The golden calf was looking back to that
Monolatry of Egypt where they'd sat
At feet of priest and king. The wilderness
Was too bucolic for such well-read slaves.
A scientific, golden worship raves
In town and ear with civilized finesse.
So even then, before the prophet's birth,
They questioned him because of land and
worth.

Belovèd, they did not believe his word,
Although their hot souls burning in them
stirred

To hear the Unity, its recitation.

A dearer thing it was to be a nation.
Destroy me too, Belovèd, wherein I am
Besides You, I'm a sacrificial lamb.

If erets Hemda does not mean the land
Of Muhammad, despite the name at hand,
Then Isaiah cannot mean Jesus Christ
When he spoke to Ahaz, for whom sufficed
The word without the sign. In fact his fate
Was to live to see the sign come not late.

If Isaiah gave sign to king and then
 Prophesied of Messiah among men,
 Then David does a better job when he
 Mentions the very name in clarity.
 Both passages relate to days of old
 Before both Christ and Arab prophet bold,
 But You, Beloved, not silent, came and told
 Us messengers should come to set us free.

26 That's why He lifted up His hand
 Against them in the desert land,
27 To overthrow their descendants
Among the nations and to prance
In all lands scattered at a glance.
 28 They joined themselves to Baalpeor,
 Ate offerings of the dead *in score*.
29 So they provoked to wrath with their
Inventions, and the plague to bear
Came on them for their evil share.
 30 Then stood up Phinehas to make
 Judgement, so the plague stayed at stake.
31 That was accounted to him for
A righteous deed for evermore.
 32 They brought wrath at waters of strife,
 So even Moses lost his life.
33 That's because they provoked his
mind
So he spoke carelessly consigned.
 34 They did not slay the nations round
 Whom YHWH commanded them to
 ground.

The failure to kill others is complaint
 You often make against Your chosen saint.
 And yet in the commandments that You
 spoke
 On Sinai You said don't kill other folk.
 Some say the word means murder, but I say
 That murder means another law in sway
 Should define what killing is justified
 And what is not where You, Beloved,
 abide.
 But what law is there above that You shed
 Upon the ears and hearts that once were
 spread
 Out beneath Sinai's peaks standing in
 dread?
 Beloved, I trust that those You sent to be
 Your representatives knew and were free
 To kill those they met in the riot's spree.

35 Instead they mingled with the folk
 And learned their heathen ways and yoke.
36 They served their idols, empty, vain,
That were a snare to them and stain.
 37 Indeed they sacrificed their sons
 And daughters to devils by tons,
 38 They shed innocent blood, the blood
 Of sons and daughters in a flood,
 Whom they offered to Canaan's gods
 Polluting with blood the land's sods.
39 They were defiled by their own acts,
And prostituting their own pacts.
 40 That's why the wrath of YHWH flamed
 out
 Against His people in redoubt,
 Disgusted by His own in rout.
41 He gave them up into the hand
Of heathen, and the hated band
Ruled over them and all their land.
 42 Their enemies oppressed them too,
 And made them servants in their crew.
43 Many times He delivered them,
But they provoked by stratagem,
And for their sins brought down to hem.
 44 He took note of their trouble when
 He heard their cry *before all men*.
45 He remembered His promise made,
And changed His mind for the parade
Of the great mercies where He stayed.
 46 He made those who took them in chains
 To pity them *for all their pains*.
47 Save us, YHWH our Alohim, and
Gather us from the heathen land
To give thanks to Your holy name,
And triumph in Your praise and fame.
 48 Blessed be YHWH Israel's Alohim
 From everlasting to *the dream*
Of everlasting, and let all
 The people say *in pew and stall*
 "Amen. Praise you YHWH *Lord of all*."

The Sabbath Psalms are ended and the tale
 Of all the Torah seems to be on sale
 Within the sparkling words I sing and wail.
 The Sabbath Psalms are ended, I make
 peace
 Within my soul and pray for the increase
 Of Your will done on earth and without
 cease.
 The Sabbath Psalms are ended and I stay
 In silence to enjoy the bit of day

That still remains of rest in Your own way.
Beloved, the Sabbath Psalms re-echo in
My heart and keep my hand away from sin
As I look toward the week before my feet
And wonder whether it will be a treat
Or doom to anyone that I may meet.

Beloved, I come upon the Sabbath day
In dhikr or remembrance of Your way,
In sema' or in hearing of Your word,
And every time I come my heart is stirred.
When I begin with ninety-second Psalm
Where Sabbath's mentioned, I rely in calm
Upon the repetition of Your name,
The holy YHWH, resident in the flame
Of Psalms up to the one of Ahmed's fame,
And as I count the repetitions here,
I find the ninety-nine of love and fear.
Beloved I whirl in Sabbath ecstasy,
And find Your name entwined forever free
With that of Muhammad eternally.

Psalms Book Five Psalm 107

1 Give thanks to YHWH for He is good,
For His mercy endures for ever.
2 Let YHWH's redeemed speak as they
should,
Who from the foe's hand those will sever.
**3 He gathered them out of the lands
From east and west, from north and
bands
Of the south. 4 They wandered the sands
Of wilderness in vacant way,
They found no city where to stay.**
5 Hungry and thirsty, they were faint.
6 They cried to YHWH in their complaint,
He saved them from distresses' *paint*.
**7 He led them out by the right way
To find a city where to stay.**

The scattering and gathering of Your own
Is something I wonder about alone.
The northern kingdom scattered in the pale
Of the Assyrian empire, no avail.
The southern kingdom led to Babylon
Came back to build the city that was gone
And scattered once more before Roman
drawn.

The people came back with a vengeance on
The Palestinian folk and waged new war
And put the olive trees to death in store.

Beloved, I wait the gathering of those
Who keep Your law alone and step on toes
Of merchants and of princes in their rows.
I've waited forty years and I'll wait more.

8 O that men would praise YHWH for
good

And for His great acts as men should!

**9 He satisfies the longing soul,
He fills with good the hungry's bowl.**

10 Those sitting in the dark death's shade,
Bound in affliction, iron weighed,

11 Having rebelled against El's word,
Disdaining Elyon's counsel heard,

12 So He brought down their heart with
pain,

They fell with no one to sustain.

**13 They cried to YHWH in their distress,
He saved them from troubles' address.**

14 He brought them from the dark death's
shade,

And broke their chains *that were displayed*.

You satisfy my soul, Beloved, it's true,
And yet I find distress in my home pew.
If there is not a taste of suffering yet
In the crocks and the crannies I have met,
I find it in my heart to be distressed
By what the others suffered and unguessed.
Though You save me from troubles, I still
find

Enough to sadden and to worry mind,
And shed a tear beneath the joyous sun
Before the pleasures of my day are done.
Beloved, in all creation there are none
So foolish as the human psyche spun
That finds complaint in every stile and turn
No matter what's to get and what's to learn.

15 O that men would praise YHWH for
good

And for His great acts as men should!

**16 He's broken down the gates of brass,
And cut the iron bars like grass.**

17 Fools for their transgressions and for
Their iniquities hit the floor.

**18 Their soul abhors all kinds of food,
They come near death's gates in their
brood.**

19 They cry to YHWH in their distress,
He saves them from troubles' *address*.

**20 He sent His word and healed them
too,
And saved them from destructions' view.**

Beloved, I have at my age certain aches
And stains that could be healed for
goodness' sakes.
And after Your word strengthens blood and
heart,
I know some others who could use Your
part.

I let fools bide in their transgressions' art,
And leave You Yourself to destroying cart
To break down walls of iron and gates of
brass.

I only ask You now, before You pass
To heal me and to heal mine on the way
To saving people from distress in sway.
Beloved, I come at morning of the day
And find the woods are barren of the gay
Leaves that last week turned glimmering
and bright.

I pray for healing before comes the night.

21 O that men would praise YHWH for
good

And for His great acts as men should!

**22 Let them offer offerings of thanks,
Rejoicing declare His works' banks.**

23 They go down to the sea in ships,

They do affairs in ocean slips,

24 They see the wonders of YHWH creep,
His miracles within the deep.

25 He raises up the stormy wind

**By His command, feathered and finned
Are lifted by the waves unbinned.**

26 They rush up toward the sky, they go
Down once more in the trough and low,
Their soul's melted at trouble's show.

**27 They reel and stagger like a drunk,
At their wits' end, scared they've been
sunk.**

28 They cry to YHWH in trouble's wake,
He brings them from distress's take.

**29 He makes the storm a calm until
Its waves themselves have become still.**

30 Then they're glad of the calm repose
Until the hoped for haven rose.

I've seen the ocean lie like pearl and wind
Itself beneath the sky unfurled, untined.

I've seen the grey and wave rise up behind
The cliffs that shadow land and out of
mind,
And hear the plummet roar of deep
resigned.

I've heard the sighing of the little waves
That plough the shells before sanderling
graves.

I've smelled the driftwood fire cypress
outlined.

Beloved, in memory I seek the light
Of ocean breathing immensely and bright,
While on the lapping lakeshore I count
where

The rings of high water marked out its
share

Below the tundra and the beating there.

Beloved, in silence I hear earth laid bare.

31 O that men would praise YHWH for
good

And for His great acts as men should!

**32 Let them exalt Him also in
The people's congregation's din,
And praise Him in the elders' bin.**

33 He turns streams into wilderness,

The watersprings to dry address,

**34 A fruitful land to barrenness,
Because of its folk's wickedness.**

35 He turns the wilderness to pools

Of water, and there dry ground cools

In watersprings *beneath His tools.*

**36 And there He makes the hungry
dwell,**

And build a city for their cell.

37 They sow the fields and come to plant

Their vineyards, and receive the grant

Of its fruit's increase *on the slant.*

**38 He blesses them also, so they
Are multiplied in a great way,
Their cattle also comes to stay.**

39 Again they're brought down on the earth
Through oppression, affliction, dearth.

**40 He pours contempt on prince and
king**

**And causes them to flee and sing
In desert places *without sting.***

41 But the poor He shall set on high

Above affliction high and dry

In families like flocks in sty.

42 The righteous shall see and rejoice,

And wicked ones shall find no voice.

43 The wise one will observe these things
And understand the wanderings
That YHWH in lovingkindness brings.

Beloved, I must be of the righteous crowd
Since I keep finding voice to speak aloud
My jingles and my rhymings by the proud.
The wicked ones find no voice in the way
Of Your Word striking fear against the bay,
In Hebrew scratchings like that left by
crow.

I have enough rejoicing for a shroud
Well woven in the sound of dirges low.
Beloved, the wise observe the tide and flow
And in their sightings they have come to
know

That after rain there comes the shine and
bright

Of heat and health before the failing night.
Your lovingkindness stands in likely pools
Unnoticed by both kings and royal fools.

Psalm 108

1 A Song. A Psalm of David.
O Alohim, my heart's steadfast,
I'll sing and give praise, *and at last*
Even with my glory. 2 Awake,
Both lute and harp! And then I'll shake
The dawn. 3 I will praise You, O YHWH,
Among the peoples, sing praise to
You among the nations. 4 For Your
Mercy *is great and what is more*
Above the heavens, and Your truth
Reaches up to the clouds, *forsooth*.

**5 Be exalted, O Alohim,
Above the heavens, and let beam
Your glory above all the earth,
6 That Your beloved ones may of worth
Be all delivered, save with Your
Right hand, and hear me ever more.**

7 Aholim has spoken in His
Holiness: "I'll rejoice, *that is*,
I will divide Shechem and measure
The Valley of Succoth *for treasure*."

**8 Gilead's Mine, Manasseh's Mine,
Ephraim also's the helmet *fine*
For My head, Judah's My lawgiver.**

**9 Moab's My washpot, on the river
Of Edom I will cast My shoe,
I'll triumph on Philistia too."**

10 Who will bring me *into* the strong
City? Who will lead me *along*
To Edom? 11 *Is it not You, O*
Alohim, *who's* cast us off so?
And *You, O Alohim, who* did
Not go out with our armies' *quid?*

**12 Give us help from trouble, for help
Of man is useless as a skelp.**

13 Through Alohim we valiantly
Shall do, for *indeed it is* He
Who shall tread down our enemy.

If David's heart is set to sing again
Psalm sixty so that every ear of men
May hear the twelves march through the
valleys clear,

I've no complaints in application here.

If Your heart is set on the happy tune,
Or on the sadness of Edom in doom

Or Moab for Your washpot by the sand
Of silver, I do not lift up my hand.

Beloved, the golden bells of Psalm ring
true

In everything that You come here to do,
To raise the weak and righteous in Your
view,

Or put down those who rebel at Your law
And pass their days on earth in bloody
claw,

While I come to Your throne, Beloved, in
awe.

Psalm 109

1 To the chief musician, a Psalm
Of David. Do not remain calm,
O Alohim of my praise drawn.

**2 For the mouth of the wicked pawn
And the mouth of deceitful men
Are opened against me again,
They've spoken against me with lies.**

3 They've surrounded me in the guise
Of hateful words, and they have fought
Me without cause in what I've wrought.

**4 For my love they've become by foes,
But I stay in the prayer I chose.**

5 They've given me evil for good,
And hatred for my love as could.

How many lies have been told about me!
I find them everywhere I turn to see!

I should not be surprised with such a state,

Since so few look to Your law soon and late.

The love of lying surrounds every place
Upon the earth, and there is hardly trace
Of truth in mouth of humankind, I swear,
Beloved, deceit and lies are everywhere.
The church is filled with filth, I hear the din,

Attack on righteousness, support of sin,
And yet, Beloved, the few who call Your name

Their rock of refuge, despite all the shame,
Remember You alone and do the right.
I seek out such to know both day and night.

6 Set a wicked man against him,
Let an accuser make him dim.

**7 Let him be judged and so condemned,
Let his prayer become sin and hemmed.**

8 Let his days be few and let take
Another his office and stake.

**9 Let his children be fatherless,
His wife decked out in widow's dress.**

10 Let his children be vagabonds
And beg for bread by empty ponds.

**11 Let the extortioner take all,
And strangers spoil his laboured hall.**

12 Let none have mercy at his call,
None take his orphans into stall.

**13 His posterity be cut off,
Let those after forget to scoff.**

14 Let his ancestors' wickedness
Be remembered at YHWH's address,
And let not his mother's sin be
Blotted out *for eternity*.

**15 Let them be before YHWH for aye,
So He'll cut off their memory's cry
From the earth and under the sky.**

16 Because he did not mind to show
Mercy, but persecuted poor
And needy so he might destroy
The broken-hearted *without joy*.

**17 As he loved cursing, so let it
Come upon him as it is fit,
As he delighted not to bless,
So let it be far from him less.**

18 He put on cursing like a coat,
So let it come like water's moat
Into his bowels, like oil into
His very bones and *spoil them too*.

19 Let it be his cloak covering,

His belt tied on him like a string.

20 Let this be my foes' fate from YHWH,
Of those who speak bad of me too.

The sweet Christian leaves out this torrid
prayer

Because he wants to appear kind and fair,
And yet cathartic speech in closet made
Could have prevented him in his parade
From sticking knife in back of those
waylaid.

The sweet Christian prefers the perfumed
hymn

To Psalm, and wakes the drum and guitar's
vim

In wild gyrations of the slick and slim,
But never prays for enemy and lost
According to the words that You embossed.
Beloved, I pray from day to day that You
Might curse my enemies in power and pew,
And leave them on the vacant sand to waste
Away in mud and blood and wicked paste.

21 But You YHWH Lord, do this for me,
For Your name's sake and Your mercy,
In Your goodness deliver me.

**22 For I am poor and needy, and
My heart is broken in my hand.**

23 I pass like a shadow when done,
Tossed like a locust in the sun.

**24 My knees are weak through fasting
long,**

My flesh fails of fatness and strong.

25 For them I'm an object of hate,
They look at me, shake heads *to rate*.

**26 Help me, YHWH my Alohim, save
Me by Your mercy from the grave.**

Beloved, bless me and mine, who take
Your law

In hope and act and leave the bloody claw.
Remember me for fasting and for good
Despite the waywardness in what I should.
For I repent of every evil thing,
I grieve for every sorrow that I bring
Upon another, though I feel the sting
Of every man's hate who hates Your law
too.

Beloved, I find the wilderness in view
As I flee from the sale and buying that

Oppress the poor and crush them on the mat.
Beloved, I find the street filled with the throng
That comes to art, accomplishment and wrong,
And quietly among them sing Your song.

27 Then they may know what's in Your hand,
What You, YHWH have done *in the land*.

**28 Let them curse on, but You bless me,
When they rise up, let shame go free,
But let Your servant joy to see.**

29 Let my foes be covered in shame,
Confusion like a mantle's *game*.

**30 I'll greatly praise YHWH with my mouth,
Praise Him with crowds from north and south.**

31 For He'll stand at the poor's right hand
To save him from the judges' stand.

David the king admits the thing is true
That the poor man before the judge and crew

Of courts of law stands to fail before those
Who scheme injustice and step on his toes.
David the king knows well how many come

With wealth and power to pretty up the sum

Against the poor to steal the poor man's fare

And take away his bread and rightful share.
That's why, Beloved, David the king repeats

That You Yourself will step in from the streets

And save the poor from judges and their heats.

Beloved, I wait to see when David's call
Is answered on the earth below the pall
Of civilized in trade and county hall.

Psalm 110

1 A Psalm of David.

YHWH said to my Lord, "Sit at My Right hand, and sit there until I Make your enemies your footstool."

2 And YHWH shall send the rod of rule

In your strength out of Zion. Rule
In the midst of your enemy!

**3 Your people shall come willingly
In the day of your power, and in
The beauties of holiness, from
The womb of the morning to win,
You have the dew of your youth's sum.**

4 YHWH has sworn and will not relent,
"You *are* a priest forever sent
According to the order of
Melchizedek *for gain or love*."

**5 The Lord is at your right hand, he
Shall thrust through kings the day that he**

Comes in His wrath. 6 He'll judge among

**The nations, He shall fill the rung
With the dead bodies, He shall slay
The heads of many lands in dread.**

7 He'll drink of the brook by the way,
Therefore He shall lift up the head.

The order of Melchizedek bears sway
Even above the order of the day
When Aaron came with censor and the sway

Of smoke and offering for all sins to pay.

The order of Melchizedek I see
In Salem sweet where Abraham was free
With booty of his warfare on the quay.

The order of Melchizedek's my way.
Beloved, the hand that wrote to Hebrews made

The order of Melchizedek parade
Of Jesus Christ, but that's easy to say.
The truth is hidden in the larger bay.

The secret priesthood of Your hidden room
Is where I flee, Beloved, from every doom.

Psalm 111

1 Praise YHWH! and I will praise YHWH
with my whole heart,

In upright assembly and congregation.

2 The works of YHWH *are* great, and all
find a part

In their perusal who find pleasure when
done.

**3 His work is honourable and glorious,
And so forever endures His
righteousness.**

4 He has made His wonderful works
remembered,
YHWH's gracious, full of compassion *in a word.*

**5 He has given their food to those who
fear Him,**

He will ever be mindful of His pact grim.

6 He's declared to His folk the power of
His works,
Giving them heritage where each nation
lurks.

**7 The works of His hands, verity and
justice,
Are all sure as His precepts *coming to this.***

8 They stand fast *and firm* forever and ever,
And are done in truth and uprightness *to sir.*

**9 He's sent *in truth* redemption to His
people,
He's commanded His covenant eternal:
Holy and awesome's His name. 10 The
fear of YHWH**

***Is the beginning of wisdom, and a true
Understanding have all those who His
words do.***

His praise endures forever, *righteous and true.*

Beloved, I may come on the grey-packed
day,
The autumn colours turned sombre from
gay,
And praise You with my whole heart, who
can say.
I search the polished corners of the room
Within my inner chamber for the bloom
Of praise and wonder if the whole heart
sounds,
Or if lip-service only meets the rounds.
Beloved, I sweep the granite floor to find
Anything that would keep me heart and
mind
From praising You, and then return with
gift
Of self alone, and with my face uplift
Praise to You once with whole heart as I
light
The lamps within my chamber for Your
sight,
Exposing every corner from the night.

Psalm 112

1 Praise YHWH! Blessed is the man who
fears

YHWH, delighting when His law appears.

**2 His descendants on earth shall be
Mighty, the generation free
Of the upright shall blessed be.**

3 Riches and gear shall fill his room,
His righteousness endure till doom.

**4 To the upright there comes a light
In darkness: He is gracious, right
Full of compassion, righteous too.**

5 A good man's merciful and lends,
Discretion marks his affairs' ends.

**6 Surely he shall never be moved,
Remembrance shall always be proved
Upon the righteous *and his friends.***

7 He'll not take fear of evil news,
His heart is firm, his trust is YHWH's.

**8 His heart is set, he shall not fear
Till he sees his desire appear
Upon his enemies *in tear.***

9 He's generous to help the poor,
His righteousness always endure,
His horn raised up in honour sure.

**10 The wicked see it and are grieved,
He'll gnash his teeth and unreprieved
He'll disappear, the great desire
Of wicked ones shall burn in fire.**

Beloved, the promise of destruction met
Upon my enemies makes me upset.
In fact I do not wish to see the pyre
Where my foes are extinguished in the fire.
I'd rather that the evil in each heart
Might be struck down, and idols all depart.
I'd rather that the work of wicked hand
Might be extirpated out of the land.
Beloved, I throw the idol down in me
And lend my heart to Your law to be free
Of lust of flesh, of lust for power, and lust
Of false faith that makes fool's gold of the
dust.

Beloved, I gnash my teeth upon the fold
Of tin and pray that it will turn to gold.

Psalm 113

1 Praise YHWH! Oh praise, YHWH's
servants here,

Praise YHWH's name, 2 and then blessed
appear

The name of YHWH from this day on
To all the bourns of time when drawn.

3 From sunrise to its going down
YHWH's name is praised *around the*
town.

4 YHWH's high above all nations round,
His glory's above the sky's bound.

5 Who is like YHWH our Alohim,
Who dwells above all things that seem?

6 Who bends down to see all things in
Both heaven and the earthly bin.

7 He raises the poor from the dust,
Lifts up the needy from the rust,
8 That he may set him with the great,
Even the folk's princes in state.

9 He builds the barren women homes
To be mothers of sons, *not gnomes.*
So praise YHWH *in every estate.*

Beloved, if I praise You from rising sun
Throughout the day until the day is done,
What of the night? What of the blessed
night?

Let me praise You when I put out the light.
No doubt this Psalm is meant for a feast
where

The services of praise continue there
Throughout the day, or it may be a day
Of fasting instead of feasting in way.
Few come to praise with feast or fast these
days,

Because there are so few You want to
praise,
And because no one now knows when
Your feast

Is on the calendar to say the least.
Beloved, let my praise every day appear
In fast or feasting, safety or in fear.

Psalm 114

1 When Israel went out of Egypt,
The house of Jacob from *the crypt*
Of a people of a strange tongue,
2 Judah became His sanctuary,
And Israel His dominion.

3 The sea saw and fled *from the rung,*
The Jordan was held back *and chary.*

4 The mountains skipped like rams *undone,*
The little hills like lambs *and merry.*

5 What's wrong with you, O sea, that
you

Flee, and you, Jordan, driven *in dew?*

6 You mountains, that you skipped like
rams,

And little hills, that jumped like lambs?

7 Before the Lord tremble, O earth,
Before Allah of Jacob's worth.

8 He turned the rock to standing water,
Into a fountain of *fresh* water.

I know when the sea fled, I know indeed
When Jordan river fell back on its steed,
I know when the rock turned to water-
spout.

But what is skipping of the hills about?
Perhaps that's telling of the day when You
Came down on Mount Tur almost in the
view

Of humankind and, as the mountain shook,
You told the people there to hear and look.
Beloved, I rise among the bowing crowd
To hear the ten commandments spoke
aloud,

And give my will to You that I may live
Within the blessings that Your statutes
give.

Beloved, I see by faith the hills that jump,
And listen in the vision to the bump.

Psalm 115

1 Not to us, YHWH, not to us, but
To Your name give glory *in rut,*
For Your mercy and Your truth's *cut.*

2 Why should the heathen say "Where's
now

Alohim of theirs anyhow?"

3 But our Alohim's in the skies,
He's done the things that He thinks wise.

4 Their idols are silver and gold,
The work of human hands *and bold.*

5 They have mouths, but they do not speak,
They have eyes, but they do not peek.

6 They have ears, but hear not a sound,
Noses they have, but smell no round.

7 They have hand, but they do not touch,
And feet they have, nor walk as much,
Nor does sound come from their throat's
bound.

8 Those who make them are likewise
made,

So are all whose trust in them stayed.

The Allah of the holy Qur'an has
A hand and a foot and all of such jazz,
But who knows if He hears a word I say,
An idol in the great transgressor's way.
Beloved, I have not seen Your hand or foot,
Nor have You any house or place to put
Your head when slumber comes to dress
you down.

You are no idol at all on the town.
Yet You are the Allah of the Qur'an,
The Aloah of Job and Psalms' out drawn,
The hope of every man and woman known
Who may not have a name for the
ungrown.

Without ear hear my call and praise to You,
Without tongue mind me of the things I do.

9 O Israel, trust now in YHWH:
He is their help and shield *in clue*.

**10 O house of Aaron, trust in YHWH:
He's their help and shield from the blue.**

11 O you who fear YHWH, trust in
YHWH:

He's their help and their shield *in crew*.

**12 YHWH has been mindful of us: He
Will bless, he'll bless Israel's place *free*,
He'll bless the house of Aaron's *tree*.**

13 He will bless those in fear of YHWH,
The small and great, *middle-sized too*.

**14 YHWH shall multiply you the more
You have children to keep in-door.**

15 You're blessed of YHWH Creator of
Both heaven and earth *all made in love*.

**16 The heavens, the heavens belong to
YHWH,**

But earth He's given to human crew.

17 The dead do not come to praise YHWH,
Those gone into silence, none do.

**18 But we will bless YHWH from this
day,**

Now and for evermore, always.

**Praise YHWH, always ever praise
YHWH.**

It was a foul thing that David once said,
That earth is for humans both born and
bred.

The sky itself is not for You alone.

The birds have the right to approach Your
throne.

And so earth is not man'd to tread in vain.
It's also lent to those who know the pain
Of being mere beasts, mammals on the
wane.

It was a foul thing David said instead.
Beloved, I do not treat David with guile,
I always look on David with a smile.
I don't believe he meant it as men now
Who take the earth as property somehow
Of humankind alone. Hypocrisy
Is shown that not all human's own the lea.

Psalm 116

1 I love YHWH because He has heard
My voice and supplications' *word*.

**2 Because He's lent His ear to me,
I'll call on Him eternally.**

3 The sorrows of death compassed me,
The pains of hell got hold on me,
I found trouble and sorrow be.

**4 Then I called on the name of YHWH,
I prayed YHWH save me, my soul too.**

5 Gracious is YHWH and righteous too,
Our Alohim's merciful, true.

**6 YHWH saves the simple: I was
brought**

Low and He helped me when I sought.

7 Return to your rest, O my soul;
For YHWH's dealt well with you in bowl.

**8 For You've delivered me from death,
My eyes from tears, and at a breath
My feet from falling at the toll.**

If I love You, Beloved, only because
You've heard my praying voice clamour in
clause,

I think the basis of my love to be
Deficient in this land's society.

I raise my service of remembrance here,
Reciting the Bible and Qur'an dear,
And it is good, Belovèd, if You hear,
And it is good, my Love, if You do not.

I raise remembrance in the silent lot,
And look for no reward but what I've got.

I beg no heaven of You, no paradise,
Although to escape hell could be quite nice.

What You have given already in the bowl
Of upright and of sinful's beyond goal.

9 I'll walk by YHWH in living land.
10 I have believed and therefore planned
My speech: I was in great distress.
11 I said in haste, "All men are liars."

**12 How shall I repay all the fires
Of YHWH's benefits I express?**

13 I'll take salvation's cup in view
And call upon the name of YHWH.

**14 I shall pay my vows unto YHWH
Before all His people in view.**

15 Precious in the sight of YHWH is
The death of His holy ones' *biz*.

**16 O YHWH, truly I'm Your servant,
I'm Your slave and son of a wench
In Your employ and on the slant,
But You freed me from slavery's bench.**

17 I'll offer You the sacrifice
Of gratitude, *if it suffice*,

And call upon the name of YHWH.

**18 I will pay my vows unto YHWH,
Now in presence of all His folk,**

**19 In the courts of YHWH's house in
stroke,**

In Jerusalem's central view.

**Praise YHWH, praise YHWH, praise
YHWH, praise YHWH.**

It seems the sacrifice of praise is still
Enough to fit salvation and its bill.
The offering of gratitude precedes
The calling on Your name like
tumbleweeds.

Wherever the wind drives me on the earth,
Through cities and through deserts in their
dearth,

Through forests and through tundras in the
scale

Of expanse like eternities prevail,
I offer You no heathen sacrifice,
No human crucifixion, that's not nice,
But only offerings of thanks on the way
To calling on Your name and without pay.
I've done it in Jerusalem, I fear,
I do it in the wilderness I steer.

Psalm 117

1 Praise YHWH, you Gentiles! Laud Him,
all

You peoples! 2 For His kindness' call
In mercy is immense towards us,
And YHWH's truth, the incredulous,

Endures forever. Praise YHWH, all!

This is the greatest of the Psalms, I swear,
Though only two small verses are found
there!

The chosen race was chosen, I've no doubt,
That Your words spoken should be written
out.

But choosing one race has resulted in
The pinnacle of treachery and sin,
The racist attitude that feeds the way
Of pogrom and of monetary sway.

Beloved, I praise You now, I praise indeed,
Because this Psalm is taught to every seed,
And Gentiles share the call to praise Your
name

And come before Your throne and without
shame

Enter the truth that shall always endure
Among the chosen races and the pure.

Psalm 118

1 Oh give thanks to YHWH, He is good:
His mercy lasts longer than could.

**2 Let Israel now say His mercy
Lasts always to eternity.**

3 Let Aaron's house now say *the same*:
His mercy's eternal *in fame*.

**4 Let those who fear YHWH say again,
His mercy's for ever on men.**

5 I called upon YHWH in distress,
YHWH then replied to my address,
Set me on a firm place, no less.

**6 YHWH's on my side, I will not fear,
What harm can man do but appear?**

7 YHWH takes my part with those who aid,
I'll see vengeance on my foes paid.

**8 It is better to trust in YHWH
Than put confidence in man's crew.**

9 It is better to trust in YHWH
Than depend on princes *in view*.

There are three groups of men who serve
the Lord

According to this Psalm of David scored.
There's Israel that's mentioned first of all,
And House of Aaron, all men on the ball,
And last but not least is the greater throng
Of Gentiles who fear You and hate the
wrong.

Beloved, how sweet to know that all such
men

And women are a-judged by You again
As welcome in the kingdom of the just
That shall remain forever above dust.
Beloved, I see the vengeance on my foes
Repaid a thousand times against the rows
Of trouble they cause coming to oppose.
The princes and their servants are all those.

10 All nations compassed me about,
In name of YHWH I set in rout.

**11 They gathered around me indeed,
In YHWH's name I'll destroy their seed.**

12 They circled me around like bees,
Succumbing like fire in thorn trees,
In YHWH's name I strike down *their
knees.*

**13 You attacked me hoping I'd fall,
But YHWH came to my aid and call.**

14 YHWH's my strength and song and
begun

To become my *great* salvation.

15 The voice of joy and salvation

**Is in the tents of righteous won,
YHWH's right hand's courageous when
done.**

16 YHWH's right hand is exalted high,
YHWH's right hand does valiantly by.

**17 I shall not die, but live and praise
The works of YHWH throughout my
days.**

18 YHWH has plagued me with
punishment,
But into death He has not sent.

Those are bold words to speak, and who
knows best

If they were not written upon the vest
Of the Psalter to wait the time when came
Wycliffe to pronounce them and without
shame.

"I shall not die, but live" it is well said,
But every man at last is put to bed.
I should not be so bold as to be led
To say such things, although it may come
true

That You will send Messiah and the great
Guided One to establish a new state
In everlasting where all those who go
In there shall never die, but grow old slow.

Beloved, let that come quickly on the shore
Where I recite the words of life and more.

19 Open me gates of righteousness,
I'll go through them and so I'll bless
YHWH *and His honoured name confess.*

**20 This gate of YHWH upright go in
And find themselves there without sin.**

21 I will praise You, for You have heard
And become my salvation stirred.

**22 The stone the builders had rejected
Becomes the cornerstone confected.**

23 This is YHWH's doing, marvellous
Before the eyes of all of us.

**24 This is the day that YHWH has made,
We will rejoice in glad parade.**

25 Save now, I pray, O YHWH, O YHWH,

26 Blessed he who comes in name of
YHWH,

We've blessed you from the house of
YHWH.

**27 El is YHWH, who has shown us light,
Bind the sacrifice with cords tight,
To the horns of the altar right.**

28 You are my El, I will praise You,
My Alohim, exalted too.

**29 Oh give thanks to YHWH, He is good:
His mercy lasts longer than could.**

The figure of the stone rejected here
Has become subject of all kinds of gear.
If it is true apostle wrote the book
Where it's applied to Jesus for a look,
Then that's one glimpse of trying in the
nook.

Every stone that's rejected in this world
Thinks that this verse of David has been
twirled

In prophecy of how his work at last
Will be accepted after sinful blast.

Beloved, my scribbles here, though for
Your fame,

Are not set in stone nor in parchment's
game,

But only on the flash of satellite
That catches them a moment before night.
I'm content to be another outcast.

Psalm 119

The only classic text that claims to be
Spoken by You direct and publicly

To show what's right and wrong to tongue
and hands

Is the one writ in Sinai's ten commands.
The other option's to do what I think
Is right because I was born on the brink
Of some establishment, or then pretend
I've got the right to force my vision's link
On all the world, because I'm free to spend.
I set aside both neighbour's view and mine
And find freedom and justice in Your line.
Of course the law of jungle is another
Good way to devour both sister and
brother.

Ten fingers and ten toes serve me just fine.

1 ALEPH. Blessed the undefiled in the
way,
Who walk in the law of YHWH's way!
**2 Blessed who keep His testimonies,
Who seek Him with the whole heart's
ease.**

3 They too do no iniquity,
They walk in His ways *faithfully*.

**4 You have commanded us to keep
Diligently Your precepts deep.**

5 Oh, that my ways were directed
To keep Your statutes corrected.

**6 Then I would not be ashamed, as
I see what Your commandment has.**

7 I will praise You with upright heart,
When I have learned Your righteous part.

**8 I will keep Your statutes. Oh, do
Not forsake me in my virtue!**

The blessing, Beloved, that You call down
on

However many people that are drawn
Out pure and sure to follow in Your way
Until the evil age fails from the sway
Seems lovely to be heard. And yet I feel
How many would turn the ship on its keel.
Among the hearers of Your word I find
Lots of reformers, most of whom are blind
To say Your law's not here to keep at all.
Help them to fail at last and come to fall.
At Sinai the sounds still reverberate,
Vainly the stout and proud exacerbate
Eleven or twelve good reasons why they
can't

Notice Your law, instead they have to
vaunt.

9 BETH. How can a young man cleanse his
way?

By taking heed to what You say.

**10 With my whole heart I have sought
You,**

Let me not wander from Your cue.

11 Your word have I hidden in heart,
That I might not sin in my part.

**12 Blessed YHWH! Teach You me Your
statutes.**

**13 My lip declares without disputes
All of the judgments of Your mouth.**

**14 I have rejoiced there is no drouth
In the way of Your testimonies,
As in all riches and their phonies.**

15 I'll meditate on Your precepts,
And contemplate Your ways 'adepts.

**16 I will delight in Your statutes,
And not forget Your word confutes.**

Only by human sacrifice, they bray,
Only by the way of the cross to stay,
There is the hope of cleansing of the way.
How then does David write and come to
stray?

Elect are those who take heed what You
say.

Right seemly it appears that those who seek
Going by Your law with whole heart and
cheek

Outstandingly succeed. Your word's
enough

Doubtless to keep the young man straight
and tough.

Some think that sin is human frailty,
Being weak to perform feats in a spree.
Unless You spoke it on Sinai, it's not
To be called sin at all, but human plot
Making slaves of the poor, priests of the
sot.

17 GIMEL. Deal bountifully with Your
servant,

I may live and keep Your word's grant.

**18 Open my eyes, that I may see
Wondrous things from Your law freely.**

19 I *am* a stranger in the earth,
Do not hide Your statutes in dearth.

**20 My soul breaks with longing for Your
Judgments at all times. 21 Furthermore,**

**You rebuke the proud and the cursed,
Who stray from Your law *for the worst.***

22 Remove from me reproach, contempt,
I've kept Your law in my attempt.

**23 Princes sit and speak against me,
I keep Your statutes before me.**

24 Your testimonies also *are*
My delight *and* my counsellor.

Eternal truth is that all wondrous things
Turn bright within Your statutes'
commandings.

He errs who proudly disdains me because
Of my adherence to Your divine laws.
Until the eye is opened and the heart
See wonders You perform and from the
start,

Help does not rise, and blindness sets the
man

Against You and You ten commandments'
plan.

Longing with hunger for Your law it takes
To see the truth, but when one does the
stakes

Never reduce, but strangers in the earth,
Outcasts are all who love Your field and
berth.

Take princes now to task and priests at
fault,

Make Your testimonies every man's salt.

25 DALETH. My soul clings to the dust,
revive

Me by Your word *and make alive.*

**26 I have declared my ways, and You
Answered me, teach Your statutes true.**

27 Make me understand the way of
Your precepts, and so shall I love
Your wondrous works and meditate.

**28 My soul melts from its heavy state,
Strengthen me by Your word, elate.**

29 Remove from me the way of lying,
And grant grace in Your law supplying.

**30 I have chosen the way of truth,
Your judgments I have sought *since*
*youth.***

31 I cling to Your testimonies,
O YHWH, do not shame me for these.

**32 I'll run the course of Your
commands,**

For in Your *grace* my heart expands.

After the choice to eat forbidden fruit,
Knowledge of good and evil and of soot,
Emancipated from the good life to
Understand for oneself what's right to do,
Nothing could give us life again but that
Tree that we left behind where we had sat.
Only I find that You, Beloved, sent down
That tree of life again upon the town,
Hove out reviving waters on the dust,
Each commandment exchanging life for
rust.

Every day that I take commandments clear
Against the evil that would be my cheer,
Nearer comes life eternal to my soul,
Your ten commandments my life and my
goal.

33 HE. Teach me, O YHWH, the way of
Your

Statutes, and I'll keep it *the more*
To the end. 34 Give me understanding,
And I'll keep firm Your law's demanding,
Observing it with *my* whole heart.

**35 Make me walk in the path *apart*
Of Your commandments, my delight.**

36 Incline my heart to Your witness,
And never to covetousness.

**37 Turn away my eyes from looking
At worthless things, revive *a thing*
In me *to travel* in Your way.**

38 Establish Your word *and Your sway*
To Your servant, who fears Your *day.*

**39 Turn away my reproach which I
Dread, for Your judgments satisfy.**

40 See, I've longed for Your laws to bless,
Quicken me in your righteousness.

Give me, Beloved, Your righteousness, not
mine.

Revive in me creation's clandestine
Argument that You have made all men
good.

Vain is the argument a serpent could
Extinguish what good You once
pronounced fine.

No heart is now incapable on earth,
Inspired by the delight of Your law's
worth.

Mankind and woman too may all rejoice
Along the purified way of Your choice.

Give me then Your grace and I shall not fail,
Expecting to gain victory, prevail.
The one who stumbles finds Your loving hand
Has all forgiveness in divine command,
Observes to blot out errors from Your band.

41 VAU. Let Your mercies come to me too,

YHWH, even Your salvation *true*,
According to Your word *in view*.

**42 So shall I have an answer set
For him who reproaches me yet,
For I trust in Your word *well met*.**

43 Don't take the word of truth from me,
I've hoped in Your judgements *truly*.

**44 So I shall always keep Your law
For ever and ever *in awe*.**

45 And I will walk at liberty,
For I seek Your precepts *truly*.

**46 I'll speak of Your testimonies
Also before kings *at their knees*
I will not be ashamed *to see*.**

47 I'll delight in Your commandments,
Which I have loved *above presents*.

**48 My hands also I'll lift to do
Your commandments which I've loved
too,
I'll meditate Your statutes true.**

Until I found Your law I did not know
Sun of freedom or liberty in glow.
Hung on the things external and the show
And on the plight of flesh, determined go,
Light left me in the chains of hopeless weal
To wander in the actions that I feel.
Now that Your law has come to bring me life

Out of the work and toil and worldly strife,
The path is clear, and freedom meets my hand,

Thought is no longer chained to contraband.

All things become bright with assurance now

Knowledge and grace are planted on my brow.

Each day is blessed with liberty since I

Took Your commandments from the Mount Sinai.

49 ZAIN. Remember the word to Your slave,

Which has raised up in me hope *brave*.

**50 This is the comfort of my pain,
Your word has quickened me *again*.**

51 The proud have held me in disdain,
I've not departed from Your law,
But kept Your commandments in awe.

**52 I minded Your judgements of old,
YHWH, and took comfort in their mould.**

53 Horror had taken hold on me:
They forsake Your law wickedly.

54 Your statutes have been my songs' page

In the house of my pilgrimage.

55 I've remembered Your name, O YHWH,

In the night, I've kept Your law *true*.

**56 I had this for myself *in view*,
Because I kept Your precepts *due*.**

How can a man desire a quickening,
Emancipation gone beyond the wing
Now found in the life quickened by Your word?

All ten of Your commandments I have heard.

Many there be who trust in crosses met
Each day where sacrifices have been set
On animal and on the holy brow
From heavenly places sent to us somehow.
The very thought that human sacrifice
Has given anything that might suffice
Evokes disgust in one who knows the life,
Light and love quickened without toil or strife

Of Your commandments ten. I keep them in
Remembrance in the night against the din.

57 CHETH. *You are* my portion, YHWH,
I've said

That I'd keep Your words *and be led*.

58 I begged Your grace with all my heart,

Be merciful to me on part

Of Your word. 59 I've thought on my ways

And turned my feet in Your laws' praise.

60 I hurried to obey Your laws.

61 I've been robbed by the wicked claws,
I've not forgotten Your law's rays.

**62 At midnight I'll get up to thank
You for Your righteous judgements' rank.**

63 I'm friend of all those who fear You,
Of those who keep Your precepts true.

64 YHWH, the earth's full of Your mercy:

So all Your statutes teach to me.

Delivered from the hook of evil men
That would surround me in attack again,
Help I find in Your word and in Your praise.

You meet me in the coming of the days,
Grant me Your presence in the dread of night.

Our meetings are few at the midnight hour,
Despite the fact You're always there in power.

I sleep away the night in the perfume
No other breath could sprinkle on my room,

Visible to my nostrils as I take
A path between my slumber and awake.
I find You ever ready where I spend
Night watch along the curtains and the bend

Round frosty branches I forget to light.

65 TETH. You have dealt well with Your slave, YHWH,

According to Your word that's true.

66 Teach me judgement and knowledge fine,

I've believed Your commandments' vine.

67 Before I was afflicted I

Went astray, but now I rely

On Your word. 68 You're good and do good,

Teach me Your statutes *as I should*.

**69 The proud have told lies about me,
I keep Your precepts faithfully.**

70 Their heart is slow to run as grease,
I delight in Your law's release.

71 It's good I'm in humble estate

In order to learn Your laws' rate.

72 The law You speak's better to me
Than gold and silver thousands' fee.

Establish in my heart and life and act
More strongly, my Beloved, the sacred pact.

Each day make my apportionment and faith
More evident than pagan range and wraith.

Be quick to set Your law before my eye,
Extinguish the desire to strain and vie,

Remember that my will is Yours alone
To follow Your instructions to the bone.

However many days my life may take,
Equal them with Your grace to rouse and wake

Secure in Your commandments and Your will.

Around me there are many who fulfil
Bright plans of heathen vintage for the mill.
Bring me another way and for Your sake.

73 JOD. Your hands have made and fashioned me,

Give me understanding to be
Learning Your commandments truly.

**74 Those who fear You will be glad when
They see me, since I've hoped again**

In Your word. 75 YHWH, I know that Your

Judgements are right, and on that score

You're faithful in that You've set me

In humble state for all to see.

76 I pray Your merciful kindness

Be for my comfort and to bless

According to Your *promised* word

That Your *own* servant's *often heard*.

**77 Let come on me tender mercy,
For Your law's my delight's degree.**

78 Let the proud be ashamed, for they
Were deceitful with me the way

They acted without reason's sway;

I meditate Your precepts' ray.

**79 Let those who fear You turn to me,
Those knowing Your testimony.**

80 Let my heart be firm in Your laws,
Without my shame for any cause.

The humble estate that You give to me,
Beloved, is the excuse the proud can see
To take advantage of my innocence

And slander me and destroy all my tents.
So give me joy in the simplicity
That Your law demands of both the gentry
And the poor on the way. Tender mercy
Be my comfort instead of all the wrong
That is the joy of the proud and their song.
Beloved, to be Your servant is a joy,
The tasks You give are scarcely to employ:
Only remembering once a week Your name
And honour to my parents for the same.
All else is simply to avoid the blame.

81 CAPH. My soul faints for Your
salvation;

I hope in Your word *as I run*.

**82 My eyes fail for Your word and say
"When will You comfort me and stay?"**

83 I'm like a bottle in the smoke,
But don't forget Your statutes' *stroke*.

**84 How many days shall Your slave live?
When will You sentence them and give
Judgement on persecuting men,
And turn back to justice again?**

85 The proud have dug snares for my soul,
They do not have Your law as goal.

**86 All Your commandments faithful be:
They persecute me wrongfully;
Come to my rescue and help me.**

87 They'd almost consumed me on earth,
I did not give up Your law's worth.

**88 Revive me in lovingkindness;
Your testimony I'll confess.**

Execute judgement on my soul and I
May resurrect in new life coming by.
Execute judgement on my enemy,
My joy shall be complete after the spree.
Blessed be Your holy law that brings about
Early and late the grace of justice' shout.
Remember me, Beloved, as You relate
The word of comfort in prophecy's state,
How Your law will come to rejuvenate
Everyone who whole-heartedly takes it.
Should I fall in the hands of humankind,
A horrid fate, keep me from mercy blind,
But save me by Your ten commandments'
law

Before I succumb to civilized claw.

89 LAMED. YHWH, Your word's set fast
in the skies.

90 Your faithfulness for generations
Is firm, You have established *nations*
On earth, and it shall stay *in guise*.

**91 They're kept to this day by command,
For all things are Your servant band.**

92 Unless Your law'd been my delights,
I should have perished in my plights.

**93 I'll never forget Your precepts,
As their reviving life expects.**

94 I am Yours, save me, for I've sought
Your precepts, *all the things You've taught*.

**95 The wicked have waited for me
To destory me, but I will see
Saving in Your testimony.**

96 I've seen an end of all perfection,
Your commandment's beyond reflection.

All things may be known by their fruits
they say.

The fruit of crucifixion on the way
Has been the conquest of Mexico and
Dachau and Auschwitz, Buchenwald at
hand.

A better fruit is that Your law produces:
Your mercy's grace obedience reduces
To man's delights, whole-heartedly when
he

Outwits temptation working righteously.
Knowing the delight of Your law I find
Enough of pleasure in the good and kind
Each day that I need not go out to kill,
Pack others' perks in pocket for a thrill,
Invite the neighbour's wife to party pet,
To witness falsely of the other's set.

97 MEM. Oh how I love Your law! I say
It's my meditation all day.

**98 By Your commandments You have
made**

**Me wiser that my foes' parade,
For all around me they have stayed.**

99 I have more understanding than
All my teachers, because Your plan
Is my contemplation *to scan*.

**110 I grasp more than the men of old,
Because I keep Your precepts bold.**

101 I have refrained my feet from all
Bad to keep Your commandments *tall*.

**102 I've not departed from what's just
In Your sight, You've taught me to trust.**

103 How sweet are Your words to my taste,

Than honey to my mouth *in waste*.

**104 By Your precepts I gain the goal
Of knowledge, and hate the false role.**

How sweet to the tongue is the cantillation
Of Your commandments, Beloved, in
elation!

Lovely indeed, and yet the word is set.
You provide in them everything that's met,
How all the problems humans make
themselves

On earth could be erased as fast as elves.
Nothing is clearer than the strategy
Of keeping ordered, great society
Under the rule of Your commandments
free.

Reward of Sabbath will avoid excess,
The labour ill, environmental mess.
How simple is solution to the ills
You have provided from the ancient hills.
Fan out the chaff that lies and steals and
kills.

105 NUN. Your word's a lamp lighting my
way,
My feet follow a path towards day.

There is a way most bright and glorious,
Beloved, a way that's broad and populous
And filled with blinding light. The light
that blinds

Is like as dark to lead astray both minds
And feet. There is a light that's sure to
guide

Aright, though every other cult beside
Cast only phosphorescent glow on bone
Sunk into hell, on crumbling gods of stone.
That light's a lamp, a guiding star, a great
And shining revelation. Light and sound,
Or rather light in truth is sound. The gate
To Paradise, the flaming swords around,
Is lighted by the sound of recitation
Of all the divine books of revelation.

106 I've sworn, and I will do the act,
I'll keep Your righteous judgements' pact.

**107 I am afflicted very much:
Quicken me, YHWH, by Your word's
touch.**

108 Accept, I pray, the sacrifice
My lips freely bring, and suffice

O YHWH to teach me Your judgements.

109 My soul stays always in my tents,
I don't forget Your law's presence.

**110 The wicked laid a snare for me;
I did not stray from Your law's tree.**

11 Your testimonies I have taken
As my inheritance unshaken
For ever, they rejoice my heart.

**112 I turn my heart to do my part
According to Your statutes' art
Until the end when I awaken.**

As many times as David says Your law
Takes charge to quicken, liven, and
withdraw

Husks of the evil in the hand and claw,
Everyone does not see the glory's awe.
Right now problems could be better solved
if

All simply swore to keep Your statutes
stiff.

Nothing is too hard in the ten to do.
Doing is all that's needed. To tie shoe
Takes more skill. Every child at home and
school

Has to be sworn to keep commandments'
rule.

Young and old soon would learn to live and
let

Mother and child enjoy sweet peace and get
Out of the pain of city and the band
Touched by the evil thought and evil hand.

113 SAMECH. I hate vain thoughts. Your
law I love.

114 You are my hiding place above,
And my shield. I hope in Your word.

**115 Leave me, doers of wickedness:
I'll keep Alohims' laws' address.**

116 Uphold me according to Your
Word so that I might live *in score*,
And not ashamed of my hope's *store*.

**117 Hold me up and I shall be safe,
And I shall respect, though a waif,
Your statutes long as I'm on shore.**

118 You've trodden down all those who err
From Your law, falsehood is their share.

**119 You put away all wicked men
Like dress upon the earth in den,
That's why I love Your law again.**

120 My flesh trembles for fear of You,

I'm afraid of Your judgements true.

Have You indeed trodden down those who
stray

Each day from Your law in the light of
day?

Right. But I think I see a few whose bumps
Trodden down in the muck, and whose
bruised lumps

Have still dressed up in plush and hold the
sway

Over the church and synagogue and pay
Up to the mosque to preach aloud and pray.
Some such, despite the stains of Your
footprints

Have sat in parliament, stood up to rinse
A good name in the ministry, or yet
Lock, stock and sterile dress their
boardrooms met

To take a profit from the hungry set
Nowhere but in the service of the great,
Outcasts, but not trodden by Your rebate.

121 AIN. I have done judgement and
justice:

Leave me not to oppressors' *kiss*.

**122 Represent Your servant for good;
Don't let the proud oppress my hood.**

123 My eyes fail for Your salvation,
For Your righteous word to be done.

**124 Deal with Your slave by Your
mercy,**

And teach me Your statutes *for free*.

125 I am Your servant, make me know
What Your testimonies would show.

**126 It's time for YHWH to rise and
work;**

**They've made void Your law *as they
shirk*.**

127 That's why I love Your
commandments

More than gold, more than pounds and
pence.

**128 So I consider all precepts
All right, and hate all false concepts.**

They have indeed made void Your law
when they

Know Trinity instead of Your own sway.
Indeed, they make void Your law when
they will

Laugh at the Gentile and to fill the bill
Let him work while their donkey's resting
still.

They have indeed made void Your law to
take

Home memories of electric chair for stake
Or raise an army for the crucifixion
Under the Tigris for a false conviction.

So they make void Your law insisting that
His or her parents must earn it out flat,
A seed of honour. So let all such men
Lie down upon their own rebellion's den
To reap the punishment of death's doom
then.

129 PE. Your testimonies are a wonder,
So I will keep them *and not blunder*.

**130 Your words open and they give light,
Understanding to simple wight.**

131 I opened my mouth and I panted,
I longed for Your commands *and ranted*.

**132 Regard and have mercy on me,
As to those who love Your name's fee.**

133 Make my steps stay within Your word,
No wickedness within me stirred.

**134 Deliver me from man's oppression,
So I will keep Your law's confession.**

135 Make Your face shine upon Your
slave,

Teach me the statutes that You gave.

**136 Rivers of tears run down my eyes,
When I fail from Your law in guise.**

No one is like to keep Your law's
perfection,

Only intend in matter of selection.

The strange thing is that it's so easy to

Contain with little striving in the pew.

One may fail in the duty of Your law,

Making mistakes and failing to keep awe.

My eyes see here that such offence need
not

Imply destruction of the righteous plot.

The time calls for repentance and with tears

Along the way, You save men from their
fears.

Demanding sacrifice does nothing for
Us waiting sinful at the open door.

Love of Your law brings tears repenting
soon

To give back life and hope beneath the moon.

137 TZADDI. Righteous are You, YHWH and upright

Are Your judgements *in human sight*.

138 Your testimonies You've commanded

Are righteous and faithful as handed.

139 My zeal consumes me, because my Enemies forgot Your words' *tie*.

140 Your word is very pure, that's why

Your servant loves it. 141 I am small

And despised, yet I do recall

Your precepts. 142 And Your righteousness

Is everlasting righteousness,

And Your law is the truth's address.

143 Trouble and anguish grasp me fast,
Your laws are my delights at last.

144 The righteousness of Your statutes

Is everlasting; give my roots

Understanding; I live in boots.

Except I had the wit to know the pure,
Rightly evaluating what is sure,
Your law would remain opaque to my view.

That must mean that You've given me a clue

How to know what is pure and what is not.
Only so many humans I have taught
Understand not the slightest what You say,
Sustaining doubts about the narrow way.
How narrow is it? In fact all is fair
Around the whole sea of the human share,
Left only a few places in the ice
To beware of, just ten of those suffice.
Now I turn back to Your law's purity,
Overwhelmed with Your commandments' beauty.

145 KOPH. I cried with my whole heart,
hear me,

YHWH, I'll keep Your statutes *truly*.

146 I cried to You; save me, and I
Shall keep Your testimonies' tie.

147 I got up before morning light,
And cried, I hoped in Your word's *sight*.

148 Before the watches of the night
My eyes search Your word for the right.

149 Hear my voice by Your
lovingkindness:

YHWH, raise Your judgement without
blindness.

150 The mischief-makers have come near,

They are far from Your law to hear.

151 Nearby are You, YHWH and the whole

Of Your commandments are truth's *goal*.

152 Concerning Your testimonies,
I've known a long time that You please
To set them for ever with ease.

Two errors rage, the first is that a man
Saves himself by doing the things he can
To keep Your law, the other error finds
Enough among those of the other kinds
Allowing that those who are saved need not
Love Your law and do everything You've taught.

Truth here is in the prayer that You might save,

Henceforward I'll keep Your law like a slave.

Outside the pale are others where they stand,

Unless You save, no one obeys in band,
So save all humankind, Beloved, and see
How many then obey in truth to be
A child and servant of the sovereign God,
Left cantillating Your law on the sod.

153 RESH. Consider my affliction and
Deliver me *on every hand*,
I don't forget Your law *to stand*.

154 Plead my case and deliver me,
By Your word come and quicken me.

155 Salvation's far from wicked ones,
They don't seek out Your statutes' *tons*.

156 Great are Your tender mercies,
YHWH,

Quicken me by Your judgements' view.

157 Many are my persecutors,
And my foes *in and out of doors*,
Yet I don't swerve from Your law's scores.

158 I watched transgressors and was
grieved,

They didn't keep Your word received.

159 Consider I love Your precepts,
Quicken me, YHWH, by *the concepts*

Of Your lovingkindness in stores.

160 Your word is true and from the starts;

Each of Your righteous judgements' darts

Eternally fulfils its parts.

The way to be saved is presented here,
No frills or statements made that are unclear.

Only You can save humankind to be
The bulwark of the bold as well as free.
But You save them by Your loving mercy
Expressed in Your commandments on the mount.

Along the way some people would recount
Renouncement and the sacrifice of blood
Finds the atonement for mankind in flood.
A simpler way and much more rational
Lies in the words of this Psalm for my sal.
Salvation's only in the hand divine
Empowered by mercy that You align
With ten commandments still ripe on the tine.

161 SCHIN. Princes have persecuted me
Without cause, but my heart stands free
In awe of Your word. 162 I rejoice
At Your word, as one that finds choice
Treasure. 163 Lying I truly hate,
I love Your law *without rebate*.

**164 Seven times a day I praise You,
For the righteous judgments You do.**

I take the two night prayers in firm
prostration

To make the sum of seven in oblation.
May praise be Yours, Beloved, both night
and day,

Both in the secret chamber and the way,
Along the margin of the new washed road
Where rain is glistening on its quartzite
load

And on the coltsfoot blooming, not in leaf.
Praise be to You who are leader in chief
Of robin choirs heard from three-day-old
bud

That sanctifies with gold the shining mud.
Praise be to You in nights wrought out in
stars,

And in the overcast skies dark with bars,

Along the margin of the shadowy wood,
Praise be to You in everything that's good.

165 Great peace have those who love Your
law,

And nothing shall come clip their claw.

**166 YHWH, I have hoped for Your
salvation,**

**And done Your commandments in
ration.**

167 My soul has kept Your testimonies,
And I love them more than the phonies.

**168 I've kept Your precepts and Your
laws,**

For all my ways before You pause.

In the exhilaration of despair,
The peace that comes from Your law being
there,

No man neglects Your hope, but finds a
share.

Each time I feel the shredding of the claw
Stinging the back and grasping at the paw,
Such doubt fills my soul for the single awe.

Any man can attain the bright and catch,
Go to the market and unlock the latch,
Any man can reveal the power's ode when
In exultation he rules all the glen.
Nothing shall keep my soul from that fair
word

Shown in the thunder and on Sinai stirred
To brighten every darkened pathway from
The fleshpots of old Egypt on the tum.

169 TAU. Let my cry come near before
You,

Give me the understanding *true*,
According to Your word, O YHWH.

**170 Let come before You my prayer
stirred,**

Save me according to Your word.

171 My lips shall surely utter praise,
When You've taught me Your statutes'
ways.

**172 So my tongue shall speak of Your
word,**

All Your commandments are averred.

173 Let Your hand help me, for I've chosen
Your precepts *above cold and frozen*.

**174 I've longed for Your salvation,
YHWH,**

And Your law is my delight, too.

175 Let my soul live and it shall praise
You while Your judgements help my ways.

**176 I've gone astray like a lost sheep,
Seek Your servant, I do not sleep
Forgetful of Your law to keep.**

Hear me, O Lord, as I finish the prayer
You set on heart of David in the air
Neatly hummed so the bird and beast
would share

Each syllable as sweet as they could care.
I speak the words of David once again,
Glad of the clear Gospel, salvation's den
Heard singly and by hand in this fair place,
Beside the tinkling mercies of Your grace.
On me be the great joke the universe
Uncovers when the pagan chapter's curse
Rises and flees away, till nothing's worse,
The soundness of Your simple way to save
Has made me son and lover, bond and slave
On the untrammelled pathway of the brave.

Until I heard the sacred sounds in peal
Sent out from Sinai for the woe and weal,
Help would not have come on my lowered
head

Around the chains determination fed.
Long on the earth the human round must go
To strive and sacrifice and make a show.
Nothing of such inventions glints a glow:
Only the divine act can set man free
To know the joys of divine liberty.
Commandments are the portals of the act
Of freedom, all else is illusion's pact.
Vaunting amid the chains the soul is shed.
Escaped from human action, I am led
To praise You now and ever in its stead.

Psalm 120

A song for pilgrimage.

**1 In my distress I cry to YHWH,
And He hears me and keeps in view.**

2 Save my soul, YHWH, from lying lips
And from a deceitful tongue's sips.

**3 What shall be given you, what done
To you, false tongue, for what you've
spun?**

4 Sharp arrows of the mighty men
With coals from the broom tree *again*.

5 Woe's me that I lived in Meschec,

I dwelt in Kedar's tents a speck.

6 My soul had long stayed with the one
Who hated peace, *Islam when done*.

**7 I support peace, Islam by name,
But they are all for war and shame.**

The conflict of this world is wrought upon
Division between those who rise at dawn
To pray to You and those who would wage
war.

Deceit and violence come from that store.
The house of peace faces the house of harb,
Now as in days of David's pilgrim garb,
And in the days he fled from Israel's woe
And sought a refuge in Kedar's clear glow.
The lines of truth united then again
Once more since Abraham and Moses'
lamb.

What son did David leave in Kedar when
He paced back to the kingship of that city
Who sought him best, but never showed
him pity?

Ahmed's son of David and Abraham.

It is a paradox indeed the place
Of Kedar calls an imprecation's trace,
And the faith that's called peace is brought
to do

Such violence before the worldly crew.
It is a paradox indeed Islam,
That ought to be taken for healing balm,
Is cried aloft for terror's place with calm
And sanguine hearts in every bugger's
view.

Beloved, though Islam fails to meet the test
Of keeping peace, the blame is not to wrest
From every other that totes gun and claw
In opposition to Your divine law.
Thou shalt not kill is made in every town
To sway before the interests of the crown.

Psalm 121

1 A Song of Pilgrimage.

I'll lift up my eyes to the hills,
From where my help comes *and distils*,
2 My help from YHWH, Creator of
The earth beneath and heaven above.

From my hotel roof in the Meccan town
I look toward the mountains bare and
brown

And hear again the words great grandma spoke

Read from this Psalm, her favourite to invoke,

And understand with insight keener than Before I knew the depth of this word's span.

My pilgrimage begins as I lift high
My eyes to these hills that join with the sky
As witness to the centuries below
Of right and wrong that run and seem to flow

Around the Kaaba. They must stand and see

All things and yet cannot close eye nor flee.
They cannot shed a tear to see the blood,
Nor smile to find Your mercy like a flood.

3 He will not let your foot be moved,
Who keeps you will not sleep *reproved*.
4 Behold, He who keeps Israel
Slumbered not nor into sleep fell.

Indeed, Beloved, I think You kept my feet
Straight in the circle that they wind
complete

About the Kaaba on the smooth refrain
Of marble touched with every human stain.
The murmur of the supplications sound
About me as I travel round and round,
No other sound is there, no other touch
Beside the press of crowd and sometimes such

As softly fall from some other bare foot.
Beloved, I follow in the way You put
Before my eyes, nor do I ever sleep,
But that I dream I still that vigil keep
That slowly circles beneath sun and bird
The house that is Your own and of Your word.

5 YHWH *is* your keeper, YHWH *is* your
Shade at your right hand, *what is more*,

**6 The sun shall not strike you by day,
Nor moon by night. 7 YHWH keeps your way**

**Preserving you from evil's sway,
He shall preserve your soul *and stay*.**

8 YHWH shall preserve your going out
Your coming in from this time out,
And even to eternal day.

I come bare-headed to Your famous house,
Beloved, and leave behind the wood and mouse,

The shy creatures of field, the spotted grouse,

And walk beneath the sun with foot and head

Uncovered to the place where You have led.

In truth, I came in winter so the sun
Would not beat on my oldish pate when done,

And found above the Meccan street the shine

Of moon both by daylight and by the vine
Of night-time where the darkened hills in turn

Uncover breasts that in the daylight burn.

The moon shall not strike me, though I may sleep

Uncovered on the rooftop where stars peep.
Both sun and moon follow You as they learn.

Psalm 122

A Song of Pilgrimage, of David.

**1 I was glad when they said to me,
“Let's go into the house of YHWH.”**

**2 Our feet shall stand inside your free
Gates, O Jerusalem, *the true*.**

3 Jerusalem is built to be
A town of perfect unity.

**4 There the tribes go, the tribes of
YHWH,**

To Israel's testimony, to

Give thanks unto the name of YHWH.

5 For there are set thrones of judgement,
Thrones of the house of David *meant*.

**6 Pray for Jerusalem's Islam,
Those who love you shall live in calm.**

7 Peace and *Islam* be in Your walls,
Prosperity in palace stalls.

**8 For my brother companions' sakes
I'll say now “Shalom in your wakes.”**

9 For the house of YHWH Alohim
Of ours I'll seek your good *to seem*.

If Islam truly reigned within the town
Of old Jerusalem without a frown,
There would be no partition and no wall

Dividing Jew and Gentile in the stall.
 Instead all nations would bow at the throne
 Where David once sat ruler of his own,
 And all would praise Your name and all
 would keep
 Your Torah statutes, and no one would
 weep.
 If Islam, that is, peace, truly found room
 In old Jerusalem and without doom,
 The guarded gates would fall open to
 prayer
 Instead of strife upon the gilded air.
 If Islam of Allah met Israel's God,
 You would be one of all upon the sod.

Psalm 123

1 A song of pilgrimage.
 To You I lift up my eyes, O
 You who live in the heavens' glow.
**2 See, as the eyes of servants watch
 The hand of their masters to botch,
 As maid looks to her mistress' hand,
 So our eyes upon YHWH to stand,
 Our Alohim, until He grant
 Mercy on us *in grace to plant.***
 3 Have mercy on us, YHWH, mercy
 On us, for we're exceedingly
 Filled with contempt *by all the spree.*
**4 Our soul indeed is filled with scorn
 Of those who were for leisure born,
 With the contempt of the proud worn.**

I was a man of little honour where
 The sweet Christians come fawn upon the
 fair.
 I was a man without glory in share,
 I was a mere servant of You and bare.
 I was a mere slave till the day that I
 Joined with the throng in pilgrimage on sly.
 And when I came into the house of God
 Beneath the dear hills above Mecca's sod,
 I found I was no longer humble slave
 But guest of the great King, Allah the
 brave.
 Look not on me in such contempt, you
 proud
 And craven slanderers beneath the crowd
 Of lying witnesses of fear for hope.
 I'm pilgrim guest of Allah, above pope.

Psalm 124

1 A song of pilgrimage of David.
 Unless YHWH had be on our side,
 Now might Israel say to abide;
 2 If YHWH had not been for a shield,
 When men rose up against us heeled:
**3 They would have swallowed us up
 quick,
 When their wrath was kindled *and slick.***
 4 The waters would have covered us,
 The stream drowned our souls *in the fuss.*
**5 The proud waters would have flowed
 over
 Our soul and we would have gone rover.**
 6 Blessed be YHWH who has not cast us
 Into their teeth as a prey thus.
**7 Our soul escaped just like a bird
 Out of the snare of fowlers *stirred,*
 The snare's broken, and we escape.**
**8 Our help is in YHWH's name to drape
 The curtain of sky and earth *erred.***

The hand that saved Israel from Pharaoh's
 flood
 And laid the Jordan out in sand and mud
 For feet to pass in safety from the strand
 Of Ammon and Edom to Promised Land,
 Can still protect the traveller as he goes
 In pilgrimage along the narrow rows.
 The hand divine that shadows from the
 wrath
 Of Amorite beneath the mountain path,
 That strengthened arm of Moses with his
 rod,
 Still bears the power and mercy of our God.
 Beloved, I walk the desert sand and see
 The spires of holy cities on the lee,
 And hear the call to worship on still air,
 A spattering of rain, and then the prayer.

Psalm 125

1 A song of pilgrimage.
**Those who trust YHWH, they are just
 like
 A mountain fortress *with a spike,*
 A fortress that is never shaken,
 But stays for ever *never taken.***
 2 As the mountains are round about
 Jerusalem, so YHWH's about
 His people now and ever more.
**3 The wicked one's rod shall not score
 The righteous, lest the righteous lay**

Their hand on wickedness to sway.

4 Do good, YHWH, to the good and right
In their hearts *daytime and at night*.

5 But as for those who turn away

To walk upon a crooked way,

YHWH shall lead them out as they stray

With workers of iniquity,

But upon Israel shall peace be.

With the same joy that travellers felt of old
On seeing towers of Jerusalem bold,
I meet the sights of Mecca and the towers
That gather round the Kaaba in the hours
The feet of millions come to pay their due
Of worship, love, respect, honour to You.
The fortress stands against a curtained sky
To see the lines of pilgrims passing by.
Beloved, I come to Your house as Your
guest.

Do not count me among those who divest
Themselves of the right way and turn aside
To idols, crosses, and in false paths ride.
Upon Your people You lay out Your peace,
The faith of Islam in its power's increase.

Psalm 126

1 A song of pilgrimage.

When YHWH reversed captivity
Of Zion, we were in a dream's spree.

**2 Our mouth was filled with laughter
then,**

Our tongue with singing in the glen:

They said among the heathen clans,

**"YHWH has done great things for their
plans."**

3 YHWH's done great things to us for joy.

4 Reverse, YHWH, our prison's employ

As the streams in the south *in scans*.

5 Those who sow in tears reap in joy.

6 The one who goes out weeping as

He bears the treasured seeds *he has*

Will surely come again with song,

Bringing his sheaves *with him along*.

Beloved, I rarely weep as I go out
To plant my garden at foot of redoubt.
My wife may weep, but that's because her
hip

Is so sore she can hardly run and skip.
But then I rarely plant a thing but flowers,
The foxglove and the poppy in my bowers.

By the same token it is rare I sing

With joy when autumn comes to end the
thing.

Beloved, despite the levelling of my ways

And stabilized emotions with rare craze,

I recognize that You do great things in

The silence of the garden's growth and bin.

I recognize the treasure of the seed

As miracle beyond my own crass need.

Psalm 127

A song of pilgrimage for Solomon

**1 Unless YHWH builds the house they
work**

In vain to build it or to shirk:

Unless YHWH keeps the city safe,

The watchman wakes up like a waif.

2 Vainly you rise early at morn,

To sit up late, to eat in scorn

The sad bread; so He gives His loved

The blessed slumber *of foxgloved*.

3 See, children are a heritage

**Of YHWH, sent from the womb *like
cage*.**

4 As arrows in the mighty hand,

So are children of youth in band.

5 Blessed is the man with quiver full,

They shall not be ashamed to pull,

But hold concourse with foes at gate,

Rising up early, sleeping late.

When I saw that a boy of three or less
Had joined our caravan in Mecca's stress,
I thought it strange to take a child along,
Knowing what care such require more than
song.

It was a lot of work for mom and dad,
But sometimes others helped and were not
sad.

He was a cute thing playing under leaf

Of palm in Ali's garden for our chief.

At last I smiled to see his head was shaved

Before the lines of Mina marble paved.

Beloved, let me live out eternity,

A child in Your temenos, let me see

The hills about in joyful company,

Walking around Your temple faithfully.

Psalm 128

1 A song of pilgrimage.

Blessed is everyone who fears YHWH,

Who walks in His ways *as they do*.

**2 You'll eat the product of your hands,
And be blessed by good things in bands.**

3 Your wife be like a fruitful vine
Climbing the walls of your house fine,
Your children like olive trees round
About your table, *hear the sound*.

**4 Behold, so shall the man be blessed,
Who fears YHWH when he is addressed.**

5 YHWH shall bless you from the fortress,
And you shall see all the goodness
Of Quds as long as life address.

**6 Indeed you'll see your childrens'
bairns,**

And peace on Israel like cairns.

I cast a spell and promise for safety
Of house and home, of wife and progeny
As I set out to make the pilgrimage
As commanded from sacred age to age.
The promise and the spell give comfort to
The heart unquiet in the things to do,
The tumult of departure and the weight
Of worry not to miss connections late.
Beloved, Your servant Jesus also made
A point of saying pilgrimage waylaid
Was a good time to practice trust in You
That rust would not come in with robber
crew.

If pilgrimage at last lengthens my life
I acquiesce and give up all my strife.

Psalm 129

1 A song of pilgrimage.

Many times they've afflicted me
From my youth, may now Israel say.

**2 Many times they've afflicted me
From my youth, yet not found a way
To gain ascendance over me.**

3 The ploughmen ploughed upon my back,
They made long furrows in their track.

**4 YHWH's righteous, He has cut across
The cords of the wicked in loss.**

5 Let them all be confounded and
Turned back who hate the fortress' stand.

**6 Let them be like grass on rooftops
That withers without bringing crops.**

7 With such the mower makes no sheaf
To bind to his bosom's relief.

**8 Those passing do not stop to say
"Be blessing of YHWH on your way:**

We bless you in YHWH's name today."

A bit of common life is stored among
The verses of the songs that have been sung
For generations past in pilgrimage,
In times almost forgotten in the age.
There is a blessing that the folk would say
Upon the pilgrim travellers on the day
They saw them dressed in white and on the
way.

"Be blessing of YHWH on your way: we
bless

You in YHWH's name." And I can only
guess

How often the glad words were spoken
round

The hills that glanced at Jordan and the
ground

New sprung with green of spring or at the
sound

In autumn's festival before the rains
Came in to relieve all of summer pains.

Psalm 130

1 A Song of Pilgrimage.

**Out of the depths I've cried to You,
O YHWH, 2 Lord, hear my voice renew!
Let Your ears be attentive to
My utterance of supplications.**

3 If You, O YHWH, should mark *the
stations*

Of man's iniquities, O Lord,
Who then could stand *before Your sword?*

**4 But there's forgiveness with You, that
You may be feared where You are at.**

O my Beloved! Out of the depths the soul
Cries for salvation and forgiveness. Scroll
On scroll gives law and condemnation to
The one who disobeys. But You, but You,
Beloved, return to hear the first voice of
Repentance in response to grace and love.
While justice is not separable from You,
You mark no sin for those who would be
true,
Who cry to You confessing and repenting.
They find You are a just Judge, but
relenting.
Why so? Why is there all forgiveness
where

You stoop to earth and find the sinner
there?

That You may be the One feared and alone,
Alone great God not made of flesh and
bone.

5 I wait for YHWH, my soul shall wait,
And in His word I hope *to rate*.

**6 My soul waits for YHWH more than
they**

Who watch for the morning's first ray.

7 Let Israel hope in YHWH, with YHWH
Is mercy, saving of the crew.

**8 He'll redeem Israel from all
His iniquities *in the stall*.**

This is a song of pilgrimage and so
Gives hope that Your redemption is not
slow

To those who make the trek to find Your
place

And seek on seeking there the divine face.
Beloved, I know the way bared in Your
grace.

The bulk of pilgrimage is in the wait,
Waiting for morning light, waiting for late
Buses and trains and sitting under tents
Set up for pilgrim crowds for pounds and
pence.

Let me, Beloved, wait in You as I rest
My weary head in pilgrimage and test
The cool of night for sound of stirring
where

The fragrance of the journey meets the air.
Redemption is a grace found everywhere.

Psalms 131

A song of pilgrimage.

**YHWH, my heart is not proud, my eyes
Are not lifted up to reprise,
Neither do I search out the high
Matters beyond my gift and eye.**

2 I've surely kept myself in peace,
Like a child from the breast's release,
My soul's like a weaned child *on fleece*.

**3 Let Israel hope in YHWH from now
And for ever after *to bow*.**

I've noticed how the singing of short
Psalms

Idles away the hours of pilgrims, calms

The heart that looks towards the sacred site
Of Your house and its courtyards of
delight.

Seven times I sing the words in repetition,
And twelve times even meet my heart's
condition.

It settles mind and weary body and
Renews the hope of travelling on the land.
Like a child satisfied to play in peace,
The Psalm repeated gives my soul release.
Beloved, I'm like a child that is content
To run outside and play, no need to vent
My worries and my hopes, the moment
clears

Around the pilgrim band, banishes fears.

Psalms 132

1 A song of pilgrimage.

Remember, YHWH, David and all
His afflictions *against the wall*.

**2 How he swore to YHWH and he vowed
To the Dread of Jacob *and bowed*,**

**3 "Surely I will not come into
The tent of my house nor in view
Of my bed, 4 "I'll not give my eyes**

**Sleep or slumber in any guise,
5 "Till I've found out a place for YHWH,
A habitation *built for You*,
The Dread of Jacob, *faithful, true*."**

6 We've heard of it at Ephrata,
We found it in the woodlands *raw*.

**7 Then we shall go into His tents,
Worship where His footstool prevents.**

**8 Rise up, YHWH, come into Your rest,
You and the ark of Your strength *best*.**

I've seen the dawn come stealing in the
shroud

Of mist upon Ephrata, and allowed
My soul to rise in song before the day.
I've seen the place Ezekiel came to pray.

I've touched the narrow doorposts, bent my
head

To enter where they met to break their
bread

And sing the anthems strange and
overspread

With simple music toned with ash and
grey.

Beloved, my soul harks back and it would
stay

With old Emmanuel along the way
Of forest voices silent now except
In the heart of those who stayed there and
kept
The vigil of the Kedar and the flame
Of Ephrata's last faith in solemn claim.

9 Let Your priests be clothed with the right,
Your holy ones joy in Your sight.

**10 For Your servant David's sake turn
Not away the face as to spurn
Your own anointed from the light.**

11 YHWH has sworn David truthfully
That He'll not turn from it to be;

"From the fruit of your body I
Will set one on your throne *to vie*.

**12 "If your children will keep My pact
And my testimony to act**

**As I shall teach them, their sons too
Shall also sit on your throne's view
For evermore under the sky."**

13 For YHWH has chosen the fortress,
He desired it for His address.

**14 "This is My rest for ever: here
Will I dwell, I've desired the cheer.**

15 "I'll bless abundantly her part,
I'll feed her poor with bread *in cart*.

**16 "I'll also clothe her priests with fair
Salvation and her holy share
Shall shout aloud for joy in air.**

17 "There will I make David's horn bud,
Ordained a lamp, anointed stud.

**18 "His enemies I'll clothe with shame,
But lay on him a crown of fame."**

The pilgrimage has always been a thing
Of power and man's authority in ring.
The northern tribes commanded by the king
Avoided going up in pilgrimage
Because the king of Judah on his page
Would draw their hearts away in his
homage.

The pilgrimage today is fraught with
power,

The competition of sectarian hour,
The Wahabi and Shi'ite lightly touch
The kettle and look round to say as much.
The pilgrimage establishes the throne
Of David to all time, and will atone
Only the family that's set a part,
Beloved, to be the treasure of Your heart.

Psalm 133

1 A Song of Pilgrimage. Of David.
Behold, how good, how pleasant for
Brothers to live in unity!

**2 Like precious oil upon the head,
That ran down on the beard to pour
On Aaron, what a beard to see,
That dripped and spotted his skirts
spread.**

3 Like dew on Hermon that comes down
Upon the mountains to the town
Of the fortress, for there has YHWH
Commanded blessing, life in view.

The Levite priesthood was an institution
Of power that produced times of
constitution

Ungloried by Korah and others spread
To hope for hand and influence on bread.
The call to unity is always made
In sweetness, but before the stern parade
Of competition for the crosier's staff.
Only the burning seraphim can laugh.
Beloved, the precious oil no longer's
found,

And even the sweet recipe, I'm bound,
Is now uncertain, while the heifer's load
Of ashes to cleanse all sacred abode
Is unknown to the people in their mode.
I praise You all priestcraft's down on the
ground.

Psalm 134

1 A Song of Pilgrimage.
Behold, bless YHWH, all servants of
YHWH, who by night stand *by your love*
In the house of YHWH! 2 Lift up your
Hands *at the sanctuary door*,
And bless YHWH. 3 YHWH who made
heaven and
Earth bless you from the fortress *stand!*

I've stood in the night by Your house
aglow

With all the lights around it in their show,
The place illuminated like the day,
And lifted up my hands to bless and pray.
I've stood in the night beside Mecca's
shore,

Because I thought the daytime would see
 more
 In crowds around Ali's birthplace for door.
 Maybe I was right, maybe I was wrong,
 I stood in any case among a throng.
 Beloved, who made the heaven and the
 earth,
 And gave the sea and sky a noble birth,
 I seek You now as then in temples worth
 Your making, under domes of the night sky
 As I did once beneath the desert fly.

Psalm 135

1 Praise YHWH! *And in your praising*
 praise YHWH's name too,
 Praise *Him indeed, all of* you servants of
 YHWH!

**2 You who stand in the house of YHWH,
 in the courts**

**Of the house of our God, 3 Praise
 YHWH, for reports**

**YHWH is good, sing praises to His name,
 for good,**

***That His name may be exalted as it
 should.***

4 For YHWH chose Jacob for Himself,
 Israel

For His special treasure, *so too Ishmael.*

**5 I know YHWH is great, our Lord
 above all gods.**

**6 Whatever YHWH please, He does upon
 the sods,**

**In heaven and earth, in seas and all deep
 places.**

7 He causes vapours to ascend *in graces*
 From the ends of the earth, and He makes
 lightnings

For the rain, He brings the wind out of His
 wings.

I translated the word as gods, and yet
 I know there are no other gods to get
 But You alone, Beloved, the only met.
 You are above all those exalted here,
 Above all those in glory to appear
 In skies upon the mountains with their gear.
 Whether with bodies of celestial down
 Or human flesh and blood about the town,
 All lie submitted rank before Your crown.
 Beloved, those who call themselves gods
 await

The coming of Your rain upon their pate,
 And those who call them gods for any rate
 All stand in judgement on the Sabbath day
 To find that truth arises in a ray.

8 He destroyed firstborn of Egypt, man and
 beast.

9 He sent signs and wonders among you
 increased,

O Egypt, upon Pharaoh, all his servants.

10 He defeated many nations and *incensed*
 He slew mighty kings, 11 Sihon Amorites'
 king,

Og king of Bashan, of Canaan every king,

12 And gave their land *as* a heritage, a
 thing

To Israel His people. 13 Your name, O
 YHWH,

For every generation, Your fame, O
 YHWH.

**14 For YHWH will judge His people with
 just good sense,
 And He will have compassion on His
 servants.**

When You destroyed the firstborn of the
 land

Of Egypt You left no one on the sand
 Who had the obligation there to stand
 Before the family altar with a brand
 To burn the daily sacrifice and bring
 A prayer of hope and faith upon the spring.
 Because the Pharaoh left Your word and
 ring

And failed to cantillate the Psalms and sing
 You left the country once bereft of all
 The pleasures of faith that rise in Your call.
 Beloved, today the firstborn also stray,
 And few call family at morn to pray,
 And few at evening make their lonely way
 Before the altar with family in stall.

15 The idols of the nations, silver and gold,
 Are work of men's hands *with souls to*
idols sold.

**16 They have mouths, but do not speak,
 eyes but don't see,**

**17 With ears not hearing, in mouths no
 breath can be.**

18 Those who make them are like them,
 and all who trust

Their lives and hopes to idols made of the dust.

19 Bless YHWH, Israel's house! House of Aaron, Bless YHWH!

20 Bless YHWH, O house of Levi! You who fear YHWH,

Bless YHWH! 21 Blessed be YHWH out of His fortress, who

Dwells in Jerusalem! Praise YHWH! Praise YHWH! YHWH!

Beloved, who set the bounds where live all men,

See how their competitions rise again!

From age to age the greedy come to slay

The poor west of Euphrates on the way.

But human greed's root's in idolatry.

To love a god of self or self's own place

May seem an utter freedom graciously,

But such must always rise to grind the face

Of those who take their living from that grace.

So Ali to Husseyn despite their heart

Compassion for the poor, take their first part

To speak for You, Beloved, Your unity,

And praise Your oneness above even sound

Of bomb and battle on the level ground.

Psalm 136

1 Oh, give thanks to YHWH, for *He indeed is good!*

His mercy *endures* forever *as it should.*

2 Oh, give thanks to the God of exalted ones!

His mercy *endures* forever under suns.

3 Indeed, give thanks to the Lord of lords *above!*

His mercy *endures* in everlasting love.

4 To Him who alone does indeed great wonders,

For His mercy's always for human blunders,

5 To Him who by wisdom has made the heavens,

For His mercy's always in spite of leavens,

6 To Him who laid out the earth above waters,

For His mercy's always to sons and daughters,

7 To Him who has made above the earth great lights,

For His mercy *endures* always in delights,

Your wonders and Your mercy are things taught,

And not to be found for their being sought.

Some men can walk upon the fields and see

Only the miracle of famed city

To be built on the borrow and the lee.

Ungrateful? No, merely blind to the path

Of mole and birch, caught up in plans and math.

Your wonders and Your mercy have their wrath.

Beloved, I stop to praise the golden hue

Of day that marks the borders of my view;

I stop in track to clear my mind with joy

Before the daywork that my hands employ;

I lop the branches from they gate and find

Thanksgiving for the banquet where I've dined.

8 The sun to rule by day *slave of its Maker,*

For His mercy's always *on sand and breaker,*

9 The moon and stars *He sets up* to rule by night,

For His mercy is forever, never slight.

10 To Him who struck Egyptians in their firstborn,

For His mercy *endures* forever *in scorn,*

11 And once brought out Israel from among them,

For His mercy's forever though *He stung them,*

12 *And* with a strong hand, and with an outstretched arm,

For His mercy *is* forever *without harm,*

13 To Him who divided the Red Sea in two,

For His mercy *endures* forever, *He's YHWH,*

14 And made Israel pass through the midst of it,

For His mercy *endures* forever *and fit,*

15 But overthrew Pharaoh's army in Red Sea,

For His mercy's forever, *eternally,*

16 To Him who led His people through
wilderness,
For His mercy *endures* forever to *bless*,

**17 To Him who has indeed struck down
His great kings,
For His mercy *endures* always in His
wings,**

18 And slew famed kings *because of their
cruelty*,

For His mercy's forever, *eternally*,

**19 And also Sihon king of the Amorites,
For His mercy *endures* forever for rights,**

20 And Og king of Bashan, *another He
slew*,

For His mercy *endures* forever and new,

**21 And gave their land as a heritage to
them,**

For His mercy *endures* forever a gem,

22 A heritage to Israel His servant,

For His mercy *endures* forever *unspent*.

**23 Who remembered us in our lowly
estate,**

For His mercy *endures* forever and late,

24 And rescued us indeed from our
enemies,

For His mercy *endures* ever, *never flees*,

**25 Who gives indeed His nourishment to
all flesh,**

For His mercy *endures* forever and fresh.

26 Oh, give thanks to the God of heaven
and earth!

For His mercy *endures* forever in worth.

Beloved, Your mercy truly walks the earth
In tons of sun, in breaking seas in girth,
In cascades of verdure in spring and
summer,

In continents of ice and snow on bummer,
And yet despite Your merciful judgement
On Og and Sihon whose craven deaths
meant

Life to hundreds and thousands, there
remain

Usurpers and tyrants upon the plain.

Though Ali Zaynul Abideen may sing
Of Your gracious mercy to him and ring,
His father and brothers bowed to the thirst
And arrow flung upon them by the worst.

Beloved, forgive me that I fail to see
Your mercy without contrast by degree.

Psalm 137

1 By the rivers of Babylon, there we sat,
We wept remembering the fortress where
we sat.

**2 We hung our harps upon the grown
willows there.**

**3 For there they asked us to sing our
songs and share**

**With those who carried us away and
captive,**

**And those who plundered us *required*
mirth to give,**

**“Now sing us *one* of the songs of the
fortress!”**

4 How shall we sing YHWH's song in a
foreign dress?

5 But if I forget you, O Jerusalem,

Then let my right hand forget *its stratagem!*

**6 If I do not remember you, let my
tongue**

**Cling to the roof of my mouth, if I've not
sung**

In exaltation of Jerusalem's joy

Above my life itself, above my chief joy.

7 Remember, O YHWH, against sons of
Edom

The day of Jerusalem, who said *in sum*,
“Raze *it*, raze *it*, to its very foundation!”

**8 Born for destruction, daughter of
Babylon,**

**Blessed be he who serves you as you
served us then!**

**9 Who dashes your little ones against the
den!**

Beside the rivers of Babylon wept
The mother with the child whose bosom
kept

No nourishment in pain of draught
although

Water was in sight of the army's show.

Beside the rivers of Babylon stayed

The seventy to meet their death waylaid,

While Husseyn showed by the way that he
prayed

The path to life while braving his death's
shade.

Beside the rivers of Babylon he

Lifted an infant for the sky to see

And cried aloud to silence to be free.

Beside the rivers of Babylon bound

The arrow found its mark and to the sound
Of that child's one last cry thrown to the
ground.

Psalms 138

1 *A Psalm of David.*

I'll praise You with my whole heart, before
the great

I will sing praises to You *in Your estate.*

**2 I will worship toward Your holy
temple,**

**And praise Your name for Your loving-
kindness full**

**And truth, for You've set Your word
above Your fame.**

3 In the day when I cried out, You called
my name,

*And made me bold indeed with strength in
my soul.*

4 All kings of earth shall praise You, O
YHWH, extoll

When they hear the words of Your mouth,
that are true.

**5 Yes, they shall sing indeed of the ways
of YHWH,**

**For great above all is the glory of
YHWH.**

**6 Though YHWH's on high, yet He
regards the lowly,**

**But the proud He knows from afar not
holy.**

7 Though I walk in trouble, You will revive
me,

You will stretch out Your hand against
enemy,

And from his anger Your right hand will
save me.

**8 YHWH will perfect what concerns me,
Your mercy,**

**O YHWH, endures forever, do not
forsake**

**The works of Your hands and the poor
souls You make.**

Prayer of the dying Husseyne still gives
praise

To You, Beloved, because he sees Your
ways

Pure and right with justice beyond the veils
That cloud the view of lesser men with
tales.

Beyond death he sees but the resurrection,
Beyond defeat the glorious insurrection
Of faith against the warfare of the small
Of soul who cling to empty power's thrall.
Saved from wrath does not mean he saves
his head,

Though that too someday will be raised
from dead,

But that his eye dying's on the perfection
Your oneness walking, sighing on selection
Of beauties varied, splintered on the world:
Who walks in trouble finds that flag
unfurled.

Psalms 139

1 For the Chief Musician. A Psalm of
David.

**O YHWH, You have searched me, you
have known me too.**

**2 You know my sitting and my rising up,
YHWH,
You understand afar off my thought to
do.**

3 You comprehend my path and my lying
down,

And are acquainted with all my ways *in
town.*

**4 For there is not a word on my tongue,
behold,**

**O YHWH, but that You know it wholly
from old.**

5 You have indeed hedged me behind and
before,

And laid Your hand upon me, *and what is
more,*

**6 Such knowledge is far too wonderful
for me,**

It is too high, I cannot attain it's store.

The Psalmist wonders that You know all
things,

The round of human life in daily rings,
I think the petty ground and summonings
That are the plot of commoners and kings
Do not today seem so remarkable.

Computers keep the data to the full.

If You are wonderful because You are
A great computer on a distant star,

Then I have better things and on a par
In reveling instead that leaves on trees

Around me, though each known to Your
own breeze,
And each uniquely captured by Your sight,
Still make a canopy for my delight,
No matter whether unique or in flight.

7 Where can I go away now from Your
spirits?

Or where can I flee from where Your
presence sits?

**8 If I ascend into heaven, You *are* there,
If I make my bed in hell, lo, You *are*
there.**

9 *If I take the wings of the morning to flee,
And live in the uttermost parts of the sea,*

10 Then even in that place Your hand shall
lead me,

Your right hand shall not desist from
holding me.

**11 If I say, “Surely darkness shall fall on
me,”**

**Even the night shall be light *all* about
me,**

**12 Indeed, darkness *itself* shall not hide
from You,**

**Night shines as day, darkness is like light
to You.**

Darkness hides no one now, technology
Sees through the darkest night on land and
sea.

If ancient men who sang Your praises
thought

It wonderful that You had never bought
An instrument to penetrate the glow
Of night, then today none of us is slow
To wonder that mere men can steal the
show.

Those who with cruel torch seek out the
way

Of terrorist who hides from poison spray
Have ways to make the darkness disappear.
You are, Beloved, no more unique, I fear.
There is no place that anyone can flee
From hand of democratic enemy.
Everywhere I look everyond can see.

13 For You formed my inward parts, from
mother’s womb.

14 I will praise You, for I’m fearfully *like*
doom

And wonderfully made, marvellous Your
works,

And my soul knows *that* right well *and*
never shirks.

**15 My frame was not hidden from You
on that day,**

**When I was made in secret, skilful array,
Wrought in the lowest parts of the
crumbling earth.**

16 Your eyes saw my substance, being yet
unworth.

And in Your book they all were written
indeed,

The days fashioned for me, when none
were *in seed*.

**17 How precious also are Your true
thoughts to me,**

**O Alohim! And how great is their sum’s
*sea!***

18 *If I* should count them, they would be
more than sand,

When I awake, I am still beside Your hand.

The very genes that make the body go
Are now revealed in microscopic glow,
And everything the Psalmist thought You
knew

Is laid bare to the scientific view.

The book of Your genetic code we break
With hope and force upon the solemn stake
That good may be done by the very means
That ancient watchers fell upon the teens
Of daughters of God to experiment
And make gigantic figures where they
went.

Beloved, You know and yet remain in
peace,

A silent watcher, seeing man’s increase
In good and evil on the earthly sod.

Step in once more and show that You are
God.

19 Oh, that You’d slay the wicked, Allah, I
deem!

Depart from me, then, you bloodthirsty
regime.

**20 For they indeed speak against You
wickedly,**

**Your enemies take *Your name* in vain
lightly.**

21 Do I not hate them, O YHWH, who do hate You?

And do I not loathe those who rise against You?

22 I hate them with perfect hatred on my count,

I too hold them my enemies *paramount*.

23 Do search me, O Alohim, and know my heart,

Now try me, and know my every anxious part,

24 And see if *there's any* wicked way in me,

And lead me in Your way everlastingly.

Beloved, You who are without place, without

Whom there is no place at all in the rout,
I who am bound to tide and sleep return
To find You in the room where deserts burn.

Your thoughts before the waning flood of earth

I cannot fathom for their justly worth,
And yet I pray a curse on those who hate
Your ways, even if that unhappy state
Be in my own soul, purge the world with fire

Till there remains but that crystal desire
For You alone. Beloved, I truly hate
The bearer of the prideful, cursed state,
The slayers of Husseyn and all his crew.
Give me more hate, Beloved, and love for You.

Psalm 140

1 To the Chief Musician. A Psalm of David.

Deliver me now, O YHWH, from evil men,

Preserve me now, O YHWH, from violent men,

2 Who plan evil in heart, always set for war.

3 They sharpen their tongues like a serpent for score,

The poison of asps *is* at their lips, indeed.

4 Keep me, O YHWH, from hands of the wicked *seed*,

Preserve me from such violent men whose way

Is purpose to make my steps stumble astray.

5 The proud have hidden a snare for me, and cords,

They've spread a net by wayside, set traps of boards.

6 I said to YHWH "You *are* my God, hear my voice,

In supplication, O YHWH, *God of my choice*.

A hundred years ago the civilized
Thought that peace would fall on earth
from the skies,

And never should a violence again
Be perpetrated here among Your men.
Time has dispelled that quaint philosophy
And spoiled the hope of both the bond and free.

And so I pray the Psalmist's prayer and wait

For Your salvation from the good and great.

Goodness and greatness cannot keep a man
From carrying out violence by plan.
Gandhi himself was disappointed when
The true estate of human hearts spued out.
Only the knowledge and awareness' shout
There's no I but You can turn us about.

7 "O YHWH the Lord, the strength of my salvation,

You've covered my head in the battle station.

8 "Do not grant, O YHWH, the wicked one's desires

Do not further the *wicked* scheme he requires,

Lest they be exalted, exalted indeed.

9 "*As for* the head of my surrounding ones' breed,

Let the evil of their lips cover them *all*,

10 "Let burning coals fall upon them, let them fall

Into fire, deep pits, that they rise not again.

11 "Let not a slanderer be set among men

**In the earth, let evil hunt the violent
Man to overthrow *him wherever he went*."**

12 I know that YHWH maintains the
afflicted's cause,
*And justice for the poor before His right
laws.*
**13 Surely the righteous shall give thanks
to Your name,
The upright shall live in Your presence
with fame.**

Though Husseyn prayed this prayer and
many more,
Wicked Yezid know how to make the score
Look in his favour, so the world of men
Still fawn up his rotten heart again.
Do not grant their desires and evil schemes,
But show that You are above all that seems
To bring Yezid's disciples to the pit
And burn their putrid souls as it is fit.
The slander against righteous Ali comes
To naught, despite the beating of the
drums.
The cause of right is in Your hand and still
Husseyn shall stand alive to do Your will,
And give thanks and praise to Your holy
name,
While the destroyer rise to bear the blame.

Psalm 141

1 A Psalm of David. YHWH, I cry
Out to You, make haste to my sigh!
Give ear to my voice when I cry
Out to You. 2 Let my prayer be set
Before You *as* incense, and let
My lifting up of hands suffice
To be an evening sacrifice.

In different times and different climes You
make
The requisites of prayer to You to take
One form or then another. Now I bring
No incense to Your throne, My God and
King,
Nor do I slaughter day by day at eve
A sacrifice of lamb, yet You receive
My prayer and I lift up my hands and call
Allahu akbar which means above all
Who stand in power You alone are great,
And there is neither church nor fateful state
Between You and the lowly dervish heart.
I stand at evening prayer and do my part,
While You, Beloved, hear every word I say

Though silent in Your everlasting way.

3 Set a guard, O YHWH, on my mouth,
Keep watch on door *both north and south*
Of my lips. 4 Do not incline my
Heart to any evil thing *nigh*,
To practice wicked works with men
Who work iniquity, and then
Do not let me eat any of
Their fine foods *offered as with love.*
**5 But let the righteous one strike me,
As kindness, let him rebuke me,
It shall be as excellent oil,
Let my head not refuse the spoil.**
For still my prayer's against the deeds
Of the wicked. 6 Their judges' *creeds*
Are overthrown by the sides of
The cliff, and they hear my words' *love*,
For they are sweet. 7 Our bones are
scattered
At the mouth of the grave, (*what
mattered?*)

As when one ploughs and breaks up earth.
**8 But my eyes are upon You, YHWH
The Lord, in You I flee from dearth,
Do not leave my soul without clue.**
9 Keep me from the snares they have laid
For me, and from the traps they've made
In *their* iniquity. 10 Let fall
The wicked in their own nets' *pall*,
While I escape safely *from all*.

Let Husseyn's army strike me down in
right
If that might turn the tide of human fright.
Let all the scattered, sacred bones arise
From Karbela to glory in the skies.
Let holy dust be scattered in the sea
And let its savour then be washed to me.
The honeyed tongues of those who see for
gain
To make the world one with their false
refrain
Ply at my door as though to speak for good.
I flee their cunning wishes to the wood.
Keep me from the snares of the false allure
Of peace in a false faith that is not pure.
Let me cling to the bold Criterion
That Ali snatched from Husseyn's dying
dawn.

Psalm 142

1 A Contemplation of David.

**A prayer when he in the cave hid.
I cry out to YHWH with my voice,
With my voice to YHWH I make choice
My supplication. 2 I pour out
My complaint before Him, I shout
Before Him my trouble. 3 When my
Spirit was overwhelmed in me,
Then You knew my path *from my cry*,
In the way in which *sorrowfully*,
I walk they have set secretly
A snare for me, a snare for me.**

4 Look on *my* right hand *now* and see,
For no one acknowledges me,
Refuge has failed me, no one cares
For my soul *threatened by their snares*.

**5 I cried out to You, O YHWH: I
Said, “You are my refuge, and my
Portion in the land of the living.**

6 “Attend to my cry, *in misgiving*
I am brought very low, so save
Me from my persecutors’ *grave*,
For they are stronger than am I.

**7 “Bring my soul out of prison’s *sty*,
That I may lift Your name *on high*,
The righteous *then* shall surround me,
For You’ll deal bountifully with me.”**

The prayer of David once was answered
where

He hid himself in cave and took beware
When all the land and people set aside
His right to rule, and pleased themselves in
pride.

The prayer was on the lips of good
Hussey

Not in a cave but on the burning plain,
When all the land betrayed his valid claim,
Supported the usurper for his fame.
Again and once again the same case comes
Upon a world that cannot find in sums
Relief from wandering after pop stars.
The soul is covered with their searing scars.
I flee to You, Beloved, and follow him
Who walks unseen, unknown, unloved and
dim.

Psalm 143

1 A Psalm of David. Hear my prayer,
O YHWH, Give ear *and give Your care*

Unto my supplications! In
Your faithfulness answer my *din*,
And in Your righteousness. 2 Do not
Enter into judgement *unsought*
With Your servant, for in Your sight
No one living knows to do right.
**3 For the foe has pursued my soul,
He’s crushed my life into the hole,
He has made me live in darkness,
Like those who’ve long had death’s
address.**

4 Therefore my spirit’s overcome
Within me, my heart’s trouble’s sum.

**5 I remember the days of old,
I meditate on Your works *bold*,
I muse on the work of Your hands.**

6 I spread out my hands to Your *bands*,
My soul for You in thirsty lands.

Your own beloved, David, once prophesied
Of the foe who pursued a soul more wide
Than any known before, to crush the right
And slay the righteous ones in heaven’s
sight.

The words of David in my heart unblest
As I remember Karbela’s address.

I too spread out my hands from day to day
In supplication in the desert way,
And pray for water for the long dead child
Who once skipped on the sand upon the
wild.

My prayer’s too late, and yet I still repeat
The words, perhaps another child is mete
To gain the blessing spent upon the grate
When no salvation came, or came too late.

7 Answer me quickly, YHWH, for fails
My Spirit! Do not hide *with veils*
Your face from me, lest I be like
Those who go down beneath the strike.

**8 Cause me to hear Your loving-kindness
In the morning, for *in my blindness*
I trust in You, cause me to know
The way in which I ought to go,
For I lift up my soul to You.**

9 Deliver me from foe, O YHWH,
In You I take shelter, *I do*.

**10 Teach me to do Your will, for You
Are my God, Your spirit *is* good.
Lead me in upright land as should.**

11 Revive me, YHWH, for Your name's sake!
Bring my soul for Your righteous sake
Out of trouble. 12 In Your mercy
Cut off my every enemy,
And destroy all those who afflict
My soul, for I'm Your servant *picked*.

When sweet Husseyn this Psalm in
cantillation
Repeated before his annihilation,
Did he know the great sacrifice that he
Was called upon to raise and faithfully?
I think he did, and took in his free will
The weight and burden of a wicked hill.
When sweet Husseyn repeated these hard
words
Beneath a cloudless sky's unpitied birds,
Did he know that the arrow should find
well
Its mark upon a child? Yet into hell
He did not send the frightful enemy.
When sweet Husseyn walked on the sandy
lee,
He found these words his solace for all
grief.
Beloved, bind me to sweet Husseyn's
belief.

Psalm 144

1 A Psalm of David. Blessed *be* YHWH
My Rock, who trains my hands to do
War, *and* my fingers for battle,
2 My lovingkindness and my full
Fortress, my high tower and Saviour,
My shield and in whom I find store
Of refuge, who subdues my folk
Under me. 3 YHWH, what *is* man's *smoke*,
That You take knowledge of *the bloke*?
Or son of man, that You remember?
4 A man is like a breath *or* ember,
His days are like a passing shade.
5 Bow down Your heavens *that You have*
made,
O YHWH, and come down, touch the
hills,
And they shall smoke. 6 Flash forth *the*
drills
Of lightning and scatter them, shoot
Out Your arrows, destroy the brute.
7 Stretch out Your hand from above, and

Rescue and save me *on the land*
From out of great waters, from hand
Of strangers, 8 whose mouth speaks vain
words,
And whose right hand with falsehood girds.

You were a rock, Beloved, a fortress and
High tower and Saviour, shield of the
command.
And yet Man was a passing shade upon
Karbela's sand, a smoke and flash at dawn.
When Husseyn prayed for saving at Your
hand
To see Your arrows strike the stranger and
Rebuke the vain words and the false
remand,
He saw the vision of Your tears that flood
Euphrates with the sorrow of his blood.
He saw You bow the heavens at the stroke
And veil the angels' faces with a cloak.
I cover too my face today in grief
To see injustice pluck the fresh green leaf,
But hold fast to Karbela's firm belief.

9 I will sing a new song to You,
O Alohim, on harp construe
Ten strings to sing praises to You,
10 *The One* who gives salvation to
Kings, who delivers David His
Servant from deadly sword that is.

**11 Rescue me and deliver me
From the hand of the enemy,
Strangers, whose mouth speaks lying
words,
And whose right hand with falsehood
girds,**

**12 That our sons *may be* as plants grown
Up in their youth, our daughters *shown*
As pillars, sculptured in the style
Of palaces, 13 That our barns' *pile*
Be full, supplying great produce,
That our sheep may bring forth, unloose
Thousands and ten thousands in fields,
14 Our oxen well-laden in yields,
No breaking in or going out,
No outcry in our streets about.**
15 Happy *are* the people who are
In such a state, and happy *are*
The people whose God's YHWH *by far!*

When Husseyn prayed this prayer he
 sought
 A blessing on his lovely children taught.
 The enemy was all around and vied
 To slaughter mother and the child that
 cried.
 But in the midst of slaughter Husseyn died
 With prayers for his own children on his
 lips.
 He prayed that they might be kept from the
 slips
 That felled the others on the river edge.
 He prayed they might be pillars in the
 wedge,
 And palaces abundant with the rich
 Divine guidance to keep all from the ditch.
 As plants green in the field his children lay
 Down in their death, and yet his prayer held
 sway
 In Ali's praises to Your name today.

Psalm 145

1 A Praise of David. I'll extol
 You, my God, O King, and my soul
 Will bless Your name as seasons roll.
**2 And every day I will bless You,
 And praise Your name as always true.**
 3 Great is YHWH, greatly to be praised,
 Unsearchably His greatness *raised*.
**4 One generation shall praise Your
 Works to another come before,
 And shall declare Your mighty acts.**
 5 I will meditate on the facts
 Of Your majesty's glorious splendour,
 Your wondrous works *as a defender*.
**6 Earth shall speak of Your awesome
 acts
 Of might, and I'll declare impacts
 Of Your greatness. 7 The memory
 Of Your great goodness they'll decree,
 And shall sing of Your righteousness.**
 8 YHWH is gracious and full to *bless*
With His compassion, slow to be
In anger and great in mercy.
**9 YHWH is good to all, and His tender
 Mercies are on all His works render.**

Above the bloody fields of world and strife
 Rises the splendour of the divine life
 That overcomes like dandelion clay

And concrete spread upon the glowing
 way.
 Beloved, I seek the glory above all
 The truant places where good men may fall
 Beneath the cutting blades of hopeless vent.
 I seek the paths where Hussein once was
 sent.
 The silence of the morning greets the flood
 Of what at evening filled the earth with
 blood,
 And year on year opens the lips to spell
 Renewal of the faith the stones must tell.
 Beloved, above the wrath Your mercy
 shines,
 Beyond death resurrection draws its lines.

10 All Your works shall praise You, O
 YHWH,
 And Your saints shall *surely* bless You.
**11 They'll speak the glory of Your reign,
 And talk of Your power in refrain,
 12 To make known to the sons of men
 His mighty acts, and glorious pen
 Of majesty throughout His reign.**
 13 Your kingdom *is* everlasting
 And Your dominion *everything*
 Throughout all generations' ring.
**14 YHWH upholds all who fall, and
 raises
 Up all who are bowed down with praises.**
 15 Expectantly the eyes of all
 Look to You, and You give *at call*
 Them their food in due season's *fall*.
**16 You open Your hand, satisfy
 The desire of each living guy.**
 17 YHWH *is* righteous in all His ways,
 Gracious in all the works He *lays*.
**18 YHWH's near to all who call on Him,
 To all in truth who call on Him.**
 19 He will fulfil the desire of
 Those who fear Him, also *in love*
 He will hear their cry and save them.
**20 YHWH preserves all who take His
 hem
 With love, but all the wicked He
 Will destroy. 21 My mouth shall agree
 To speak the praise of YHWH, all flesh
 Shall bless His holy name afresh.**

Your saints come to bless Your name with
 their lives

And with the blood that in this world
 contrives
 To bear the witness to Your law and throne.
 Your saints come to bless You with heart
 and bone.
 All flesh must bless Your name indeed, the
 wight
 Winged despots as well as the sons of light.
 All flesh must come again before the face
 Of every face after the darkened chase.
 Beloved, desire rises to You alone
 And scratches its petitions on the stone
 Of Karbela until Your hand is filed
 Against the wickedness irreconciled,
 Until all evil things fail in the lamp
 Of living and go down into the damp.

Psalm 146

1 Praise YHWH! Praise YHWH, O my
 soul, praise!
 2 While I live I'll praise YHWH, I'll raise
 Praises to my God while I've being.
**3 Do not put your trust in the *seeing*
Of princes, nor in son of man,
*In whom there is no help nor can.***
 4 His spirit departs, he returns
 To his earth, in that way he learns
 That very day all his plan burns.
**5 Happy is he who has the God
 Of Jacob for his help and prod,
 Whose hope is in YHWH his Exalted,**
 6 Who made heaven and earth *unfaulted*,
 The sea, and all that *is* in them,
 Who keeps truth forever *a gem*,
 7 Who executes justice for the
 Oppressed, who gives food to hungry.
 YHWH gives freedom to prisoners.
**8 YHWH opens the eyes of blind fers,
 YHWH raises those who are bowed
 down,**
YHWH loves the righteous in the town.
 9 YHWH watches over the strangers,
 He relieves the fatherless and
 Widow, but the way of the hand
 Of the wicked He turns around.
**10 YHWH shall reign always, and your
 God,
 O Zion, to all on the sod
 Of earth for generations due.
 Praise YHWH! Again I say, praise
 YHWH!**

Put not your trust in princes, so You say,
 Beloved, then show the world another way.
 If Son of Man saves none for all his
 crosses,
 At least leave us our kings and union
 bosses.
 Do You say no? Then what a
 disappointment
 In Palestine it is a vain anointment
 To crucify a man! It won't set right
 The wrongs of any world or woe for spite.
 But that is all a prince can think to do.
 I set things right by whirling, crying Huu!
 If any man think such an act is vain,
 Then let him see what bombing does for
 gain.

I put my trust in You, Beloved, in whom
 I care not whether there's a grace or doom.

Psalm 147

1 Praise YHWH! For *it is* good to sing
 Praise to our God in pleasant ring,
And praise is beautiful. 2 YHWH builds
 Up Jerusalem, gathers guilds
 Of the outcasts of Israel.
**3 He heals the brokenhearted well
 And binds up their wounds by a spell.**
 4 He tells the number of the stars;
 He calls them by their names *and bars*.
**5 Great is our Lord, and great His
 power,
 His understanding hour by hour.**
 6 YHWH raises up the meek, He throws
 The wicked on the ground *in rows*.
**7 Sing to YHWH with thanksgiving's
 voice,
 Sing praise on harp to Alohim,
 8 Who covers skies with clouds of choice,
 Prepares the rain for earthly stream,
 Who makes grass on the mountains
 team.**
 9 He gives to every beast its food,
 To the young calling ravens' brood.
**10 He delights in the horse's strength,
 Though none in a man's legs at length.**

Though I do not share Your passion to see
 The horses racing round the track to be
 The object of men's bets and fights and
 flights,

I understand Your disdain at the sights
 Of men who try to run a race as well.
 I also deride human flies at spell.
 Instead of horses, I consider best
 The jumping grasshopper, from east to west
 The winner of gold medals for its feats
 In jumping far more body-lengths for treats
 Than any man can dream of. I like those,
 Beloved, more than the animals You chose.
 I sit with the grasshopper on the leaf
 To listen to Your word beyond belief.

11 YHWH takes pleasure in those who fear
 Him, and hope in His mercy's *gear*.

**12 Praise YHWH, Jerusalem, and praise
 Your Alohim, fortress and maze.**

13 He's strengthened the locks on your
 gates,

He's blessed your children in their states.

**14 He makes peace of your borders, fills
 You with the finest wheat in bills.**

15 He sends out on the earth His laws,
 His word runs quickly *on its paws*.

**16 He gives snow like wool, He spreads
 out**

The hoarfrost like ashes about.

17 He casts forth ice like bits and pieces,
 Who can stand where His cold increases?

**18 He sends out commands and they
 melt,**

**He makes His wind blow helter-skelter,
 And the water flows and releases.**

19 He shows His word to Jacob and
 His statutes and judgements still stand
 In Israel's sight *as He has planned*.

**20 He's not dealt so with any nation,
 And judgements, they've not known the
 ration.**

**And so praise YHWH. And so praise
 YHWH.**

No other nation has received the plot
 Of Your law in the total memory slot.
 Rather among the Gentiles some men rise
 Alone to witness of Your mercy's guise.
 Your Scriptures have been kept in quiet
 need
 By Jacob and Abraham's dearest seed.
 For this I praise Your name, Beloved, and
 say
 That the treasure vouchsafed becomes a ray

To every nation, those within Your pay
 And those also who long have gone astray.
 Beloved, I come of every nation, I
 In whose veins every blood runs and to vie,
 Of every nation but the one You chose.
 I still take my place in the hallowed rows.

Psalms 148

1 Praise YHWH! Praise YHWH from skies
 above,

Praise Him in heights! 2 Praise Him *in
 love,*

All His angels, praise Him, and all
 His hosts! 3 Praise Him, sun diurnal
 And moon, praise Him, all you stars of
 Light! 4 Praise Him, you the heavens
 above,

And you waters above the skies!

**5 Let them praise YHWH's name, *who
 are wise,***

**For He commanded and they were
 Created and the lovelier.**

**6 He also established them there
 Forever and ever, a fair
 Decree He made that shall not pass.**

Eternity is a word beyond match.
 I wonder if the Psalmist at the latch
 Intends to invoke all of that in catch.
 If not eternity for sun and moon,
 If not for ever under light of noon,
 If time does not place anything in boon,
 At least I am certain that by Your word
 All things are once created and then stirred.
 Beloved, I praise Your word because I am
 A syllable upon Your earthly cam,
 Established for eternity to blow
 A moment here beneath the love and show
 Of summer fleeting out toward its death,
 Of grace in perpetration of a breath.

7 Praise YHWH from the earth, you great
 sea

Creatures and all the depths *that be*,
 8 Fire and hail, snow and clouds, and wind
 Of storm fulfilling *disciplined*
 His word, 9 mountains and all the hills,
 Fruitful trees, all cedars *with skills*,
 10 Beasts and all cattle, creeping things
 And flying fowl, 11 and earthly kings
 And all peoples, princes and all

Judges of the earth *at their call*,
12 Both young men and maidens, old men
And children. 13 Let them praise again
The name of YHWH, His name alone
Is exalted, His glory's known
Above the earth and heaven shown.

**14 And He has exalted the horn
Of His people, the praises born
Of all His saints, of Israel's folk,
A people near to Him that spoke
"Praise YHWH! Praise YHWH!" and
Him invoke.**

Hanna, the mom of Samuel in her day
Made the first prophecy of horn in sway.
After that time the horn arose to be
The sign of Your anointed on the spree
As well as sign of power infernal where
Men made their empires on the empty air.
Let Your horn and appointed rule my life,
Deliver me from all imperial strife.
Beloved, I see the fruitful tree, the till
Of cattle lowing, and sheep on the hill,
The wealth of earth come from Your power
and hand

And seeing, try again to understand
What worth is in Your word in silence
spoken,
A gauge of right and wrong and beauty's
token.

Psalm 149

1 Praise YHWH! Sing to YHWH a new
song,

His praise in congregation long,
Where saints 2 of Israel rejoice,
And Zion's children lend their voice
With joyful praises in their King.

**3 Let them praise His name *high and
sharp***

**With dancing, let them praises sing
To Him with the timbrel and harp.**

4 For YHWH takes pleasure in His folk,
He'll beautify salvation's cloak
For every humble one *and broke*.

**5 Let the saints be joyful in glory,
And sing aloud in beds their story.**

6 Let high praises of Alohim
Be in their mouth, and *like a stream*,
A two-edged sword held in their hand,
7 To work vengeance on every land

And nation, punishing the people
8 To bind kings with chains *under steeple*
And their nobles with iron fetters,
9 Executing on them *their betters'*
Written judgment. This honour all
His saints have to praise YHWH withal!

Grandfather used to say to me aloud,
"Sing at the table and sing in the bed,
The bugger man will get you 'fore you're
dead!"

I come out of this childish fear like cloud
To hear You say that I can sing aloud
In bed and out. You are more modest far
Than audiences today and their star.
They do not tolerate the couch
performance,
With rare exception in an opera dormance.
You, on the other hand, accept the voice
That I may have with or without my choice,
And welcome song both standing and
inclined.

Indeed Your tolerance is rare, I find.
Beloved, in this I quietly rejoice.

Psalm 150

1 Praise YHWH! Praise Alohim in His
Own sanctuary, praise in His
Great firmament! 2 Praise Him for His
Great acts, praise Him according to
His excellent greatness! 3 Praise Him
With sound of trumpet, and praise Him
With the lute and the harp! 4 Praise Him
With timbrel and the dance, praise Him
With stringed instruments and flutes too!

**5 Praise Him with cymbals loud, praise
Him**

**With clashing cymbals! 6 Let all things
That have breath praise YHWH yes,
praise YHWH!**

All things with breath *and feet or wings!*

Beloved, the instruments of great and good
Tell praises to Your name as well they
should.

My instrument of praise is only breath
That comes and goes each moment in the
death

And life that keeps me in Your well-praised
heart.

While men and angels praise You with
 great art,
 I only have, like ten beads on a string,
 Ten syllables in feeble praise that ring
 No longer than one breath and then are still.
 And yet my vanishing pearls come to fill
 My praises with the shy saints of the field
 And forest where lone dervish lifts a shield.
 Beloved, You hear my praise of You as I
 Breathe waking or asleep beneath the sky.

Psalm 151

1 Among my brothers, I was small,
 In Father's house youngest of all,
 And I tended my father's sheep.
**2 My hands made me a harp to keep,
 My fingers fashioned me a lyre.**
 3 And whose is the ardent desire
 To declare the thing to my Lord?
 The Lord Himself is He who hears.
**4 He sent His messenger like sword
 And took me from my father's sheep,
 Anointing me above my peers
 With the anointing oil and deep.**
 5 My brothers were handsome and tall,
 But them YHWH was not pleased *to call*.
**6 I went to meet the Philistine,
 Who cursed me by his gods and wine.**
 7 But I laid hand on his own sword,
 Beheaded *in name of the Lord*,
 Removed reproach from Israel's vine.

Beloved, how You loved David with his
 sheep!
 I see the boy by day and in my sleep
 I dream his melodies above the fields.
 I hear the sting of stone in sling he wields
 As well as the bright sounds of harp and
 lyre.
 He picks up sword in both hands when You
 speak
 To tell him what new and strange song to
 seek.
 The love of David sets my heart on fire
 And so I join You, my Beloved, in this
 Passion for David in both dark and bliss.
 Eternal throne of David stands beneath
 Your footstool, my Beloved, upon the
 heath,
 And all around the swallows swoop to hear,
 The silver notes he sings fall on the ear.

How many Davids are there in Your way,
 Beloved, before the sinking of the day?
 The one whose name is found only by half
 In the claim of archaeologic staff,
 The one who graced Damascus with his
 magic
 To entertain with comic and with tragic,
 The one who founded twelve convents to
 keep
 The Sabbath by prayers day and night and
 weep
 And praise Your name with work like ox
 and prayer,
 All three breathe on me life and faith from
 where
 Their witness still remains from Palestine
 As far as lack of Cambrian grog and wine.
 Beloved, let this be now my trinity,
 Dawid, Dawud, Saint David on their spree!

Kaddish

Be magnified and sanctified
 His great name in the *whole world wide*
 Which by His will He does create.

**May He establish in its state
 His kingdom in your life and days,**
 In the life of all in the ways
 Of God's house, even speedily
 And at a near time may it be,
 And say all truly "Let it be."

**Let His great name be blessed indeed
 Forever and always succeed.**

Blessed, praised and glorified, exalted,
 Extolled and honoured *and unfaulted*
 Be magnified and lauded too
 The name of the Holy One who
 Be blessed, though He be high above
 All blessings and hymns, praises' *love*,
 And consolations which are spoken
 In the world, say Amen *as token*.

**May there be peace abundantly
 For us and for each and every
 Prince of God, and say "May it be."**
 He who makes peace in His high places,
 May He make peace for us and *faces*
Of every prince of God and know
 To say each one "May it be so."

Beloved, I speak with faltering, failing
 tongue

The ancient words for many centuries sung
For Your praise in the lands where they far-
flung
Have been heard in both hoping and in
sorrow.

This morning I repeat them, and tomorrow
May I again recite the praiseful store.
I follow the sweet syllable through door
And gate of law onto the loving shore
That looks up into Your high places' peace.
May that Islam I see there never cease,
But bring all people into its submission,
So that as You are One by definition
And by Your essence, so may mankind be
One in Your reflected eternity.

The Book of Proverbs

The bulky book of Proverbs mostly runs
In fancy tunes proclaimed as Solomon's.
The latter part has other names for fun.
Whoever penned these words of wisdom
here

Deserves a toast and many thanks for
cheer.

The Jews in Jamnia thought the heavenly
host

Was good enough to make the canon's
boast

Of sacred Scripture. Who am little I
To come so lately and boldly deny?
Let Wisdom build her house of seven trees
Supporting royal faith under the breeze
Of timely doctrines out to fill and freeze,
I find the wisdom as a little word,
Not as a mistress wife of Sophia stirred.

Proverbs 1

1 The proverbs of Solomon son
Of David, king of Israel *spun*.
2 To know wisdom and instruction,
To perceive words of understanding,
3 To receive the instruction landing
From wisdom, justice and judgement,
And equity *in what is sent*,
4 To give subtlety to the simple,
To the young man *still with a dimple*
Knowledge and discretion *for pimple*.
5 The wise will hear and will increase

His learning, and a man release
His understanding to attain
To the wise counsels *not in vain*.
6 To understand a proverb, and
The interpretations that stand,
The words of the wise and dark sayings
That they have left in their relayings.

I'm not sure that the sayings are so dark.
Proverbs are easy when they hit the mark.
Yet some interpretations might arise
From ambiguity among the wise.
I've noticed often that the texts of those
Who write on their account in prophet's
pose

Are often capable of twist and throes,
In contrast to the Decalogue that rose
In quiet dignity and without fail,
Not easy to misunderstand, like kale.
A child of eight can tell the common sense
Of what the Decalogue means without
dents,

It's only prophecies of men require
A wise head to avoid the mud and mire.

7 The fear of YHWH starts knowledge out;
Fools despise wisdom without doubt
And instruction *like any clout*.

8 My son, hear your father's instruction,
And do not leave mother's induction.

9 They'll be fine jewels upon your head
And necklaces *of gold instead*.

10 My son, if sinners tempt you, do
Not consent *to follow their cue*.

11 If they say, come, let's wait for blood
To ambush innocent in mud,

12 Let's swallow them alive as in
The grave, and whole, as those in bin:

13 We'll gain all precious things and fill
Our houses with spoil *in the till*.

Join us and keep a common purse.

15 My son do not join them for worse,
Keep your foot from the path *of curse*.

16 For their feet run an evil way
Quickly to shed blood *as for pay*.

17 Surely in vain the net is spread
While birds are watching for the dread.

18 They lie in wait for their own blood,
They lurk in secret for a dud.

19 So are the ways of everyone
Who's greedy for gain on the bun,

And takes away the life of son.

Solomon's thought that pure knowledge
must rust
Into applied technology in dust
Of bloody lying in wait for the kill
Is apt upon this democratic hill,
Where rule of the majority in fact
Is law of jungle when the lobby's tracked.
It's quite another thing, after the view
Clear-eyed of our reality and true,
To say that all would be cured in the pew
If pure knowledge itself started in fear
Of what You, my Beloved, think and hold
dear.

I side-tracked all the power play when I
Started as a youth to be smart to vie,
And now just enjoy knowledge like a pie.

20 Wisdom is crying out of doors,
She sends her voice along the stores.
21 She shouts at the cross-roads and in
The openings of the gates' spin,
She speaks her words in city's din.
22 How long, you simple ones, will you
Wallow in simplicity's pew?
And scorners delight in their scorning,
And fools hate knowledge *for adorning*?
23 Repent at my reproof, behold,
I'll pour my spirit on you bold,
I'll make known my words in your fold.
24 Because I've called, and you refused,
I've stretched out my hand, all abused,
25 But you from my words are aloof,
You'll have nothing of my reproof.
26 So I'll laugh at calamity,
I'll mock when your fear comes to be.
27 When your fear comes as desolation,
And your destruction as elation,
When distress and trouble find you.
28 Then they'll call me, I'll not give clue,
They'll seek me early, without view.
29 Because they hated knowledge and
Did not choose the fear of YHWH's hand.

Your Decalogue has cried in public places
Since Sinai thundered in our frightened
faces,
And yet there's not a single sect that bides
All ten of Your commandments on their
sides.

I don't say that the earthquake and the fire
Are punishment from You in Your desire,
But by these words of Solomon I rate
The human question why as simple plate.
It's no use to ask why, when no one
troubles
To follow Your advice while chasing
bubbles.
Beloved, I look around catastrophe
And fail to ask why things happen to me.
Instead I ask the better question why
Do I and mine let Your commands pass by.

30 They would have nothing of my
counsel.
They despised all my reproof's *pounce*.
31 That's why they'll eat the fruit they've
planted,
And be filled with their own ways *slanted*.
32 Stupid folk will fall in their own
Stupidity and fools shall *groan*
Destroyed by their prosperity.
33 But those who take heed to my *voice*
Shall live in safety *by their choice*,
Free from fear of evil *degree*.

The world's prosperity today is greater
Than ever before, though it did come later.
It's based on military industry:
Destruction making room for goods in
spree,
And selling fear, whose market's never
flooded
Like that of wheat and corn by the cold-
blooded.
Experiment of Soviets was perfected,
That military spending once deflected
Could destroy all by its prosperity,
And so it's now expanded sea to sea.
Not content with the profit of mere apples
Plucked in Eden, we now need more in
grapples,
The bombs and missiles that line pocket-
books
Destroy the world except elitist nooks.

Proverbs 2

1 My son, if you'll receive my words,
And hide my commandments *in sherds*
With you; 2 So you incline your ear
To wisdom, and your heart *with fear*

To understanding, 3 if you cry
 After knowledge and lift your eye
 To understanding, 4 if you seek
 Her as silver and search *the bleak*
 For her as for treasures to view,
 5 Then you shall grasp the fear of YHWH,
 And find knowledge of Alohim.
 6 For YHWH gives wisdom, from His
 tongue
 Knowledge and understanding's sung.

The commandments that You once spoke
 aloud
 On Mount Sinai before the waiting crowd
 Are wisdom to be sought with mind and
 heart,
 As though of silver wrought, a treasured
 part.
 The fair commandments hidden in the
 room
 Of inner self delighting in their bloom
 Are fruited with the fear of You to know
 The knowledge from Your tongue that was
 not slow
 To be the thunder and the lightning round
 Mount Sinai running all along the ground.
 Beloved, I grasp the Decalogue in state
 Of wisdom and find knowledge on the
 plate,
 And understanding of the sum of days,
 Revealed and polished in Your name and
 praise.

7 He keeps salvation for the just,
 A shield for those who walk the dust
 In the perfection *of His trust*.
 8 He guards the paths of justice and
 Preserves the way of His saints' band.
 9 Then you shall understand the just,
 And judgement and equity's must,
 Indeed, every good path *uncurst*.
 10 When wisdom comes into your heart,
 And knowledge is your pleasant part,
 11 Discretion shall preserve your way,
 Understanding save from astray,
 12 To save you from the evil man,
 From the one speaking in the span
 Of scornfulness *as though by plan*
 13 Who leaves the paths of uprightness
 To walk in the ways of darkness;
 14 Rejoicing to do evil things,

Delighting in the wicked rings;
 15 Whose ways are crooked, they
 themselves
 In their paths mischievous *as elves*.

The Decalogue is wisdom of the sort
 That saves a man from punishment at court
 By showing the right way to come to port.
 No king stands against order and the way
 Of keeping one's hand from attack and
 sway.
 But beyond safety from one's own foul
 acts,
 The Decalogue preserves from evil pacts,
 From scornful and the robber on the day
 They come out from their tents to run and
 play.
 Beloved, I flee to Your commandments
 now
 From the scornful that rake against my
 brow
 Both words and deeds of evil at the plough.
 I see their grand rejoicing come to naught,
 The shadow fall on their delight in plot.

16 It saves you from the strange woman,
 The stranger flattering by her plan;
 17 Who forsakes the guide of her youth,
 Forgetting her Allah *of truth*.
 18 For her dwelling inclines to death,
 Her ways to the shades without breath.
 19 None that go to her shall return
 To take hold of what life's paths earn,
 20 That you may walk in the good way,
 And keep in righteous paths to stray.
 21 The upright shall live in the land,
 The perfect shall come there to stand.
 22 The wicked are cut off from earth,
 Transgressors rooted out of berth.

Solomon has in mind above all things
 The problems that come to both chiefs and
 kings
 From devious women with their lights and
 strings.
 At one thousand, I guess experience knows
 Enough to keep a man well on his toes.
 But these false wenches that he fears are
 those
 Who are not wives or concubines in rows,
 But harlots taking in the secret dark

The whole queue waiting her outside the park.

Beloved, no doubt king Solomon is right
That living on the land is for upright,
And perfect ones shall be the ones who stand.

No doubt the song is true the wicked men
Shall be cut off, uprooted from the den.

Proverbs 3

1 My son, do not forget my law,
But keep my commandments in awe.
2 For length of days and for long life,
And peace they shall give *without strife*.
3 Don't let mercy and truth forsake,
Tie them around your neck and take
Their writing on Your heart *for stake*.
4 Then you'll find favour understood
In sight of Alohim and *good*
Men. 5 Trust in YHWH with all your heart,
Do not depend on your own part.
6 In all your ways acknowledge Him,
He shall direct your paths *not dim*.
7 Do not be wise in your own eyes,
Fear YHWH, and evil things despise.
8 It shall be health to body and
Relief to your bones *when you stand*.

Why not forget Your law, Beloved, and
why

Keep Your commandments in awe on the
sly?

The law that Solomon and wisdom speak
Is the same law I read from week to week,
The spoken from Sinai, the written fair
In scrolls of Moses, I see Your law there.
Some bind the sacred word on forehead and
Some tie them to the fingers of left hand,
Some then encapsulate them at the door.
But here You say to hang them out in score
As a gold necklace and a pendant's mate.
So many are the ways to keep Your slate.
For my part I delight and most of all
To keep them in my heart on fleshly wall.

9 Honour YHWH with your strength of
gear,

And the firstfruits *of every year*:

10 So your barns will be filled and fine,
Your presses gush with the new wine.

11 My son do not despise the rod

Of YHWH, nor tire upon the sod
From His correction: *He is God*.

12 The one YHWH loves He will instruct,
Just as a father will induct

The son in whom his delight's tucked.

13 Ashrei Adam matza khokhmah,
Blessed is the man in wisdom's claw,
The man able to understand.

14 Such things bought are better than grand
Items of silver and the gain

Of it's better than fine gold's skein.

15 She's more precious than rubies' stone,
All things desired cannot atone.

16 Length of days is in her right hand,
In her left riches, honour stand.

17 Her ways are ways of pleasantness,
And all her paths their peace confess.

The ancient folk thought that to honour
You

It was enough to bring a goat in view
And slit its throat and flay the shaggy skin,
Then make a feast and dance with kith and
kin.

The slaying of a goat is something nice
For those on holiday and thinking twice.
Your pedagogy is in wisdom's claw,
Not in the satisfying of the maw.

The words You teach on how to live the
life

Of herd and yeast without the struggle's
strife

Are finer than the wealth I do not get
For meditating on Your words I've met
And writing quaint rejoinders on the set.
Maybe I ought to buy myself a fife.

18 She is a tree of life to them
That lay hand holding on her hem,
And blessed are they that stay in stem.

19 YHWH by wisdom founded the earth,
By understanding set the girth
Of heaven. 20 By His knowledge the deep
Is broken up, the clouds fly steep
To drop down the dew *where they creep*.

21 My son, do not let them depart
From your eyes, keep within your heart
Sound wisdom and discretion's *part*.

22 So shall they be life to your soul,
And grace to your neck *as in toll*.

23 Then you shall walk in safety's way,

Your foot not to stumble or stray.
 24 When you lie down, you shall not fear,
 You shall lie down until appear
 Sweetness of sleep *on eye and ear*.
 25 Don't be afraid of sudden fear,
 Of wicked desolation's tear,
 When it comes. 26 For YHWH shall be
 your
 Confidence and keep foot in store
 From being taken. 27 Don't withhold
 The good from those to whom it's due,
 When it is in your power to do.
 28 Don't tell your neighbour, "Go and
 come
 Again tomorrow for the sum,"
 When you have got it not yet sold.

It is a childish thing to say I'll lend
 Tomorrow, when today I need not spend
 The wealth in store that could feed and
 clothe those
 That stand there waiting in their patient
 rows.
 The sudden fear comes on the populace
 Despite Your ardent expressions of grace.
 Ten thousand churches are initiate
 In Africa, some better than the great,
 And still the famine strikes the fevered
 land.
 Beloved, hold out a full and helping hand,
 Be it the hand of charity that winces
 Or hand of angels sent as one convinces.
 Let me withhold no good that I can do,
 Whether in field or market or in pew.

29 Don't invent wicked things to do
 To your neighbour, who lives by you.
 30 Don't quarrel with a man in vain,
 If he has done no harm *or stain*.
 31 Do not envy oppressors' days,
 But be sure not to choose his ways.
 32 The perverse man's abomination
 To YHWH, but righteous ones in station
 Recognize him *by his relation*.
 33 The curse of YHWH is on the house
 Of the wicked, both man and spouse,
 But He blesses the habitation
 Of the just people *in the nation*.
 34 He scorns indeed the scorners' rate,
 But gives grace to lowly estate.
 35 The wise shall inherit the glory,

But shame shall be the fools' last story.

It is, no doubt, a waste of time for me
 To invent wicked things to do in spree
 Against the fools that provoke in degree
 Above forbearance in my neighbourhood.
 Since I never fulfil my plans, no good
 Comes of the habit. Quarrelling though
 bides.

I'm glad You allow quarrelling when he
 Has done some harm in actuality.
 The only quarrelling You would avoid
 Is when the neighbour is one overjoyed
 To fail in real harm. So I'm glad to rate
 Some harsh words on the wicked, roiling
 pate.

The way of the oppressor's not to fuss:
 He is conniving, not a blunderbuss.

Proverbs 4

1 Hear, children, a father's instruction,
 Attend understanding's deduction.
 2 For I give you good teaching, draw
 Not back from keeping then my law.
 3 I was my father's son, unique
 And tender for my mom to seek.
 4 He taught me also, and told me,
 Let your heart continue to see
 My words and keep my commandments,
 And so you'll come to live *with sense*.
 5 Get wisdom and get understanding,
 And don't forget the reprimanding
 From my mouth. 6 Do not forsake her,
 And she shall preserve you, love her
 And she shall keep you safe and sure.

When David transmitted the faithful word
 To Solomon, he did so with heart stirred
 To found a dynasty of lawfulness
 That should come to all ages and to bless
 All humankind, though only those few that
 In every time and place came in and sat
 Around the teaching of commandments
 bold
 In Decalogue and in the Psalms are sold
 And in the Proverbs more precious than
 gold.
 Beloved, I take the son of David here
 And turn against the throng that would
 appear
 To go the other way. I find a place

Among the canopied couches and trace
Among the few the teachings of his race.

7 Wisdom's the principal thing, get
Wisdom, and with all getting set
Out to find understanding met.
8 Exalt her, and she'll promote you,
She'll bring you honour in your due,
When you embrace her *and her clue*.
9 She'll give your head a jewel of grace,
A crown of glory set in place.
10 Hear, my son, and receive my sayings,
Your life's years shall be many *strayings*.
11 I have taught you in wisdom's way,
I've set you in right paths to stay.
12 When you walk, your steps will be firm,
And when you run, you'll come to term.
13 Hold fast instruction, don't let go,
Keep her, for she's your life *in show*.
14 Don't go into the wicked path,
Nor in the way of evil *wrath*.
15 Avoid it, don't go near the way,
Turn aside from going astray.

At twelve years of age the teacher asked us
What we would like to be with age and
fuss,

And others wanted to be farmers and
Scientists or businessmen in the land.
I only caused a consternation when
I said I'd be the wisest of all men.
I did not know then what a task I meant,
Excluded from all livelihood and bent
To seek wisdom both human and divine.
I've lived to learn the meaning of the line.
The wisdom that I sought left me bereft
Of all I thought I knew, till I had left
No shred of knowledge but still clung to
You,
With wisdom out of reach but still in view.

16 They do not sleep till they have done
Some evil mischief on the run,
They lie awake and cannot sleep,
Till they cause some to fall down deep.
17 They eat the bread of wickedness,
And drink the wine of violence.
18 The path of the just's in the dress
Of shining light, increasing vents
Until the perfect day *confess*.
19 The wicked was is as darkness,

They trip on unfamiliar tents.

The bread of wickedness is small and
round,
A little wafer of white to be found
Upon the altar where the wine is set
To turn to blood as soon as tinkling fret
Of bells proclaims the sweetness and the
foul.

Ah! Paganism's so refined a jowl
Since pedicidal sacrifice relents
To substitutions in church and convents!
Does Your wise man, Beloved, mean to say
here

That even bread and wine taken in cheer
Is unacceptable as sacrifice
Of human beings on Baal's good advice?
Beloved, Your attitude is arrogant
And bigoted. Tolerate Protestant.

20 My son, take heed to what I say,
Incline your ear to hear my way.
21 Don't let them depart from your eyes,
Keep them in your heart and apprise.

22 They're life to those who find them
fresh,

And health to them and all their flesh.

23 Keep your heart with all diligence,
For from it life issues *with sense*.

24 Put off from you a perverse mouth,
And unjust lips cast to the south.

25 Let your eyes look right on, and let
Your eyelids see straight to the set.

26 Ponder the path of your feet and
Let all your ways be set to stand.

27 Don't turn to the right hand or left,
Remove your foot from evil *cleft*.

Sometimes the health or wealth of me or
mine

Are in such state to keep me on the vine
Awake, or sometimes something fresh in
mind,

A joy of a discovery and refined
Keeps slumber from my eyes as memory
turns.

I've never yet experienced such burns
That the desire to do some damage earns.
I'll take it on trust such souls have their
urns.

Beloved, let me not turn to left or right

Of Your commandments seen in a clear
light
Of eight small negatives and two things
more:
Remembering Your name at Sabbath's
door,
And honouring my mom and dad a score.
Otherwise let me put up a good fight.

Proverbs 5

1 My son, attend to my wisdom,
Bow ear to understanding's sum,
2 That you may regard discretion,
Your lips keep knowledge *in the sun*.
3 The lips of a strange woman show
Sweet drops as from honeycomb's *flow*,
Her mouth is smoother than oil's *go*.
4 Her end is bitter as wormwood,
As sharp as a two-edged sword could.
5 Her mincing feet go down to death,
Her steps take hold on hell *for breath*,
6 To keep you from thinking things straight
About life, she moves at a rate,
Not to be known in any state.

Flavoured and scented lipstick's nothing
new,

It was around with Solomon and crew,
And so was a good metaphor defined
In contrast to the better end in mind.
It's not the lipstick in itself that takes
The young man from the right path to the
lakes

Of his destruction, but the fact that he
Follows a lady that's not his to be.
Who knows was sicknesses arose back then
Among the gallant partners and her men,
But now at least the promise is one true
That death awaits the joining of her crew,
The institution itself still prevents
People from thinking clearly and with
sense.

7 Hear me now then, children and do
Not depart from my words in clue.
8 Take a route that avoids the grouse,
Don't come near the door of her house,
9 Or others shall receive your glory,
And your years end in cruel story.
10 Strangers will be filled with your
wealth,

You'll work in foreign towns with stealth.
11 You'll mourn at last when your flesh
and
Your body are consumed like brand.
12 You'll say "Why did I hate the hand
That taught me, why was my heart hard
Against reproof, and has not starved
Obeying what my teachers said,
Why was my ear to them not led
That once poured wisdom in my head?"
14 I was on verge of full destruction
Before church and synagogue's *ruction*.

Assemblies do have the affect upon
The young brought up in safety of the dawn
That they are not impressed by warning
spoken,

Simply because the danger's just a token.
It hasn't been seen with the eye that glows
Upon reality, instead the shows
Of entertainment give the thing a twink.
Besides that, children don't know how to
think.

When I was in school, though, they brought
in dolls

To show how filth and blackness joins the
stalls

Of those who smoke. Perhaps a doll that's
choked

With syphilis would be better than yoked,
And something in reply when young folks
joked.

Churches and synagogues live under palls.

15 Drink water from your own dug well
And streams from your own springs to tell.

16 Let your fountains be scattered round,
Rivers upon the streets and ground.

17 Let them be only of your own,
And without strangers be alone.

18 May your fountain be blessed and glad
With the wife as a youth you had.

19 The loving hind and pleasant roe,
Let her breasts be enough in row,
Be ravished with her love and stow.

20 Why will you, my son, be attracted
By a strange woman and enacted
With the bosom of stranger's fare,
When such is found near everywhere?

21 The ways of man before YHWH's eyes,
Of all his goings He is wise.

22 His own iniquities shall take
The wicked himself, for his sake,
He shall be bound with cords of sin.
23 He'll die without instruction's din,
And in the greatness of his folly
He'll go astray *from right, by golly*.

My well is really beautiful beneath
The ancient lilacs growing there in wreath.
The hundreds of blue eyes that Scylla
makes

Around the flowing spring within me
wakes

No fear at all. Charybdis it appears
Has long since gone away. I have no fears.
The water's sweet in my own well and I
Refused the pipes the city on the sly
At last brought past our property and by
The highway that sends people on the fly.
Beloved, my own well is enough in view
In summer under morning coats of dew
On lady's mantle, and in winter's dress
When humps of snow make the well's site
a guess.

Proverbs 6

1 My son, if you have undersigned
A note for a friend, and resigned
Agreed to be the surety
Of a stranger and pay his fee,
2 You're snared in the words of your
mouth,
You're taken up by your own mouth.
3 So do this, my son, save yourself,
When you're caught by the hand of elf,
Go, humble yourself and make sure
Your friend *works hard to pay the cure*.
4 Do not give sleep to your eyes then
Or take your rest *among his men*.
5 Save yourself like a deer that runs,
Like a bird from the fowler's *buns*.
6 Go to the ant, you lazy man,
Consider her ways and her plan.
7 She has no guide or overseer,
Or ruler, but she is the freer
8 To earn her food in summer time,
And gather harvest in its prime.

A great anthill appeared this year near by
My house, in the woods few steps if you
try,

You'll find it on the right, good two feet
high.

Next year it may be bigger, now who
knows?

It's in protected area where grows
The mighty fern, anemones in rows.
I pass the thing six or eight times a day,
But never once stopped in to greet or say
A welcome to the neighbourhood to play.
It seems these times that neighbours rarely
seek

Moments to stop and pass the day or speak.
I hardly know the name of these ones and
I doubt I could remember out of hand
So many names of folk in such a band.

9 How long will you sleep, lazy man?

When will you get up, if you can?

10 Just a little more time to rest,

To fold the hands in sleep on breast!

11 So shall your poverty arrive

As one upon a journey thrive,

And your lack come up suddenly

Like an armed robber *in the tree*.

12 A foolish man and wicked one

Goes round with perverse words by ton.

13 He winks an eye, he shifts a foot,

He signals with a finger put.

14 Perverseness lies down in his heart,

He invents mischief for his part,

He sows discord *by word and art*.

15 Therefore shall his calamity

Come down on him and suddenly,

He's broken without remedy.

16 These six things does YHWH hate *the most*,

Seven indeed in silly boast:

17 A proud look and a lying tongue,

Hands that shed innocent blood rung,

18 A heart full of wicked plans made,

Feet swift to mischief on parade,

19 A false witness *who* speaks in lies,

One who sows discordant replies

Among his brothers without sighs.

If there are seven holy ones to serve
And seven divine guides who do not
swerve

From the right way, there are also their
mates

Who trample righteous ways and righteous fates.

The pride of one who knows no unity
Of divine will and being, lying tongue,
And hands that take blood and from court
go free,

And wicked hearts with plans not to be
sung,

The evil footstep, and false witness share
Your frown, and yet there's one remaining
there.

Human discord comes from the fateful
thought

That all men are in separate dealings
taught,

While truth is that Your oneness must
imply

A oneness among men beneath the sky.

20 My son, keep your father's command,
Do not forsake your mother's hand.

21 Tie them always upon your heart,
And bind them round your neck *to start*.

22 When you walk it shall lead you there,
When you sleep it shall keep you ware,
And when you wake up it shall talk
With you *and tell you how to walk*.

23 For the commandment is a lamp,
And the law a light *on the ramp*,
Reproofs instruct life *and revamp*,

24 To keep you from the evil dame,
Flattering tongue of a strange flame.

25 Do not lust for her beauty's part
In your heart, neither take her part
Because her eyelids flutter start.

26 For by means of a harlot one
Comes to a crust of bread when done,
And an adulteress will prey strife
Every day on his precious life.

The true light is not in the brightened eyes,
Nor in the meditation of the wise,
But in commandments You, Beloved, sent
down

To guide both humble and men of renown.
The true light is not lifted adoration,
Inspiring thoughts, but rather revelation
That might grate on elation and desires.
The altar holds both holy and strange fires.
The flattering of tongue to downhill paths
Perfumes the way to silken asses' baths.

I take my crust and cup to where You speak
And find in word recited light I seek.
Let none seduce me with the glorious light
That recognizes neither wrong nor right.

27 Can fire be kept on human breast
Without burning jacket and vest?

28 Can anyone walk on hot coals
Without his feet burning on shoals?

29 So too one sleeping with the wife
Of neighbour gains guiltiness' strife.

30 Men do not look down on a thief
Stealing when hungry for relief.

31 But if he's caught, he'll have to give
Back seven times more than in the sieve;
He'll give his house, substance and all.

32 But the one who's caught in the thrall
Of adultery with woman's gall
Has no understanding at all.

Such a one destroys soul in stall.

33 A sickness and dishonour he
Shall get, and his reproach shall be
Not wiped away *eternally*.

34 For jealousy is rage of man,
So he'll not wait until the span
Of the day of vengeance *in plan*.

35 He'll not accept indemnity,
He'll not be satisfied to be,
Though you give many gifts *in fee*.

It is a strange thing in that ancient day
That great and small considered that the
play

Of copulation was the needful way
To get the crops to grow and in their way
The flocks and herds to propagate in sway,
And yet the jealousy of man for man
Prevented free access to yoke in span.
The same occasion waits upon the hour
Today when pagan scientific power
Looks with the greatest favour on the free
Frenetic copulation in the spree.

Men still find jealous hearts for motive
great

To go out and kick others in the gate.
The gift and satisfaction are one rate.

Proverbs 7

1 My son, keep my words and lay up
My commandments to keep *in cup*.

2 Keep my commandments, and you'll live,

My law's apple of the eyes give.
 3 Bind them upon your fingers *too*,
 Write them on your heart's tables *due*.
 4 Tell wisdom "You're my sister true"
 Call understanding your kin's crew.
 5 They may keep you from wenches'
 wrong,
 From strangers with flattering song.
 6 For at the window of my house
 I looked through window pane *like mouse*,
 7 And saw among the simple ones,
 Among the young folk, a young man
 Without understanding or plan.
 8 He passed through the street near her
 corner,
 He went to her house *without warner*.
 9 At twilight, in the evening in
 The black and dark of the night's din,
 10 He met a woman with a dress
 On like a whore, cunning to mess.
 11 She's raucous and has her own way,
 Her feet at home refuse to stay.
 12 She ranges in the streets and lies
 In wait at every corner's guys.

 Did never any man seduce a maid?
 Why all this innocence of male parade,
 As though all evil comes from women's
 store
 And men are always righteous at the door,
 Except that wenches entice them the more?
 It takes two fools to find adultery
 Is the highway desired by those thought
 free.
 She ranges not alone who seeks her prey,
 The young man too is out with coin to pay.
 If Solomon had warned the maid of those
 Brave, raucous, boisterous cads lined up in
 rows
 There's many maid that might have stayed
 on toes
 And kept her purity despite the will
 Of royal princes under Zion's hill.

 13 So she caught him and kissed him too,
 An impudent face in his view
 And said to him *against the true*,
 14 I've offered up the sacrifice,
 Today I've paid my vows *for vice*.
 15 That's why I came out to meet you,
 Seeking your face among the crew,

And at last I came and found you.
 16 I've decked my bed with coverings
 Of tapestry and with carved things,
 With fine linen as Egypt brings.
 17 I've scented my bed with the myrrh,
 Aloes and cinnamon *to stir*.
 18 Come, let us take our fill of love
 Until the morning raise its glove,
 And comfort us in treasures' trove.
 19 My husband is not now at home,
 Gone on a journey out to roam.
 20 He took a bag of siller too,
 To stay until the day he's due.

 In old days men and women met to make
 The sacrifices for the common sake
 Of grand fertility, and in their joy,
 Joined in the copulation to employ
 The sacred groves and temples like a cake.
 We have the churches still where sacrifice
 With jangling rock and roll makes all
 things nice,
 And preachers from the tv screen relate
 With sensitive appreciation's rate
 To those who offer bed and sweet perfume,
 A secret tryst with playthings in their room.
 Beloved, the Canaanite religion still
 Thrives on each Roman and Genevan hill,
 In every place the cross would foot the bill.

 21 With her much speech and cajoling
 She caused him to yield to the thing,
 With flattering of her lips she
 Forced him *to act unfaithfully*.
 22 He followed after her direct
 As an ox to the slaughter necked,
 Or as a fool to punishment
 Of the stocks *where he has been sent*.
 23 As a dart strikes through liver's ware,
 As a bird hastens to the snare,
 He does not know his life's *in care*.
 24 Listen to me now then, children,
 Attend to my mouth's words again.
 25 Don't let your heart follow her ways,
 Deceived in her paths where it strays.
 26 She's overthrown many a man
 Wounded to death, many by plan
 Have been killed by her *as she can*.
 27 Her house is on the way to hell,
 Down to death's chambers *at a spell*.

The ox led to the slaughter is a figure
Of speech that fits in several kinds of
wigure.

The prostitute is only one of many
Who lead a man to death for just a penny.
The prostitution of the advertiser
Is far more dangerous than that of miser.
The prostitution of the church and state
Produced a list of doctrines to relate
That since have been the masters of the fate
Of men and women just and pure, though
late

To cast their faith on Sun worship and Baal
Gathered in Sunday worship and for sale.
Beloved, I rush with eager step to You
The day before, my love is fresh and true.

Proverbs 8

1 Does wisdom not shout aloud, and
Understanding sound voice *at hand*?
2 She stands in the top of high places,
By the paths where men run their races.
3 She cries at the gates to come in
The city, at the doors with din.
4 "I'm calling all men with my voice,
You sons of men, come and rejoice."
5 O you simple people, come try
To understand the wise way nigh,
And you fools, have a learning heart.
6 Hear, for I'll speak of costly part,
And open lips with right things' art.
7 Indeed my mouth shall speak the truth,
And wickedness to my lips' youth
Is abomination uncouth.

A child learns early that to speak the truth
Will only lead to punishment uncouth.
The truth is something humankind cannot
Abide a single moment in a slot.
No wonder wisdom's shouting goes amiss
And no one stops to hear or get a kiss.
No wonder pounding on the gates is fraught
With nothing but the echoes where she
sought.

The truth You promise? No, let me now
flee
To lies and quiet customs of the wee.
Beloved, I've lived to know that the truth
stated

Arouses ire of rich and poor elated.
In my stupidity I looked for that

Shouting wisdom. I am a stupid cat.

8 All my mouth's words are righteousness,
I've no perverseness in address.

9 They're all plain to the understanding,
And right to those in knowledge landing.

10 Take my teaching, not silver *cold*,
And knowledge rather than choice gold.

11 Better than rubies, wisdom find,
All things desired are not in kind
To be compared to it *combined*.

12 I wisdom deal in counsels deep,
I've found knowledge of all things *steep*.

13 YHWH's fear's to hate evil and pride,
And arrogance and wicked ride,
The perverse mouth I hate *beside*.

Wisdom cannot abide the perverse mouth,
And yet there's hardly else from north to
south.

The rubies shine and tempt the wicked
hand

To robbing the rich women of the land,
But when I held to knowledge sweeter far,
I found I was the one shut behind bar.
Plain understanding makes a man perverse
To church and state and subject to their
curse.

Find wisdom, yes indeed, and with the
finding

Find ostracism from the gilded binding.
Beloved, after the pains of light to bear
In eyes not so accustomed to its share,
I chose at last wisdom as from the first,
And rest now satisfied among the cursed.

14 Counsel and justice are mine, I
Have understanding and strength's *tie*.

15 By me kings reign and heads of state
Decree justice. 16 By me do rule
Princes and nobles and *the school*
Of judges of the earth. 17 I love
Them who love me, and those who seek
Me early shall find me *not meek*.

18 Riches and honour are with me;
Riches and righteousness' degree.

18 My product is better than gold,
Better than finest gold *that's sold*,
My profits than choice silver *told*.

20 I lead the way of righteousness,
The paths of judgement I confess.

21 I enrich those who love my measure,
And I will come to fill their treasure.

By wisdom those who truly ruled in time
And place where holy strategy in crime
Was still that honesty pays in the climb,
Gave up the grand desire to keep the state
In the oppression of the small and great.
But wisdom is no longer such a tool.
Today it's cunning shifts for every fool.
The hopeful cast of eye to golden pool
Is just a myth's nostalgia. I am sure
That wisdom never had a place made pure
Among the rival nations of all men.
This world has always been impoverished
den

Where wisdom passes in a golden coach
Seen only by those not crap-shooting roach.

22 YHWH possessed me from His way's
start,

Before His ancient works *of art*.

23 I was set up from days of old,
From the beginning and all told
Before the earth was *bought or sold*.

24 When there was no Tehowm I'm born,
Before rushing waters adorn.

25 Before the mountains had been set,
Before the hills my birth was met,

26 While as yet He had not made earth,
Nor the fields nor the highest berth
Of the dust of the world *in mirth*.

27 When He prepared the skies I stood,
When He set the directions good
Upon the surface of Tehowm,

28 When He set clouds above *at home*,
When He strengthened springs of Tehowm,

29 When He gave the sea His decree,
That waters pass not His degree,
When He appointed earth's foundations;

30 Then I was by Him as in rations,
And I was daily His delight,
Rejoicing always at His right,

31 Rejoicing where His earth gave
dwelling,

My delights with mankind were swelling.

The great Tehowm that the first words relate
To those reading the Scriptures in the state
Of Hebrew here appears again as great.
Wisdom is of an older settlement,

A deeper foundation than Tehowm's vent.
To ancient mind no doubt Tehowm was
deep

In absolute and ancient as was steep.
But wisdom prides herself that she was
there

When the Tehowm was set down fair and
square.

Beloved, I too rejoice to know the world
And all the universe undone, unfurled,
Is caught up in the round of wisdom's vice.
Wisdom's salvation, and not sacrifice,
Wisdom's the lowered boom on all that's
nice.

32 So listen to me now, children,
Blessed are those who keep my ways then.

33 Hear teaching and be wise and yet
Not refuse *wisdom when it's met*.

34 Blessed is the man who does hear me,
Waiting each day where my gates be,
Hoping at my doorposts *to see*.

35 Those who find me also find life,
They get YHWH's favour without strife.

36 The one who sins against me wrongs
His own soul, all those *in their throngs*
Who hate me love their own death *songs*.

Let me, Beloved, keep wisdom's ways I
hear

As soon as Your word comes trumpeting
near,

Reciting once again from Sinai's hill
The orders of the regiment and bill.

Let me, Beloved, keep ten commandments
true

That are the express image taught of You,
And find their joys reflected in my face
As I whirl round and round this desert
place.

The tinkling syllables flash on the trees
Where ice cracks from the birches in the
breeze,

And strikes my ear like silver bells and
gold

Returning on the grated crystal mould.
Beloved, I hear again Your law sung bright
In the brief day of winter before night.

Proverbs 9

1 Wisdom has built her house and she

Has hewn out her seven pillars wee.
 2 She's killed her beasts and mixed her wine,
 She's furnished her table to dine.
 3 She's sent out maidens *to give word*,
 She's cried on the city walls *stirred*.
 4 "Let the simple one turn in here,
 The one who lacks in mindful gear,"
 She says to him, 5 "Come eat my bread,
 And drink my wine mixed and outspread.
 6 "Forsake the foolish now and live,
 And go the way the thoughtful give."
 7 The one who chides a scorner gets
 Shame on himself, and he who sets
 A wicked man to an account
 Gets a blot on himself *to mount*.
 8 Do not reprove a scorner lest
 He hate you, but rebuke the best
 Of wise men and he'll love your zest.

How true it is! I've seen the place where
 one
 Cannot in peace and quiet under sun
 Withdraw from company of scorners met
 But he will be slandered by all the set.
 The lies that scorners tell and publicize
 About the just mount up into the skies.
 If I had only minded that the crew
 That claims on this earth to represent You
 Is such a scorner band, I might have saved
 Myself the barrage of what fools engraved.
 Beloved, let me have discourse with You
 and
 Leave others to their own device at hand,
 And dwell in peace to cantillate Your word
 While fools recite their litanies absurd.

9 Teach a wise man, he'll be but wiser,
 Teach a just man and no despiser,
 And he'll increase in learnings' visor.
 10 The fear of YHWH is wisdom's start,
 Knowledge of holy things *in cart*
 Is understanding *for an art*.
 11 By me your days are multiplied,
 The years of life increased to bide.
 12 If you're wise, you just benefit,
 If you're a scorner, it's your kit.
If you should prove a wicked one,
You'll bear alone the evil done,
The one who depends on the false,
Attempting with the wind to waltz,

Will chase after birds in their flight.
For he's forsaken vineyard's right,
And turned his own cart-wheels to spite.
He wanders in dry desert land
Appointed for the drought at hand,
Gathers for harvest blowing sand.
 13 A foolish wench clamours aloud,
 Simple, she knows nothing *but cloud*.
 14 She sits at the door of her house,
 On the walls of the town *like mouse*.
 15 She calls to travellers on journey.
 16 "Let ignorant ones come to me,
 Who lack understanding freely,"
 She says to travellers *she can see*.
 17 "Sweet are the stolen waters and
 Secret bread is pleasant in hand."
 18 He does not know the dead are there,
 Her guests have depths of hell *for share*.

Relinquishing reason is just the same
 As dancing with the wind for harvest claim
 Upon the dry and desert sands where none
 Have planted any crops under the sun.
 To set aside fair reason is the act
 Of one who travels, despite marriage pact,
 And stops to sleep with harlots on the stray,
 And so takes on death's burden for the day.
 Beloved, I lay my mind and tongue upon
 The reason You created from the dawn
 Of human history to be the guide
 Of human hearts to right and justice' side.
 I take the reason first and put away
 The things that may feel right in darkness'
 sway.

Proverbs 10

1 Here are proverbs of Solomon.
 A father's glad of a wise son,
 But a fool's a weight of a ton
 To his mother *out on the run*.
 2 Treasures of wickedness are spite,
 Righteousness saves from the death's night.
 3 YHWH will not suffer righteous souls
 To faint with hunger *on the doles*.
 But He throws out the substance wrought
 By the wicked *in what they sought*.
 4 The lazy hand becomes poor stitch,
 But hard working will make one rich.
 5 The one who harvests in the heat
 Of summer is a wise son's feat,
 But the son that sleeps in the time

Of harvest causes shameful crime.

6 Blessings are on the head of just,
Violence takes the mouth with dust.

7 The memory of the just is blessed,

The wicked one's name rots at best.

8 The wise in heart receive precepts,
Foolish lips fail among adepts.

The memory of the just is enclosed
In Your heart, my Beloved, and not
exposed

To monuments that wear, and rust and
crack.

The wicked name rots on such bronze and
slack.

The memory of the just is fast engraved
Upon Your divine heart, Beloved, and
saved

Within Your songs upon the universe
That sweep in cosmic breaths away the
curse

That rises from the human lip to bear
Away forgotten on the empty air.

Beloved, I crave that memory of Yours
That's hidden from human eyes by the
doors

Of faith and righteousness, obedience
To Your commands hidden in secret tents.

9 The upright walks in a sure way,
But the one who perverts his stay
Will be known *when he goes astray*.

10 The one who winks an eye is cause
Of sorrow, but foolish lips' flaws
Shall fail. 11 The mouth of righteous ones
Is a well of life, but the runs
Of violence cover the mouth

Of the wicked *from north to south*.

12 Hatred stirs up strife, but love covers
All sins *wherever a sin hovers*.

13 In lips of one with understanding
Wisdom is found, but a rod's landing
On the back of the one without.

14 Wise people lay up knowledge *stout*,
But the mouth of the foolish *lout*
Is near destruction *thereabout*.

15 The rich man's wealth is his strong
town,

Destruction of the poor is *crown*
Of their poverty lying down.

16 The righteous labour comes to life,

The fruit of wicked sin is strife.

Solomon is naive, Beloved, to think
That hatred can be smitten with a wink.

The truth is not all strife is result of
The porter's failure and his lack of love.

Truth is the victim may be innocent,
With not a shred of hatred in his tent,
And still be pounced upon and made to
look

A sorry spectacle in human book.

I trow the most of famous men are fools
And rascals drinking from unlawful pools,
While those who are great truly are
unknown

To the encyclopedia and throne.

Beloved, count me among the bold and
brave

Who keep Your law, whether free man or
slave.

17 He is the way of life to keep
Instruction, but the one asleep

To reproof wades in error deep.

18 The one who hides hatred with lips
Of falsehood is the one that slips

In slander, and he is a fool,

The dupe of power, unthinking tool.

19 In many words no lack for sin,
The one who doesn't speak will win.

20 The just man's tongue is silver choice,
The wicked heart gives empty voice.

21 The righteous lips feed many, but
Fools die outside of wisdom shut.

22 The blessing of YHWH, it makes rich,
He adds no sorrow in *the stitch*.

23 A fool thinks doing mischief's funny,
A man's wisdom's worth more *than money*.

24 The fear of the wicked shall come
Upon him, but the righteous *hum*

Of hope shall be fulfilled in scope.

25 As the whirlwind passes, so cope
The wicked no more, but the just

Has eternal foundation's trust.

It may be true the more the speech the more
Sin lies exposed and raw at the heart door.

If so I've sinned above all men to write
So many words in praise of wrong and
sight.

It may be true the multiplying words

Set speakers out among the flocks of birds
 Where wisdom is long gone and only
 specks
 Of insect matter on the ground perplex.
 It may be true that with each word the soul
 Lays bare the sin of centuries on the dole,
 While Your one speech can be heard in the
 space
 Of three minutes of standing face to face.
 Beloved, I take the words on tongue to taste
 Whether the sin is sweet or whether waste.

26 As vinegar to teeth and smoke
 To eyes, so is the lazy bloke
 To those who sent him *for a stroke*.
 27 The fear of YHWH lengthens man's
 days,
 The years of wicked ones are haze.
 28 Hope of the righteous shall be glad,
 The wicked expectation sad.
 29 YHWH's way is strength to the upright,
 But sinners' destruction's in sight.
 30 The righteous shall never be moved,
 The wicked on earth not be grooved.
 31 The just mouth brings forth wisdom's
 fruit,
 A perverse tongue pulled out by root.
 32 The righteous lips tell what is right,
 The wicked mouth speaks perverse blight.

Myself I don't eat things that have included
 Such liquids as vinegar when exuded.
 I disremember what it's like to taste
 The acid wine of apple unerased,
 Or even that of grape in wine that's gone
 Unsavoury from sophisticated brawn.
 But laziness I think I know, for I
 Have felt the pull of warm sun in the sky
 And white sands on bright beaches whether
 by
 The Arctic loneliness or tropic wealth.
 I've walked hand in hand with such lazy
 stealth.
 But still when something catches hold of
 me
 And my imagination for a fee,
 I'm up and doing as though faithfully.

Proverbs 11

1 Dishonest weights are abhorred by
 YHWH, but a just scale *in His eye*

Is a delight. 2 Pride stands in stall,
 Then comes the shame in face of all
 Who buy and sell in market place.
 But with the humble, wisdom's grace.
 3 The upright man's integrity
 Will guide him as though with a fee,
 But the wicked's perversity
 Shall destroy him *eternally*.
 4 In wealth there is no profit found
 Upon the day of wrath when bound.
 But righteousness saves one from death,
As long as he can get his breath.
 5 The perfect man's righteousness will
 Direct his way *up and down hill*,
 But the wicked shall fall down by
 His own iniquity in sty.
 6 The upright man's righteousness saves,
 But sinners go down to the graves.

So I interpreted that last word loosely,
 But only because the context obtusely
 Said that the wicked go into that death
 That righteous ones avoid by their sweet
 breath.
 Paul and his preachers must have failed to
 read
 This text that says clearly for any need,
 That there are perfect people and they're
 saved
 By their right doing of what You engraved.
 By contrast those stubborn to stay in sin
 Are gathered on the day of wrath in bin.
 No grace is found for those who raise a cry
 That Jesus came to save them and to die,
 But only for the ones in covenant
 Whose righteousness is seen and is not
 scant.

7 When a wicked man dies his hopes
 Perish with him in his death's ropes.
 The hope of the unjust is grapes.
 8 The righteous is saved from the pit,
 The wicked falls in that place fit.
 9 A hypocrite with his mouth slays
 His neighbour, but through knowledge
 ways
 The just shall be saved *in his days*.
 10 When it goes well with the upright,
 The city rejoices, the night
 Of destruction of wicked men
 Is filled with *happy* shouts again.

By blessing the upright exalts
The city, but the wicked's faults
Bring it down *with a mouth in frown*.

The blessing, barakat, as by this word
Comes on the earth and every city stirred
By whirling feet and cantillation taught
From lips of the upright in what they
sought.

It seems strange to the living men today
That dancing, as it were, and on the stray,
Could do the world some good, and yet the
king

Here recognizes it like anything.
Beloved, I have no hand to cure the ills
Of this world of its armaments and mills,
But I can cantillate the sacred song
And keep my hand from doing any wrong.
I take with my right hand the blessing

strong
And scatter barakat the left hand fills.

12 The one who lacks wisdom despises
His neighbour, but a man in guises
Of understanding holds his peace.

There is no way not to despise the
neighbour
Except to leave off trying to by labour
And recognizing there's no soul but one
Reflected bright or dim and without sun
From You, Beloved, Creator of all things.
There's no despising merchantmen or
kings,
The farmer, fisherman, the one in rings
Who keeps guard of the city when he's
done.

Beloved, I see Your face reflected in
The neighbour's and the evil man's of sin,
For sin itself can only come about
When the soul that's divine errs when
without

Awareness of divine in every face
Thinks he alone is source of heavenly
grace.

13 A gossip's telling secrets, but
A faithful spirit keeps things shut.

14 Where there is no counsel there fall
The people, but a mighty wall
Is good advice given by all.

15 The one who undersigns a note
Security for unknown stoat
Will surely lose, but he who hates
To stand in is safe *in his gates*.

16 A gracious woman keeps her honour,
And strong men save their wealth *upon her*.

17 The merciful helps his own soul,
But a cruel man earns his death's toll.

18 The wicked does deceitful work,
Reward's to one who does not shirk
In sowing righteousness *in kirk*.

19 As righteousness ends up in life,
So wickedness in death and strife.

20 Those who have heart's perversity
Are an abomination, *see*,
To YHWH, but upright in their way
Are His delight *both night and day*.

Abomination's not a matter of
The genealogy in land of love,
But all about the heart and where it stands
In its perversity upon the sands.
The upright are not defined by the faith
They put in sacrifices of a wraith,
But by the walk, not frock, and by the good
They do about them everywhere they
should.

Beloved, take Your delight in me today,
As You have kept me in the perfect way
That You once pronounced in the
mountain's sway,
As I give thanks for guidance and the
power
You lay on hand and foot in trouble's hour,
For rest beneath the shedding lilac's bower.

21 Despite the help they give each other,
Punishment falls on wicked brother;
But the descendants of the just
Shall be delivered *from the dust*.

22 A jewel of gold in a pig's snout,
A dame without good sense *in rout*.

23 The righteous desire only good,
The wicked wait for wrath *as could*.

24 Some scatter and increase in wealth,
Some save for poverty in stealth.

25 The soul that blesses shall be fat,
Who gives water finds where it's at.

26 The one who keeps back corn is cursed,
But many blessings shall be versed
On him who sells it *from the vat*.

27 He who diligently seeks good
 Gets favour, but the one who could
 Do mischief, gets it back on him.
 28 The one who relies on wealth dim
 Shall fall; but the upright shall be
 Like a branch to flourish *and see*.
 29 The one who troubles his own house
 Shall inherit the winds *of grouse*;
 The fool shall come to serve *at last*
 The wise in heart *with a mind fast*.
 30 The fruit of the righteous shall be
 A tree of life, and he who's free
 To win souls is wise *to a tee*.
 31 See how the upright recompense
 Receive upon the earth *for vents*,
 Much more the wicked *in their tents*
 And sinners *who act without sense*.

I'm not sure what this verse is speaking of
 That says some win souls in wisdom and
 love,
 Since in the time of Solomon the share
 Of Baptists with attendance goals to bear
 Had not yet made appearance on the stage.
 Maybe it was a prophecy to wage
 The promises of John who came to dip,
 And Paul and Peter, latter with a slip.
 Beloved, the great soul-winners of the past
 Are with us no more. See the fallen cast
 Of our twin billies gave You such bad
 name
 That Freud will soon take Your place and
 Your fame.
 If I could just convince now one or two
 To keep the ten commandments, I'd be
 through.

Proverbs 12

1 The one who enjoys being taught
 Is one who loves his knowledge sought,
 But he who hates reproof's a bore,
And better shunted out the door.
 2 A good man gets favour from YHWH,
 Those in wicked devices' crew
 He will condemn *there in their pew*.
 3 A man shall not be set for life
 By wicked actions done in strife,
 But the root of an upright man
 Shall not be moved *by any plan*.
 4 A virtuous woman's a crown
 To her husband, but one who brings

Him shame is like rottenness down
 Into his very bones *and springs*.
 5 The thoughts of the upright are right,
 But wicked counsels are false sight.
 6 Affairs of the wicked are that
 They lie in wait for blood *in vat*,
 But the mouth of the upright will
 Give witness to his justice' fill.
 7 The wicked ones are overthrown
 And cease to be, but the house grown
 Of the upright shall stand *like stone*.

I build a house of praise to You, my Lord,
 And with the precious stones and gems
 adored
 Of Hebrew cantillation I strike chord
 Of Your eternity with my small voice.
 I build a temple that stands like the stone
 Beneath the wind and weather all alone,
 And yet abides around eternal throne,
 Without regret the building is my choice.
 The house I live in has foundation weak
 Made so by careless road builders with
 cheek.
 It's lasted for a century and might
 Last while I am myself living in sight.
 But the house that stands is one from my
 lips
 That rises on the air and runs like ships.

8 A man shall be commended by
 His wisdom, but he that is sly
 In heart shall be despised thereby.
 9 Better's the poor man who provides
 His sustenance, than who derides
 All vaunting but lacks bread besides.
 10 An upright man thinks how it feels
 To beasts of burden *pulling wheels*,
 But tender mercies of the wicked
 Are cruel *in the ways they stick it*.
 11 The one who tills his land shall be
 Satisfied with bread faithfully,
 But he who follows vanity
 Is void of understanding's *fee*.
 12 The wicked hope in evil net,
 But roots of the upright still get.
 13 The wicked's caught up in the snare
 Of transgressions that his lips bear,
 The just comes out of trouble's share.
 14 A man is satisfied with good
 By what mouth produces or should.

What a man's hands earn shall at last
Come to him *in reward or blast*.

Beloved, the works of my hands may
repent

And turn to dust and toil from which
they're sent.

But let what's good and right in what I say
Responding to Your love-knots in my way
Earn peace and comfort on the Judgement
Day.

Beloved, I've done the this and that for
work

And have not been one on the earth to
shirk,

But let all disappear except the praise
I bring to You in response to the lays
Of billets doux with which You bless my
days.

Beloved, I'm satisfied at times to read
And reread my sonnets and spell my creed,
So give me my reward and punishment
In the grace of Your loving heart and spent.

15 The way of a fool's right to see
In his own thinking, but then he
Who hears good counsel's wise *and free*.

16 A fool flies out in wrath to start,
A prudent man hides his hurt's part.

17 The one who speaks the truth shows
right,

A false witness is deceit's wight.

18 Many scatter words like the pricks
Of a sword, but the tongue that licks
Wisdom is like medicine's kicks.

19 What truthful lips say is steadfast,
But lies are temporary cast.

20 Deceit is in the heart of those
Who imagine evil in rows,
But to the counsellors of peace
There is joy *ever in release*.

21 No evil shall befall the just,
The wicked shall be filled with dust.

Perhaps Solomon did not read the case
Of Job manhandled by accusers base.
If he had done, he'd know that some have
been

The butt of evil even without sin.

Perhaps Solomon in his wealth and plot
Of wives and concubines, many unsought,

Was too filled with the pleasures of good
things

To realize not all men sit like kings.

Beloved, I see the rain fall on the just

And on the unjust as the raincloud must,
And fill my heart with hope that I may run
A slender soul and quickly on my bun

To pass between the raindrops till I'm done
And smell the sweet rain splattering the
dust.

22 Lying lips are abomination

To YHWH, but those who deal their ration
In truth are His delight *and nation*.

23 A prudent man hides what he knows,
But fools' hearts proclaim foolish rows.

24 The diligent one's hand bears rule,
The slothful shall be tribute's mule.

25 Heaviness in the heart of man
Makes it stoop, but a good word can
Make it glad *quickly or by plan*.

26 The righteous is more excellent
Than his neighbour, but the descent
Of wickedness seduction's meant.

27 The slothful man will never roast
The hunted prey *and raise his boast*,
But what a diligent man has

Is wealth *and health and all that jazz*.

28 In way of righteousness is life,
And in its path's no deathly strife.

How many of the six millions and more
Who died at hand of holocaust in store
Were righteous? I count not a few of them,
Both Jewish and Gentile to show a gem.
And yet they all went up in smoke while
those

Who fired the ovens range around in
clothes

Of latest fashion and give interviews
That show not even slight remorse in dues.

Beloved, I take the counsel of the king
Solomon and its followers who sing
To heart and know my actions must
improve

By following the wisdom of their groove.
But since I live in Auschwitz' wake I know
My life hangs on a thread despite my show.

Proverbs 13

1 A wise son hears what his dad teaches,

A scorner rejects what he preaches.

2 A good man shall eat of good things,
The transgressor of wicked stings.

3 The one who keeps his mouth keeps life,
To open it is to have strife.

4 The lazy man wants but has not,
The diligent gets fat *in pot*.

5 A righteous man hates lying tongues,
The wicked's loathsome in shame's rungs.

6 Righteousness keeps the upright straight,
Wickedness spills the sinner's gate.

7 Some pretend to be rich when poor,
Some pretend poverty for sure.

I've seen such pretence all my life I swear.

When I lived in America the fair,
Everyone I saw tried to look the part
Of millionaire, his donkey after cart.

When I came to the northland I found out
That only wealthy folk complain about
Not having funds to keep in house and
home,

Starvation from the door, put out to roam.
Beloved, I smile at human hearts like mine,
Who wish to paint a mask of wealth or
brine,

And never satisfied to be the thing
They are in summertime when on the wing
Or in the winter barren on the field.
No man is satisfied with his life's yield.

8 Wealth ransoms life of man in danger,
But the poor hear no call of ranger.

9 The light of the upright rejoices,
The wicked's lamp's put out of choices.

10 Only by pride comes in contention,
Wisdom's the well advised's convention.

11 Wealth from idolatry falls low,
But from hard work has what to show.

12 Hope deferred makes the heart go sick,
Desire come, tree of life grows thick.

13 Destroyed shall be the one despising
The word, but he who takes advising
From the commandment shall gain grace.

14 The law of the wise man's to trace
The fountain of life, to depart
From snares of death *and do his part*.

15 Good understanding will give favour,
Transgressors' paths have a hard savour.

16 Every wise man keeps knowledge well,
A fool lays open folly's spell.

The rich think that they must have guards
to keep

Their houses and wealth from the thieves
who creep

About the world to steal the lovely share.
The truth is those who do not have to bear
The burden of wealth need not fear the
thief.

It takes both wealth and greed to bring to
grief.

That's why the poor man hears no call at
night

Of someone scratching at his cupboard site.
I thank You, my Beloved, for greedy men
Whose wealth keeps thieves away from my
own den,

Where they know stock is small and
picking few.

For greedy men to guard my house, thank
You.

Of course if wealth were scattered among
all,

Neither guard nor thief would scale the
stone wall.

17 Wicked messengers fall to grief,
Good representative's relief.

18 Want and shame come on those who
stay

From instruction, but those who say
They take reproof get honour's way.

19 Satisfied desire's sweet to soul,
Fools hurt departing evil's goal.

20 Who walks with the wise shall be wise,
Fools' friends are destroyed *under eyes*.

21 Evil walks in sinners' tracks bound,
To righteous good's in payment found.

22 Good men leave own inheritance,
Sinner's wealth's for the just's instance.

23 Much food is in tillage of poor,
Without justice destruction's sure.

24 He who spares his rod hates his son,
But he who loves corrects his bun.

25 The righteous eats to fill his soul,
But wicked man's paunch lacks the toll.

How many centuries ago did You
Tell Solomon to write the proverbs' view
That the wealth of the wicked should go
down

To the upright folk living in the town.
 The fact is wicked men steal more today
 Than ever before in history's pay,
 And they can do it now by legal fee,
 Since wealth's created by a pen in glee.
 Beloved, I'm waiting still to see all things
 Put in the hand of upright men and kings
 Instead of in the hands of those who wait
 In lobby at the parliamentary gate.
 I'll wait a thousand years it seems to me,
 Apocalypse in an eternity.

Proverbs 14

1 Every wise woman builds her house,
 The foolish nibbles it like mouse.
 2 The one who behaves right fears YHWH,
 Who acts perversely hates His *crew*.
 3 The foolish mouth's a rod of pride,
 But wise lips shall preserve their side.
 4 Without oxen the crib is clean,
 By strength of ox increase is seen.
 5 A faithful witness will not lie,
 A false witness can't pass it by.
 6 A scorner seeks knowledge in vain,
 Understanding is wisdom's gain.
 7 Leave the sight of a foolish man,
 When you see he speaks without plan.

I trow the man who leaves the fool's sight
 when

He notices he speaks without the den
 Of knowledge, if the man's his boss, he'll
 go

From one job to another in the flow
 And never find a stable place to work.
 The foolish rise to power, it is a quirk
 Of the reality where I now live,
 In a world based upon success to give
 Aushpits and Buckbald in experiment.
 The pattern's been fine everywhere it went.
 Beloved, I might step out of line and take
 My number from the roster for Your sake,
 But I would not last long upon the plate,
 Slaughtered with all the rest in smoky fate.

8 The wisdom of the prudent here
 Will understand where to appear,
 But the folly of fools is gear.
 9 Fools make a mockery of sin,
 The righteous live in favour's bin.
 10 The heart knows its own bitterness,

A stranger does not come to mess
 With the joy of other's address.
 11 The wicked house is overthrown,
 The upright's tent raised *upon stone*.
 12 There is a way seems right to man,
 The ends of it are death to scan.
 13 Even in laughter heart has grief,
 Sadness comes after mirth's relief.
 14 A fool is filled with his own ways,
 A good man has a higher praise.

Freud and the sweet ones come in
 consolation

Of every heartfelt grief found in the nation,
 And in their meddlesome intrusion bear
 But more stones into Bunyan's slough of
 care.

Life in Aushpits is not meant to be just
 Hilarious before we hit the dust.
 We're meant to work in sorrow and to trust
 That You will make it right, though man is
 cursed

By human lips and not Your own, Beloved.
 I keep my bitterness as one work-gloved,
 And shun the diagnosis of the shoved.
 I rage if I must in the vacant stare,
 And nurse the burning coal hidden with
 care,
 And so win out above the pagan share.

15 The simple man believes each word,
 The prudent watches out for turd.
 16 A wise man takes warning and flees
 From evil, but fools come to please
 With heedless confidence *in sleaze*.
 17 Quick temper leads to foolish acts,
 Wicked device hatred exacts.
 18 The simple have a heritage
 Of folly, but the prudent's stage
 Is crowned with knowledge *of the age*.

19 The evil bow before the good,
 The wicked at upright gates should.
 20 Even his own neighbour is filled
 With hatred to the poor unspilled,
 But the rich has many friends billed.
 21 The one who hates his neighbour sins,
 But the one who takes from his bins
 To feed the poor, it's he that wins.

I do admire the simple soul who still
 Can shop and trust advertisement and fill

Her poke with goods promised to make one wise

And beautiful in every neighbour's eyes.
My own heart is like many more that shake
A head at all that's spent in vain words' sake

To cause the poor to enter poverty
By giving up her wealth to company.
The evil bow before the good and sell
The innocent a rainbow and brass bell.
Beloved, I buy from You alone what I
Need to keep me afloat under the sky,
And trust You more than any friends I buy,
And wait for Your lifting me out of hell.

22 Do they not err who devise wrong?

Mercy and truth shall come along
To those who devise good *for song*.

23 In all labour there's profit's share,
But talk just keeps the table bare.

24 The crown of the wise is their wealth,
Folly comes on the fools in stealth.

25 A true witness delivers souls,
Deceitful lying wrecks on shoals.

26 In YHWH's fear the strong places trust,
His children have a spot they must
Find refuge *from the mouldy crust*.

YHWH's fear is a fountain of life,
Departing from death's snares of strife.

28 In crowds of folk is the king's glory,
In lack of crowds, it's end of story.

The difference between You and the king
And prancing of new prime ministering,
Is that the honour of the royalty
Needs shouting crowds to feel its honour's fee.

You are the king of universe and yet
You're satisfied with worship on the set
Of two or three, at times just one, to pray
You praises and petitions and the sway
Of penitence and plaint after the dark.
The phantom court and rule needs brick
and stone

And gold and gems and wealth to buttress
throne.

But You need nothing more than simple lay
Of Psalm to find a dwelling where to stay,
An orchard where to pluck fruit in the park.

29 Patience is of great understanding,

But hasty wrath raises demanding.

30 A sound heart is life of the flesh,
But envy rots the bones afresh.

31 Oppression of the poor's reproach
Poured on his Maker, but the coach
Who honours Him has mercy on
The poor *at noon, at night, at dawn*.

32 The wicked stumble at the weight
Of their own wickedness in fate,
But upright men hope in their death.

33 Wisdom rests in the heart and breath
Of him in understanding's gate,
But that which is among the fools
Is well reflected in their pools.

34 Uprightness brings a nation high,
But sin's a shame in each folk's eye.

35 The king favours a wise servant,
But rages at a shameful slant.

I'm not sure what You mean, Beloved, by
this:

The upright hope in their death not to miss.
The fate of the wicked ones come before
In falling in a wilderness for shore
Suggests that the upright get something
more,

A fine reward after their own death's door.
But then the sentence could mean that they
hope

In the death of sinners at end of rope.
Beloved, not sure at all what Your word
means,

I turn to You for better, firmer scenes,
Proposing that the both are things I'll take
And thank You with the giving for Your
sake.

Let wicked men die quickly's my desire,
But let me find rejoicing after ire.

Proverbs 15

1 A quiet answer puts out wrath,
But grievous words stir up its path.

2 The wise tongue uses knowledge right,
The foolish mouth runs out of sight.

3 YHWH's eyes are cast in every place,
Evil and good before His face.

4 A peaceful tongue's a tree of life,
Perversity is spirit's strife.

5 A fool casts out his father's teaching,
Prudence takes reproof far as reaching.

6 In the house of the righteous one

There's a great store of treasure spun;
But all the wicked earn is trouble.

7 The lips of the wise disperse knowledge,
But foolish hearts just blow a bubble.

8 The sacrifice of wicked *college*
Is an abomination to
YHWH, but the prayer of the upright
Comes up before Him in delight.

The wicked college of the priests of yore
Who sacrificed to Moloch on the shore
And lifted children to the hands of Baal
Are still in Rome and in Geneva hale.
The human sacrifice atones no whit
For human sin, but only making fit
In sound repentance for the damage done,
And praying with an upright heart that

You,
Beloved, shall have grace on repenting
crew.

Atonement by the intercession made
Of the just before Your throne is not paid
With honour in the world today, but when
You turn Your hand of mercy to all men.
Then sacrifice shall cease, the victory won.

9 The wicked way come before YHWH
Is an abomination's view,
But He loves the one that is true
In following righteousness due.

10 Correction's grievous to the one
Who forsakes the way of life *spun*,
And he that hates reproof shall die.

11 Sheol and destruction before
YHWH, hearts of mankind how much
more?

12 A corrupt man does not love one
That reproves him, and yet he'll run
Away from advice the wise stun.

13 A glad heart makes a cheerful face,
But grief of mind casts down its trace.

14 The heart of the wise seeks instruction,
But fools' mouths feed on foolish *suction*.

15 All the days of the poor are evil;
Contented hearts with feasts coeval.

16 Better the little YHWH provides
With fear than treasures on their tides.

The cheerful face has become the mark
known

Among all Christians, it seems, at Your
throne

In proof of their faith. Any folk that groan
Under oppression do so at the risk
Of getting reputations far from brisk.
If anyone looks sad or has the rate
Of bank account as empty as his plate,
The sweet Christian comes in to say he's
late

And ought to make repentance for his fate.
Beloved, if You made faces that could
smile,

You also made them capable a while
Of being sad without sin, without guile.
So I put on a sad face when I will,
Or then a happy one: You foot the bill.

17 Better a meal of herbs with love
Than fatted calf hatred in glove.

18 A raging man will stir up strife,
The patient appeases the rife.

19 The slothful way's a hedge of thorns,
Just way's without offence in bourns

20 A wise son brings his father joy,
The fool despises mother's sigh.

21 Folly is gladness to the fool,
The wise man makes straight steps his tool.

22 Plans fail without good counsel, so
Where many give advice, they glow.

23 Folk joy to make a smart retort,
But the right word's a better sort.

24 The path of life's high for the wise,
To keep from Sheol's wicked guise.

I much prefer the vegan fare to that
That's based on roasted meat and broiled
fat.

I prefer it I think with love or hate,
It makes no difference to my hungry slate.
That's why I've had occasion in the world
To be lax in the labour of the swirled,
And take it easy as I dig my herbs
While others spend their wealth upon the
curbs

Of steaks sirloin and possum fat and bacon
With sauces and with spices there to cake
on.

Beloved, I taste a mutton chop indeed
When guest of the upright and holy seed,
But when I come back home my lentil soup
Is tastier than egg from chicken coop.

25 YHWH tramps upon the proud man's
hut,
But widow's boundaries He'll shut.
26 Wicked thought's horrible to YHWH,
But sweet words purify the crew.
The greedy gain trouble at home,
But the one who hates bribes *of Rome*
Shall live. By mercy and by faith
Are sins atoned *and not by wrath*.
By fear of YHWH each one turns back
From doing evil *on the slack*.
26 The upright heart will contemplate
To do obedience *in rate*,
The wicked mouth will overflow
With evil deeds *done on the go*.
29 YHWH's far away from wicked ones,
He'll hear the prayers of upright duns.
30 Light for the eyes makes glad the heart,
A good name the bones fat *in part*.
31 The ear that hears reproofs of life
Shall bide with the wise *without strife*.
32 The one who sets aside the teaching
Despises his own soul *for preaching*,
But the one who yields to reproof,
From understanding's not aloof.
33 The fear of YHWH's wisdom's accord,
Humility at first is stored,
And then glory *before the Lord*.

Mercy and faith make up the precious load
Of tools by which salvation is bestowed.
Not by the raging sacrifice of man,
Not by the resurrection as by plan
Of man-gods in the fertile fields for gain
That grace with water the Canaanite plain.
An ear to hear Your law is what it takes,
Not willingness to eat the sacred cakes
Of Queen of Heaven decked out for Mary's
sakes,

Who would with horror hear the chimes
ring stakes.
To hear reproof read from Your law and
then
Repent in faith to take Your grace to men,
That is the way and only way to live.
The pagan heart is buried like a sieve.

Proverbs 16

1 Man's part's to prepare the heart well,

YHWH shall take care of the tongue's
spell.

2 All ways of man in his own eyes
Are pure, but YHWH weighs spirit's guise.

3 Lay open to YHWH all your works,
So you'll succeed and without quirks.

4 All has YHWH made by His own plan,
The wicked too for their day's scan.

5 Abomination to YHWH's each
Proud man, though hands joined each to
preach,

He is not innocent to teach.

*The start of a good way's to do
Justice, it's better in God's view,
And offering sacrifice's rue.*

6 By mercy and truth wickedness
Is redeemed, and by fear's address

Before YHWH men leave evil's mess.

7 When men's ways please YHWH, He'll
convert

Even His foes to peace *alert*.

8 Better a little in account
With justice, than a large amount
In gross iniquity *for fount*.

There's hardly anyone alive on earth
Who does the evil deed for its own worth,
But everyone whose hand is set to that
Does so because what he sees where he's at
Is that the thing's a profit to his bill,
Or justified by past or future ill.
Decision to take human life is caught
Each time it's done because the narrow plot
Says it is necessary to the joy
Of me and mine and so I must employ.
Beloved, keep me from acting on the sway
Of what I think is good and right today,
But rather on the word made clear that You
Reveal of what is beautiful and true.

9 The heart of man plans out his way,
But YHWH shall keep him not astray.

10 The divination's the king's lips
His mouth in judgement knows no slips.

11 The weight and measure are for YHWH,
He's made all the weights in the brew.

12 Kings have horror of doing wrong,
For justice keeps the throne *along*.

13 Just lips are the delight of kings,
Those speaking right find love *in springs*.

14 The king's wrath is death's messenger:

The wise will pacify the cur.
15 Life's when the king has a glad face,
His favour's like soft rain *in pace*.
16 Get wisdom, it's better than gold,
More precious than silver untold
Is prudence bought *and kept in hold*.

You made earth's gravity to bear on all
With equal weight so that balances fall
With justice to both stranger and the friend.
The automatic gives You time to spend
In contemplation of the human soul,
That portrait that You dote on to the pole.
If I were truly as divine as You,
I'd never take eyes away from the view
Of human faces where the soul is met
In polished gems, both rubies and the set
Of diamonds and of emeralds' parade
Across the sapphire pathway to the jade.
If I were truly as divine as what
Your hand has made, I should not keep eye
shut.

17 The path of the just bars events
That arise as in accidents,
He keeps his soul in ways of sense.
18 Pride goes before destruction's way;
Highmindedness before fall's sway.
19 Better in the wake of the meek
Than fighting for prey the proud seek.
20 The learned in word finds good things,
Trusting in YHWH and His blessings.
21 The wise heart lies in prudence' fame,
Soft words on the lips great things claim.
22 Knowledge is a fountain of life
To those who have it, but the strife
Of fools with foolishness is rife.
23 The wise heart gives the mouth no slips,
And it shall add grace to his lips.
24 Words of grace are like honeycomb,
Sweet to the soul, balm to the loam.

I follow in the wake of the meek who
Are despised by the market and its crew.
I see the azure eye, the blackened pool
Of eyes that turn every man into fool.
I search with probing glance beneath the
brow,
They arc of Your descent upon the how,
And find wherever I turn in the meed,
Your heart's reflected above every need.

Beloved, I follow in the wake to see
The etchings of mighty eternity,
Where tyrants have no guess of what is
there,
Of what shimmers beneath the scalding air,
Of what can never be destroyed, effaced,
But by itself alone darkened, disgraced.

25 There is a way right in men's eyes,
The end of it is death's disguise.
26 Who labours labours for himself,
His own mouth makes him work like elf.
27 The wicked man delves wickedness,
His lips the burning fires caress.
28 A perverse man spreads mischief round,
Deceitful, he spills friends aground.
29 An unjust man allures his friend,
And leads him in the ways of fiend.
30 The one who contemplates his thoughts
With eyes closed, biting lips in plots
Brings wickedness to pass in draughts.
31 Age is a crown of dignity
When it's found in just ways to be.
32 The patient man's better than those
With courage and lined up in rows,
And he who rules his spirit than
The guards upon the wall who scan.
33 The lots are cast into the lap,
But YHWH makes the decision's gap.

The way that seems right in the eyes of
man
Becomes the blueprint of religious scan,
And so are born the many faiths that see
The torment of fashioned humanity.
The only faith that is pure in the sun,
Is not that which brings glory to the one
Who was its founder as it seems to be,
But that faith that from earth's eternity
Is spoken and proclaimed upon the shore
Where Sinai raises up an open door.
Beloved, I cast my lot upon the lap
Of Your true faith and suckle at the sap
That sweetly nourishes the soul laid bare
Where praises and petitions rise on air.

Proverbs 17

1 Better a dry crust in peace broken,
Than a palace filled with the token
Of quarrel and intrigue *unspoken*.
2 A prudent servant rules the coop,

Dividing heritage in group.
 3 As silver and gold purified
 By fire are choice hearts at YHWH's side.
 4 The evil man obeys unjust
 Tongue, deceitful obeys the cursed.
 6 Grandchildren are old men's delight,
 And fathers are sons' glory bright.
 The faithful has the whole world's wealth,
 The faithless not a farthing's *stealth*.
 7 Distinguished words do not become
 A fool, so how much less in sum
 Do lying lips become a prince,
To hear them I shudder and wince.

The goat believes that since the gold is sent
 Into the fire of purifying meant,
 Then humankind must meet the bitter edge
 Of pain before sitting on glory's ledge.
 Fie on the poor excuse grasping men make
 For gloating on a brother for the sake
 Of hopes that such strokes shall not fall on
 me,
 For judging of the heart immorally!
 Beloved, the word of Solomon is that
 You love the human soul not for the vat
 Of fire but for the beauty that has sat
 On human brow in the decision made
 To act according to Your law's parade.
 The beauty of holiness, not pain's spade.

8 A bribe's a jewel for one to wear it,
 Where're he goes, he's glad to bear it.
 9 The one who hides transgression's view
 Seeks friendships in the motley crew,
 The one who repeats the offence,
 Divides friends *and makes social rents*.
 10 Reproof does more good with the wise
 That one hundred strokes on the guys
 Who have no sense *before their eyes*.
 11 An evil man's rebellion's blame,
 A hard messenger takes his claim.
 12 It's better to meet a bear that
 Has been robbed of her cubs than drat
 Fools who trust their foolishness pat.
 13 The one who gives back evil for
 The good that he's received in store,
 Shall find that it has not departed
 From his own house *although it carted*.
 14 To start a fight's to open dike,
 So leave the spot before first strike.

The hiding of transgression is a sword
 With the two edges as proverbs have bored.
 Hiding the sins of the oppressor must
 Merely support the government of dust.
 Hiding the faults of those whose penance
 sheds
 A glory on the low prostrating heads
 Is reason well displayed. And yet the mind
 Will always find a way to pay in kind.
 The one who fosters buggery by staying
 The tongue from witness that it should be
 saying
 Always has holiness as an excuse.
 This proverb is subject to gross abuse.
 Beloved, make every sin appear in sight
 That offers consternation of the right.

15 The one who justifies the way
 The wicked act as well as they
 Who condemn the just, are both caught
 Abominable in YHWH's plot.
 16 What good's wealth to a fool, since he
 Cannot buy wisdom in the spree?
 The one who builds his house high seeks
 Its downfall, and the one who speaks
 Without learning shall fall into
 Evil things *when they come in view*.
 17 A friend is always loving and
 A brother in distress at land.
 18 A stupid fool claps hands for joy
 When he's surety in employ
 Of his own friends *and at their hand*.
 19 The one who loves strife and unrest
 Loves sinful ways and sinful zest.
 20 The one who has a perverse heart
 Shall not find good in house or cart,
 And the one whose tongue is perverse
 Shall fall in evil ways or worse.
 21 A fool's born to his own disgrace,
 Even his dad has a sad face.

With silence and with word a man can give
 False witness on the earth, and yet may
 live.
 False witness is the justifying tongue
 That frees oppressors to oppress in rung.
 False witness is the hanging lip that joys
 Condemning the upright with sinful toys.
 Beloved, I tread a meagre path below
 The eyes of many people on the go,

And some take trouble to condemn the
truth
That I have with voice proclaimed from my
youth,
That Your commandment is the way to go.
And some set me in the oppressor's row.
But most pass on without a glance for me,
And leave me to the job of being free.

22 A joyful heart is health to age,
Sorrow dries up the bones in wage.
23 The wicked man takes bribes from
pocket
To pervert justice in the docket.
24 Wisdom's reflected in the face
Of the wise man in every trace,
The eyes of fools roam all around
The world to see what can be found.
15 A foolish son's his father's sorrow,
And mother's bitterness to borrow.
26 To fine the innocent's not good,
Or strike prince judging as he should.
27 The one who sets bounds on his words
Is knowing and wise *like the birds*,
The man of understanding is
Of precious spirit *in the whiz*.
28 Even a fool will appear wise
If he keeps his mouth shut in guise,
And if he closes fast his lips,
He will not be caught up in slips.

I've lived in years and tears enough to
know
That joyful heart's the only way to go.
The hurt imagined and the cut that's true
Bring down the body with the spirit too.
I've lived in days and praise enough to see
That cantillation of eternity
Upon Your sacred word gives life and
health,
Although it does not always lead to wealth.
Beloved, I take the calm of spirit now
And come before You on Your throne to
bow,
I take the merry heart and chosen word
To brighten up the day that had been
blurred
With care and share of pain and toil and
grief.
I let in angels and put out the thief.

Proverbs 18

1 The one who sets himself apart
From humankind in hand and heart
Bears his own reproach *in his cart*.
2 A fool does not accept the words
Of prudence, unless like the birds
He finds the grains desired in heart.
3 When the wicked man comes to fill
His sin, he rises in the hill
Of his disdain, but shame's his bill.
4 A man's mouth's words are waters deep,
Wisdom's fountain a stream to leap.
5 Accepting the face of the sinner
Is not good, to decline from winner
Of truth in judgement not to keep
Is a mistake, *look and not leap*.
6 A fool's lips meddle with the strife,
His mouth provokes quarrels *for life*.
7 The mouth of a fool's his destruction,
His lips are his soul's ruin's induction.
8 The gossip's words so harmless seem,
They reach into the stomach's beam.
Fear throws down the lazy man's wall,
Effeminate in hunger's thrall.

How many times I've been the fool to stir
Troubles by coming to the aid and fur
Of those that injustices caught in whirl.
I have not made the world a better place
By linking justice to my form and grace,
But only caused myself the pain of hell
To help the helpless get a breathing spell.
I am a fool to speak up for the right,
And silence would be wiser than the night.
Beloved, tell me each time I'm tempted to
Resolve the problems of the world in view,
To keep my mouth shut and avoid the
blame
Of those pretending to live in acclaim
Of justice, but keep hand and foot in flame.

9 The one who's loose and slack in work
Is brother to the ones who shirk.
10 The name of YHWH is a strong tower,
The just runs to it raised in power.
11 The rich man's substance is the town
Of his strength, and like walls' renown
It comes around him *like a bower*.
12 Before destruction a man's heart
Is raised in pride; before the part
Of his glory, it's humble tart.

13 The one who answers before hearing
What the other's saying's appearing
Shows himself a fool and a shame.

14 A manly spirit keeps the weak
Firm, but a spirit that would seek
Wrath, who can bear with such a flame?

15 A wise heart shall acquire good sense,
The ear of the wise seek presence
Of good instruction *in his tents*.

16 A man's bribes will enlarge his way
And make room before princes' sway.

I thought the gifts that Solomon betrayed
As smoothing out the path of the waylaid
Were talents and capacities that I
Was born with and attained beneath the
sky.

Only upon the straight and narrow way,
In tight rooms without honour, without pay,
Did I find out the gifts of Solomon
Were all the bribes taken from those who
run.

Beloved, the hope of highway and of room
Is too late for my pocket and my doom,
And so I sit beneath the shade in joy
For my unused gifts still in my employ,
And taste the cold spring water without
wine,

The sprig of mint, and on potatoes dine.

17 The first to speak seems in the right,
But when the other comes in sight,
Both sides of the coin come to light.

18 The flip of coin serves to adjust,
Even between the great in thrust.

19 A brother once betrayed is more
Difficult to regain in store
Than a strong city, and their hate
Is greater than the city gate.

20 It's by the mouth man eats his fill
And by his lips satisfied still.

21 Death and life are in power of tongue,
Those who love it eat fruits in rung.

22 The one who's found a good wife finds
His fortune, and his pleasure winds
From YHWH. The one who drives away

A good wife sends his goods astray,
But he who gets adultery
In a wife is a fool on spree.

23 The poor appeals with supplications,
But rich folk answer in rough rations.

24 A man with many friends is naught.
There are friends better to be sought
Than is a brother's loyalty,
And such are friends of quality.

The problem with friends, my Beloved, is
this,

That in this day and cage there's not to
miss

The galloping about the world to find
The marvellous, and places to be dined,
And while one's prancing under palm and
fir

One loses touch with those at home who
stir

About themselves in every continent.
Old friends are gone, forgotten in their tent.

Beloved, be You a friend to me as I
Whirl on a world where hardly any guy
I see about me is one that I knew
Before the gallivanting caught the crew.
Beloved, be You a friend to me and mine,
Alone beside the well and coloured vine.

Proverbs 19

1 Better the simple life and poor
Than wealth with perverse lips *to lure*.

2 The lack of knowledge is not good
For anyone, and those who should
Walk quickly stumble in the wood.

2 Man's own folly destroys his way,
He frets in heart against YHWH's sway.

4 Riches make many friends, but those
Who are poor see them leave in rows.

5 A false witness shall not remain
Unpunished, and who speaks in vain
Shall not escape *the judgement train*.

6 Many give honour to the brave
As friends of those with gifts *they crave*.

7 All of the brothers of the poor
Hate him, also his friends for sure
Leave him to stand outside the door.

8 The one who has a mind loves his
Own soul, and the one who's in biz
Of prudence finds good things in whiz.

Beloved, I see a good thing in the fact
I have no property to tempt the act
Of friendship or of robbery which seems
To be about the same thing in the dreams

Of populace these days. The rich man
 knows
 That people flock to him to fleece his rows,
 But cannot be sure which are real friends.
 The poor man knows it all before he
 spends,
 Who is a friend and who is not. I see
 That life is better lived in poverty.
 Beloved, perhaps that's why so many
 choose
 To live without a bank account and lose
 The opportunity to be struck down
 By every con man riding into town.

9 A false witness shall not remain
 Unpunished, and who speaks lies vain
 Shall perish *under all the strain*.
 10 It's not becoming for a fool
 To live at ease beside the pool,
 Nor for a servant to have rule
 Over his princes *like a mule*.
 11 The wisdom of a man is known
 By patience, and his glory's shown
 To pass over wrongs *set in stone*.
 12 As is the roaring of a lion,
 So is the wrath of king to try on,
 But as the dew upon the grass
 Is the king's cheerfulness to pass.
 13 A foolish son's grief to his father,
 A wrangling wife's like a roof rather
 That constantly leaks *like crevasse*.
 14 Both house and lands come from *the*
hands
 Of parents, but a prudent wife
 Comes properly from YHWH *for life*.
 15 Sloth casts into a *deeper* sleep,
 An idle soul's hungry *to weep*.
 16 He that keeps the commandment keeps
 His own soul, but the one who peeps
 In neglect of his way meets steep.

Diogenes was such fool that he
 In Corinth was bought as a slave to be
 The master of his master and his sons.
 So he fulfils the proverbs in his tons.
 Diogenes was such a fool to look
 About him with a lantern in the nook
 And square to find an honest man intact.
 There are no honest men, and that's a fact.
 Beloved, I am dishonest in the glare
 Of every lantern that Diogenes

And Solomon can bring out at their ease.
 I give up to Yourself my lasting share
 Of robbery of life and breath and make
 You only to exist for Your own sake.

17 The one with mercy on the poor
 Lends to YHWH, and He'll pay for sure.
 18 Educate your son, there's still hope,
 But don't expect too much to cope.
 19 Impatience just results in harm,
 It only gets worse under arm.
 20 Hear counsel and receive instruction,
 You'll be wise at end of reduction.
 21 Many thoughts are in a man's heart,
 But YHWH's will stands firm *from the*
start.
 22 The loveliest thing in a man
 Is his mercy, and better span
 Is in the poor than in the lies
 A man may tell *and so despise*.

I don't know why, Beloved, that Solomon
 Is so enamoured of the poor that run
 About his city and the fields that lie
 Around Jerusalem and under sky.
 He still hopes in his luxury to set
 His son to knowledge and in time to get
 Wisdom. And still admiring eye is let
 Upon the poor. Solomon has no eye
 It seems for what he has in wealth and sty.
 The grass is always meaner on the sly.
 Beloved, let me stand here content with this
 Small corner of the world that my lips kiss
 Beneath the sudden frost, beneath the night
 Of winter coming over hill and sight.

23 The fear of YHWH brings into life,
 And he shall abide night as rife
 Without a wound *and without strife*.
 24 The lazy man reaches the pot,
 But then neglects to take the lot.
 25 Slap down the mocker and a fool
 Will become wiser *for the ghoul*,
 But if you rebuke a wise man,
 Then he will understand the plan.
 26 The one who mistreats father and
 Puts out his mother from the band
 Is shameful and disgraced *to stand*.
 27 Do not stop, my son, hearing well
 Instruction, and do not dispel
 The words of knowledge *from your dell*.

28 An unjust witness scorns judgement,
The mouth of the wicked is sent
To consume its iniquity
And in an everlasting spree.
29 Judgements are handed down for scorn,
And striking for fools' backs forlorn.

The lazy man can get his hand into
The platter but cannot take what to chew.
My cousins were sent to the field to work
Until their father came to see them shirk.
He said he'd give a quarter to the one
Who was the lazier upon his bun
If he only knew which one that could be.
The one jumped up and said "That must be
me."

The other merely drawled there where he
lay,
"Just put it in my pocket for my pay."
Beloved, I am so lazy that I need
No quarter at all for my harvest seed,
I'm too far gone to spend it in my greed,
I'd give a glance perhaps and let it stay.

Proverbs 20

1 Wine is a mocker and strong drink
Rebellion riotous *at brink*,
The ones who delight in such *spree*
Are without wisdom's *equity*.
2 The king's terror's like lion's roar,
Provoke him at your own life's score.
3 Honour's to keep out of the brawl,
But fools have a reproach for all.
4 The sloth finds it too cold to plough,
He'll beg in summer with vain brow.
5 A man's motives are deep in heart,
But wise men will expose the part.
6 Many men are called merciful,
But who'll find a man called faithful?
7 The just in his simplicity
Shall leave offspring in blessing's lea.
8 The king that sits on judgement's throne
Scatters all evil with look's loan.

Beloved, I am an anti-clerical
And frown on ministers and the royal,
So I resent Solomon's constant rate
Of royalty as if in righteous state.
He's always warning people to beware
The wrath of kings, and praising kingly
share

Of hard-handed beneficence with care.
His view's one I do not appreciate.
Beloved, be You my king and president,
Be you the priest and deacon in my tent,
And I shall live in that simplicity
Of justice that beneath the dome and free
Of sky remains a temple and a cloud
Of Your presence by fir and birch allowed.

9 Who can say "My heart's purified,
And I'm cleansed of my sin beside"?
10 Two different weights and measures are
Abomination under star
Of YHWH, and so's their maker's *car*.
11 Even by what he does is known
A young one, if his works are shown
To be right and clean *as a bone*.
12 The hearing ear, the seeing eye,
YHWH has made them both *on the sly*.
13 Do not love sleep, for poverty
Shall come to oppress, rather flee
With open eyes to find your bread.
14 "It's worthless" says the buyer, then
He goes to boast of it to men.
15 There's gold and every kind of gem,
With lips of knowledge above them.

St Paul forgot about this verse, no doubt,
Because in his day there just was no shout
Of concordances complete, even Crude
Books then did not exist in any brood.
He could have used this verse as well to say
That all are sinners and in wicked pay,
But it would have been just as great abuse
As of the Psalms when put to such a use.
Though none is pure who's willing to
declare

His righteousness upon the market square,
Yet there are many, I've no doubt, who live
Just lives and about whom the knowing
give

A good report of upright word and deed,
The heart, though, is not theirs, but Your
own speed.

16 Take away the garment of him
Who's surety for stranger dim,
And take a pledge from him also
Who takes it in the strangers' row.
17 The bread of lies is sweet to man,
But then his mouth is filled with bran.

18 Plans are enforced by counsels set,
 And wars by governments *in debt*.
 19 Don't mess with those who secrets tell,
 Walk in deceit and open well
 Their lips *as though to bide a spell*.
 20 The one who curses dad and mom,
 His light shall fail with darkness come.
 21 Inheritance quick from the start
 Shall end without a blessing's part.
 22 Don't say "I'll get revenge upon
 The wicked deed," wait for the dawn
 Of YHWH and He will bring help on.

I'm often tempted to pour on the foe
 My vengeance for his wicked deeds in
 stow.

But then I think to what avail the dart
 Of nuclear warhead sent on my part,
 When I can get You to destroy the guy,
 Both body, soul and wealth here on the sly.
 I know that tattling's ugly, so I'll wait
 For You to notice how I suffer fate,
 And then I'll gloat to see the burning ration
 That You pour out on enemy and nation.
 Beloved, let me take no wicked revenge
 On any in my sight from old Stonehenge
 To Timbucktoo, where all the hidden books
 Reveal the flaming wisdom of Your looks.

23 Two different weights are horror to
 YHWH, and deceit in balance true
 Is not good, *but turns back on you*.
 24 The steps of men are guided by
 YHWH, but who can know his own try?
 25 It's fatal to devour the holy,
 And go back on vows made *to lowly*.
 26 A wise king scatters wicked ones,
 And covers them by wheel *in tons*.
 27 A man's spirit must be YHWH's lamp,
 To search all hidden things in damp.
 28 Mercy and truth preserve the king,
 His throne's strengthened by mercy's ring.
 29 The joy of young men is their strength,
 Old men's dignity grey hair's length.
 30 The bruising stroke on wicked men
 Blots out their evils once again.

The wise king Solomon appeals to here
 Is no doubt coming down the years in fear,
 Cyrus the Great invented scattering
 And ruling by the pitting ring on ring

Of one against the other, such a sting.
 Assyrians invented the faith of
 Samaritans to keep the land in glove,
 And then the Persians with a wit to sound
 Invented Jews upon the sacred ground,
 So one would hate the other and inform
 The king of any duties left to warm.
 Beloved, I do not love the rule that makes
 Divide and conquer wisdom for the sakes
 Of those who will divide and rule the
 stakes.

Proverbs 21

1 Deep streams of water is the heart
 Of the king in hand of YHWH's part,
 Wherever He desires He may
 Turn it *since He possesses sway*.
 2 Man's ways seems right in his own eyes,
 But YHWH searches the hearts *in guise*.
 3 To do mercy and judgement pleases
 YHWH more than sacrificing eases.
 4 Proud looks enlarge the heart indeed,
 The lamp of the wicked's sin's seed.
 5 Industrious plans produce results,
 But every sluggard stays in faults.
 6 The one who gets rich by his lying
 Is vain and foolish for relying,
 But shall stumble on snares of death
Where finally he'll lose his breath.
 7 The violence of evil men
 Shall become their downfall again,
 Because they would not do judgement
Wherever they in time were sent.

The way that seems right to a man is that
 A human sacrifice will fill the vat
 Providing sure salvation for the fat.
 The truth is You, Beloved, in mercy hold
 A better way, and one that's clearly told,
 A man who does in mercy in Your sight
 And in his doings does what's right in light
 Will please You far more and in better
 grace

Than one who comes with sacrifice to trace
 The crosses and the resurrections' pace
 Of god-men who atone for sin and waste
 And leave them free to sin and cut and
 paste.

Beloved, I set my hand to do Your law,
 The big ten, and keep You always in awe.

8 The guilty follow crooked ways,
But the pure do right works *for praise*.

9 It's better to sleep on the roof
Than listen to woman's reproof.

10 The wicked one in evil lust
Has no pity on neighbour's crust.

11 Before the punishment of mockers
Fools become wiser *when they're stalkers*,
And if they then follow the wise
They shall receive knowledge in guise.

12 The just considers seriously
The house of the wicked in spree,
So he may bring the wicked out
Of evil lying round about.

13 The one who plugs his ear from hearing
The cry of the poor on appearing,
Shall also cry himself in fearing.

14 A secret gift appeases wrath,
A prized donation smoothes the path.

15 The just find joy in doing right,
But sinners dread it *in the light*.

The litmus test to find out if one's just
Is whether one is happy with the crust
Of doing what You command in the ten
You spoke upon a day before all men.
The wicked heart finds that obedience
Tastes dry and dusty and it gives offence.
Beloved, I joy in taking only You
And no man for my King where I in pew
Rejoice in Sabbath day and quit the fray
Unwilling to take life of wicked hue.
Beloved, the joy of following Your way
Is more than enough in the divine pay.
Relinquishing the fearful soul I cast
Out vengeance from my heart, and so I last.

16 The one who departs from right ways
Shall find his rest in deathly stays.

17 The one who desires luxuries
Shall be the prey of poverties,
He that loves wine and dining too
Shall not get rich whate'er he do.

18 The wicked ones become the rate
Of ransom for the righteous state,
And unjust for the upright mate.

19 It's better to live on dry sand
Than in a raging woman's band.

20 Treasures of Muhammad remain
With oil where the upright have gain,
But foolish men shall waste it all.

21 The one who follows justice' call
And mercy, shall find life and justice
And glory too *able to trust us*.

22 The wise man's scaled the strong men's
town

And cast strength of confidence down.

23 The one who keeps his mouth and
tongue,
Keeps his soul from distress *when stung*.

The wicked ones become the price to pay
For ransom of the righteous in the way.
Yet all sweet Christians make of Christ a
sin

To pay for their right to commotion's din.
They quote poor Paul and Peter to the dust,
And find Christ made sin for the ones who
trust

That doing evil is the cast of men,
And You're unable to give grace again
So all might act according to Your law.
Such reasoning opposes proverbs' claw.
Some day, Beloved, You'll treasure up
Your own

And cast the wicked in lake of brimstone
And so rid universe of all that's ill
And ransom the upright on Zion's hill.

24 The proud and arrogant is called
Ignorant, working wrath unvalled.

25 The sloth is killed by his desires,
Because his hand from work retires.

26 He pines and wishes all day long,
The upright gives and still is strong.

27 The sacrifice of wicked men
Is an abomination then,
Because it's come from evil den.

28 A lying witness shall fall down,
Obedience shall have the crown.

29 The wicked man is impudent
To harden his face as he went,
But he who's righteous comes to stay
By correcting his *crooked way*.

30 No wisdom, care or counsel's share
Avails against YHWH, *so beware*.

31 The horse is prepared for the day
Of battle, but YHWH's safety's sway.

The one who makes the soul of Christ to be
Atonement for his sin unfaithfully,
Is sinner when he lifts the sacrifice.

So You refuse to think the offering's nice.
 The sacrifice of wicked men You see
 As an abomination on the tree,
 And so the sacrifice can cleanse no sin,
 No matter how great it may seem to win,
 The death and resurrection of the just,
 Not only just, but god-man in the dust.
 The only sacrifice that could avail
 Would be, according to Solomon's trail,
 The sacrifice of righteous men below.
 But such need no such blotting with the
 snow.

Proverbs 22

1 Fame is better by far than wealth,
 And popularity than *health*
In gaining gold and silver's *stealth*.
 2 The rich and poor have met each other,
 YHWH is the Maker of the brother.
 3 The prudent man saw evil and
 Hid himself *in the secret land*,
 The simple kept on *in the state*
 And suffered loss *by every rate*.
 4 The product of humility
 Is fear of YHWH, wealth and glory
 And life *in all eternity*.
 5 The wicked take up arms and sword,
 But he who keeps himself unscored
 Departs far from arms *where they're*
stored.
 6 Train up a young man in his way,
 When he's old he'll not go astray.
 7 The wealthy rule over the poor,
 The borrower's a servant sure.

The day of good rule's past, the day of
 church
 And synagogue and mosque: all leave in
 lurch.
 The prudent man will seek a hiding place
 Out in the wilderness, where he can trace
 The lowly living of the herb and find
 His bread upon the tubered and the vined.
 The prudent man sees evil of the day,
 The fall of reason, and the goddess' sway
 Of the irrational called self-esteem.
 The world is living in a ghastly dream.
 The prudent man finds water and his share
 Of lentils and a hut to sleep though bare.
 Beloved, I flee to Your footstool to see
 The woodland hills give gracious company.

Fifty years back every poor land around
 The world could feed itself and not be
 bound.

Such freedom was a slap in bankers' faces,
 And so they made a show of waving traces
 Of loans to make the rich richer, the poor
 Foodless and hungry under the stakes sure.
 The borrower's a servant, it is true,
 Now every government's a slave in due,
 A mercenary state to take up arms
 In foolish carpetbagging and for harms.
 Beloved, I flee to You and to the soil,
 The gathered juices of the honey-foil,
 The dandelion and violet for sweet,
 The nettle and potato for my meat.

8 The one who sows iniquity
 Shall reap evils things for his spree,
 And with his very rod of wrath
 He shall be consumed *on the path*.
 9 He who's inclined to mercy's pace
 Shall be blessed; for of his bread's grace
 He's given to the poor. He who
 Makes presents shall gain victory true,
 And honour, but he carries off
 The souls of receivers to scoff.
 10 Cast out the scoffer and contention
 Shall go out with him *as prevention*,
 And quarrels and reproach shall cease.
 11 He who loves purity in heart,
 For his lips grace shall have the part
 Of the king for his friend *to start*.
 12 YHWH's eyes preserve wisdom's
 increase,
 The words of the unjust shall cease.
 13 The sloth says "Some lion's about
 To kill me in the street *or route*."
 14 A strange woman's mouth's a deep pit,
 He who draws on himself *as fit*
 The wrath of YHWH shall fall in it.
Evil ways are before a man,
He will not turn away from plan;
But it's needful to turn aside
From a perverse and bad way's ride.

I love the pure in heart, Beloved, but find
 No king like Solomon with gifts to bind,
 But only rulers like strange women round
 Seducing businessmen to make a pound
 On evil plans and violence on ground.

I love the pure in heart, Beloved, but see
 That they are few and hard to find, agree
 That one in a thousand's too much to be
 The restoration of Sodom in glee.
 Beloved, I wait for unjust words to cease
 And justice from Your hand here to
 increase,
 And while I'm waiting like the slothful
 beast,
 Filling my face and tummy at Your feast,
 I can avoid the lion that's without.

15 Folly's found in heart of a child,
 Correction will subvert the wild.
 16 He who oppresses the poor folk
 To increase his own wealth *for broke*
 Shall himself lose what he has got
 To one that's richer *on the spot*,
 And shall be needy *in the plot*.
 17 Incline your ear, hear a wise word,
 Apply your heart and be it stirred
 By my right doctrine. 18 For it's sweet
 To hide such in inner retreat;
 If you keep it inside your heart
 It shall flow out in your lips' part,
 19 So that your trust may be in YHWH,
 Which is why I've shown it to you
 Today. 20 I've already three ways
 Shown it to you, in thoughts and stays.
 21 So I might show you certainty,
 And the words of truth *faithfully*,
 To answer out of these to those
 Who sent you *out not to oppose*.

The principles of the stock market rose
 In Solomon's mind dressed in royal
 clothes:

With stunning planning try to take the meat
 From off the neighbour's table and his seat,
 And when the wealth is gained to an excess
 Some cunning fool will find the new
 address

And take that pile away in the same way:
 The children of Belial never stray.
 Beloved, make me and mine as faithful to
 The good and right as those who sit in pew
 Of cleverness to rob the poor are there
 Faithful and constant in their evil share.
 So a bastion of righteousness would rise
 Unheard of in all history's disguise.

22 Do no violence to the poor
 Because he's poor and that is sure,
 And do not oppress needy folk
 In the gate *helpless under stroke*.
 23 Because YHWH will judge that man's
 cause,
 And will afflict them that with claws
 Have attacked him *against all laws*.
 24 Don't be a friend to angry men,
 Don't go with raging ones again.
 25 You might end up learning their ways
 And make yourself scandal *for praise*.
 26 Don't be with those who shake the hand
 And promise under debts to stand.
 27 If you don't have the means to pay,
 Why should they take your bed away?
 28 Don't go beyond the old landmarks
 Your ancestors set up *in parks*.
 29 Have you seen a man skilful swift?
 His place is among kings to lift
 And not before the obscure shrift.

Rage is the mark of divine on this earth,
 So why does Solomon warn of their worth
 Who rage upon the paths of wickedness?
 It's cunning that's the danger to address.
 The cunning in the government and plot
 Of media and business have a lot
 To answer for when crowds gather to rage.
 Mark Anthony himself on the rampage
 Was cunning more than wrathful on the
 stage.

It's rhetoric condemns the world to loss,
 It's rhetoric, not arms, that make the boss.
 Solomon, wise as is his wisdom's cross,
 Has not yet learned that words in evil toss
 Out violence overt for covert page.

Proverbs 23

1 When you sit with a prince to eat,
 Take a good look at drink and meat,
 2 And put a knife at throat's desire
 Even if hunger *flames like fire*.
 3 Be not desirous of his meat,
 In which is the bread of deceit.

If one must beware of the king's right hand
 Raised up against his guests for contraband
 In eating to the full of sweet meats laid
 Out to impress the mind more than the raid
 Of hunger, then the opposite is true.

Sit with a poor man and eat all that you
 Desire of lentil soup and barley grain.
 There is no danger in the poor man's reign.
 Beloved, I sit each day to drink the wine
 And eat the feast that You set out to dine.
 I taste my humble fare, I bite the crude
 And thank my wife that she's made
 something good
 Of Your simplicity, though You still sit
 Upon the throne of universe with mit.

4 Do not labour hard to get rich,
 With prudence set bounds with a ditch.

The wisest word Solomon ever said
 Was that who earns above his daily bread
 Is greater fool than any born with head.
 To take more on the plate than one can eat
 Is the first thing forbidden by the meet
 Who tend their children barely weaned on
 feet.
 If such is wisdom that is taught the child
 Before he leaves the playground and the
 wild
 To learn his numbers and his letters fair,
 I wonder at the honour given where
 Grown men take stocks and rocks beyond
 the rate
 That they can fit upon their dinner plate.
 That's why Messiah told us all to thank
 For daily bread, not for what's in the bank.

5 Don't raise your eyes to riches which
 You cannot have *beyond the ditch*,
 For they shall sprout wings like those on
 An eagle and fly towards the dawn.
 6 Do not eat with an envious man,
 And don't desire his meals *to scan*.
 7 Because, like an astrologer,
 He thinks, but does not know the stir.
 "Eat and drink" he will say to you,
 But his mind's on another view.
 8 The victuals you ate you'll throw up,
 Your sweet words wasted in the cup.
 9 Do not speak where fools can hear you,
 For they'll despise what you say true.
 10 Do not move boundaries of the small,
 Nor enter fields of orphan's stall.
 11 For their near kinsman's strong to judge,
 He'll bring their cause against your
 smudge.

12 Be diligent and study well
 Instruction and let ear hear spell
 Of knowledge. 13 Do not keep a child
 From his correction in the wild,
 For if you give his wisdom's knocks,
 He will not die *upon the rocks*.
 14 Give his body the discipline,
 And save his soul from hell and sin.
 15 My son, if you have a wise mind,
 My heart in you its joy shall find.
 16 My kidneys too shall sing a song,
 When your lips speak right *and not wrong*.

A little pain now in the body that
 Would rather run free from the place he sat
 Is worth the cost when virtue's to be
 gained.
 For virtue's rare among the one's who've
 reigned.
 A little care and tiring at the mill
 Of drudgery to learn the right from ill
 Turns into wealth unknown among the
 great,
 The wealthy robbers sitting in estate.
 Beloved, I thank You that the poor can find
 Your treasures above those who have
 turned blind
 To justice and to mercy, but acquire
 The gold imperishable and the fire
 Of oil upon the ground of their desire.
 Distinctions are made in the hand and
 mind.

17 Don't envy wicked people in
 Your heart, but remain without sin
 In the fear of YHWH all day long,
 18 Because you'll have a future hope,
 In expectation safety rope.
 19 Hear now, my son, and become wise,
 And guide your mind in the way's rise.
 20 Don't sit in the great drinkers' feasts,
 Nor in their revellings *with priests*
 Who bring out flesh to eat *in prize*.
 21 Those who give themselves up to
 drinking,
 And club together shall be sinking,
 And their sleep covered with rags *stinking*.
 22 Take care to hear your father's word,
 Who has begotten you and heard,
 And don't despise your mother when
 She has become old *among men*.

23 Buy truth and do not sell wisdom,
And instruction and try to hum
With understanding *and not rum*.

With what does one buy truth, Beloved, tell
me?

It's falsehood that's for sale eternally.
The truth comes crashing in like act of
God,

The thunder and the lightning without rod.
Truth's not to be bought, no, nor parried
down,

But trumpeted forlorn about the town
Where everyone turns faces towards the
creed

That supports murder, war, and cosmic
greed.

With what does one buy truth? I fit the bill
With flight from the exposure on the hill.
No man wants truth about himself but just
About the neighbour's morals in the dust.
Beloved, there is no market for the truth.
Let Solomon expose ignorant youth.

24 The father of the just rejoices
Indeed that he's begotten choices
In wisdom's son, and shall have joy
To be dad of so good a boy.

25 Bring also joy to mom and dad,
May your begetters too be glad.

26 Give now, my son, your heart to me,
And let your eyes keep my ways free.

27 A prostitute is a deep ditch,
And a strange woman narrow hitch.

28 She waits for prey like robbers too,
Increasing evil things men do.

29 Who has a woe, who has a groan?
Who has contentions, who's alone?
Who has wound without explanation,
Who has red eyes, *infection's ration*?

30 Those who indeed pass time in wine,
And study to drink cups from vine.

31 Don't look for the wine when it's rose,
When it shines brightly as it goes
Pleasantly in the glass in rows.

32 At last it shall bite like the snake,
And sting like basilisk *awake*.

33 Your eyes will engage a strange dame,
Your heart seek out a wicked flame.

34 You'll be like one rocked in the sea,
A pilot fast asleep on watch.

35 You'll say "They struck me but I felt
Nothing at all of the pain's welt.
They dragged me, I lay wretchedly,
When shall I wake up and find Scotch?"

I always figured those who say Your word
Allows a bit of jolly wine unstirred,
Ought to take all the Bible for their share,
And accept death penalty for the glare
Of drunkenness. That is a good deterrent
When alcohol's for sale at the rate current.
But alcohol is good to keep sight blurred
When not able to distinguish a curd
Face for the wife, and when the call is
strong.

Beloved, methinks that Solomon's not
wrong.

I have a Scottish name, I have the coil,
But I'm not sot on keeping Scottish soil
Drenched in the blood of alcoholic swoon.
I'd rather see a better side and boon.

Proverbs 24

1 Don't try to be like evil men,
Don't want to be with them in den.

2 They plan out robbery, their lips
Speak of deceits *with hands on hips*.

3 By wisdom the house shall be built,
By prudence strengthened to the hilt.

4 By instruction storerooms are filled
With precious, pretty riches billed.

5 A wise man's strong, a knowing man
Is stout and valiant *in his plan*.

6 Because war's managed by due order,
It's safe with more than one recorder.

7 Wisdom is too high for a fool,
Beside the gate, *beside its pool*
He shall not open his mouth's tool.

8 The one who invents evil things
Shall be called fool *by men and kings*.

9 The very thought of fools is sin,
And the detractor *out to win*
Is abomination *in bin*.

Only the wise man sins by act alone.

The thought of fools needs something to
atone,

And even deaths on crosses do not make
A foolish thought acceptable in stake.

There is no use in telling the thing to
The fool, since wisdom is outside his view.

The only thing there is a man can do
Is plod along within the right and true.
Beloved and Father of just and unjust,
Look down on Your children, all made of
dust,

And take responsibility at last
For the results of Your creation's blast.
Then I too will submit in judgement fair
To Your recourse upon the evil share.

10 If you lose hope in trouble's day,
By weariness your strength in sway
Shall be diminished *for a day*.

11 Deliver them led out to death,
And those condemned to lose their breath,
Don't hesitate to save them then.

The governor of Texas, I've no doubt,
Neglected to read this word in the spout
Of punishment capital, when he did
Not deign in mercy to lift awful lid
On sentences that sent the killer and
The murderer to death. So here I stand
In judgement on the murderers that chose
To kill and join the criminal in rows.
Beloved, I thank you for the Decalogue
That guides the human mind left in the fog
To know what's right in judgement and
what's left.

Otherwise humankind is laid bereft.
How many judge in hundreds of false
things!
In only ten is judgement right for kings.

12 If you say "I've not strength enough,"
The one who sees in the heart's stuff,
He understands, nothing deceives
The keeper of your soul, His sleeves
Shall render a man by his pen.

Indeed I have not strength or inclination
To cut off heads of wicked men in stations,
Although I find them all about me here,
And even my own heart has learned to fear
The evil thought and evil word that makes
The hands and feet susceptible in wakes.
But You, Beloved, know well the evil part
Of every soul, and every hand and heart,
And so I pray that You will render me
The punishment of every evil spree
That I commit in justice, I demand

No mercy at Your just and gracious hand.
But let the evil fall away from mine
And me and from the neighbour come to
dine.

13 Eat honey, my son, it is good,
And honeycomb tastes like it should,
Sweet in your throat *and sweet again*.

This is the word of Solomon, I guess.
Surely You've better things around to
bless,

Beloved, than to command me to be sweet
By eating honey and the comb for treat.
I do not have to be told it is good,
Whether found wild and perishing in wood,
Or whether gracing hives made by the
farmer

Who hopes to sell it to make his house
warmer.

Beloved, I eat the honey of Your word,
And find that heart as well as stomach's
stirred.

I eat the honey of Your law and find
It sweeter than the comb of the combined.
I eat the honey of Your Names recited
And find both heart and hand on paunch
indicted.

14 So also is the doctrine of
Wisdom to your soul *and in love*,
Which when you've found it, you'll have
hope,

In the end not run out of rope.

15 Don't lie in wait, nor wickedness
Seek in the house of righteousness,
Nor in the spoil of his rest *guess*.

16 For a just man seven times shall fall
And rise again to beat the ball,
But wicked men shall fall down in
The evil *results of their sin*.

17 When your foe shall fall, don't be glad,
And in his ruin let there be had
No joy of heart (*though don't be sad*),

18 Lest YHWH see it and it displease
Him and He turn away the breeze
Of wrath from him *and give him ease*.

19 Do not contend with wicked men
Nor try to be like them again.

20 Evil men have no future hope,
And the lamps of the wicked grope.

Beloved, what use is vengeance on the dust
Of evil-doers, if before the crust
Of its news when it comes to me I must
Not rejoice that the wicked witch is dead?
Could You not spare my greying hair and
head

To find a cause for celebration led
When wicked men fall on their pate
instead?

This world's a dark place largely because
they

Oppress the righteous and the wicked way,
And little there be to make merry for.
So why not let us rejoice all the more
When wicked men are beaten out of door?
Do You not fear the rise hypocrisy
Will make if man must bridle up his glee?

21 My son, fear YHWH and fear the king,
Have nothing with detractors' sting.

22 Their fall shall come up suddenly,
And who knows ruin of both in spree?

*A son that keeps commandment's word
Shall escape from destruction stirred,
Since he's fully received the word.*

*Let no false word be spoken by
The king from the tongue on the sly,
Indeed let no falsehood proceed
From his tongue be whatever need.*

*The king's tongue is a sword and not
A tongue of flesh set in its plot,
And whoever falls under it*

Shall be destroyed, though a man fit.

*For if his wrath should be provoked,
He destroys men with cords unyoked,
And devours men's bones, and burns them
Up as flame not fit to condemn*

*To be devoured by eagles' young.
My son keep in awe words of tongue,
Receive them and repent while young.*

23 These things also be to the wise:

It's not good to respect in guise
Persons in judgement *to despise*.

24 The one who tells the guilty fer
"You're innocent" comes to infer

A curse upon the folk's *demise*.

25 They that rebuke him shall be praised,
A blessing come upon them raised.

Society is made up of the twist

Of spirits out to embrace what's been
kissed

By the false witness calling guilty right,
And raising violence against all spite.
None shall be praised for the rebuke that
stands

Against the false witness in many lands,
Simply because such things are never
heard:

The media has turned into a turd.

Beloved, it is so rare a thing today

That truth is upheld in the courts that sway

The hand of justice as its falsely called.

The morning is a sunset and well walled.

I turn to You and find You're nailed down
fast

To pagan crosses in the beating blast.

26 He'll kiss the lips replying right.

27 Prepare your outside work in sight
And diligently till your ground

Upon which a house you may found.

28 Don't be a witness without cause

Against you neighbour, against laws,

Do not deceive any man with

Your lips *repeating a false myth*.

29 Don't say "I'll do to him as he

Has done *the evil thing* to me.

I'll give back in kind *in the spree*."

Do unto others as they do to you

Is golden rule that's followed in the pew.

Do unto others as you wish they'd do

To you is golden rule designed for few.

Too often I have seen the dangered brink

Of vengeance offered in the mortal stink,
And kept my hand back from the proffered

rod,

Not fearing neighbour's vengeance, only
God.

Beloved, I've found the stroke of stick runs
quick

Upon my back for righteousness as thick.

The blindness of the human heart is such

That good deeds seem black to the flesh in
touch,

And so the tired soul lashes on the mate

Who honoured her and raised her in estate.

30 I passed by the lazy man's field,

By the foolish man's vineyard yield,

31 And saw it all with nettles filled,
 And thorns in cover and the hilled
 Stone wall broken *under the heeled*.
 32 When I had seen it, I laid up
 The thing in my heart *and my cup*,
 And by the parable I got
 Instruction *in the way and lot*.
 33 A little sleep, a little slumber,
 Fold hands in rest *to do a number*.
 34 And poverty shall come astern,
 And begging as an armed man earn.

If Solomon's sly word is true, I'd like
 To know why poverty's not come to strike
 Those who fold hands in so-called prayer
 and thus
 Fulfil the word of Solomon in bus.
 The folded hands in Scripture are in time
 Always the symbol of the lazy crime.
 For prayer men fall down on the craven
 earth,
 Or stand or bow to show You're God of
 worth.
 The hands are spread in supplication's way,
 Or raised beside the ears and head to say
 Allahu akbar in the chosen way.
 But only lazy men fold hands to pray.
 So why are such still wealthy in the fray?
 Somebody answer why the wicked stay.

Proverbs 25

1 These too are Solomon's proverbs,
 That Hezekiah, Judah's king,
 Had his men copy out *for curbs*.
 2 It is God's glory to conceal
 The word, and glory to reveal
 That speech on the part of kings' reach.
 3 The heaven above, the earthly beach,
 And heart of kings can no man teach.

Indeed, Beloved, You do conceal Your
 word
 In languages so ancient and not heard,
 In proverbs and in laws that take the best
 Of a man's years to contemplate and rest
 And still each day find greater gems in
 treat,
 And greater enlightenment at Your feet.
 King Solomon indeed revealed the plot
 Of what You concealed in the vacant lot,
 And he was king too as he does not fail

To relate in the proverbs of his tale.
 But most kings here just have not got a clue
 Of all the glory concealed in Your view,
 But still seem just as great a mystery
 As heaven and earth for all eternity.

4 Take off the tarnishment of siller,
 And a pure vessel comes to fill her.
 5 Take wickedness from the king's face,
 His throne is set in justice' place.
 6 Do not take airs before the king,
 Do not stand in great men's place' wing.
 7 It's better he should tell you come,
 Than that you be put down in sum.

The sweet Messiah Jesus took this word
 As his own without giving credit heard
 That Solomon first told men to sit low
 And wait for the prince to raise up their
 show.
 That's all right since the both of them were
 true,
 The sons of David in the people's view.
 So what the son of David says today
 Can always be taken up in the fray.
 Beloved, I sit beneath Your footstool here,
 Apparently without the slightest cheer
 Of human glory on my head or ear.
 I wait to find my glory in the grace
 Of morning come before Your beaming
 face,
 Alone among the trees and snow in trace.

8 Do not in haste say what you've seen
 When you get in a quarrel keen,
 For you may fail to make amends
 Dishonouring one of your friends.
 9 Defend yourself by friend or foe,
 But don't reveal a secret's show.
 10 He might insult you for the thing
 That he has heard and on the wing
 Not stop to chide you. Beyond grace
 Friendship will save a man in case,
 Keep these for yourself, do not fall
 Under reproach *for what you call*.
 11 To speak a word at the right time
 Is gold apples in silver rhyme.
 12 Worth an earring of gold set bright
 With a pearl is one who does right
 Reproving a wise man whose ear
 Harkens *to faith of YHWH and fear*.

13 As cold of snow in harvest time,
So is a faithful messenger
To one who sent him out *to climb*,
For he refreshes his soul's *fur*.

Sometimes I think I've had enough of cold.
In youth the frost seemed like a burning
gold,
But now it only touches to the bone
And on occasion calls forth a small groan.
I need no more of messengers of late.
It's good You sent no more down on my
pate
After Muhammad to stake in my share.
I've heard enough reproach for all I care.
Beloved, enough I read in verdicts drawn
By scholars of the writings in the dawn
Of revelation. I'm ready to stand
In silence of Your presence on the sand
Of pearl and silver, rubbed with the morn,
And woollen scarfed before the evening
scorn.

14 As clouds and wind when no rain falls,
So is the boastful man who calls
But does not do as promise stalls.
15 By patience princes are appeased,
A sweet tongue breaks the bones when
greased.
16 If you've found honey, eat enough
To satisfy, lest in the cuff
Of being gluttoned with it you
Vomit the whole *and lose the due*.

I knew a dog once that, let in the house,
Jumped on the table, and like quibbling
mouse,
Ate all the honey he could from the pot,
And then with little tummy on the spot
All rounded with the weight of contraband,
He vomited the whole out on the sand.
Beloved, I am a dervish dog, it's true,
And I come to Your table spread in view
With sweetness more than I can take and
eat.
I do not stop to think of cold or heat,
But gobble up Your blessings till I fail
To keep Your cakes inside me in the gale.
If once I'd learned, it would be little loss,
But I keep coming back for what You toss.

17 Go visiting your neighbour's table
But rarely, lest he find your fable
Too much and start to hate your label.
18 A man that bears a witness false
Against his neighbour's like a *waltz*
Of dart and sword and arrow's *malts*.
19 To trust in an unfaithful man
In time of trouble is a plan
Like rotten tooth and weary foot,
20 Like taking off the coat you put
On for a freezing day *outdoors*,
Like vinegar and lye *on sores*,
As he sings songs with wicked heart.
As a moth treats a woollen scart,
And worm the wood, so sadness' part
Consumes a man down to the heart.

I've heard the wicked singing, if You call
It singing that is done today in brawl.
Indeed good Solomon was right to say
It's like a toothache and footache to bay.
Although the rocky summit was not known
In Solomon's day where the sun once
shone
On grove and high-place where the priests
arose
To gyre and tremble on the grabey grose,
It was familiar also to his ear,
Who knew no new thing comes with novel
gear
Under the sun, but every wicked way
Is just a repetition of its pay.
I shiver passing vinegar and lye
That consumes evil hearts that will stand
by.

21 If your foe's hungry, feed the guy,
If he's thirsty, bring water nigh.
22 For you'll heap hot coals on his head,
And YHWH shall reward you instead.

I've never yet been fed by enemy,
Although the hundreds who've come to my
table
May not all be among the strong and able
Who count me friend and so friend
faithfully.
That's why I have no scabs upon my wee
Bald pate like the Ash-boy in Indian fable,
Nor do my foes, if any be to cabal,
Show scars of my good hospitality.

Beloved, You have fed me and given water
 By hand of wife, and kept me from the
 slaughter
 All these years, yet I feel no painful rift
 Upon my scalp where cinders come to drift.
 I thank You that You don't treat me as foe
 Despite my lack of sacrifice in stow.

23 The north wind drives away the rain
 As does the countenance in pain
 The tongue that backbites *men in vain*.

24 Better to stay on housetop gable
 Than at a brawling woman's table,
 And in one house to hear her cabal.

25 As cold drink to a thirsty soul,
 So is good news from a far toll.

26 Like a spring troubled under foot
 And a well spoiled by filth and root,
 So is a just man who falls down
 Before the wicked *in their town*.

27 Too much honey is no good thing,
 So seeking glory before king
 Ends in honour's overwhelming.

If Solomon would just make up his mind.
 This is the third time honey's been
 enshrined

In his words holy to the seeing blind.
 At first he said to eat it to the full,
 And then he reckoned limits bountiful
 Should guide the tongue and stomach on
 the rung.

And now just hear what Solomon has sung.
 Instead of praising honey's properties
 Of health and healing under entreaties,
 He warns that taking too much is not good.
 I guess this trinity of hollow wood
 Pounds out a message from Your throne
 indeed:

All things in moderation have their need,
 All journeys in their limits have their
 speed.

28 As a city lies without walls,
 So is a man who has not balls
 To stop himself from speaking-halls.

I have not quite learned to keep my mouth
 shut,
 Since on occasion, as though the joke's
 butt,

I accept invitation to the hall
 To give a speech in honour of a ball.
 Though hair is grey and falling, perhaps I
 Still have some years left to give self the
 lie,

And prove my good intentions carried out
 Not to go ranting, preaching all about,
 But stay duly at home and just write
 prayers

In ghazel-sonnets for You Name's fair
 shares.

Beloved, my many words above the din
 Of many others' words spoken in sin
 Reduce Your thunder-speech on Sinai's
 slope

To far-off pantomime and slender hope.

Proverbs 26

1 As snow in summer, harvest rain,
 So honour to a fool is vain.

2 As the bird flees, sparrows escape,
 So every curse without right drape
 Has no effect on any nape.

3 A whip for every horse, and goad
 For every ass, so is *the load*
 Of a rod on fools' back in mode.

4 Do not reply to any fool
 According to his folly's *drool*,
 And so avoid being his tool.

5 Answer a fool and show his fit,
 Lest he imagine he has wit.

6 The one who sends his message by
 A fool is lame of feet and sly
 To drink up his iniquity.

7 As a lame man has pretty legs
 Of no use, so's the speech's pegs
 In the mouth of a fool to be.

The fool is the one who in government
 Listens to the word of the lobby's vent,
 And lays a stack of stock against the right,
 Pretending that he's keeping in his sight
 The load of justice. With a flick of pen
 He joins the civilized among the men.
 Beloved, the pretty leg, the stand for state,
 The well-cut suit, the talent to relate,
 The finer taste in art or then the belt
 For rock music that hits him with a welt,
 All are the cover of vain speech and way
 That turns to artificial in the bay
 And must in time fail of the greater pay.

I watch the springtime come and see snow
melt.

8 The one who ties the stone inside
The sling is just as like to bide
As glory at a fool man's side.

9 Like a thorn piercing a drunk's hand
Is a proverb that a fool's planned.

10 Like an archer who shoots at all
Is guarantor of a fool's stall.

11 As a dog turns to what he's heaved,
So a fool takes what he's received.

*There is a shame that brings on sin:
And shame with grace and glory in.*

12 Have you seen one who thinks he's
wise?

There's more hope for a fool in guise.

13 The lazy man says "On the road
There is a lion, and the goad
Of lioness guards every load."

14 As the door turns on hinges set,
A slothful man's on his bed met.

I reckon hinges have more than one use,
The one to set the moving parts obtuse
In working order and the other one
To illustrate how close the lazy bun
Swings in the bed to avoid work in sun.
My hinges swung this morning before four,
But still I took a nap till the sun's store
Had met the pines above my house with
light,
And stirred the darkened firs beyond that
site.

Beloved, there is a brash growth that turns
on

The undergrowth of leafy brush at dawn,
While the pines fail to plant their progeny
Among the foliage, firs creep in to see
Their future once assured by seedlings
drawn.

15 The lazy man reaches the plate,
But is too lazy at that rate
To put food in his mouth *too late*.

16 The sluggard's wiser in conceit
Than seven men set at reason's feet.

When the good tinker set in Bedford gaol
Spun reason's seven good parables and
hale,

He knew that coxcombs could be wiser still
In their retreat to St. Paul's on the hill.
The reason that the prelates reach the plate
And never put a morsel of Your rate
Into their bellies, is because they find
The golden spoon more delicately tined
Than faith in its simplicity well-wined.
Beloved, though I'm a coxcomb in my
chair

Of carven oak along the quire in share,
I take the sweetly sung of word in truth
And lay aside the collects of my youth,
And taste the syllables that are not bare.

17 As one who takes hold of dog's ears
Is he who meddles in the gears
Of others' quarrels to his tears.

18 Like raving ones shooting out flames
And lances to destroy in claims,

19 Is the man who deceives his friend
And claims it was a joke in end.

20 When the wood fails the fire goes out,
And when the gossip's thrown about,
Contentions cease *along the route*.

21 As charcoal is to burning coals,
And wood to fire, like angry shoals
A man in wrath stirs of strife's tolls.

22 The words of a gossip may seem
But simple things, yet in the cream
They reach to the bottom and beam.

I've told a tale or two in my lifetime
And lived to see it was mistaken rhyme.
A tale or two has been told on account
Of me and mine drawn from a lying mount,
And I have lived to see it take its toll.
How easy it is to steal from the dole.
The guilty have passed on without reprieve,
Too proud to admit fires when they
deceive.

Beloved, account to me no tale untrue,
And pluck from hell the ones who without
due

Deceived the world about my actions done
In innocence despite the ready run.
Let no soul be lost in the fading path
Because of vain and tempting songs of
wrath.

23 Like argentine on a clay pot
Are burning lips and corrupt heart.

24 A foe is flattering with his lips,
But in his heart his deceit slips.
25 Trust not the simpering voice and sweet,
Seven mischiefs in *wicked* heart beat.
26 The one who hides hatred behind
Deceit, assembly'll not be blind.
27 The one who digs a pit shall fall,
A stone rolled shall return *like ball*.
28 A lying tongue loves not the truth,
A slippery mouth works ruin *for ruth*.

The base metal and clay are hidden by
The gilding and the silver on the sly.
So pretence of friendship held as polite
Is just a way to take the neighbour's right.
Would that the words of Solomon were true
That such behaviour always ends in rue.
Some fine deceit committed years ago,
And centuries back has not hit the show.
Beloved, do not gild me with shining ware,
But keep my outside humble as the fare
Within my inner chamber where my crust
Is bitten with the ashes and the dust.
The little flame of truth shines on its walls
Of stone and granite slabs where whisper
calls.

Proverbs 27

1 Don't boast about tomorrow, for
You do not know what is in store.
2 Let other's praise you, not yourself
And not your own lips *off the shelf*.
3 A stone is heavy, sand has weight,
But worse than both's a fool's wrath's
state.
4 Anger has no mercy, nor fury
When it breaks out, who's in a hurry
To bear the violence provoked?
5 Open rebuke is better yoked
Than hidden love *that leaves one stirry*.
6 Better the sore wounds from a friend
Than lying kisses in foe's end.
7 A soul that's satisfied shall tread
Upon the honeycomb and bread,
But a soul that's hungry shall take
Even the bitter for sweet's sake.

Beloved, just call me sticky foot and be
Done with the epithets cast upon me.
My soul is satisfied as I sing out
In cantillation all the rounds of shout

That Your word gives me in sweet words
and bitter.

So I need no more honey in my litter.
And yet I'm like the hungry in that I
Am satisfied to cantillate or try
Your bitter words as well as what is sweet.
The whole Tanakh to me is just a treat.
Be Psalm and Torah sore wounds from a
friend
Or lying kisses in the common trend,
I whirl in fast contentment on the sky,
And doubt not, on You, Beloved, I rely.

8 As a bird wanders from her nest,
So a man leaves his place at best.
9 Ointment and perfumes grace the heart,
Good counsels of a friend *to start*
Are sweet to the soul *for their part*.
10 Your own friend and your father's
friend
Do not forsake, do not intend
To go to your brother's house when
You are afflicted *in your den*.
Better's a neighbour that is near
Than a brother far off *and drear*.

I am no hermit, my Beloved, it's true,
Although I live with fir and pine in view,
The city lies spread out beneath my feet,
And all the dogs are led past in retreat.
I have occasion, if I like, to speak
To three or four who pass my cabin peak
Each day to take their exercise and seek
A vital place in market, church and pew.
Beloved, I have no brother on the wing,
Nor any kin near me for anything,
So I am forced, whether I like or not
To give the neighbour a chance at the shot.
Four houses grace the fringes of the wood
Where I see neighbour for better or good.

11 Study wisdom, my son, and make
My heart joyful, so you can take
Up a reply to answer him
Who would reproach you *with the dim*.
12 The prudent man when evil comes
Runs and hides, but the simple bums
Keep on the way and suffer pains
From every president who reigns.
13 Now confiscate the man's cloak who
As a scorner passing in view

Lays waste another's goods *undue*.

14 The one who wakes his neighbour up
Before the sun shines in his cup
With a loud shout of blessing's praise
Is like one who curses his days.

The damning with faint praise is civilized,
And satisfaction comes when it's devised,
Especially when the culprit gets his thanks
From the one whose head was hit by his
wanks.

No better way to elbow those aside
Who target the same slope in raging pride.
The best way to avoid the managed mess
Is find a profile below the address.
Beloved, my praise to You is faint indeed,
Because my tongue is flat and gone to seed,
Because my heart turns with the pride of
sun,

And I have reasons for the things I've done.
But when You take me on Your lips to hear
My bones are filled with life, my barns
with gear.

16 The north wind, it is biting sharp,
With such a name no one will carp.

17 As iron files the iron, so one
Man polishes his friend's face *spun*.

18 The one who plants a fig tree eats
Its fruit, and so the one who treats
His master is honoured in feats.

19 As faces are in pools reflected,
So man's heart's by the wise inspected.

20 Hell and destruction don't fill up,

So man's eye's unsated by cup.
*The one who sets his eye on gain
Is before YHWH a horrid stain,*

*And those who are without the light
Of His instructions fail in spite
To restrain their tongue from its bite.*

I'd think that in Solomon's day at least
The mirrors of brass garnished every priest,
But it may be that some looked in the pool
To see the face well-painted like a fool.
Since I stopped cutting off the growing
beard

And styling hair in fashions of the weird,
Many days go by that I fail to peer
Into the pool or mirror as a seer.
Beloved, instead I look into Your law

As James says in epistle made of straw
And find the lineaments divine that You
Reveal from deeper places, yet in view.
And in that pool I also wash my ways
And lend my life each day to be Your
praise.

21 As silver's tried in fining-pot,
And gold in the furnace made hot,
So a man's tried by the mouth of
The one who praises him *in love*.
*The wicked heart seeks evil things,
But righteous hearts seek after wings
Of knowledge after questionings.*

*The heart of the transgressor seeks
After mischiefs; the upright peeks
Around for knowledge without stings.*

22 Though you should pulverize a fool
In mortar with pestle *as tool*

Among the grains, still foolishness
Will not depart from his address.

Solomon is outraged by foolishness,
The mind covered by dark illusion's dress.
The wise do not enter in peace of mind
But, irritated by the mien of blind,
Rage and rage on against earth's
faithlessness.

Wisdom is deep, it seems, and yet is just
The realization upon the dust
That every face reflects the divine trust,
Not only mine, but all created crust.
None can escape the knowledge that Your
share

Is found within his heart and throne to bear,
But wisdom sees by faith the same soul
where

The other man is toiling in the must.
Solomon's outraged that Your lovely face
Goes here unrecognized from base to base.

23 Be diligent to know the face
Of your cattle and your flocks' trace.

24 For you'll not always have the wealth;
The crown is transferred on in stealth.

25 The meadows bloom, green herbs
appear,

The hay is gathered from hill's weir.

26 Lambs for your clothing and kid goats
For the price of the field *in oats*.

27 Let goats' milk be enough for food,

And for the needs of house and brood,
And for the keep of handmaids *rude*.

I too think that the goat's milk is the best,
But that's because I live in wealth and rest.
A woman who became so dear to me
Beside the Euphrates' eternity
When asked what she would choose of all

to see

Upon the earth, if she could have it free,
She said in common wisdom of the race,
"I'd like to have a cow in the goat's place."
Beloved, some seek the gold, some seek the

trace

Of honour and of jewels, some beware
The hopes of power and oil beyond their
share.

But some dream of a cow instead of goat,
A lovely cow giving both milk and note
Of lowing melodies in courtyard's share.

Proverbs 28

1 The wicked flee when none pursue,
The just, bold as a lion in view
Is without dread of *one or two*.

When Solomon wrote this, he had not
heard
About the Nazi ways and what occurred.
The man of steel had not yet raised a head,
And George and Sam had not divided
spread.

Today the just keep profile low and sweet
And make a wise and excellent retreat,
While those who own the companies and
thus

The parliaments are those who make a fuss.
Beloved, I flee as bold to You when I
See how the great to least here come to vie,
And when I see You flick away a fly,
I turn and flee to You. Wherever turns
The earth around the meadows and the
burns

I find You fail not from the earth and sky.

2 A land revolting has for chiefs
Many, but a man in reliefs
With wisdom and intelligence,
His reign is prolonged in *his tents*.

3 A poor man oppresses the poor
Like a storm in violence sure

That brings in famine to the door.

4 They who forsake the law will praise
The wicked man *for days and days*,
Those who keep it in anger rage
Against the one *who tore the page*.

If those who keep Your law are marked by
rage,

Solomon must then have another gauge
Of righteousness than those here in my
town.

Before my rage the Baptists pull a frown.

If I rage that men fail to keep Your law,
The first thing is they want to clip my claw.

If I rage that men fail to cut their meat
From foreskin and to take a resting seat
Upon the Sabbath day, they find me quaint
In splitting cares, pretending to be saint.
Beloved, I rage and rage on, though the
quire

Of Christians sweet condemn me to the
mire,

And in the fire find that Your voice alone
Sustains me where I stand before Your
throne.

5 Men in the thrall of evil know
Not what is right and just to show,
But those who search for YHWH are those
Who understand *the law that glows*.

6 Better's the poor man when he walks
In his simplicity of stocks,
Than the rich man in crooked ways.

7 The one who keeps in *all his ways*
The law is a wise son *for praise*,
But the one who gives gluttons share
Is a shame for father to bear.

8 The one who gathers up wealth by
Interest and loan gathers the shy
For him who keeps poor under eye.

The interest taken on the loan is what
Is in Your law, Beloved, forbidden glut.
I'm not sure what this cryptic proverb here
Means with that thing in memory and gear.
The practice of economy that's based
On interest while the people spend for
waste

Is one that in the end sooner or late
Creates war in both city and in state.
Beloved, I see how well the world today

Contains the violence that keeps the sway
Of wealth based on the industry of fine
Bombs and their missiles while I drink my
wine.

Fear is a thing for sale no limits meet,
While sugar and rice in surfeit defeat.

9 The one who turns away his ears
From hearing the law in his fears,
His prayer's abomination's *tears*.

I guess this text means that the ones who
wait

To observe Sabbath on a day too late,
Come with prayers that arise before Your
throne

As an abomination and a groan.
No doubt this proverb taken at a shout
Means that the one who disrespects in rout
His mother and his father, when he prays
Is humming horrid things for days and
days.

Beloved, I dare to pray to You in trash
Of sonnets wakened with the morning's
lash,

As though I kept Your law in board and
sum.

Forgive abominations that I hum,
And I shall bend a will to keep Your law,
Not kill, not break the Sabbath, not fail
awe.

10 The one who deceives wickedly
The just, shall fall in his own free
Destruction, and the upright shall
Possess his goods, *both house and sal*.

11 The rich man thinks that he is smart,
The poor man shall search out his art.

12 In joy of the just there's great glory,
When wicked reign, bad ends the story.

13 The one who hides his sins shall not
Prosper, but one *before he's caught*
That shall confess and forsake them,
Shall obtain mercy *like a gem*.

Beloved, I do thank You that it is easy
To get forgiveness for my actions sleazy.
It is enough to confess and forsake
My sins to bask in mercy and its wake.
I do not have to study out the tales
Of twenty god-men in the eastern vales

Who died on trees and rose again to bring
Health, wealth and some fertility in wing,
To find out which one is the best to sing.
Beloved, I do thank You that I can find
Forgiveness without the atonement's blind
In phallic crosses set on every hill
And ranged in wood and silver and the drill
Of gold and gems before I get my fill.

14 Blessed is the man who always fears,
But he that is hard in his gears
Shall fall into evil *arrears*.

15 A roaring lion, hungry bear,
So is a wicked prince to fare
Over poor people *sitting there*.

16 A prince without prudence oppresses
Many by harsh acts he addresses,
But he who hates the covetous
Shall lengthen his days *without fuss*.

17 One guilty of another's blood
Will flee headlong into the mud.
Let no one help him from the flood!
Discipline your son, he'll love you,
And give honour in your soul's view,
He'll not sit in a sinful pew.

18 He who acts upright shall be saved,
But the perverse one shall be waved
And fall suddenly in the graved.

It is upright to keep Your law and such
Receive Your mercy for the things they
touch,
Are saved from every ill and circumstance.
But the perverse are those who come to
dance
With joy that some god-man came out to
prance

Upon a tree and dying thus set free
All people to commit sin in a spree.
Such ones with their gross, vain theology
Shall fall indeed in the mire suddenly.
Beloved, I lay hold of Your law to know
Simplicity of action keeps me low
Before Your throne and Your authority.
Before the sunrise on the holy lake,
I meditate Your law, confession make.

19 The one who tills his ground is fed
And he shall be filled with *white bread*.
But he who follows idleness,
Shall live in poverty's address.

20 A faithful man shall be much praised,
But the one who's by riches dazed
Shall not be innocent, but grazed.

The first million, they say, is never share
Of honesty, the seconds to come there
Are given to philanthropy in fair
Hope that it may make grosser
compensation

For evil done in struggling for the ration.
If my wealth shall be based on what my
land,

Or that of wife and dad-in-law to stand,
Produces of the flower and bush and root,
I fear my riches are no more than soot.
Beloved, my wealth lies in the golden sun
That hovers on a winter's day begun
Upon my window sill, where I look out
On aspens that in summer were so stout
In waving, waving little hands about.

21 The one who favours any man
In judgement does not well by plan,
And such a person for the pay
Of a breadcrumb will sell truth's sway.

22 A man who rushes to be rich
And envy others in the pitch
Does not know he'll be thrown in ditch.

23 The one who rebukes later finds
Favour with him, but those in binds
Of flattery find no such hitch.

24 The one who steals from dad and mom
And says "This is no sin in sum"
Is partner of the murdering bum.

25 A greedy man incites to fight,
But one who trusts YHWH to do right
Is satisfied *both day and night*.

26 The one who trusts his own heart's
dumb,

But trusting YHWH will beat the sum.

27 The one who provides for the poor
Shall not be in need, that is sure,
But he who turns deaf ear upon
The cry of the poor in the dawn
Shall himself suffer poverty.

28 When the wicked rise up to see,
Men shall hide themselves. When they fall
The just shall increase on the ball.

Beloved, I gave away my salary
To the poor and those who asked me freely

Until my wife and daughter put a stop
To such things while we still had store and
crop.

They took away my wallet and my pence
And would not let me go out without sense.
It was no virtue, my Beloved, I'm sure,
And yet it was foolish innocence pure.
Beloved, I did indeed give pence and
pounds

And I indeed am still upon the grounds
Of wealth in my simplicity and rounds.
My riches are increased and beyond
bounds:

The silver of the quartzite on my hill,
The gold and rubies on my morning still.

Proverbs 29

1 The stubborn man who will despise
The one who instructs him as wise
Shall suddenly meet failure and
Health shall not follow *in his hand*.

2 When righteous men increase, the folk
Rejoice; when wicked lay the yoke,
The people mourn under the stroke.

3 A man that chose wisdom makes glad
His father, but the one who's had
To keep harlots spends his wealth bad.

5 Deceitful flattering in a man
Is spreading nets to catch as can.

6 A snare shall trip the feet of those
Wicked ones sinning in their rows,
While the just shall praise and rejoice.

7 The just takes notice of the voice
Of the poor; the wicked one's vice
Is in lack of knowledge *of price*.

The one today who parades as the just
Takes notice of the poor whose voice from
dust

Reveals what he is willing in great trust
To buy from the just merchant for a crust.
The population's so increased because
The ones whose wealth creates the running
laws

Are teeming in a market for their claws.
No longer do the poor buy axe and saws.
Beloved, I know that You are poor beyond
Relief of praise and prayer under the frond
Of crosier and of blessing on the pond.
Baptism fails to bring Your voice these
days

Despite the crinkling of the icy plays
Drawn out beneath the firs just for Your
praise.

8 Corrupt men bring a town to spoil,
But wise men turn away wrath's *coil*.
9 A wise man arguing with a fool,
Be he angry or laughing cool,
He shall find no rest by the pool.
10 Bloodthirsty men hate the upright,
But just men seek his soul *from spite*.
11 A fool speaks all that's in his head,
A wise man defers at the spread,
And saves some knowledge for the dread.
12 A prince that hears lies gladly finds
All his servants have wicked minds.
13 The poor and the oppressor both
Meet under YHWH's eyes *and His oath*.
14 Kings truly giving the poor right
Establish their thrones in time's light.

There's not a man on earth who does not
choose
The crowd with which he comes to browse
and bruise.
The one who is served best by flattery
Will find ulterior motive in that glee
That strips him of the things that people
crave.
The one who is served best by gall and
slave
Will pay the salary it takes for knave.
The one who's out for laughs returns to
find
The floor must still be swept by someone
kind.
Beloved, the crowd I choose is one that
brings
The silent worship of love to Your rings,
Without the gems and jewels the quire
sings,
Without the hems and tools the wire flings.
I too choose something out of sight and
mind.

15 Rod and reproof give wisdom's woof,
The child left to his own will's goof
Keeps his mom from shame not aloof.
16 The wicked are increased on earth,
So crimes do not appear in dearth,
But the just shall see them all fail

As the unjust bite dust on trail.

17 Instruct your son, he'll give you rest,
And make your soul delight in best.
18 When prophecy shall fail, the folk
Shall be scattered under the stroke,
But he who keeps the law is blessed
With bounties unheard of, unguessed.

I no doubt fail to keep Your law since I
Am sunken in the mire of lusty cry.
But still I lay hold on prophetic word
Aligned with the great anthem I once heard
In thunder's sound on Sinai's crimson
cloud

Reverberating over all the crowd.
The prophecy has long since failed and he
Who last held up the word and faithfully
Is washed at Ali's hand and in the tomb.
I say a prayer within that very room.
But he who keeps the law in hand and heart
Is blessed with all the prophets' bounties'
part,
And finds among the scattered peoples here
The two or three who worship You in fear.

19 It's not with words a slave is manned,
He'll not obey though understand.
20 A man who speaks before he thinks
Has less hope than a fool *at brinks*.
21 The servant treated softly from
His childhood will think he's become
A son of the house and not bum.

Today we do not think like Solomon
In terms of treating slaves under the sun
In ways to keep them working a fair share
While beating on their backs when they're
laid bare.

The Torah law for slavery is that when
The seven years are over, then the men
May go free and with property to spare.
That's why they must be worked to death
before
The seven years come rolling at the door.
Beloved, though You're a slave to me and
mine,
To all the pimps and prostitutes in line,
I treat you kindly, till You think at last
That You are of the household not outcast.
Let Solomon keep his proverbs half-mast.

22 A man of passions stirs up strife,
 And he that has quick-tempered fife
 Is like to sin *more than his wife*.
 23 A man's abased by his own pride,
 Glory's on humble spirit's side.
 24 The one who takes shares with a thief
 Hates his own self *without relief*;
 He hears the hateful word and yet
 Is silent while he hedges bet.
 25 The one who fears man quickly falls,
 But trusting YHWH walks on the walls.
 26 Many seek the face of the prince,
 But judgement comes from YHWH to
 wince.
 27 The just abhors a wicked man,
 The wicked loathe those in the span
 Of the right way; the son that keeps
 The word, he no destruction weeps.

Everyone hates the wicked man, not just
 Those who are righteous on the earthly
 dust.
 No one loves the man who breaks in to
 steal,
 Nor those who murder under robbing heel.
 The fact that I hate such, if hate I do,
 Proves nothing of my mettle in the pew.
 Rather I rage against convention's choice
 That muffles my fast desires and my voice,
 And keeps me from the passionate embrace
 Of both the just and unjust in this place.
 I loathe not any to my hurt and harm,
 Who would take each and all upon my arm
 To share the kiss of life, the bread and treat
 Where nothing of the winter cools my heat.

Proverbs 30

The words of Agur son of Jakeh,
*Unless it's Gatherer in faker,
 The son of Vomiter and staker.*
 So spoke the man with whom God is,
 One strengthen by God in his biz,
 Abiding with him, here's his whiz.
 2 I am most foolish of all men,
 And human wisdom's missed my wen.
 3 I have not learned wise things, have not
 Known holy sciences *in plot*.
 4 Who has gone up into the skies,
 And who has come down in like wise,
 Who has held the wind in his hands?
Who has wrapped up the waters' bands?

*Who has dominion of all ends
 Of the earth? What's his name and friends?
 Or what name to his children bends?*
 5 Each word of Allah's fire-tried,
 He is their shield when they abide.
 6 Add nothing to His words, lest you
 Be reproved and found liar *in view*.

There are men living now who've spend a
 time
 Upon the moon itself, above the clime
 Of air and sky, so Agur in his rhyme
 Has lost the argument set out in prime.
 That does not mean that Allah's word come
 late
 Or soon before the human heart and gate
 Is of less value for revealing's rate.
 It merely means the numbing bottom set
 In the pew gains relief from being let
 Out on the leash a moment, then to get
 More carefully in ear the word's regret.
 Beloved, whether I spin about the earth
 Or settle in a dry desert of dearth,
 I hear the fire-tried temple on my bet.

7 Two things I've asked of you, do not
 Deny them me before I rot.
 8 Remove far from me vanity
 And lies. Give me not beggary
 Nor riches. Give me only what
 I need before my life is shut,
 9 For fear that in wealth's glut I might
 Be tempted to deny the right
 And say "Who is YHWH?" or in grasp
 Of poverty compelled to rasp
 In thievery and so deny
 The name of my God *set on high*.

How few notice that great stupidity
 Lies in the hand that grasps at more in fee
 Than what the stomach can hold in the
 spree.
 Only the children and fools set on plate
 More than they can eat after the first sate.
 Give me, Beloved, my daily bread and
 drink,
 A forest lane, and wisdom's word to think.
 Remove me far from idols' vanity,
 And set me in the temple of the free.
 These two great bounties Agur asks of
 You,

And satisfied, he sits down in the pew.
I sit beside the Gatherer and see
What vomit the rich pour out soon and late.

10 Don't tell a master what his slave
Has done, lest he a curse engrave
Against you and you lose *the brave*.

11 A wicked generation's here
That curses father *ear to ear*
And does not bless mother *with fear*,

12 A generation innocent
In their own eyes, yet far from vent
Of being washed from filthy rent.

13 A generation with proud eyes,
And eyelids that know to despise.

14 A generation that has swords
For teeth and grinds with the jaw cords
To consume the poor off the earth,
And the needy of men by worth.

15 The horse-leech has two daughters who
Say "Give, give, give and more is due."
There are three things unsatisfied,
The fourth never says to abide:

16 Sheol, the barren womb and earth
Not saturated in the dearth,
And fire never says "Stay" *for worth*.

Stay, my Beloved! It is enough I say!
I've made complaint enough to hear the
way

The poor are so oppressed and yet their suit
Is silenced in their own mouths to the root.
I am no daughter of the horse-leech that
I ask for more Scriptures against the spate
Of evil on this earth for justice rate.

I've had enough of fight with dog and cat.
I turn and return to Your pearl-drawn gate.
The generations of the past are not
Worse than the one I see before my plot.
The heart of man degenerates no more,
And all things turn about eternal door.
Beloved, look down on what we here have
got.

17 The eye that mocks his father's beam,
That despises his mother's steam
In bearing him, let ravens come
Up from the brooks pluck from such bum
His eyes and young eagles eat *rum*.

18 Three things are wonders to my eye,
And four things beyond what I spy:

19 The path of eagles in the sky,
The way of serpent on a rock,
The way of a ship out of dock,
And the way a young man will rock.

20 So too adulterous woman's way,
Who eats and wipes her mouth to pray
And says "I have not gone astray."

21 By three things the earth is disturbed,
The fourth thing of it is not curbed.

22 By a slave when he's become king,
By a fool filled with everything,

23 By a slob when she's married and
By a maidservant come to stand
As heiress of her mistress' land.

The world turns with the fated wheel and
so

The first are last and the last come to go,
Just as the dear Messiah said in speech
According to the Gospel that men preach.
I know a woman in adulterous state
Who's sure that what she's done could
never wait,

But was the product of God-given love,
And so was meant to be, come wish or
shove.

I know a young man too, who's come to
rock
And roll about the city without clock,
Until his freedom causes the town's shock
To have produced so unready a stock.
Beloved, the threes and fours around the
moon
Are wonders and familiars late and soon.

24 Four things on earth are very small,
But they are still wisest of all.

25 The ants are without power as folk,
But take their summer fruits in stroke;

26 The rabbit too is weak as people,
But makes house of the stony steeple;

27 The locusts have no king at all,
And yet go out in bands from stall;

28 The lizard goes on all fours where
It may be taken without care,
And yet lives in kings' houses there.

29 There are three things that will do well
And the fourth walks as if by spell:

30 The lion, strongest of all beasts,
Who fears neither famine nor feasts;

31 A horse with bridle set, a ram,

And a king who claims that I am.
 32 If pride would make you act the fool
 With evil thoughts in mind as tool,
 Lay hand on mouth *and cut the drool*.
 33 The one who squeezes hard the udder
 At last makes come from it the butter;
 The one who blows his nose too hard
 At last gets blood *upon his card*,
 And those who provoke wrath *in sight*
 Produce at last the *desired* fight.

The lizard is a fine thing on the sash
 Of every window where their long tongues
 clash
 With flies who would come trample down
 the butter
 And sandwiches of bread before we cut
 her.
 I say less of the ant, though in its realm
 It has a place along the frozen helm
 Where every year it seems the mound is
 higher
 And every summer the ants climb the pyre.
 With lions and with horses I'm acquainted
 A bit less, yet the very ones I've sainted
 Are locusts with their ears fine-tuned and
 all,
 Ready to hear Your cantillated call,
 And then go out without a king or roost
 To eat the roof off of the world in boost.

Proverbs 31

1 The words of King Lemuel, the speech
 By which his mother used to preach.
 2 What, my son, what, son of my womb,
 What, beloved of my vows *to doom*?
 3 Do not give wenches of your pay,
 And riches to destroy kings' way.
 4 Do not give to kings, Lemuel,
 Do not give to kings the wine's spell,
 Because there's no secret thing kept
 Where drunkenness has the floor swept.
 5 Lest they drink and forget the right,
 Pervert the cause of poor in sight.
 6 Give strong drink to those who are sad,
 And wine to those grieved in mind clad;
 7 Let them drink and forget their pain,
 Remember not sorrow for gain.
 8 Open your mouth to help the dumb,
 For the cause of children in sum.
 9 Open mouth with decree that's just,

And do right by needy in trust.

The principle is that strong drink is just
 A medicine for those who think they must.
 It's not for entertainment set by kings
 To give their congressmen laughter in
 rings.
 It's quite alright to drink fermented stuff
 When the law of the land has remained
 tough
 And gives for drunkenness death sentence
 fair
 According to the Torah to beware.
 But since no government is styled with
 power
 To carry out such outrage in an hour,
 Then alcohol too must go down the drain.
 One cannot pick and choose among the
 sane.
 Either death sentence and freedom to swill,
 Or else teetotalling to fit the bill.

10 Who finds a woman of virtue?
 She's worth more than her pearls in view.
 11 Her husband's heart trusts in her too,
 And he'll need no spoils *in his pew*.
 12 She'll do him good and never bad
 All the days of the life she's had.
 13 She finds both wool and flax to make
 Fine things by her hands' power *in wake*.
 14 And she is like the merchant's ship,
 She brings her bread from far *on hip*.
 15 She gets up early before light
 And provides food for household right,
 And sustenance for maidens' might.
 16 She examines a field and buys,
 She plans a vineyard in her guise.
 17 She gathers up her strength and goes
 Out with a strengthened arm in rows.
 18 She tastes and finds her produce good,
 She keeps her lamp all night in wood.
 19 She puts hand to the spinning wheel,
 She takes the spindle into heel.
 20 She's generous to needy folk,
 Stretches her hands to poor in stroke.
 21 She's not afraid of winter snow,
 For all her servants come to glow
 With underwear longer than show.
 22 She's made herself good blankets too,
 Of fine linen and purple hue
 For covering *and beauty too*.

23 Her husband is known in the gate,
 He sits among elders and great.
 24 She makes fine linen and for sale,
 Set with Canaanite *merchant's* pale.
 25 Strength and beauty remain her garb,
 She laughs to see tomorrow's barb.
 26 She opens mouth with wisdom's speech,
 Her tongue is fine and sweet to teach.
 27 She guards the pathways of her house,
 Not eating idle bread *like mouse*.
 28 Her children rise and call her blessed,
 Her husband praises her *ungessed*.
 29 A crowd of women gather wealth,
 But you surpass *in gear and health*.
 30 Favour's deceitful, beauty vain,
 The woman who fears YHWH again,
 She shall be praised *without a stain*.
 31 Give her of the fruit of her hands,
 Her works praise her in the gates' *stands*.

This would have been a finer thing to hear,
 If Solomon or Lemuel with a tear
 Had praised the grace of women as they
 steer.

Unfortunately the whole piece is made
 By Lemuel's mother speaking in parade.
 Men must be taught time to appreciate,
 They can't be trusted to notice their state,
 But with instruction from a mother's
 tongue,
 They're able sometimes to step up a rung.
 Beloved, I take Agur and Solomon
 And Lemuel and his mother who's won
 A place in Your word for the wisdom that
 Knows how to find the right place on the
 mat.

Beloved, spare righteous folk under the
 sun.

Ecclesiastes

A farmer now retired came to my gate
 The other day and sat down to relate
 That Solomon spoke in the Proverbs fair
 The wisdom to delight and show the stair
 To heaven to the steps in youthful start.
 The book that follows is a different art.
 Instead of wisdom a priori he
 Looks back with learned chagrin wisely to
 see.

Foresight and hindsight both are all around
 And taught by Solomon in heavenly sound.
 Beloved, let me go now beyond that way
 Until I come to insight with the ray
 That Solomon shines on me day to day.
 I draw me to Your throne and there I stay.

Ecclesiastes 1

1 The words of the Preacher, the son
 Of David, in Jerusalem
 Reigning as king, *named Solomon*.
 2 "Vanity of vanities," said
 The Preacher *in his stratagem*,
 "Vanity of vanities, all
Is vanity and to it wed."
 3 What profit has a man from all
 His labour in which his toils call
 Under the sun, *under the sun?*
 4 One generation passes on,
Another generation's dawn
 Comes, but the earth abides forever.
 5 The sun also rises *to sever*
Night, and the sun goes down, and hastens
 To the place where it rises, *chastens*.
 6 The wind goes toward the south, and
 turns
 Around to northward, whirls and spurns
 About continually, and comes
 Again on its circuit *in sums*.
 7 All the rivers run to the sea,
 Yet the sea *does not come to be*
 Full. To the place from which they come,
 There they return again *in sum*.

All things indeed turn in the cycle brought
 From all eternity and at last sought
 By time and place and matter in the light.
 All things indeed return before Your sight.
 The turning and returning of creation
 At first marks human mind with an elation
 Until the whirling falls in weight of dream
 And takes the edge from taste of things that
 seem.

Beloved, I too return before Your face,
 To that one face to which all things must
 race

In spirals and gyrations of the mind
 And body too among the more refined.
 Beloved, I too return to find that none
 Exist in truth but You, the only One.

8 All things are full of weary toil,
A man can hardly tell the foil,
The eye is never satisfied
By all the sights with which it's plied,
Nor ear filled with hearing the spoil.

9 The past repeats itself again,
What men have done, again shall men
Do, no new thing's under sun's *ken*.

10 Is there anything can be said
To be innovation when spread?
It's already been of old time
Before us in the ancient *rime*.

11 No remembrance of what's before,
No remembrance of what's in store
Shall come after the thing's *in core*.

12 Well, I the preacher was the king
Of Israel in Jerusalem.

13 I gave my heart to seek the thing
And search out by wisdom *the gem*
Of all done under heaven's *eye*.
It's a God-given task to vie.

14 I've seen all that's done under sun,
All's vanity, vexation won.

15 What's crooked cannot be made
straight;

That which is wanting has no weight.

16 I pondered in my heart and said

"See, I have grown an adult head
With more wisdom than all before
Me in Jerusalem's *fair door*,

Indeed my heart had much in store
Of wisdom and of knowledge lore.

17 "I set myself to find out truth,
To know madness and folly's *youth*,
And saw this too to be no more
Than spirit's vexing *at the door*.

18 "For in much wisdom is much grief,
To increase knowledge for relief
Is only to increase the grief."

There are some in the dress of faith who
say

That innovation in faith's the wrong way.
In fact there is no new thing under sun,
And innovation's a misnomer won.

What seems to be a new thing and a fresh
Is just the old false way in a new mesh.

It's only ignorance of the past rate

That makes anything seem new in the state.

Enthusiasm hits the ban because

It's blind to former laws and present cause.

Beloved, I see the track of great and tall
Upon the cobblestones along the mall
And follow at a distance to remain
Apart from innovation's new-found gain.

Ecclesiastes 2

1 I said in my heart, Go to now,
I'll prove with high living somehow,
Enjoy yourself, but see this too
Was also just vanity's due.

2 I said of laughter, madness, and
Of mirth, of what use is the stand?

3 I gave myself over to wine,
Though with wisdom I came to pine,
To lay hold on folly in sign,

Till I might see what profits rise
For the sons of men from the skies
In all the days of their life's *prize*.

4 I made myself great monuments,
I built myself houses for tents,
I planted vineyards *with contents*,

5 Gardens and orchards, planted trees
In them all with fruitful bounties.

6 I dug there reservoirs by which
To irrigate my trees by ditch.

7 I got servants and maidens, and
Servants born in my house and land,
I also had great wealth of large
And small cattle more than the charge
Of all within Jerusalem.

8 I gathered silver and gold gem,
A kingly treasure from the hem
Of lands outlying, and I had
Men and maid singers to be glad
With the delights of sons of men,
Musical instruments in den
And everything there is again.

The vanity that Solomon provides
Himself is not all dross to dream besides.

El Greco also paid musicians drawn
To perform on the gold-enchanted dawn.

He painted better while the silver notes
Were hovering on the air, dancing like
motes

Across Toledo's sun-benched terraces,
And so no painting has been done like his.

Beloved, I take the lesson still to heart,

Despite the loveliness of human art,

And know that all is vanity and dart

Before the grand reality that You

Proclaim from throne and the celestial pew
Along the meadowed covenants of dew.

9 So I was greater than all who
Reigned before me and those who drew
Breath in Jerusalem, also

My wisdom was a thing to show.

10 I did not deprive myself of
Anything of desire or love,
Nor my heart from any joy's fruit
Or labour of myself to boot.

11 I looked at all my hands had made,
On all my own labour had paid,
And see, all was vanity stayed,
Vexation of the spirit strayed,
Without profit under the sun.

12 I turned myself to see wisdom,
Madness and folly, for in sum
What can man do for the king come?
Only what's already been done.

13 I saw that wisdom's greater than
Folly as far as light can scan
Above the darkness *wherein's man*.

14 The wise man's eyes are in his head,
But the fool walks in darkness spread,
And I myself perceived also,
The same end comes to all below.

The same end comes to both the fool and
wise,

And all are equally beneath Your eyes.
The vanity of existence is great,
And yet You set creation up in state.
There's no escape from vanity of air,
But there's no one to fault: it is Your share,
And if Your share and Your reflected
grace,

It's nothing to deplore before Your face.
Beloved, I flee to vanity and find
The empty universe as well and blind,
And as I whirl upon the diamond stair,
I meet the reason of all things in trace
Fast painted on the hopeful, pungent rind,
Sunk to the core of everything unmined.

15 Then I said in my heart, "As it
Happens to the fool, so is fit
To come upon me also, and
Why was I then more wise to stand?"
Then I said in my heart again,
"This also is vanity's *den*.

16 "There's no remembrance of the wise
Than of the fool under the skies,
Since what is now in days to come
Shall all be forgotten in sum.

How dies the wise man as the fool,
All enter into the same pool."

17 That's why I hated life; because
The work done under sun has claws
For me, and all is vanity,
Vexation of spirit *at sea*.

18 Indeed I hated all my work
That I'd accomplished without shirk
Under the sun, because I had
To leave it to other men glad
Who should come after me *for bad*.

19 And who knows whether he'll be wise
Or a fool? Still he'll rule in guise
Over all my labour wherein
I have laboured for good or sin,
And wherein I have been shown wise
Under the sun, both set and rise.
And this too's vanity's *surprise*.

Illusion of the senseless waste of being
Comes from the timely way I have of
seeing.

If I could enter in the way that You
Sit above time and space and keep in view
All things both past and future in their way,
All things both in and out creation's sway,
Then I too could with equanimity
Look on boredom or nostalgia freely.
Beloved, I take my flight above the known
Idols of vanity I have been shown
To enter at last the celestial throne.
I see the whirling planets with their share
Of light and darkness streaming
everywhere;
I see the whole above the parts of care.

20 That's why I was about to let
My heart despair for all the net
Which I took under the sun's set.
21 There's a man whose labour is wise,
In knowledge and in justice' guise,
Yet to a man who has not worked
He'll leave it heritage unquirked.
This too is vanity and great
Evil *upon the earth and state*.

22 For what has man for all his toil,
And anguish of his heart in coil,

Working under the sun on soil?
 23 For all his days are sad in grief,
 His heart at night has no relief.
 This too of vanity's the chief.
 24 There's nothing better for a man
 Than eating and drinking a span,
 That he should let himself enjoy
 The fruited labour of employ.
 I saw this also that it came
 From hand of Alohim *in fame*.
 25 For who shall so feast and abound
 With delights as I have been found?
 26 For it is given to good men
 In His sight wisdom and the den
 Of knowledge and joy, but to those
 Who sin He gives but pain in throes,
 To gather wealth and to heap up
 What God has made good in his cup.
 This too is vanity and more
 Vexation of the spirit's *store*.

By Solomon lust is a better vice
 Than greed or cruelty, and that is nice.
 Enjoyment of the harvest and the wait
 To watch the warm night cover all the state,
 These are the only things creation gives
 To humankind upon the earth he lives.
 Beloved, the pagan kings of old who shut
 Their gold within their tombs in wasteful
 glut
 Favoured their heirs by making them to
 strut
 In labour to amass another hut.
 If You have made the purchase price to lie
 Upon the sons who steal their father's sky,
 You also provide for the thief who comes
 To steal the buried crowns and golden
 sums.

Ecclesiastes 3

1 To every *thing there is* a season,
 Every time under heaven a reason:
 2 A time to be born, time to die;
 A time to plant, a time to fly
 And pull up what is planted by;
 3 A time to kill, a time to heal;
 A time to break down, time to feel
 Elation to build up in steel;
 4 A time to weep, a time to laugh;
 A time to mourn, a time *for gaff*
And dancing over, under staff;

5 A time to throw stones, and a time
 To keep from throwing stones *in rhyme*;
 A time to embrace, time to stop
 Embracing *all but mom and pop*.
 6 A time to get, a time to lose;
 A time to keep, time to refuse.
 7 A time to rend, a time to sew.
 A time for silence *to be slow*,
 A time to speak *when on the go*.
 8 A time to love, a time to hate;
 A time for war, for peaceful state.
 9 What profit more awaits the man
 For all his labour *and his plan*?
 10 I've seen the rushing to and fro
 In trouble God has made to go
 The sons of men, *both fast and slow*.
 11 He's made all things good in their time,
 And set them for the world in rhyme,
 So that men cannot find out what
 Alohim has made from the butt
 Of time until the time is shut.

There is a time for everything, the good,
 The evil and the things that I think should
 Occur and those that I think all go wrong:
 Your verdicts, my Beloved, become my
 song.

A man sticks at the law in justice held.
 But Your reality comes in to weld
 All things about the world and sky and
 deep
 Into one whole, both those who laugh and
 weep.
 Beloved, I rage and praise You in one
 breath,
 I live in song and laughter, life and death.
 The hopeful hell and heaven of despair
 Unite to cleave the crackling, cloudy air
 And open to my view the one estate:
 You on Your throne alone above all fate.

12 And I have realized that there
 Is naught but to rejoice a share,
 And do well in this lifetime *bare*.
 13 For every man who eats and drinks
 And sees good of his work, he thinks
 This is the gift of Alohim,
The best of waking and of dream.
 14 I've learned that all the works God
 made
 Continue and for ever stayed,

We cannot add there anything,
Nor take away from wandering
Those things that Alohim has made,
That He may be feared *in parade*.
15 What has been made continues on,
The things that shall be, from the dawn
Of time have been, and Alohim
Restores what is past *and in dream*.

The works of human hand add not a whit
To Your creation, My Beloved, and fit.
There's naught but to eat and drink lovely
sorts
And then rejoice to give You Your reports.
The time that carries me past flooded states
Is motionless to You in what relates
The distant legends of past centuries,
The pulse I feel today, with equal ease
The future dimly caught in symphonies.
Beloved, I now rejoice and let that joy
Be the eternity that You employ,
And when I fail in praise let those be days
Of the illusion for which no one pays.
Let all reality once come to cloy.

16 I saw under the sun in dress
Of righteousness there wickedness,
And in the place of justice lay
Iniquity *by night and day*.
17 And I said in my heart, indeed
God shall judge both the just in seed
And wicked ones, and then shall be
The time of everything *to see*.
18 I told myself that humankind
Would be proven by Alohim,
And He would show them all aligned
To be like beasts *groping in dream*.
19 For that which comes on sons of man
Comes on the beasts too *in their span*,
As the one dies so die they all,
Indeed they have one breath in thrall,
So that a man has nothing more
Than what a beast has *on that score*:
For all is vanity *in store*.
20 And yet all things go to one place:
Of earth they were made in a trace,
And into earth they run their race.
21 Who knows if the breath of the sons
Of Adam ascend up in tons,
And if the breath of beasts goes down?
22 I've found nothing's better in town

Than for a man to joy in work,
That this is his lot, not to shirk.
For who shall teach him of what things
Shall be after him on their wings.

The sweet Christian and Jew and Muslim
too
Are all sure that they are a higher crew
Than animals caught on the slender screw.
Truth is the breath that feeds the art and fall
Of science in the human heart and stall
Is the same breath that touches every lung
Of bird and beast, and trills on every
tongue.
Though none may know if breath goes up
or down,
I trust that every breath upon the brown
Meadow of autumn in the deathly pale
Goes back to You without other avail.
I follow on my breath even in dark
And see Your face illuminated stark
Against the vision of the primal park.

Ecclesiastes 4

1 I turned and thought about the things
Oppressors do in names of kings
Under the sun, and saw the tears
Of the oppressed, and *for their fears*
They had no comforter, but on
The side of the oppressors drawn
Was power, but no comfort *at dawn*.
2 So I thought that the dead were lucky,
More than the living caught in mucky.
3 Indeed, better than both are those
Who have not yet been born or chose,
Who have not seen the evil things
Done under the sun *in its rings*.
4 I thought of all the effort and
Every right work, and how it's scanned
With envy by the neighbour. This
Too's vanity, vexation's kiss.
5 The fool just folds his hands to wait,
And eats his own flesh *in his gate*.
6 Better a handful and in peace
Than both hands filled without release
With effort and vexation's *crease*.
7 Then I returned and then I saw
Under the sun vanity's claw.

Amen, my brother, I say to the man
Who wrote Ecclesiastes as by plan!

It is a vain thing to work hard in toil
 Merely to gain the envy and the spoil
 Of neighbours with claw ready to show
 what
 Greed is secreted in the traitor's gut.
 Refusal to get out and make a dime
 Is just as crass and is a waste of time.
 Beloved, the right way is to work six days
 And rest upon the seventh for Your praise,
 And find the daily bread and eat the nut,
 The radish and the celery to strut,
 The corn and bean and squash, but put the
 knife
 To throat and hand of action for the wife.

8 The man who lives alone and he
 Has neither child nor brother's *fee*,
 Still works head off whilst his eye's not
 Satisfied with the gear he's got,
 Nor stops to question why he works.
 This too's vanity without quirks.

9 Two are better than one, because
 They have a good reward in paws
 For all their effort *in the straws*.
 10 For if one fall the other comes
 To lift his fellow *on his drums*,
 But hard it is to one alone
 Who falls down, *maybe breaks a bone*,
 With no one to help *back on throne*.

11 By the same token, if two sleep
 In the same bed, they do not weep
 For the cold, but how can one be
 Warm by himself *and in his tree*?
 12 Against a single man some might
 Come out into his street to fight,
 But two can hold up a defence.

A threefold cord is strong *in tents*.
 13 Better a child both poor and wise,
 Than an old king who will despise
 Wisdom, and cannot see the right
 Of what the future brings to light.
 14 Sometimes out of prison and chains
 A man comes to kingdoms and reigns,
 And one born to the royal seat
 Is struck with poverty replete.

15 I've seen all living under sun
 Surround heir to the throne and won.
 16 The number of folk before him
 Is infinite and all those dim
 Who shall come after, they shall not
 Rejoice in him, but this too's plot

Of vanity, vexation's spot.

I don't know if good Solomon when old
 Suffered in bed from heartache or the cold.
 He had enough of wives to keep the mat
 Well warmed before he came to lie or sat.
 I don't know if good Solomon when fat
 And ancient envied children for their youth,
 And thought that they had plenty of the
 truth.

I don't know if good Solomon loved gold.
 Beloved, I know that You give in Your
 share

The power and strength to one, to one
 beware

The hopes that disappoint, because the
 heart

Cannot stand where the riches play their
 part.

With wealth and power You give the
 chance to do

The right, but see how many fit the shoe.

Ecclesiastes 5

1 Just watch your step, when you come in
 The house of God to hear the din.
 Much better is obedience
 Than sacrifices without sense
 Of those who do not know how bad
 The things they do are, *it is sad*.

It seems the problem of those who hold that
 One need not obey You, but burn the fat
 Of candles before crucifixes where
 The sacrifices without sense shine bare,
 Is nothing new at all. I see complaint
 And warning anciently told to the saint.
 But watch your step is right, for those who
 pray

To images on crosses hold the sway,
 And they are out to get the ones who stay
 Obedient on the straight and narrow way.
 Beloved, I take Your warning and remain
 At home on Sabbaths to recite for gain
 The Decalogue and holy prophets' cry
 In syllables Semitic to the sky.

2 Don't use rash words, don't let your heart
 Be hasty to utter a part
 Before Alohim, for God stands
 In heaven and you upon earth's lands,

So let your words be few in hands.

Your words, Beloved, are few, I don't deny,

Just one hundred and seventy-two not shy
As spoken by You upon Mount Sinai.

I cannot get along with such a speech:
I have so much to say when on the beach.
I might take time in moments' crime to think

Before I make a statement on the brink,
But still I need more words than You, I fear:

I counted "eths" too in commandments' gear.

Indeed You stand in heaven. If I did too,
Instead of on the earth and in all view,
I might get by with silence as You do.
But here where all reality is met,
My words' illusions are a better set.

3 Dreams follow after many cares,
In many words are folly's shares.

4 If you've vowed aught to Alohim,
Don't wait to pay it *and with cream*,
For an unfaithful, foolish vow
Displeases Him, and so then now
Pay what you've promised, *ram or cow*.

5 And it's much better not to vow,
Than after vowing not perform
What you promised *when you were warm*.

6 Don't let your mouth cause you to sin,
And don't tell the angel to win,
"There is no providence", lest God
Be angry at your words in prod
And destroy all your works in pod.

7 Where there are many dreams there are
Many vanities, and words' *star*
Without number, but fear God's *car*.

How many dreams of superstitious rank
Give way to omens sinister and lank!
Daydreams and the night visions bridle
husk

To grave out new gods on the dawn and dusk.

The vanities of ancient days and those
That rise today to keep men on their toes
All call the sentence with its fatal blows:
There is no providence for which to thank.
Beloved, I walk in providence and swear

The scent of the gardenia heady there
Returns in proof of all that's great and fair.
Beloved, I stand in providence and see
The shadows of its jewels about me
In honeyed overgrowth eternally.

8 If you see the poor are oppressed,
And violent sentence addressed,
And justice perverted and guessed,
Do not be surprised at the rest,
For the one in authority
Is also under a thumb's *spre*,
And there are others *in the tree*
Who sit even above *those three*.

I always thought that it was true the fate
Of civil servants who can never wait
To lay a stripe upon those with no power
To stand up to them in the naked hour
Were marshalled to their evil deeds by
those

Who rank in file of hierarchical pose.
Beloved, if men in their chain of command
Find in that rush excuse to lay the hand
So heavy on the back of poverty,
They do so whilst forgetful of degree
With which You rule creation faithfully.
Do You tire of hearing my vain complaint
Of such oppression on the poor and saint?
Your servant brought it up. I was not
quaint.

9 The best thing for the land is that
The king were honoured where he sat.

10 The one who loves money shall not
Be satisfied with what he's got,
And he who loves wealth above claim
Shall have no pleasure in the same,
For *all* this too is vanity.

11 Where there are riches great there are
Also many to eat the bar.

What profits to the owner rise
To see his wealth before his eyes?

12 While sleep is sweet to working men,
Whether or not he eats again,
But the full stomach of the rich
Makes him sleepless to turn and pitch.

13 It's tragic what I see beneath
The sun, riches held to bequeath
To the hurt of the one who keeps.

14 For it is lost, the owner weeps,

He's sired a son poverty reaps.

The good Solomon ought to know that men
Are happy when they see their guests again
Eat much, no matter what the cost in view.
The master joys to see a healthy crew.

Do You not too, Beloved, the Sovereign of
The universe, look upon us in love
As we devour the substance of Your earth,
And render to You nothing here in worth?
Beloved, the veils of human eyes are such
That even divine of the wise in touch
Will utter strange things and walk with a
crutch.

The helping hand is weak, and yet there's
much

That needs support of veiled knowledge in
kind.

Before the fruit we have to bite the rind.

15 As he came naked from the womb
Of his mother, so shall *in doom*
Return with nothing for his labour.

16 A tragedy: as he came out
Shall he return and without doubt.
What profit's in work to the wind?

17 All the days of his life are binned
In darkness and in many cares,
In misery and sorrow's shares.

18 This therefore has seemed good to me,
That man should eat and drink freely
And enjoy the fruit of his labour,
As he has worked under the sun,
All the days of his life when done,
Which Alohim has given him:
And this is his portion *grown dim*.

19 Every man to whom Alohim
Has given wealth and substance and
Has given him to eat in hand,
And to enjoy his share rejoicing
In his labour, this is the voicing
Of Alohim's gift *on the land*.

20 For he shall not much mind the days
Of his life, for Alohim's praise
Delights his heart *in all his ways*.

It is a true thing that the one in praise,
In cantillation of the Hebrew lays,
Forgets to count the passing of his days.
I sing the Psalms and quibble at the quirk
Of every kind of cantillating work,

And still my heart is lifted as I raise
My thanks to You, Beloved, and do not
shirk.

It is a true thing that the hour is light
When the scrawled footprints You have left
in sight

Become a thing to hear, the peak of sound,
The ease of burdens left upon the ground.
So as I travel on the brief path here
That takes me from the cradle to the bier,
I find delight wherever I may steer.

Ecclesiastes 6

1 This too's a tragedy I've seen
Under the sun where men have been.

2 Alohim gives a man his wealth,
Riches and honour, in his stealth
There's nothing lacking from desire,
But Alohim does not retire
And let the man enjoy it all,
But gives to another in stall.
This is a vanity and thrall.

3 If a man has a hundred sons,
And lives a long life on his buns,
And he consumes nought of his wealth,
And has no funeral *for his health*,
I say the still-born child is better
Than he is *down to the last letter*.

4 He came in vain, goes to the dark,
His name forgotten *in the park*.

5 He did not see the sun, his rest
Is better than the rich man's best.

6 Although he lived two thousand years,
But had no joy in wealth and gears,
Don't all haste to one place in fears?

7 All human effort's for his mouth,
But his soul's not filled *north or south*.

The twist of time caught on a corner of
The cloak of my existence and its glove
Turns all things sweet to bitter as they flee
From time to taste into eternity.

And yet without the limitation's fee
There could be no moment of ecstasy,
To coming on of taste as the fruit sinks
Into the maw of lust with links on links.
Beloved, I am the burden of Your song
Essential that You might remember long,
As long as I am whirling like a spark
Of light and love toward eternal dark.
My melancholy by-product is vain,

But Your enjoyment of the world is sane.

8 What has a wise man more than fool?

And what the poor man in the pool,

Walking before the living school?

9 Better to see what is desired

Than to desire what's not required.

But this too is a vanity,

Chasing of wind *that blows freely*.

10 What shall come has been given name

And plot since the start of the game,

And man cannot escape the net

Determined for him, he will get.

11 The cycles of philosophy

Are words without meaning to see.

12 Why ponder abstracts when man knows

Not even what profits his toes

In all the days in which he goes

And time passes like shadow rows?

Who can tell him what is to come

After him and under the sun?

It did not take Wittgenstein to tell us

Philosophy's an endless, wordy fuss,

And yet the human mind requires the lot

As much as bread and wine upon the plot.

The sound of the wind on the tundra bare

Is futile, yes, as futile, I so swear

As all the wisdom that the saintly wear,

And yet it is a necessary thing,

Determined by the flesh in ring on ring.

Beloved, I raise the memory of Your name

As though it were a matter of acclaim,

And in determined, necessary flame,

I step upon the circle and return

Illuminated where my life would burn.

Ecclesiastes 7

1 A good name before good perfume,

Death day rather than birthday's gloom.

2 Better the house of mourning than

The house of feasting, for the plan

Is to put in mind all the end

Of life in what's to come in trend.

3 Better to rage than laugh because

In serious countenance the clause

Of the offender meets its laws.

4 There's mourning in the wise man's

heart,

The heart of fools takes joyful part.

5 Better to hear wise man's rebuke,

Than be deceived by flattering fluke.

6 Just like the crackling of the brush

Burning under a pot's the gush

Of laughter from a fool, now hush.

Good Solomon the preacher comes to make

Reversal of his former sermon's stake.

Now sorrow is the better way to go

And leave the feasting and the feathered

show.

I doubt his words, except that time is slow.

Both sorrow and the laughter in its wake

Are empty, true, but they're here for the

sake

Of universe that is an empty screen

Until Your image, my Beloved, is seen.

I turn upon my atom in relief,

And whirl upon belief and unbelief

Until the mixture's fixture's pictured there,

And I go to the slaughter ground as bare.

Beloved, the image is eternal stare.

7 Oppression troubles the wise man,

Destroying his heart's strength in span.

8 The end of a speech beats the start,

And better is patience than art

Of hubris *applied in the mart*.

9 Don't be quick to get angry, for

Anger's in a fool's bosom's store.

10 Don't say "What do you think's the

cause

The good old times had better laws?"

Such questions are foolish *in clause*.

The bad old days is more like to say truth.

The human heart now is just as uncouth

As in the days of Noah and David.

So Solomon has no secrets to lid.

The main concern today is that the toys

Are bigger and worse, though the wicked

boys

Are just the same as ever on the heath.

No generation deserves any wreath.

Beloved, I think that evil times may be

In their own character's tranquillity,

And yet no better and no worse in fact.

The average human ways in how to act

Are average for all time, and yet I make

No promise for sin original's sake.

11 Wisdom is worth a fortune and

Brings benefit to all the land.

12 Wisdom's defence and so is siller,
But learning and science are thriller,
And give life to all *but the killer*.

13 Ponder the worlds of Alohim,
Who can correct His stitch and seam?

14 When things go well, enjoy yourself,
Knowing that times will turn to elf,
For Alohim has made them both,
So man finds no reason for oath.

If oppression troubles the wisest men
And so's the mark to bat clear as a wen,
I wonder why I keep harping upon
Oppression all around me on earth drawn.
Perhaps in older times it took a man
Of wisdom to see the oppressor's plan.
But now that obvious is watchword's toll,
Even a fool can see the hidden shoal.
Beloved, no man can right creation's path
Determined by Your love and by Your
 wrath,
But even if a fool today can see
Oppression on the bank of Galilee,
There still are moneyed clients who deny
All things that happen here beneath the sky.

15 These things I also saw in days
When vanity had taught my ways:
A just man perishes to find
His justice returns not in kind,
A wicked man lives long *and sweet*
In his own wickedness's *treat*.

16 Do not be more just than is meet,
Nor more wise than requires the street,
For why destroy your hands and feet?

17 Do not be wicked to excess,
And don't be foolish in address,
Lest you die before your time *bless*.

18 It's good to help and hold the just,
Do not betray the good man's trust,
For the one who fears Alohim
Neglects nothing *that he would deem*.

19 Wisdom has strengthened the wise arm
More than ten princes on the farm.

20 For there is no just man on earth
That does good without sin *in berth*.

21 But do not eavesdrop all the time,
Lest you hear your servant *in crime*
A-laying curses on your *prime*.

22 For your conscience knows well that
 you
Have also often said undue
Of others *when they're not in view*.

Not so, Beloved, I'm almost sure that I
Have been more butt of evil speaking sly
Than I have given of the sure offence.
But then, who knows what secret sins are
 dense.

The word of Solomon gives me no thrill:
He claims there is no righteous on the hill,
But all or most are mediocre souls
Both good and bad, and with no higher
 goals.

The fact is, my Beloved, the words You
 gave

On Mount Sinai to liberated slave
Are few and easy to follow to letter.
Solomon is too hasty a go-getter.
I've know a guy or two, if not a gal,
Perfect in keeping Your law for the sal.

23 I've tried all things in wisdom. I
Have said "I will be wise *or try*,"
But it has kept far from my eye.

24 It is at a far deeper place,
Who can come to the place to trace?

25 I set my heart and mind to know,
And seek out wisdom in the flow,
To know the wickedness of fool,
The error of imprudent stool.

26 I found a wench more bitter than
Death, who's a hunter's snare for plan,
Her heart's a net, her hands are bands.

The one who pleases Alohim
Shall escape from her *on the sands*,
But every sinner on the scene
Shall be caught by her *as in dream*.

27 "Here this I have found," said the
 preacher,

Examining each thing to teach her,
And to discover the account,

28 Which still my soul seeks in amount,
And I've not found it. One man in
A thousand I've found *without sin*,
But not a woman in the bin.

29 Only this I have found, that God
Made man right, but he's caught in pod
Of questions to infinity.

Who is as the wise man *and free*?

And who has known the ultimate
Of matters *when the consummate?*

Each species has uniqueness in the sway
Of universe, the eagle has its way
Of sight, the dervish dog a sense of smell.
All things created are created well.
What is the greatness of the human soul?
Perhaps men are exceptional for toll
In their capacity to enslave more
Beasts and men than the ant upon the shore.
Perhaps men are exceptional in that
They will destroy their living habitat.
Or then the preacher's right whose best
suggestion
Is that humankind knows to ask a question.
Before he hears replies, he has a set
Of hundreds more vain questions for a bet.

Ecclesiastes 8

1 Who knows the wise, and meaning's
grace?
A man's wisdom's shown in his face,
And who can explicate its trace?
2 I watch the king's mouth and that for
The commandments of God's oath's *store*.
3 Don't be quick to turn from His face,
But leave the evil work *in place*,
For He'll act by His own good pleasure.
4 His word is full of power *in treasure*,
And no one can say to Him, "Why
Do You act in this manner *sly?*"
5 The one who keeps the commandment
Shall find no evil *in his tent*.
The heart of a wise man takes hold
On the times and the answer *bold*.
6 There is a time and place for all
And great affliction for man's thrall.
7 For none knows what shall come to be,
And who reveals eternity?
8 It's not in man's power to stop breath,
Neither can he choose day of death,
Nor can he rest when war's at hand,
Nor shall his evil make him stand.

The secret of prophetic gift is just
The taking hold of times and measured
dust.
It is a power that's granted to those who
With long experience and detachment view
The ways of men and causes and effect,

The structures of the worlds set to reflect.
But prophecy is made only by men
Of virtue, evil cannot scan the glen,
Because the wicked way must blind itself
To what the human heart lays up on shelf.
That's why prediction of the future's
thought
Always to be the divine product wrought.
The hidden truth in all lies fine revealed
Before the eye of righteousness and healed.

9 I've pondered all things, set my heart
To all under the sun in art.
Sometimes one man rises to rule
Over another as a fool.
10 I saw the wicked buried well,
Who had lived in the temple's dell,
Praised in the town as just men too,
But this too is vanity's view.

The Neolithic faith gave place of proof
To burial as evidence of woof.
And yet one is not sure if such required
Belief in souls or just body retired.
Cremation gives a hint that such may fly
Up in the air after folks burn and die.
The care that ancients used to dispose of
The body may just speak of human love.
The horror of unburied bodies brings
The harsh words of the prophet out in
springs,
Explains why You, Beloved, threaten the
wings
Of life before Jerusalem at bay,
Before the troubled heart comes up to pay
The price of life in Kidron for a day.

11 Because the judgement falls not fast
Upon the wicked, they are cast
To do evil without fear *past*.
12 But though a sinner sin apace
A hundred times by patience' face,
I know it shall be well with them
That fear God and trust in His grace.
13 But let it not be well in den
Of wickedness, nor days prolonged,
But let them pass, all those who've
wronged
As a shade that fear not the face
Of Alohim *in their disgrace*.
14 Another vanity on earth:

There are just men who suffer for
 Having done no evil in store,
 And there are wicked men whose fate
 Is as sure as though they were straight
 To do the deeds of righteousness:
 But this too I judge a vain dress.
 15 That's why I praised the joyful way,
 For there's no good for man *in sway*
 Under the sun, but to eat and
 To drink and be in merry band,
 For he shall take nothing with him
 Of his labour in the days *dim*
 Of his life which Alohim gave
 Him under the sun *where to slave*.
 16 And I applied my heart to know
 Wisdom and understand the go
 Of what's upon the earthly *show*,
 For there are some that day and night
 Take no sleep with their eyes *alight*.
 17 I understood that man can find
 No reason for all these divined
 That are done under the sun, and
 The more he tries to find the sense,
 The less he shall have *for his pence*,
 Indeed though wise men claim to know,
 He shall not be able to show.

One thing is good and true about the way
 Philosophy has gone in recent day:
 They search no longer to find out the truth,
 But think such attitude one of the youth.
 They know that they do not know of the
 score
 Of why and how events laid up in store
 Show lack of line from cause to their effect,
 And fail to meet expectations elect.
 Beloved, there is no answer to the quire:
 I only pray You light the wicked pyre
 And in the end save righteousness to be
 Rewarded with a generous hand's fee.
 The last shall be first is divine decree
 If Jesus is lifted to that degree.

Ecclesiastes 9

1 I've pondered all this in my heart
 To understand them for my part,
 There are just men and wise ones too,
 And their works are in God's hand due,
 And yet man does not know if He
 'S worthy of love or enmity.
 2 All things are kept uncertain till

The time to come *and foot the bill*,
 Because all things in equal measure
 Fall on the just and wicked leisure,
 Upon the good and evil too,
 Upon the clean and unclean crew,
 To him who offers sacrifice,
 And him to whom just prayers suffice.
 The good and wicked share their fate,
 Just as the false witness in rate
 Succeeds as well as truthful mate.

The ancient quarrel of the priest and singer
 In Solomon's fair temple without wringer,
 That blood of beasts must or must not be
 shed,
 And whether singing Psalms by cantor led
 Suffices for the worship of the true
 Is something that goes on nowadays too.
 Some say the blood of Christ must cleanse
 the sin,
 And You cannot forgive those who don't
 win
 Without a human sacrifice or three,
 The crucifixion on a sacred tree.
 But others think it is enough to pray
 And praise Your name and raise it in the
 way
 Of some repentance and so gain the pay
 Of Your forgiveness and eternally.

3 This is a tragedy and great
 Among all things done under sun,
 That the same fate awaits all men,
 Whereby their hearts are filled again
 With evil and contempt while they
 Live, and afterwards they're the prey
 Of hell where they're brought down to pay.

The preacher notices that punishment
 For sin put off to days when You present
 The final judgement of all beings here,
 Results in wicked humans losing fear.
 If sin had its reward upon the day
 That sinners sinned, then in another way,
 They would prevent themselves from pride
 and fall
 And stand as righteous by the slaughter
 wall.
 Beloved, perhaps You think to preserve
 best
 The love and freedom of men in the West,

But think, at last, would they not rather
have
Life and reward than death at hand of Slav
And sinking into Tophet for the guile
They perpetrated in a wicked while?

4 No man's immortal and none hope
For this, and living dog on rope
Is better than a lion dead.

5 The living know that they are led
To death, but the dead do not know
Anything at all of the show,
Nor do they come to claim reward,
For they've forgotten *peace and sword*.

A lot of people try to call the dead
In consultation to see what they've said.
It seems that's a mistake, since they do not
Know anymore whatever's in the plot.
The Jewish teaching now is that the soul
Is as immortal as the Grecian bowl.
The Christian and the Muslim both agree
With Jewish thoughts about the human tree.
I guess the Free Thinker and Marxist cad
Are all that's left of this preacher's last pad.
The dead know nothing of the whirling
dance,
But sleep in shades of Sheol without
chance
To wander like a lion dead for dog,
Or croak a message to the world of frog.

6 Their love and hatred too are gone,
Their envy perished *with the dawn*,
They have no more a part to play
In this world's work under sun's sway.

7 Go then and eat your bread with joy,
And drink your wine in glad employ,
Because your works please Alohim
And bring you glory in His beam.

8 At all times let your garments be
White and let not your head be free
Of *fragrant oil to smell sweetly*.

9 Live joyfully with the loved wife,
All the days of unsteady life,
Which are given to you beneath
The sun, all the time *and the wreath*
Of vanity, for this your lot
Is life in the labour you've got
Beneath the sun you work in plot.

Because the shades forget the joys of earth
The preacher says to live in faithful mirth
While one can, for the days soon shall
appear

When death claims all, health, wealth, and
land and gear.

There is no bread to eat within the grave,
The clothing of the king as well as slave
Is all the same to those who do not see
Nor hear the praise of watching company.
The wife is loved as long as she's around,
But soon forgotten resting in the ground.
Beloved, the preacher must invent a hell
And paradise to bring the hallowed bell,
To fill the offering plates with cockle shell
Or other glitter stuff the prideful tell.

11 I turned me to another thing,
And saw under the sun *in ring*
The race is not won by the swift,
Nor the battle to the strong *gift*,
Nor bread to the wise, nor the wealth
To the learned of man or elf,
Nor favour to the skilful one,
But time and chance are in all done.

12 A man does not know his own end,
But as fish caught on the hook's bend,
And as birds tripped up in the snare,
So men are taken unaware
In evil times, when it shall come
Upon them in a sudden hum.

When any job is filled, the bet is sure
The competent did not get the vote pure,
But whoever appealed by outward show
Of hue of skin or wit to gain the glow,
Or paid a fee in sex or compliment,
Or fudged credentials on a paper lent.
Even a race is not won by the swift
But by the one who somehow got a lift.
Beloved, I wonder how You got Your place
As Sovereign of the dastard human race.
If You were honest at the God trials then,
I daresay someone else about the glen
Is better qualified to play at God,
Is better shooter of peas from the pod.

13 This wisdom also I have seen
Under the sun, and it has been
To me a mighty thought to lean.

14 A little town with few defenders,

There came to attack it *in benders*
 A great king and set round to build
 Bulwarks against it and fulfilled
 A perfect siege *without blood spilled*.
 15 Now there was in the place a man
 Both poor and wise who found a plan
 To save the city, but no man
 Afterward remembered his ban.
 16 And I said wisdom's better far
 Than strength, how then is this man's *star*
 Neglected for his wisdom heard,
 And not given reward deserved?
 17 The words of the wise in the hall
 Of silence are heard more than bawl
 Of a prince among fools in stall.
 18 Better is wisdom than arms set,
 And the one who offends one met
 Shall love many good things *in bet*.

Encyclopaedias are books of myth
 That tell who stole the credit for things
 with
 Approval of his peers. The story drawn
 Distracts observers from the sun at dawn,
 And shows the fiery skirts of dancing girls
 Claimed to be all the light and heat in
 twirls.

The mass of men live in the meagre hoax
 Of mediocre rhyme and simple jokes.
 The great and the sublime are set for eyes
 Of only one or two at most in guise.
 Beloved, Your art above the heavens is
 spread
 In glories human eyesight can't be led
 To see. Instead I look around the lot
 Admiring dandelions for hue and plot.

Ecclesiastes 10

1 Dead flies in the oil of perfumer
 Cause it to stink to the consumer,
 So is a little folly in
 Reputed for wisdom in bin
 And honour. 2 And a wise man's heart
 Is at his right hand, but the part
 Of a fool's at his left *to start*.
 3 Indeed when a fool walks along
 The way his wisdom is not strong,
 And he reveals to everyone
 That he's a fool *by what he's done*.
 4 If the ruler's spirit is wrought
 Against you, do not leave your plot,

For yielding pacifies a lot.
 5 There's error I've seen under sun,
 Evil coming from ruler done,
 6 Folly decked out in dignity,
 While the rich sit in low degree.
 7 I've seen the servants mounted fine
 While princes just like servants dine.
 8 Who digs the pit falls in its grim,
 Who breaks Ghadir, snakes shall sting him.

The word's too general to take the cumb
 With seriousness and with a certain sum,
 And yet the walling out of Hebrew word
 Is walling in of Arabic when stirred.
 The word reminds me of the serment
 spoken
 By Muhammad and for a lasting token,
 The last word given to the bowing crew.
 To take Ali as governor and true
 Is to submit, Beloved, again to You.
 Beloved, I see the servants mounted fine,
 I see the Muslim monarchies in line,
 But turn away with thanks and take instead
 The poverty of Ali on my head,
 Obedience to his hand where I am led.

9 The one who takes away the stones
 Shall be hurt by them to his groans,
 And those who cut down trees shall live
 To have them fall on them *like sieve*.
 10 If iron has lost its edge for blunt,
 It can be sharpened with a grunt,
 So after diligence and work
 Shall follow wisdom *from its lurk*.
 11 If some snake bites without the charm,
 It's the same as backbiter's harm.
 12 A wise man's mouth makes words of
 grace,
 But fool's lips show him his disgrace.
 13 He starts his words with folly, and
 He ends his talk in error planned.
 14 A fool keeps talking. A man knows
 Not what has been and what more goes,
 And who shall keep him on his toes?

I must be a fool too, Beloved, since I
 Keep chattering beneath the darkening sky.
 I rise before the sun on winter days
 To twitter on and on to You in praise,
 Just like the green and rosy angels that

Spread out their wings upon my window
flat.

I've never yet been bitten by the snake,
Despite the abhorrence for him I make,
Despite the free way humankind will spill
The lips and tongue with every kind of ill.
Keep me, Beloved, within the angels' song
To speak the good and to avoid the wrong,
If I must flap my jaws and fingers bare
In jingles to Your praise on empty air.

15 Fools' labour shall disturb the ones
Who don't know the way or the runs
Into the city *on their buns*.

16 Woe, land, when your king is a child,
When princes from the dawn run wild.

17 Blessed is the land whose king is great,
Whose princes only eat in state
And not in riotous rebate.

18 By sloth a building is brought down,
Through weakness of hands *in the town*,
The house shall leak like sieve for crown.

19 For mirth men make their bread, and
wine

That living and feasting be fine,
But all things obey money's line.

20 Don't curse the king even in thought,
Nor rich men at your chamber pot,
Because the birds upon the air
Will carry your voice everywhere,
And the winged messenger will tell
Everything you uttered pell-mell.

I've criticized the governor and those
Who lobby him with all the wealth he
chose,

While at my window birds come to repose
And listen to the words that from me rose.
I take back all the comments I have made
Against the priests and presidents waylaid,
And beg pardon that I let justice blind
Me to the power of gold upon the rind.
Beloved, let all the curious men of state
Forgive my words of injudicious weight,
And grant me dispensation at the gate
Of Buchenwald and Auschwitz. Rather
give

Free meals left from Treblinka. Let me
live!

I promise to say "siege heil" at fast rate.

Ecclesiastes 11

1 Just cast your bread upon the waters,
And after many days *and slaughters*,
It shall return to you *like daughters*.

2 Give portions to seven or eight,
For you don't know the evil fate
That may come on earth *while you wait*.

3 When clouds are full they pour out rain
Upon the earth. If a tree's fair
To fall to southward or to gain
The north side, wherever it falls,
There shall it lie *beneath the walls*.

4 The one who waits for a good wind
Will not sow, and the one who's ginned
To watch for clear weather shall not
Come out to reap his ripened plot.

5 As you do not know how the wind
Comes or how the bones joined and binned
Together in the womb of one
That's pregnant, till it's formed and done
You do not know the works of God,
Who's maker of all *on the sod*.

6 But sow your seed by morning light,
And in the evening let no spite
Keep your hand from the task, for you
Do not know which will come to view,
But if both, it's a better stew.

7 The light is sweet and it's delight
To see the sun come into sight.

8 If a man lives for many years,
And has rejoiced beyond his tears,
He must remember the dark time
And many days done without rhyme,
Which when they come all the things past
Shall be accused of a vain blast.

9 Rejoice then, young man, in your youth,
And let your heart rest in the truth,
And walk in the ways of your heart,
And in the sight of your eyes' part,
And know that for all these things God
Will take you to account by rod.

10 Remove the anger from your heart,
And put away the fleshly start
Of evil, for both youth and pleasure
Are vain *treasure in every measure*.

I lay the anger from my heart as I
Learn from the years of living on the sly
That nothing wins, neither the hand that
waits

In patience nor the loud mouth that berates.

I lay the wrath out from my path and dream
 No more of vengeance on the hand extreme
 That tears the peach down from the silver
 bough
 And casts the shimmered leaves into the
 slough.
 Beloved, though venging wrath is Yours
 alone,
 I see that You hesitate to the bone
 To cast on wicked men their load of fate.
 I learn the divine heart come as Your mate.
 The terror seeps at last from marrow's heart
 And praise alone becomes my single art.

Ecclesiastes 12

1 Remember your Creator when
 You are still young and in the den,
 Before times of distress arrive,
 And the years come when you contrive
 To say no fun to be alive.
 2 Before the sun, before the light,
 Before the moon and stars for spite
 Be darkened and the clouds return
 After the rain; 3 when keepers spurn
 The household toil, and strong men quake,
 And grinders be idle in wake
 Of few in number, and they who
 Look through the windows find the view
 In darkness; 4 And they shut the doors
 In the street, and the one who pours
 The voice in copulation's scores
 Is silenced to a whimper, and
 They start in fear to hear a band
 Of sparrows, and the ears that heard
 Sweet music are no longer stirred.
 5 And they shall fear high things above,
 They'll startle in the path of dove,
 While almond tree shall blossom fair,
 And locusts made fat on the share,
 And caper tree shall be destroyed,
 Because the man there once employed
 Shall enter the house of his time
 And his eternity to rhyme
 Of mourners on the street to climb.
 6 Before the silver cord is split,
 The golden fillet shrink from it,
 The pitcher be crushed at the well,
 The wheel be broken from the bell
 Upon the cistern, 7 And the dust
 Return to earth from whence it must,
 And breath return to God in trust.

As in the very start of Your clear word
 The soul is made of earth when it is stirred
 With breath of life from Your lips bent to
 kiss,
 So when the kiss is done, I come to miss
 Life and my body goes down to the grave,
 The earth to earth, the slave to swollen
 slave,
 And my breath shall return, Beloved, to
 You,
 Where glory may rend through the veil in
 view,
 And sleep and slumber of this earthly life
 Shall be replaced by conscience without
 strife
 Awaiting the day when again You bring
 The breath out once more where I stop to
 sing
 Before the judgement seat, before the
 throne
 Where life and grace are Yours and Yours
 alone.

8 "The vanity of vanities,"
 Says preacher ecclesiastes,
 "All things are merely vanities."
 9 And since the preacher, he was wise,
 He taught the people all the prize,
 And declared the things he had done,
 And seeking out, and semblance won.
 10 He sought words of profit and wrote
 The words as right and truthful quote.
 11 The words of the wise are like goads,
 And nails to fasten their abodes,
 Which by the counsel set and stirred
 Are released from the one shepherd.
 12 More than these, my son, don't require.
 There's no end to books on the wire,
 And much study is a distress
 To the flesh *and the mind in dress*.
 13 Let us all hear together now
 The conclusion of speech's how.
 Fear God and keep His commandments,
 For this is all a man presents.
 14 And all things that are done God brings
 Into the judgement all that stings,
 Whether it be for good that sings
 Or for ill *at His ponderings*.

The book of the preacher is fraught

With sayings hard and to be bought,
 But at the end I see the light,
 There is no greater thing in sight,
 And all the need and all the fright
 Of many books need not be taken
 To thought, but all else just forsaken
 But this one word, that man obey
 The ten commandments in their sway
 And nothing more is needed here
 To wait the judgement without fear.
 Beloved, I take hold of the true
 And come with praise and plaint to You,
 Petition and penitence too.

Song of Solomon

The reader lies in quandary who finds
 The flashing syllables this story binds.
 Whether the strong caress of Solomon
 Or written after exiles had begun,
 The words lift up the heart to You,
 Beloved,
 A temple from which all idols are shoved,
 A place where You may rest to hear Your
 name
 Recited in the passions and the flame
 Of love to You and to the one You sent
 To dwell in desert and in nomad tent,
 Revealing all the treasures You have spent
 Upon the human heart. I lift my song
 To join with Solomon's, who knows no
 wrong,
 But enters in the inner chamber long.

Song of Solomon 1

1 The song of songs, and which *is this*
 That Solomon *sang in his bliss*.

I too, Beloved, like Solomon lift song
 To You, though indeed I may sing it
 wrong,
 Less tunelessly than he, less truthfully.
 Though I am also lover, I make free
 To doubt as well as love, and like a lover,
 To pout as well as shove where lightened
 hover.
 I seek enlightenment not in my prayer
 Nor in my raising eyes to heavenly air.
 I seek not such at all. I kiss the clod

Instead and learn naught from the staff and
 rod.
 Unknowing and unseeing I seek only
 To hear a word in silence for the lonely,
 Or else to call You by Your name while
 whirling
 Across the polished floor, Your name of
 sterling.

2 Let him kiss me with kisses of
 His mouth, because, because your love
Is better than your wine. 3 Because
 Fragrances of your ointments *cause*
A fine scent, your name's ointment poured
 Forth makes the virgins love you. 4 *Toward*
Yourself draw me away!

We shall run after you, *away!*

Your fragrance, my Beloved, is there to
 sow
 The morning with radish and
 meadowsweet.
 Sweet cicely promises a rare treat
 Behind the empty breezes where You go.
 My blue-green iridescent wings flash by
 The sun glints as I seek Your path and cry
 Like precious beetles drawn to alder leaves
 Your fragrance, my Beloved, is everywhere
 The morning minutes mount up in brief
 prayer
 With wild vines that creep up against the
 eaves.
 Draw me away, Beloved, for there You are,
 Behind sun or some invisible star.
 Draw me away, or else let me stay here
 Crouched somewhere waiting beside Your
 left ear.

The king has brought me *limp and willing*
 Into his chambers, *joys fulfilling*.

The rock-hewn chamber of my soul is lit
 By seven-branched candle stick, and it is fit
 With furnishings of gold, a table where
 Delicious smelling loaves entrance the air,
 And golden censor wafts the smoked
 perfume
 Before the draperies dividing room
 From room. And all about is scarlet, blue

And purple to hide angels, gold, and You.
Within the inner chamber of my heart
The golden chest bears manna, budding rod
And words writ rare. The tables of blue
stone

Beneath the mercy seat no human art
Has struck, Beloved, but only hand of God.
I enter here with You struck to the bone.

We will be glad, rejoice in you,
Remembering more than wine *the dew*
That scattered your love's billet-doux.

Beloved, all turn to You remembering
More than the wine they drink—the
tempering
Of loss and striving—Your love permeating
All life and breath and thought and thus
creating

The medium of all seeking. I think I
Desire the this and that, the reach of sky,
The tinsel and the train, then stop to know
In lightning flash that all the come and go
Is just reflection of my frantic rush
To Youward. I abandon public crush
To step the bridge of art and find the goal
Within my self—also abandoned soul—
The Self of You, remembered more than
wine.

Rejoicing I return to You to dine.

Rightly do they love you, *rightly*.
5 Dark I may be, but I'm lovely,
O daughters of Jerusalem,
Like the tents of Kedar, *a gem*,
Like the curtains of Solomon.

6 Oh, do not, do not look upon
Me, because I *am* dark, because
The sun has tanned me *without pause*.
My mother's sons, angry with me,
They made me keeper of *lovely*
Vineyards, but my own vineyard lies
Unkept, unkempt before my eyes.

When Israel wept for Tammuz and the sun
Had turned the Christian's faith to power
and gun,

When Ahmad's cry was left unheard by all
Who deemed they were obedient to his call,
Then You, Beloved, returned to Axum
where

The faith was always kept as something
rare

Since days of son of Solomon. The tents
Of Kedar seen across the gulf's defense
Welcomed the dark-skinned love that hid
from view

Of curious eye the inner ark's gold hue.
Daughters of Athens, Mecca, Quds and
Rome

Alike gather beneath the shining dome,
While I seek You, Beloved, in desert tent,
Unlovely and unloved where're You went.

7 Tell me, O you whom I love, where
You feed *your flock*, and where you *care*
To make it rest at noon. For why
Should I be as one who's veiled by
The flocks of your companions, why?

Beloved, I truly ask of You the place
Where there are gathered those before Your
face

Who worship You in truth and innocence.
I find fair doctrines in the church and tents
Of Jew and Christian, in the mosque and
crowd

Wherever Your name is proclaimed aloud.
But when their actions bare the heart to see
What stains break out in violence and free
Oppression of the other, faint for grief.
Beloved, I can do nothing against thief
And murderer, the violent and gross,
The wicked ones in silence, the verbose.
But I open both hand and heart to You
To cleanse what I desire and what I do.

8 If you do not know, O fairest
Among women, follow the rest
In the tracks of the flock, and feed
Your little goats *when they have need*
Beside the shepherds' tents. 9 I do
Compare you, my love, my love, to
My filly among Pharaoh's cars.

10 Your cheeks are lovely with *the stars*
Of ornaments, and Your neck's shining
With chains *of gold and jewels combining*.

Beloved, though Axum's sun has burnt my
skin,

You see me fair and beautiful within.

Though my hair and my sleeves retain the
 wisp
 Of leaf and cobweb from the terraced crisp
 And draw of vineyard where I spend my
 days
 In labour, You ignore the rents and frays,
 And see my burnt cheeks lovely as in
 jewels,
 My neck glistening with chains that kings
 and fools
 Covet for their rare value weighed in gold.
 Beloved, You see me like the lamb in fold,
 The filly frisking in the morning cold
 With frost, the little goats jumping and
 bold.
 I follow all the tender tracks I find
 And find You there when I arrive, though
 blind.

11 We shall make ornaments for you
 Of gold, with studs of silver too.

12 While the king's at his table, My
 Spikenard sends forth its fragrant cry.
 13 A bundle of myrrh's my beloved
 All night between my breasts *ungloved*.
 14 And my beloved's to me a cluster
 Of henna in the vineyards' *luster*
 Of En Gedi *by sea and sky*.

I spent a night, a lovely night in winter
 At the kibbutz at En Gedi. The squinter
 Gazing at sea or orange cliffs fails not
 To smell the clustered flowers in their plot.
 The soft night still caresses memory's
 breast.
 Beloved, You silently breathe east and west
 Into sweet being as in motions caught
 In love I turn the whirling step You taught.
 The breakfast table of a king was set,
 While kings and visitors came there to get
 Their bread and porridge for the new-
 taught day.
 And then I rose and took my traveller's
 way
 Toward Jerusalem, first north, then west.
 The soft night still caresses memories best.

15 Behold, you're fair, my love! Behold,
 You *are* fair! You *have* eyes as bold
 As dove's eyes *made of liquid gold*.

I've seen the dove's eye, quick and
 pertinent,
 Choose seed before the blow of storm
 cloud sent
 The birds a-scurry from the gravelled road,
 Craws awkward and bulged with the seedy
 load.
 I've seen dove's eye not curious but bright
 Surprising me beneath a window light.
 I've seen dove's eye upon the rare
 occasion,
 And having seen, I am of the persuasion
 There's many eye more fair. I know the
 black
 In Arab desert sight's more fine than track
 Of blue and brown and gold or shades of
 green.
 The favourite of all eyes is the black sheen.
 But no eye, my Beloved, nor black nor fair
 Can find Your sight for looking anywhere.

16 Behold, you *are* handsome, beloved!
 Yes, pleasant! Also our bed's green.
 17 The beams of our houses *are shoved*
 In cedar, rafters of fir *sheen*.

Song of Solomon 2

1 I *am* the rose of Sharon, *and*
 The lily of the valley *land*.

I, whose eye is not able to see You,
 Who am the rose of Sharon in the dew
 And just a tiny lily in Your view,
 And live in Your house on a bed that's
 green,
 Beneath a cedar beam and argentine,
 Look up to see Your face, but see the
 rafters
 Of fir block sight from heaven, and You,
 and laughers.
 If Your face could be seen by mine and
 here,
 Know that, Beloved, to me it would appear
 More handsome than the face of all
 creation
 That now informs my joys and my elation.
 I look upon the handsome brow of sky,
 And bow to You, I hear the forest cry,
 Repeat Your name with breath and song
 and sigh.

2 Like a lily among the thorns,
So's my love in the daughters' bournes.

That drop of I-ness that You lent to me
That You might be found as a treasure,
free,
Is like a lily also hid in thorns.
The scintillating selves that make the
bournes

Of my veiled travels through these crowded
days
Tempt me to emulate their templed ways.
The thorn from where I crouch seems like a
lily,
And that lily I am sometimes seems silly.
Thanks, my Beloved, for reassurance here
That lily's what I am and what appear
To You, who see reality in me.
Your word's enough, I do not need to see.
I'm satisfied to be, Beloved, alone
In Your sight lily. Others may see stone.

3 Like apple tree among the trees
Of *all* the woods, so among these
Is my beloved, among the sons.
I sat down in his shade with *tons*
Of great delight *and without waste*,
And his fruit *was* sweet to my taste.

Beloved, the apple on the tree was once
Forbidden in the park, and now like dunce
I seem to think the prohibition's care
Was meant to tempt and slay me
everywhere.
But not the case! Your Paradise is free,
Now open and the flaming sword calls me
To pluck and eat the magic fruit and tree.
But what reverse! Forbidden fruit was sight
The first pair saw before them day and
night.
Now I run through the park of pine and
birch
By thousands and they all retard my search.
At last I turn from temple arch and beam
To find the apple tree beside a stream.
Sweet tree, Beloved, at last I know Your
theme.

4 He brought me to the banquet hall,
His banner on me was love's call.

5 Sustain me with cakes of dried grapes,
Refresh with apples, in love's shapes
I'm ill. 6 His left hand's under my
Head, his right holds me the by.

7 I charge you by the *fleet* gazelles,
O daughters of Jerusalem,
By the gazelles or doe that dwells
Among the fields, do not stir stem
Nor waken love until it swells.

I sit in banquet whether I have meat
Or bread, or only herbs. I tuck my feet
On bare earth or on silk and marble chair,
I sit in banquet now and everywhere.
It is alike if gold and silver spoon
Grace table and my plate, I'd just as soon
Eat with bare hand, Beloved, since I'm
with you.

I sit in banqueting no matter what I do,
No matter where I go. Your grand repeat
Is decorated with the sun and stars,
And with the silent silver moon at last,
Is banquet in free air or behind bars.
I waken to Your feast of love and still
Give You, Beloved, what's left of human
will.

8 The voice of my beloved! Behold,
He comes leaping and leaping bold
Upon the mountains, skipping on
The hills. 9 My loved is like gazelle
Or a young stag. Behold, look well,
He stands behind our wall, He looks
Through window and the lattice crooks.
10 Then my beloved spoke, said to me
"Rise up, my love, my fair and free,
And come away. 11 For lo, the frost
Of winter's past, the rain is *lost*,
Over *and* gone. 12 The flowers appear
On earth, the time of singing's near,
And the voice of the turtledove
Is heard in our land, O my love.
13 The fig tree puts forth her green figs,
And the vine *with* tender grapes digs
A good smell *from the earth*. Rise up,
My love, my fair, away to *sup*!

O my Beloved, I hear Your voice, or think
I do, when stepping on a glade or brink
Of stream, and then I stop to hear again,
Wait longer than the silence of most men,

And sigh, for that sweet breath ephemeral
Is just a glimpse and not a proof, a call
And disappearing in the trees of stag
That leaves the heart quite overcome by
crag

And wilderness and lake. The fig tree sends
Its figs on white and dripping stems and
bends

Beneath the vine whose tender grapes
appear,

Sweet scented, reveling that You are near.

You leap, Beloved, and jump and skip
about,

Leave everywhere You go a love and
doubt.

14 “O my dove, in the clefts of rock,
In secrets of the cliff, take stock
Of your face, let me hear your voice,
Your voice *is* sweet, and your face choice.”

You live forever seeing as You wish
My face, while I, enraptured in Your dish
And cup, see only sky when I look up.
Ah me, and vain complaint, with well-filled
cup

I look into Your face, both blue and gray,
The star-graced night and the resplendent
day,

The ponderous of lightning and the rush
Or heavy stillness on the mist. I hush
In awe complaint, and see again Your face,
And know my failure was that every place
Reflects Your glories so there is no edge
To guide my vision with its bound and
hedge.

Why cry for lesser vision than the one
You are, Beloved, in everything that’s
done?

15 Catch us the foxes that spoil vines,
The little foxes *in the lines*,
Our vines have tender grapes *and tines*.

Beloved, I love the exultation I
Feel from moment to moment in the sky
Where I find Your face in reflection and
In all the coloured forests of the land.
But catch for me the foxes that distract
My loving thoughts, I catch them in the act,
And still they slip away. Beloved, I may

Serve You the better if You take away
The foxes, little foxes that surprise
Me with their irritating yaps and eyes.
I could live in Your constant raptures if
You’d take away the foxes from my skiff.
I’d sail a sea of glass to heavenly shore
If only yapping foxes were no more.

16 My beloved’s mine, and I *am* his.
He feeds *his flock* among lilies.

17 Until day breaks, and flee away
The shadows, turn, beloved, and stay
Like a gazelle or young stag on
The mountains of Bether *at dawn*.

The long night fills my fevered brain with
visions,
Disjointed, running, clambering provisions
Across the mountains and ravines till dawn:
Turn, my Beloved, and stay, day’s coming
on.

Upon the mountains You alone appear
To feed Your flocks, and You in
shepherd’s gear

Sit down with me, You knowing not a
letter,

And take out loaf and break the flattened
bread

And cut the cold meat in small slivers
better

Than marbled banquets, with both hands
together

You place each morsel at my lips. Like
leather

Are those two work-worn hands. With each
piece fed,

You speak and say “Efendim” as tears start
Again and once again to hear Your part.

Song of Solomon 3

1 By night on my bed I sought him,
The one I love, there I sought him,
But seeking I did not find him.

2 “I shall rise now,” *I said*, “And go
About the city *in night’s glow*,
In the streets and in every square
I’ll seek him I love everywhere.”

I sought, did not find anywhere.

3 The watchmen in the city found me,
I said, “Have you seen him I love?”

4 Scarce had I passed and looked around
me,
When I found the one that I love.
I held him, would not let him go,
Until I'd brought him to the room
Of my mother, into the gloom
Where she conceived me. 5 I charge you,
O daughters of Jerusalem,
By the gazelles or by the ewe
Does of the field, do not stir stem
Nor waken love until I do.

I seek you throughout rain-soaked alley
ways
In glistening lantern light, and in broad
days
And crowded boulevards. I search averted
Faces, furtive as well as mass deserted,
Empty of all things but the frantic search
For pleasure. I seek You, Beloved, through
birch
And pine, along the docks, in park and
square,
I search the myriad faces everywhere,
And in my blindness see only the care,
The longing and the laughter in them there.
And still I seek You, my Beloved, until
Exhausted I collapse body and will.
Then of a sudden where the least expected,
I find You with the homeless and rejected.

6 Who *is* this coming like the smoke
Out of the wilderness and *broke*
Like pillars of smoke, perfumed *tents*
With *fragrant* myrrh and frankincense,
With all the merchant's fragrant powder?
7 Behold, it's Solomon's couch, *louder*
With sixty valiant men around it,
Of Israel's valiant *ones to sound it*.
8 They all hold swords, expert in war.
Each man *has* his sword on before
Because of fearing in the night,
And watching for a glimpse of light.
9 Of the wood of Lebanon made
King Solomon himself a shade
Of palanquin: 10 He made its pillars
Of silver, its support *instillers*
Of gold, its seat *of* purple *gem*,
Interior paved *with* love by
The daughters of Jerusalem.
11 Go forth, O Zion's daughters, *cry*,

And see King Solomon in crown,
His mother crowned him *with renown*
On his wedding day *for her part*,
The day of gladness in his heart.

Beloved, pavilions of the air and sky
Covering Your parade and passing by
With royal banners, carriages of wind
Through fir and pine and birch once
twinned and twinned,
Delight my heart and eye to find You there.
The smoking mountain and the mists of air
Hide and reveal the passing of Your glory.
The earth beneath Your feet, storey on
storey,
Is paved in goldenrod and wheat, a pale
And glowing setting for the tribe and tale
Of jewels in Your crown, the crimson
throat
Of humming-bird, carnelian eye of goat,
And iridescent grackle's wing, all told
In priceless gem, fresh-sprung and newly
old.

Song of Solomon 4

1 Behold, you're fair, my love! Behold,
You *are* fair! You've dove's eyes behind
Your veil. Your hair's like flocks of bold
Goats, down from Gilead inclined.
2 Your teeth *are* like a flock of shorn
Come up from washing *without thorn*,
With twins each one bearing along,
None of them barren, but all strong.
3 Your lips *are* like a thread of scarlet,
And your mouth lovely *as a starlet*.
Your temples behind your veil *are*
Like a piece of pomegranate bar.
4 Your neck *is* like David's tower built
For armoury, on which hang quilt
A thousand bucklers, and the shields
Of mighty men *known in the fields*.
5 Your two breasts *are* like two young
fawns,
Twins of a ewe gazelle, *on lawns*
Among the lilies feeding. 6 Till
The day breaks and the shadows flee
Away, I'll go my way to hill
Of myrrh and to the mountain free
Of frankincense. 7 You *are* all fair,
My love, without spot anywhere.

The pomegranates and the lilies are
No veil, Beloved, I have no fear of star
Like Babylon, nor of the passing flesh
Like Athens, I know well bodies enmesh
With souls, nor do I seek the divine spark
Hidden among the trees about the park
Bound and solemn where its fruit is still
fresh.

I know the myrrh and mountain are as real
As any soul and spirit in the deal.
No, no, the veils are not of flesh and steel.
The veil hides eye and neck, not empty
spirit.

There's no veil but the human will, or near
it,

And when it's rent, it's not my sight but
Yours,

Beloved, that sees my face through open
doors.

8 From Lebanon, come with me, spouse,
With me from Lebanon, *my grouse*.

Look from the top of Amana,
From Senir and Hermon, the maw
Of lions' dens, from the leopards' hills.

9 Your ravishing how my heart thrills,
My sister, spouse, you've ravished my
Heart with one *look out* of your eye,
With one link of your necklace. 10 How
Fair is your love, my sister, spouse!

How much better than wine your *house*
Of love, and the scents that endow
Your perfumes better than all spices!

11 Your lips, O spouse, drip as *entices*
The honeycomb, honey and milk

Are under your tongue, and *the silk*
Of your garments *is* like the scent
That Lebanon in fragrance *lent*.

12 An enclosed garden is my spouse,
And sister, a spring *by the house*
Shut up, and like a fountain sealed.

13 Your plants *are* an orchard revealed
Of pomegranates, pleasant fruit,
Fragrant henna with spikenard *root*,

14 Spikenard and saffron, calamus
And cinnamon, with all trees thus
Of frankincense, myrrh and aloes,
With all the spice a garden grows.

Illusion is the human has a duty
Beyond being for You, Beloved, a beauty.

Illusion is You are a treasure to
Be found beyond creation, rather You
Created men and women not to love,
If so, they should have loved, but rather of
Your own desire to love. Untouchable
With passion in philosophy, but full
Of all passion in Your reality,
You have made cinnamon and myrrh not
that

They might enjoy their odours where they
sat,

But that You might Yourself, Beloved,
enjoy

Their scent. From both labour and love set
free,

I am content, Beloved, to be Your toy.

15 A fountain of the gardens, well
Of running waters, streams that fell
From Lebanon *where they arose*.

No longer mystic who thirsts for Your
being,

Imagining the veils that crowd my seeing,
I seek no pools refreshing to my heart,
No living waters, no ablutions' start,
No rivers of wine nor chalices of
The heavenly nectar and the heavenly love.
Instead I lie and sparkle under sun,
I who have neither sports nor battles won,
Rush or flow with the current of Your hill,
Who have no mite left of desire or will.

I thirst not, do not pant, but am the dew
Itself that You, Beloved, drink for sweet
brew.

You are the thirsty stag, and I the stream,
Drink me, Beloved, and be refreshed with
dream.

16 Awake, O north, and come, south wind!
Blow on my garden, *that* its hind
Of spices may flow out. Let my
Beloved come to his garden, try
And eat its pleasant fruits the by.

Beloved, I am a garden of Your planting,
Garden of blowing spice and fruit-trees
granting

The tastes and odours You best would
desire,

Made of mere light and shadows on Your fire.

Let Your divine breath blow on my retreat,
And gather to You all my scents and sweet,
The scents of sacrifice and scents of prayers

That are the sum that my respiring bears.

Blow, blow Your winds on me, let branches free

And tossing in the air, break, fall on me,
And set free the scents of their resined wood.

Let my fruit ripen, and as ripened should,
Split for Your pleasure on the blackened ground.

I am, Beloved, the treasure You have found.

Song of Solomon 5

I have come to my garden, spouse
And sister, gathered in my house
My myrrh and spice, I've eaten my
Honey and honeycomb, and I
Have drunk my grape juice with my milk,
In scent of spice and sound of silk.

O friends! Eat, drink, yes, deeply drink,
Beloved ones, *at the marble brink!*

My slaughter, my Beloved, be sweet to You,

But let me not feel anything You do,
Not pain of knife nor thrust of ecstasy,
Let all pleasure be Yours alone, let me
Be like the shining stone, a ruby fed
To You and all Your angels at the bed
Where I am dressed with spices, braised in milk

And boiled wine and honeycomb smooth as silk

To Your tongue, my Beloved, so let me live

In that pleasure that flesh and spirit give
To those whose food I am created for.
Drink deeply, yes, Beloved, and drink me more,

So I become in You eternal, true,
Keeping in Your expanse even curfew.

2 I sleep, but my heart's waking still,
The voice of my beloved! *I thrill!*

He knocks, *and says*, "Open for me,
My sister, love, my dove, and my
Perfect one, for my head *freely*
Is covered with the dew, and my
Locks with the dewdrops of the night."

3 I've taken off my robe, what right
Have I to put it on *again*?

I have washed my feet, and now then
Shall I defile them? 4 My beloved
Put his hand by the latch, *and gloved*,
And my heart yearned for him. 5 I rose
To open for my one beloved,

And my hands dripped *with myrrh and rose*,

My fingers dripping myrrh upon
The handles of the lock *at dawn*.

6 I opened for my one beloved,
But my beloved, *spent and ungloved*,
Had turned away *and* he was gone.

My heart leaped up to hear him speak.
I sought him vainly where to seek,
I called him, but without reply.

7 The city watchmen who went by
Found me. They struck me *with a cry*,
They wounded me, the keepers on
The walls took my veil from me, *shone
Their lamps on me*. 8 So I charge you,
O daughters of Jerusalem,
If you find my beloved, *my gem*,
You tell him I'm lovesick, pray do!

The watchmen on Your city walls find me
And strike me with their staves to set me free

From the veils that encumber mind and eye.

I quiver in shame before their firefly
Revealing all the secrets of my face,
The throbbing temple, laid bare in disgrace
Convulsing throat and trembling lip,
revealing

The care I had to hide myself and feeling.
The reason I do not find You when seeking
Is merely that my rush, for all its shrieking,
Although I think I seek You, in truth I
Am fleeing from Your waters and Your cry.

I fear to lose my veils, but now they're gone,

Meet me, Beloved, and take me in the dawn.

9 What's your beloved more than *another*
Beloved, O fairest? Any brother
Of women, say, what more is your
Beloved, that you so charge us for?

They chide me to be irresponsible
Finding You in each eye, and finding full
Divine and without parts and without
bounds

In every human face and voice that sounds.
Beloved, is there breath that You do not
breathe?

To say so lets idolatry unsheathe.
Since You proclaim that You are One let
there

Be no competitor, not anywhere.
Humility inflames the heart to be
None other than the one of deity.
Let me not find nor make an idol here
Where only You, Beloved, come to appear.
You are unique in every errant knight
That stumbles in his armour at the fight.

10 My loved *is* fair and ruddy, chief
Among ten thousand, 11 and like *leaf*
Of finest gold's his head, his locks
Are wavy, raven black. 12 His eyes
Are like doves by the river *docks*
Of waters, washed with milk *in wise*,
And fitly set. 13 His cheeks *are* like
A bed of spices, banks *that strike*
The air with scented herbs. His lips
Are lilies, dripping liquid myrrh.
14 His hands *are* rods of gold set with
Beryl. His body's lovelier,
Carved ivory all inlaid *with*
Sapphires. 15 His legs *are* pillars, *hips*
Of marble set on bases of
Fine gold. His countenance *of love*
Is like the Lebanon, the fine
Cedars. 16 His mouth *is* sweet *like wine*,
Yes, he's Mahammadim indeed.
And *this is* my beloved *decreed*,
This is my friend *and diadem*,
O daughters of Jerusalem!

Oh my Beloved! Give me a pen both white
And ruddy in the flaming, flaming light,
Above ten thousand, head of finest gold,
And wavy locks like jet, the rarest sold,

With eyes like doves and cheeks like bed of
spices,
And golden beryl hands above all prices,
And lily lips, beneath, carved ivory
Inlaid with sapphires, marble pillary
Set in their bases of the purest gold,
And excellent like cedars known of old,
With mouth most sweet reciting angel
songs,
Come down, Desired, to right all earthly
wrongs.
Beloved, Your breath alone makes such a
man,
Beloved and friend, as only Your word can.

Song of Solomon 6

1 Where has your one beloved one gone,
O fairest among women? On
What hand has your beloved one turned,
That we may seek with you *unspurned*?

I thank the rabble for the invitation
To form a blessed dervish congregation.
Indeed the whirling in fair company
May multiply the blessings of the spree.
But here's the rub, and it is always so,
The rabble will ask in which way to go
Instead of looking straight to You to guide,
Or else, not even asking, turn aside.
The two alternatives, idolatry
Or going off the path to look for Me,
Are not mine to pursue, and so I go
On as a lone dervish, though I am slow,
And pray the blessing that You give to me
May be theirs too and more abundantly.

2 My one beloved has gone *alone*
To his garden, to beds of spices,
To feed in the gardens *and blown*,
And gather lilies' *paradises*.
3 I'm my beloved's, and he is mine.
He feeds among the lilies fine.

You only, my Beloved, take Sabbath rest,
For You alone create the east and west.
You come to me in gardens in the cool
Of evening, lie down by the sacred pool
And rest Your heart in me, who build Your
room
Of Psalms sung in the language of sweet
doom.

You take Your Sabbath banquet at my hand,
 Beloved of spice and lilies contraband.
 You eat and drink with me since You are mine,
 And I am Yours in lily Sabbath shrine.
 You only, my Beloved, work and take rest,
 Though You are never tired to do the best,
 While I, who neither work nor rest nor am,
 Enjoy the vision of Your song and lamb.

4 O my love, you *are* beautiful
 As Tirzah, lovely as *the pull*
 Jerusalem *has on my heart*,
 Awesome as banners *in war's art!*
 5 Now turn your eyes away from me,
 For they've *surely* overcome me.
 Your hair *is* like a flock of goats
 Descending Gilead *like lotes*.
 6 Your teeth *are* like a flock of sheep
 Come up from the washing to keep
 Each one its twins and none is barren.
 7 A piece of pomegranate *thereon*
Is like your temples under veil.
 8 With sixty queens to make the tale
 And eighty concubines there are,
 With virgins numbered like the star.
 9 My dove, my perfect one, is only
 Child born of her mother and lonely,
 The favourite of her who bore her.
 The daughters saw her *to implore her*,
 And called her blessed, the queens also
 And concubines praise her and know.
 10 Who is she who looks forth as morning,
 Fair as the moon, as sun's adorning,
 Awesome as *army* banners warning?

I blush to hear such speech from You, my Love.
 What is this thing that You are talking of?
 Must I turn eye away from You because
 The vision is too much for You to pause
 And feast upon? Creator of all things,
 Beloved, scorn not Your servant's tattered wings.
 Call me not perfect, but reflection of
 Your own creating power and tender love.
 Am I too beautiful for Deity
 To look upon and still be full and free?
 Am I brighter than sun, Beloved, that You

Look and are blinded by my sparkling dew?
 I blush again, Beloved and God, for cheer
 That You hold me and me alone so dear.

11 I went down to the garden of
 Nuts to see verdant valley's *love*,
 To see whether the vine had budded,
 The pomegranates' blooms had studded.
 12 Before I was even aware,
 My soul had made me *become there*
As chariots of my noble folk,
Before my love I even spoke.

I walk before the wind above the ground
 To find the brown nuts by their tinkling sound
 Above the verdure of the valley's scent,
 To find vines and pomegranates where I went.
 My feet crush the cruel coals of crass desire,
 And part the martyr's path between the fire,
 And all grows green and cool around my sole
 Before I touch the meadow and my goal.
 I do not know if I was struck by sword
 Before I caught the vision of the Lord,
 And rode in chariots of fire and cloud
 To meet the seraphim chanting aloud.
 Before I knew the veils had floated down
 And I was given chariot and crown.

13 Return, return, O Shulamite,
 Return, that we may have your sight!
 They beg me to return into the dark,
 Into the world of sale and city park.
 They want to crush my flowers and bruise my heart,
 But that is something that can never start.
 They want a sight of one who's tasted of
 The manna and the honeycomb above,
 And do not realize there's no return
 Because there is no windward in the burn.
 I have not gone away, nor up nor down,
 Nor to the west nor east, nor in the town,
 The north and south are just as present as
 The wheels and heels and flowers the
 jasmine has.
 Return I cannot, since I'm not away,

And sight they cannot have until their day.

What would you see in Shulamite,
As if two camps had danced or might?

The whirling is no stepping in a trance,
It is no jostling in a crowded dance,
It is no herd, no herd of loving souls
That's seen in two opposing football goals.
If they would see the Shulamite and You,
Beloved, in sacred dance about the yew,
They must stay long enough to crack the
nut,
And spit out all the tough, hard grape
seeds, but
Share all the waking fruit in forty parts.
They must skip like a little goat upon
The sacred Sinai in the rosy dawn,
And empty all the wine out of their hearts.
Beloved, I whirl and dance with You an
hour
Without a muscle moving from Your
power.

Song of Solomon 7

1 How beautiful your feet in shoes,
Sandals, O prince's daughter, *choose!*
The curves of your thighs *are* like jewels,
The work of skilful hands and tools.
2 Your navel *is* a rounded cup
That lacks no blended wine to sup.
Your waist *is like* a heap of wheat
Set all about with lilies *sweet*.
3 Your two breasts *are* like two young
fawns,
Twins of a ewe gazelle *on lawns*.
4 Your neck *is* like an ivory tower,
Your eyes *like* pools in Heshbon's *hour*
Beside the gate of Bath Rabbim.
Your nose *is* like the tower *to seem*
Of Lebanon which looks down on
Damascus. 5 Your head *is like dawn*
On Carmel, and your hair *is* as
The purple that a captive has
In kings. 6 How fair and how pleasant
You are, O love, with your delights!
7 Your height's like a palm, elegant,
Your breasts its clusters in its heights.
8 I said, "I'll go up the palm tree,
I'll take hold of its branches free."
Now let your breasts be like the vine

With clusters, your breath scented fine
Like apples, 9 the roof of your mouth
Like the best grape juice *from the south*.

Beloved, I thank You that You place the
table
Of that bright thunder and light You were
able
Once to proclaim from Sinai, on my breast,
Condensing all Your glories east and west.
Instead of stone and glossy words You
make
The tables of Your Decalogue now take
On flesh and blood in human heart as told
By every prophet and divine guide's gold.
The sapphire stones have turned into two
breasts
That stand like towers and pointed at the
crests.
What You once tenderly spoke into being
On Sinai in the people's hearing, seeing,
Are now the breasts You fondle in my care,
Exposed to Your eyes only and the air.

For my beloved *that wine goes down*
Smoothly, moving gently *to drown*
The lips of sleepers. 10 *I am* his,
And my beloved's desire *is*
Toward me. 11 Come, my beloved, let's go
Forth to the field, and let's lodge so
Among the villages. 12 Let's rise
Up early to the vineyards' *guise*
To see if the vine is in bloom,
If the grape blossoms in costume
Teach pomegranates to be fair,
And I shall give you my love there.
13 The mandrakes give their scented spell,
And at our gates pleasant *and well*
All kinds of fruits, both new and old,
Which I, beloved, for you have told.

Song of Solomon 8

1 Oh, that you were to me like brother,
Who suckled at breasts of my mother!
If I should find you outside, I
Would kiss you, I would not thereby
Be aught despised. 2 I would lead you
And bring you to the house where you
Would find my mother, she *who* used
To teach me. There you'd be amused
With spiced grape juice to drink awhile,

My pomegranate juice to spoil.

3 His left hand *is* beneath my head,
And his right hand embraces me.
4 I charge you, do not stir my bed,
O daughters of Jerusalem,
Nor waken my love unto me
Until I have the diadem.

The sweet and fleshy breasts of mother
were

The tables of the Decalogue made sure
And written on the tables of her heart,
From which she poured her teachings and
her art.

She taught me with her milk to drink of
You,

Beloved, and always seeking find the true.
I lead You, my Beloved and God, to find
My mother's bed and share sweets of her
mind.

There You shall take Your pleasure at my
hand

Who am created but for Your command.

The daughters of Jerusalem shall give
Us peace and stillness where we both can
live,

Beloved, until the clouds have gone and
passed

And I awaken in Your heart at last.

5 Who's coming from the wilderness,
Leaning on her beloved's *caress*?

I wakened you beneath the tree,
The apple tree under which you
Were brought forth. There your mother
brought

You forth, there she gave birth to you
And brought *you* forth there *as she ought*.

I walk with You, Beloved, and rise up from
The desert where the hidden rivers come
Beneath the sand to water all the way
The fig trees and the olives in their sway.
We meet with many relatives, a few
Of whom can give my witnesses to You,
That I was born beneath the apple tree
That nourished my mother and made her
free.

The hands are living still that wakened me
To the sweet milk of Your theophany,

And made the mountain's thunder lullaby
And lightning a lamp for my guiding by.
Till now my infant feet stumbled along
When I at last, Beloved, hear Your love
song.

The wise and simple say the apple tree
That's mentioned here by Solomon in glee
Is that with blossoms pink in west country
Joanna Southcote saw as a baby.
The pure in heart are oft derided here
Where steel trees mark the roadways of our
fear,

And in derision men take stock and chain
Against the softer sex, and take in vain.
Beloved, keep every sweet child of Your
ways

Beneath the apple blossoms of Your praise
No matter what the priest has left to say,
And what the rich consent to do today.
And I shall bring three gifts to that new
son:

An apple blossom, pear, and cherry won.

6 Set me a seal upon your heart,
As a seal there upon your arm,
For love *is* strong as death *and art*,
Jealousy cruel as the harm
Of grave, its flames *are* flames of fire,
A most vehement flame. 7 *Desire*
Nor love are quenched by many floods
Of waters not to drown it's buds.
If a man gave for love all that
His house contained in wealth and mat,
'T would be despised and all bespat.

I do not ask for seal in head or hand
To grace me in a dragon's harrow-land,
Nor do I ask for strength to meet the fall,
Nor ears to hear or not the siren's call.
Let others be sealed and get great reward
In service wrought and fought for their dear
Lord.

Instead I ask, that You, Beloved, be sealed,
Not on head nor in hand, but arm and heart.
Let me be on Your arm never to yield
Tattooed in divine flesh never to part.
Let me be on Your heart a seal and stay
And Your remembrance in both night and
day.

I am unworthy to bear seals and rings,

Let You, Beloved, hold all the things of kings.	Once spoke in lightning and thunder above The bowed heads of the people. Those words sigh
8 We have a little sister who Has no breasts, now what shall we do In the day when she's spoken for?	And whisper in my heart at night, they fly From lip to ear at the noon day and speak Above clatter and din of those that seek Gods rather wrought in silver and in gold, In oil and shares, in speculations cold And innocent. I am a wall indeed.
9 If she's a wall, we'll build her more, A battlement of silver <i>store</i> , And if she <i>is a gate or door</i> , With cedar boards we'll close and shore.	But send two hundred, my Beloved, to seed The grapevines at my shoulder, thousands more
Is there a city that has no support, No wall, no tower, and still no sturdy fort? For such the walls and towers may sure be built.	For Suleyman and David put in store.
Is there a sister without breasts and guilt? For such the promises are firm and sure. The words, Beloved, You speak are true and pure,	13 You who live in the gardens near it, Friends hear your voice, let me too hear it!
And graven on sapphire stones to catch the eye.	The mystic thrills to hear Your voice of doom,
Of these sapphires flesh breasts make by and by	Its loving syllables tiptoe and loom About the table where the banquet's spread, And where the longing soul is quenched and fed.
That shall support a city and a wall. Two tables of the law are Your love call, And they are firm and sweet like honeycomb.	But You, Beloved, have promised me no voice,
No need for wall and tower when there is home.	And no exulting station, and no choice Of sweetmeats for my fare. Oh, no, instead You jealously remark that others hear My murmured cantillations for Your ear Alone meant to be sung. Put me in mind To sing for You alone, forget the wined And suited throng, for You alone my song. My garden wall be high against the wrong. Let none but You, Beloved, be and belong.
Beloved, Your battlements of cedar, gold Shore up the gates and make a sure sheepfold.	
10 I <i>am</i> a wall, my breasts like towers, Then I became in his eyes <i>flowers</i> As one who had found peace <i>in showers</i> .	14 Make haste, beloved mine, and be Like a gazelle or young stag free On the mountains' of spices lea.
11 Solomon had a vineyard at Baal Hamon, leased where keepers sat, And everyone came there to bring For its fruit a thousand sterling.	
12 My own vineyard <i>is here</i> before me. You, Solomon, a thousand o'er me Is yours <i>for taking</i> . Those who tend Its fruit have two hundred <i>to spend</i> .	
I am a wall indeed, Beloved, since I Have breasts like living towers from Mount Sinai, Whereon writ in flesh are Your words of love	

Wisdom

Though many men of faith in times gone
past
Relate Wisdom to Solomon's repast,
The truth is that the book was written late
In the fine Greek of Hellenizing state.
If it is not found in the Tanakh held
By Jew and Karaite in light dispelled
I trow it is because its language taught

Is not the sweet Hebrew it should have
caught.

But wisdom is its name and to its fame
It is wise in the way it shows the flame
Of humankind to be ephemeral,
The high effects of wisdom on the mall,
And why idolatry is evil sal.
No better Trinity is there in claim.

Wisdom 1

1 Love justice, rulers of the earth,
Consider YHWH with upright worth,
And seek Him with a sincere heart,
2 Because He's found by those who part
From tempting Him, and shows Himself
To those who do not trust in elf.
3 For perverse thoughts separate men
From Alohim, and His power when
It's tested, it convicts the foolish,
4 Because wisdom will not be schoolish
To enter a deceitful soul,
Nor live in a body in toll
Of sin's slavery. 5 For a holy
And disciplined spirit will flee
From deceit, and will rise and part
From foolish thoughts, and will from start
Be ashamed at unjust approach.
6 For wisdom is a kindly coach,
But will not free a blasphemer
From the guilt that his words incur,
Because Alohim is witness
Of his inmost feelings' address,
A true observer of his heart,
And hearer of his tongue *in art*.

Beloved, they say I tempt You on the run,
And blaspheme at Your name as though in
fun,
And yet I do not seek You, do not search,
Because I always find You on my perch,
Near as my breath, near as the artery
That pumps blood to my brain in scatter-
free.

I do not search and find: I can't break free
Of the presence divine that follows me.
Only the ones who search to find the Self
Need rummage on the glowing cosmic
shelf.

The kind who have no self but You alone
Seek not, because they are at heroed bone,

Immoveable from before Your sleek
throne.

Beloved, I step into eternity.

7 Because the Spirit of YHWH's filled
The earth, and what holds all things stilled
Knows what is said, 8 therefore no one
Who speaks unrighteousness when done
Escapes note of justice but it
Will punish when it passes fit.

9 Examination of the plans
Of wicked men stand as it scans,
And record of his words will come
Up before YHWH, convicting bum
For his unlawful works, 10 because
A jealous ear hears every clause,
And complaint is heard as it draws.
11 Watch out for idle complaint, keep
Your tongue from slander, there's no deep
Secret word but has its effect,
And lies destroy the soul elect.

12 Do not invite death by the error
Of your life, nor bring on the terror
By the works of your hands to scare her,
13 Because Alohim did not make
Death, and He does not delight take
In the death of the living stake.

14 For He created all things so
They might exist and also glow,
And growing things in the world are
Good, and from destruction are far,
And the dominion of Sheol
Is not on the earth *or its goal*.

15 But righteous deeds can never die.

16 Ungodly men who come to vie
By their works are called into death,
As a friend so they lost their breath,
And made a covenant with him,
Because they fit his party dim.

Slander and plaint are the great foes I see
Around me on the shore and in the lea
Of forest where I walk, but what trips me
Is none of those. But rather the heart bare
As it was once created on the air.
I follow with such lust all that is fair
Beneath the purple pines shining in light
Of red sunset, within the joining sight
Of aspens in their worsted hues contrite.
Beloved, I lay aside the quaint retreat
To slight the sting of ant, the formal beat

Of bumblebee. I lay aside the talk
That criticizes cabbage-fly's new frock.
I follow with such lust all that is sweet.

Wisdom 2

1 Without good reason they have said
"Brief is our life in sorrow led,
And there's no cure for man at last,
And none come back from Hades' *blast*,
2 Since we were born in hazard's way,
And after death there is no sway;
The breath of our life's like a smoke,
And thought just a spark that awoke
By the pulse of our hearts *in stroke*.
3 When it's extinguished, into dust
The flesh goes and the spirit must
Dissolve like empty air *for crust*.
4 Our name will be forgotten soon,
No one remember our works' *tune*,
Our life will pass without a trace
Like cloud and be scattered from space
Like mist spoiled by the rays of sun
And overwhelmed with the heat done.
5 For our age is determined like
The passing of a shadow's strike,
And there's no coming back from death,
Because it's sealed up without breath.

It is great wisdom to become aware
That thought is just another form of air.
It is not certain, as pride would maintain,
That human thought is greater and more
sane
That what lies on the breath of dog or
mouse,
Or that what's art to me upon the house
Is finer than the tangled web of grief
Devised by rats behind the cellar's *foeff*.
Beloved, the ancients realized the truth
That life is little beyond joy of youth
And gone forever after that, unless
You form a new creation from the guess.
Today hardly any faith doubts the way
Of human soul in her eternal sway.

6 "So come and let us take joy in
The pleasures we have *without sin*,
And use creation to the full
As in youth *when we felt the pull*.
7 Let us take our fill of fine wine
And odours, and let no bloom's vine

In spring pass by us *with a whine*.
8 "Let us crown ourselves with rosebuds
Before they wither *on their studs*.
9 "Let each of us take part in mirth,
Leave traces of our joy in berth,
For this is our portion on earth.

So far so good, there's nothing wrong with
joy,
And to grasp the day of youth's happy boy
Is no sin. But I trust experience
To tell me that the ending of no fence
Is the oppression of the righteous soul.
Without the care and warning with the goal
The trampling of the other comes to pass
Without the need of plan set on the glass.
Beloved, while I take part in Gospel mirth
Enjoying every feat from death to birth,
Let me leave off the fine wine and the
smell
Of sweetness that would bring the drowsy
spell,
And hide from me the core reality
That flits between the branches of the tree.

10 "Let's oppress the innocent poor,
Nor spare the widow nor look pure
Upon the grey hair of the old.
11 "Let might be right and our hearts bold
To leave the weak out in the cold.
12 "Let's lie in wait for righteous men,
Because he's inconvenient then
To us and opposes our works,
He chides us for our sin that shirks
The law and so accuses us
For acting naturally *in fuss*.
13 "He claims to have knowledge of God,
Calls himself slave of YHWH in pod.
14 "He is reproof even of our thoughts,
15 "The very sight of him distraughts,
Because he lives a different way
To others and he's strange in *dray*.
16 "He looks down on us as cheap fools,
Avoids us as in unclean pools,
He calls the end of righteous life
A happy thing and as in strife
Boasts that Alohim is his father.
17 "Let us see if his words *for bother*
Are true, and let us wait and see
How his life will end in the spree,
18 "For if the righteous man's a slave

Of God, He will help from the grave
 And from his adversaries' glaive.
 19 "Let's test him with insult and torture,
 To find out how gentle a *scorcher*
 He is, and try his patience' breath.
 20 Let's put him to a shameful death,
 Since he makes the claim God will save."

I'm weary with the explanations' bound
 Of why the divine plan and wicked pound
 Concur to set oppression on the world.
 I turn from the discussion now unfurled
 And take up my song of the rosebuds'
 share.

I bought a poke of them beneath the air
 Of Kuwait's market place and brought
 them home
 To add to my tea with precious arome.
 Beloved, I do not know that rosebuds do
 A thing for health or beauty or accrue
 Increase of bank account, but still I take
 A whiff of the perfume and for Your sake
 Retire to duty and to pleasure with
 Not only Your presence but rival myth.

21 So they argued, but they were led
 Astray, by wicked blindness sped.
 22 And they did not know secret aims
 Of Alohims, nor hope in claims
 Of holiness, nor see the prize
 Laid up for blameless souls in guise,
 23 For Alohims created man
 For incorruption, and *by plan*
 Set him within the image of
 His own eternity *of love*,
 24 But through the devil's envy death
 Entered the world, and those whose breath
 Goes forth to his party all know
 By experience the awful show.

The fond belief that man's Your image here
 Caught for admiring glance of fish and deer
 Is old enough to be found in this place,
 This text joined with the Persian sort of
 grace,
 The Hellenistic weave of thought and
 power,
 The Babylonian perfumes of the hour.
 Beloved, I know that man's not such a trace
 Of Your nobility by face or grace,
 But just the last piece modestly inset

Within the picture puzzle that we get
 With universe displayed on empty screen
 Filled with all things, Your image without
 spleen.

Beloved, I look out from my corner where
 Your image rolls in forest, lake and air.

Wisdom 3

1 But the souls of the righteous are
 In the hand of Alohims' *star*,
 No torment ever touches them.
 2 In the eyes of the foolish hem
 They seemed to have died, and their fate,
 Departure thought affliction's rate,
 3 Their going from us as destruction,
 But they're at peace from all the muction.
 4 Though in men's eyes they felt the lash,
 Their hope's in an immortal stash.
 5 For suffering a small thing they'll find
 A great reward, since in the kind
 Alohims proved then and found them
 Worthy of Himself as a gem,
 6 Gold purified in furnace tried,
 And like a sacrificial side
 He shall accept them *for His pride*.

The wicked try to prove their right to rule
 By persecuting others with each tool
 Of torture they can find, the best refined
 Pricking both outward body and the mind
 With psychic needles and fleshly
 combined.
 The world is always governed by a fool.
 Beloved, I flee from promises of power,
 I flee from friends who have a hand and
 hour
 Among the courts and legislatures' file.
 I flee from every man of strength and guile.
 The Tao of hopelessness is my retreat,
 I trade the victory for small defeat,
 And touch the greater treasure and the
 meat.
 There is no waiting for the passing while.

7 When their time comes they will be
 bright,
 Running like sparks through stubble light.
 8 They'll govern nations and rule folks,
 And YHWH will reign over their yokes
 For ever. 9 Those who trust in Him
 Will understand the truth *not dim*,

The faithful will abide with him
 In love, because grace and mercy
 Are on His chosen ones, and He
 Guards His holy ones *faithfully*.
 10 But the ungodly will receive
 The punishment their minds in leave
 Deserve, who disregarded men
 Of righteousness and rebelled then
 Against YHWH, 11 for who will despise
 Wisdom and instruction in guise
 Is miserable. Their hope is vain,
 Their labours shall come to no gain,
 Their works are without profit's bane.
 12 Their wives are foolish, children bad,
 13 Their offspring are accursed *and sad*.
 Blessed is the barren woman pure,
 Who's not gone in a wicked sure
 Union, she will have barren cure
 And offspring when Alohim will
 Examine souls *and count the bill*.

The Bible is a fiery book. I see
 How much it divides people into two
 Outrageous groups set in respective pew.
 My thought is that all people faithfully
 Arrange to do by nature as they see,
 Some just succeed better than the last crew
 Making its way as best it can in view.
 Can any man do better than his fee?
 Excuses are abundant why all men
 Live and dwell in the circumstances that
 Weigh on conditions of reality.
 Account that You give in Your word again
 Is that there are two groups set out on mat:
 None have excuse: some sin and some are
 free.

14 Blessed also is the eunuch whose
 Hands have done naught which might
 accuse,
 And who has not devised a thing
 Wicked against YHWH *and His king*,
 For special favour will be shown
 To him for his faithfulness grown,
 And a place of delight in store
 In YHWH's temple *inside the door*.
 15 The fruit of good labours is famed,
 The root of understanding claimed
 Does not fail. 16 But the children born
 Of adulterers grown in scorn
 Will not come to maturity,

And offspring of impurity
 Will perish. 17 Even if they live
 Long they'll have no honour to give,
 And finally their old age will
 Be without honour *on the hill*.
 18 If they die young, they'll have no hope
 No consolation, strand or rope,
 In the day of decision's scope.
 19 For the end of a wicked score
 Is grievous *now and ever more*.

The length of life tells nothing in its way,
 How children fall in two groups scattered
 bright:
 Outside Your grace there are two sets for
 spite.
 Many may live more than the common stay
 Above three score and ten, many bear
 sway,
 Sinking in youth before the lowering night.
 Much could be told of wealth and power
 and right
 Come to the children of the wicked bay.
 Elected for damnation by the fraud
 Lingering in their hands from their parents'
 skill,
 With no desire to change to righteousness,
 Among their spawn in regiments they trod
 In paths of infamy down to the kill.
 Nothing of goodness comes to fix the mess.

Wisdom 4

1 Better than this is childlessness
 With virtue, for in memory guess
 Of virtue's immortality,
 Because it is known both by men
 And Alohim *in His own glen*.

Some seek the fickle fame of human
 thought,
 What neighbours find of glory in the plot,
 And others bear the burdens and the share
 Of hope that some raise them in glory's
 snare.
 There are a few whose names are known
 throughout
 The crowd of living today with a shout,
 And have been known for centuries for
 weal
 Or woe: some wear a jingling silver heel.
 Beloved, I seek a better memory,

A fame not based on fickle human scree,
But on the mind and heart that never fails,
The infinite in love above such scales.
Give me, Beloved, immortal fame in You,
Remember my name for the good and true.

2 When it is here, men follow wake,
When it is gone, long for its sake,
It always goes in victory's crown,
Winner of prizes all hands down.
3 But the prolific offspring from
The ungodly is just a bum,
And none of their bastards take root
Or have firm foundations to boot.
4 If they spring shoots for a short time,
They will fail before the wind's clime,
Uprooted by the gales in rime.
5 The branches will be broken off
Before they're grown, their fruit for scoff
Be futile, never ripe to eat,
And good for nothing *under feet*.
6 For children born of unions made
Unlawful are witnesses paid
Of evil against their parents
When Alohim tests them for vents.

All born of womankind are useful here
Upon the planet torn with laugh and tear:
The excrement of man as that of beast
Is spread for all plant life in filling feast,
The very air expelled from human lung
Is freshening to the cowslip's mortal tongue.
Whether of good behaviour or of ill,
The human body is here useful still.
Beloved, I shudder at the craven way
That folk make themselves useless by the bay.

They drop their excrements in water pure,
And mummify their bodies to be sure
They give no single crumb to web of life.
Only my breath contributes without strife.

7 The righteous man, though he die young,
Will be at rest *for what he's sung*.
8 Old age is not honoured for time,
Nor measured by count of years prime,
9 But understanding's men's grey hair,
And blameless life old age's share.
10 There was one who pleased Alohim
And was loved by Him *in His dream*,
And while he lived with sinners he

Was taken to eternity.

11 He was caught up lest evil change
His understanding or *in range*
Guile should deceive his soul *with strange*.
12 Fascination of wickedness
Obscures what is of good address,
Roving desire perverts the mind
Of innocence *before the rind*.
13 Perfected quickly, he fulfilled
Long years, 14 for his soul was instilled
To please YHWH, therefore he took him
Quickly from wickedness with vim.

I do protest, Beloved, that old age has
No rights untouchable and all that jazz.
There are rights of the human race that are
Not to be daft extinguished like a star,
That need not be won but are due to all,
No matter how they tread sublunar ball.
If Enoch was perfected in his state
Faster than masses that failed to relate,
It does not mean that humanly respect
Is not due to the grey head unelect.
Beloved, I am no greater now as man
Than I was as a child before the span,
And yet I demand the respect that's due
To everyone sitting on earthly pew.

15 Yet people saw and they did not
Understand, nor take such in plot,
That God's grace and mercy are with
His elect, and He sets *in pith*
His guard over His holy ones.
16 The righteous man who died *by tons*
Condemns the living ungodly,
And youth that's soon perfected will
Condemn the old age of the swill
Of the unrighteous man truly.
17 For they will see the wise man's end,
And will not understand or fend
What YHWH purposed for him, and for
What He kept him safe *at His door*.
18 They will see, and will have contempt
For him, but YHWH will not exempt
Them from His scorn. After this they
Will have dishonoured corpses' sway,
And an outrage among the dead
For ever, 19 because He with dread
Will dash them speechless to the ground,
And shake them from foundations found,
They will be left barren and dry,

And they will suffer anguish nigh,
And perish will their memory.
20 They will come with dread in their *spree*
Of sins accounted, and their deeds
Lawless will convict all their needs
To their faces bared *in their creeds*.

It is no secret that the wealth one's gained
Does not follow into the grave when
 stained
With time and earth. The only thing I take
With me beyond the last breath on the
 make
Is with what goodness I have left the earth,
The character for weal or woe from birth.
The darkened heart too seeks the credit due
More than the gold itself in greedy view.
The true wealth is not what a man has got,
But what he has become within the plot
Of grace or weal. Outrage among the dead
Is only one reflection on the spread
Of actions right or wrong. Beloved, my
 song
Rises a moment, then I turn from wrong.

Wisdom 5

1 The upright then shall stand in pride
Before those who afflicted *snide*,
And those who his labours deride.
2 When they see him, they will be shaken
With dread and fear, and will be taken
With surprise at his great salvation.
3 They'll tell each other *in prostration*
Of their repentance, and in pain
Of spirit they will groan *in bane*
And say 4 "This is the man whom we
Once held in derision *freely*
And made a byword of reproach,
We were fools! We thought his life's *coach*
Was insane and his end to be
Without any honour *truly*.
5 "Why has he been numbered among
The sons of Alohim *and sung*?
And why's his lot among the saints?
6 "So we strayed from truth's way *for*
 plaints,
And light of righteousness did not
Shine on us, and the sun in lot
Did not rise on our dwelling spot.
7 "We took our fill of lawlessness
And destruction *for our address*,

And we journeyed through trackless waste,
But YHWH's way we came not to taste.

The regret of the proud oppressor seems
Like sour grapes before the judgement
 beams.

Reality that presses on my pate
Is not a happy one to see as fate.
Pretence of justice is what wins the day,
And innocence is made to pay and pay.
Outright oppression with an ugly face
Is path of choice, but in the pinch of pace
Pretence will do to cover up the score
Facilitating markets shore to shore.
Beloved, save up the pious hopes and tears,
I tighten belt and lay away my fears,
And meet the awful darkness with a flinch
Perhaps, but without giving them an inch.

8 "What profit's in our arrogance?

What good is boasted wealth in stance?

9 "All those things vanished in the shade,
And like a rumour on parade,

10 "A ship that sails through billowed
 wave,

And when it's gone past *to the nave*
Remains no trace nor track of keel
Upon the waters *for its weal*,

11 "Or as, when a bird flies the air,
No evidence of passing there

Is found, the air lashed by the beat
Of its wings and struck in the heat
Of its flight plunging is traversed
By the feathered movement in burst
To leave afterward not a sign

Of its come or go in the line;

12 "Or as, when an arrow is shot
At the bull's eye, there at the spot
The air divides and comes again
Together, so that no one then
Can find its pathway in the lot.

13 "So we too, from birth ceased to be,
Without a sign of virtue's fee,
But were consumed and wickedly."

14 Because hope of ungodly man
Is like chaff driven by the span
Of wind, and like a light hoarfrost
Carried away by storm and tossed,
Dispersed like smoke before the wind,
It passes like remembrance binned
Of guests of just a day *then lost*.

Quotation of the first Psalm in the chaff
 Is thunder blunder with a raucous laugh.
 The promise is a sure thing to the one
 Who wades and waits in murmuring in fun
 The gracious syllables of Your law spun
 On Sinai for the comfort of slaves lost
 From civilized, good Egypt to be tossed
 Upon the burning desert and the way
 Where stones attack the feet in spite for
 pay.

Beloved, I see the smoke before the blaze
 On Sinai trouble every eye and craze
 The heart to tremble as the sounds roll
 round
 And stop at last upon the sandy ground.
 They straighten all the twists set in life's
 maze.

15 But righteous ones shall live for ever,
 From their reward YHWH will not sever,
 The Most High takes care of them ever.
 16 So they'll receive a glorious crown,
 A diadem from YHWH's hand down,
 For with His right hand He will cover,
 And with His arm He'll shield *and hover*.
 17 The Lord will take His zeal as His
 Whole armour, and will arm all whiz
 Of universe against His foes,
 18 He'll wear righteousness for breastplate,
 And put justice' helmet on pate,
 19 He'll take holiness as a shield
 Invincible, 20 and will not yield
 Stern wrath sharpened and like a sword,
 Creation will join like a horde
 To fight against the madmen scored.
 21 Shafts of lightning fly with true aim,
 And leap to the target as flame
 From a well-drawn bow in the clouds,
 22 And hailstones full of wrath in crowds
 Will be hurled as from catapult,
 The waters of the sea tumult
 Against them, and rivers will rise
 Relentlessly up to the skies,
 23 A mighty wind against them too,
 Like tempest to winnow the crew.
 Lawlessness lays waste the whole earth,
 And evil-doing of such worth
 Will overturn the rulers' thrones
And set all humankind to groans.

The problem with apocalyptic hope
 Couched in the fiery gusts of unseen rope
 Is simply that such prophecy did not
 Really rise until heathen hand had wrought
 The victory and set Your people low.
 Then, only then, did retribution show.
 The only way alternative to go
 Would be to fight with murderous hand and
 sword,

But such is now forbidden in adored
 Commandments. To keep in the narrow
 way,

The only thing to do is hope for pay
 Beyond the veil of death and destitution
 And find in hopeless hope a restitution.
 That's why I still cling to the feeble ray.

Wisdom 6

1 Listen now, kings, and understand,
 Learn, O judges of all earth's land.
 2 Give ear, you that rule multitudes,
 And boast of many nations' broods.
 3 For your dominion's granted you
 From YHWH, and your sovereignty too
 From the Most High, who will search out
 Your works and inquire of your doubt.
 4 Because as servants of His reign
 You did not rule rightly *for gain*,
 Nor keep the law, nor walk by will
 Of Alohim, 5 he will come still
 Upon you terribly and quick,
 Because severe judgment falls slick
 On those in high places and thrones.
 6 For the lowliest man for groans
 May be pardoned in mercy, but
 Mighty men will be straightly shut.

Beloved, it seems You are an emperor,
 A great king with underlings by the score,
 And some are angel messengers that pace
 The universe to execute Your grace.
 And others are the men on earthly thrones,
 The ones who disobey You in these zones
 Of violence and crass instead of wealth
 Of wisdom, men who thrive on gutting
 stealth.

Beloved, the underling's responsible
 To overlord, but overlord in full
 Must make good what his servants do in
 hate.

Beloved, You are responsible for state.

I'm not the guilty one in my pawn's rate:
I accept Your apologies in rate.

7 For YHWH of all will not stand in
Awe of any one, nor let win
Deferring to greatness, since He
Himself made both small and great free,
And He takes thought for all alike.
8 But strict inquiry is in strike
For the mighty. 9 To you then, O
Monarchs, my words directed go,
That you may learn wisdom and not
Transgress. 10 For they will be made holy
Who observe holy things as lowly,
And those who have been taught the share,
Will find a defence in them there.
11 Therefore set your desire upon
My words, long for them, and be drawn
Into instruction *eve and dawn*.
12 Wisdom is radiant and unfading,
And she is easily parading
Before those who love her, and found
By those who seek her *in the round*.

I thank You, my Beloved, for promising
Investigation of the oppressing
That human rulers and their minions do.
I'm counting on Your justice in the pew.
But while I wait for justice here in grace,
I pray light illuminating Your face
Shall lead me gently in the path to know
Your law and do it despite all the show
Of evil and hypocrisy that go
Around the market and cathedral door.
Give me of righteousness a little more,
A scoop of mercy that will make more
sweet
The product of my busy hands and feet.
Beloved, I seek You with unflagging wing.

13 She hastens to make herself known
To those who desire her alone.
14 He who gets up early to look
For her will have no hard task's brook,
For he will find her sitting where
He comes out *of his house for air*.
15 To concentrate one's thoughts on her
Is right understanding to stir,
And the one who's watchful for her
Will leave off soon anxiety,
16 Because she goes around to see

Who is worthy of her, and she
Is gracious to appear to them
In their paths, and meets them *for gem*
In every thought *and faithfully*.
17 The start of wisdom is the thirst
To be instructed *and not cursed*,
And hope for teaching is her love,
18 And love of her is hand in glove
To keep her laws and to give heed
To her laws is assurance' creed
Of life everlasting indeed.

The fame of sin original is that
It's found in heart and marrow and the fat
And cannot be forsaken, though men try,
But guards the gate and lets wickedness
vie.

But closer to the human heart and mind
Is wisdom, if but sought a while in kind.
The willingness to seek wisdom suffices
To bring her out in triumph over vices.
As soon as the man looks about him where
He sits beside the gates, she flies in air
And perches on the throne of inner heart,
And makes all a man does and thinks an
art.

It does not take decades of study and
Effort, but only thirst for her to stand.

19 And everlasting life brings one
Near to Alohim when it's won,
20 So the desire for wisdom leads
To a kingdom. 21 So if the beads
Of thrones and sceptres tempt your eye,
O monarch that over folk vie,
Honour wisdom so you may reign
For ever and ever *in gain*.
22 I'll tell you what wisdom is and
How she came to be, and in band
I will hide no secrets from you,
But I will trace her course in view
From start of creation, and make
Knowledge of her clear in the wake,
And I will not pass by the truth,
23 Neither will I travel forsooth
Along with vain jealousy's eye,
For envy does not dwell long by
Wisdom. 24 A multitude of wise
Men is the salvation in guise
Of the world, a sensible king
Is his people's stabilizing.

25 And so be taught now by my words,
And you will profit *above sherds*.

The path that begins with wisdom goes on
To keeping of Your law in love to spawn
Eternal life, and that life is Your own
And found only beneath Your sovereign
throne.

I lay hold on life lusting for its bill
And find that You are there, near me to fill
My paunch with good things of creation's
fat,

The glories of truth and justice on mat.
Beloved, if I am to be taught by what
You speak, I cannot turn away or shut
My ear from Sinai's whispers and the
sound

Of thunder pealing on the barren ground.
Instead I turn my gaze toward the light
And flee the darkness of the wicked night.

Wisdom 7

1 I also am mortal, like all
Men, a descendant in the stall
Of the first-formed child on earth's ball,
And in the womb of mother I
Was moulded into flesh, 2 to vie
Within the period of ten moons,
Compacted with blood, from the runes
Of a man and the pleasure croons
Of marriage. 3 And when I was born,
I began to breathe air by horn,
And fell upon the kindred earth,
And my first sound was a cry's dearth,
Like that of all at hour of birth.
4 I was carefully nursed and wrapped.
5 For no king alive has been tapped
Otherwise, 6 there is for all men
One start of life, a common den.

Today we say nine months are hidden way
From the conception to joyous birthday.
Wisdom counts no doubt that conception
stands
Upon the full moon and that's why its
bands
Include the days of ten months lunar's
score
Before the babe begins to knock on door.
All those alive by nature sing that tune,

Though not all nurse at teats to hear the
croon.

Beloved, the first commandment of the plot
Commends to humankind their common lot
By saying and by showing You are one,
And there's no God but You under the sun.
Despite the artificial walls men make
Between the races, cultures and the stake.

7 So I prayed, and got understanding,
I called on Alohim demanding,
And wisdom's spirit came on me.

8 I preferred her to royalty,
And counted wealth as nothing in
Comparison to wisdom's skin.

9 I did not equate her in price
With any gem of worth and nice,
Because all gold is only sand
Compared with her, and silver band
Worth less than clay before her stand.

10 I loved her more than health and beauty,
And chose to have her for my duty
Rather than light, because her ray
Never ceases from day to day.

The choice is often between wisdom and
Wealth in the eyes of stealthy, thieving
band.

One can have gold and power and rubies'
ray

Without the light of understanding's sway,
Or then relinquish all the fun and pay
And take the yoke of wisdom in its day,
And suckle at her breast of poverty.
There's hardly an exception in the spree.
Good Solomon was wise and wealthy too,
The good book says, and so I guess it's
true.

But he sought wisdom instead of his riches
And that's why was not thrown into the
ditches.

It takes stupidity to put more on
Your plate than you can eat: good sense is
gone.

11 All good things came to me along
With her, and in her hands belong
Untold wealth. 12 I rejoiced in them
All, because wisdom will lead them,
But I knew not she was their mother.
13 I learned without guile of the other

And I give without keeping back;
I do not hide her wealth in stack,
14 For it's unfailing treasure for
Men, those who get it have in store
The friendship of Alohim, and
Commendation from teaching's hand.

How many who have knowledge give the
best

Without the pay of siller in the chest?
The Sunday school teacher's the only one
In the system we settle under sun.
But rarely does that auntie or the man
Who functions in the pew as functions can
Dispense wisdom to one and all freely.
More often such are hardly more ably
Endowed with wisdom than the priestly
crowd

That skims cream wallets while praying out
loud

The mega-church has make the humble
task

Of es es teacher a nostalgic bask
In memories bane. Beloved, I do not ask
For more than that when I come into
shroud.

15 May Alohim grant that I speak
With judgement and have thought in peak
Worthy of what I have received,
For He's the guide I have believed
Even of wisdom and the wise.

16 For we and what our words devise
Are in His hand, and as are all
Understanding and skill *in call*.

17 For it is He who gave to me
Unerring knowledge of what be,
To know the structure of the world
And all the elements unfurled,

18 The start and finish of the times,
Their core and alternations' climes,
And solstices and seasons' change,

19 The cycles of the year in range,
And constellations of the stars,

20 The natures of the beasts and bars
Of the wild things, the powers that tend
To spirits and reasonings' end
Of humankind, varieties

Of plants with virtues by degrees
Of roots, 21 I learned both what is hidden
And what is revealed and unbidden,

22 For wisdom, former of all things,
Taught me. For in her there are wings
Intelligent, holy, unique,
Manifold, subtle, mobile, *chic*
And clear, unpolluted, distinct,
Invulnerable, loving the *linked*
Good, keen, and irresistible,
23 Beneficent, humane, and full
Of steadfastness, sure, free from fear,
All-powerful, seeing all near
And far, and penetrating through
All spirits that are wise and true
And subtle and pure *in their view*.

The Oriental way of churning out
The sciences along with wisdom's clout
Seems strange to those today after the
whine

Of nomenclature on the science vine.
The poet thinks that You, Beloved,
revealed

The pathway of the universe unsealed,
While now empirical approach crowds out
Awareness that You speak in a loud shout.
You are, Beloved, ultimate Real in store,
And as such my experiment in lore
Is nothing but a tugging at Your sleeve.
The Oriental's right, I do believe.
The sacred is a science, no reprieve,
And finding is a searching at the door.

24 For wisdom is more mobile than
Any motion, because her span
Of purity pervades and goes
Through all things *set up in their rows*.

25 For she's breath of Alohim's power,
And a pure emanation's hour
Of the glory of the Almighty,
Therefore nothing defiled and flighty
Gains an entrance into her *tower*.

26 She reflects the eternal light,
A spotless mirror recondite
Of the working of Alohim,
An image of His goodness' beam.

27 Though she is but one, she can do
All things, and while remaining true
In herself, she renews all things,
In every generation's springs
She passes into holy souls
And makes them friends of God for goals,
And prophets, 28 for Alohim loves

Nothing so much as the man's *gloves*
 Who lives with wisdom. 29 For she's more
 Beautiful than the sun in store,
 And excels every constellation
 Of the stars. Compared with the ration
 Of light she's found to be by far
 Better than that, 30 after it comes
 The night, but against wisdom's sums
 Evil does not prevail or bar.

The wise man sees that wisdom's
 emanation
 From You, Beloved, as in medieval nation
 Of Islam such philosophy took root
 And formed, alas, Andalus's three boot
 Religions to point at the Thomist soot.
 Even Whitehead saw it with an elation.
 How then does wisdom here at last remain
 A constant ray in contrast to the reign
 Of day and night reflecting wax and wane?
 The static wisdom of this book, I fear,
 Is not the root of faith and knowledge sere
 That paints about millennial time's gear.
 It is a secret not to disappear
 From the perfect man's heart, despite the
 bane.

Wisdom 8

1 She reaches mightily from one
 End of the earth to other's run,
 And she orders all things well done.
 2 I loved her and sought her from youth,
 And I desired to take her truth
 For my bride, and I fell in love
 With her beauty *as of a dove*.
 3 She glorifies her noble birth
 By living in Alohim's worth,
 And YHWH of all loves her. 4 For she
 Is an initiate in fee
 Of Alohim's gnosis and channel
 Of His works *and she is not banal*.
 5 If riches are desired in life,
 What is richer than wisdom's fife
 That measures all things *without strife*?
 6 If understanding is effective,
 Who more than she is an elective
 Of what exists? 7 If any one
 Loves righteousness, her labours done
 Are virtues, for she teaches all
 Both self-control and prudence' *wall*,
 Justice and courage, naught in life

Profits more to men than these rife.

In Ephrata they used to claim the bride
 Sophia instead of the fleshly side.
 Some fell in fits of lust and came to naught,
 Some grew old in the lovely thing they
 sought.

The efforts to achieve the thing once lost
 When Adam was split in two halves
 embossed

With divine will once in the garden grown
 In Ephrata returned to seek the throne.
 Beloved, I know the penal load in time
 Casts out the airy hopes of reasoned rhyme,
 And those who join ascetic rigours last
 Till disappointment comes in feeble blast.
 I turn to You alone for wisdom's crown
 And turn my back upon the market town.

8 If any lust experience,
 She knows the ancient things in sense,
 And predicts those things still in store,
 She understands mysteries of speech,
 And riddles propounded by each,
 She has foreknowledge of all signs
 And wonders of feasts in their lines.

9 So I intended to take her
 To live with me, knowing that her
 Good counsel would encourage me
 In all cares and anxiety.

10 Because of her I shall have glory
 Among the people for my story,
 And honour in the elders' seat,
 Though I am still both young *and sweet*.

11 I shall be found keen in judgement,
 And in the sight of rulers sent
 I shall be admired *for my bent*.

12 When I am silent they will wait
 For me, and when I speak they'll rate,
 And when I speak at greater length
 They'll cover mouths and lose their
 strength.

13 And because of her I shall gain
 Immortal fame and leave in train
 Eternal remembrance to those
 Who come after me in their rows.

The fevered quest for immortality,
 Philosopher's stone in the hours wee
 Of midnight night work and the share of
 dawn

At last is still, the hopes at once withdrawn.
 Some smile in condescension of the way
 The inmates of Ephrata taught their day,
 But the replacement evangelical
 Of all those mysteries and magical
 Is merely mythic burden of the gods
 Bourn to the high places with Baal's sods.
 Beloved, no mystery beckons to me,
 No resurrecting god-men set me free.
 Instead I trust You and Your word alone
 From Sinai still repeated by Your throne.

14 I shall govern peoples, and nations
 Will be subject to me in stations,
 15 Dread monarchs will fear me when they
 Hear of me, among the folk's sway
 I shall show myself able and
 Courageous in battle to stand.
 16 When I enter my house, I'll find
 Rest with her, and so be resigned,
 No bitterness, with her no pain,
 But with gladness and joy to reign.
 17 When I think of these things inside,
 And in my mind considered wide,
 That hand in hand with wisdom's guide
 There is immortality's lane,
 18 And in friendship with her a strain
 Of pure delight, and in the fruit
 Of her hands sure riches to boot,
 In the experience of her way
 Understanding, and in the sway
 Of her words renowned in array,
 I went about to seek her pay.
 19 As a child I was well endowed,
 And a good soul was me allowed,
 20 Or rather, being good, I came
 To enter body without shame.
 21 But I perceived that I would not
 Possess wisdom unless I got
 Her from Alohim in my plot,
 And it was my insight to know
 Whose gift she was and whose glow, so
 I begged YHWH and besought the show,
 With my whole heart I spoke a row.

No bitterness and pain indeed repair
 Within the house of wisdom where I share
 The seven columns on the open air.
 No bitterness and pain are mine since I
 Find sweetness and a balm under the sky
 Where wisdom dwells in cantillations' vie.

No glitterness in vain meets me upon
 My rounds of slaughterhouses on the dawn,
 Nor any idol in my heart withdrawn.
 Beloved, I take the shorter path to You,
 The instant one that catches mountain's
 view,
 And where I hear the comfort of Your
 words
 I sweep away the many-coloured sherds
 Of all religions and sit in Your pew.

Wisdom 9

1 "O Alohim of my ancestors
 And Lord of mercy to *all* *questers*,
 Who have made all things by Your word,
 2 "And by Your wisdom formed man
stirred,
 To have dominion over *all*
 The creatures You've made on *the ball*,
 3 "And rule the world in holy call
 And righteousness, and set judgement
 In uprightness of soul *as meant*,
 4 "Give me the wisdom that sits by
 Your throne, and do not reject my
 Soul from among Your servants *here*.
 5 "For I am your slave and the mere
 Son of your maidservant, a man
 Weak and brief of life, with a *span*
Of knowledge small of judgement and
 Laws, 6 "for even if one is *manned*
 Perfect among the sons of men,
 Yet without wisdom come again
 From You he is nothing in view.
 7 "You have chosen me *in the pew*
 Of king for Your folk, to be judge
 Over Your sons and daughters' *budge*.

The text in Wisdom is so late that it
 Remembers that Your daughters too are fit.
 But then I get impression from the way
 The Bible uses words in ideas' sway
 That early times were less in patriarchal
 And with the centuries women lost their
 sparkle.

Perhaps the truth is in all times and places,
 Among all tribes and nations and all races,
 Some are just in their dealings with all
 faces,
 Whether rich or poor, whether man or
 wight,

They treat all as though equal in Your sight.

But such are rare, and Wisdom's Solomon
Appears at last in Scripture to be one.
To find a few more such-like would be fun.

8 "You have commanded me to build
A temple on holy mount filled,
An altar in Your dwelling town,
In pattern given in renown
Of sacred tabernacle worth
In image of the one on earth
You prepared from the start *and birth*.

9 "With You is wisdom, who knows Your
Works and was present on the shore
When You made the world, and who know
What's pleasing in Your sight and show,
And what is right as Your laws go.

10 "Send her out from the sacred sky,
And from Your glory's throne on high
Send her, so she may be with me
And work and so I learn to see
What is Your delight set to be.

11 "She knows and understands all things,
She'll guide me wisely *above kings*
In my actions and guard me by
Her glory. 12 "Then my works will fly
Up and acceptable to be,
And I shall judge Your folk justly,
And of my father's throne worthy.

Some doubt the pattern of the sacred tent
That followed in the desert the cloud sent
Was from eternal, heavenly designs lent.
Such trust in mere matter and time and
place

Set down in tribal glories of the race
Is beyond all belief. Denial reigns
And ignorance of what's behind the stains
Of all things in creation, where You stand.
Not even earth and stone comprise mere
land,

But all is taught in its perfection laid
Within the divine mind where You have
stayed.

Beloved, I see the temple perfect still
In cantillation of Your word to fill
With incense all the chambers on the hill.

13 "What man can learn Alohim's way?

Or who can perceive YHWH's will's
sway?

14 "The reasoning of mortals lacks,
And our plans fail in all their slacks,

15 "For body perishable weighs
Down the soul, and these earthy stays
Burden the mind in thoughtful sways.

16 "We can hardly guess earthly things,
And what is near in effort springs,
But who has penetrated what
Is up and in the heaven's shut?

17 "Who has learned Your plans, unless
You

Have given wisdom and sent due
Your holy Spirit from on high?

18 "And thus the paths of those that vie
On earth were set right, and men taught
What's Your delight in wisdom sought."

The sciences of men thrust in a hand
And eye well magnified to understand
The universe belayed, betrayed, and
bought,

But Your design remains hidden though
sought.

Reality is larger than the bill

Of anything we touch and try to fill.

Delight I have to see created things,
Wisdom I gain to watch them in their rings,
But what a man can know is just the start
Of all the wonders of the divine heart.

Beloved, I see the black and white and
grey,

And praise You for the colours on their
way,

Beyond my eye and instrument to stray.

Wisdom 10

1 Wisdom guarded the father first
Formed in the world *before the cursed*.

When he alone had been created,
And she saved him from sin instated,

2 And gave him strength to rule all things.

3 But when a wicked man for stings
Departed from her in his wrath,
He perished because in the path
He raging killed his brother *staff*.

4 When the earth was flooded because
Of him, wisdom once more her paws
Showed in salvation, steering man
Righteous by a bit of wood's span.

5 Wisdom also, when nations in
 Wicked pact's agreement had been
 Confounded, knew the upright man
 And saving him innocent by
 Alohim, and kept him to vie
 Before his compassion to try
 For his child. 6 Wisdom rescued then
 A righteous man when wicked men
 Were perishing, he fled the fire
 That came down on five cities' ire.
 7 The evidence of their sin's still,
 A smoking wasteland without hill,
 Plants bearing fruit that's never ripe,
 An image of salt standing stripe
 In memory of soul's unbelief
Where the woman came to her grief.

The sweet Christian wishes now to deny
 That wisdom saved Adam there on the sly,
 But will have all men thrust out into shame
 Because of that one slip up done in fame.
 In truth Your wisdom guides aright the
 ones
 Who are Your elect to live without guns.
 The wisdom of Your deep commandment
 let
 Abraham know that You will never get
 A human sacrifice in pleasure drawn.
 Wisdom corrects the heathen king and
 pawn.
 Beloved, I see the radiant fruit abroad
 That wicked bombs created on the sod,
 And so affirm Your wisdom in the nod.

8 For because they passed wisdom by,
 They not only were hindered dry
 From recognizing the good, but
 Also left for humankind glut
 Reminder of their folly, so
 That their failures could never go
 Unnoticed. 9 Wisdom rescued from
 Troubles those who served her to come.
 10 When a righteous man fled out from
 His brother's wrath, she guided him
 On straight paths, she showed him undim
 The kingdom of Alohim, and
 Gave him knowledge of angels' hand,
 She prospered him in all his tasks,
 And multiplied where his hand asks.
 11 Those who oppressed him envied him,
 But she gave wealth to rescue him.

12 She guarded him from all his foes,
 And kept him safe from all of those
 Who lay in ambush for his toes.
 In his great struggle she gave him
 The victory, and one not dim,
 So he would learn that godliness
 Is of greater power in the guess.
 13 When an upright man had been sold,
 Wisdom did not leave him out cold,
 But saved him from sin of the bold.
 She went down with him to the pit
 Of prison, 14 and when he did sit
 In gaol, she did not leave him there,
 But brought him kingdom's sceptre's share,
 And rulership over his masters.
 Those who accused him and outcasters
 She showed to be false, made for him
 Everlasting honour *and trim.*

Surely the false witness against the man
 Joseph did not believe the fatal plan.
 Wisdom has more to do than just enlighten,
 She must shake wicked people, come to
 frighten
 The lordly wife as well and king on throne,
 The president of company for loan.
 The victory that was not dim for father
 Arose at last to save him from his bother.
 And yet like millions more upon the earth,
 Joseph went through a decade without
 mirth.
 If You sold one into glory and fame,
 There are left millions more without a
 claim,
 Who languish in the prison gates and groan
 With only wisdom to cherish their bone.

15 A holy people and blameless
 Race wisdom saved from their disgrace.
 16 She entered soul of YHWH's servant,
 Withstanding dread kings in her cant
 With signs and wonders *on the slant.*
 17 She gave holy men the reward
 Of their toil, she guided and scored
 Along a marvelled way with sword,
 To shelter them by day, by night
 A starry flame guided outright.
 18 She brought them over the Red Sea,
 And led them through waters' degree,
 19 But she drowned every enemy,
 And threw them in depth of the sea.

20 Therefore the upright plundered then
The ungodly and wicked men,
They sang hymns to YHWH's holy name,
And all together praised the fame
Of Your defending hand *in flame*,
21 Since wisdom opened mouth of dumb,
And made babes speak clear words in sum.

They say that Moses since he was a child,
A very babe in arms, though once when
wild,
Touched tongue to burning coal and so
became
Slow of speech and halting in word to
blame.
But on a day and year when Pharaoh's
claim

Over the folk had run out and was lame,
Wisdom entered the man and he then rode
Both strong and eloquent to praise Your
name.

Beloved, my throat is kin to that of toad,
And I have no words great or small that
stowed

The back of fame and popularity,
But I pray that I may in clarity
Also praise You above the desert sea.
I take Your promises and leave my load.

Wisdom 11

1 Wisdom prospered their works by hand
Of a holy prophet to stand.

2 They journeyed through a desert land,
And pitched their tents where none had
trod.

3 They withstood enemies *with rod*
And fought off their foes *with the prod*.

4 When they thirsted they called on You,
You gave water from a rock's due,
And quenched their thirst by hard stone's
hue.

5 The very things that made foes bleed
Were benefits to them in need.

6 For bloody river water sent

7 For babies killed in punishment,
You have abundant springs of fresh
Water in unexpected mesh

8 Showing by their thirst at that time
What foes suffered in punished crime.

Thirst is a lovely thing, as it reveals

Intensity of pain upon the heels
Of those who're punished for the way they
killed

The babies of the Hebrews that they billed.
So Hussein and his friends laughed for the
joy

To know the lash that You at last employ
Upon the wicked earth. Comfort gave them
A vision of both paradise and gem.
Beloved, I thirst for You here in the den
Of lion and in pillared furnace when
The fires of love flame up around my soul.
I greedily drink from the tempered toll
Of Kauthar, where a lovely hand extends
The alabaster bowl Your mercy sends.

9 For when they were tried in the crux
Of discipline, mercy was flux,
They learned how the ungodly sucks,
Tormented when judged in wrath's *trucks*.

10 For You did test them as a dad
Does in warning a little lad,
But You examined wicked men
As a harsh king in sentence then.

11 Whether abroad or left at home,
They were always distressed in comb
12 Of a two-pronged grief, and a groan
When they remembered the harsh tone.

13 For when they heard that through their
own

Punishment the upright were blessed,
They knew it was YHWH's act, or guessed.

14 For though they had come to reject
In mocking him whom they had pecked,
In the end they marvelled at him,
For their thirst was not of like whim
As that of the righteous *undim*.

The Maccabean thought that You request
A tender punishment upon the best
To call them to repentance, after which
You lift the loved ones up out of the ditch,
But by contrast when judgement comes to
fall

Upon the Gentile pushed against the wall,
It's only for destruction and not call
To repent of the wicked wail and pall,
Is here reiterated and exposed.
Beloved, both wicked and upright have
dozed.

No matter what my past and punishment,

No matter what reward on me is spent,
Let me turn from the glory and the shame
To praise You and Your throne and lovely
name.

The rest may pass into obscurity,
The fading light of hope and history.

15 In return for their foolish thoughts
Of wickedness, which led their plots
Astray to worship mindless snakes
And worthless animals in wakes,
You sent on them a multitude
Of mindless creatures in a brood
To sting them *since they had been rude*,
16 So they might see that one gets back
The stinging pain from very stack
Of things for which he sins *a crack*.
17 For your all-powerful hand, which
Created the world out of stitch
Of formless matter, did not lack
The means to send upon them rack
Of bears, or bold lions, 18 or just
Newly created unknown fussed
Beasts, or such as breathe fiery breath,
Or belch forth thick black smoke of death,
Or send sparks' terror from their eyes,
19 Not only could their work devise
To liquidate men, but the sight
Alone could kill men by the fright.

The writer of the book of Wisdom thinks
The legendary dragons at the brinks
Of darkened pools with scaly tail that slinks
And fiery snout that lowers when he drinks
Is not a myth at all, but punishment
Divine on those who failed obedient.
That's fine with me, my scientific mind
Is not offended by belief resigned.
It's possible that some beast in the past
Now merely bones in quarry and upcast
Is really dragonly in every way.
Both views I trow can stand the light of
day.
What's still to find proof in experiment
Is whether You tread down the wicked
dent.

20 Even apart from these, men could
Fall at a single breath when stood
Up by justice and scattered by
The breath of Your power *on the sly*.

But You've arranged all things in sort
By measure, number and weight's sport.
21 For it is always in Your power
To show great strength, and hour by hour
Who can withstand Your mighty arm?
22 The whole world before Your alarm
Is like a mote that tips the scales,
And like a drop of dew that fails
Not to appear in morning *pales*
To drop upon the ground *in bales*.
23 But You are merciful to all,
For You can do all things, and tall
You overlook men's sins, that they
May repent *on another day*.
24 For You love all things that exist,
And have loathing for none You missed
Not to have made, for You would not
Have made anything of the lot
If You had hated it *for rot*.
25 How would anything have endured
If You had not willed it inured?
Or how would anything not called
Forth by You have been saved and walled?
26 You spare all things, for they are yours,
O YHWH, You love the living stores.

But You are merciful to all. I say,
Your mercy seems to have selective way.
Your mercy keeps the guilty on the throne,
Your mercy turns the heart of poor to stone.
Come down in mercy on the side of those
Who lie beneath the crushing weight and
throes
Of the oppressing elite hand of gold.
Come down in mercy and destroy the bold.
Beloved, the law of jungle is the fare
We eat who ride upon the rushing air.
I know You gave a Decalogue as sweet,
I know You speak to each man on the
street.
Put teeth in Your speech, then I'll know the
great
Mercy of God has fallen on the state.

Wisdom 12

1 For Your immortal spirit's in
All things. 2 Therefore You come to win
Correction step by step in those
Who transgress, and remind with woes
Them of the things wherein they sin,
So they may be set free from *stew*

Of wickedness and trust in You
O YHWH...

O YHWH indeed! Bless You to say I'm
right
That man alone is not Your image bright,
But all things here created day and night.
The inescapable awareness of
The "I" within that fits soul like a glove,
The YHWH-shaped emptiness arising from
Each act of evil, is the proof in sum
That there's no I but You, Beloved, and no
Reality except the hands that go
Creating universes on the show
Screen of néant. Beloved, I am not slow
To react to the pricks within my heart,
The inner chamber where You start and
start,
And step by step correct transgression's
part.

3 Those who lived in ancient times in
Your holy land, 4 You hate for sin,
Their works of sorcery and rites
Unholy, 6 their slaughter on sites
Without mercy, their sacrifice
To feast on human flesh and blood.
These initiates from the splice
Of heathen cult *come in a flood*,
6 These parents who took innocent
Lives, You did well *in Your contrives*
To destroy them *and all their hives*
By hands of our ancestors sent,
7 That the land most precious of all
To You might receive worthy call
In colony of servants true
Of Alohim, *servants of YHWH*.

The ancient faith of Canaan that appears
Was destroyed by the hand of Hebrew seers
Is simply that which takes place in arrears
And sanitized by altar in the church.
They work the sorcery when come to perch
With bread and wine, and feast on sacrifice
Of human flesh and blood. But it is nice
They offer to the fire not their sons now
But Your son, my Beloved, for bleeding
brow.
In ancient times the righteous pagan held
His own and precious to the knife that
spelled

Death, now degeneration of the path
Is criminals are treated with the wrath
Of Methodist and Baptist paralleled.

8 But even these You came to spare,
Recognizing their blood and chair,
And sent before Your army's run
Wasps to destroy them *for Your fun*
A little at a time *to stun*,
9 Since You could not give wicked up
To be destroyed by righteous tup
In battle and all at a blow
By dreadful beasts or Your word's show.
10 But judging them in sleight of time
You gave them a chance in their clime
To repent, since You knew that they
Had started in the evil way
And had been born to wickedness,
And that their thinking in address
Would never change *but in duress*.
11 For they were an accursed race
From the beginning, without trace
Of fear of anyone You left
Them unpunished for sins *in cleft*.
12 For who will say, "What have You
done?"
Or will resist Your judgment won?
Who will accuse You for destruction
Of nations You made *for obstruction*?
Or who'll come before You to plead
As advocate for wicked seed?
13 For neither is there any god
Besides You, whose care on the sod
Is for all men, to whom You proved
That You were not unjustly moved,
14 Nor can any king or monarch
Oppose You for the punished stark.

Thank You once more that You spell out
the true:
There is no other god to come in view
To die on crosses and rise from the pew
An advocate for sinners in the stew.
No other god come in to intervene,
To plead the cause of those who scatter
bean
Against Your good commandments and
then wean
Others away from Your obedience keen.
It's all a heathen myth, the advocate
Who justifies both sinners in his rate

And condemns You, Beloved, for Your
judgement
Against oppression on the poor once sent.
You do not hesitate today for fear
Of criticism coming to Your ear.

15 You are righteous and rule all things
In righteousness, in Your dealings
You do not condemn innocent
To punishment. 16 For Your strength's bent
To uprightness, Your sovereignty
Over all makes You set all free.

17 For You show Your strength when men
doubt

Your power to rule, and You are stout
To rebuke any insolence

Among those who regard Your fence.

18 You who are sovereign in power judge
With mildness and forbearance smudge,
For You can do all as You choose.

19 Through such works You have taught
Your folk

That the upright man must not bruise,
And You've filled your sons at a stroke
With good hope, because You bring out
Repentance for sins *all about*.

20 For if You did punish with such
Great care and kindness the foes' crutch
Of Your servants and those who came
Deserving of a death in flame,
And granting them time and a chance
To relinquish their wicked dance,

21 With what severity have You
Judged Your sons, to whose fathers You
Swore and made promises in pact
That for good only You would act.

I had not thought of that before! I faint
In shame that I so often make complaint
That You do not destroy the wicked from
The face of the whole earth, the dreadful
scum.

Forebearance that You show to those who
must

Go into the oblivion of dust
With guilt upon both hands and bloody rust
On soul, without a slight redeeming crust,
Is but the gauge of how much patience You
Have in store always for the upright crew,
Those who lay hold of Decalogue in view,
Repenting when they fail to meet the due.

I now rejoice in all the patience spent
On every salesman, every president.

22 So while You punish us You scourge
Our enemies *and all named George*
Ten thousand times more *at the forge*,
So we may meditate on your
Goodness when we judge *on that score*,
And when we are judged we may find
Expectation of mercy kind.

23 Therefore those who are in life's folly
Living unrighteously, *by golly*,
You torment through the way of their
Abominations in their share.

24 For they went far astray on paths
Of error, accepting the wraths
Of beasts as gods which even their
Enemies despised, were deceived
Like foolish babes *when they are thieved*.

25 Therefore, as to such mindless youth,
You sent Your judgement without ruth
To mock them. 26 But those who have not
Heeded the warning of light plot,
Will feel deserved judgement of God.

27 For when in their suffering in pod
They became angry with those beasts
Which they had thought gods at their
feasts,

Since they were punished by them, they
Saw and knew true Alohims' way,
Whom before they refused in sway.
That's why the utmost condemnation
Came on them, *both on root and nation*.

The evil that men do returns to bite
The bass, as says contemporary wight.
The very gods of gold and oil come down
Upon the heads of those who gave the
frown

To You and Your commandments in the
town.

The ships spew out the blackened waste to
make

A hell of punishment in the sins' wake
That would destroy the earth by burning
lake.

A century of hell that men have made
Bears witness to the faith at once displayed.
The proof of hell is clear for all to see.
Now let them show us for eternity
The paradise of their technology.

It's only fair turn and about in trade.

Wisdom 13

1 For all men who were ignorant
Of Alohim were foolish slant
By nature, and they could not know
Him from the good things in the show,
How He exists, nor recognize
A craftsman by his work in guise,
2 But they supposed that either fire
Or wind or air, or constellations,
Or running water or the lights
Of heaven were the gods in their rights
Who rule the world and all the nations.

The grasping at the four gates in their
power
Is also an idolatrous mind's hour.
The four gates are but pedestals of grief
Where the inspired soul rests to find relief.
If I stop whirling for a moment's sound,
I fall upon the heathen slaughter ground,
And grasp in dizzy faint at what I've found,
Relying on the railing, iron bar,
The silver slant, the glistening golden star.
Beloved, let me whirl on, whirl on past all
The gates and idols where the veilings fall
And live in Your heart only for a stall,
Where no wind and no water touch my
frame,
No earth and yet no fire feed on love's
flame.

3 If delight in the beauty of
These things inspired men to bring love
To them as gods, then be aware
How much more beautiful in stare
Is their Lord, for the source of such
Beauty created them *to touch*.
4 And if men were amazed at their
Power and function, let them compare
To how much greater in power He
Must be who formed them and set free.
5 For from the greatness and beauty
Of things created comes degree
Of perception of Maker's spree.

The great apostle Paul can rarely quote
A passage from the Bible as was wrote,
But draws conclusions from the text that
seem

Most fanciful to reason on the beam.
But when he wrote to Romans for their
share

That all creation in sight comes to bear
A witness of the deity to wear,
He quoted Wisdom right and got down pat
The concept that idolatry is flat,
A surface looking at created things
And catching all their beauty in its wings.
Not only all creation but the faith
In idol and in artificial wraith
Come bearing witness of their divine
spings.

6 These men are little to be blamed,
For perhaps they're astray as claimed
While seeking Alohim with thirst
To find Him *above all things cursed*.
7 For as they live among his works
They keep searching, and without shirks
They trust in what they see, because
The things they see follow the laws
Of beauty that everywhere lurks.
8 And yet they cannot be excused,
9 For if they had the power and used
It to know so much that they could
Investigate the world for good,
How did they fail to find more quick
The Lord of these things at a lick?
10 But miserable, with their hopes set
On dead things, are the men who met
The works of men's hands and to name
Them "gods", gold and silver in frame
Of skill, and beastly image too,
A useless stone made by a crew.

Instead of looking to the source behind
The beauty on the surface of the rind,
The human will set up ideal thought
In place of You, Beloved, and so is taught
To make of beauty in ideal set
The god of every kind of thing he's met.
Trajectory of beauty in the thing
Should have led to Creator and the King.
Instead it inspired men to inventing
Expression of his delight in the ring.
The self-expression in place of the sight
Of cause and effect leads into the night
Of heathen worship, whether sung before
In ancient times or on technical floor.

11 A skilled woodcutter may saw down
 A tree easy to draw to town
 And with skill strip away the bark,
 Then with pleasing workmanship park
 And useful thing that serve's life's need,
 12 And burn the extra wood to feed
 Himself, and eat his fill with greed.
 13 But a cast-off piece from the lots,
 Useful for nothing, crooked, knots
 Abounding, that he takes and carves
 With care at leisure at the wharves
 With skill born from his idleness,
 He forms it like a man's address,
 14 Or makes it like some worthless beast,
 Puts on some crimson paint at least
 To cover every fault increased
 With paint, 15 then makes for it a niche
 To set it off on wall with leash
 Attached to iron. 16 So he takes thought
 So it won't fall, it can't be taught
 To help itself, for it is just
 An image to be raised from dust.
 17 When he prays about wealth and more,
 His marriage and offspring in store,
 He has no shame to give a name
 Addressing a lifeless thing's claim.
 18 For health he begs something that's
 weak,
 For life then he will come to seek
 From a dead thing, for aid entreat
 A thing that's never done a feat,
 To bless his journey make appeal
 To one without a step or heel,
 19 For profit, work, success of hand
 He asks strength of a thing whose hand
 Has no strength or any strength planned.

Aesthetic delight is presented here
 As both the source of love and wisdom's
 fear
 Of the Creator, and the source in fact
 Of heathen thought that gives way to the
 act.
 The complaint of the wise neglects to see
 The weight of delight in psychology,
 But only focuses on surface fuel,
 Utilitarian in carving duel.
 Beloved, the argument denies the weight
 Of beauty on the human heart and pate,
 Despite the good beginning that the eye
 On beauty could find out its Maker's cry.

Almost, Beloved, mankind attains the true,
 But then falls back to darkness or to You.

Wisdom 14

1 Again, one setting out to sail
 Across the raging waves in gale,
 Prays to a fragile piece of wood
 Much weaker than the ship that stood
 To carry him. 2 Desire for gain
 Prompted the plan to ship the main,
 And wisdom was the craftsman who
 Built it, 3 but Your providence' view,
 O Father, steers its course, because
 You've given it a path that draws
 Across the sea, and a safe way
 Through the waves, 4 showing that Your
 way
 Can save from the danger's delay,
 So that even if a man lacks
 Skill, he may put to sea *in tracks*.
 5 You will Your wisdom to prevail,
 Therefore men trust their lives in sail,
 Even to the smallest piece of wood,
 And pass through billows as they should,
 On a raft come safely to land,
 And guided always by Your hand.
 6 For even at the start and when
 Proudful giants fell among men,
 The hope of the world took refuge
 Upon a raft, even if huge,
 And guided by Your hand remained
 Seed of a new spawn on earth gained.
 7 So blessed is the wood by which right
 Comes *to the world dispelling night*.

Although the wood of which is built the
 ship
 Is much a better aid than image slipped
 In carved out of the self-same tree to be
 A god and guide to both the bond and free,
 It is wood too. And yet from early times
 The wood alone did not create the rhymes.
 It matters not perhaps how strong the oar,
 Or strength of arm in those set from the
 shore.
 What keeps all nature, not just human race,
 On course and in the right and lawful place,
 And in successful mode under Your grace,
 Is rather guidance from Your blessed face.
 I do not break my compass and yard-arm,
 And still I trust You in the face of harm.

The baba sat and smoked in peace his pipe
While all the passengers with fear made
ripe

By storm and grief set up a wail and prayer
To beg of You salvation from the blare.
When the ship came to harbour safe and
bound,

They asked him where his calm hope had
been found,

Did he not know and inch of rotting wood
Alone stayed certain death among the
good?

He only said now that we're on the dock,
There is no longer even that in stock,
But I walk here with certain death beside
Me everywhere I turn to walk or ride.

Beloved, take every veil between my way
And death and keep me only in Your stay.

8 But idol made with hands is cursed,
And so is he who made it worst,
Because he did the work and it,
A perishable thing unfit,
Was named a god *by a nitwit*.

9 For equally hateful to God
Are ungodly men and the rod
Of their ungodliness on sod.

10 For what was done will be at last
Punished together with outcast
Who perpetrated the repast.

The sweet Christian that hates my gut
replies

That 'hate the sin but love the sinful guys'
Is the sure way of Christ, and yet Your
word

Is clear upon this matter and unblurred.
At least You Yourself hate the sinful man
As much as You despise his wicked plan.
O my Beloved, I have received such tale
Of teaching that I love both heart and hale,
Both wicked and the righteous in the camp.
Beloved, teach me to hate aright the scamp.
By contrast, may I choose a heart to keep
My love of the most righteous high and
deep.

For just as You love what the good man
does,

You also love the man, straight hair or
fuzz.

11 So judgement falls on pagan gods,
Because, though part upon the sods
Of Alohims' creation here,
They became abomination,
And became snares for men's souls near,
And pits for foolish foot *and bun*.

12 The thought to make idols was start
Of fornication, and their dart
Was the corruption of men's life,
In house and home and child and wife.

13 They did not exist from the start,
Nor will they stay when they depart.

14 For through the vanity of men
They entered in the worldly den,
And quickly will they in their time
Disappear from both space and clime.

Idolatry, the false belief about
You, my Beloved, as God, is start of rout
In evil, in all wickedness at hand.
Those who say it does not matter when
planned

What men believe about You on the stand,
Since You are great and above human
thought,

It only matters here what men have
wrought,

Are here to perpetrate the evil score.
The bad theology is nothing more
Than spring of evil act upon the shore.
Beloved, keep me in worship of the One
Who has been here before things were
begun,

Who is alone my Sovereign and my God,
The One who spoke upon Sinai's hard sod.

15 A father, consumed with his grief
In bereavement's time for relief,
Made an image of his own child,
Who had been taken unbeguiled
From him in suddenness, and he
Now honoured as a god to be
What once was dead humanity,
And handed down to those that came
After of his dependents' fame
The secret rites initiate.

16 Then the ungodly custom late
Grown strong with time as law of state
Till at command of kings it came
Carved images worshipped *in shame*.

17 When men could not honour their kings
 In their presence, for distancings,
 They kept in mind how they looked where
 They were, and made visible share
 In image of the king so they
 Might honour him in the right way,
 By their zeal flattering the one
 Though absent as though present gun.
 18 Then the ambition of the man
 Of skill inspired by beauty's plan
 Even the ones who did not know
 The king to greatly worship so.
 19 For he, perhaps indeed to please
 His ruler skilful in his sleaze
 Fudged in the likeness to be more
 Beautiful in image than store.
 20 And so the crowd charmed by his art,
 Looked on it as object in part
 For worship, though of one they had
 Before honoured as a man sad.

The theory of the origin of sin
 In worshipping idols in wicked bin
 Is the beginning of the art I stay
 To practice in the academic way.
 Comparative religion once set out
 To find the origins of faith about
 The ghosts that haunted tale and dwelling
 place,
 Or to define what high god's ancient race
 Degenerated in to many ways
 That people come about to pray and praise.
 We have not yet surpassed Wisdom in that
 Fell theory to describe religion pat.
 Who knows and who explains the evil claw
 That usurps love and faith from Your first
 law?

21 And this became a hidden trap
 For humankind, because men's rap,
 In bondage to misfortune or
 To royal authority's bore,
 Bestowed on wooden objects or
 Of stone the name not to have score.
 22 After that it was not enough
 For them to err about the stuff
 Of Alohim, but they would live
 In great strife through ignorance' sieve,
 And they call such great evils peace,
Though a burden without release.

Each time a king has ordered all the realm
 To worship at one altar by his helm,
 The result is that men and women too
 Are beaten to submission by the crew
 Of priests elected and paid with the bread
 From widows' mouths and orphans to be
 fed.

Each time a king has ordered heathen grace
 To fill the churches and the temples' space
 The result is that peace proclaimed aloud
 Is really just oppression of the crowd.
 Beloved, Islam's hypocrisy I fear,
 I flee the name and its oppressive gear,
 And take the peace that comes from You
 alone,
 Bowed and repentant at Your sovereign
 throne.

23 For whether they kill children in
 Initiations, or begin
 To celebrate secret mysteries,
 Or hold frenzied revels with sleaze,
 24 They no longer keep either lives
 Or marriages pure in their hives,
 But they as traitors either kill
 Each other, or grieve each one still
 By their adultery on the hill.
 25 All is a rage and riot of
 Blood and murder, theft and false love,
 Corruption, faithlessness, tumult,
 And perjury *to an insult*,
 26 Confusion over what is good,
 Forgetfulness of favours stood,
 Pollution of souls, sex perversion,
 Disorder in marriage, immersion
 In adultery's debauchery.
 27 For the worship of idols' spree
 Not to be named is the early
 Cause and end of every sad fee.
 28 For their worshippers either rave
 In exultation, or engrave
 A prophecy of lies, or live
 Unrighteously, or readily
 Commit perjury like a sieve,
 29 Since they trust in lifeless idols
 They swear wicked oaths for their souls
 Expecting no harm in the tolls.
 30 But penalties in justice will
 Overtake them on two counts' bill:
 Because they thought wickedly of
 Alohim in devoting love

To idols, and since in deceit
They swore unrighteously through *meet*
Contempt for holiness *in feat*.

31 For it is not the power of things
By which men swear, but the just stings
For those who sin, that will pursue
Always wrong of the wicked crew.

The faith of state that's claimed to be of
peace,
But is in fact the source of all release
Of evil on the world, is perpetrated
For ever as a vehicle instated
To keep the power of kings, the status quo
Through controlled violence and on the go.
Beloved, the government of Decalogue,
That law forsaken by all in the bog,
Is what I wish above all things to see,
That law of faith and freedom on the free.
Roll in the day of justice on the mass,
And as it takes root in the heart of lass
And laddie everywhere the sound is heard,
I trow in righteousness Your world is
stirred.

Wisdom 15

1 But You, our God, are kind and true,
Patient, and ruling all things due
In mercy. 2 For even if we sin
We are Yours, know Your powers begin,
But we will not sin, because we
Know we're accounted Yours freely.
3 To know You is full righteousness,
And to know Your power and confess
Is root of immortality.

Eternal life according to the word
Of Jesus Christ in John seventeen stirred
Is to know You the only True God. I
Suspect that Jesus quoted on the sly
The grand Apocrypha and Wisdom's book
Despite the fact he as a Baptist shook
In fear to quote a Catholic verse and
chapter.
Maybe he thought no one would see the
mapter.

Beloved, I quote You anywhere I find
Your word established in spirit and kind,
In Mad or Donald Duck, but please remind
Me to keep to the Decalogue and so
Interpret comics in the proper glow.

My eyesight's failing and my reading's
slow.

4 Neither has human art's intent
Of evil misled us in vent,
Nor fruitless toil of painters spent,
A figure dyed with hues for rent,
5 Whose likeness rouses up in fools
The yearning to desire from tools
The lifeless form of image dead.
6 Lovers of evil things are fed
And fit for such objects of hope,
And they are those who come to cope
By making or worshipping slope
Of artificial forms in dope.
7 For when a potter kneads soft clay
And with effort moulds each cup's way,
He makes out of the same lump both
The clean pots and chamber pot's oath
With the same technique, he decides
For which use each one here abides.
8 With vain actions he forms a vain
And futile god from the same grain,
This man who was himself just made
From earth and after his parade
Goes down to the earth from which he
Was taken, when he has to see
His soul return to Him who lent.
9 But he is not concerned that he
Is destined to die or his spent
Life is brief, but instead competes
With workers in the craftsman's feats
In gold and silver, copperware,
And he considers it his share
Of fame that he moulds counterfeit
Gods by his imitation's wit,
And considers his name of fame
For making idols without shame.
10 His heart is ashes, his hope's cheap,
More so than dirt, his life to keep
Less worth than clay, 11 because he failed
To know the One who formed him flailed
And inspired him with active soul
And breathed in him living breath's toll.
12 But he considered our existence
An idle game, and life's consistence
A festival for profit's gain,
For he says one must get insane
Money however one can, yet
By dishonest means when need's met.

The basics of today's philosophy
 Are just the same as in that ancient spree:
 The game of life is just to make a pound
 If it takes making idols from the ground.
 Indeed, there's hardly anything to buy
 In all the market places of this sty
 But idols, idols made of gold and brass,
 Of plastic, papier mache and such crass.
 Beloved, I'm grateful that I do not starve
 Upon this planet where the most men carve
 Out idols or if not fall in the wake
 From hunger before all the market's stake.
 As though by special grace here one, there
 two
 Are saved from pretty profits that accrue.

13 For this man of all men must know
 He sins when he makes from the show
 Of earthy matter vessels' row
 And graven images' row.
 14 But foolish and in misery
 More than an infant on the tee
 Are each and every enemy
 Who has oppressed your folk in spree.
 15 For they thought all their heathen props
 Were gods, though these have neither flops
 From their eyes to see with, nor nose
 With which to draw a breath *in pose*,
 Nor ears with which to hear, nor yet
 Fingers to feel with, and their set
 Feet cannot walk when they are let.
 16 For a man made them, and one whose
 Spirit is borrowed formed their clues,
 For no man yet can form a god
 Which is like himself *on the sod*.
 17 He's mortal, and what he can make
 With lawless hands is a dead stake,
 For he is better than the things
 He worships, since his life has wings,
 But they have no life in their springs.
 18 The foes of your folk worship most
 Hateful of animals in boast,
 And are worse than all others, when
 Judged by their lack of judgement then,
 19 And even as animals they
 Are not so beautiful to stay
 In looks as one would hope, but they
 Have escaped both Alohims' praise
 And His blessing *out from the maze*.

The centuries in which Wisdom's book saw

The light are those when pagans in false
 awe
 Developed in a flash idols to stand
 In temples round the world, where in the
 scanned
 Days before that, no images were found
 Upon the eastern lays and morning's
 ground.
 Proliferation of idolatry
 Circled the globe when Hellenizing fee
 Was set upon the land of Palestine,
 And with the spread, also the bread and
 wine.
 Beloved, I turn back to the books before
 The images entered into the store
 To find the closer values of respect
 For parents and for Creator's elect.

Wisdom 16

1 Therefore those men got their deserts
 Through such creatures and to their hurts
 Tormented by a crowd of such.
 2 By contrast I see Your kind touch
 To Your folk, and You gave them quail
 To eat, delicacy's avail
 To satisfy the appetite,
 3 While those men when they wanted bite
 Might lose the least part of desire
 Because of those creatures of ire
 Sent to them, while Your folk in want
 A short time might last come to haunt
 The halls of delicate cuisine.
 4 For it was needed on the scene
 That those oppressors should feel heat,
 While to these others it was meet
 That they should see their foes' retreat
 In torment. 5 For when the great rage
 Of wild beasts came on Your folk sage
 And they were in destruction's wave
 Bitten by writhing serpents' crave,
 Your anger did not stay to grave,
 6 For they were troubled for a while
 To warn them, received without guile
 A token of salvation's smile
 Reminding them of law's command.
 7 For he who turned toward the stand
 Was saved, not by what he saw, but
 By You, the Saviour of all *cut*.

I trust the giving of the quail was meant

To show Your mercy and the grace You
sent

Among the people who came up to stand
Against the face of Egypt and the grand.
And yet the story goes on to reveal
How Your grace can be turned on ear and
heel,

When lust and greed impale the hopeful
slant

And meat between the teeth slays those
who can't.

Beloved, I take a toothpick on my score
And carefully extract the stringy gore,
And turn again to grace from my own store
Of lust and grasping at the heavenly door.
Instead I whirl a tune upon the floor
And rise again against the sky and rant.

8 And by this also You convinced
Our foes You saved all those who winced
From every evil on the strut.

9 For they were killed by locusts' bites
And flies, without healing in sights,
Because they deserved punishment
By such things on them as were sent,

10 But your sons were not done away
By even poisoned serpents' day,
For Your mercy came down to stay
In help and healing in array.

11 To turn them back to what You said
They were bitten, and as they bled
They were saved quickly, lest they fall
Under deep forgetfulness' pall,
And fail to respond to Your call.

12 For neither herb nor poultice cured
Them, but it was, O Lord, Your word,
Which heals all men when they are stirred.

The fiery serpents in the desert way
Provide the metaphors in decades' sway
And in the centuries that ponder time
The vipers still wriggle, and squirm and
climb.

I'd rather feel the bite of locust than
The asp's tongue flicking on the skin of
man,

And yet I mind my own grandfather's wail
At age of two, when he sat down to flail
The pet blacksnake that lived behind the
stove.

It bit him on the arm, the scar where drove

The snake's teeth could be seen in my own
day.

He let go of the churn and paddle quick.
My own thoughts rise and I have bell to
pay,

As I meet serpents if not forms of stick.

13 For You have power of life and death,
You lead men down to the gates' breath
Of Hades and bring back again.

14 A man in his wickedness' den
May kill another, but he can't

Bring back departed spirit's haunt,
Nor set free the imprisoned soul.

15 To escape from Your hand in toll
Cannot be done. 16 The ungodly,
Refusing to know You and see,
Were beaten by strength of Your arm,
Pursued by strange rains, hail and harm
Of storms, and utterly consumed
By fire. 17 For strangely though once
doomed

To water, which quenches all things,
The fire was still greater in stings,
For so defends the universe
The upright *and from every curse.*

Beloved, I speak to You as though You
were

A personage beloved, such as occur
In sight and bound of earth, and such as stir
By form and grace love and awe beneath
fur.

I know the Grecian thought that makes
abstract

And spirit what should be both form and
act,

And know that the sophisticated hacked
Naiveté for all the things it slacked.

And still I speak to You, Beloved, though
You

Are thought when thought to be behind the
crew

Of all things made, silent, spirit in lieu
Of lover. If You are the universe,
All in all, One, and not a loving curse,
I still embrace You in my love and true.

18 At one time the flame was restrained,
So it might not consume the trained
Creatures sent against wicked ones,

So that the sight might show their tons
That they were objects of judgement
From Alohim in what was meant,
19 And at another time right in
The middle of the water's din
It burned more strongly than the fire,
To destroy the crops in its ire
In the land of unrighteous bin.

20 Instead of these things You did give
Your folk food on which angels live,
And without toil You did supply
Them with bread ready from the sky,
Providing every pleasure and
Suited to every taste at hand.

21 Your providence showed how sweet
You

Were toward Your children and for brew
And bread You served the one who took
It to make suited every look.

The manna too is subject of the tale
That's drawn from centuries in heart and
hale

To be the metaphor of all things good
Drawn from Your hand of providence as
could.

The mystic and the true believer come
To taste of Your blessed harvest and in sum
To find celestial bread in flesh and blood
Of god-men resurrected from the flood.
My doubting Thomas' heart turns back to
find

The desert way and looks across the blind
To know that You accept no human gift,
No sacrifice, nor even love to lift
Untainted in the pews. For sacrifice
Is just a man's attempt not to suffice.

22 Snow and ice withstood fire without
Melting, so that they might no doubt
Know their foes' farms failed at the root
Under the blaze of fire and soot

In the hail and the showers of rain,
23 Whereas the fire, in ordered bane
Came that the righteous might be fed,
Even forgetting its power bred.

24 For the creation, serving You
Who have made it, exerts the true
To punish the unrighteous crew,
And in kindness relaxes hand
In behalf of the righteous band

Who trust in You *there where they stand.*

The stars that in their courses came to trap
Good Sisera who merely hoped to nap,
Reflect the universe spread out with cap
To trip the wicked and give upright rap
To those who love Your name and keep
Your law.

Such an idea seems insane in my craw.
And yet I act accordingly in awe
And still expect obedience in paw
To be the best way to meet nature's theft,
The best way to avoid being bereft.
After the crusades of the church and state,
When I have barely gear and cabbage left,
I still believe there's something beyond
fate,

A glory and a lifting at the gate.

25 Therefore at that time also, changed
Into all forms, it served as ranged
Your providential bounty by
The desire of those needing cry,
26 So that Your children tenderly,
O Lord, might learn that it's not free
Productions of the fields that feed
Humankind, but Your word indeed
Preserves those who trust in Your *creed.*

27 For what was not destroyed by fire
Was melted when warmed by the ire
Of a fleeting ray of the sun,

28 To make it known that anyone
Must rise before the sun to give
You thanks, and must pray as to live
To You at the dawning of light,
29 For the hope of ungrateful men
Will melt like winter's frost again,
And flow away like water waste,
Darkly and too muddy to taste.

You set, Beloved, the time of morning
prayer

While darkness still touches the sudden air,
And fail to give the hopes of men who stay
Asleep in their ungrateful given way
A light and glimmer of the golden ray.
I see the mighty rivers of the lost,
The detritus of heathen hopes out-tossed,
Move in majestic awfulness toward
The sea of blackened oil instead of sword.
Beloved, in winter's claw I too rise up

To find my prayers recited and the cup
Of nectar waiting after the night's sup.
In summer, though, there is no dark nor
dawn.
And still I wait for You, a frozen fawn.

Wisdom 17

1 Great are Your judgments and beyond
Description, that's why the undawned
Have gone astray. 2 When lawless men
Thought they held the holy in den
Of their power, they themselves were laid
As captives, because they had strayed
In darkness, slaves of the long night,
Shut in under their domes in plight,
Exiles from the eternal right.
3 For thinking that their secret sins
Were not seen behind their veils skins
Forgetful, they were scattered out,
Alarmed in terror, and in rout
Appalled by spectres of redoubt.
4 For not even the inner room
That held them protected from doom
Of fear, but terrifying sounds
Rang out around them, and the rounds
Of dismal phantoms gloomy faced
Appeared *there everywhere they traced*.
5 And no power of fire could give light,
Nor did the brilliant flames *at night*
Of the stars suffice to light up
That hateful night *drawn in their cup*.
6 Nothing was shining through to them
Except a dreadful sort of gem,
Self-kindled fire, and in their fright
They thought the things rose in their sight
Worse than the unseen in its spite.
7 The delusions of magic art
Lay humbled, and their boasted part
Of wisdom scornfully rebuked
*Where vain hearts had been darkly
spooked.*

The very heathen powers that stretch
abroad
Their wicked wings to ploy upon the sod
Oppression of the righteous and the poor,
Also have inner temples to be sure.
The inner chamber is a thing of men
That cannot be fled, for it is a den
Of light wherein the candle of Your life

Burns bright, or else the darkness of the
strife
Creates illusions of illumination
For kings and generals to keep their station.
Beloved, I live in empires of the dust,
And yet my inner chamber knows no rust,
And always there I find the carved crust
That feeds my body and my soul's elation.

8 For those who promised to drive off
The fears and disorders to scoff
At a sick soul were sick themselves
With ridiculous fears *of elves*.
9 For even if nothing at all
Disturbing frightened them in stall,
Still frightened by the passing sound
Of beasts or serpents on the ground,
10 They perished in their trembling fear,
Refusing to look at the bound,
Though everything there must appear.
11 For wickedness is cowardly,
Condemned by its testimony,
Distressed by conscience, always it
Exaggerated the hardship.
12 For fear is nothing but surrender
Of the aid come from reason's splendour,
13 And the hope inside, being weak,
Prefers to ignore what laws seek
The torment. 14 But throughout the night,
Which was indeed without power slight,
And pressed upon them from the deep
Of Hades powerless to keep,
They all slept in a common sleep,
15 And now were driven by monstrous
ghosts,
And now were paralysed from boasts
By their souls' surrender, for soon
An unexpected fear aswoon
Came over them. 16 Whoever there
Was fell down, and was kept in care
Of prison not made of iron, 17 for
Whether he was a farmer or
A shepherd or a workman who
Toiled in the wilderness, in due
He was seized, and endured the fate
Not to be escaped any rate,
For with one chain of darkness they
Were all bound *and then put away*.

The life and death of the unrighteous makes
A subject for contemplations' mistakes:

But through the fog on unknown brass and
claw

One thing appears in psychologic law.
Fear is the state of all who come to take
The share undue from widowed, orphaned
cake,

And fright maintains its hegemony clear
On those who first refused to shed a tear.
The sycophantic scare of superstition,
The magical, the mythical ignition,
That frightened our ancestors from the roof
Now treads upon our hearts with the same
spooft

In fear of all disasters both aquatic
And atmospheric pollutants exotic.

18 Whether there came a sougning wind,
Or sound of melody unpinned
Of birds in a wide-spreading tree,
Or gurgle of water run free,
19 Or the harsh crash of rocks hurled down,
Or the running of beast or clown
Unseen, or the beast's savage roar,
An echo thrown back from the store
Of mountains, it freezes with fright.
20 For the whole world lit up with light
Was engaged in unhindered work,
21 While over those men alone dirk
Of heavy night was spread, in dark
Shadows and where they come to park,
But still beyond the weight of shade
Were they to themselves *in charade*.

The heavy night creeps on both those who
wield

The power of electronic saving shield
And those who in their symbiotic field
Live on the refuse from that wealthy store.
The heavy night enters man to the core.
Beloved, I set a single candle glow
Upon the barren niche within the stow
Of inner chamber, and find the heat there
Enough to shade my soul from fear and
care.

The darkness of the woods that once rose
up

In horror of the twitter and the lup
Of night sounds now becomes a warm
retreat,

And blanket of my comfort, for my feet
A safe path and a haven on my street.

Wisdom 18

1 But for your holy ones there came
Very great light. Their foes *in shame*
Heard voices but did not see form,
Happy not to pass through the storm
Of suffering, 2 and were grateful too
For Your holy ones in their pew,
Though wronged before, did not avenge
Themselves, and they begged for revenge
Pardon for their differing in view.

3 That's why You sent a flame of fire
To guide Your people from the mire,
And cloud to cover up the sun
From burning them when they'd begun.
4 Their foes deserved to have no light
And be locked in darkness from sight,
Those who'd kept your sons in the store
Of prison, through whom open door
Of uncorrupted light's law came
To be given a world of blame.

5 When they'd decided they would kill
The new born of Your holy hill,
And one child had been left to float
And was rescued *from his reed boat*,
You took a multitude away
Of the children as though in sway
Of punishment, and did destroy
Them in a mighty flood *with joy*.
6 That night was made known beforehand
To our ancestors, so in band
They might rejoice in certain sight
Of the oaths they trusted aright.
7 The saving of the righteous and
Destruction of the wicked band
Of foes was awaited and long
By Your people *under the wrong*.

What was the great light that in Egypt came
To blind the eyes of the oppressor's blame
And fill with hope and knowledge those
who stood

In guise of slaves to represent the good?
It could not be the plagues of blood and
fire,

It could not be flies and frogs of desire,
It must not be the rod and serpent cast
Upon the sandstone floors with eyes aghast.
The light You sent, Beloved, was that the
call

To sacrifice in wilderness from stall

Was prefaced first by Sabbath in the field
Of Pharaoh and rebellion of its yield.
The boycott and the strike of Sabbath day
Is light indeed, task-masters lose their way.

8 For by the same means by which You
Did punish our enemies' crew
You called us to Yourself to be
Your glory *in eternity*.

9 In secret holy children of
Good men offered offerings above,
And with one mind agreed to keep
The divine law, that saints would reap
The same things, both blessings and
dangers,

And already they were as rangers
Singing the praises of ancestors.

10 But the discordant cry of questers
To the attack echoes around
Their children's lament's pitied sound.

11 The slave was punished with the same
Penalty as the master's blame,
And common man suffered the same
Loss as the king, 12 and all together,
By the one form of deathly feather,
Had corpses too many to count.

The living were too few to mount
Their burying, since in one stroke
Their favoured sons fell as they broke.
13 Though they had doubted because they
Engaged in magic arts for play,
Yet when their first-born were destroyed,
They admitted Your folk employed
To be son of Alohim there.

14 For while the silence covered all,
And night in its swift course to fall
Was half gone, 15 Your great word leaped
down

From heaven upon the royal crown,
Into the land that then was doomed,
A stern warrior bearing the gloomed
Sword sharpened by Your true command,
And rose and filled all in the land
With death and touched the sky on high
While standing on the earth to try.

Your word, Beloved, is not an echoing
Of nothingness upon the vibrant string,
But when it falls, leaps up to bare the
sword
And shine upon the firmament like Lord.

Your word, Beloved, is not a breath unseen
Like that of humankind fleeting and lean,
But when it rises, its eternity
Fails not to lighten earth and sky and sea.
The one called the Messiah took a dirk
Or two and said the sword should do his
work

Dividing fathers from their sons and all
Scattered beneath Your burning law's
appal.

Your word, Beloved, though still and small
in time

Becomes a flaming power before its rhyme.

17 At once phantoms in dreadful dreams
Greatly troubled them, and it seems
Fears fell on them, 18 one here, one there
Fell down half dead, made known the scare
Of why they died, 19 for the dreams share
Predicted the disturbing care,
So they might not die without knowing
Why they suffered for all their showing.
20 The plague of death touched also those
Who were righteous and on them rose
The plague on the multitudes in
The desert, but the wrath for sin
Did not continue long in din.

21 A blameless man was quick to rise
A saviour, in his office' guise
Brought shield of prayer and atonement
By incense, he withstood the sent
Anger and put an end to that
Disaster, as Your serving cat.

22 He conquered the wrath not by strength
Of body, and not by arms' length,
But by his word he conquered fear
Of the plague, and made to appear
The oaths and covenants You gave
To our ancestors before slave.

23 The dead already fell in heaps
Upon each other and in leaps,
But he came in between and held
Back wrath and cut off its way spelled
To the living. 24 For on his robe
Was pictured the whole world in globe,
And glories of ancestors were
Engraved on the four rows in stir
Of stones, and Your majesty fell
Upon the crown of his head well.

25 To these things the destroyer gave
Way, these he feared, for merely grave

Test of the wrath sufficed to stave.

The same act of grace that destroys the weak,

The sinful, beastly army out to seek
The upright with destruction, is the hand
That brings salvation to the upright band.
The end of one is just a warning set
To others on the right path when they met.
The plague of death and scorching turns
aside

Before the bright robes of the priest to bide,
The flashing of the gems upon his chest,
The righteousness that clothes him in his
best.

Beloved, I seek the four rows of the clear
And sweet gems set upon the breastplate
near,

And know the sword raised at my head is
just

The warning to pass before me in dust.

Wisdom 19

1 But the ungodly were assailed
To the end by anger *unveiled*
Without pity, for Alohim
Knew beforehand the future beam
Of *all* their acts, 2 so that, though they
Themselves had led Your folk astray
And sent them quickly out, they would
Change their minds from the way they
should

And pursue them. 3 While they were still
In busy mourning, and lamenting
At the graves of their dead *preventing*,
They took another foolish thought
And went after the fugitives,
Those they had begged, *as their king lives*,
To leave. 4 For the fate they deserved
Drew them on to this end unswerved,
And made them forget what occurred,
So they might incur punishment,
Which their torments still lacked inferred,
Upon the path that they were spent,
5 And that Your folk might take the road
To an incredible trip *slowed*,
But they themselves might meet strange
death.

6 For all creation in its breath
Was formed anew by Your commands,
To keep Your children *in their bands*

Unharmd by *any evil hands*.

The plagues on Egypt it seems sufficed not,
But there was need for greater torment's
lot.

The bloody river of the Nile in flood
Was added to the Red Sea and its mud.
I send my slaves out from my sight and
find

That without their help I'm no longer blind,
And so I stand amazed that any might
Upon a day and year go out to fight.
Beloved, the waters of baptism failed,
The darkness of the cloud, the folk that
wailed,

Bring to my sight the fleeing, hope-tossed
folk

Saved from their impasse by Your mighty
stroke.

I walk amid the reeds between the two
And take a view of both hands in their
crew.

7 The cloud was seen in shadow on
The camp, the dry land rose upon
The water that had stood before,
An open way through Red Sea's shore,
A grassy plain from raging waves,
8 Where those protected by Your staves
Passed through as one nation to gaze
On all the marvels of Your maze.
9 Cavorting like horses, they leaped
Like lambs, praising You, Lord, who
heaped

Deliverance on them. 10 For they
Recalled the events of their stay,
When earth produced gnats and not beasts,
And instead of fish *for their feasts*
The river spewed out throngs of frogs.
11 After these wondered dialogues
They saw a new species of bird,
When desire for food their heart stirred,
12 To their relief quails from the sea
Came up. 13 The punishments to be
Came on sinners not without signs
Beforehand in thunder's designs,
For they in justice suffered for
Their wicked actions. They did more
In bitter hatred on the score
Of foreigners. 14 Others in spite
Refused to receive strangers right

When they came to them, but these made
Slaves of guest benefactors' trade.

The awfulness that's stated in repayment
To benefactors come in goodly raiment
May be true. But two things now come to
mind

To mitigate the statement in its kind.
The first is that we're talking about those
Who were descended from principle rows.
The one's who gave the benefit You chose
Were honoured in their time and place with
fame.

The second point is that good Joseph came
Up with a plan that enslaved those of blame
In Egypt, who sold body and soul to
The king in slavery. Policy in view
From Joseph was the root that slavery
drew.

Your word is biased to the last slave crew.

15 Not only so, but punishment
Will come upon the former tent
By lack of hospitality
To strangers, 16 but those latterly,
After receiving them with joy,
Afflicted by horrors' employ
Those who had shared in the same right.
17 They were stricken with loss of sight,
Just as those at the door of *Lot*.
That righteous man in *Sodom's plot*,
When lost in darkness' cave around,
Each tried to find his own door's bound.
18 For elements changed places then
With one another, and as when
On a harp the sounds change in way
Of rhythm, while the same notes stay.
We know that clearly from events.
19 For land beasts were changed in
presence
Of water creatures, and the sea
Creatures that swam came up to be
Upon the land. 20 And even fire
Kept in water its normal ire,
And water forgot how to quench
The fire *when it came up to drench*.
21 Flames, by contrast, failed to consume
The flesh of mortal creature's bloom
That walked among them, nor did they
Melt glass as in their wonted way.
22 For in all things, O Lord, You make

Height and glory for Your folk's sake,
And You have not failed in Your time
To keep them in all things from crime.

There have been those occasions when the
file

Of what I had expected of the mile
Was changed in fire and water and in earth:
In times of plenty I have seen the dearth,
And when the water flowed, I saw the dry
Come rushing from the wall into the sky.
There have been those occasions on the fair
And on the wicked too, no doubt, beware,
For on the just and on the unjust You
Spare neither pains nor rains nor even dew.
Beloved, the fish of the reed sea who came
To walk upon the desert sand in flame
Can find an explanation in the book
Of science if we only look and look.

The Wisdom of Sirach

Despite the Greekness of this book I see
The glimpses of eternal prophecy,
The hidden sound of the Semitic store,
The name of fair Muhammad at the door.
I'm justified by this because the show
Says that the book original did glow
In Hebrew syllables, and so insight
Behind the Greek is not darkness but light.
Despite the worldly wisdom in the text,
It is also a guide to the perplexed
Who love the law of Moses and the way
That Enoch walked in glory on a day.
And even Nehemiah here holds sway,
A righteous figure in Scripture annexed.

Most scholars think this book appeared
In Hebrew two centuries steered
Before the common era drawn.
It was translated into Greek
Sometime after the year to seek
One thirty-two before the peak
Of common era. Nowadays
The book is found in Hebrew maze,
Which I've consulted rarely but
Translated from the Greek in glut,
Though reading also RSV
As well as King James on the spree
And Bible of Jerusalem,

Which is, I think, a treasured gem.

The Prologue by the Greek Translator

1 Whereas many great teachings come
To us through law and prophets' sum
And those who followed them, for which
We should praise Israel for the pitch
Of her instruction and wisdom,
2 And since it's necessary not
Only that readers should be taught
But also those who love the word
Should be availed with their heart stirred
To help the strangers both by tongue
And writing *for both old and young*,
3 My grandfather Jesus, who gave
Himself to reading the law's wave
And prophets and the other books
Of our ancestors *in their nooks*,
And so becoming adept there,
Was himself led to write a share
Of teaching and of wisdom fine,
4 So that by his work at the vine
Those who love learning should make more
Progress in living by law's score.
5 I urge you therefore to read well
And with attention to the spell,
And be indulgent where we might,
Despite out diligence *in plight*
To translate everything here right,
We may have erred *by day or night*.
6 For what was done in Hebrew dress
Does not have exactly address
When turned in other language mess.
Not just this work but even law,
The prophecies turned out in claw
Vary greatly from what in awe
Was written by original.
7 When I came to Egypt the year
Thirty-eight of the reign in fear
Of Euergetes and stayed there
For some time, I found a good chance
For quite a lot of study's dance.
It seemed my job to spend some time
And labour at this work *in rhyme*
To translate it as follows here,
8 Observing then, it would appear,
Great watchfulness and skill to make
And publish this book for the sake
Of those who live abroad and wish
To gain learning prepared *in dish*
To live according to law's *swish*.

Sirach 1

1 All wisdom comes from YHWH and is
With him for ever, *all is His*.

2 The sand of the sea, drops of rain,
Eternal days, count them in vain.

3 The height of heaven, the breadth of
earth,

Abyss and wisdom, search their worth.

4 Wisdom was made before all things,
Eternal prudence *before kings*.

5 6 The root of wisdom, when revealed?
Her deep devices, who's unsealed?

7 8 There is One who is wise and feared,
Sitting on His throne. 9 It appeared
YHWH Himself has all wisdom made,
He saw her then and so He *stayed*,

Apportioned her, and poured her out
On all his works. 10 She dwells *no doubt*
With all flesh measured by His gift,
Supplied to those who love him. 11 *Lift*
His praises, for the fear of YHWH
Is glory and an exultation,
Gladness and crown of jubilation.

Awareness of the divine "I" revealed
Is wisdom made eternally concealed
In all creation, sand of sea, and drops
Of rain, day of eternity that stops
Nowhere, the heavenly heights, wisdom's
abyss,

In all creation lost, concealed to miss.
Her root goes unrevealed, device unknown,
For there is only One upon the throne
Of all the universe, and He it was
Who hid wisdom in earth and all its laws.
But there the hidden treasure may be found,
Beloved, in You-made I-ness and the sound
Of Your name raised in gladness and in
praise
Eternity is hidden in life's days.

12 The fear of YHWH delights the heart,
And gives gladness and joy and part
In life eternal. 13 With him who
Fears YHWH it will go well to end,
At death he will be blessed *unkenned*.
14 To fear YHWH is wisdom's beginning,
She is created *for their winning*
With the faithful in the womb. 15 She
Made among men eternally

Her foundation, and among their
 Descendants she'll be trusted *fair*.
 16 To fear YHWH is wisdom's full
 measure,
 She satisfies men with her treasure
 Of fruits, 17 she fills their whole house
 with
 Things of Muhammad, further with
 Her produce she fills their storehouses.
 18 The fear of YHWH indeed arouses
 The crown of wisdom, making peace
 [Islam]
 And perfect health grow and increase.

 What things of Muhammad, Beloved, have
 You
 Bestowed upon the human pack and crew?
 Wisdom's full measure, and the fear of
 YHWH,
 Treasures of fruits, dates chewed and
 lovingly
 Placed on the infant's tongue, and droughts
 of tea
 Made from the rare herbs of theophany?
 Well-being in perfection, peace to all
 Who find the crown of wisdom, know its
 call,
 These are the things of Muhammad
 produced
 In delights to the heart, in grapes well
 juiced,
 Divided into forty and set out
 In silver goblets from a golden spout.
 Meet me, Beloved, at Muhammad's guest
 house
 To sip the nectar and make drunk the nous.

19 He saw her and apportioned her,
 He rained down knowledge *upon her*,
 Discerning comprehension, and
 He exalted the glorious *hand*
Of those who held her fast. 20 To fear
 YHWH's the root when wisdom appear,
 And her branches are length of days.
 21 22 Unrighteous anger *in one's ways*
 Cannot be justified, for man's
 Anger tips the scale to his blight.
 23 A patient man endures until
 The time is ripe, and then joy will
 Burst forth for him. 24 He'll hide his *right*
 Words until preferred moment, and

Many lips praise his self-command.
 25 In wisdom's treasures there are
 Choice proverbs, but godliness' star
 Is a sinner's abomination.
 26 If you want wisdom's elevation,
 Keep the commandments, and YHWH will
 Supply it you. 27 Fear of YHWH's *still*
 Wisdom and instruction, and He
 Joys in faith and humility.
 28 Don't disobey the fear of YHWH,
 Don't approach Him with mind in two.
 29 Be not a hypocrite in sight
 Of men, and keep watch *recondite*
 Over your lips. 30 Do not exalt
 Yourself lest you fall, and bring *fault*
 Dishonourable upon your *head*.
 YHWH will reveal your secrets *dread*
 And cast you down in the midst of
 The congregation, because you
 Did not come in the fear of YHWH,
 Heart full of deceit gone above.

The counsel brave and secret of this book
 Is how to find fair wisdom, where to look.
 The secret is one that brings sorrow to
 The mind of humankind for what they do.
 To find wisdom does not require the search
 Of expedition to the golden perch,
 Nor years experimental in the pay
 Of intellect and method gone astray.
 Beloved, You grant Your wisdom freely on
 The soul that keeps the Decalogue from
 dawn
 Till sleep engage the heart and mind and
 hand
 And show the way into eternal land.
 I grasp the brave commandments and I find
 All wisdom spread before my wondering
 mind.

Sirach 2

1 My son, if you come forth to serve
 YHWH, be prepared then not to swerve
 Before temptation. 2 Set your heart
 Right and be steadfast, do your part
 Timely before calamity.
 3 Cleave to Him and do not depart,
 That you may be honoured at end
 Of life. 4 Accept what He may send
 Upon you, and in changes be
 Patient in your humility.

5 For gold is tested in the fire,
And worthy men on meekness' byre.
6 Trust in Him, and He will help you,
Make your ways straight, and hope in
YHWH.

7 You who fear YHWH, wait for His grace,
Turn not aside, fall in disgrace.

The two great principles that Sirach sings
Are things rejected by both pegs and kings.
Such people think they can serve You and
still

Fulfill each human wish and lust to kill.
Such people think Your service does not
take

Humility, but rather a large stake
In self-esteem. That's why I think the wake
Of Christian church and Jewish synagogue
Joins with the mosque in the faith of a frog.
Let me, Beloved, trust You and when You
speak

On Sinai, let me find the truth I seek
And come to obey Your word quickly
while

Humility comes in to make me smile.
All other faiths, Beloved, are up the creek.

8 You who fear YHWH, trust in Him, and
Your reward will not fail your hand,
9 You who fear YHWH, hope for good
things,

For joy eternal and the rings
Of mercy. 10 Consider the old
Time *in their* generations told
And see: whoever trusted in
YHWH and was put in shameful *bin*?

Or whoever persevered in
The fear of YHWH and was forsaken?
Or whoever called Him to waken
And was overlooked? 11 For YHWH is
Compassionate, merciful, His
Forgiveness of sin's great, He saves
In time of affliction's *sore glaives*.

12 Woe to timid hearts and to slack
Hands, and to the sinner whose track
Goes along two ways! 13 Woe to faint
Of heart, who have not trust's restraint!
Therefore they will not find refuge.

14 Woe to you who have lost *like stooge*
Your perseverance! What will you
Do when YHWH comes to punish you?

15 Those who fear YHWH'll not disobey
His words, and those who love Him true
Will keep His ways. 16 Those who fear
YHWH

Will seek His approval *each day*,
And those who love Him will be filled
With the law. 17 Those who are instilled
With fear of YHWH prepare their hearts,
And humble themselves at His smarts.
18 Let's fall into the hands of YHWH,
But not into the hands of men,
For as His majesty is true,
So too is His mercy again.

There have been people since the time
Sirach

Was writing who found that You turned
Your back

Despite their vital trust that You would
bring

The good from evil, and the balm from
sting.

The Christ died on a cross or humble tree,
And Jeremiah was sawed cleverly,
And both were sure their lives conformed
in all

They did to Your commandments under
pall.

Poor Husseyn and his near four score were
free

Of hope and life, despite how faithfully
They honoured You and obeyed every
word

That You spoke on the mount they
overheard.

Beloved, I take obedience in hand,
But do not trust You in this pagan land.

Sirach 3

1 Listen to me, your father, O
Children, act accordingly so
That you may be kept in safety.
2 For YHWH honoured the fatherly
Above the children, He confirmed
The right of the mother *who yearned*
Over her sons. 3 The one who does
Honour to his father *that was*
Atones for sins, 4 who glorifies
His mother is like one who buys
Up treasure. 5 Whoever honours
His father will be glad by fers,

His own offspring, and when he prays
He will be heard *in what he says*.
6 Whoever glorifies his father
Will have long life, who obeys rather
YHWH will refresh his mother, 7 he
Will serve his parents in his fee
As his masters. 8 Honour your father
By word and deed, so that a blessing
From him may come on you *addressing*.

The Christ also spoke of this truth when he
Condemned the folk of his day for the
spree

Of leaving parents unfed with excuse
That korban, that is, sacrifice in use
Relieved them of the spell. So many still
Pretend that the atonement on the sill
Of Calvary is death enough to spill
The punishment for sins condemned by
You.

But Sirach knows that no atonement's true
That makes the human sacrifice in view.
Rather to honour father and his wife
Atones for sins here in this earthly life.
Beloved, let my sins be atoned alone
By Your grace and my father's happy tone.

9 For a father's blessing makes strong
The houses of the children's song,
But a mother's curse uproots their
Foundations *and it spoils their share*.

10 Do not glorify yourself by
Dishonouring your father's *pie*,
For your father's dishonour is
No glory to you, *lacking his*.

11 For a man's glory comes from this:
Honouring his father *for bliss*,
And it's a disgrace for children
Not to respect their mother *then*.

12 O son, help your father in his
Old age, and do not grieve his fizz
As long as he lives, 13 even if
He's lacking in discernment's whiff,
Show him forbearance, in your strength
Do not despise him *then at length*.

14 For kindness to a father will
Not be forgotten *in a chill*,
And against your sins it will be
Credited to you *and your fee*,
15 In the day of affliction it
Will be remembered *to your fit*

And in your favour, as frost in
Fair weather, it will melt your sin.
16 Who forsakes his father is like
A blasphemer *before the strike*,
And who angers his mother's cursed
By YHWH *and held to be the worst*.

My fame is not a sure thing in this world,
And I have not experienced unfurled
Acclaim and glory yet, despite the pearly
Way I have brought a contribution set.
My mark upon the slate of human board
Remains a scratch or two among the
shored.

And now as I come near the end of cord
Of silver, I look for my honour met.
Beloved, I know the rule of faith and tower,
The generations of the church and power,
And find there's only one condition where
The soul is refined from its coil and care:
And that is honour given by the son
And daughter to their parents on the run.

17 My son, perform your tasks in
meekness,
Then you will be loved *in your weakness*
By those whom Alohim accepts.

18 The greater you are *in adepts*,
The more you must humble yourself,
So you will find favour *on shelf*
In the sight of YHWH. 19 20 For YHWH's
great

In might, and so the humble's state
Glorifies Him. 21 Seek not the rate
Too hard for you, investigate
Not what is beyond your own power.
22 Reflect upon what *in the hour*
Has been assigned to you, for you
Do not need what is hidden *too*.
23 Do not meddle in what's beyond
Your tasks, for matters to respond,
Too great for human knowledge are
Shown to you *as you reach the bar*.
24 For their hasty judgment has led
Many astray, wrong views afar
Have caused their thoughts to slip instead.

The son of Sirach does not seem to know
That self-esteem's today the way to go,
And those who are too humble in the glow
Are shunted fast aside because they lack

The great ability honoured in stack,
 Called leadership, but what is in truth just
 A selfish disregard for others' trust.
 When I was growing up, teachers began
 To emphasize the wonders of the plan
 That leadership was a and o in can.
 Results are clear today for those who look
 At how the world is muddying the brook.
 I lead myself successful in my nook.

Beloved, I do not seek the knowledge of
 Things beyond my small mind to push and
 shove.

I do not understand the Trinities,
 I do not fathom grace that needs the fees
 Of human sacrifices on a cross.
 I count all such things heathen and a loss.
 I do not seek to understand the great
 Creeds of the Christian church set up in
 state.

Beloved, Your simple law set out in ten
 Is barely known and within human ken,
 And so I take that only and I wait
 Increase of knowledge while I contemplate
 The wonders of those things I understand
 Within Your law and by Your guiding
 hand.

25 26 A stubborn mind will in the end
 Be afflicted *by foe and friend*,
 And who loves danger perishes.

27 A stubborn mind once burdened is
 By troubles, and the sinner will
 Heap sin upon sin *like a hill*.

28 Affliction of the proud has no
 Healing, for wicked plants in tow
 Have taken root in him. 29 The mind
 Of the intelligent man's kind
 Will ponder parable, and ear
 Attentive is the wise man's peer.
 30 Water extinguishes a fire
 Uplazing, so alms never tire
 Of atoning for a sin's *ire*.

31 Whoever requites favours gives
 Thought to the future *life he lives*,
 At the moment when he shall fall
 He'll find support *beside the wall*.

How many wicked plants appear in tow
 Of proud men and proud women on the go!
 I see them sitting in the halls of state,

I see them in their companies with great
 Profits around the globe, and still deride
 Such people who pretend success in pride.
 Success is keeping Your commandments
 well.

But everywhere I look under the spell,
 I find that Trinities replace Your face,
 And idols dress in hypocritic grace,
 And Sabbath is a thing thrown underfoot
 By every worker and boss on the root.
 Their fathers and their mothers too must
 earn

Their respect, while no consciences here
 burn.

Sirach 4

1 My son, deprive not the poor of
 His living, do not keep above
 Their needy eyes waiting. 2 Do not
 Grieve one who is with hunger taught,
 Nor anger a man in his want.
 3 Do not add troubles to the font
 Of angry mind, nor delay gift
 To a beggar. 4 Don't fail to lift
 Afflicted suppliants, nor turn
 Your face away from poor *and spurn*.
 5 Do not avert your eye away
 From the needy, nor give a stray
 Man a reason to curse you, 6 for
 If in bitterness of his soul
 He calls down on you curse and more,
 His Maker will grant him his goal.

Beloved, I demand that You grant my plea
 Of curses on every man faithfully
 Who has pushed me aside from right and
 due.

I demand my right on the wicked crew.
 I have not perpetrated evil here,
 Nor trampled on another causing tear,
 But I can hardly leave my house without
 The careless and the blameful sort of lout
 Coming to thrust his evil on my own.
 Beloved, I now demand return on loan.
 Drop all Your providence and hear my
 prayer

And then rise up to take the world in care.
 Auschwitz was an experiment to see
 What folk would take. But I protest freely.

7 Make yourself beloved in the group,

Bow your head low and even stoop
To a great man. 8 Incline your ear
To the poor, and don't make him fear
When you answer in peace and clear.

Relations with the sons of men are like
Taming the shy of animals on bike
On mountain trails while shouting to a
friend.

It takes immense skill and a natural bend.
With patience one can get a squirrel to take
A peanut from the hand. Another stake
Is taming human hearts to feel no fear
Before the innocent without a tear.
To keep the human heart from trembling's
such

A challenge, that most do not waste the
touch.

It's quite another thing seducing all
With rhetoric and hypocritic call.
The human canailles rush to take the bait,
As long as hunter is a wicked rate.

9 Save the oppressed and wronged from
hand

Of the wrongdoer *in the land*,
And don't be fainthearted in judging
A case. 10 Be like father ungrudging
To orphans, and their mothers' face
Stand before them in husband's place.
Then you shall be like a son of
The Most High, and he'll surely love
You more than does your mother's *race*.

11 Wisdom exalts her sons to give
Help to those who seek her *to live*.

12 Whoever loves her loves his life,
And those who seek her *without strife*
And early will be filled with joy.

13 Whoever holds her fast's employ
Will obtain glory, and YHWH will
Bless the place she enters *to fill*.

14 Those who serve her will minister
To the Holy One, YHWH loves her
Who loves her. 15 He who obeys her
Will judge nations, and whoever
Obeys her will live safe and sure.

16 If he has faith in her he will
Obtain her, and his children will
Remain in possession of her.

Indeed, to save the oppressed and the
wronged

And provide justice to fainthearted pronged
Is like to make a man like the son of
The Most High, if the man You claimed to
love

Is Your son, when he healed the pushed for
shove.

But son of Sirach fails to mention here
That such activities of time and gear
Are likely to result in crucifixion.
After a night trial and a rigged conviction.
Beloved, I've saved a few in their distress,
And I've been saved a time or two, I guess,
But honour's the last thing to come about
For acting in the model of the stout
And brave in morals. I'm just pointing out
The dangers that await the knight to bless.

17 For at first she will walk with him
On crooked paths, and she will trim

Fear and cowardice upon him,
And will torment him by her hand

Until she trusts him *in the land*,
And she will test him with her laws.

18 Then she will come straight back *from*
claws

To him and gladden him, and will
Reveal her secrets to his fill.

19 If he goes astray she'll forsake
Him, and hand him over to rake.

20 Observe the right time, and beware
Of evil, and do not bring share

Of shame on yourself. 21 For there's shame
Which brings sin, and there is a shame
Which is glory and favour's name.

22 Do not show partiality
To your own harm, or deference' fee
To your downfall. 23 Do not refrain
From speaking at the time of gain,
And do not hide your wisdom *sane*.

I've seen the two faces of shame and I
Have spoken too quickly and on the sly,
Until I wonder if the better way
Is not that I have chosen, and to stay
At the foot of my mountain by the glint
Of quartzite washed by melting snows and
hint

Of thaw in the midwinter's bounty's stint.
From here I can observe the times and see

The evil on the sky and in the tree
That thins before the winds of poisoned
dust.

I whirl beneath a shadow of the rust
That paints the morning fine above the
lake.

I turn again, and straighten out my rake
And settle once more for my mountain's
sake.

24 For wisdom is known through men's
speech,
And education come *to teach*
Through the words of the tongue *to reach*.

25 Never speak against truth, but be
Aware of ignorance' degree.

26 Do not be ashamed to confess
Your sins, and do not try to mess
With the current of a steam's power.

27 Do not subject yourself an hour
To a foolish fellow, nor show
Partiality to a chief's row.

28 Strive even to death for the truth
And YHWH Alohims *from your youth*
Will fight for you.

You'd better start quickly now, my
Beloved.
I have not seen You outfitted and gloved
To fight for me yet, though plenty there be
Of every kind of opportunity.
You'd better start to fight for justice' sake,
Though I admit I do not take the cake,
And millions more lie under thrall and
wake
Of greater evils than I have to bear.
In my small circle the wrongs I can share
To right are small. I still lift up my voice
In strident protest for Your gun of choice.
If You are God, there must be more that
You
Can do against the wicked, wily crew.
You act and I shall stay here to rejoice.

29 Do not be reckless
In your speech, sluggish or feckless
In your deeds. 30 Don't be like a lion
In your home, nor come in to try on
Faultfinding with your servants' share.
31 Let not your hand extend in care
To receive, but withdraw when it

Is time to repay *cat and kit*.

The one who never speaks against the truth
Has learned the prudent thing up from his
youth,

That ignorance of this world's high degree
Will stop his mouth for good eternity.
It's quite another thing to keep mouth shut
Than to speak up for truth before the cut.
I too miscalculate the fair decree
Of ignorance about me like a sea,
And take the middle way between the
speech

And silence silver like a picture peach
To write my blessings and my curses here
Upon the lakeshore of a northern sphere.
At least I have no servants to lie stung
Beneath the heavy songs that I have sung.

Sirach 5

1 Do not set your heart on your wealth,
Nor say, "I have enough *by stealth*."

2 Do not follow your inclination
And strength, walking into the ration
Of the desires of your own heart.

3 Don't say "Who'll have power on my
part?"

For YHWH will surely punish you.

4 Don't say "I sinned, what hit my view?"

For YHWH is slow to anger's due.

5 Don't be so sure of atonement
That you add sin to sin *to vent*.

The whole establishment of Christendom
Is so assured of the atonement's rum
Upon the cross that with impunity
They wait upon a pagan Trinity
And break the Sabbath week by week to
test

How much of sin they can fit in suit vest.
If that were not enough, the call to war
Is always on the lip of Roman whore
To say what war is just and what is not.
The democratic lobby's in the plot
To make sure that the battle that is fought
Is in the interests of big business wrought.
Beloved, I'm sure of no atonement yet
But intercession of innocent met.

6 Don't say, "His mercy's great, and He
Will forgive my sins in their spree,"

For both mercy and anger are
With Him, and His anger's not far
From sinners. 7 Do not hesitate
To turn to YHWH, postponing date
From day to day, for suddenly
The wrath of YHWH will come to see,
And at the time of punishment
You'll perish though within your tent.

So many people in my world are sure
That the atonement of the cross is pure
And Gospel truth, and yet I find You warn
Me not to be sure of such mercy born.
So many people in my quire require
No actions good defined by Sinai's fire,
But say belief in Jesus is enough
To save the impure, sinner, and the tough.
Beloved, I am unsure of every gift
Of an atonement that requires the rift
Of human sacrifice to pave the way.
I list instead the Pentecostal day
When You spoke once forever on the
ground
And sent down from the mount a certain
sound.

8 Don't depend on dishonest wealth,
For it will not benefit health
In the day of calamity.
9 Do not winnow with every wind,
Nor follow every path that sinned:
The double-tongued sinner does that.
10 Be steadfast in your wisdom's vat,
And let your speech be consistent.
11 Be quick to hear, slowly present
Your answer. 12 If you've understanding,
Answer your neighbour, if remanding,
Put your hand on your mouth *and stay*.
13 Both glory and dishonour come
From speaking, and a man's tongue's hum
Is his downfall. 14 Do not be called
A slanderer, and don't lie stalled
In ambush with your tongue, for shame
Comes to the thief, and severe blame
To the double-tongued. 15 In great and
Small matters don't act as wrong planned.

It does not matter what I come to say,
Beloved, on this or such and such a day.
If I am silent or if I speak up,

They knock me down with the force of a
tup.

Calamity to me is peace and grace
Of marketing about the wretched place
Ignoring Your commandments while the
sound

Of praise and rocking blessing flow
aground.

Beloved, in matters large and small I take
The Decalogue to define soon and late,
And in that definition find myself
Secluded and set aside on the shelf.
What may seem right to me and other men
Is not always what You say once again.

Sirach 6

1 Do not become an enemy
Instead of friend, for bad degree
Brings about both shame and reproach
Which are the fork-tongued sinner's coach.
2 Don't let your soul cause you to brag,
Lest your soul be tattered to rag
Like a bull. 3 You'll consume your leaves
And drop your fruit out of your sleeves
And be left like a withered tree.
4 A wicked soul will wickedly
Destroy the one who's in its fee,
And cause him to be a derision
Before all his enemies' vision.
5 A pleasant voice multiplies friends,
A gracious tongue many amends.
6 Let those who are at peace with you
Be many, but allow the true
Advice to come from one among
A thousand in council when sung.
7 When you gain a friend, gain him through
Proof of his wear, and do not trust
Anyone hastily for crust.

The average man it seems has enemies
As well as friends of varying degrees.
The trick's to keep one's foes in number
As small as possible to slumber,
At the same time a thousand friends
Kept at the right distance and bends
Ought to be balanced by the few
Who know to give good counsel due.
Beloved, it is an art, I trow, and yet
It's one that must be taken with a bet.
I have an enemy or two around,

I have some friends who encumber my
ground,
But only You are counsellor and found
The truest friend that I have ever met.

8 For there's a friend who is such at
His own convenience *on the mat*,
But will not stand by you in day
Of trouble. 9 And there is a gay
Friend who changes to enemy,
And tells your secret faults in glee.
10 And there's a friend who drinks with
you,
But in your trouble leaves your pew.
11 When things go well he is your mate
Ready to give your servants rate,
12 But if you're brought low he will turn
Against you, and hide what you earn.
13 Keep yourself far from enemies,
And be on guard toward your friends'
pleas.
14 A faithful friend's a sturdy shelter:
Find one and find a treasure's welter.
15 Nothing's so valued as a friend
Who's faithful, and no scales can bend
To measure out his worthiness,
No matter where is his address.
16 A good friend's an aperitif
Of life, and those who in their grief
Fear YHWH will find Him in relief.
17 The one who fears YHWH directs his
Friendship aright, for as he is,
So also is his neighbour's feoff.

Beloved, I have no drinking buddies here,
And that's because I simply don't drink
beer.

It's good to know I'm missing nothing
dear,

But that such friends are lacking in sincere.
Beloved, I have no servants to seduce
False friends to come and drink up all my
juice,

But it's a good thing that I know abuse
By such friends is a waywardly excuse.
Beloved, if I feared You in the right way,
No doubt I'd be a better friend in sway,
Faithful in everything not to betray.
Here where I sit I'm far from enemy
As well as friend, a hermit in the tree,
The willow fallen by my well for free.

18 My son, from your youth learn to
choose

Right teaching, when old don't refuse
To keep on finding wisdom's clues.

19 Find her like one who ploughs and
sows,

And expect her good harvest rows.

For in her service you will toil
A little while, and soon the spoil
Of her produce you'll eat *in foil*.

20 She seems strict to those without
thought,

The feeble-minded won't stay caught
With her. 21 For she will weigh him down
Like a great testing stone for frown,
And he'll not be slow to leave her.

22 For wisdom's like her name in fur,
She's not the talk of all the town.

The first switchback brings to the gentle
rise

Where markets brim with every bright
surprise,

And there the many stay to enjoy fat,
And drink the sweet and not get over that.
The second takes the fewer on around

To where the rituals' delights are found,
And there the cosy join the loving few
To look out on a fertile and green view.

The third turns on a rocky place to hide
The fairer grapes of wisdom on the side,
And those who find them dream on in their
pride.

The pinnacle is the fourth place to go,
Windswept with neither friend nor
challenged foe,

With only blue by day, night stars to glow.

23 Listen, my son, hear my judgment,
Do not reject my counsel lent.

24 Put your feet in her fetters, and
Your neck into her collar's band.

25 Put shoulder under her and bear,
Don't fret beneath her bonds and swear.

26 But come to her with all your soul,
And keep her ways with your strength
whole.

27 Search out and seek, and she'll become
Known to you, when you take her sum,
Don't let her go *away a bum*.

28 For at last you will find the rest
 She gives, and she'll be changed to best
 Joy for you. 29 Then her fetters will
 Become for you protection's hill,
 Her collar a fine garment still.
 30 Her yoke's a golden ornament,
 Her bonds a cord of blue unbent.
 31 You'll wear her like a glorious cloak,
 A crown of gladness *at a stroke*.

The trouble with the finding of wise things
 Is that the loss while learning under stings
 Is never gained again, new situations
 Require the knowledge of renewing rations.
 The knowledge gained is that I would have
 found

More useful in already travelled ground.
 I know the steps that I've taken before:
 It's future steps I need to keep in score.
 Beloved, You teach by life and heart
 conviction,

But too late for my own inspired
 prediction.

And what I have of wit, though I would
 share,

No one is living but who want the care
 Of learning by experience what I
 Might have revealed to save them from the
 sty.

32 My son, if you're willing, you'll be
 Taught, and if you work hard you'll see
 Results. 33 If you love to hear well
 You will gain knowledge in a spell,
 If you turn your ear, you'll be wise.
 34 Observe the group of elders. Who
 Is wise, stick with him, don't despise.
 35 Be ready to hear every view
 And don't let wise words escape you.
 36 If you see a wise man, go soon
 To find him, and let your foot's boon
 Wear out his doorstep *night and noon*.
 37 Contemplate YHWH's statues and keep
 His commandments in mind in sleep
 And waking. It is He who'll give
 Insight to your mind how to live,
 And grant your wish you may acquire
 All the wisdom that you desire.

No one wears out my doorstep here to find

What wisdom I have gained among the
 blind.

I guess that means that none have read
 these words,

Or those who have, need none of my fresh
 curds.

I have worn out the doorsteps of the wise
 And taken gems from many in their guise,
 But all these treasures stay in store with
 me,

Perhaps because I have no wise degree.
 Beloved, I contemplate Your word and bear
 The sweetness of Your law and still find
 there

After the decades I have read the bright
 Things sparkling in Your Torah of delight.
 I hide them in the sonnets that I write
 And keep the speckled sparkling for my
 share.

Sirach 7

1 Do no evil, and evil will
 Never befall you. 2 And stay still
 Away from wrong, and it will turn
 Away from you *by what you learn*.

Good gracious, give a break! How many
 more
 Beside myself have smelt the blood and
 gore,

The waking of the innocent to death,
 Welcome relief after the chilling breath
 Of fast oppression on all who somehow
 Have been left open to the rake and
 plough?

Beloved, it simply is not true the weight
 Of evil falls alone on wicked pate.
 Such optimism is almost insane,
 The draught of poison to deaden the pain.
 Let me stay wide awake, ungarbled by
 The siren hopes of pie up in the sky,
 Until I breathe my last and realize
 My innocence brought me into this guise.

3 My son, do not sow injustice,
 And you'll not reap sevenfold remiss.

4 Don't seek from YHWH the highest
 places,

Nor honours from the royal graces.

5 Do not clamour your righteousness
 In front of YHWH, nor make address

Of your wisdom before the king.
6 Don't seek to be justice judging,
Lest you fail to stop wickedness,
Lest you be partial in address
To the great and so place a stain
On your own righteousness in vain.

Indeed, no use is it to clamour for
Due justice at Your shut fast divine door.
I ask no boon from You, Beloved, nor from
The king or president. I know the sum.
You give nothing but breath and nerve to
feel

The injustices of the divine heel.
The other is out to make sure all men
Succumb before the divine claims again
That he trills out in murmuring of fate.
There's no trusting in You nor in the rate
Of any living man. The only store
Of help is the help of oneself, no more.
I face the living hell of Your creation
And face it with a lifting and elation.

7 Do not offend the common folk,
And don't disgrace yourself *like smoke*.
8 Do not commit a sin two times,
Even for one you'll suffer crimes.
9 Do not say, "He'll consider how
Many good deeds I have done now,
And when I make an offering to
The Most High Alohim *and true*
He will accept it *as my due*."

Some think to atone for their crimes by
deeds
Of charity and so exchange their weeds
For roses. But the wise man comes to say
That You, Beloved, don't seem to work
that way.

The one who plans his wickedness before
And hopes that later he'll come to restore
Dishonesty with pilgrimage and blood
Of sheep has faith not yet even in bud.
Beloved, keep me from crimes of sin so I
Shall not be tempted to atone and try
To make up for my evil deeds with what
You tell me to bring You from heart and
gut.

The calculating heart's not one to love,
But only finds the empty back of glove.

10 Don't be fainthearted in your prayer,
Nor neglect to give your alms' share.
11 Don't ridicule a man who grieves,
For there's surely One who receives
The right to let down and exalt.
12 Do not devise a lie in fault
Against your brother, nor the like
To a friend. 13 Refuse at a strike
To speak any lie, for the deed
Of lying serves no good *nor seed*.
14 Don't rattle on in gathering
Of elders, nor repeat a thing
In your prayer. 15 Do not hate the toil
Of labour on the farm and soil,
Which were created by Most High.
16 Do not participate awry
Among the crowd of sinners, mind
That retribution is not kind.

The ten commandments of the wise are
here
And show that natural faith upon the pier
Is much the same throughout the world of
grief
And everywhere a man's heart seeks relief.
But the wise heart of Sirach's son cannot
Limit itself to just ten of the taught,
But must increase the load to several more.
And yet with that forgets to keep in store
The great commandment of the Sabbath
day.
This book's like many in such wise in lay
Throughout the world, the Chinese
classic's gong,
The Tao Te King with its bright jingle
song.
All beautiful and just against the wrong,
But insufficient despite the long ray.

17 Abase yourself and so repent,
For the punishment that is sent
Upon the wicked's worms and fire.
18 Do not exchange a friend for hire,
A true brother for Ophir's gold.
19 Do not deprive yourself to hold
A wise and good wife, for her charm
Is worth more than the gold in arm.
20 Do not abuse a servant who
Performs his work as well as due,
Or a hired labourer who spends
His strength to bring about your ends.

21 Love an intelligent servant,
 Do not withhold from him the bent
 Of his freedom. 22 Do you have cows?
 Look after them, feed from the mows
 If they bring you a profit sure
 Then keep them alive, *well and pure*.
 23 Do you have children? Discipline
 Them, and make them obey *no sin*
 From their youth. 24 Do you have
 daughters?
 Be careful of their chastity,
 And do not be as lenient stirrs.
 25 Give daughters in marriage degree,
 And you'll have finished your decree.
 But give her to a man that shows
 Understanding *the way he goes*.

The reference to cattle and to sons
 Is commentary on the Sabbath runs,
 Which is the commandment where both are
 mentioned
 As having rights indelibly conventioned.
 I take back my words that the Sabbath's
 missing
 From natural law with mercy's justice
 kissing.
 The thoughtful heathen man in justice
 smirking
 Is just as right and true as prophet working
 And You Yourself in law and rhyme and
 puns.
 Beloved, I take the lesson of the cattle
 And go on with my fevered, shameless
 prattle
 In praise of Your law spoken on the mount
 And writ on human heart for an account.
 Bless old Confucius and Lao Tse in battle.

26 If you have a wife to please you,
 Do not cast her out of the pew,
 But do not trust yourself to one
 Whom you detest *from head to bun*.
 27 With all your heart honour your dad,
 And don't forget the birth pangs sad
 Of your mother. 28 Remember that
 Through your parents you hit the mat,
 And what can you give back to them
 That equals their gift to your hem?
 29 With all your soul fear YHWH, and
 come
 To honour His priests in their sum.

30 Love your Creator with your strength,
 And don't forsake His priests at length.
 31 Fear YHWH and honour the priest, and
 Give him his portion by command:
 The first fruits, the guilt offering, and
 The gift of the shoulders, the part
Inspected and confirmed in art
 Of sacrifice of holiness,
 And the first fruits of holy dress.
 32 Stretch out your hand to feed the poor,
 So that your blessing may be sure.
 33 Give graciously to all who live,
 And withhold no kindness but give
 To the dead. 34 Do not fail those who
 Weep, but mourn with those who mourn
 too.
 35 Don't hesitate to go to see
 A sick man, because for such fee
 You will be loved. 36 In all you do,
 Keep the end of your life in view,
 And you will never sin *construe*.

The repertoire of Sirach's son goes through
 The commandments one by one and so
 true.
 It minds the blessing on both mom and dad,
 The only practice of faith to make glad
 The heart and soul both human and divine.
 But the addition that I don't find fine
 Is blessing on the priest. The ones I know
 Are mere usurpers of the Gospel show.
 There are some Cohens to be found, I'm
 sure.
 Perhaps I should look some up as a cure,
 And give each one a silver dollar for
 The blessing on Aaron and Moses' store.
 Enoch means more to me, though, in his
 right,
 And he provides no priesthood in my sight.

Sirach 8

1 Do not contend with men of power,
 So's not to fall into their tower.
 2 Don't quarrel with a rich man either,
 Lest by the weight of wealth *and tither*
 He win his case, for gold has spoiled
 Many and ruined kings' minds uncoiled.
 3 Don't argue with a wordy fool,
 Nor pile wood on his fire *to cool*.
 4 Don't joke around with ill-bred folk,
 Lest shame fall on ancestors' stoke.

5 Do not reproach a man who's turning
 Away from sin, mind we're all earning
 Our punishment. 6 Do not disdain
 A man when he is old in pain,
 For some of us are growing old.
 7 Do not rejoice at the news told
 Of any one's death, mind that we
 Must all die. 8 Do not slight the word
 Of sages, but stay with heart stirred
 By proverbs, because from them you
 Will get instruction in your due
 And learn to serve in great men's view.
 9 Don't disregard old people's sayings,
 For they themselves learned from their
 strayings
 When their own fathers taught them well,
 And from them you will get a spell
 Of understanding and learn how
 To give an answer in time's row.
 10 Don't kindle now the sinner's coals,
 Lest you be burned in flaming bowls.

There are so many ways to meet the fool
 Of humankind, so many rules of school!
 I've been a sacred fool myself to choose
 The same way of speaking out all my
 views:

Appeal to justice and to right the wrong
 Has been the error of my saintly song.
 I've erred, Beloved, in such presumption
 sure,
 If only because justice is not pure
 On human lip and heart, no matter how
 Sincere the weight upon the youthful brow.
 Let me, Beloved, learn at this late day now
 To leave all justice to Your helpful hand
 And merely further my own interest
 planned.
 I'm neither god nor brother's keeper
 manned.

11 Do not walk out on insolence,
 Lest he hide out for your vengeance.
 12 Do not lend to a man who's stronger
 Than you, but if you lend a monger,
 Reconcile yourself to the loss.
 13 Do not give surety *to toss*
 Beyond your means, but if you do,
 Give it with the intention due
 To pay it all yourself *in brew*.
 14 Don't go to law against a judge,

Because the case will never budge
 Against him for his standing's fudge.
 15 Don't travel with a careless mate,
 Lest he be burdensome in state,
 For he will act just as he please,
 And you'll share in his folly's ease.
 16 Do not fight with a wrathful man,
 And don't join him in desert span,
 For blood is nothing in his sight,
 And when there's no help for a wight,
 He'll strike you down with all his might.
 17 Do not consult a fool, for he
 Will not keep secrets faithfully.
 18 Before a stranger do no thing
 You wish to keep in secret ring,
 For you do not know what he'll sing.
 19 Do not reveal your thoughts to all,
 Lest you lose your luck in the brawl.

The son of Sirach has more wit to see
 The way of lending in this worldly spree
 Than does the fond Messiah that I find
 In course of Gospel written to the blind.
 He does not tell me to lend to sundry,
 But warns that I shall lose my coat and
 shoe

If I presume to undersign the due.
 Mary's son would have me lend free to all
 And lose my shirt as well and dining hall.
 But both are wise enough to know the court
 Will always bring a verdict that is short
 On justice and long on the fawning on
 The one of wealth and power before he's
 gone.
 I take the both of them as a good sport.

Sirach 9

1 Do not be jealous of the wife
 Of your bosom, and don't teach strife
 To her in wicked chart for loss.
 2 Don't let a woman be your boss
 Controlling your strength *as in dross*.
 3 Don't go to meet a prostitute,
 Lest you fall in her snares *to boot*.
 4 Don't follow after a pop star
 Lest you be put in the same jar.
 5 Don't rest your eyes on virgin beauty,
 Lest you stumble and shirk your duty.
 6 Don't give yourself to harlots lest
 You waste your heritage in jest.
 7 Don't look around the city streets,

Nor wander deserted retreats.
 8 Turn aside from the female form,
 Do not rest eyes on beauty *warm*,
 Many have been misled by that,
 Kindled where fiery passions sat.
 9 Never dine with another's wife,
 Nor entertain her at wine's life,
 Lest your heart turn aside to her,
 And in blood you sink from life's view.

I wonder if the wisdom of mankind
 Will ever find the medium unblind:
 Avoidance of the harlot on the hill,
 Avoidance of male chauvinistic bill.
 The feminist ideal seems not to take
 A step without immoral acts in wake.
 I'd much prefer to let a woman be
 A boss in firm and factory than see
 Breakdown of eternal morality.
 Beloved, there is no boss at all but You,
 And power struggles in this land and view
 Are futile escapes into dark and dust.
 The silver turns to brass, the gold to rust.
 I turn again and circle as I must.

10 Forsake not an old friend, a new
 Does not compare with pride in true.
 A new friend is like the new wine,
 When it has aged you'll find it fine.
 11 Don't envy sinful honour's place,
 You don't know when's the end of grace.
 12 Do not delight in what is fair
 To the ungodly eye, beware
 They'll not be held guiltless as long
 As they have been living *in wrong*.
 13 Keep far from a man who has power
 To kill, and you will not be sour
 In fear of death. But if you come
 Near him, make not misstep in sum
 Lest he rob you of your life too.
 Know that you tread where traps not few
 Are hidden round the battlements
 Of the city *and near its tents*.
 14 As much as you can, aim to know
 Your neighbours, and give the wise show.
 15 Converse with men of understanding,
 And talk of what Most High's
 commanding.
 16 Let righteous men sit at your meal,
 And let your glorying conceal
 The fear of YHWH. 17 A work is praised

For the skill that the craftsmen raised,
 So a folk's leader is proved wise
 By his words as he will advise.
 18 A babbler is feared in his town,
 And reckless speech met with a frown.

Old friends of mine for the most part are
 gone
 Through death and distance from my
 youthful dawn.
 New friends may be insipid, it is true,
 But I tend to rejoice in prattle's dew.
 If I prefer new friends, the truth is told
 When whispered that the wine, when aged
 and old,
 I set aside for others, the more bold,
 To drink, as Rechabite with water cold.
 Beloved, You are a friend both old and
 new,
 The oldest in my memory and heart,
 And new with each sip of the heady start.
 The babbling of a fool has not a shred
 Of fear in hermitage where I am led,
 And reckless speech is tasty when I'm fed.

Sirach 10

1 A wise ruler will educate
 His people, and the law *in state*
 Of an understanding man will
 Be well ordered *to fit the bill*.
 2 Like the magistrate of the folk,
 So are his officers to stoke,
 And like the ruler of the town,
 So are its dwellers up and down.
 3 A king without discipline brings
 The ruin on his people's wings,
 But a town will grow and increase
 Through the wisdom of rulers' *fleece*.
 4 The government of earth's in hand
 Of YHWH, and over it He'll stand
 The right man for the time *and age*.
 5 The success of a man to wage
 Is in the hands of YHWH, and he
 Confers his honour on the fee
 Of the scribe. 6 Do not be angry
 With your neighbour for injury,
 And do not attempt anything
 By acts of insolence for shame.
 7 Arrogance is hateful to YHWH
 And before men, injustice too
 Is outrageous to both in view.

8 Sovereignty passes from one nation
To another because of ratiō
Of injustice and insolence
And wealth *at interest in the tents*.

Philosophy political that bears
The tale from age to age and unawares
Comes from the prophet Daniel who wrote
late

Of governments and kings, affairs of state.
He saw each kingdom have its chance to
show

Justice divine for generations' go,
And then fall to the conquest of another
Arising from the sweltered sea to smother.
The son of Sirach here explains the fate
And why such kingdoms fall before the
slate.

Injustice and the insolence that share
Both rulers and the populace with care
Are reasons for the fall. I'd like to add
There must be more than acting like a cad.

9 How can he who is dust and ashes
Be proud? For even under life's *sashes*
His guts rot. 10 A long illness will
Stump the physician, king on hill
Today will die tomorrow led.
11 For when a mortal man is dead,
He will inherit in his bed
The creeping things, and wild beasts, and
Worms *come out there to feast as planned*.
12 The start of man's pride's to depart
From YHWH, his heart has left the cart
Of His Maker. 13 For the beginning
Of pride is sin, and the man winning
It pours abominations' ginning.
Therefore YHWH brought upon them great
Afflictions, and destroyed their state.

14 The Lord has cast down thrones of
kings,

And seated lowly in their rings.

15 The Lord has pulled up nations' roots,
And planted humble in their suits.

16 The Lord will overthrow the lands
Of all the nations, and the bands
Of the earth He'll destroy in hands.

17 He has removed some of them and
Destroyed them, and put out the strand
Of their remembrance from the earth.

In days when human wisdom had attained
The knowledge of what the new grave
contained

Political theory rose to admit
That You are Sovereign everywhere You
sit.

In later days autopsies would reveal
The inner trauma of the cloven heel,
And find an economic reason for
The woe and weal of the communal store.
Beloved, I too stand up to guess if right
Can be attained by any human might.
Without a single case to spare my heart,
I still take Your commandments and their
part.

Whether You are the Lord of nations or
The impotent by-stander, Yours is core.

18 Pride was not made for men, nor wrath
For those born of a woman's path.

19 What race is worthy of renown?
The human race. What race come down
Is worthy of honour? Those who
Fear YHWH. What race deserves no
crown?

The human race. What race is void
Of grace? Those who transgress the law,
Commandments of YHWH spoke for awe.
20 Among brothers their first-born's chief,
And those who fear YHWH, without grief
Are worthy of grace in His eyes.

21 22 Rich, eminent, the poor in guise—
Their glory is the fear of YHWH.

23 It is not right then to despise
A poor wise man, nor is it due
To give sinful man honour's brew.

24 The nobleman, the judge, and chief
Will all be honoured, but no sheaf
Of them is greater than the man
Who fears YHWH *in his righteous plan*.

Beloved, I seek my honour above all
Things that seduce upon the earthly ball.
I thank You that the revelation small
To all mankind and women in the stall
Reveals the most direct and easy way
To enter into glory and to stay.
I make my name immortal in the light
Of Your commandments kept here in my
sight,

And grasp with greed the honour that's still
bright
When all the supposed great fall left and
right.

Beloved, I seek my honour every day,
Ready to trample all else in the lay
As I take prizes to my breast and heart
In Your commandments' easy way to start.

25 Free men will serve a wise servant,
A man with understanding's slant
Will not grumble. 26 Don't make display
Of your wisdom on your work day,
Nor glorify yourself in time
When you are in want *of a rhyme*.

27 Better's a man who works and keeps
Abundance of all things he reaps,
Than one who goes about in boast,
But lacks the bread *and wine and host*.

28 My son, praise your humility,
And count your honour by your fee.

29 Who'll justify the man that sins
Against himself? And what man wins
Honour that dishonours his life?

30 A poor man's honoured for his rife
Knowledge, while a rich man is praised
For his wealth. 31 A man praised while
poor,

How much more when his wealth is sure!
And a man dishonoured in wealth,
How much more in poverty's stealth!

The wealth of beauty that turns around me
In every sort of winter leafless tree,
In rare ice crystals on the frozen air,
On delicately hued sky where I dare
Lift hope and help, remains eternal share.
The wealth of light and sound about my
choice

Gives subject to my urges to rejoice
And praise the silent scattering of weeds
Caught up in curls of brown and dried up
seeds.

Beloved, a poor man's honoured for his
mind,
And wealthy men are glorified and wined,
But I am rich and wise merely to see
Creation spread upon eternity.

Sirach 11

1 The wisdom of a humble man

Will lift up his head, and *in plan*
Will set him up among the great.

2 Do not praise a man for the rate
Of his good looks, nor loathe a man
Because he looks bad in a pan.

3 The bee is just a small insect,
But she produces sweets select.

4 Don't boast about wearing fine clothes,
Nor raise yourself in the day's pose
That you are honoured, for the works
Of YHWH are wonderful for quirks,
And His works are concealed from men.

5 Many kings are cast down again,
While one unnoticed wore a crown.

6 Many rulers have met the frown
Of their disgrace, and high-placed men
Have been arrested, put in den.

7 Don't find fault till you check things out,
Consider first, then raise a shout.

8 Don't answer before you have heard,
Don't interrupt a speaker's word.

Just because bees make honey's no excuse
To praise them all about the calaboose.

I don't know why, Beloved, your man in
Rome

Is writing here to strike so far from home.
The pop stars and celebrities that smile
And foster this and that market awhile
Must always be followed in hope or guile.
There is no other way to live aground
This sunken planet and always be found
The darling of the neighbour and the friend.
Beloved, I beg Your pardon in the end,
But choice is here between the civilized
And sweet and tempered and in glory
guised,

And You. You are just one. Your vote must
bend.

9 Do not argue about a matter
Which does not appear on your platter,
Nor sit with sinners when they judge
A case *with their injustice' smudge*.

10 My son, do not busy yourself
With many matters *like an elf*,
If you multiply what you do,
You'll not go unpunished in view,
You'll not catch up when you pursue,
And fleeing you will not escape.

11 There is a man who works *like ape*

And labours and presses the cape
 But all the more lies in his lack.
 12 There is another who is slow
 And needs help and pat on the back,
 Who lacks strength and is always poor,
 But YHWH's eyes see that man for good,
 He lifts him out of swamp and wood,
 13 And raises up his head, so many
 Are amazed at his gains *in penny*.
 14 Good things and bad, both life and
 death,
 Poverty and wealth *in a breath*,
 Come from YHWH *as everything should*.

There is just one thing in the maze of truths
 That ply upon the hearts and minds of
 youths,
 The great concerns for how the planet may
 Revolve or not despite the human pay,
 Which is of value on the judgement day.
 That one thing is that I have done Your will
 No matter what the others in the mill
 Vote for. Beloved, You are not democratic.
 You know no progress, You are far too
 static.
 If You came out each year with fashions
 new
 Instead of the same old commands in view,
 Then You too would have a fan club as
 great
 As You-know-who, for gear and golf and
 gate.
 As it stands, You're alone in Your own
 pew.

15 16 17 The gift of YHWH endures for
 those
 Who are godly, what He approves
 Will have success to last *in rows*.
 18 There is a man who's rich in grooves
 Of diligence and self-denial,
 And this is what he gets in style:
 19 When he says "I have found rest, and
 Now I shall enjoy my goods' band!"
 He does not know how much time will
 Pass till he kicks bucket of swill.
 20 Stand by your promise and attend,
 And grow old working to the end.
 21 Don't wonder at the sinner's acts,
 But trust in YHWH and stick to facts,
 For it is easy in YHWH's sight

To give a poor man wealth outright
 And suddenly without respite.
 22 YHWH's blessing's a good man's
 reward,
 And quickly Alohim's restored
 His blessing to abound once scored.
 23 Do not say "What do I need, and
 What prosperity could in hand
 Be mine upon the future stand?"
 24 Do not say, "I've enough, and what
 Calamity could come and shut?"

Your man at home writes for the great elite
 Who would repress the funds that now
 complete
 The pensions of the retired on their feet.
 Keep working till the day you die, says he.
 Keep working till the grave shall make you
 free.
 Beloved, I have a better plan in glee:
 A pension plan that butters faithfully
 The bread on both sides and at sixty-five
 Promotes a holiday to stay alive.
 I know it might encourage rat and mouse
 To think prosperity in the old house
 Will keep them to the end without a shred
 Of trust in You. Don't wake the living
 dead.
 Calamity or hope, by You I'm led.

25 In the day of prosperity,
 Adversity's forgotten plea,
 And in day of adversity,
 None minds of his prosperity.
 26 For it's an easy task for YHWH
 To reward a man in his due
 Upon the day of death's review
 According to all he would do.
 27 The misery of one hour makes
 One forget luxury in stakes,
 And at the close of a man's life
 His deeds will be shown thick and rife.
 28 Call no one happy before death,
 A man will be known through *the breath*
Of his children. 29 Do not bring each
 Man into your home, for the reach
 Of the crafty is manifold.
 30 Like partridge decoy in a cage,
 So is the mind of pride in rage,
 And like a spy before he's told
 He will observe your weakness bold,

31 For he lies in wait, turning good
 Into evil: do what you should
 He'll still blame you with a heart cold.
 32 From a spark of fire many coals
 Come burning, and a sinner trolls
 In wait to shed blood as his goals.
 33 Beware a scoundrel, who devises
 Evil, lest he give in his guises
 A lasting blemish. 34 Bring a stranger
 Into your home and he'll be danger
 To cause commotion and estrange
 You from your family in range.

I blame the Protestants so smug and brief
 That I lived so long in sorrow and grief.
 If I had had the Catholic teaching sooner
 I might have saved myself from wicked
 gooner.

I've opened doors to many wicked folk
 Because I thought that angels in a stroke
 Might be among the guests, I took in all.
 But if I'd read Apocryphal in stall,
 I might have known that wisdom and
 restraint

Are blessings for the bold as well as faint.
 So many scoundrels have eaten my table
 That I'm reduced to hermit and a fable.
 But there's still room for You, Beloved,
 and I

Keep my door open in my forest sly.

Sirach 12

1 If you do a kindness, be sure
 You do it to one known and pure,
 And you will be thanked for what you
 Do in goodness *and mercy's view*.

2 Do good to a godly man, and
 You will be repaid by his hand
 Or certainly by the Most High.

3 No good will come to the man who
 Continues in the evil stew,
 Or to one who does not lay by
 Alms to give to the poor *in pew*.

4 Give to the godly man, but do
 Not help the sinner *or his crew*.

5 Do good to the humble, but not
 To the ungodly in his plot,
 Hold back his bread, and do not give
 It to him, lest by its strength live
 To overcome you, for you'll get
 Twice the evil for all the set

Of good that you have done to him.

6 For the Most High also takes dim
 View of sinners and will inflict
 Punishment on ungodly *tricked*.

7 Give to the good man, but don't help
 The sinner *and his woeful whelp*.

Take care, Beloved, when giving such
 advice

Having a loophole to do things not nice.
 Of all the men and women of the realm
 Many may be righteous and steer the helm
 Among the shoals with cunning hand and
 true,

Still they may seem in my eyes ugly crew.
 Mayhap my choice of doing good to those
 Come in my likeness will neglect the rows
 Eternally praised by the words You chose.
 Let me do good to all, or let me know
 Who is the righteous and the wicked crow.
 All I can say or should is in the glow
 I find Your Decalogue to teach and preach.
 No more can I say truly each of each.

8 A friend will not be known in time
 Of prosperity, nor will rhyme
 Of enemy be hidden in
 Adversity. 9 A man's foes grin
 Not when he prospers, and in his
 Adversity a friend of his
 May turn aside from him and his.

10 Don't ever trust your enemy,
 For like the tarnishing you see
 On copper, so's his wicked spree.

11 Even if he humbles himself
 And cringes like a little elf,
 Watch and be on your guard for him,
 And you'll be like one not to dim
 A mirror for him, and you'll know
 Not without reason tarnished show.

12 Don't put him next to you, lest he
 Overthrow you and take your fee,
 Do not have him sit at your right,
 Lest he try to take your seat's light,
 And at last you will realize
 The truth of my words, and be wise
 To what I've said *not to despise*.

13 Does anyone take pity on
 The snake charmer bitten *at dawn*
 By his serpent, or any who
 Train wild beasts to do what they do?

14 So no one will take pity on
A man who meets with sinners *drawn*
And takes part in their sin *as pawn*.

I trust a bright and shiny copper penny,
Despite the words Jesus Sirach for any
Writes in a warning fair and true to be
The admonition of righteous and free.
Friendship with evil-doers, it is true,
Abides until the colour changes hue,
And what was burnished bright with
hardihood
Becomes green with the envy not
withstood.
Beloved, I look about me where I live
And fail to find a soul ready to give
Your Decalogue it's due. Explain to me
Why so few know the truth upon the tree.
It's in the catechism and the round
Of schoolwork to which all children are
bound.

15 He'll stay with you for a brief time,
But if you falter *in your climb*,
He'll not stand by you *for a dime*.
16 An enemy will speak sweetly
With his lips, but in his mind *free*
He'll plan to throw you in a pit.
An enemy weeps with his eyes,
But if he finds a chance in guise,
His thirst for blood will not be slaked.
17 If a calamity has smacked
You, you will find he got there first,
And while pretending help uncursed,
He'll trip you by the heel when durst,
And clap his hands and whisper much,
And grimace *gladly at the touch*.

I too have grimaced at the fate of one
Who tucked his foot both in his mouth and
bun.

Perhaps I should have been a better friend
And feel the weight of courage on his end.
But then I think it was the man's own fault
For reading too illiterate occult.
I leave the mass to judgement day and hope
That You will justify us both who cope
The best we can, and come repentant where
You dispense grace and mercy without
care.

Beloved the danger runs the other way:

It's I who often tolerate the gay
And gruesome crowd in lawless living's
pay.

Let me retreat from such men and their
share.

Sirach 13

1 Whoever touches pitch will be
Defiled, and whoever is free
With a proud man will be like him.
2 Don't lift a weight beyond your vim,
Nor buddy with the rich and great.
How can clay pot associate
With the iron kettle in its fate?
The pot will dash against it and
Will itself be reduced to sand.
3 A rich man does wrong, and then he
Blames everyone around to see,
But a poor man suffers the wrong
And adds apologies along.
4 A rich man will exploit you if
You can be used to row his skiff,
But if you're needy he'll refuse
To help you, but only abuse.
5 If you own something, he will live
On you and pour through like a sieve
Your bank account, not care to give.
6 When he needs you he will deceive,
He'll smile at you in hope's reprieve.
He'll say kind words and ask what he
Can do for you and faithfully.
7 He'll shame you with his feastings till
He's emptied you to foot the bill,
And then he'll make fun of your case.
If he should see you at the chase
After that, he'll forsake your face
And wag his head at your disgrace.

I shall beware, Beloved, the hopeful fair
Who have a name for good in what they
dare.

Treatment is not according to the rate
Humanity deserves for the bald pate
Or greying hair, or for the good one's done.
Such things were never seen under the sun.
It's always whom you know, not what is
true,
Nor ever at all what good thing is due.
Beloved, help me to live along the path
Of the sweet woods away from raging
wrath

Of wealth and power, until I find the song
Of dandelion and coltsfoot not gone wrong.
The wealth I seek is gold of buttercup
When other golds have passed the traveller
up.

8 Take care not to be led astray,
And not be humbled on feast day.
9 When a great man invites you in,
Be circumspect and you will win
An invitation day by day.
10 Don't push yourself forward, lest you
Be sent back in a line or two,
And yet do not remain afar
Lest you're forgotten as a star.
11 Don't try to be his equal nor
Trust in his many words in store,
For he will test you through much talk,
And smiling put you through your walk.

I've been the guest of great and good and
seen
Sometimes my words have broken on the
sheen,
And other times my boldness to beware
Has turned out to my benefit in share.
Truth is the human race is fickle and
Sometimes smiles and sometimes will lend
a hand,
And other times will beat down on the back
Of innocence or wickedness a stack.
The happy median Jesus Sirach
Advises is no easy thing to thwack.
Between the elbow pushers and the track
Of those who find nothing at all at last
Is hope and hesitation, cast, recast.
I flee to You alone, Beloved, for lack.

12 Cruel is he who does not keep words
To himself, he will not leave birds
To injure or imprison you.
13 Keep words to yourself and be true
And watchful, for you're walking round
With your own downfall on the ground.
14 15 For every creature loves its like,
And every man his neighbour's spike,
16 All living things gather by feather
And fur, and so a man *in weather*
Clings to one like himself *in tether*.
17 What friendship have a wolf and lamb?
No more has sinner with a ram

Who's godly. 18 What peace is there twixt
Hyena and a dog *when mixed*?
And what peace between a rich man
And a poor man *within his scan*?
19 Wild asses in the wilderness
Are the prey of lions' address,
Likewise the poor are pastures for
The rich. 20 Humility in store
Is an abomination found
To a proud man, likewise the ground
Of poor men is a wretched site
To a rich one *who thinks he's right*.

The politics of the day where I live
Fail to remember what the words would
give
From Jesus Sirach, who notes well the poor
Are pasture to the proud, and that is sure.
The poor are dupes of careful
advertisement
Paid for by what they buy in thick
advisement.
They vote for the one who has loudest
voice
To make himself heard as the media's
choice.
Beloved, the fact is vote for wealthy men
Is why this world is running to the den.
The attitude that all is here for pay,
To be consumed before another day
Is blessed and bleated in the praises grey.
Let the poor vote for the poor once again.

21 When a rich man stumbles, his friends
Rush in to help and make amends,
But when a humble man falls down,
Even his friends return the crown.
22 If a rich man slips up, many
Come to his aid, if he is free
To speak unseemly words' folly,
They're there to justify his spree.
A humble man may slip and they
Rush to reproach him for his stay.
If he arrives to speak good sense,
No one will listen to his vents.
23 When the rich speaks, all hold their
tongue,
Then praise to the clouds what he's sung.
When the poor man speaks, they will say
"Who is this fellow anyway?"
And should he stumble they are there

To push him down the stony stair.
 24 Riches are good when free of sin
 And poverty's to blame in din,
 Is the opinion of such men
 As are ungodly in their den.
 25 A man's heart's revealed in his face,
 Either for good or evil trace.
 26 Mark of a happy heart is found
 In a cheerful face, but to sound
 Proverbs requires deep thought, profound.

I know a rich man who goes to the mosque
 Each Friday and gives those around his
 kiosk

A twenty dinar note from the thick stack
 He pulls out from the pocket at his back
 Until the stack is gone and all the men
 Are satisfied to go away again.
 I do not doubt that many live the week
 And eat from that one bill they came to
 seek.

Beloved, reward the man who does not
 speak

A word to draw attention to his cheek,
 But always comes to help the poor who
 know

The sweetness of his alms without a show.
 Beloved, reward that man, I pray again,
 And give him a long life, four score and
 ten.

Sirach 14

1 Blessed is the man who does not blunder
 With his lips and not suffer thunder
 For sin. 2 Blessed is he whose heart
 Does not condemn him, and whose part
 Still has his hope. 3 Riches are not
 Seemly for stingy men in plot,
 And of what use is property
 To a man who's filled with envy?
 4 Whatever man accumulates
 By depriving his own estates,
 Accumulates for other men,
 And others will live in his den
 Of luxury and on his goods.
 5 If a man's mean in livelihoods
 To himself, to whom will he be
 Generous? He'll not in degree
 Enjoy his own wealth *joyously*.
 6 No one is meaner than the man
 Who's grudging to himself in span,

And this is what he gets for being
 So basely false *in all his seeing*,
 7 Even if he does good, he will
 Do it without intention's skill,
 And so betrays at last his bill.

The great beatitudes that Jesus taught
 Have been repeated round the world for
 thought.

Of all the things the dear Lord had to share
 Most have not had effect on human care.
 Among beatitudes, his own namesake
 Summed up the truth as though a piece of
 cake.

Make sure the tongue errs not in
 wickedness,

Come out of all things with the heart's
 address

Enough to reassure commandments' view
 Lives in the life and makes that living true.
 When men come into judgement on a day
 Around the table spread, before the ray
 In Sabbath's welter, or before the throne,
 None are so blessed as those who stand
 alone.

8 Evil's the man with grudging eye,
 He turns his face and walks on by.
 9 A greedy man's eye is not filled
 With his portion, and mean, unstilled
 Injustice will dry up his soul.

10 A stingy man begrudges bread,
 It's missing from his table spread.

11 My son, treat yourself well, by all
 You have in store, and from the stall
 Bring worthy offerings at YHWH's call.

12 Remember death will not delay,
 Hades' decree has hidden sway.

13 Do a friend good before you die,
 And reach out and give *on the sly*
 As much as you can *without pay*.

14 Don't deprive yourself of a day
 Of happiness, nor let your share
 Of pleasant good pass under care.

The man is evil with his grudging eye.
 How I remember in Istanbul by
 One pleasant mosque for Friday prayers
 how I

Made my way past a beggar at the door
 Along the stony path before the shore

Sunken of my own heart. I left no change.
Many said those who came within that
range

Came out from plenty and took alms as
strange.

Evil was my heart, since I had no proof
Lounging before me was rich man aloof.
Without a thought since then, when I have
found

Another beggar on the mosque ground
I've made atonement for that deed
unsound.

Now, my Beloved, forgive me for my goof.

15 Shall you not leave what you have
earned

To others, and what you've discerned,
Shall it not be divided out,

And given to those round about?

16 Give, and take, and beguile yourself,
Because when you're on the grave's shelf
You cannot look for luxury.

17 All living things that come to be
Grow old like a garment in fee,
For from old has come the decree:
"You must surely die presently."

18 Like leaves upon a spreading tree
Which drops some and fresh buds renews,
So are the generations' views
Of flesh and blood: one dies and one
Is born *before the set of sun*.

19 All things decay, cease to exist,
And the man who made it and kissed
Will pass away with it *unmissed*.

20 Blessed is the man who meditates
On wisdom and reason relates.

21 The one who bears in mind her ways
Will also ponder secret maze.

The ways of wisdom I do meditate.
However long I tremble in the sound
Of wisdom while I'm living on the ground,
My heart is empty of the knowing state.
Among the great men who tell me the rate,
Some are appalled to hear the common
bound,

Most live in certainty of knowledge found.
Come my release, I'm still with empty
plate.

Each day I seek the sweetness of Your
word,

Long on the able limits I replay
What propositions for the grace and gold.
Among the broken shards of tribute heard
I find the diamonds in the dust and clay,
No comprehensive hope in what I'm told.

22 Pursue understanding like hunters,
And lie in ambush for her view.

23 One who peers through her windows
will

Also listen at her doorsill,

24 He who encamps near her house will
Also fasten his tent peg still

To her walls, 25 he will pitch his tent
Near her, and spend the night in scent,
26 He'll place his children in her care,
Encamp under her boughs and fair,
27 She'll shelter him both from the heat
And make him live in glory's seat.

The dawn is barely glowing like a thread
Hung by the velvet hope on darkened lake.
Out from the sullen sky above the stake
My minutes tinkle from my sleeping bed.
Along the pebbled archways widely spread
Sheer past the frozen words of prayer I
take,

My wilderness for harbour where I wake
Contents the murmurings by prophet led.
Even the growing light seems frail beside
Long shadowless remains of divine aid.
While help and healing stake the stars
above

Around my grassy crusts of ice and pride,
I leap the lower walls of prayer's parade,
Not failing to defend my morning love.

Sirach 15

1 The man who fears YHWH will do this,
Who holds the law has wisdom's bliss.

2 She'll meet him like a mother, and
Like the wife of his youthful hand
She'll welcome him *and make him stand*.

3 She'll feed him with bread of the wise,
Water of understanding's guise.

4 He'll lean on her and will not fall,
Rely on her and find no pall

Of shame. 5 She will exalt him over
His neighbours, and will like a drover
Open his mouth in congregation.

6 He will find gladness and elation,

A crown rejoicing, and acquire
An everlasting name's desire.
7 Foolish men will not obtain her,
And sinful men will not see her.

Tradition is to translate "she" and not
"It" for wisdom within the Hebrew plot.
But fact is it is never found at all
And he and she serve for the common call
Of it depending on the gender set
By Hebrew grammar everywhere we get.
Your wisdom is personified indeed
In early Jewish writings without greed,
Which only goes to show the Trinity
Could just as well be a Quadrinity.
Anything will do I expect that stays
The human mind from shying in its craze
From oneness of divine reality,
Revealed in every word of prophecy.

8 She is far from all men of pride,
And liars will never find her side.
9 A hymn of praise is not one fit
To be on sinner's lips to sit,
For it has not been sent from YHWH.
10 A hymn of praise should be sung with
Wisdom, and YHWH will prosper myth.
11 Do not say "Just because of YHWH
I left the right way I should do",
For He will not do what He hates.
12 Don't say, "He led me out the gates",
For He does not need sinful mates.
13 The Lord hates all abominations,
And they're not loved by those *in nations*
Who fear Him. 14 It was He who made
Man from the start, and so he stayed
In the power of his own will's grade.

The old Baptists of former time took this
Great principle that hymns of common
bliss

Must never be sung in assembly's voice,
Because there may be present to rejoice
One who has not believed yet in Your
Word
And singing such hypocrisy incurred.
The hymn is fit only for holy lips,
And anyone who takes it without slips.
The province of the sinner's not to sing,
But bow in abject repentance to cling
In sorrow to the earth until the grace

Divine has blotted out the sinful trace.
Forgive or not, Beloved, the sinful score
Of churches full of sin and song in store.

15 If you will, you can keep
commandments,
And act in faith *without disbandments*,
It's your own choice that you have made.
16 He has placed before you both fire
And water: stretch out your hand *higher*
For whichever you want *to take*.
17 Before a man are life and death,
And whichever he chooses *breath*
Will be given to him *in stake*.
18 For great is the wisdom of YHWH,
He is mighty in power and *true*
Sees everything, 19 His eyes are on
Those who fear Him, and He knows *drawn*
Every deed of a man. 20 He's not
Commanded any one in plot
To be ungodly, and he's not
Given permission for sin *taught*.

Commandment keeping simply is a choice,
Despite the preachers raising avid voice
To say that You command impossibles
To those who cannot meet the wicked
bulls.

The truth is simple and a child can know
Obedience is no impossible show.
The fire and water are the choices now:
Some choose their hell, others baptismal
vow.

Beloved, I choose neither the fire nor yet
The waters of denominations' bet,
But only You, Beloved, and only You
Be my joy and the choice I have in view,
Until obedience to each command
Bring me into the hoped for Promised
Land.

Sirach 16

1 Do not desire a multitude
Of useless children, nor the crude
Rejoicing in ungodly sons.
2 If they multiply into tons,
Do not rejoice in them, unless
The fear of YHWH's in their address.
3 Do not trust in their survival,
Do not rely on numbers' pall,
For one's better than thousands, and

To die childless is better planned
 Than to have ungodly children.
 4 For through one man of understanding
 A city will be filled like den,
 But through a tribe of lawless men
 It will be made desolate landing.
 5 Many such things my eye has seen,
 And my ear has heard things between
 More wonderful than these commanding.
 6 In sinners' assembly a fire
 Will be struck, and a nation's ire
 In disobedience upraised.
 7 He was not appeased *nor amazed*
 For ancient giants who rebelled
 In their strength *that at last was quelled*.

The books of Jubilees and Enoch note
 The former giants who rebelled to gloat
 And who found no forgiveness in the boat.
 You did not hear the prayer of Enoch when
 He came to plead for those unrighteous
 men.

So is always the wicked human den.
 Beloved, I see the tribe of lawless ones
 Rise up about me in their gloried tons
 In praise of jungle's wayward ways and
 guns.

The law of the majority is best
 They say because it hampers royal crest
 And spreads out justice to the blooming
 rest.

In fact it just gives more wicked men
 power
 Over a feoff of pastured folk that cower.

8 He did not spare neighbours of Lot,
 Whom He loathed for their wicked plot.
 9 He showed no pity for a nation
 Devoted to destruction's ration,
 And for those destroyed in their sins,
 10 Nor for six hundred thousand men
 On foot, who rebelled to their shins
 Assembled in their stubbornness.
 11 Even if there's just one in den
 Who is stiff-necked in his address,
 A miracle then to confess
 If he goes unpunished for less.
 For mercy and wrath are with YHWH,
 He's mighty to forgive when due,
 And He pours out His wrath in view.
 12 As great as His mercy, so great

Is also His reproof in state,
 He judges a man by his deeds.
 13 The sinner will not escape *needs*
 With his plunder, and those who wait
 In godly patience not frustrate.
 14 He will make room for every act
 Of mercy, every one will stacked
 Receive according to his deeds.

Expression that brings fear into my find
 More than any other that pricks the rind
 Is that Your fair reproof is just as great
 As is Your mercy in Your divine state.
 The preachers always taught me that Your
 grace

Would overcome Your justice in this place,
 And I could get by with a sin or two
 Conforming to the common sort of view.
 But if reproof is equal in its share
 With mercy, then I'm likely to stand bare
 Before the judgement and fail in the glare.
 Beloved, measure today Your vast reproof
 Upon me where I stand stricken aloof
 Before Your law of love to build my roof.

15 16 17 Don't say "I'll be hidden from
 YHWH,

And who from on high will mind me?
 Among so many people I
 Shall not be known, for what is my
 Soul in bound of eternity?

18 "See, heaven and highest heaven's *view*,
 Tehowm and earth tremble *in pew*
 At His appearance *in time due*.

19 "The mountains also and the *beds*
Of earth's foundations shake to shreds
 When He looks on them *and their spreads*.

20 "And no mind will reflect on this.
 Who will ponder His ways *of bliss*?

21 "Like a storm that no man can see,
 So His works mostly hidden be.

22 "Who will declare His righteous acts?
 Or who'll wait for their thundered pacts?
 For covenant's in distant facts."

Humility is human in the way
 The robber trusts the darkness in the day
 To cover him and what he does to stray.
 A man is sure he's not seen in the crowd
 By all the people shouting there aloud,
 But though no human eye is turned to see,

You do not bat an eyelash on the spree,
But with unmoving calm gaze out and
know

All Your creation as a gaudy show.

The greatness of Your doings does not veil
The gnat and atom from Creator's sight.

All things lie open in eternal right.

The eye of calm is the heart of the gale,

The sea though vast marks out each passing
sail.

23 This is what one devoid of sense
Thinks misguidedly in his tents.

24 Listen to me, my son, acquire
Knowledge, and listen and not tire
Of my words. 25 Then I shall impart
Instruction measured, and the start
Of wisdom's calculated cart.

26 The works of YHWH have been drawn
out

From the start by creation's clout,
And when He made them, He set line
Upon divisions *of their kine*.

27 He set His works in order wrought
Eternal, with dominion sought
To generations faithfully,
Neither be hungry nor weary,
Not ceasing from their labours' fee.

28 They do not jostle each by each,
Nor disobey His word to reach.

29 After this YHWH looked on the earth,
And filled it with good things of worth,
30 With all sorts of life spread the plain,
And to it they return again.

I see the suns in twinkling majesty
Pass through the courses of the sky and me,
And find that they obey the track set out
Beyond eternity to turn and rout.
I feel the movement of the dust and tone
Of moisture that bears off the waiting
throne

Of microscopic motion, and alone
I know that all is caught in web and cone.
Beloved, though I am thus laid out to be
Obedient to the natural laws that see
My weight and posture in the light and
sound,

I know that I am more than duty bound.
I have the choice of turning all around

And breathing air above the dancing
ground.

Sirach 17

1 The Lord created man from earth,
And turned him back to it for berth.

2 He gave to men few days to live,
A brief time, but the power to give
Over the things upon the earth.

3 He granted them authority
Like his own, and made them to be
In His own image. 4 He placed fear

Of them in all life round them near,
And gave power over beast and bird.

5 6 He made for them tongue and eyes
stirred,

He gave them ears and mind unblurred.

The son of Sirach knows creation story
And how You made man after Your own
glory.

I must be the only man on the earth
Who reads the text as of another worth,
Not that the male and female on the shore
Were Your own image before all the store,
But that as the last piece in crossword
puzzle

You set them between sharpened beak and
muzzle

Within Your image made of all creation
To take part in universal elation.
The great dominion that You gave to all
Was that men might not munch the grass in
stall

But eat the fruit, the seed, the grain, the nut
Until the grinding mills of grace were shut.

7 He filled them with knowledge and skill,
And showed them good and evil will.

8 He set His eye upon their hearts
To show them His majestic arts.

9 10 And they will praise His holy name,
The grandeur of His works proclaim.

11 He bestowed them with knowledge, and
Allotted them life's law in hand.

12 He set with them eternal pact,
And showed them His judgements in fact.

13 Their eyes saw His great majesty,
Their ears heard His voice's glory.

If humankind is given the power to eat

The nut, the grain as well as the fruit sweet,
His purpose in creation is a treat.

You made the man and woman on the
street

For one thing only, and that thing is meet,
To praise Your holy name and lift it up
In sweetness from the alabaster cup.

All human knowledge is set out in claim
To be the source and harbour of Your fame
Sprung up in Psalms of gratitude and game.
My skill though small I set to praise Your
name

And show Your wonders in the cloud and
flame.

I spread my arms and heart to take the good
And give the blessing out as all men
should.

14 He said to them, "Beware of all
Unrighteousness." He would install
Commandment to each of his neighbours.

15 Their ways are always in their labours
Before Him, they will not be hidden
From His eyes *and as though unbidden*.

16 17 He set a chief for every nation,
But Israel is the Lord's own ration.

18 19 Everything they do is as clear
As the sun before Him for cheer,
And His eyes constantly relate
The ways upon which they are late.

20 Their sins are not hidden from Him,
Before YHWH their deeds are not dim.

21 22 A man's almsgiving's like a ring
With YHWH, and He will keep saving
A man's kindness like apple of
His eye. 23 After He'll go above

And take vengeance for them, and He
Will bring recompense on their tree.

There is no chief of nations that has taken
The crown by force or stealth that is not
shaken

To rule by Your will and Your lone accord.
No man exists to govern: You are Lord.
It is a fickle view and poor conceit
That some men are elected from defeat
To sit in legislation and in power.
Yours is the only rulership and tower.
Some are set where they think the rod
remains,

Some sit among the cinders and their
stains,

But all are valued only for the pains
They spend in alms and kindness in their
gains.

Beloved, take vengeance on those whom
You will,

And recompense with justice my own bill.

24 Yet to those who repent He grants
Return, and He favours the dance
Of those whose strength fails as in trance.

25 Turn to YHWH and forsake your sins,
Pray in His presence and that wins
Decrease of you offences' bins.

26 Return to the Most High and turn
Away from wickedness, and spurn
Abominations intensely.

The way of Your salvation is set plain:
To those who shall repent there is the gain.

I turn to You, Beloved, forsaking sin,
Pray in Your presence for the grace to win,
And spend no groat on sacrifice to pay
Some hidden and imagined fee to sway
You from Your judgement to look down in
grace.

I lay no hopes in sacrificial trace
Of crosses or of dark Gethsemanes.
Repentance and forsaking sin agrees
With my own sense of what Your word
stakes out.

I wonder that sweet Christians fail to doubt
The heathen message of their gospel's rout.
Beloved, I turn to You on bended knees.

27 Who will sing praises to Most High
In Hades, as do those who vie
In life and give thanks *to the sky?*

28 From the dead, as from one who does
Not exist, thanksgiving that was
Has ceased, he who's alive and well
Sings the Lord's praises *hill and dell*.

The Hellenistic beat that soul's a thing
Eternal on the silvered, shining wing
Is unknown to the desert man and he
Who stands within Semitic pageantry.
There is no singing to Your praise when
life

Has fluttered from the lip, and earthly strife

Lies quiet on the field, the body slipped
Into the tomb to wait for the unshipped.
Beloved, death is a sleep, as all must know
Who see the corpse laid out to neighbour's
show.

None have returned to say what dreams
invest
The darkened kingdom of the fatal west,
And so I lend my praises to the air
While life returns to me in measured share.

29 How great is the mercy of YHWH,
And His forgiveness for those who
Turn to Him! 30 For all things cannot
Be in men, since son of man taught
Is not immortal. 31 What is brighter
Than the sun? Yet its light fails slighter.
So flesh and blood devise the ill.
32 He marshals the host of the hill
Of heaven, but all men are dust
And ashes *and no thing to trust*.

Though You alone set kings upon the earth,
Both in the nations of their heathen worth
And Israel and Judah on the reign,
Your kingdom is established without gain
To David and his sons upon the plain.
The roads are filled with goods on cart
piled higher
To markets in Jerusalem and Tyre,
But nowhere do I see the promised fire.
The kingdom of Your David's only met
In Psalms sung to Your praises to forget
The weight of taxes given to the throng
Of butchers and the bakers of the wrong.
Some hope the fair messiah will appear,
Some wait for his return, some stand in
fear.

Sirach 18

1 He who lives forever created
The universe entire instated.
2 YHWH only will be declared just,
All others are laid in the trust.
3 4 To none has He given power to state
His works, and who can search the gate
Of His great deeds *and then relate?*
5 Who can measure His glorious power?
Who can fully recount the tower
Of His mercies? 6 None can diminish
Them and no one can start or finish

Of their increase, nor can one trace
The wonders of YHWH and His grace.

The logic here is not too hard to follow,
Although it might hook and sweep like a
swallow.

The reason You only are just is that
You are Creator of both hill and flat.
Justice requires the knowledge of all things
Relevant to the question in the rings.
Only the One who made the world can be
Just in that world, since He only can see
All sides of every issue and still know
That nothing important escapes His show.
My human way of looking at the facts
Is that my feelings tell me which of acts
Is right and which is wrong. Yet reason
knows
My limitations must prevent the flows.

7 When a man has finished, he's just
Beginning, when he hits the dust
He will be at a loss, astonished.
8 What is man, and how's he admonished?
What is his good and what his ill?
9 The number of man's days is great
If he reaches a hundred's state.
10 Like a water drop from the sea
And a grain of sand there to be,
So are a few years *in the lea*
Of man's life in eternity.
11 Therefore YHWH is patient with them
And pours out His mercy on them.
12 He sees and recognizes their
End will be evil *for their share*,
Therefore He grants them forgiveness
In an abundance *and address*.

The one thing every man must know for
sure
About reality and temperature
Is that when everything he knows is
counted
He realizes that all it's amounted
Falls short of the whole universe of mind
And space and matter and of every kind.
The human limitation is the stock
Of knowing that is absolute like rock.
Beloved, Your mercy does not depend on
The weight of righteous acts before the
dawn,

The weight of sorrow for having
withdrawn,
But on the great extent of limitations
That apply to each soul in all the nations.
Such universal grace is treatful rations.

13 The compassion of man is for
His neighbour, but compassion's store
Of YHWH is for all living things,
Both with their horns and with their stings.
He rebukes, trains and teaches them,
And turns them back into His hem
As a shepherd his flock *in gem*.
14 He has compassion on those who
Accept His discipline and who
Are eager for His judgments too.

Despite the grace that's infinite in You
And limitations that afflict the crew
Of humankind and so awoken state
Of mercy in Your heart, because it's great,
You spread that mercy on those who do not
Fail to accept Your discipline in lot,
And who are eager for Your judgement's
dot.

So grace is great, but mercy chooses late.
Beloved, Your name is gracious by the call
Of the Qur'an upon the earthly ball,
And after grace is given to one and all,
There still remains Your mercy at the gate:
Each moment and each soul call for their
rate,
And some go into glory, some to fate.

15 My son, don't mix reproach with your
Good deeds, nor cause some grief by your
Words when you come present a gift.
16 Does not the dew assuage *the rift*
Of scorching heat? So a word's found
Better than any gift *in sound*.
17 Indeed, does not a word surpass
A good gift? Both are in taste class
In gracious men, *though few, alas*.
18 A fool's ungracious and abusive,
And the gift of a grudging man
Makes the eyes dim *and tears effusive*.
19 Before you speak, learn, *if you can*,
And before you fall ill, take care
Of your health. 20 Before judgment share,
Examine yourself, in the hour
Of visitation *of God's power*

You will find forgiveness is there.
21 Before falling ill, humble self,
And when you are about *the shelf*
Of sinning, turn back *from the elf*.

So many times have so many men found
The temptation too hard to bear on ground
Of this world and its marsh reality!
A good word in good time sets a man free.
Before falling, humbling the self is just
The recognition that the self of dust
Is an illusion, and no other self
Exists but the one Self upon the shelf
That You lend to the consciousness of each
Who reaches toward the tree to take the
peach.

Beloved, I too love peaches and they seem
More real sometimes than any idle dream
Of power in I-ness, so I humbly take
The way to righteousness and for Your
sake.

22 Let nothing keep you from your vow
In its due time, and do not cower
Before death to be saved somehow.
23 Before making a vow, prepare
Yourself, and do not take the share
Of a man who tempts YHWH *to glare*.
24 Think of His wrath on day of death,
And of the moment *and the breath*
Of vengeance when He turns away
His face *to go away and stay*.
25 In time of plenty mind the time
Of hunger, in the days of lime
Think of poverty and need's *climb*.
26 From morning to evening things change,
And all move swiftly in YHWH's range.
27 A wise man is cautious in all,
And in *his* days of sin *to call*
He guards against wrongdoing's *shawl*.

Kol nidrei need not be sung anytime,
Not on Yom Kippur nor in pleasant rhyme
By Mecca. I'll just refrain from the share
Of making vows beyond the things You
dare

To require of the human soul and mate:
The Decalogue set out by human gate.
I vow that I shall not do anything
In good and righteous act beyond the sting
Of ten words in the mouth of divine King

Upon the mount of Sinai. There's the ping.
Beloved, now that I am bereft of all
Desire before the shredded, heavenly pall,
I find all vows return in a sweet song
Beyond the fasting and the supper gong.

28 Every intelligent man knows
Wisdom, and he praises the rows
Of those who find her. 29 Those who keep
The sayings become skilled to sweep,
And pour out fine proverbs *and weep*.
30 Do not follow your base desires,
But restrain your appetites' *fires*.
31 If you allow your soul to take
Pleasure in base desire *and stake*,
It will make you the laughingstock
Of your foes *on both sea and dock*.

It may be well that every clever man
Knows wisdom and praises as praises can
Those who find her. But they are far
 between,
Those clever men, and few be to be seen.
Those who pour out their proverbs go from
 sight,
Forgotten by the multitude for right,
Simply because there's no intelligent
Gent to praise them for all the words they
 sent.
Those who do not follow the base desire,
But restrain all the appetites conspire,
May not become the laughingstock indeed,
But surely will be left to go to seed.
I munch the seed in measure for each day
And so find for a time enough to pay.

32 Don't revel in great luxury,
Lest you come into poverty.
33 Do not become a beggar by
Feasting with borrowed money's sty,
When you have nothing in your purse,
And so avoid want and its curse.

The world is feasting still on money lent
And borrowed on the future before spent.
It is supposed to be a wisdom found
New and brave on the fertilized bare
 ground.
The featured new economy is bent,
But hope will always covet what is round.
The gardens of the kings in other days

Were decked with tribute from the
 conquered drays.
But now the banks of silver and of gold
Have turned to documents of favours told.
All see the wisdom of the past and note
The great abyss before the rushing boat,
And nod in solemn agreement to tote
The words of Ben Sirach in what he wrote.

Sirach 19

1 A worker who's a drunk will not
Earn wealth, *but be put on the spot*,
The one who's not careful of small
Things in due time will fail and fall.
2 Wine and women lead wise men off
The right course, and the one to scoff
And go with harlots is a doff.
3 Decay and worms will his heirs,
Such reckless ones will hit the stairs.
4 The one who is too quick to trust
Has the intelligence of dust,
And one who sins will wrong himself.
5 One who rejoices like an elf
In wickedness will be condemned,
6 And for the one who has contemned
Gossip, evil's put on the shelf.

Drink, drugs and devious women lead the
 way
Where evangelical preachers hold sway.
The one who stays on the right course
 today
Can never take the pulpit for his share
From those delivered from the evil snare.
One must have flashy witness of the wrong
He used to do to feed the hopeful throng
Waiting with hated breath to hear the news
Of what disgrace performed before the
 peps
Attracted him with din of clinking coin
And songs he liked before he came to join.
Beloved, I have no testimony here
Except that from my youth I would appear
To desire You beyond the joy and tear.

7 Never repeat a conversation,
And you'll lose nothing of your ration.
8 With friend or foe do not report it,
And unless it would be to sort it
As sin for you, do not disclose it,

9 For some one's heard you, watched and
chose it,

And when the time comes he'll hate you.

10 Do you have a message though true?

Let it die with you. Be brave! Thirst

To tell tales will not make you burst!

11 With such a word a fool will suffer

Pangs like a woman without buffer

In labour with a child *and rougher*.

12 Like an arrow stuck in the flesh

Of the thigh, a word will enmesh

Inside a fool. 13 Question a friend,

It may be he did not offend.

But if he did do anything,

Not to do it again *for sting*.

14 Question a neighbour, maybe he

Did not say it, but if he did,

So that he may put on the lid.

15 Question a guy, for often it

Is slander, do not come to sit

Believing everything you hear.

16 A man may even make a slip

Without intending any lip.

Who has never sinned with his tongue?

17 Question your neighbour what he's sung

Before you threaten him, and let

The law of the Most High be set.

Believe the half of what you see, my dad

Told me with fervour against every cad,

And nought of what you hear, because the
tongue

Distorts all things even when truth is sung.

Hearsay's the plague of mind and

neighbour's peace,

And rumour of both good and ill must
cease

Before the hope of life can once take root.

Better to make shoes and the polished boot

Than words. And yet, Beloved, I come to
share

With You more words than any anywhere.

But I beg You do not believe, beware!

Take what You see, but on the strident air

Let my words be no more than temple bare

Where You may rest enthroned and without
soot.

18 19 20 All wisdom is the fear of YHWH,

And in all wisdom there's in view

Fulfilment of the law *as true*.

21 22 But the knowledge of wickedness

Is not wisdom, nor is there dress

Of prudence in iniquity.

23 There is a cleverness to see

Which is abominable, but there

Is a fool who merely lacks share.

24 Better the God-fearing man who

Lacks intelligence in his view,

Than the highly intelligent

Who transgresses the law's *intent*.

25 There is a cleverness which is

Scrupulous but unjust *in biz*,

And there are people who distort

Kindness to gain a verdict's *fort*.

26 There is a rascal bowed in mourning,

But inside deceitful, take warning.

27 He hides pretending not to hear,

But when nobody else is near,

He'll sneak in and take all your gear.

28 And if by lack of strength he's not

Able to sin, when chance he's got

He will do evil and a lot.

29 A man's known by what he looks like,

A sensible man's face will strike

You as such when you meet in light.

30 The way a man dresses aright

And how he laughs freely and how

He carries himself by his act

Will reveal what he is in fact.

I plague myself that I may be one wise,

And for that goal I see I must despise

The fell of fashions everywhere I rise.

I plague myself instead to fear You while

The others only love You for Your smile.

Those who know Your grace and mercy in
pile

Know that You punish none, but gaze

away,

And wink at sin, and give the stars in pay.

I plague myself to obey what You say.

Beloved, the grant of what seems in the

face

To be the hopeful star in loving trace

May well define the man and show his

place.

Such knowledge helps to sell the barbecue,

The dishwasher, the car, the yacht with

crew.

Sirach 20

1 There's a reproof which is not timely,
And there's a man who keeps his crimely
Mouth shut but is not wise *or rhymely*.

2 Then how much better to reprove
Than to stay in an angry groove!
And the one who confesses wrong
Will be kept from loss all along.

3 4 Like a eunuch's desire to grip
A maiden is a man to slip
In judgements by violent *lip*.

5 Some who keep their mouths shut are
wise,

And others find others despise
Them since their chatters balladize.

6 Some shut up who've nothing to say,
Others knowing just when to stay.

7 A wise man waits till the right time,
A braggart and a fool in rhyme
Rattle on in a weary chime.

8 The long-winded man will be loathed,
(*Unless he's French*), and one who's
clothed

Himself in someone else's right
To speak will be hated for spite.

The times to speak and what to say are
meant

To be the gauge of civilized present,
But hardly any man on earth knows how
To say the right word in a petty row.
And every woman born of mom and dad
Returns her lips on wicked tongue and sad.
I live in a land where silence is best
According to the lines the folk invest,
And song itself is known to be a sword
Before the fens and bogs of the adored.
And yet a thousand years of practice taught
None of the inmates when to open plot.
If silence reigns instead of the wrong word,
Then silence reigns when the right might
have stirred.

9 An accident may bring a man
Good fortune despite every plan,
And in a time of loss may come
A windfall *in generous sum*.

10 There is a gift with no return,
And there's one with double to earn.

11 There are losses because of glory,
And there are men whose own life story
Is rags to riches, *nothing gory*.

12 Some men buy much for small outlay,
And then suffers seven times to pay.

13 The wise man makes himself beloved
Through his words, but courtesies *shoved*
By fools are wasted. 14 A fool's gift
Will profit you nothing *but rift*,
For he has many eyes to *stay*
Instead of one *in the right way*.

15 He gives little and upbraids much,
He opens his mouth at a touch
Like a herald, today he lends,
Tomorrow asks back what he sends,
Such a one is a hateful man.

16 A fool will say as if by plan,
"I have no friend, and there's no thanks
For my good deeds or my good shanks,
Those who eat my bread come to speak
Unkindly of the things they seek."

I am a fool indeed, for few friends make
There way to my table and come to break
The bread with me. My missionary wake
Knows scores who ate and afterward
prevailed

To say an unkind word before they sailed.
That's why I ask no boon or blessing when
I welcome now friend and foe to my den.
Let all see to their own devising of
The laws of good and evil and of love.
Whether I plan assemblies and the feast
Or don the coat of fasting with the least,
The truth is You alone know what is best,
And You will intervene when come the
test.

I stand in wealth or poverty increased.

17 How many will make fun of him,
And how often they'll hold him dim!
18 To stumble on the path is better
Than slip of tongue by a go-getter,
And so the sinner's downfall comes
As quickly as he speaks his sums.

19 An ungracious man's like a tale
Told at the wrong time, under sail
By unwise lips that long prevail.
20 A proverb from a fool's lips finds
No reception in the rinds

Because he does not say the word
At the right time when it was spurred.
21 Poverty may keep some from sin,
So he can rest with a clear grin.

22 A man may lose his life through shame,
Or then his foolish look's to blame.
23 A man for shame may promise aught
To a friend and without need taught
Make him an enemy unsought.

I've spent a lifetime watching what right
word

Might be appropriate as things occurred.
That does not mean my temper at the sound
Of some injustice did not spoil my ground.
But for the most I've played the local part
Like Paul of Tarsus in the noble start
Of being each to each by course and heart.
I've finished with the diplomatic brood.
It has not produced either gains or food.
Instead my proverb runs to every man:
Just keep the Decalogue in hand and plan.
No other proverb's needed where I sit,
No other wisdom comes to rival it.
The ten words solve all riddles that I scan.

24 A lie is a man's ugly blot,
But always on lips as untaught.
25 A thief is better than a liar,
But the lot of both's in the fire.
26 The lying spirit brings disgrace,
His shame's always before his face.
27 He who speaks wisely will advance,
A sensible man will *by prance*
Please great men. 28 Whoever tills soil
Will gather in his harvest spoil,
And whoever pleases great men
Will atone for injustice' den.
29 Presents and gifts blind the wise eyes,
Like muzzle on the mouth in guise
They avert reproofs of the wise.
30 Hidden wisdom and unseen treasure,
What benefit is in their measure?
31 Better's the man who hides his folly
Than one who hides his wisdom's *trolley*.

Say now, Beloved, as You review the
writing
Of sonnet after sonnet where I'm smiting,
If there are any here that cover up
The folly of my heart and my false cup.
Say now, Beloved, as You hear what I say
To You in praise, petition and the lay
Of plaint and penitence, whether I hide
My wisdom or show it on every side.

If I show both to the elated crew,
That gives me fifty percent of the view.
If I hide both in querulous appeal,
Half of the project goes under the heel.
If I hide wrong and bring the right in sight,
Then I have praised the day and earned the
night.

Sirach 21

1 Have you sinned, my son? Do no more,
But pray about your sinful score.
2 Flee from sin as from serpent sore,
For if you open up sin's door,
It will come to bite you. Its teeth
Are lion's teeth, and sharp beneath
To destroy men's souls *in the wreath*.
3 All lawlessness is like a sword
Two-edged, there is no healing cord
For its wound. 4 Terror's violence
Will lay waste riches, so the tents
Of the proud will be laid waste hence.
5 The prayer of a poor man goes from
His lips to Alohims' ears' sum,
And his judgement comes speedily.
6 Whoever hates reproof of spree
Walks in the sinner's steps, but he
That fears YHWH repents in his heart.
7 He who is great in spoken art
Is famous everywhere to start,
But the man of sense, when he slips,
Is aware of it *to the hips*.
8 A man who builds his house with fund
Of other people's moribund
To gather stones for his mound *dunned*.
9 A wicked assembly is like
Tow gathered for the match to strike.

Most people nowadays who want to build
A house for themselves ceiled and floored
and silled

Go out to borrow money for the trick,
Instead of paying cash and paying slick.
Yet Ben Sirach is sure that's a mistake,
A preparation for one's own death wake.
It is a wicked gathering to him,
A binding of fools with their wits so dim
They must be lighted by their burning
bright

In hell-fires raised upon the coming night.
Beloved, I once built on a stretch of wire
A hut of Spanish moss, and found the dire

Skink living there the next day, though I
paid
No borrowed money at all for the shade.

10 The way of sinners is smoothly
Paved with stones, but its end to be
Is the pit of Hades *in scree*.

11 Whoever keeps the law controls
His thoughts, and wisdom that unfolds
The fear of YHWH. 12 He who is not
Intelligent cannot be taught,
But there is cleverness around
Increasing bitterness *in pound*.

13 The knowledge of a wise man will
Increase like a flood *on the hill*,
His counsel like a flowing spring.

14 The mind of a fool is a thing
Like a broken bottle to sing,
It will hold no understanding.

15 When a man of knowledge perceives
A wise saying, he'll take its sleeves
And add to it with praise, but when
A reveller hears it in den,
He dislikes it and casts it out.

16 A fool's tale's like a burden stout
Upon a journey, but delight
Is found in clever speech and right.

17 The speaking of a man of sense
Will be sought in the people's tents,
They'll ponder his words in their minds.
18 Like a house vanished from the rinds,
So is wisdom heard by a fool,
And knowledge in talk without school.

I must be a wise man, Beloved, since I,
When I hear a good proverb on the sly
As I read in the book Ben Sirach wrote,
I take it by the sleeve and make it gloat.
I savour on my tongue the words and smell
The fragrance of the mighty, magic spell,
And then I add my bit in sonnet's care
To comment on Your wisdom from the air.
Though I am wise, Beloved, a man of sense
I am not, since no people recompense
My mutterings and complaints with the
sound

Of contemplation on the dewy ground.
And still I spread my clever speech around,
And squelch my own occasion of pretence.

19 A senseless man finds education

As fetters on his feet in ration,
And manacles on his right hand.
20 A fool raises his voice to stand
When he laughs, but a clever man
Smiles quietly. 21 But to a man
Of sense education is like
A golden ornament on spike,
And like a bracelet on the right.
22 The foot of a fool rushes right
Into a house, but a man who
Has much experience in view
Stands in respect before the due.
23 A boor peers in the house beside
The door, but cultured men abide
Without. 24 Ill manners make a man
Listen at the door to each plan,
But a discreet man's grieved to scan.
25 The lips of strangers speak these things,
But prudent words take measured wings.
26 The mind of fools is in their lips,
But the mouth of a wise man slips
Within his mind. 27 When wicked men
Curse their foes, they curse once again
Their own souls. 28 A gossip defiles
His own soul hated round for miles.

I must be senseless, my Beloved, since I
Find education manacles to fry
My right hand in the panned and fatty ply.
A title from the school, even the best,
Just gives the populace reason to jest
And throw out jeers upon the fatal ears
That listened to the teaching years and
years.

Obesity can be reduced in time
By eating less and exercise in crime,
But once the sheepskin's written with a
name,
One's caught forever with that awful
shame.

Beloved, though I have titles and degrees,
I only turn to You and hope to please
With my confession of Your divine breeze.

Sirach 22

1 A sloth is like a dirty stone,
Everyone boos at him alone.
2 A lazy man is like the pile
Of dung, anyone who'll defile
His hands with it will shake it off.
3 It's a disgrace and many scoff

At the father of a son who
 Is without discipline to do,
 And such a daughter's a loss too.
 4 A sensible daughter obtains
 Her husband, but one who remains
 In shame brings grief to her own dad.
 5 An impudent daughter makes sad
 Both father and husband, each cad
 Will despise here along with them.
 6 Like music at a funeral
 Is a tale told outside corral,
 But chastening and discipline
 Are always wise and never sin.

I leave the tale of sons and daughters to
 The men and women who know that
 they're true.
 Instead I mind the tale that's told in view
 When it is not appropriate to spue.
 Myself, I must be some fool, for my rate,
 I love a tale, no matter what the state,
 And dote on fiction as well as the mate
 Of science that I daily take on plate.
 I read the dictionary and the book
 Of every encyclopaedia and look
 For poetry and prose until my share
 Of red eye and the burning brow of care
 Forces me to the woods to chat a spell
 With birds that do not wait and cones that
 fell.

7 The one who teaches a fool's like
 One who glues potsherds with a spike,
 Or wakes up a man from deep sleep.
 8 He who tells a parable deep
 To a fool tells it to a man
 Who's sleepy and at end of span
 He'll ask, "What does it mean by plan?"
 9 10 11 Weep for the dead, for he lacks
 light,
 And weep for the fool, for his bright
 Lack of intelligence, but weep
 Less for the dead, for he shall keep
 His rest, but the life of a fool
 Is worse than death *and that's a rule*.
 12 Mourning for the dead lasts seven days,
 But for a fool or wonder-maze
 It lasts a lifetime in his craze.
 13 Do not talk much with foolish men,
 Don't visit a fool in his den,
 Guard yourself from him to escape

Trouble, and you'll not have to scrape
 The mud off when he shakes himself.
 Avoid him and rest on your shelf,
 And you will not be wearied by
 His madness *when he comes to try*.

I have taught fools in my day and I know
 The dirge that goes repentantly and slow.
 Beloved, keep me from classrooms and
 from men
 Who graduate to habitate the den
 Of every house and block of flats from here
 To Kamchatka, or if You are sincere,
 From Baffin's Island to the land of fire,
 With special focus on state of empire
 And the lone star that glitters from its weir.
 Beloved, I still weep for the madness found
 Around me in the sky and on the ground,
 And in my fevered way or in calm sound,
 I flee from such stupidity and bound
 To find You speaking Sinai's sense and
 pound.

14 What's heavier than lead? And what
 Is its name except fool *or shut?*
 15 Sand, salt, and cast-iron of a piece
 Are easier to bear in lease
 Than a stupid man *on increase*.
 16 A wooden beam when firmly set
 In a building will not be threat
 In time of earthquake, so the mind
 Firmly fixed on reason inclined
 Will not fear in a crisis' bind.
 17 A mind settled on a good thought
 Is like the plaster that is wrought
 On the wall of a colonnade.
 18 Fences set on a hill's parade
 Will not stand up against winds laid,
 So a heart timid of a fool
 Will not stand before fearful tool.
 19 A man who pricks an eye will make
 Tears fall, and one who pricks the wake
 Of a heart makes it show the stake
 Of feeling. 20 One who throws a stone
 At birds scares them away, the drone
 Who reviles a friend will break off
 The friendship *without philosophe*.

That's why, Beloved, my house is just not
 set
 Upon the top of the hill where I've met

The dawn of recognition in the sky,
The morning of Your glory passing by.
Instead I sit below the fir and pine
And drink Your nectar and in pleasure
dine.

And even so, Beloved, I've frightened bird,
Though not with stones I throw, but they
have heard

Me tramping through the brush or at a turn
Scrape with my feet the leaves they cannot
burn.

Beloved, I know of houses on the hill,
I know the windswept country and its fill,
But I sit here to contemplate Your coming
Down to meet me where I cantillate
humming.

21 Even if you have drawn your sword
Against a friend, despair no lord,
For friendship can be well renewed.
22 If you have opened your mouth crude
Against your friend, don't worry, for
Your reconciliation's score,
But for reviling, arrogance,
Repeating secrets or the glance
Of treachery, in such a case
Any friend will flee from the race.

23 Gain the trust of your neighbour when
He's poor, so you'll rejoice again
With him in his prosperity,
Be true in affliction's degree,
So you may share inheritance.

24 The vapour and smoke of furnace
Precede the fire, so insults' pace
Precedes bloodshed. 25 I will not be
Ashamed to protect a friend's fee,
And I will not hide from his plea,

26 But if some harm should come to me
Because of him, whoever hears
Of it will beware of his tears.

27 Oh that a guard were set upon
My mouth, a seal of prudence drawn
Over my lips, that it might keep
Me from falling into the steep,
So my tongue might not destroy me!

Not true, Beloved, I think that friends
appear
To forgive drawn sword and the chopped
off ear,
Even when it is healed by hand sent down

From you in messianic voice in town!
Not true, Beloved, I think that friends relate
To any sudden word against their gate.
The friend is like the bird in bush, I find
I must tame such or else be lone resigned!
Beloved, I've set the guard upon my lips,
And yet as soon as I return with skips
To Your word, I find all my vows are
broken,
And I revile You with a witty token.
The words are proven true, You're such a
friend
That has not yet struck down my bow and
bend.

Sirach 23

1 Lord, Father, Ruler of my life,
Do not abandon me to strife,
Let me not fall because of them!
2 O that whips were set on the hem
Of my thoughts, and the discipline
Of wisdom over my mind's *bin!*
That they may not spare me in my
Mistakes, and not pass my sins by,
3 So that my errors might not be
Multiplied, and my sins' degree
Might not abound, then I'll not fall
Before my adversaries' *wall*,
And my foe not rejoice on me.
4 Lord, Father and God of my life,
Do not give me proud eyes *like knife*,
5 And take from me evil desire.
6 Let neither gluttony nor fire
Of lust overcome me, and do
Not ever abandon me to
A shameless self. 7 Listen, children,
To my instruction *and my pen*
About speaking, the one who takes
Cognizance will not fall in shakes.

The prayer of the wise is instruction taught
To his own children, those whose ears he
sought.

Few find their children's ears are so
inclined,
Which suggests that children are deaf and
blind,

Or that parents are not as wise in due
As Ben Sirach appears to be in view.
The prayer of the wise in instruction's met
By me, also, Beloved, where I am set

Against the taunting of the windy world
 And blasphemy of ignorance uncured.
 Beloved, I've given up both greed and
 power,
 And so I join this prayer of holy hour
 To be stripped of lust in my gluttony,
 And so from all good things I am set free.

8 The sinner is caught through his lips,
 Reviler, the arrogant trips.
 9 Don't accustom your mouth to oaths,
 And make no habit in your clothes
 To utter name of Holy One,
 10 For as a servant who's condemned
 To torture to find out unstemmed
 What he has done will not lack bruises,
 So also the man who oft cruises
 To swear and utter the Name will
 Not be cleansed from sin's *staining spill*.
 11 A man who swears many oaths will
 Be filled with iniquity, and
 The scourge will not leave house *and land*,
 If he offends, his sin remains
 Upon him, and if he maintains
 His disregard, he doubles sin,
 What he has sworn needlessly in,
 He will never be justified,
 For his house will be filled inside
 Where its calamities reside.
 12 There is an utterance that is
 To be compared to death's *clutches*,
 And may the thing never be found
 In Jacob's portion of the ground!
 For all these errors will be far
 From godly *in particular*,
 And they will not wallow in sins.
 13 Do not accustom your mouth's *bins*
 To lewd vulgarity, for it
 Entails sinful speech and unfit.

The good advice of Jesus Ben Sirach
 Is that one should not vow and swear alack.
 Few do today in Western cities now,
 Because the rhetoric of high-toned brow
 Is advertising language and not sense
 To appeal to Your name when tax relents.
 The good advice may still be heard with
 power
 In Middle Eastern country, town and tower,
 Where those who lift a load with Ya Allah
 Are surpassed by the goad of those in awe

Rather of Muhammad or Ya Ali.
 Beloved, I certainly am not set free
 From recitation of Your name where I
 Whirl on the dergah floor before I die.

14 Remember your father and mother
 When you sit with great and another,
 Lest you forget yourself in their
 Presence, and be deemed a fool rare
 For your behaviour, then you'll wish
 That you had never seen the dish,
 And you will curse your day of birth.
 15 A man using insulting words
 Will never all his days be worth
 For discipline *among the birds*.
 16 Two sorts of men multiply sin,
 And a third incurs wrath within.
 The soul heated like burning fire
 Will not be quenched *of its desire*
 Until it is consumed, a man
 Committing fornication's flane
 With his near of kin never ceases
 Until consuming fire increases.
 17 All bread tastes sweet to such a tongue
 Who fornicates, his song is sung
 Until he dies. 18 A man who breaks
 His marriage vows says for his stakes,
 "Who sees me? Darkness surrounds me,
 And the walls hide me, none will see.
 Why should I fear? The Most High will
 Not take notice of my sins' fill."
 19 His fear is confined to the eyes
 Of men, he does not realize
 That YHWH's eyes are ten thousand times
 Brighter than the sun, they see crimes
 In all the ways of men, perceive
 Even the hidden places' eave.

Ben Sirach knows that taste acquired in
 fields
 Played by the playboy soon and ever yields
 The incapacity to stay aground,
 But every bread is tasty in its round.
 It's not the eye divine that looks in wrath
 Upon the infidelities and path
 Of darkness, but the very body shown
 Such ways learns in its own sorrows to
 groan.
 Your eyes may well see all that I have done
 Because they are brighter than sharpened
 sun,

But my own heart and hand lead in the skill
Of planting the regret of tasteless fill.
I do not hide from You, Beloved, but stand
Away from the bleak shadows I have
planned.

20 Before the universe was made,
It was known to Him, and it stayed
Also after the thing was done.
21 This man will be punished in sun
In the streets of the city, and
Where he least suspects it, the band
Will seize him also. 22 So it is
With a woman who leaves whom is
Her husband and provides an heir
By a stranger. 23 For first of all,
She has disobeyed the law's share
Of the Most High, second of all,
She's done her husband an offence,
And thirdly, she's through harlotry
Committed an adultery
And borne another man's offspring.
24 She herself will be brought *to sing*
Before the assembly, and sting
Will fall upon her children *too*.
25 Her children will not take root *due*,
And her branches will not bear fruit.
26 She'll leave her memory to boot
For a curse, and her disgrace will
Not be blotted out *of the ill*.
27 Those who survive her come to know
That nothing's better than the *glow*
And fear of YHWH, nothing is sweeter
Than to heed the commandments meter
Of YHWH in every place you go.

Ben Sirach knows Your eyes that stroked
the plain
Of all eternity have seen the gain
And loss of every man and woman here
Who bow to lust to find the path of fear.
He does not ask, as do the modern men,
How we can be responsible when ken
Of doings was eternally revealed
To You before we stepped into the field.
Instead he goes directly to the point:
Adultery is sordid in this joint.
Beloved, I care not either if Your eyes
Have followed me before the great sunrise
Of earth's appearance, I care only that
I would live in Your law and on Your mat.

Sirach 24

1 Now Wisdom praises herself, and
She glories in her people's band.
2 In the assembly of Most High
She'll open her mouth, and rely
On His host's glory *by and by*.
3 "I came from the mouth of Most High,
And covered the earth like a mist.
4 "I lived in high places, my throne
Was in a pillar of cloud *kissed*.
5 "I have made the circuit alone
Of the sky's dome and walked down in
The depths of the abyss *to win*.
6 "In the waves of the sea, in all
The earth, and in every folk's call
And every nation I have got
A possession *and comely plot*.
7 Among these I sought resting place,
Where I might lodge *diminished pace*.

The Epicurean and Stoic rate
Does not outflank my own Platonic mate.
Before I learned to think, I learned to read
The pods of Aristotle gone to seed.
The tongues of sun and star beyond the
moon
Rave in the night and at the foregone noon,
And even the sea's depth I grope in turn
To find at last the things I want to learn.
Beloved, a pilgrim I have spent an age
Before the dusty and the ink-fresh page,
And still I find no word in tune to beat
The rhythm of Your Decalogue in heat.
If there is resting place upon the earth,
The blistered coast of Sinai takes the berth.

8 "Then the Creator of all things
Gave me commandment *without strings*,
And the one who created me
Assigned a place for my tent *tree*.
And he said, 'Make your dwelling place
In Jacob, and in Israel's race
Receive your inheritance' grace.'
9 "From all eternity, in start,
He created me *for His part*,
And for eternity I'll not
Cease to exist *or fail to trot*.
10 "In holy tabernacle I
Ministered before him *to fly*,
In Zion was I set to be.

11 "Likewise in the beloved city
He gave me a resting place, and
In Jerusalem was my stand.
12 "So I took root by honoured folk,
In the portion of YHWH *a stroke*,
He is their inheritance' *grand*.
13 "I grew tall like a cedar in
Lebanon, and a cypress thin
On the heights of Hermon's *fair land*.

I found a place to sleep in the old town
Jerusalem beneath a blue sky's frown,
And paid my way among the arching halls
To the niche where Palestinian calls.
The Swedish hostel gave a better rate
Than any other, though the bedroom gate
Was tight for any of obesity.
My staying there is proof of being free
Of excess fat, but friendly faces there
Were worth more than the luxury of care.
Beloved, I come to Israel's state and find
Myself secure in Ahmed's veined and
vined,
Ready to find the temple mount and pray
Within the mosque for peace another day.

14 "I grew tall like a palm tree in
En-ge-di, and like rose plants in
Jericho, like an olive tree
Flourishing in the field and free,
And like a plane tree I grew tall.
15 "Like cassia and camel's thorn all
I gave forth aroma to thrall,
And like choice myrrh spread pleasant
scent,
Like galbanum, onycha rent,
And stacte, and like the fragrance of
Tent's frankincense *in clouds above*.
16 "Like terebith I spread out my
Branches, and my branches defy
All glory and all grace to vie.
17 "Like a vine I caused loveliness
To bud, and my blossoms' address
Grew glorious, abundant fruit.
18 19 "Come to me, you who desire suit,
And eat your fill of my produce.
20 "For the remembrance of my use
Is sweeter than honey, and my
Inheritance sweeter thereby
Than honeycomb. 21 "Those who eat me
Will hunger for more, and the fee

Of those who drink me thirst freely.
22 "Whoever obeys me will not
Be put to shame, and those who sought
Work with my help no sin are taught."

If wisdom is so fragile on the air
That she is like the fragrance on the stair
Of En-ge-di, I might think her to be
Ephemeral as sunset on the lea.
And yet the words writ fast so long ago
Are still true in the temple of the show:
The blossoms still shed light beneath the
cliff,
And scents still flame about the tall and
stiff
Palms that remember everything the proud
And humble sang above the shore and loud.
Remembrance of the place is still as sweet
As honey, and the breakfast is a treat.
One night in En-ge-di in darkness wrapt
Remains forever nectar's scent uncapped.

The fashing mind of Christ loved to read all
He might find in the scroll of law and pall
And stash away a word to contradict
With paradoxes charmed, chosen and
picked.

If wisdom is so fine that everyone
Who tastes it must hunger and thirst when
done

To have again the blessed share, then he
Will offer drinks at wells of infamy.
The water that makes never thirst again
Is not a thing for mortal, fleshly men,
Despite the fact a woman at the well
Hopes not to have to come to cast a spell
Each day with pail and pitcher from the
font.

The thirstings and the hungerings are gaunt.

23 All this is book of covenant
Of the Most High Alohim *sent*,
The law which Moses commanded
Us as an inheritance *fed*,
For Jacob's congregations *led*.
24 25 It fills men with wisdom indeed,
Like the Pishon, and like the *freed*
Tigris at the time of first fruits.
26 It makes them full of understanding,
Like the Euphrates, and the landing
Of Jordan at the harvest time.

27 It makes instruction like light shine,
 Like the Gihon at vintage time.
 28 Just as the first man did not know
 Her perfectly, the last one's show
 Cannot fathom her in her row,
 29 For her thought's more abundant than
 The sea, and her counsel will span
 Deeper than the great abyss *can*.
 30 I went out like a canal from
 A river and like water's sum
 Into a garden. 31 I said, "I
 Will water my orchard and try
 To drench my garden plot", and see,
 My stream became a river's *cry*,
 And my river became a sea.
 32 I will again make instruction
 Shine forth like the dawn, and *from dun*
 I'll make it shine afar *when won*,
 33 I'll pour out my Torah again
 Like prophecy left to all men.
 34 See how I labour not alone
 For myself but for all who groan
 For my instruction *and my tone*.

Torah of wisdom comes to follow me
 And swell my puddles to make up a sea
 Of blessing and of glory on the scope
 Of my own hillside where I live in hope.
 Torah of wisdom is itself the sound
 Of breakers on the rocks that pound and
 pound,
 Until the earth seem flat instead of round
 Caught on the castings of eternity.
 Beloved, I've seen the waters that in slight
 And sweetened channels burst after the
 night
 Along the courses of the green and bright
 Of Ali's gardens where Medina sits.
 The date-palms raise their fronds, the
 shadow fits
 The pools of rushing waters in the light.

Sirach 25

1 My soul takes pleasure in three things,
 And they are beautiful *as springs*
 In the sight of YHWH and of men:
 Brothers' harmony in their den,
 Friendship between neighbours *to spring*,
 And spouses without quarrelling.
 2 My soul hates three kinds of men too,
 And I'm offended at their view:

A beggar who is proud, a rich
 Man who's a liar, and *the breech*
 Of an old adulterer who
 Does not have good sense *in his pew*.

Five categories I can understand,
 But the sixth goes beyond my outstretched
 hand.
 Confucius-like, I admire brothers who
 Remember their own place in kinship's
 crew,
 And neighbours who mind how they ought
 to treat
 Each other with or without heaven's feat,
 While spouses who live without quarrel's
 lot
 Seem far-fetched, still I understand the
 plot.
 I also understand that lying is
 A thing unwanted in both life and biz,
 And that adultery's a stupid way
 To live the single life one has to pay.
 But that a beggar must not be proud I
 Do not accept, no, not for earth or sky.

3 You've gathered nothing in your youth,
 How then find your old age forsooth?
 4 How fine's judgement in grey-haired
 men,
 And for the old good sense again!
 5 How fine is wisdom in the old,
 And understanding's counsel bold!
 6 A wealth of experience is crown
 To the aged, they boast no frown
 Before YHWH whom they fear *in town*.
 7 With nine thoughts I've gladdened my
 heart,
 And with a tenth I'll tell my part:
 A man rejoicing in his spawn,
 A man who lives to see down drawn
 His enemies, 8 and happy he
 Whose wife knows to act cleverly,
 And who has not slipped with his tongue,
 Nor served a fool when he was young;
 9 Happy if he's kept his good sense,
 And people listen to his vents.
 10 How great is he who's gained wisdom!
 But there is no superior bum
 To him who fears YHWH. 11 Fear of
 YHWH
 Surpasses everything in view,

And who's to compare with the cat
Who holds it fast and outright flat?

I have been young and though I still feel
 young,
My years begin to mount up, while my
 tongue
Has not yet learned the wisdom of the store
Of Proverbs and Ecclesiastes' door.
I lack the wisdom that grey hair should
 show,
I lack the understanding of the row
Of practices and customs that relate
To buying and to selling in the state.
But while I fail to give respect thought due
To CEO and president in view,
And take each man for good or ill to spew,
I in my lack still hope that I fear You.
Yet by accounts I truly fear men more,
Knowing that they reject Your law for
 gore.

12 13 Any wound, but not wound of heart!
Any wickedness, but not start
Of wickedness on a wife's part!
14 Any attack, but no attack
From those who hate! And any rack
Of vengeance, but not vengeance of
The enemies who come to shove!
15 There is no venom worse than that
Of a snake, and no wrath that sat
Worse than the anger of a brat.
16 I'd rather live with lion and dragon
Than with a wife evil *and bragging*.
17 The wickedness of a wife makes
Her beauty fail before its shakes,
And darkens her face like a bear.
18 Her husband takes his meals in share
Among the neighbours, he cannot
Help sighing bitterly *once caught*.

I have a neighbour whose wife is adept
At cooking with the fat after she slept.
And the man too is good to bake the rare
And cut a slice as thick as anywhere.
My own table is tasty to my tongue,
Though simple in the ways and maze of
 sung,
With little of great cost, and much in fare
Caught from the wayside lake and meadow
 bare.

Beloved, I still prefer the modest rate
Of all the victuals in my life I ate
To dainties trucked in bestial fat and butter
Where jowls will tremble and the stomach
 mutter.
That's why I still take all my meals at
 home,
And leave the neighbour to the fancy loam.

19 Any iniquity is naught
Compared to a wife's sinful plot,
And may she fall into the lot
Of sinners for the things she's got.
20 A sandy hill for aged feet,
Such is a wife with chatter's beat
For a husband's quiet retreat.
21 Don't be seduced by woman's beauty,
Do not desire her for her booty.
22 There is both wrath and impudence
And great disgrace when in her tents
A wife supports her husband's bents.
23 A mind dejected, gloomy face,
And wounded heart are all the trace
Of a wife of iniquity
Bent on spoiling all she can see.
Drooping hands and weak knees appear
Before a wife who does not *gear*
To make her husband happy here.
24 From a woman sin had its start,
And because of her we depart.
25 Don't let a water vessel leak,
Nor wicked wives begin to speak.
26 If she does not do as you say,
Divorce her and go on your way.

Beloved, let us just draw a curtain on
This tirade of male chauvinist that's drawn
Before my wondering eyes that take
 offence
At the thought that a woman in her vents
Is any worse than man without good sense.
Truth is all creatures with breath are defiled
Unless they adhere to Decalogue styled
And leave the law of jungle and the wild.
Beloved, I do not claim that Your estate
As Father and as Lover at the gate
Implies You have a tool hidden to wait
Beneath Your breeches to make soul elate.
It's not the genitals that even score,
But keeping of Your law and nothing more.

Sirach 26

1 Happy's the man with a good wife,
His years will double without strife.
2 A loyal wife's joy to a man,
He'll die in peace *without a plan*.
3 A good wife is a blessing true
She'll be counted among the few
Blessings of the one who fears YHWH.
4 Whether rich or poor, his heart's glad,
And at all times his face not sad.
5 Of three things my heart is afraid,
And of a fourth my fear is paid:
The slander of a city made,
The gathering of a rabble laid,
And accusation false arrayed,
All these are worse than death's *parade*.
6 There's grief of heart and sorrow when
A wife is envious in her den
Of a rival, and so her tongue
Makes it known to all *from her lung*.

When Ben Sirach can take his mind away
From foibles of the female sex and play,
He has a word of wisdom here to say:
The process of a revolution stands
Against all human hopes in contrabands.
The first thing is the slander set abroad
To demonize a city for its fraud
Or country as it lies beneath Your eye.
When hearts are sure pre-emptive fight is
needed,
Then rabbles raised by flouted feeling
heeded
Produce desired effect. The city falls,
And then the accusations from the walls
In lies extend beyond the kings and courts
To where the people gather for their sports.

7 An evil wife's an ox yoke which
Rubs on the shoulder with sore pitch.
She's like a scorpion in the hand.
8 There's great wrath when a wife will
stand
In drunkenness, for she will not
Cover her shameful honey-pot.
9 The harlotry of a wife shows
In lustful eyes, a lid that glows.
10 Keep strict watch over headstrong
daughter,
Lest she, when free, go to her slaughter.
11 Watch out for impudence of eye,

Don't wonder when her sins reply.
12 Like thirsty traveller opens mouth
And drinks water from north or south,
So she will sit before the post
Of any chiel and open host
Of quiver to his arrow's boast.
13 A wife's charm delights her husband,
And her skill puts fat on his spanned.
14 A silent wife's a gift of YHWH,
Naught is so precious in the view
As a soul disciplined *in pew*.

I do believe the word of Jesus Ben
When he says drunken women among men
Are plague and sore on any town or den.
I cry You, my Beloved, to set a flail
On those who make the liquor that's for
sale,
And those who sell the stuff, and those who
drink
And bring the world up to destruction's
brink.
I do believe the word of Sirach when
He gives no praise to drunken women's
men,
Who rack the wealth and song from den to
den
And touch the world with brass instead of
gold.
I cast my judgement on the brazen bold
And lift the cry of the oppressed once told
Before Your throne and beg You not stand
cold.

15 A modest wife adds charm to charm,
No scales can weigh a chaste soul's arm.
16 Like sun coming up in YHWH's sky,
So is the beauty by and by
Of a good wife in ordered sty.
17 Like shining lamp on holy stand,
So is a fine face on the brand
Of a fine figure on the land.
18 Like pillars of gold on a base
Of silver, so beautifully trace
The feet with steadfast heart in place.
19-28 At two things my heart's greatly
grieved,
And with a third wrath's unreprieved,
A soldier stuck in poverty,
A wise man seen contemptuously,
And one who turns from righteousness

To sin. Let YHWH prepare address
Of sword to cut him down for less.
29 A merchant can hardly be kept
From doing wrong, a tradesman swept
Into sin will not be proclaimed
Innocent of for which he's blamed.

I am amazed that anyone who takes
The pen to write down wisdom for the
sakes
Of people and of God should show such
stakes.

He praises soldiers and hopes every one
Who survives blast of cannon and of gun
Who be hale and whole, happy with the
fun.

You once said not to kill, I'd think the host
That did so had no place for hope or boast.
And then You let the man cast blame on all
Who sell their wares in peace in market
stall,

And make assumptions of their hidden sin,
Instead of criticizing battle's din.
Beloved, trade is a better way to live
Than in the warmonger's unbroken sieve.

Sirach 27

1 Many sin for a trifle's gain,
But one who would get rich in vain
Will turn away his eyes *for shame*.
2 As a stake's driven firm *and game*
In a crack between two stones, so
Is sin caught between come and go
Of commerce. 3 If a man is not
Steadfast and zealous in the lot
Of YHWH, his house soon falls on spot.
4 When a sieve's shaken, the sticks stay,
So a man's filth stays in his way.
5 The kiln proves potter's pots, and so
The test of a man's in the show
Of how his reasoning will go.
6 The fruit reveals the sort of tree,
So thought expressed shows what's to be
Of a man's mind's *iniquity*.
7 Do not praise a man before you
Hear him reason, for this is true,
The test of men *for what they do*.

When Jesus by Matthew's account would
say
That a tree is known by its fruit in sway,

He was just quoting his namesake one day.
That does not mean that what he says is
wrong,

In fact I sort of like the cherished song,
And figure following it gets along.
But here the test is not good deeds or bad,
As Christian false expositor has had,
But reasoning, that A is not both B
And not-B on the ebb and flow of sea.
Beloved, this day is like Bunyan's again,
When seven coxcombs came out of their
den

And turned a reason or not on its end.
Since Schopenhauer, irrational's our friend.

8 If you pursue justice, you'll get
It and wear it as a robe set.

9 Birds flock with their kind, and so truth
Returns to those who practice ruth.

10 A lion lies in wait for prey,
So does sin for the sinner's way.

11 The speech of godly man is wise,
But fools change like the moon in guise.

12 When among stupid people, watch
For a chance to leave *and not botch*,
But among thoughtful people stay.

13 The speech of fools' offensive way
Is to laugh in wanton array.

14 The talk of men who swear a lot
Makes one's hair stand on end *and trot*,
Their quarrels make one stop his ears
And run away from all their gears.

When Peter said the devil stood to catch
From ambush everyone who's not his
match,

He quoted from Jesus Ben Sirach's hatch.
Although he did not give the reference,
Nor get permission written for offence,
The word may still be true then as in past
Time when the sharp and sure temptation's
cast.

The trick's to find a flock behind the mast.
So when the devil jumps out from the
breast

Or from the thicket burning in the west,
The flock will all run in a single turn
In the same way You teach them and they
learn.

But everywhere I turn I see the flock
Is one that listens to both pop and rock.

15 The strife of the proud leads to blood,
And their abuse like hearing mud.

16 The one who tells secrets destroys
His confidence, and *in such ploys*
He'll never find a friend with poise.

17 Love your friend and keep faith with
him,

But if you betray secrets dim,
Then do not follow after him.

18 For as a man destroys his foe,
So you've at last destroyed the *show*
Of friendship in your neighbour's row.

19 And as you let a bird escape
From your hand, so you've let the nape
Of your neighbour go, and you'll not
Catch him again *with any plot*.

20 Do not chase after him, for he
Has too far gone, and fled to be
Like a gazelle from a snare free.

21 A wound may be bandaged, abuse
Finds reconciliation's use,
But whoever's repeated what
Was secret is from all hope shut.

I wonder who told Sirach's secrets wild,
And what they were, since his reaction's
styled

To the extreme, when it could have been
mild.

Vindictive I do say he seems to me:
It was not he the Master in his plea
Meant when he said that seven times
seventy

Is how often a brother should offend
And how often one might forgive a friend.
Beloved, I've told Your secrets far and
wide

To every hawk and sparrow on my side,
And still I find You faithful as a guide.
Beloved, Your secrets are not safe to be
Spoken in my hermetic company:
I send them out upon the winds to ride.

22 The one who winks his eye plans deeds
Of wickedness, and such one heeds
The good advice of no man's *creeds*.

23 In your presence his mouth is sweet,
And he admires your words in feat,
But later he will twist his speech
And with your own words over-reach.

24 I've hated many things, but none
To be compared *under the sun*
To him, even YHWH will hate him.

The sweet Christian tells me that love is all
There is to make go round this feeble ball
Beneath the feet of thunder and the pall
Of faith and hope struck up against the
wall.

The sweet Christian says You, Beloved,
love each

As though he were a succulent red peach,
When Jesus Ben Sirach knows how to
preach

That there is one at least You came to teach
Your hate and only hate within his reach.
Beloved, I too have met this common kind,
Though I thank You that such are in the
bind

Of vast minority before the rind.
Let every hated one fall in the press
Till only You remain and Self confess.

25 Whoever throws a stone straight up
Throws it on his own head *and cup*,
A treacherous blow opens wounds.

26 He who digs a pit in the boonds
Will fall into it, and he who
Sets a snare will be caught *in rue*.

27 If a man does evil, it will
Fall back on him, and so he will
Not know where it came from for bill.

28 But mockery and abuse come
From the proud man, but vengeance' sum
Will ambush him by lion's tum.

29 Those who rejoice in the fall of
The godly will be caught in shove,
And pain will consume them before
Their death *has time to find their door*.

30 Anger and wrath, these also are
Abominations, and the car
Of sinners is filled with such tar.

If hate is both acceptable to You,
Beloved, and to Sirach beneath Your view,
I do not understand how wrath can be
The proof of wickedness' iniquity.
It seems from my perspective that the one
Implies the other at some times of sun,
If not at all. It's just how things are done.
Perhaps You mean that anger should be set

Aside before the joy that's ever met
 When the ungodly fail and fall to get
 Foot crushed in traps of steel before the bet.
 If that is so, I am remiss, for I
 Join in the heathen crowd to sing and sigh
 The dirge of plaint for what falls from the
 sky.

Sirach 28

1 He that takes vengeance will contend
 With vengeance from YHWH *for his end*,
 And he will set his sins in stone.
 2 Forgive your neighbour and atone
 For what he's done, and then your own
 Sins will be pardoned when you pray,
 For that's the only righteous way.

You shall be once forgiven as you do
 Forgive your brother is a thing said true
 By Jesus the Messiah to his crew.
 He quoted Jesus Ben Sirach in that,
 But may have got it from his mother's flat,
 Since books were rare and costly in his day.
 It is a true thing to know anyway.
 I'm glad to know forgiveness does not need
 The bloody sacrifice of pagan sieve,
 Or humans dying on a cross to breed
 A generation of heathen to live.
 Beloved, I live to forgive those who rate
 The wrong on me, and so rejoice to skate
 Upon the slick surface of Your estate.

3 Does a man hold a grudge and then
 Seek healing from YHWH *for his wen*?
 4 Does he have no mercy toward
 A man like himself for reward,
 And yet pray for his own sins' *stored*?
 5 If he himself, being mere flesh,
 Nurses his anger, who'll be fresh
 To expiate his sins *in mesh*?
 6 Keep in mind the end of your life,
 And cease from enmity and strife,
 Remember destruction and death,
 And be true to commandments' breath.
 7 Remember the commandments, and
 Do not be angry with your band
 Of neighbours, mind the covenant
 Of the Most High, and smile at scant
 Intelligence. 8 Refrain from strife,
 And you will lessen sins *for life*,
 For a man given to wrath will start

A quarrel *and fight for his part*.
 9 And a sinful man will disturb
 Friends and cause enmity *to curb*
 Those who are at peace *and perturb*.

Remember the commandments, so indeed,
 Beloved, I find the secret, sacred seed
 Of health and wealth and stealth of
 happiness

And true delight, the secret of success.
 Success is not the product of great plan
 To conquer challenges the world in span,
 And does not take months, years and lives
 to take:

It is the gain of one moment to make.
 When I remember Your law and recite
 The silver and the golden words by night
 And day, I step into success and bright
 Ways that bring peace and calm into the
 fight.

Let me keep service of remembrance now
 And every time I turn and bend my brow.

10 In proportion to the fire's fuel,
 So will the burning be *to rule*,
 And in proportion to the rise
 Of stubbornness by strife in guise
 Will be the burning *of the eyes*,
 And in proportion to the strength
 Of the man will be his wrath's length,
 And in proportion to his wealth
 Will he heighten his wrath *in stealth*.

11 A hasty quarrel kindles fire,
 And urgent strife sheds blood *in ire*.

12 If you blow a spark, it will glow,
 If you spit on it, it will slow
 And go out, but both things come out
 Of your own mouth, *there is no doubt*.

13 Curse those who whisper and deceive,
 For he's destroyed many to please.

14 Slander has shaken many, and
 Scattered them from nation to land,
 And destroyed great cities in band,
 And cast down houses of great men.

15 Slander has driven out again
 Courageous women, and deprived
 Them of the fruit of their toil thrived.

16 Whoever pays heed to slander
 Will not find rest, nor will incur
 A life of peace. 17 Blow of a whip
 Raises a welt, but a tongue's quip

Crushes the bones, even the hip.

When I was young and less than young we
said

That sticks and stones were marvellous
instead

Of words to break the bone, which in
themselves

Could never hurt a child, a flea or elves.
That contradicts the plain message that
writes

Jesus Ben Sirach in the Scriptures' flights.
The word can take the health and wealth
and stealth

Out of the righteous and from
commonwealth

Of wickedness: all lie exposed to grief
Of tongue and word as well as robber thief.
Beloved, I've lived to learn that truth exists
In You alone, a man's here and subsists
On stop-gap measures in his nourishment,
But has no light of knowledge in his tent.

18 Many have fallen by the edge
Of the sword, but more at the pledge
Of tongue. 19 Happy's the man who lies
Protected from the tongue in guise,
Who has not been exposed to wrath,
Who has not borne its yoke and path,
And has not been bound with its chains.
20 For its yoke is a yoke of steel,
And its bronze fetters bruise the heel,
21 And its death is an evil death,
And Hades is preferred in breath.
22 It will not master godly men,
And they'll not be burned in its den.
23 Those who forsake YHWH, they will
fall

Into its power to burn in gall
Not to be extinguished at all.

And like a lion it is sent
Against them, like a leopard bent
To mangle them *as it was meant*.

24 See that you fence in your own plot
With thorns, lock up your silver lot
And gold, 25 make balances and scales
For your words, and make a door's nails
For your mouth. 26 Beware lest you err
With your tongue, lest you fall before
Him who lies in wait at the door.

The danger, my Beloved, is not so much
In telling lies about the neighbour's clutch,
But telling what one thinks is truth and then
Later finds was not so by gods and men.
Beloved, guard me from truth, it is too
great

For human shoulders to bear such a weight,
But rather let my tongue stay and relate
Your Psalms among the lesser and the
great.

Nail down my tongue, Beloved, caught in
the door,

And let my wayword words wind on the
shore

Among the winds of hell and paradise.
Beloved, keep me from repeating things
nice.

The tongue is truly a small thing says one
Who knew that it could tie knots not
undone.

Sirach 29

1 The one who shows mercy will lend
To his neighbour, and he will *spend*
To strengthen him and so he keeps
The commandments *in what he reaps*.

2 Lend to your neighbour in the time
Of his need, and in your own climb,
Repay your neighbour *without crime*
As soon as promised, *every dime*.

3 Confirm your word and keep your
promise,
And every time, *no doubting Thomas*,
You will obtain all that you need.

4 Many persons think of the seed
Of a loan as an unexpected
Bonus, and so treat the elected
Who help them with trouble indeed.

5 A man will kiss another's hand
Until he gets the contraband,
And whisper of his neighbour's funds,
But when repayment time immunds,
He will put it off lightly and
Will ask for more time *running sand*.

6 If his creditor will insist,
He'll hardly get back half *in fist*,
And think he's lucky *with the kissed*.
If he does not *put pressure on*,
The borrower has robbed the pawn,
And needlessly gained him a foe,
Who will repay with curses' flow

And reproaches, instead of glory
Will repay him dishonour *gory*.
7 Because of such wickedness many
Refuse to lend a hand or penny,
Fearing needless defrauding *at*
The hands of borrowers got fat.

When Jesus is so sweet to quote this word,
He does not give so much in comfort
 stirred,
But leaves the modern reader who has not
Read the Apocrypha in Catholic plot
To wonder if he really must give out
His wealth and savings to each one to shout
And demand borrowing, to every lout.
If Jesus had been careful in his speech,
We would not stand in wonder on the
 beach.
Beloved, I've lent and given too in time,
But only once not got back for my rhyme
What I gave out, and that I let pass by
As charity to help man and small fry.
My wife too lost a smaller sum to crime.

8 Nevertheless, have patient stance
With a man's humble circumstance,
And do not make him wait for alms.
9 Help a poor man and without qualms
For the commandment's sake, and for
His need, don't send to empty store.
10 Lose silver for your brother's sake
Or for a friend, don't let the stake
Rust under a stone and be lost.
11 Lay up your treasure by command
Of the Most High, you'll have in hand
More profit than your gold can stand.
12 Deposit alms in treasury,
And it will rescue you from fee
Of all suffering in poverty,
13 More than a mighty shield and more
Than heavy spear, it will fight score
On your behalf against your foe.
14 A good man will be surety
For his neighbour, but a man free
Who's lost his shame will miserably
Fail him *both here and on the go*.

The Proverbs disagree with surety,
And say the wise man will not join the
 spree
Of lend and borrow, but require the wealth

Of all he needs for management and health.
Jesus Ben Sirach knows the risk to take
When lending to a sinner at the stake,
But still encourages the mate to show
His neighbour mercy and to lend a hoe.
Beloved, I've lent in time and also writ
A note to borrow for a brief time's fit,
But in the main fear debt like plague and
 make
No gesture to borrow for lending's sake.
Beloved, lose silver for my sake and I
Will give You thanks beneath the tarnished
 sky.

15 Do not forget your surety's
Kindness, for he has given to please
You of his life. 16 A sinner will
Destroy his surety's good bill
In his prosperity to fill.
17 And one who does not return thanks
Will abandon his helper's banks.
18 Being surety has in fact
Ruined many men who were not slacked
In their prosperity. It's shaken
Them like a sea-wave overtaken,
It's driven strong men to exile,
To wander strange lands mile by mile.
19 The sinner who has fallen in
Suretyship and pursues bin
Of wealth will fall into lawsuits.
20 Assist your neighbour by your boots,
But watch out you don't fall in soots.
21 Necessities for life are just
Water and bread, not ash and dust,
And clothing and a hut to shelter
One's nakedness *from cold and welter*.

The four gates are essential to the soul,
While body has at least eight on the dole:
Sunlight and fresh air as well as the cool
Of water make the first in healthful school.
Rest and motion are added to the bread
To keep the body healthy and well fed.
The shelter of the body, both from shame
Of nakedness and heat and cold have claim.
Add to the seven trust in divine power,
The balance of come and go in the hour,
And all necessities known to man's use
Are clear and natural without abuse.
I need no movie stars, pop singers' ways

To show me joyful paths within Your
praise.

22 Better is the life of the poor
Under his roof's shelter in tour
Than dainties of meat in the gate
Of other men *come soon or late*.

23 Be content with little or much.

24 It is a miserable life to clutch
Going from house to house, and where
You are a stranger you may *stare*

But not open your mouth, beware,

25 You'll play the host and provide drink
Without being thanked *on the brink*,
And besides you'll hear bitter words:

26 "Come here, stranger, prepare the curds
Upon table, if you've got

Anything at hand, give the lot."

27 "Give place, stranger, to honoured
guest,

My brother's come to stay and rest
With me, I need my house *for best*."

28 These things are hard for men to bear
Who have the feeling share and share:

Scolding about lodging a night,
And reproach of lender in sight.

I've travelled round the world about but yet
Have not found the settlement where you
get

This treatment of the stranger and the
guest.

Where I've been I've received only the
best.

It may be that the golden words that flowed
In wisdom in the Middle East have slowed
The power of owner and at last have load
Of good in greeting traveller with the mode
Of hospitality. Besides I've seen
Hotels spring up around the soup tureen,
And few now venture out who have not
gold

To pay for fancy lodging that is sold.
Still beggars sleep upon the polished stone
Of the mosque steps where You are host
alone.

Sirach 30

1 The one who loves his son will whip
Him often, so in joy may quip
At the way he turns out *in slip*.

2 He who disciplines his son will
Profit by him, and will boast still
Of him among acquaintances.

3 He who teaches his son his biz
Will make his foes green with envy,
Among his friends reap his glory.

Beloved, strike out these words, I find them
rash.

First of all whipping's not the way to hash
A child today. It does not seem to help,
And social services may steal the whelp.
The second thing is fathers who expect
A profit from their children I reject.

The third thing is that boasting is a habit
Unworthy in both man and beast and
rabbit.

The last thing is that friends and foes alike
Are capable of envy at the strike,
And no one gives glory and honour to
Anyone today, but for evil due.
And so I finish my speech at the mike
And return in my silence back to You.

4 The father may die, and yet he
Is not dead, for he's left in fee
One like himself, 5 while alive he
Saw and rejoiced, and when he died
He was not grieved, 6 he's left to bide
Avenger against enemies,
And one to repay kindness fees
Of his friends. 7 He who spoils his son
Will bind up his wounds, and when done
His feelings will be troubled soon.

8 A horse that's untamed *like a goon*
Turns out to be stubborn, and so
An unrestrained son turns to show
A wilful spirit *on the go*.

9 Pamper a child, and he will come
To frighten you, play with the bum,
And he will give you grief in sum.

10 Do not laugh with him, lest you get
Sorrow with him, *though he's a pet*,
And in the end you'll gnash your teeth.

11 Give no authority beneath
His youth, and don't ignore his faults.

12 Bow down his youthful neck *to waltz*,
And beat him up and down while young,
Lest he become stubborn of tongue,
And disobey you, and you get
Sorrow of soul for what he's set.

13 Discipline your son and take pains
With him, that you may not *in banes*
Be offended by shameless stains.

Both Greek and Roman agree on the way
To discipline a child made to obey,
And even Hebrew wisdom in its sway
Would touch the whip to horse and son at
last

As long as the stall provides them repast.
While Your commandment tells the child
to be

Respectful of his parents faithfully,
And parents not to lay a burden's care
Upon the child on Sabbath day for share,
There is no word that lets the father pile
A rod upon the son or daughter's style.
There's only one practice of cult in view:
Honour your parents above every crew.
If that's taught, nothing else need fill the
due.

14 Better off is a poor man who
Is well and strong in body's view
Than a rich man who's in poor health.
15 Health and soundness are better wealth
Than all gold, and a robust body
Than countless riches and unshoddy.
16 There is no wealth better than health
Of body, and there is no gladness
Above joy of heart without sadness.
17 Death is better than painful life,
Eternal rest than chronic strife.
18 Good things poured out upon a mouth
That is closed are like offerings' south
Placed on a grave in *wasted* food.
19 Of what use to an idol rude
Is an offering of fruit? For it
Can neither eat nor smell a bit.
So is the one that YHWH has let
Be afflicted, 20 he sees the set
With his eyes and groans, like a *cut*
Eunuch who hugs a maiden's butt
And groans for his genitals shut.

Both health and wealth are merely strokes
of luck
Or else the unjust and uneven cluck
Of what You have provided for all men.
There's no use in Ben Sirach's strolling pen
To praise the one and other once again.

Virtue's the only wealth a man can gain
By his own striving, yet what there's in
strain

Is little: just the Sabbath rest and still
The honour piled on mom and dad to fill.
Beloved, I thank whatever stars You let
Give me a little of both body's set
And money to buy food and drink and
share

Of clothing and of shelter without care,
But most for knowledge of virtue to bear.

21 Do not give yourself up to grief,
Do not afflict yourself like thief.
22 Gladness of heart's the life of man,
Rejoicing's length of days in span.
23 Delight your soul, comfort your heart,
Remove sorrow far from your part,
For sorrow has destroyed the strong,
And there's no profit in its *song*.
24 Envy and anger shorten life,
Anxiety brings old age rife.
25 A man of cheerful and good heart
Will take heed of what food's his part.

The trick's to find delight while keeping all
The commandments that you have set on
ball.

Most joy that's advertised today requires
Departure from Your law into the mires.
The trick's to leave the Freudian cast that
will

Give over introspection and the bill
Of self-responsibility to take
The joy and not merely lie in the wake
Of sorrow as if nothing could be done
About the fate of every human spun.
Beloved, though I take cheerful heart a
while,

I fall into the great ungracious pile
Too easily, when I forget what guile
Lies in seduction underneath the sun.

Sirach 31

1 Wakefulness over wealth wastes life,
Anxiety removes sleep rife.
2 Wakeful anxiety prevents
Slumber, and illness in the tents
Carries off sleep. 3 The rich man toils
As his wealth grows in greater spoils,
And when he rests he fills himself

With delicate foods from his shelf.
 4 The poor man toils and sees his deed
 Diminish, and he rests in need.
 5 He who loves gold will never be
 Justified, and the one who'll see
 After money is led astray.
 6 Many have come to ruin's day
 Because of gold, and their destruction
 Has met them face to face *for fluxion*.
 7 It is a stumbling block to those
 Who are devoted to its rows,
 And every fool becomes its slave,
 Taken captive *by golden knave*.

It's true, Beloved, the rich man needs a pill
 To sleep at all. The reason's fast to bill:
 He does not do a day's work on the hill
 To tire his muscles, so the nervous drain
 Keeps him awake, even if he's not sane.
 Beyond that is the worry that his gain
 Will be robbed by intruder or a friend
 In the stock market out to beat his end.
 Beloved, I do not envy any man,
 Neither the rich nor poor by human plan,
 The one's insane to overfill his plate,
 The other worries about hunger's rate.
 I have no gold, and yet until today,
 I still eat, though it's nettles from the way.

8 Blessed is the man rich and blameless,
 Who does not seek golden address.
 9 Who is he? We will call him blessed,
 For he has done things of the best
 Among his folk. 10 Who's met the test
 And been found perfect? Let it be
 For him reason for boasting's spree.
 Who has had the chance to transgress
 And did not transgress, to do wrong
 And did not do it *for a song*?
 11 Prosperity is set for him,
 And the assembly will show trim
 His acts of charity *not dim*.

I thank You, my Beloved, that there have
 been
 Rich men and blameless, lacking greedy
 sin.

Though I know only one or two such men,
 The world is worth Your stake to live again
 Because they live and give in charity

To those who come to find them in the
 spree
 Of handing out banknotes after the prayers
 On Friday in the mosque and on its stairs.
 Beloved, I follow footsteps and turn eye
 Away embarrassed, since I am not sly,
 Not wanting to be taken for the crowd
 Who come to get their living as allowed.
 Bless all such men, Beloved, and give them
 room
 And happiness today and in the doom.

12 Do you sit at a great man's feast?
 Do not be greedy in the least
 And do not say, "There's quite enough."
 13 Remember a greedy eye's rough.
 What in creation has more greed
 Than *human* eye, now what indeed?
 That's why it sheds tears from each face.
 14 Don't reach out your hand in disgrace
 For everything you see and wish,
 Don't crowd your neighbour at the dish.
 15 Judge other's feelings by your own,
 And always take thought of the bone.
 16 Eat like a human being that
 Which is set before you *on mat*,
 And do not chew with greed, lest you
 Be hated *by the host in view*.
 17 Be the first to stop eating, for
 The sake of good manners *in score*,
 And do not be insatiable,
 Lest you give offence to the full.
 18 If you are seated with a crowd,
 Don't reach out before you're allowed.
 19 A little goes a long way for
 A man well-disciplined *in store*.
 He does not snore upon his bed.
 20 Healthy sleep comes from being led
 To eat no more than need be fed.
 One gets up early and feels fit.
 Insomnia, in stomach pit
 The queasy feeling, all of it
 Are with a glutton *like a mitt*.
 21 If you are overstuffed with food,
 Rise from the table before brood,
 And you'll have relief *from the crude*.

When I was young I could eat the rich fare
 I rarely tasted, if at all in share,
 To any pile, enormously and fine,
 But now I'm old, I come to disincline.

Rich food may now be at my beck and
 stall,
 But hunger does not lie in ambush tall
 As it did when I was a youth and all.
 I can do now without the meat and wine.
 Beloved, I taste the sliced grape and I chew
 The walnut after breaking the skin's rue,
 And as I crunch the seeds on tongue and
 teeth,
 I mind to whirl about the barren heath.
 My hunger is appeased with herbal brew
 As I set out in sacrifice to You.

22 Listen to me, my son, and do
 Not disregard me, and in due
 You will appreciate my word,
When you have been patient and heard.
 In all your work be like a crew,
 No sickness will overtake you.

Beloved, Your word written so long ago
 Provides the key to health and wealth and
 glow
 Of happiness. It is the up and go
 To act and do, and get good exercise.
 The circulation of blood in that guise
 Is better medicine than doctors wise.
 Eat right and modestly and take a walk
 After the meal, if work is slow in stock.
 Beloved, I whirl about the hidden wood,
 I trample briar and take the path I should
 To find heart racing and the faintness
 where
 I leave my footsteps and take to the air.
 Whether in health or ecstasy I climb
 The golden stairs of prayer and tinny
 rhyme.

23 Men will praise the one who is free
 With food, and their testimony
 To his goodness is trustworthy.
 24 The city will complain about
 The one who's stingy with the bout
 Of eating, and their witness is
 Accurate of his stingy whiz.
 25 Don't aim to be valiant for wine,
 Since wine has destroyed many fine.
 26 Water and fire prove tempered steel,
 So wine shows hearts and will reveal
 The strife of the proud with their heel.
 27 Grape juice is like life to a man,

If you drink it in moderate plan.
 What's life to a man who's without
 Grape juice *to enjoy in a bout?*
 It's been created to make glad.
 28 Grape juice drunk in season not sad
 And temperately's joy to the heart
 And gladness to the soul *to start.*
 29 Wine drunk to excess to the soul
 Is bitterness, provokes in toll,
 And causes stumbling *on the dole.*
 30 Drunkenness increases the wrath
 Of a fool to his hurt in path,
 Reducing his strength, adding sores.
 31 Do not reprove your neighbour's scores
 At a banquet of wine, and do
 Not despise him his merry crew,
 Speak no word of reproach to him,
 And do not cause him sorrows dim
 By making some demands on him.

The Torah provides death for drunkenness,
 And I agree that profit nonetheless
 Would be to carry out the pale address.
 More innocent die from the drunken spoil
 Each year than would die in the sharpened
 toil
 Of drunks put down by the electric chair.
 But Ben Sirach says not to speak or dare
 When others riot in their wine and beer,
 Hoping against pope to attain some cheer.
 Beloved, I trow that You inspired the word
 Of Ben Sirach, hoping that hearts were
 stirred
 To temperance and mercy in their lot.
 The hope is not well-founded in the plot,
 Since centuries go by and still I trot.

Sirach 32

1 Should they set you up as the chief
 Of the feast, don't exalt your grief,
 Be with them as just one of them,
 Take good care of them *head to hem,*
 And then be seated. 2 When you've done
 Your duties, take your place well won,
 And take cheer for their part and get
 A wreath for fine work that you set.
 3 Speak, you who are older, for it
 Is what you should do and it's fit,
 But with knowledge in truthful fee,
 Not interrupting minstrelsy.
 4 Where there is entertainment, do

Not chatter nor bring into view
 Your cleverness in time undue.
 5 A ruby seal in a gold ring
 Is a melody and singing
 At a banquet of wine *to fling*.
 6 An emerald seal in golden clasp
 Is music with good wine in hasp.

Ben Sirach does not favour the ascetic
 With praise of banquets of wine in hermetic.
 He makes the etiquette of sitting round
 And drinking wine a form of ethics sound.
 I doubt not what he has to say is good:
 The older ones should make speeches, not
 hood

Of youth who has nothing to say except
 The funny story of the inanept.
 Yet I should not despise the youthful talk
 Around the joyful table and the stock
 Of jokes that pass the time with laughter
 there.

I do not hold such humour to be fair
 And yet my repertoire of pranks is great,
 And I repeat my anecdotes till late.

7 Speak, young man, if there is a need
 Of you, but no more than twice deed,
 And only in petition's speed.
 8 Speak briefly, say much in few words,
 Be as one who knows *like the birds*
 And yet holds his tongue. 9 With the great
 Do not act as of equal state,
 And when another's speaking, do
 Not babble, *even if it's true*.
 10 Lightning rushes before the thunder,
 Approval is modest man's wonder.
 11 Leave in good time and do not be
 The last, but return home quickly.
 12 Amuse yourself there, and do what
 You have in mind, but not for gut
 Sin through proud speech, keep your mouth
 shut.

13 And for these things bless Him who
 made
 You and satisfies in parade
 With His good gifts. 14 He who fears
 YHWH
 Will accept his discipline due,
 And those who rise early to seek
 Him will find favour *for the meek*.

The danger of the young is not so much
 The glitter of the female form to touch,
 But proud words spoken in public to clutch.
 The banquet taken in a somber view,
 That is, not too much intemperate stew,
 Is not the wrong itself, but that it must
 Prevent a young man from rising in trust
 Early at dawn to seek You and Your face,
 And thus come into joy, mercy and grace.
 The danger of the celebration's not
 In laughter and in delicacies lot,
 But that it might distract the youthful mind
 From gratitude to You by being wined.
 Beloved, I turn to You from my own kind.

15 He who seeks the law will be filled
 With it, but the hypocrite stilled
 Will stumble at it. 16 Those who fear
 YHWH will form true judgments *and dear*,
 And like a light they'll kindle good.
 17 A sinful man will shun reproof,
 And find a decision that would
 Go to his liking, *though a goof*.
 18 A man of good judgment will not
 Overlook an idea *on spot*,
 An insolent and proud man will
 Not cower in fear *as in swill*.
 19 Do nothing without thinking well,
 And when you act, regret no spell.
 20 Don't go on a hazardous way,
 Don't stumble on stones where you stray.
 21 Do not be overconfident
 On a smooth way, 22 and give good vent
 To your ways. 23 Guard yourself in all
 You do: this is commandments' stall.
 24 He who believes the law gives heed
 To the commandments, in his need
 He trusts YHWH will not leave unkeyed.

The seeking of the sweet is not a sin,
 But failure of commandments and to win
 Their approbation in distraction's din.
 The hedonistic job is not as queer
 And futile as the one that would appear
 To seek Your law, but really wants to find
 Excuses in the Scriptures for the blind
 Path he would take in disobedience.
 Beloved, I guard my ways and keep my
 tents
 Under the vision and the thundered sound

Of Your commandments skipping on the
ground.

I leave the Baptist fold and Calvin's wrong,
The Papist sense and nonsense, for the song
Of Decalogue and find the light is strong.

Sirach 33

1 No evil will befall the man
Who fears YHWH, but in trial's *span*
He will deliver him who can.

2 A wise man will not hate the law,
But hypocrites in mind and claw
Are like a boat out in a storm.

3 A man with understanding *warm*
Will trust in the law, for the law
To him as trustworthy as draw
Of inquiry by Urim's brow.

4 Prepare what to say, and so you
Will be heard, bind together due
Instruction, and make answer true.

5 The fool's heart is like a cart wheel,
And his thoughts turning axle reel.

6 A stallion's like a mocking friend,
He neighs under each rider's bend.

7 Why is any day better than
Another, when all the light's span
In the year is from the sun's *pan*?

8 By YHWH's decision they were met,
And he appointed seasons set
And feasts, 9 some of them he made high
And holy, and some He brought nigh
As ordinary days' *reply*.

I see the cart-wheel of philosophy
Turn in the wisdom of human mind's spree,
And by contrast I see the tables shine
With the sweet words of Decalogue like
wine,

And know that men and horses have their
show

In all the pleasant, artful ways they go,
But that my trust is in Your law to know
The straighter path, the sharper, certain
line.

Beloved, there are some who trust in the
death

Of human sacrifice in ragged breath
Upon the crosses of Rome and its hills.

"The spirit wakens, but the letter kills"
They tell me, who hand out death sentence
where

The arm of king and priest come to
compare.

10 All men are brought forth from the
ground,

Adam created of dust's *pound*.

11 In the abundance of His knowing
YHWH divided and set their showing,
12 Some of them He blessed and exalted,
And some made holy and unfaulted,
And brought near to Himself, and some
Of them He cursed and brought down
dumb,

And turned them from their place *to hum*.

13 As clay in the hand of the potter,
For all His ways are his will's daughter,
So men are in the hand of Him
Who made them to be bright or dim.

14 Good is the opposite of bad,
And life opposite of death sad,
And so the sinner is in fact
Opposite of the godly tract.

15 See all the works of the Most High,
They're in pairs too and they go by
In opposites *and not to vie*.

Ben Sirach is a Calvinist at best,
Just see how predestined his manners rest.
I look into the street and must admit
That some see to take Your law and well fit
While others ignore life and light and go
Into the quandaries of humming-ho.
Beloved, the light and darkness in the show
Fills all men and their wives, it is just so.
While some seem holy on the outer bench,
In private they are good for wine and
wench.

The quietist between the red and black
May or may not fill up a grey hair-sack,
But what I drink in philosophic stack
Is still enough to nourish in my shack.

16 I was the last on watch, and I
Was like one who gleans on the sly
After grape-gatherers, and by
The blessing of YHWH I excelled,
And like a grape-gatherer spelled
Filled my wine press *as much as held*.

17 Consider that I do not labour
For myself only, but the neighbour
And all who seek instruction *jelled*.

18 Hear me, you who are great among
 The people, and you leaders sung
 Of the assembly, hear my speech.
 19 To son or wife, to brother's reach
 Or friend, do not give power over
 Yourself, as long as you are trover,
 And do not give your property
 To someone else, lest latterly
 You change your mind and then must ask
 For it back *with another task*.
 20 While you are still alive and breathe,
 Don't let anyone come to seethe
 In your place. 21 For it's better that
 Your children ask from you than that
 You depend on your sons for fat.
 22 Excel in all you do, bring no
 Stain on your honour *or your glow*.
 23 At the time when you end the days
 Of your life, in the hour and ways
 Of death, deal out your wealth for praise.

The power of attorney is the way
 That children rob their parents in a day.
 I've seen them coming like a buzzard flock
 To take away the house and hold and crock
 While mother stands by looking like a rock,
 In full mind and full powers, or almost
 such,
 But thrown out of her own house by the
 touch
 Of daughters who find that her early share
 Of work and duty's diminished by care.
 Do not give others power, the cynic
 preaches,
 But the wise man will listen when he
 teaches.
 Beloved, give me the power to break Your
 world
 And see how quickly all You've made is
 furled
 And no ark or escape for all these leeches!

24 Fodder and a stick for an ass
 To bear its burdens on the pass,
 And bread and discipline and work
 For a servant *and not to shirk*.
 25 Set your slave to work, and you'll find
 Rest, leave his hands idle in kind,
 And he will seek his liberty.
 26 Yoke and thong will bow the neck free,
 And for a wicked servant there

Are racks and tortures for his share.
 27 Put him to work, so he'll not shirk,
 Idleness teaches a bad quirk.
 28 Set him to work, as it is fit,
 And if he does not obey it,
 Make his fetters heavy a bit.
 29 Don't act intemperately toward
 Anyone, use discretion's sword.
 30 If you have a servant, let him
 Be as yourself, because with vim
 You have bought him. 31 If you have got
 A slave, treat him like brother's lot,
 For as your own soul you'll need him.
 If you ill-treat him, and he leave
 And run away, will you not grieve?

How does Ben Sirach reconcile the law
 Of serving slave by rack and torture's claw
 With treating him like brother or in-law?
 This is the rate of Scripture on the dole,
 I see it everywhere I turn my soul.
 The sacred word is always filled with
 doubt,
 And inconsistencies, and clinging clout.
 The Decalogue alone is clear and bright,
 All other is a quandary in sight.
 Beloved, I take no slave, I take no rack,
 I take no whip nor hold it to his back,
 But flee to you from civilized contempt
 That only keeps the wealthy ones exempt.
 Beloved, give me or this world rope in
 slack.

Sirach 34

1 One without understanding has
 Vain and false hopes and all such jazz,
 And dreams give wings to fools whereas.
 2 As one who chases shadows and
 Pursues the wind, so is the stand
 Of those who heed dreams *bright and*
 grand.
 3 The vision of dreams is this by
 That, and the likeness of a wry
 Face confronting a face near-by.
 4 From an unclean thing what's made
 clean?
 And from a false thing, is truth seen?
 5 The divinations and the cry
 Of omens and dreams are fools' sty,
 And like a woman in travail
 The mind has fancies *that prevail*.

6 Unless they are sent from Most High
As visitation, don't reply
To give your mind to them *for frail*.

The tardema that once produced the rate
Of male and female in Eden's estate
Falls on the children and grandchildren for
A lesser blessing with each era's score.
When Plato saw the dream and when the
cave
Revealed the fires and shadows of the
slave,
The mind was dark already, although
brave.
The brief belief in immortality
Alone suffices to set truth soundly
Awry. Beloved, I single out the cry
Of prophecy and doubt the evil eye.
Along the paving stones with direful tread
I meet the omens of both good and dread
And turn from shadows to my table fed.

7 For dreams have deceived many men,
And those who put their hope again
In them have failed. 8 Without such crude
Deceptions the law is imbued
With its fulfilment, and wisdom
Is made perfect in truthful hum.
9 An educated man knows much,
And one with experience to touch
Will speak with understanding's *crutch*.
10 The inexperienced one knows but
A few things, while the one who's cut
Out any journeys has a glut
Of cleverness. 11 I have seen much
In my travels, and understand
More than I can express *in hand*.
12 I've often been in danger's way,
But escaped in experience' sway.

I stop right here to point beyond belief
The pride of Ben Sirach, whose travels
brief
Entitle him to wisdom of such stretch
That all the world must wonder at the
wretch.
I too have travelled here and yon and still
Find that my wisdom does not fit the bill.
Perhaps I am a dunce beside that great
And thoughtful traveller of former estate.
But after seeing half the world in hand,

I find my vision is a narrow band,
And wisdom has gone knocking at a door
Where others live behind a well-filled
store.

I too have been in danger, but my brood
Of wisdom has not grown from being
crude.

13 The spirit of those who fear YHWH
Will live, for their hope is in view
Of Him who saves them *in their pew*.
14 He who fears YHWH will not be faint,
Nor play the coward to the taint
Of his hope. 15 Blessed is the soul
Of the man who fears YHWH *for goal!*
To whom does he look? Who helps him?
16 The eyes of YHWH do not grow dim
On those who love Him, a strong shield
And great support, a shelter wheeled
From the hot wind and a shade from
The noonday sun, a guard in sum
Against the stumbling and defence
Against falling. 17 He lifts up vents
Of the soul and gives eyes their light,
He grants life, healing, blessing bright.

Beloved, let me fear You and I shall live
In Your prosperity without a sieve.
The desert does not touch me where I stay
Beneath the Arctic tundra and the sway
Of fir and pine and birch in every way.
The sun is not a problem for its heat,
But still I take Your shield in my retreat.
I can do with the healing and the life
You provide for those who live without
strife,
And blessing is not something I reject,
Despite the way I return and reflect.
Beloved, the journey of the soul is tight,
And yet before Your throne all things are
right

Despite the coming and the shade of night.

18 If one sacrifice from what's been
Wrongfully obtained, it is sin,
The gifts of the lawless are not
Acceptable *in the Lord's plot*.
19 The Most High is not pleased to see
The offerings of the ungodly,
And He is not propitiated
For sins by crowds of offerings slated.

20 Like one who kills a son before
His father's eyes is the man's score
Who offers sacrifices rated
From the property of the poor.

The son that was killed before Father's
eyes
Is claimed to be the blessed Messiah's
prize.

The man was stolen from the upper room,
And from the garden to shut in the tomb,
And so if sacrifice the offering be,
It is not accepted eternally.

The dying and the cross cleanse not from
sin,

Despite the crowds who come to take it in.
The gift acceptable to You is just
The heart repentant and bowed to the dust.
The sin is cleansed by no blood shed, but
yet

Blotted out by the intercessor's set
Who raises holy hands before Your throne:
The prayers of Moses, Jesus, such atone.

21 The bread of the needy's the life
Of the poor, whoever in strife
Deprives them is a man of blood.

22 To take away a neighbour's food
Is to murder him, to deprive
An employee of his wage drive
Is to shed blood. 23 When one builds and
Another tears down, what's in hand
But toil? 24 When one prays and one
curses,

By whose voice will YHWH grant
disburses?

25 If a man washes after touch
Of corpse, and touches it again,
What has he gained by washing much?

26 So if a man fasts in his den
For his sins, and goes out again
And does the same things, who will hear
His prayer? And what will then appear
In gain by humbling in his fear?

The import of Ben Sirach is that when
One touches a corpse ablutions are then
In order. And he goes on for a spell
To say that fasting will atone as well
For sins repented of and put away.

That is too much for sweet Christians
today.

They have ablutions once at most in life
When they are baptized, but care not a fife
For touching corpses. Some may pray and
fast

In their repentance of their sins at last.
If they do, my Beloved, I lend my prayer
That such find Your forgiveness on the air,
And strength and hope to keep
commandments fair
Despite the torment of the sordid past.

Sirach 35

1 The one who keeps the law will make
Many offerings *of that law's sake*,
The one who heeds commandments will
Make peace offering sacrifice still.

2 He who returns a kindness now
Offers fine flour, and he whose brow
Gives alms sacrifices in thanks.

3 To keep from wickedness in ranks
Is pleasing to YHWH, and forsaking
The evil is atonement's making.

Ben Sirach is a lovely man to tell
The world what offerings are in truth to
spell:

They are not flour and wine or ox's blood,
Nor smoke and fire above the gory flood,
But keeping Your commandments in the
way,

And giving alms to the poor every day.

The slaying of a lamb, a bull or man
Is not the sacrifice of divine plan,
But the atonement is awakened when
A man forsakes the evil in his ken.
Beloved, with empty hand I come to You
Relinquishing all else to do the true,
And finding that true sacrifice is best,
The doing of the right before the test.

4 Do not appear before YHWH with
Empty hands, 5 for all things *from myth*
Must be done by commandment's call.

6 The offering laid in righteous pall
Anoints the altar, and its scent
Rises to please the Most High *bent*.

7 The sacrifice of righteous men
Is accepted, its memory then
Is not forgotten *as its meant*.

8 Glorify YHWH abundantly,
 And do not come to be stingy
 With the first fruits of your hands' fee.
 9 With every gift show cheerful face,
 And bring your tithe with gladness' trace.
 10 Give to the Most High as He's given,
 As generously as your hand's striven.
 11 For YHWH is the one who repays,
 Sevenfold He'll give you in stays.

I fail to count the benefit or loss
 Of giving in alms and charity's cross
 That I have got in hand since I was young.
 I fail to count in mind, finger or tongue.
 And so I merely trust, Beloved, that when
 I've given out in charities to men
 I have received the seven in return
 In everything I come to find and earn.
 If You, Beloved, repay the sevenfold,
 And I should be perfect like You when old,
 Then must I also give back with such hand
 Of generosity to evil band
 In vengeance for their gross iniquity?
 I think I'll leave off counting martyr's fee.

12 Don't offer Him a bribe, He'll not
 Accept it, and don't trust the plot
 Of an unrighteous sacrifice,
 For YHWH is the judge *to surplice*,
 And He is not partial *or nice*.
 13 He'll not be partial to the poor,
 But He will listen at the door
 To hear the prayer of one who's wronged.
 14 Supplication he'll not ignore,
 Not of the fatherless *who longed*,
 Nor of the widow come to pour
 Out her tale of oppression's woe,
And His response will not be slow.

Ben Sirach is so late a scribe that he
 Fringes on Jesus in the faithful spree
 And minds one of Muhammad for a while
 By speaking of the orphan without guile.
 The sacrifice that You regard the best
 Is the provision brought and to invest
 On behalf of the orphan in his pain
 And hopelessness before the royal reign.
 The one who comes before the orphan now
 With empty hands brings no offering
 somehow
 To You, Beloved, the offering of delight

Most often praised before Your throne of
 right.
 And yet, Beloved, You are not partial to
 Even the poor impoverished in pew.

15 Do not the tears of widow's run
 Down her cheek as she cries *in dun*
 Against him who has made them fall?
 16 He whose service is pleasing call
 To YHWH will be accepted, and
 His prayer will reach the clouds *and stand*.
 17 The humble prayer pierces the cloud,
 And he'll not have comfort allowed
 Until it reaches YHWH, he'll not
 Stop until the Most High is brought
 To visit him in justice for
 The righteous and judgement in score.
 18 And YHWH will not delay, nor will
 He be patient with them until
 He breaks the haunches of those who
 Have no mercy and pay the *crew*
Of nations with His vengeance *due*,
 Until He takes away the crowd
 Of insolence, and breaks the *proud*
 Sceptres that the unrighteous *spew*,
 19 Till He brings recompense upon
 The man according to *the spawn*
Of his deeds, and the works of men
 According to inventions' *den*,
 Till He judge the case of His folk
 And make them rejoice at *the stroke*
Of His mercy. 20 Mercy's welcome
 When he afflicts them as *the sum*
Of rain clouds in time of drought *glum*.

It's hard for men like me now in the wear
 And tear of schoolmen to take up the share
 Of faith that sacrifice and humble prayer
 Can pierce the clouds and relieve man of
 care.

Temptation's great to wonder what good
 will
 Rise from the prayer coming above the hill,
 For beyond clouds there are just empty
 space,
 And burning suns, and more clouds of the
 race
 Of stars as far as telescope can see.
 The universe seems big and harsh to me.
 But if the rain is answer from the sky,
 A divine word, a silver sort of sigh,

It is enough for doubters on the sea,
It is a ray from stout eternity.

Sirach 36

1 Have mercy upon us, O Lord,
The Alohim of all *adored*,
And look upon us. 2 May Your fear
Fall on all nations *far and near*.
3 Lift up Your hand against the crew
Of foreign nations, let them view
Your might. 4 As in us You have been
Made holy before them, so in
Them be You magnified to us.
5 And let them know You *glorious*,
As we have known that there is not
An Alohim but You in plot.
6 Show signs anew, and wonders more,
Make Your hand and right arm before
More glorious. 7 Pour out Your wrath,
Destroy the adversary's path
And wipe out the foe *from the lath*.

The hymn of Jesus ben Sirach is great
And beautiful to praise Your divine state
And show to all the wonders of Your reign
Over the earth, the hills, the floods and
plain.

I wonder that destruction's judgement
shows
The man Your holiness in people's throes,
As he imagines and hopes for his foes.
Today Your holiness is taught to mind
The welfare of the wealthy and the blind.
The populace is like to denigrate
You when an "act of God" comes on them
late.

Beloved, make Your hand generous with
hate
Or benefits, I see You concentrate
Your Being strange and unestranged at
gate.

8 Hasten the day, and mind the time,
And let the people *in their rhyme*
Recount Your mighty deeds *in mime*.
9 Let the survivor be consumed
In the fiery wrath *where he's doomed*,
And may those who harm Your folk meet
Destruction *in their own retreat*.
10 Crush the heads of the enemy
Rulers, who say "There's none to see

But we ourselves." 11 Gather the tribe
Of Jacob all, and so prescribe
Their heritage as at the start.
12 Have mercy, YHWH, upon the part
Of the folk called by Your name's art,
On Israel, whom You compare
To a first-born son. 13 Have a share
Of pity on the city where
Your sanctuary lies in care,
Jerusalem, place of Your rest.
14 Fill Zion with the feast and zest
Of Your wonders, Your temple by
The gleams of Your glory *to spy*.
15 Bear witness to those whom You did
Create in the start of the bid,
And fulfil the prophecies spoken
In Your name. 16 Reward *for a token*
Those who wait for You, let the call
Of your prophets be truth to all.
17 Hear, YHWH, *at last* Your servant's
prayer,
According to the blessing's share
Of Aaron for Your people, and
All who are on the earth in band
Will know that You are YHWH, and You
Are Alohim of ages' *view*.

I'm glad the prophet of old knew to curse
Your enemies as well as bless the nurse
Of Your commandments and the folk who
stray
Not in the by-paths of the evil way.
Today the curse is hidden under pile
Of protocol and tendered with a smile.
I much prefer the direct to the guile,
And so praise those who curse me for a
while.

Beloved, the human tongue in praise or sin
Is gone upon the winds after the win,
And there remains alone Your blessing due
On those who chant Your law in what they
do.

All know You as the one within the breast,
But only the wise seek You out of zest.

18 The stomach will take any food,
Yet one food's better than the crude.
19 As the tongue tastes the kinds of game,
So a clear mind detects false claim.
20 A perverse mind will just cause grief,
But men of experience' relief

Will pay him back. 21 A woman's lief
To accept any man, but one
Daughter is better than the dun.

22 A woman's beauty gladdens heart
Surpassing every human art.

23 If kindness and humility
Mark her speech, her husband is free,
Not like other men *in grief*. 24 He
Who acquires a wife gets his best
In possessions, an aid with zest
For him and pillar of support.

25 Where there is no fence to report,
The farm is plundered, where there's no
Wife a man sighs when on the go.

26 For who will trust a robber who
Is slick to go from shoe to shoe,
And town to town? So who will trust
A man who has no home, but must
Lodge wherever night finds his *dust*?

The home is where the wife is seems to be
The great invention of Ben Sirach's spree.
When I think on the proverb with some
care

I find that there's a strain of truth
somewhere

Within its folds of wisdom when laid bare.
And yet the man without a wife for good
Is smiled upon as every failure should,
Rather than pitied by the populace
For lack of home, hearth, comfort,
fireplace.

The only one who pities such a man
Is the free woman who takes him in span
And hitches him to her and the right plan.
Beloved, amid the sighing I give thanks
To be still among those dry on the planks.

Sirach 37

1 Every mate will say "I too am
A friend", but some mates *like the ram*
Are friends in name only and *scam*.

2 Is it not a grief to the death
When a mate and friend turns his breath
To enmity? 3 O evil thought,
Why were you formed to cover plot
With such deceit? 4 Some mates rejoice
In a companion's happy voice,
But when he's in trouble, their choice
Is against him. 5 Some friends stick by
Because of what their stomachs vie,

But in the face of battle take
The shield *against companion's stake*.

Beloved, I thank You as I thank all men
That few have been an enemy again
After the yoking of hearts each to each
In friendship human and within my reach.
The most of friends I've had are my friends
till

Or else they've been estranged by distance'
till

And top of time. But few live to become
Deceitful enemies to pound and hum.
The enemies I have are mostly those
Who hate me without knowing what I
chose,

Who never ate beside my table where
I cantillate Your holiness threadbare.
Beloved, I thank You that my low profile
Within Your heart protects me from some
guile.

6 Do not forget a friend in heart,
Be not unmindful of his part
In your wealth. 7 Every counsellor
Praises counsel, but some give shore
Of counsel in their own interest.
8 Be wary of a counsellor,
And learn first what is his interest,
For he will take thought of himself,
Lest he come out and play the elf
Against you 9 and say your way's good,
And then stand far off *in the wood*
To see what will happen to you.
10 Do not consult the ones who view
You with suspicion, though undue,
Hide your counsel from those who are
Jealous of you, a *shining star*.

They say advice is free, and so it may
Be somewhere in the house of peace and
fray,

But I have lived my youth with hardly
word

To tell me where the fortune is interred.
I've lived to find its paths in life alone,
With little of advice for heart or stone.
If counsellors, such ones I covet now
That should have aided me more in the
trough,

Are really such as Ben Sirach pretends,

Are foes dressed up in light and clothes of friends,

Then I am grateful that I've kept the way
Of counsel from Your heart alone to sway,
Even if it is slow to turn the mill,
And leads me not to wealth and fame to till.

11 Don't consult a woman about
Her rival or with coward *shout*
About war, or with a merchant
About barter or with a scant
Buyer about selling, or with
A stingy man about *the myth*
Of gratitude or with a man
Without mercy of kindness' span,
Or with an idler about work
Or with a man hired not to shirk
For a year about finishing
His job, with a lazy servant
About a big task and not scant,
Pay no attention to these in
Any matter of counsel bin.

12 But stay constantly with a man
Who's godly whom you know in scan
A keeper of commandments' plan,
Whose soul's in accord with your soul,
And who will sorrow if you fail
In caravan or under sail.

13 Establish your heart's counsel goal,
For none's more faithful to prevail
For you than it is. 14 A man's soul
Sometimes keeps him better informed
Than seven watchmen above stormed
Watchtower where they sit in toll.

My soul keeps me better informed, it's true,
Than the Watchtower society could do,
Not because human heart above all things
Is steeped in deceit of paupers and kings,
But because I turn my heart and anew
Each day and night to contemplate the true,
The ten commandments and Your face with rue.

The seven men who would surround my faith

With passles in the air of arm and wraith
Fail all before Your word on Sinai sung.
My foot is firmly placed upon the rung.
Beloved, watch from the tower of cloud
and fire

The swimming of Egyptians in the mire

While I praise You above the heavenly quire.

15 And besides all this come to pray
To the Most High and every day
That He may truly guide your way.
16 Reason is the start of each task,
And planning comes before the bask.
17 As a clue to changes of heart
18 Four turns of fortune have their part:
Good and evil, and life and death,
And it's the tongue that rules their breath.
19 A man may be shrewd and the teacher
Of many, yet unworthy preacher
To himself. 20 A man skilled in words
May be hated, he'll have no curds
To eat, 21 for grace was granted not
To him by YHWH, since he's no lot
Or portion in all wisdom got.

If reason is the start of every track
That leads to light and life after the flack,
Then every man I find behind my back
Has got the course before the heart to crack.

Reason is rather a slave of the one
Who thinks he knows the secrets of the bun
And forces her to testify with gun
That he is right in all things under sun.
Beloved, I turn to reason from the start
And poke my mind to wait there in the mart
Until she tells me where the moat is laid.
I see philosophies all on parade,
And find their reasons grand and always true,
When they but affirm the command from You.

22 A man may be wise to his profit,
And the fruits of his thoughts not scoff at
Trustworthiness on his own lips.

23 A wise man will instruct *the ships*
Of his own folk, and the fruits of
His understanding *from above*
Will be trustworthy. 24 A wise man
Will have praise heaped upon his span,
And all who see him call him blessed.
25 The life of a man is confessed
By days, but Israel's days are blessed
Without number. 26 He who is wise
Among his people will devise

To inherit their confidence,
 And his name will live *in their tents*
 For ever. 27 My son, test your soul
 While you live, see what's bad in toll
 For it and do not give it that.
 28 For not everything that is fat
 Is good for every one, and not
 Every person enjoys each pot.
 29 Do not have a lust for a thing
 Of luxury, and do not sing
 To give yourself up to eat food,
 30 For overeating brings the brood
 Of illness, and gluttony leads
 To nausea. 31 Many in their feeds
 Have died of gluttony, but he
 Who is careful to avoid spree
 Prolongs his life *eternally*.

The many lines of thought that curl the
 breeze
 In fetid and fervent philosophies
 Across the rise and fall of centuries
 Each have their due in human hope and
 tongue:
 They each are tasty to some old and young.
 You grant a reason as in fashioned dress
 For every personality to bless,
 And warn only against glutton's address.
 Beloved, the pot of every nation's sure
 And like to bring a blessing with the cure,
 But what is common to all men to stand
 Or not, is adherence to Your command.
 The recipes are wonderful diverse,
 But without common salt are merely curse.

Sirach 38

1 Honour the physician with what
 Honour is due the man *and butt*,
 According to your need of him,
 For YHWH also created him,
 2 For healing comes from the Most High,
 And He will receive a gift by
 The hand of king. 3 The skill *to try*
 Of the physician lifts his head,
 And in great men's presence he's led.
 4 The Lord created medicines
 From the earth, and a man that wins
 Will not despise them in their bins.
 5 Was not water made sweet with tree
 In order that His power be
 Made known? 6 And He gave skill to men

That He be glorified again
 In his marvellous works to ken.
 7 By them He heals and takes away
 Pain, 8 the pharmacist in his way
 Makes of them a compound to sway.
 His works will never be done here,
 And from Him health will then appear
 Upon the face of the earth *near*.

For pain and thinning blood the willow
 bark,
 For tumours burdock root and the root stark
 Of turkey rhubarb, for the pains of flu
 The boneset, and the camomile for rue,
 Valerian to calm to sleep and start,
 The hawthorn berry for the pain in heart,
 The huckleberry for the stomach's art,
 And black tea for its pains and runs and
 fart.
 Beloved, I take the chickweed on the
 tongue
 And sorrel too for taste as well as sung
 Health, and the dandelion and the score
 Of fireweed and of nettle on the sore.
 The lady's mantle helps the lady too,
 And plantain keeps the cuts from biting
 crew.

9 My son, when you are sick do not
 Be negligent, but pray YHWH's lot,
 And He will heal you *on the spot*.
 10 Give up your faults and so direct
 Your hands aright, and cleanse select
 Your heart from all sins *that affect*.
 11 Offer sweet-smelling sacrifice,
 Memorial portion of fine, nice
 Flour, and pour oil on your offering,
 As much as you afford to bring.
 12 And give the physician his place,
 For YHWH created healing race,
 And let him not leave you to face
 Your need without him *and his grace*.
 13 There is a time when success lies
 In the hands of physicians' guise,
 14 For they too will pray to YHWH that
 He should grant them success out flat
 In diagnosis and in cure,
 For sake of preserving life sure.
 15 He who sins before his Maker,
 May he fall in physician's care.

My father once when I was just a child
Was diagnosed with MS in the wild
And found it struck him down so that his
feet

No longer carried him about his beat.
He laid a sacrifice and prayer to You
As well as going to the doctor's view,
Until surprise to all around his pew
You healed him and raised him to walk and
do.

Beloved, I do believe the Word You sent
Is also medicine when men relent
And come in faith and spirit to repent.
Beloved, I've seen some rise to walk again,
And others die in faith as of brave men,
And never understood what You had
meant.

16 My son, let your tears for the dead
Flow, and lament with bitter dread.
Lay his body with honour due
And don't neglect the burial pew.

17 Let your weeping be bitter and
Your wailing fervent, come to stand
In mourning by his merit grand,
One day or two, till none complain,
Then be comforted once again.

18 For sorrow leads to death, and grief
Of heart drains the strength for relief.

19 Catastrophes maintain the way
Of sorrow, and the life of grey
By the poor man weighs down his heart.

20 Do not give your heart to the part
Of sorrow, drive it from the start,
Remembering the end of life.

21 Do not forget, there is no fife
To call back from death to the strife,
You do the dead no good, and you
Injure yourself *by grief and rue*.

22 "Mind my doom, for yours is the same,
Yesterday it was mine in game,
Today it's yours *as is your due*."

Some hearts believe that sorrow gives more
worth

To the life that's departed from the earth,
And longer the eye weeps, greater the
weight

Of honour to both living and the late.
Some hearts believe attachment is the
wrong,

And true love is a flight above the song
Of grief and tears that mingle with the
throng
Of earthly darks and deeps, weighted and
strong.

Beloved, I hide in You both happiness
And sorrow, yet the grief of my address.
I find the searing tear of death pulls down,
And yet I fly above it in the town,
To find the pace of my departure known
In quietness where I seem all alone.

23 When the dead is at rest, let cease
His remembrance, comfort's release
Fill you for him when his breath goes.

24 The wisdoms of the scribe repose
On leisure changes in their rows,
And he who has but little way
In business may find wisdom's ray.

25 How can he become wise who takes
The plough and glories for the sakes
Of a rod, who drives oxen down,
Is busy with their toil *and brown*,
And only talks of bulls *in crown*?

26 He sets his heart on ploughing rows,
Is careful of fodder he chose
For the heifers *of his he knows*.

27 So too is every craftsman and
Master workman whose labours stand
By night as well as by day, those
Who cut the signets of seals' glows,
Each is diligent in the toils
Of all kinds, he sets heart for spoils
On painting a lifelike image,
Careful to finish his work sage.

28 So too is the smith at the weight
Of anvil, intent on his plate
Of iron, the breath of fire may melt
His flesh, and with what he had felt
He wastes away in furnace heat,
He inclines his ear to the beat
Of the hammer, and his eyes are
On the form of the object star.

He sets his heart on getting done
Careful of finishing and spun.

29 So too is the potter who sits
At his work and turning the skits
Of his wheel with his feet, so he
Is always concerned with the free
Speed of his toil, and so he counts
His product in growing amounts.

30 He moulds the clay with his arm and
 Makes it soft with his feet to stand,
 He sets his heart on finished glaze,
 Careful to clean the furnace trays.
 31 All these rely upon their hands,
 And each is skilful in his bands.
 32 Without them a city cannot
 Be set, men living with no plot
 There nor finding a share in lot.
 33 But they are not sought for advice
 By the folk, they do not suffice
 To gain high standing in the crowd
 Of the people gathered allowed.
 They do not sit in judge's seat,
 Nor do they understand to mete
 Out sentence of judgment, they don't
 Expound discipline and they won't
 Know justice, nor proverbs' way sweet.
 34 But they keep stable the world's web,
 Their prayer's in their trade's flow and ebb.

The followers of good Muhammad came
 Not realizing to their awkward shame
 That prayer is more than bowing at the
 flame

And standing toward the temple of Your
 name.

The followers of good Muhammad share
 The Jewish and the Christian hope of
 prayer,

But none of the three know that everywhere
 The hand is on the plough, the wheel, the
 bare

Hoe and the hammer, You are present
 there.

Beloved, my prayer is the breath that I take
 As I return from market to the stake
 Of life where hand had once bent down to
 shake

The earthly toil. Each action in the wake
 Of life is prayer, if life at all's a cake.

Sirach 39

1 But he who devotes his days to
 The study of the law *in view*
 Of the Most High will seek *out word*
 Of wisdom of the ancients *stirred*,
 And ponder prophecies *for clue*.

2 He'll keep the speech of noble men
 And penetrate subtleties' *den*
 Of parables, 3 he will seek out

The hidden meanings *without doubt*
 Of proverbs and be at home with
 Parables' obscurities' myth.

4 He'll *surely* serve among great men
 And appear before rulers' ken,
 He'll travel throughout foreign lands,
 For he tests the good and the stands
 Of evil among men. 5 He'll set
 His heart to rise early and yet
 To seek YHWH who made him, and will
 Make petition before the hill
 Of the Most High, he'll open lips
 In prayer and make petitions' sips
 For his sins and his errors.

6 If the great Lord is willing, he
 Will be filled with the spirit free
 Of understanding, he'll pour out
 Words of wisdom and *with a shout*
 Give thanks to YHWH in prayer about.

7 He will direct his counsel and
 Knowledge aright, and ponder grand
 Secrets of His *throughout the land*.

The three sources of knowledge in the way:
 The law, the prophets, and the writings
 sway

Are mentioned in the lines that drew the
 flame

Of Ecclesiasticus for the game
 Of catechumens all dress up to learn
 The way of righteousness and how to earn
 The bliss of paradise. Beloved, discern
 The wisdom of mankind in act and aim.
 I rise, Beloved, before the light of day,
 At least in winter with the snow to pay,
 And seek You early as I come to pray.
 The search is never weary, You are found
 Before the jugular is up and bound.
 The secret is too near to leave the ground.

8 He'll show instruction in his teaching,
 And glory in YHWH's Torah's pact.
 9 Many will praise his wisdom preaching,
 Never will it turn out unstacked.
 His memory will not disappear,
 His name will live as ages rear.
 10 Nations will publish his wisdom,
 And the assembly praise *in sum*,
 11 If he lives long, he'll leave a name
 Greater than a thousand *in fame*,
 And if at last he goes to rest,

It is enough he's done *his best*.

The more, Beloved, I devote my days to
The study of Your Torah, it is true
That my name wanes and becomes less
account
Beside the cobblestones and market fount.
If I had sought the ways of fame I might
Have built myself a monument in sight,
But that was never my intention here.
And yet I find the promise insincere.
Beloved, I do not need a thousand grand
In reputation on the shifting sand,
But I point out the wicked promise made
Since very opposite comes in parade.
I am content alone before Your throne
To turn from flesh and tears to whiting
bone.

12 I still have more to say, which I
Have pondered, and to satisfy
Like the moon at full *in the sky*.
13 Hear me, you holy sons, and bud
Like a rose growing by the flood,
14 Send forth fragrance like frankincense,
And put out blossoms like the tents
Of a lily. Scatter the scents,
And sing a hymn of praise, bless YHWH
For all His works, 15 ascribe the due
Majesty to His name and give
Thanks to Him with praise, and so live
With songs on your lips, and with lyres,
And you shall say this in the quires
Of thanksgiving, 16 "All things are
YHWH's

Works, for they're very good *in views*,
And whatever He orders will
Be done when His time shall fulfil."
17 None can say "What is this?" "Why
that?"

For in God's time all things have sat.
At His word waters stood in heap,
And the reservoirs of the deep
At the word of His mouth to keep.
18 At His command whatever please
Him is done, and no one can freeze
His saving power. 19 The works of all
Flesh are before Him, and none mesh
In hiding from His eyes *of flesh*.
20 From everlasting to all time
He sees them, and there is no clime

That is a marvel in His sight.
21 None can say "What is this?" "Why
that?"

For everything's created right.
22 His blessing covers the dry flat
Like a river, and drenches it
Like a flood. 23 The nations are fit
To incur His wrath, just as He
Turns fresh water into salt sea.

I too have much to say, Beloved, as I
Look out upon the coldly winter sky
Of morning where the colours bend to left
And streaming right sink in the frozen cleft.
I too have much to say in praise to You
For consciousness of frost instead of dew,
Of stillness on the snow, the crack of tree,
The slighting groan above eternity.
Prosaically my booted feet crunch out
The punctuation of my round-about
Left for the hounds to sniff and for a doubt
Rejoice and then pass on to pay no heed
To what I may or may not have in deed,
To when I may or may not be devout.

24 To the holy His ways are straight,
Just as they are walls to the rate
Of wicked men. 25 From the start good
Things were made for righteous manhood,
Just as evil things for the hood.
26 The necessary for man's life
Are water, fire, and iron for fife,
And salt, and flour and milk and honey,
Grape juice and oil and clothing's *money*.
27 For the good all these things are good,
But they turn evil for the hood.

I must not be a holy man below
Your countenance, for I am very slow
To see straight paths in all the ways You
go.

Instead I see the thicket run about
In crooked maze for rabbit's silent shout,
The turn and twist of trail by boulder lent
The form of the dog's hind-leg brown and
bent.

Instead I see all zig-zags and the braise
Of ice cracked on the barrel in a craze
Of colours and of splintered fingers there.
There is no straightness even in the air.
The firs and birches at my window frame,

For all their straightness, have no tear or
shame
To crook and crack even under heaven's
stare.

As there are ten commandments that
express
The whole duty of mankind and confess
The wonders of Your power and
sovereignty,
So there are ten things of necessity
For humankind to live and bank the fee.
Water and fire and iron and salt and flour,
The milk and honey, grape juice and the
dour
Dress seem both biased by culture and less
Than truth. I mean an acorn and a bean
Or walnut or at least a fish in seine
Seem to my mind like necessary guess.
Perhaps You're right, Beloved, You know
the mess.
I could ask confirmation from someone
Who knows nutrition or what fashion's
done.

28 Some storm winds were made to
avenge,
Which in their fury can unhenge
The mountains. In catastrophe
They spend their force in anger's spree
Appeasing their Maker for free.
29 In His treasure-house also's kept
For the right time fire and hail swept,
Famine and sickness, and wild beast,
30 The scorpion, vipers increased,
Venging sword to annihilate
The sinners. 31 When they keep His state
They take joy in their tasks in rate.
32 So from the start I took my stand
And wrote down my subject at hand.
33 All works of Alohim are good,
He fills every need as He should.
34 There is no reason to complain,
"This is not good as that in wane."
For everything comes in its time
To show its proper prose and rhyme.
35 So with heart full of joy proclaim
The righteous blessing on the name
Of the One who's holy *in fame*.

I too take joy, Beloved, in the storm cloud

That breaks upon my mind and shouts
aloud
Against my neighbour and against the
crowd
Of Lutherans and Pentecostals loud
Who shout their way against Your law and
name.
I too take joy to speak the bitter claim
Against the sinner and the craven brood
That make society I see so crude.
Ten simple words direct all humankind,
And yet there are so few not crass and blind
Who drive their lives according to Your
law.
I rejoice in the vengeance of Your claw.
The thunder and the rushing rain appears
An ecstasy drowning all human tears.

Beloved, You made man gifts of life to
please
With the half score of sweet necessities.
But vengeance that is stoked is less than
these
By two. And that shows the ratio's degrees
Of how You are more gracious than a
threat.
I myself would be more destroyer met
Than You, who wake each morning with
the bet
Of how far beyond Jupiter Your light
Might trace its dancing way before the
night.
Ten things You give to humankind to sway
Him to walk in the grace of mercy's way,
And only eight things lie in store for need
In case man lives in cruelty and greed.
Beloved, I lay hold on Your grace for
creed.

Sirach 40

1 A burden of care God has set,
A heavy yoke on all men met,
From the time that a man is born
To the day he returns *outworn*
To all creatures' mother *forlorn*.
2 His cogitations and the fear
In his heart and omens appear
Till the day he lies *on his bier*,
3 Whether he sits upon the throne
Or lies in dust and ashes blown,
4 Whether he wears a sparkling crown

Or gathers a rough woollen gown,
 5 His thoughts are wrath and envy's tread,
 Troubled about and full of dread
 Terror of death, raging conflict.
 He seeks his bed for rest untricked
 And finds nightmares to fill his head.
 6 His brief rest seems like none at all,
 Striving in dreams as in day's pall,
 Frightened by figments of the mind,
 Like one pursued and running blind,
 7 Till he grasps safety and awakens
 Amazed no danger threatens *bacons*.
 8 So it is with all creatures made,
 Both human and beast on parade,
 But for sinners seven times in grade.

It's true that dog and man both dream in
 sleep
 And flee the fierce pursuer and the keep
 To waken crazed and tired upon the shore
 Of dawn to lap a drink and bolt the door.
 But is it true the nightmare is a rage
 Of seven times hotter fire in pilgrimage
 Of sinners? There is no research to cast
 A light on quantity of the half-mast.
 Beloved, my dreams do not surpass the
 way
 That rage around me on the earth would
 play
 Against both righteous and against the
 poor,
 And I wake up to find the dream is sure.
 I mind my lot, if that is innocence,
 Thankful to find no greater in my tents.

9 Pestilence, bloodshed, wrath and sword,
 Plunder and ruin *of the horde*,
 Famine and death, 10 For wicked ones
 These were created evil stuns,
 And they themselves bring on the guns.
 11 All from the earth returns thereto,
 And what's from above goes there too.
 12 The profit gained from unjust bribes
 Will be blotted out *from the tribes*,
 But faithfulness always transcribes.
 13 Wealth caught from wickedness is like
 A flash-flood in arroyo's spike,
 A heavy stream beneath the clash
 Of lightning and the thunder's crash.
 14 It rises and carries the stone,
 But suddenly is gone as flown.

How well, Beloved, You have described in
 times
 Past the stock market and its ripened limes!
 The money writ in paper forms comes in
 With a rejoicing 'most as sweet as sin,
 And after all the blather and the din
 Ekes out again and leaves one high and dry,
 Another floundering beneath the sky.
 Beloved, I seek my treasures in the law
 Of Your lips spoken on Sinai, not straw
 Of excess fodder or wine in the trough.
 Catastrophe is the result of all
 The striving to get more stuff on the ball
 Than is due to each one born in the race
 Of humankind scattered about the place.

15 The bud of violence will not
 Blossom and flourish in the spot,
 Because the godless root is set
 On rock *and not the loam's deep net*.
 16 Or they're like reeds beside the stream,
 Withered before all plants that seem,
 17 But goodness will never be struck,
 And justice endures through the muck.
 Wealth or wages can make life sweet,
 But better than both is the treat
 Of finding treasure *at one's seat*.
 18 Offspring or a town founded may
 Establish one's name for a day,
 But better than either in stray
 Is to attain to wisdom's way.

Jesus the sweet quoted this proverb when
 He spoke of the sower who came again
 To scatter seeds upon the stony ground.
 It was a joke, I guess, because I've found
 That those who sow don't miss the fertile
 mound,
 But scatter well and evenly up to
 But not including path and stone and slew.
 Force as an argument is the fair way
 That Rome always hides its plans from the
 gay,
 But even the Scholastics on their bent
 Of logic knew its fallacy and sent
 Their students back to syllogisms' pent.
 Force seems, Beloved, the best plan to all
 men
 Who rule, but there's a way to death again.

19 Sheepcotes and orchards bring the rife
 Health in prosperity *for strife*,
 Better than either's a good wife.
 20 Wine and music delight the soul,
 But better is a couple's toll.
 21 The flute and harp sing graciously,
 But better's a tongue truthfully.
 22 Grace and beauty delight the eye,
 But better than either to spy
 Flowers that in the meadow lie.
 23 Both friend and neighbour are good
 guides,
 But none like a prudent wife bides.

Like Solomon before him, Ben Sirach
 Knows that a good wife gives a man his
 slack.

He sets her above cattle and the fruit
 Of orchards growing in season from root,
 Above both wine and music in the boot,
 Above the cello, piano and the flute.
 He knows a wife is better than a friend
 Or neighbour, even one that comes to send
 His help and gear before trouble can bend.
 Beloved, the Oriental kind of mind
 Dotes on the queen of heart and may be
 blind,

And yet the barren stones of northern reach
 Have no recourse other than the same
 peach.

It's something every man learns each to
 each.

24 A brother is a helper in
 The times of trouble's perigrine,
 But better than either is that
 Charity that rescues *the cat*.

25 Silver and gold's security
 Is every man's hope in the way,
 But better than either in fee
 Is sound judgement *upon the day*.

26 Wealth and strength build up
 confidence,

But better than either's the fence
 Of fear in Alohim. YHWH's fear
 Leaves nothing in deficit's rear,
 And the one who has that need seek
 No other comfort *for the weak*.

27 God's fear's a garden of the blessed,
 Its shelter is shining with rest.

28 My son, don't live a beggar life,

Better to die than beg *to fife*.

29 When someone has to depend on
 Another table, his life's drawn.
 The neighbour's sweets bring but disgust
 To the spirit of one who must
 Understand the inside of trust.

30 The tongue of shameless men find sweet
 The word of begging in the street,
 But the discerning man finds it
 A burning fire on tongue to sit.

Fear of starvation sends a man to greet
 The stranger with a kiss upon the street,
 In hope that bread and wine may come his
 treat.

Fear of You only, my Beloved, strokes law
 Of the commandments held before Your
 awe.

Six days of labour for fodder and straw
 Suffice to bring the joy of Sabbath's strain,
 When sustenance is given in the grain.

The day of double manna comes each week
 To bless all men, and yet there is a streak
 Of dying by starvation of the meek.

I am not meek, Beloved, but just so my
 Rulers, if they should notice my fine cry,
 Would starve me without turning, without
 sigh.

Sirach 41

1 O death! How bitter is the thought
 Of you to the man who is brought
 To peace among wealth and lot,
 For the man in success and ease,
 Who still enjoys life as he please!

2 O death! How sweetly comes your blow
 On weak men whose strength fails to go,
 Who totter and are sent out slow,
 With no more sight or hope to know!

3 Do not fear death's decree for you,
 Remember it took those of crew
 Before you and will come to view
 For those after you *in the pew*.

4 So has God ordained for all flesh,
 Then why should you reject out fresh
 The will of the Most High? If one
 Has lived a thousand years when done,
 A hundred or ten, in the world
 Below he has no life unfurled.

Death has three faces in the human show:

The face of fear and dread to those who glow
 Still in the false belief that life is sweet;
 The face of gratitude for those who meet
 Death as a saviour from the troubled feet;
 And last of all the face of trust and joy
 That You, Beloved, who set the bounds
 Troy,
 Give no decree to Your own children here
 But what is best despite the pain and tear.
 Death has three faces, cursèd Trinity,
 That freezes hearts that should be turned to
 Thee.
 But You, Beloved, have one face where I
 flee,
 Toward You or away, I always see
 The haven of creation and the free.

6 A wicked generation are
 The children of sinners for star,
 And senseless spawn are in the tents
 Of wickedness *in their presence*.
 6 Dominion's lost to sinners' sons,
 Reproach falls on their spawn *in tons*.
 7 The children curse their wicked dad,
 Through him disgrace is what they've had.
 8 Woe to you, O sinful men tossed,
 Who make the Most High's law one lost.
 9 If you have sons, catastrophe
 Will fall on them, you beget wee
 Only for sighing in degree.
 When you totter, they laugh for joy,
 When you die, you are curses' toy.
 10 Whatever's of nought must return
 To nought, so too the godless earn
 From emptiness *and left to burn*.
 11 Man's body is a fleeting thing,
 But a name of virtue will ring
 Forever *and beyond death's sting*.
 12 Take care of your name, it will stand
 By you better than treasures grand.
 13 The boon of life's for days in count,
 But a good name's for the amount
 Of days without number to stand.

It's easy said to take care of one's name,
 But this world that we live in is a shame
 Of destruction of every name that's fair,
 And elevation of the vile with care.
 Beloved, I have no name at all but that
 One name that I receive from Father flat,

Your name of grace and mercy, and the
 store
 Of judgement on the wicked threshing
 floor.
 The word of every man, whether in hope
 Of telling truth or falsehood, has in scope
 The limitations of the human mind
 Well as the potential to be unkind.
 Beloved, in every name by which I stand
 I find nothing of good but at Your hand.

14 My sons, listen to what I say
 About shame, judge of disgrace' sway
 Only by the law of my hand.
 For it is not always command
 To be ashamed, nor is it right
 Always to blush at every sight.
 15 Before your father and your mum
 Be ashamed of immoral hum,
 Before master and mistress blush
 To tell a lie, *but rather hush*.
 16 Before a prince and king have shame
 To speak with flattery in claim,
 Before the public assembly,
 Have shame for any crime's degree.
 17 Before a friend, before a mate,
 Be ashamed of disloyal rate,
 And breaking an oath or pact's state.
 18 Be ashamed of theft by the folk
 Where you have settled *under yoke*,
 And of stretching your elbow out
 When dining *at the table stout*.
 19 Take shame when you refuse to lend,
 When you defraud another friend.
 20 Shame when you fail to greet one who
 Has been so friendly to greet you.
 21 Shame staring at a married wench,
 And having thoughts to keep in trench
 About another's wife, to take
 In trifle a servant girl's cake,
 To violate her bed *and stake*.
 22 Shame on harsh words used among
 friends,
 And after giving gifts for ends
 Following them with insults' bends.
 23 Shame on you when you spread a tale,
 Revealing secrets under veil.
 24 These are the things that you should
 take
 As shameful for the people's sake,
 So you might walk in favour's wake.

These ten commandments of shame here
declare

The things that should not be seen on the
air.

All fit in jealousy to keep the share
Of custom and of law of which beware,
But one, that's taking of a servant girl
Who has no refuge from the master's curl.
Some Muslims seem to think the Qur'an
gives

The right to take a servant girl who lives
By the same tent. This cannot be the
meaning

Of the Qur'an, because it would be
screening

Away Ben Sirach's word direct and true.
Marriage and proper such is what is due
By word of good Muhammad. I draw back
From taking what is in my power and slack.

Sirach 42

1 But do not be ashamed of these
And sin by human ways to please:
2 Of the Most High's law and His word,
Or judgement passed on sinful herd;
3 Of sharing costs of enterprise
Or a journey *among the wise*;
Or of dividing heritage
Or property in the right wage;
4 Of accurate scales in the mart,
Of tested measures and their art;
5 Of earning much or little store,
Of bargaining at merchant's door;
Of training sons in the right way,
Beating a slave to make obey;
6 Of a lock to keep erring wife
At home, a lock against *the strife*
Of many hands put to the knife;
7 Of numbering each profit's store,
Recording transactions and more;
8 Of punishment for silly fools,
Or old and sick in life's hard schools.
So you'll be wary before men
Who shall all know you're wise *in den*.

I've learned to bargain a bit in my time,
And yet I wonder at the fitting rhyme
Of bargaining today with those who sit
Upon the edge of refugee camps knit
To sell a scrap or corner or a bit

Of metal to the passer-by and fit.

Is there a sale where bargaining is not
A righteous way to fulfil every plot?
Some say that it is legal when agreed
Upon by both the one caught up in greed
And the merchant who sells in desperate
need.

Beloved, I'm glad that You have not made
me

Interpreter of Your law on the free,
Even if I translate Your word in spe.

9 A daughter is a treasure that
Keeps her father awake *on mat*,
And worrying about her keeps
His rest away from where he sleeps,
For fear she shall not get a man,
And when she does and if she can,
That she'll be hated in her plan.
10 Unmarried, that she'll be seduced,
Or as a wife she'll be reduced
To unfaithfulness; that she might
Conceive in her dad's house at night
Or be barren in her man's sight.
11 Keep a close watch on daughter so
She'll not make you a joke to foe,
A proverb in the town, a warning
Among the folk, object of scorning
In the assembly. Make sure there
Is not lattice in her room's share,
No window that looks on the street.
12 Let her not set her charms like treat
Before men, or spend time to greet
Married women; 13 for just as come
Moths from the wool, so harm in sum
To women comes from women's hum.
14 Better the harshness of a man
Than spoiling a woman in plan,
Better a frightened daughter than
A disgrace *in the public scan*.

Ben Sirach's way of treating women seems
To find recourse mainly in Arab dreams,
The locked room and the darkened way in
keeping
Both virgin and the erring one from
sleeping
With neighbour man or robber on the
street.

Ben Sirach sees women just as men's treat.
Is there no fear that sons may be seduced

By weird and woeful older ones secluded?
If boys can go to play without a chain,
Then why not girls too without pain on
pain?

Beloved, the fear in human hearts is much,
And harried and unburied in the clutch
Of circumstance. I see the coloured dress
Of women at the well, hear laughter's
guess.

15 Now I'll remember God's great acts,
What I have seen, I'll show the facts.
At God's word were His works brought
out,

They do His will and without doubt.

16 As the sunrise is seen by all,
So YHWH's glory fails not to fall
On all He's done. 17 Yet God's saints too
Fail in justice to acts of YHWH,

17 Though God has given them work to do
As crowds to stand firm in their crew
Before His glory *in their pew*.

18 He searches depths, opens to view
The heart; their innermost He knows.

The Most High has all knowledge pose,
And sees from ancient times the things
That are to come in future's wings.

19 He makes known the past and the rate
Of what's to come, opens the gate
Of deepest secrets *to relate*.

20 No understanding does He lack,
Nothing at all escapes His knack.

21 Often returning in its power
Is His almighty wisdom's hour,
He is from all eternity

One and the same *without degree*.

22 With nothing added or subtracted,
He needs no counsellor enacted.

23 How beautiful are all His works,
Even the glimpse of shining quirks!

24 All things live and abide in time,
Each in its purposed place and clime.

25 Each is unique, yet none in vain,
Each is good in its turn and plain,
Can their glory then ever wane?

The theological attributes waken
In Ben Sirach's words stoked and then out-
shaken.

You are omnipotent by His account,
Omniscient too, Revealer on the mount,

Eternal, One, Unchanging and the same,
Without attributes added for Your fame
And none subtracted in an evil game.
So Ben Sirach stands firmly in the view
Of attributes unadded by the crew,
Agreeing with the Shi'ite part and pew
That what You are is not in parts, but You.
Beloved, I fail to understand the start
And end of theological in art,
But take Your blessing as my worthy part.

Sirach 43

1 The shining dome of sky is bright
Like heaven itself with glory's light.

2 The dazzling globe of sun to rise
Is the Most High's work in the skies.

3 At noon it bakes the earthly ground,
And who can bear its fire around?

4 Like flaming oven of hard steel,
Igniting mountains in its keel,
Its arrows fired burn up the land,
The eyes are blinded by its hand.

5 Great is YHWH indeed who made it
To whip its chariot horses fit.

The countdown of the gods upon the sky
Ben Sirach sets in order by and by,
Beginning with the sun unnamed to vie,
Aware that men still worship light and
power.

Its flaming hands he sees where shadows
cower,

And men seek relief from the life and
flower

That wells up in the solar song and hour
To set at last where evening purples creep.

Beloved, I see the waning and new birth,
I see the cycles of the sun and earth,
And realize their Maker does not sleep.

I turn away from burning altar's weight
And feel the cool of Your presence come
late

And plunge into the fine, refreshing deep.

6 The moon marks also seasons' round
In cycled sign upon the ground.

7 By it we know feast days and dates
Fixed by the waning of its gates.

8 Its name shows how each month renews,
How marvellous this course in cues!

These words do not resolve the issues yet,
How calendars are calculated high
On moons or suns or stars against the sky
Made clear by cycles almost to the fret.
As I follow the wane of moon I've met
Stout promises of days and weeks as sly
Moments accounted and arrayed as by
Computers stacked as high as the hills get.
Elated by the silver sickle's shroud,
Lounging two weeks upon the waxing
cloud,

While the moon rises, the illusion's right
Among the stars made calendar of night.
I shake off the illusion and I find
No better than the Jubilee can bind.

9 The gloried beauty of the skies
Is the stars arrayed in such wise
To shine upon great heights and rise.
10 At His word they follow their track
And in their guard they're never slack.
A shield against flood waters stored
On High, lighting the sky *adored*,
11 See how the rainbow *sends its cord*.
So praise its Maker, for indeed
It is a splendour majestied.
12 It arches on the sky with light,
This bow bent by God's hand of might.
13 His word defines the lightning's way,
And sends arrows on judgement day.
14 At the sign the storehouse lies wide,
The clouds like vultures cease to hide.
15 With glory He grants storms their power
And casts down hailstones in their hour.
16 The sound of His voice makes the earth
Tremble, before His power the berth
Of mountains shakes *for all its worth*.
17 By His command the south winds rise,
The wrath of the north wind in skies,
The hurricane and storm's reprise.
18 He scatters the snow like a flock
Of birds aflutter, come to dock
Like swarms of locusts *on the rock*.
19 Its shining whiteness blinds the eyes,
The thoughts are choked to see it rise.
20 He shakes out frost on earth like salt,
It glitters like flowers without fault
Upon the thorn bush *where it lies*.
21 Out from the north He sends cold blast
That turns standing waters to last
As ice. He freezes every lake,

Arrays each pool in armour's stake.

The primitive of humankind sets store
Upon the rainbow guiding to the door
Of universe, of fortress, and the safe:
And so concreteness is the hope of waif.
In wisdom of new science I have come
To find the rainbow in its size and sum
So unsubstantial that the steel and smoke
Of shield and weapon both fell down and
broke.

If what I thought were binding cords in
youth
And columns so immoveable as truth
Turn out to be just passing light and hue,
It does not mean that I must turn from You.
Reality, no matter what the cake,
Is true and truth is always for Your sake.

22 When mountain meadows scorch with
heat,
And flowering plains as in flames' beat,
23 Drops from the clouds bring life again,
The scattered dew awakes the glen.
24 His is the plan that calms the deep,
And sets the islands' rock and steep.
25 Those who venture down to the sea
Tell parts of it in history,
And we who listen thunderstruck
26 Hear of His creatures in their luck,
Horrendous in size to amaze,
All living things, monsters to craze.
27 From Him each angel finds the way,
All His commands comes to obey.
28 There's nothing left at all to say
Except He's over all in sway.

Ephemeral in life, I stand amazed
By the mere counting of the harvest crazed
And cracking patterns of the islands set
West of Ecuador in the oceanette.
Galapagos is born volcanic age,
Each island spreading out in a white page
Where You write sentences in heritage,
Then send the rock away toward the east
And take another from the womb of beast.
When will Your correspondence end at last
As the first messages that were out cast
Sink back into the sea? You shake Your
skirts,

Adjust Your hair, think main course and
desserts,
And turn to the tasks of a day that starts.

29 Let us praise Him above, since we
Cannot fathom His depths or see
The extent of His poetry.
30 Awesome is YHWH in majesty,
And wonderful His potency.
31 Lift up your voices to praise YHWH,
Though He's beyond your praise to do.
32 Exalt Him as with strength renewed,
Do not be weary though unviewed
Lies the bound *of His multitude*.
33 For who can see Him and describe?
Who can raise up a diatribe
As He is, *not as sees His brood*?
34 Much beyond this lies secret store,
Only few of His works outpour
Before our eyes, *around our door*.
35 YHWH only has made all things be,
To those who live in His fear He
Gives wisdom *of eternity*.

The seas that fill the immense hole that I
Dig on the shore with spade and pail
comply
With the great rule of universe that You
Set in motion by Your creation's stew.
The synergistic train of science goes
On with the generations of my toes
Crinkling the sand and arming me with
thoughts
Of cold and wet, or hot and dry in pots.
Beloved, the sciences that extend out
From human heights may in their furthest
doubt
Attain to fleeting and a mystic cry
Of some seagull that rises up to fly
And then resettles on the unseen wave
Of Your eternity and my lost grave.

Sirach 44

1 Now I will praise those godly men,
Our ancestors, each in his den.
2 Abundant glory of the lot
Of the Most High, His own part sought
From ancient times. Those who subdued
In royal rate ancient men crude
In their might *and their multitude*.
3 Or advisers in wisdom's grasp,

Or prophets of all things in gasp,
4 Stalwart princes among the folk,
And rulers with their staves to stroke,
Writers of skill in epigrams,
5 Composers of Psalms in their drams,
Discourers on poetic themes,
6 Stout men established on their dreams,
At peace on their own land *it seems*.
All these were honoured in their time,
7 And famous in their place and clime.

I too praise ancient men and women too,
But most of all the Psalm-composing crew.
At least two women wrote Psalms still in
view:
Hannah and Deborah, heroines true.
I too honour those who in times gone past
Kept Your law and repented when they cast
Outside the things permitted while they
last.
To sing and do are what men were made
for.
Beloved, I look back on the past in store
And recognize the heroes on Your floor.
Some fought and some resigned, but all
were blessed
To do the words You spoke and they
confessed.
Mind those today who follow in their wake
And bide within Your law for Your own
sake.

8 Some of them were renowned and men
Still tell of what they did again.
9 Others were forgotten at death,
As though they had not drawn a breath,
They and their offspring in their den.
10 Yet those were also godly men
Whose virtues have not been forgot,
11 Whose wealth remains in family plot,
Inherited by offspring's lot.
12 Their family goes on and on
Through God's promise made from the
dawn.
13 For all time their children endure,
Unspotted fame for ever sure.
14 Their bodies are laid out to rest,
But their fame lives on with the best.
15 In the assembly what they've said
Is recalled and for all men spread
To their praise and honour instead.

Wise Ben Sirach has come to realize
That not all men who were created wise
Are known and recalled by fickle folk's
fame.

The greatest of the true may have a name
Now unknown to all who live and require
A book to lead them to sing in the mire.
Wise were the words that told the fatal
truth:

The greatest Psalms are lost on old and
youth.

The greatest deeds of virtue fail to find
A place in human word and human mind.
But all, both praised and the forgotten swell
Are kept close in the heart of divine spell,
Ready to live again and then to tell
The ways and means of Your leading in
kind.

16 Enoch walked with YHWH and was
gone,
Taken up so folk of his spawn
Might learn what he brings from earth's
dawn.

The first that Ben Sirach would praise of all
The prophets and the sages under pall
Of time is Enoch, who escaped the wall.
Enoch is my instructor in the way,
I touch his robe and turban every day
I come before Your throne, Beloved, to
sway.

The whirling of the sacrifice in round
Of three hundred and sixty four days'
sound

Comes to the end of the years and at last
Sees Enoch drawn up in the chariot fast
To wait for good Elijah on the sea
Of crystal without waves eternally,
Of winds perfumed in myrrh and
frankincense,
Of light and shadows covering my tents.

17 Noah was just and perfect and
Gave the race a new start to stand
After destruction of the land.
Because of his obedience
There were survivors in presence,
And so the flood came to an end
With a sign to him *not to bend*.

18 Eternal covenants were made
With him that all flesh on parade
Should never more be blotted out
By flood *come on the earth in rout*.

I follow in the covenant You made
With Noah, but delight not in parade
Of the excuses the Rabbis have stayed
To flatter humankind with verdicts played.
The law that Noah knows, knows also
when

The week returns on earth and sea again,
And what is clean and what unclean to eat,
It is not limited to Gentile street.

I take the Decalogue, Beloved, and yet
I add to it the ordinances set
By Noah's Flood and by the candle flame
That guided him to cantillate Your name.
When I have spent the statutes in all hues
Of rainbow, then I'll look for other clues.

19 Abraham was the father great
Of multitudes of nations late,
And no one has been found like him
In glory, 20 he kept the law grim
Of the Most High, was taken in
The covenant with Him, his win
Established the covenant in
His flesh, when he was tested he
Was found faithful, *faithful to be*.
21 That's why YHWH swore to him in
oath

That the nations would be blessed both
Though him and his posterity,
That he would multiply him like
The dust of the earth, and *on spike*
Exalt his children like the stars,
And make them all inherit *cars*
From sea to sea and from the stream
To every part of the earth's *dream*.

The covenant of Noah was expanded
To Abraham who was the first commanded
To offer sacrifice and not just wheel
In circumambulation at Your heel.
The circumcision was sent down in place
To Abraham to indicate the race
Of those who follow You in every trace.
The many nations that bless Abram's name
Appear before You with a valid claim,
Keeping the Decalogue, the covenant

Of Enoch and of Noah while they pant
In emulation of Abram in faith.
I do not follow shadow, no, nor wraith,
But see the clear command and stop my rant.

22 To Isaac too He gave the same
Promise for the sake of the fame
Of Abraham his father's *game*.

23 The blessing of all men He made
The covenant to rest and stayed
Upon the head of Jacob, He
Acknowledged him by blessings free,
And gave him his inheritance,
Determining his portions' *dance*,
Divided in twelve tribes *in glance*.

The law is now complete with Abraham:
Isaac receives the promises like lamb,
Obeys the ordinance and statute set
By You, Beloved, and greets all that he met.

But Isaac does not get new laws to keep:
His heritage is money and the deep
Soil where his flocks and words graze on
the heap.

Beloved, I take the God of Isaac and
The God of Jacob, and beneath that hand
I find Your guidance and Your promise grand,

The gleams before me of the better land.
The holy twelve before me come to whirl
About the dergah floor, and at their swirl
I join the forties in their secret band.

Sirach 45

1 From his descendants YHWH brought
out

A man of mercy, who was stout
Before all creatures, and beloved
By Alohim and man *ungloved*,
Moses, whose memory's blessed, *no doubt*.

2 He made him equal in his fame
To the saints, and made great his claim
To bring his foes to fear *and shame*.

3 By his words he caused signs to cease,
YHWH glorified him in release
Of kings. He gave him commands for
His people, and showed him the store
Of His glory. 4 He sanctified
Him through faithfulness *to abide*

And meekness, He chose him from all.
5 He made him hear His voice and call,
And led him into the thick dark,
And gave him the commandments stark
While face to face, the law of life
And knowledge, and to teach *from strife*
Jacob the covenant, and folk
Of Israel His judgments' stroke.

You sanctified, Beloved, Moses to run
His race as faithfully under the sun
As the stars in their traces and the moon
In its orbit from week to week and soon.
It's not by faith at all, but faithfulness
That Your servants and sons come out to
bless,

While those who refuse to do and confess
Your statutes are turned back to rack and
rune.

Beloved, Moses is tall before Your face,
But even he's a scholar under mace
Of Enoch, who eternally fulfils
The circumambulation of Your hills.
I cannot look upon the shining nose
Of Moses, but I follow where he goes.

6 He raised up Aaron, Moses' brother,
A holy man like him another
Of Levi's tribe. 7 He made a pact,
One everlasting, and made act
In the priesthood for all the folk.
He blessed him with fine garments' yoke,
And put on him a splendid cloak.

Ben Sirach might have stopped right here, I
guess,

In his description of Aaron's fine dress.
And yet I reckon there are many who
Prefer the latest fashions in both shoe
And hat and cloak, and they will stop to
read

With diligence the colours of the greed.
Quite frankly I don't care what Aaron
wore.

I even think the woollen garb in store
Pretentious. I myself wear what I find
Thrown out or in the flea market resigned.
It's not that I do not appreciate
Both the aesthetic and symbol of state,
But I simply do not have eyes for more
Than glory seeping out under Your door.

8 He clothed him with perfection too,
 And strengthened him with powers due,
 And linen breeches, the long robe,
 And the ephod. 9 And *like a globe*
 He circled him with pomegranates,
 With many golden bells in rates
 To tinkle as he walked, to make
 Their ringing heard in temple's stake
 As a reminder to the sons
 Of His people *before their guns*;
 10 With a holy garment, of gold
 And blue and purple, the work bold
 Of an embroiderer, and with
 The judgement oracle, no myth,
 The Urim and Thummim, 11 and with
 Twined scarlet, the work of craftsmen,
 With precious stones engraved again
 Like signets, in settings of gold,
 The work of jeweller, for reminder,
 In engraved letters, by the binder
 Of Israel's tribes, 12 with a gold crown
 Upon his turban, inscribed down
 Like a signet with "Holiness,"
 Distinction to be prized, *I guess*,
 The work of a master, delight
 For eyes, richly adorned *in sight*.

The jewellery that men and women now
 Put on the wrist, the ankle, neck or brow,
 Or even pierced beyond the ear in tongue
 Or tit or wit or anything that's hung,
 Is still thought to have properties as great
 As Urim and the Thummim to relate.
 Each crystal has its form and hardness and
 Its colour, but beyond that contraband,
 Its mystic powers of health and stealth and
 hand.

For every state of mind there is a stone,
 Not only for the future, but the bone
 Of hear and how, of hope's anxiety.
 All things are quick imbued with dignity
 Of the Creator that no man can see.

13 Before his time there never were
 Such beautiful things to occur.
 No stranger ever put them on,
 But only his sons and their spawn.
 14 His sacrifices shall be burnt
 Entirely twice each day as learnt.
 15 Moses ordained him, and anointed

Him with holy oil and appointed,
 It was eternal covenant
 For him and his offspring in cant
 All the days under heaven's slant,
 To minister to YHWH and serve
 As priest to bless his folk with verve
 And from His name never to swerve.
 16 He chose him out of all the living
 To deliver YHWH offerings, giving
 Incense and pleasant odours there
 As a remembrance in their share,
 To make the folk's atonement *bare*.

It's incense makes atonement and not blood
 Gushing from Roman crosses in a flood.
 If there is no atonement without shedding
 Of blood there is no other kind of wedding
 But that spelled with both frankincense and
 myrrh,

Remembrance as in intercession's stir.
 Eternal plot of Aaron and his sons
 Remains with Cohens still in tons and tons,
 Though few of them spread perfumes on
 the grate

And none come with blood sacrifice to
 wait.

The covenant is made with their fine
 clothes,

The willingness to obey on their toes,
 The hope that they remember father's gift,
 And live to repair every helpless rift.

17 In His commandments He revealed
 Authority for him and sealed
 Statutes and judgments, and to teach
 Jacob what testimonies *preach*,
 And to enlighten Israel
 With His law *as he had to tell*.

18 Outsiders conspired against him,
 There in the wilderness, *the grim*
 Dathan and Abiram and their
 Men and the band of Korah's share,
 In rage and anger. 19 The Lord saw
 And was not pleased, and in *the draw*
 Of His wrath they were destroyed a',
 He did wonders against their claw
 To burn them in the fiery caw.

20 He added glory to Aaron,
 Gave him a heritage in spawn,
 He divided to him the first
 Of the first fruits, He so rehearsed

Food of the first fruits in great store,
21 For they eat YHWH's offerings the
more

He gave him and his offspring's score.
22 But in the land of the folk he
Has no inheritance, and he
Has no portion among the folk,
For YHWH Himself became his stake.

Though not a priest nor even of the state
Of Cohen, I have heritage to mate.
I too am without family goods and land,
A pilgrim on a strange and wondered
strand.

I eat the offerings that come to my share,
Hardly a penny have I that I bear
From labour or from charity, yet I
Still eat bread under satin grey of sky.
My apples and my berries from the wild
Are not the first fruits of a garden mild,
Nor are they brought with faith or hope or
trust,
And yet they glimmer luscious by the dust.
Like priest I have no portion on the earth,
But You, Beloved, are everything of worth.

23 Phinehas Eleazar's son
Is the third in the glory won,
For he was zealous in YHWH's fear,
And stood fast, when the people near
Turned back, in the right goodness brought
Of his soul, and atonement sought
For Israel. 24 Therefore a pact
Of peace was set with him by act,
For him to be the temple chief,
And of his people for relief,
That he and his descendants meet
Should have the priesthood's dignity
For ever *and eternally*.

25 A covenant was also cut
With David, Jesse's son *to strut*,
Of the tribe of Judah: the lot
The king is from the son begot
Only to son, so heritage
Of Aaron is for his sons' wage.
26 May YHWH grant you wisdom in heart
To judge His people for their part
In righteousness, so that their lot
May not disappear, and their glory
May endure in eternal story.

Here's one occasion that atonement made
Came from the death of one or two who
stayed

As sacrificial offerings on parade.
A chief of Israel took a princess to
His tent to engage in the sacred cue
Of the fertility cult Canaan knew.
When Phinehas found them, he thrust a
spear
Through both those holy bodies without
fear,
And so they died in an atonement dear,
Like Jesus on the cross and Baal once laid
In Hades waiting for the accolade
To rise and start the fair for being paid.
The faith of human hearts is still the same,
Deceitful, sure of pagan fire and flame.

Sirach 46

1 Then Joshua the son of Nun
Was mighty in the wars he won,
And was Moses' successor in
His prophesying. He became,
As it would seem too by his name,
A great saviour of God's elect,
Avenging foes that would expect
To rise against them, so he could
Give Israel its heritage good.
2 How glorious he was when he
Lifted his hands and stretched out free
His sword against every city!
3 Who before him had stood so firm?
He waged YHWH's battles to their term.
4 Was not the sun stopped by his hand?
And did not one day come to stand
As long as two? 5 He called upon
The Most High, the Mighty One drawn,
When enemies pressed all around,
6 And the great Lord replied in sound
Of hailstones great in weight and pound.
He cast down battle on that nation,
And at Beth-horon's indication
He destroyed all resistance there,
So all nations might know his share
To fight before the eye of YHWH,
For he followed Almighty's view.

This Joshua seems to want to live his day
And night in light of the sun in its sway.
He need not have committed wonders then.
He could have acted like birds and not men.

The arctic tern, they say, also delights
 In living where there are no darkened
 nights,
 And flies from the north pole to seek the
 glare
 Of its eternal summer in the bare
 And southern attitudes' eternal ware.
 Beloved, I too turn toward You who must
 be
 My sunlight, and I fly in strategy
 Across a world of twists and burns to find
 My basking place beneath Your throne in
 kind.
 The arctic tern and I, we are not blind.

7 And in the days of Moses he
 Did a loyal deed, he and *wee*
 Caleb the son of Jephunneh:
 And they withstood the assembly,
 Restrained the people from their sin,
 And quelled their murmuring in din.
 8 And these two alone were preserved
 Out of six hundred thousand swerved
 People on foot, to bring them to
 Their heritage, a land of *new*
 Flowing milk and honey *as dew*.
 9 And YHWH gave Caleb strength that
 stayed
 With him to old age, he waylaid
 The foe in the hill country and
 Gained for his children lots of land.
 10 So all the sons of Israel saw
 That it is good to follow YHWH.

Jah indeed! My Beloved, I find the way
 That Joshua and Caleb saved the day
 An inspiration in my roundelay.
 It seems that I too hear a drummer's voice
 That is not known by others for their
 choice,
 Not by six hundred thousand strong I see
 March out against the market and the spree.
 Be my reward a sip of milk and honey
 And leave to others coin and paper money.
 Beloved, the whirling in the desert may
 Have been a punishment for those astray,
 But some like Joshua and Caleb run
 The gauntlet of the years and just for fun
 I join them in the light and dark for ray.

11 The judges also, with their names,

Those whose hearts did not fall in flames
 Of such idolatry and who
 Did not turn away from Lord YHWH,
 May their memory be blessed too!
 12 May their bones revive from the place
 Where they lie, and may the name's trace
 Of those who have been honoured live
 Again in their sons *come to give!*
 13 Samuel, beloved by his Lord,
 A prophet of YHWH, set restored
 The kingdom and anointed chiefs
 Over his people *for reliefs*,
 14 By the law of YHWH he judged all
 The congregation, and YHWH's *call*
 Watched over Jacob *on the wall*.
 15 By his faithfulness he was proved
 To be a prophet, and *as moved*
 By his words he was *widely* known
 As a trustworthy seer *grown*.
 16 He called upon YHWH, Mighty One,
 When his enemies pressed and won
 On every side, in sacrifice
 He gave a sucking lamb *and nice*.
 17 Then YHWH thundered from heaven,
 and made
 His voice heard with mighty parade,
 18 And he wiped out the leaders met
 Of the folk of Tyre and the set
 Rulers of the Philistines yet.
 19 Before time of eternal sleep,
 Samuel called men to witness deep
 Before YHWH and His Messiah:
 "I have not taken any draw
 Of property, not so much as
 A pair of shoes *as leather has*."
 And no man accused him of that.
 20 Even after he had gone flat
 To death he prophesied and showed
 To the king his death *and his road*,
 And lifted up his voice aloud
 From the earth in prophecy's shroud,
 To blot out all the wickedness
 Of the people *in their address*.

The ways of death are clear it seems to me
 In Ben Sirach's sight, as he chose to see.
 At first he finds man's immortality
 To lie in sons alone born in estate.
 And then he toots aloud the deathly rate
 As an eternal sleep beside the gate.
 So far so wood, and even leaf and flower:

The concept rates Semitic on the hour.
But then he spoils his own consistency
By trumpeting that Samuel on a spree
Spoke from his dreamless sleep in
 prophecy.

I know the text reports the shrouded form,
But is it not much to consider storm
Of spirit speech in evidence set free?

Sirach 47

1 After him Nathan rose to speak
Prophecy when David was sheik.
2 As the fat's chosen from peace offering,
So David was chosen from *proffering*
Sons of Israel. 3 He played his strength
With lions as with young goats *at length*,
And with bears as lambs of the flock.
4 In his youth he killed giant's stock
And took away the people's shame,
When he raised his hand *in the game*
With a stone in the sling and struck
Boasting Goliath in the muck.
5 For he appealed to YHWH, Most High,
And he gave him strength *at his cry*
In his right hand to slay a man
Mighty in war, to raise *the span*
Of his folk as far as he can.
6 They praised him for ten thousands slain,
And for the blessing of YHWH's reign,
When shining sceptre came to him.
7 For he wiped out enemies *grim*
On every side annihilating
His foes the Philistines berating,
He crushed their power even to this day.
8 In all he did he gave thanks sway
To the Holy One, the Most High,
With exaltations he sang praise
With all his heart, he loved to raise
His Maker *always to the sky.*
9 He set singers in altar's way
To sing sweetly there every day.
10 He beautified the feasts and set
Their times throughout the year, and met
God's holy name with praise so that
The temple sounded from the bat
Of rising of sun till it set.
11 The Lord took away all his sins,
Exalted his power in its dins
For ever, He gave him the pact
Of kings and Israel's throne to act.

The secret is let out by one word slipped:
It was David who set the feasts and shipped
The yearly round throughout the land to tell
The times of gatherings of Israel.
It was a later hand that edited
The books of Moses and raised up the bid
Of Jubilees and finally pretended
That all was ancient revelation hid.
Beloved, political expedience
Gave him the right. He saw in Israel's tents
The keeping of sacral fertility,
The times and crimes of gross idolatry,
And so he called them all to keep the feasts
Under his eye and led by godly priests.

12 After him rose up a wise son
Who'd succeeded for what he'd done,
13 Solomon reigned in days of peace,
And Alohim gave him release
On every hand, so he might build
A temple for His name and filled
With holiness to stay instilled.
14 How wise you were from your youth
 on!
You overflowed a river drawn
With understanding from your dawn.
15 Your soul covered the earth, and you
Filled it with parables and true.
16 Your fame spread to countries far-off,
You were loved for your peace in trough.
17 For your songs, proverbs, parables,
For your interpretations' *pulls*,
All marvelled *and forgot to scoff.*
18 In the name of YHWH Alohim,
Who is called Israel's Alohim,
You gathered gold like tin and seam
Of silver like lead piled *to beam.*

So peace was given for a single slot
In all of Israel's days and years in plot,
Not for the comfort of the old and sot,
The young at breast, the weaker women
 taught,
But rather that Solomon might succeed
In building up a monument to greed.
Beloved, I cry You down. I see the ways
That humankind builds and builds up for
 praise,
And reckon that the common hut of old,
The cave and brush fire so one shan't be
 cold

Are far superior to all things built,
To pyramids and temples that must wilt
Before eternity. The greater house
Is inner chamber where there is no mouse.

19 But you were struck with womankind,
And put your body in a bind.
20 You stained your honour and defiled
Your spawn and so brought anger wild
On your own children and brought grief
For your last folly *in belief*,
21 So that the sovereignty was rent
In twain and out of Ephraim's tent
Arose a reign in evil bent.
22 But YHWH never relinquishes
His mercy, nor lets some of his
Works perish, He will not blot out
Descendants of His chosen clout,
Destroying the posterity
Of him who loved him, and so he
Gave a remnant to Jacob, and
To David a root from his stand.
23 Solomon slept with his dads, and
Left one of his sons in his stead,
Full of folly and without bread
Of understanding, *and whose name*
Was Rehoboam, who for shame
Caused the folk to revolt *in blame*.
Also Jeroboam the son
Of Nebat, caused Israel when done
To sin and gave to Ephraim
A sinful way. 24 Their sins became
Exceeding many, till their claim
Was removed from the land. 25 For they
Went after every sort of way
Of wickedness and had to pay.

You erred, Beloved, in thinking dynasty.
That's very human, but Your Majesty
Is not a man to err, nor son of man
To lie and spoil whatever lies in scan.
You did a better job with Saul and sons:
You kept the father but released the buns
Of all his offspring. David with his guns
Was a good choice, but decadence arises
As soon as generations change their prizes.
The fatal promise made to David in
A moment of Your weakness does for sin
Perpetuation in the human din.
Out with all human governments and show

Your law and hand alone and don't be
slow.

Sirach 48

1 The prophet Elijah like fire
Rose and his word burned like torch dire.
2 He brought a famine upon them,
And by his zeal he made them few
In number. 3 By the word of YHWH
He shut out the heavens from them,
And also three times brought down fire.
4 How glorious you were, O Elijah,
In your wonderful deeds to hide you!
And who can boast for right like you?
5 You raised a corpse up from death and
From Hades, by the word to stand
By the Most High, 6 who brought down
kings
To their destruction, and *the stings*
Of famous men up from their beds,
7 Who heard rebuke at Sinai and
Judgments of vengeance at the sand
Of Horeb, 8 who anointed kings
To inflict retribution, and
Prophets to succeed you at hand.
9 You were raised in whirlwinds of fire,
In fiery horses' chariot squire,
10 You now expect appointed time,
As it is written, to calm clime
Of Alohim's wrath before it
Breaks out in fury where they sit
To turn the father's heart to son,
Restore the tribes that Jacob won.
Blessed are those who saw you and those
Who've been adorned with your love's
rows,
For we also shall live when done.

Like fire, indeed, Your prophet came to be,
And yet he was a master of the sea,
The earth and whirlwind, all the matters
three.
He called down rain, he stopped the skies
above,
He piled the earth with things to hate and
love;
He parted Jordan River with a cloak
And showed his rulership of waters' yoke:
Like fire, indeed, Your prophet's sophistry.
Beloved, I know that good Elijah wakes
Still in his occultation for men's sakes,

And rides the canopy of clouds to find
Fair Enoch reigning still above the mind,
And Jesus caught up in the light to bring
The Guided One upon the earth to sing.

12 Elijah by whirlwinds was hidden,
Elisha filled his spirit bidden,
In all his days he did not shake
In front of any ruler's stake,
And no one brought him down to stay.
13 Nothing was too hard for his sway,
And when he was dead *in the way*
His body prophesied *one day*.
14 As in his life his wonders rose,
So in death his deeds were of those
To marvel at. 15 But after all
This the people did not hear call
To repent, they did not forsake
Their sins, till they went in the wake
Of captives from their land and then
Scattered on all the earth in den.
The folk were left but few beneath
The house of David in sad wreath.
16 Some of them obeyed Alohim,
But others increased sin in stream.

Anyone with a bit of time and thought
Caught in the round of human doings
wrought
Would know not to expect that wonders
told
Every prevented sinners being bold.
So what if the dead bones of prophets made
The dead come back to life and on parade!
Such marvels are not calculated best
To raise morality in east or west.
Beloved, if You think miracles will bind
Our hearts to You, You are a God that's
blind.
It is a mystery why men will do
Your will while others here fail to be true.
It is a mystery why some go down
To the grave without faith before the town.

17 Hezekiah strengthened his city,
And brought water in for its pity,
He tunnelled the sheer rock with tools
Of iron and built for water pools.
18 In his days Sennacherib came
And sent Rabshakeh in his claim.
He lifted up his hand to fall

On Zion and made a great ball
Of boasting in his arrogance.
19 Then their hearts were shaken in stance
And their hands trembled, and they stood
In anguish, like women in brood.
20 But then they came to call on YHWH
The merciful *as well as true*,
Stretching out their hands in His view,
And the Holy One quickly heard
Them from the sky and He was stirred
To save them by Isaiah's hand.
21 The Lord struck the camp of the band
Of the Assyrians and He sent
His angel to destroy their tent.
22 Hezekiah did what YHWH wanted,
Held to the ways of David vaunted,
His ancestor, and what Isaiah
The prophet commanded to try you,
One great and faithful in his view.
23 In his days the sun started back
And went the wrong way on its track,
He lengthened the life of the king.
24 By the spirit of might on wing
He saw the last things, came to bring
Comfort to those who mourned in Zion.
25 Revealing what should come to try on
At end of time, he showed the things
Hidden before their occurings.

Prediction is not what makes me doubt
here:
It's rather these two miracles I fear.
I can believe by stretching in a faint
That dead bones raised to life a fresh
corpse quaint,
But that the sun returned upon its track
Is something my worldview counts up as
slack.
I've heard so many tales of saints and bards
That I am sceptical of all men's cards.
Beloved, work miracles or not, I go
My way each day to find Your law in glow.
It needs no grand embellishment to show
The humble, simple pathway that is right,
The way to peace and love, respect and
right.
I need no miracles beyond the night.

Sirach 49

1 The memory of Josiah's like
A blending of incense to strike

By art of the perfumer's hand,
 It is sweet as honey and grand
 To every mouth, and like a song
 At a banquet to do no wrong.
 2 He was led right in what he did
 To change the people from their bid
 Of idols and iniquity.
 3 He set his heart upon YHWH's fee,
 In the days of wicked men he
 Strengthened godliness faithfully.
 4 Except David and Hezekiah
 They all were sinners but Josiah,
 For they forsook the Most High's law,
 Came to an end, kings of Judah,
 5 For they gave their power to strange
 kings,
 Their glory into foreign wings,
 6 Who set fire to the chosen town
 Of the temple set in renown,
 And made her streets a desolation,
 By Jeremiah's word and station.
 7 For they'd afflicted him, yet he
 Had been ordained in the womb free
 As prophet, to bring out, strike down
 And destroy everything in town,
 As well as build and plant a *crown*.

Ben Sirach limits the good kings to three,
 While the book of Kings in loving mercy
 Finds twelve in number, perhaps just to see
 The right amount as all things here should
 be.

I doubt not all kings are a fatal stab
 At Your law and for the folk a mere scab.
 The miracle is that three can be found
 Who were good men as well as kings as
 sound.

Beloved, three is a number to raise doubt
 Even if twelve seems many at the spout.
 Those who find You are three instead of
 one

Are to be doubted, yea, even to shun.
 I trust Your word alone, and still I take
 Three men and twelve together for Your
 sake.

8 Ezekiel saw the splendid vision
 Which Alohim showed in precision
 To him above the chariot stayed
 With cherubim all in parade.
 9 For Alohim remembered all

His enemies with storm *and call*,
 And did good to those who directed
 Their ways aright *and not confected*.
 10 May the bones of twelve prophets live
 Where they lie, for they comfort give
 The people of Jacob and save
 With hope from there beyond the grave.

If there are not twelve good kings, at least
 there

Are twelve good prophets linked up with
 the fair.

Their names are bright, their words are
 brighter still.

I cantillate them off-key with voice shrill.
 If there are not twelve good men on the
 throne,

At least there are twelve prophets with a
 bone

Of life beyond the silence of their death,
 A song, a message and refreshing breath.
 Beloved, may the bones of twelve prophets
 live

Within my heart and on my tongue like
 sieve,

And may their melodies grow brighter as
 I cantillate their faith instead of jazz.

And when their resurrection comes to me
 I'll keep that Sabbath of eternity.

11 How shall we praise Zerubbabel?
 He was like a signet in spell
 On the right hand, 12 and so *for stack*
 Jeshua the son of Jozadak,
 In their days they built the house and
 Raised a temple holy *and grand*
 To YHWH, prepared for glory's *stand*.

13 The memory of Nehemiah
 Also is lasting *not to try her*,
 He raised for us the fallen walls,
 And set up gates and bars *and stalls*,
 Rebuilt our ruined houses' *halls*.

14 No one like Enoch has been made
 On earth, for he was drawn *and stayed*
 Up from the earth. 15 And no man like
 Joseph has been born, and his *spike*
Of bones are cared for. 16 Shem and Seth
 Were honoured among men *for breath*,
 And Adam above every one
 Living in the creation done.

Good Nehemiah never built a house
 For me or grouse of nibbling of a mouse
 Within my territories. Yet I take
 His word for Yours except any mistake.
 Bright Enoch never wrote upon the dawn
 A message for my eyes to look upon,
 But still he lives and sometimes in the dark
 I hear his cantillations from the park.
 If Shem and Seth are honoured, I'd be bold
 To wonder about Shem out in the cold,
 Who lived to see Abraham's honour told.
 I doubt the one, I take the other's straw
 To call upon Your name in fear and awe,
 While guided in my action by Your law.

Sirach 50

1 The leader of his brothers and
 The pride of his people and band
 Was Simon the high priest and son
 Of Onias, who in the run
 Of his life repaired the house, and
 In his time strengthened temple's stand.
 2 He laid foundations for the high
 Double walls, retaining walls high
 To the temple and temenos.
 3 In his days a cistern across
 For water was carved out, a tank
 Like a pool and from bank to bank.
 4 He pondered how to save his folk
 From spoil, and strengthened the town's
 yoke
 To withstand siege *and every stroke*.
 5 How glorious he was when the folk
 Gathered around him as he came
 Out from the inner temple's flame!
 6 Like morning star among the clouds,
 Like moon when it's full *under shrouds*,
 7 Like the sun shining on the house
 Of the Most High, and like the dowse
 Of rainbow gleaming in clouds' glory,
 8 Like roses in the days of story
 When the first fruits come, like the lily
 By spring of water no more chilly,
 Like a green shoot on Lebanon
 Upon a summer day *at dawn*,
 9 Like fire and incense in the censer,
 Like a vessel hammered and tenser
 With gold adorned in precious stones,
 Of every kind, 10 like olive tones
 Where trees bear fruit, like cypress trees
 Shooting up to the clouds *and breeze*,

11 When he put on his glorious robe
 And clothed himself like to the globe
 Of perfection and went up to
 The holy altar, he made view
 Of the court of the temple bright.
 12 And when he received portions right
 From the hands of the priests, he stood
 By the hearth of the altar good
 With a ring of brothers around,
 He was like a young cedar crowned
 On Lebanon, where they surround
 Like the trunks of the palm trees found.
 13 All sons of Aaron in their weight
 Of dignity stood round in state
 Like poplars, with offerings to YHWH
 In their hands, and in presence too
 Of the crowd of all Israel's crew.

Sirach loves the fair priesthood, it is true,
 And while there are none now for derring-
 do,

I reckon such is not amiss, when he
 Is Torah-true and lives life faithfully.
 So Simon is a hero, there's no doubt
 That many loved the man supported stout,
 Though at that time the Hellenizing horde
 Was also to be reckoned with and scored.
 Beloved, though I have no priest in my
 way,

No church or synagogue to light my day,
 Nor even mosque where I may go to pray,
 I still praise every leader of the flock,
 The Christian, Jewish, Samaritan rock,
 As well as Shi'ite and Sunnite to balk.

14 Once he finished the services
 At the altar with all of his
 Arranging of the sacrifice
 For the Most High *with all things nice*,
 15 And stretched out his hand for the cup
 To offer the blood of grape up,
 And poured it at the altar foot,
 A sweet scent to Most High God put,
 16 The sons of Aaron sounded blast,
 The priests on their trumpets all cast
 Of beaten metal: a great sound
 Remembrance before Most High's ground.

The service of remembrance sometimes
 comes
 In grape juice scattered by the altar's sums,

Sometimes in sacrificial goat and lamb
 In memory of the prophet Abraham.
 Sometimes the service of remembrance
 takes
 The form of incense burning in its cakes,
 And sometimes in the blast of trumpet
 sound
 That shakes and trembles everything
 around.
 But when I come to mind Your name and
 fill
 My heart with cantillation at the sill
 Of mercy, my remembrance is of none
 Of these sweet evidences of my run.
 I come, Beloved, with just the gentle word,
 In quietness recited with heart stirred.

17 Then all the people with one stroke
 Quickly fell prostrate at the yoke
 Adoring before the Most High,
 Before Israel's Holy One nigh.
 18 The hymns would echo and re-echo,
 Over the crowd *like mouse and gecko*
 Cantillations of praise came by.
 19 All the folk of the land would shout
 For joy, and praying all about
 To the Merciful One *and stout*,
 As the high priest would finish all
 The services at altar's stall
 By offering the sacrifice due
 To Alohim *the only true*.
 20 When he came down, he raised his
 hands
 Over all of Israel in bands.
 The blessing of YHWH on his lips,
 The name of YHWH in glory *dips*.
 21 Again the folk prostrated got
 From him the Most High's blessing *sought*.

Prayer in prostration is a thing that's rare
 Except among the Muslim kind of fare.
 And yet it is the best the temple there
 Had to offer the worshipper on stair.
 Prayer in prostration is not kept today
 By Christian or Jew in the common way,
 Though Orthodoxy has a simple ray
 And there are times a Jew falls under sway
 Of earth prostration on a holiday.
 Beloved, I too prostrate toward the town
 Of Mecca and Jerusalem for crown,

And call upon Your name with love and
 faith,
 Confessing what I ought, praising like waif
 Your name, Your house, Your law, Your
 sacred stay.

22 And now, bless Alohim of all
 Who does wonders upon the *ball*
Of earth, who fosters men's growth from
 Their mother's womb, and out they come
 According to His will *in sum*!
 23 May He grant you both joy in heart
 And peace abiding in your part.
 24 May His goodness toward us endure
 In Israel as long as is sure
 The sky above. 25 But my whole soul
 Loathes two nations, a third in toll
 That is no people *but a role*:
 26 Those who live in Philistia,
 And those in Seir, and in the claw
 Degenerate of Shechem's law.
 27 Wise words and proverbs I have wrote
 In this book, I Jesus the goat
 Of Eleazar Sirach's son
 As they poured from my heart and won.
 28 Blessed is the man who meditates
 Upon these things, in wisdom's gates
 The man who takes them all to heart.
 29 If he puts them in doing's part,
 He can cope with any strange art,
 For YHWH's fear will be his lamp's start.

Shame on the foul expression of the sin
 Of racist contemplation in the din
 Of right praise and right honour on the tin!
 Despite the politics of word and speech
 I doubt that any man has call to preach.
 I too look down with scorn and wrath upon
 The colonists infesting New York's dawn.
 If You bless Israel as long as sky
 Remains, I think my Indian forebears by
 Another word were remiss when they said
 As long as grass shall grow where rivers
 sped.
 Both are polluted now, both grass and
 stream,
 So the imposter's free of treaty's gleam.
 Only the brazen sky remains instead.

Sirach 51

I'll give thanks to You, O Lord King,

And praise You as Alohim, sing
 To You my Saviour. I give thanks
 To Your name, 2 for You have the ranks
 Of my protector, helper and
 Have saved my body from the band
 Of my destruction and from snares
 Of tongues in slanders unawares,
 From lips that utter lies *untrue*.
 In sight of those who stood by, You
 Became my helper, 3 and saved me,
 In the greatness of Your mercy
 And of Your name, from the gnashings
 Of teeth about to crop my wings,
 From hands of those who sought my life,
 From the many afflictions' strife
 That I endured, 4 from choking fire
 On every side and from the fire
 Which I did not kindle, 5 from mire
 Of the depths of Sheol, and from
 An unclean tongue and lying strum,
 6 The slander of unrighteous tongue
 To the king. My soul drew near *sung*
 Death, and my life was very near
 To Hades beneath *me and sheer*.
 7 They came around on every side,
 And there was no help there to hide,
 I looked for aid of men, and found
 There was none anywhere around.

Ah, my Beloved, the men who most
 proclaim
 That they are here to give help in the game
 Are those who strike most fervently the
 back
 With dagger of deceit, they have no slack.
 There is no help in man, nor woman yet,
 There is no help in human hand. I fret
 No more abandonment, since I rely
 On You alone beneath a silver sky.
 Beloved, know that I sing no other song,
 I breathe no other word as all along
 The rocky edges of the lake I take
 My way toward the end of journey's wake.
 Beloved, know that I cantillate Your name
 Where there is no other for grace or fame.

8 Then I remembered Your mercy,
 O YHWH, and Your work of degree
 Of ancient times, and that You save
 Those who wait for You from the grave,
 Hand of their enemies. 9 And I

Sent up my supplication high,
 Up from the earth, and prayed that I
 Might be saved from death *come to spy*.
 10 I called to YHWH, the counsellor
 Of my ancestors to implore
 Him not to forsake me the day
 Of my affliction without stay
 Of any help against the proud.
 11 I'll praise Your name always aloud,
 I'll sing praise with thanksgiving's *shroud*.
 My prayer was heard, 12 for You did save
 Me from destruction of the grave
 And rescued me from evil plight.
 Therefore I'll give thanks to You right
 And praise you, and I'll bless the name
 Of YHWH. 13 While I was in the game
 Of youth, before I went abroad,
 I sought wisdom in prayer to God.
 14 Before the temple I asked for
 Her, and I'll search for her the more
 To the last. 15 From blossom to time
 Of ripening grape my heart *in rhyme*
 Delighted in her, my foot went
 Upon the straight path, and not bent
 From my youth I followed her step.
 16 I lent my ear a bit, with pep
 Receiving her, and so I found
 Instruction much and all around.

Too quickly I thought that You had not led
 Hot footsteps in my ways of death unsped.
 Out of my universe of times and ways,
 Maybe there are some in a deathly maze
 Across which I have travelled with intent,
 Somehow not knowing that Your shield
 was meant.
 Many times there may be the sword fell
 true,
 Came close to where I had stood in my
 pew,
 Eagle-eyed, while I was blind to the cast.
 Lasting here in this world set at half-mast
 When death leers at my unseen, unkempt
 past,
 Among the tangled webs of snares and
 gruff,
 I doubt at last that I have thanked enough.
 Now let me thank for shield from unseen
 tough.

17 I made progress in her, to Him

Who gives wisdom I will *with vim*
 Give glory. 18 For I have resolved
 To live according to the solved
 Wisdom, and I was zealous for
 The good, and I shall never more
 Be put to shame. 19 My soul grasped tight
 Wisdom, my conduct I kept right,
 I stretched my hands to heaven above,
 Sorrowed by ignorance to love
 Her, 20 but through purifying's glove
 My soul directed found her stand.
 I gained understanding with her
 From the first, therefore I concur
 I'm not forsaken by her hand.
 21 My heart was stirred to seek her, so
 I've gained a good possession's show.
 22 YHWH gave me a tongue as reward,
 And I will praise Him with it scored.

Like the grandson of Sirach, I have from
 My earliest days come to count the sum
 Of wisdom from the temple and the gate,
 The teacher and the preacher of my fate.
 Like son of Sirach, I have gathered store
 Of wisdom more than I know how to pour
 Out in the acts of grateful sense I should.
 Like Sirach I'm just a grabe in the wood.
 Beloved, the tongue that You reward me
 with
 Is greater than I thought by light of myth,
 And still it turns from day to day with more
 Than I had meant to put before the door.
 I praise You for the ways and stays You
 set,
 I praise You for the rhymes I'm here to get.

23 Draw near to me, you the untaught,
 And lodge in my school and my plot.
 24 Why do you say you're lacking in
 These things, why do your souls in din
 Cry out for thirst? 25 I opened my
 Mouth and said, "Get these things or try
 For yourselves without money's lie.
 26 Put your neck under yoke, and let
 Your souls receive instruction met,
 It is found close by *at the set*.
 27 See with your eyes that I have worked
 But little and though labour shirked
 I've found myself much rest *to get*.
 28 Get instruction with silver sum,
 And you will have much gold to come.

29 May your soul rejoice in mercy
 From Him, and may you never see
 Shame when you praise Him faithfully.
 30 Do your work by appointed time,
 And in Allah's fame He will climb
 To give you your reward freely.

Like Sirach's family I call all to me
 To learn the good and true, the wise and
 free.
 They need not pay with silver, no, nor gold,
 They need only come here out of the cold
 And for a moment hear the price of bold
 Good news, that wisdom is a tale that's told
 In just three minutes of the speaker's ware.
 The Decalogue contains all of the share
 Of wisdom that can be found anywhere.
 Let everyone who reads or hears receive
 That gift at my hand, nothing's to believe.
 It's proven in the pudding, there's no stand
 To wave and hope and ponder on the grand.
 With that I turn away and take my leave.